

微风  
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薄雾

MIST

# Information

**Table of Contents URL:** <https://www.lightnovelworld.co/novel/mist-05122221>

## Mist (Web Novel CN)

**Bowu (薄雾 [无限] )**

Author: [Wei Feng Ji Xu](#)  
**RANK 524**

**4.8**

**108**

Chapters

**610K**

Views

**1.88K**

Bookmarked

**Completed**

Status

## Categories

- [Action](#)
- [Adult](#)
- [Mature](#)
- [Mystery](#)
- [Sci-fi](#)
- [Yaoi](#)

Mist (Web Novel CN) novel is a popular light novel covering Action, Adult, and Mature genres. Written by the Author Wei Feng Ji Xu. 108 chapters have been translated and translation of all chapters was completed.

## Summary

Hyperthymesia. Those with this condition can remember every detail of their lives from something as significant as the world's turning point to something as small and as insignificant as a minor fleeting thought. They cannot forget and their thirst for knowledge allows them to be considered genius in some senses.

Legend has it that Ji Yushi was this kind of genius.

In addition, it was said that he was gay and very beautiful.

As soon as the news that he was going to support Tianqiong's seventh squad broke out, it sent everyone buzzing.

Everyone knew that the captain of the seventh squad, Song Qinglan, was a hoodlum and deeply homophobic.

He not only relied on his super-powerful abilities to become the dark horse on the battlefield in less than two years, but he also hates it when those at the top forces a flower vase\* into his squad.

Sure enough, Song Qinglan announced in front of everyone, "Useful? Us brothers are going out there working ourselves to the bone, we don't need a little genius who can only speedread quantum waves!"

Later.

The squad was forced into a dire situation during their mission.

That beautiful little genius calmly continued, every gunfire hitting the mark, his fighting power peaking.

Song Qinglan begged in front of everyone, "Adviser Ji, stay."

In the end, he added, "I'll work myself to the bone for you."

\*\*\*\*\*

Ji Yushi had a secret.

He would often be awake at night, suffering from memory overload and recurring nightmares.

There was only one thing that could let him fall asleep peacefully.

And that was Song Qinglan.

\*Flower vase: Someone who only looks pretty but can't amount to much

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## Tags

- Arrogant Characters
- Calm Protagonist
- Cannibalism
- Clever Protagonist
- Co-Workers
- Cold Protagonist
- Death
- Death of Loved Ones
- Devoted Love Interests
- Discrimination
- Eidetic Memory
- Futuristic Setting
- Gore
- Handsome Male Lead
- Love Interest Falls in Love First
- Multiple Timelines
- Mutated Creatures
- Near-Death Experience
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- Protagonist Strong from the Start
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- 5  
MiroKurai  
Reader  
7d

Let me commemorate this day as the day I started this novel from Turning. Wish me luck 🍀

Reply

1  0

◦ 1  
Yuderlover  
[MiroKurai](#)  
Reader  
6d

me too <33

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1  0

- 60  
Sumer  
Reader  
2mo

Starting  $\mathbb{C}(\text{oó}\text{~})\mathfrak{D}$

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4  0

- 1  
MNG023AT  
Reader  
5mo

The synopsis is mad funny lmfaoo. "He's also gay and beautiful"  
Lmaoo Not my thing tho.

[Reply](#)

10  0

◦ 1  
AreYuFrBruh

MNG023AT

Reader

2mo

Was gonna say the same lmao

[Reply](#)

6  0

- 1

AoMay

Reader

5mo

IT WAS SO GOOD. The plot, the ending, the translation, the characters, and the theory (I feel you, Li Chun). Everything is so... So rare for me to find this gem. The main characters really are IMPERFECT PERFECT COUPLE. The supporting characters MADE MY DAY. The plot is INTERESTING AND CONFUSING. The ending... WHY DID I READ SO FAST. Anyway, I think it's a good story for us (fujo/fudan) to read.

[Reply](#)

8  0

- 1

maryclau

Reader

7mo

Definitely one of the best novels I read, without holes in the plot, although it seems confusing at times and you have to reread certain parts, I completely recommend it, advice you just have to read paying attention or you won't understand anything.

[Reply](#)



6  0

- 3  
SamySamy  
Reader  
8mo

Not a fan of bl sadly.

[Reply](#)

8  1

- 1  
Lookool  
[SamySamy](#)  
Reader  
1mo

It's okayy

[Reply](#)

0  0

- 3  
Killianna  
Reader  
9mo

Okay hear me out, the 1st part will be a bit slow and confusing but as it play out and all the pieces start falling into place you will be amazed by the past events, the characters are so loveable too.

[Reply](#)

3  0

- 1  
Mysteriousincognito  
Reader

10mo

Confusing, but I recommend

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6  0

- 23

heedkneesnshoulders

Reader

10mo

Third line caught me off guard.

[Reply](#)

11  0

- 11

Fiction\_is\_life

Reader

11mo

For a short novel of 100 chapter this novel is really good. In the starting time theory was confusing but the way they did there mission... in short this novel is really good.

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3  0

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# Chapter 1: Chapter 1

Welcome to my new novel! This one is rather plot heavy and complicated so feel free to give it a pass if that's not what you're looking for ^^

Now, this novel is set in a futuristic/sci-fi world and it involves time travel. The mystery is thick at the beginning and everything may seem super confusing but it will all be cleared up later! (Just depends on how good your patience is haha) One of my reasons for translating this was because I was confused in some parts and I'm hoping that I can understand it better if I translated it.

Please don't expect your questions to be answered immediately because that's not really how a mystery novel works..... 😞

I *highly recommend* not reading any of the spoilers because that just ruins the whole experience of this novel >< (Even the author emphasised this so please take heed!!!)

This is a more complicated novel to translate so the update schedule will be weekly on Mondays (or sporadic if I struggle 😅)

Happy reading!!

## Beginning

### Chapter 1

December 1396, Star Era. First snow.

A green-skinned train shuttled through mountains and valleys, like a dragon crossing through the vast land.

Snow fluttered and danced outside the window as the remote town in the distance gradually came into view. Inside the carriage, a not-so-sweet sounding female voice announced: “Dear passengers, we have arrived at Huadong County. Passengers who need to get off at this stop, please remember to take along your belongings. Please do not push or shove and kindly disembark one at a time.”

As the speed of the train dropped, the young man in the corner who was immersed in his black and white gaming console finally raised his head.

During the time it took for the train to travel from the previous stop to Huadong County, this young man’s Tetris score had climbed from zero to more than 400,000 points. The extremely fast falling speed of the blocks and his skilful manoeuvres made this well-known casual game seem like it would never end.

Hearing the announcement from the speaker, the young man briefly glanced out the window. When he looked down again, the words ‘GAME OVER’ had already appeared on the game interface.

“Ah!” The passenger next to him who had been secretly watching him play cried out reflexively, “What a pity.”

Despite the game abruptly stopping at this score, the young man didn’t appear the slightest bit disappointed. He just casually turned the console off and stored it inside his backpack.

The passenger next to him couldn’t help but ask, “Young man, what’s your highest score? You might even be able to break a record like this.”

The young man’s appearance was ordinary, but his eyes were bright and very clear, “Similar to just now.”

The passenger felt that it was a pity, “If you didn’t stop just now, it probably would be much more than that!”

The young man wasn’t the talkative type. He stood up and got ready to get off the train, “No time.”

The young man stepped out from his seat and followed the crowd of people over to the door with his backpack.

The passengers in this carriage came from all over the world. With conversations in all kinds of accents, it was quite noisy. He walked past the quietest seats in the carriage on his way out. The people sitting there were uniform wearing intellectuals who had got on at the previous stop, Huanan County. At this moment, they were gathered together, quietly discussing the papers on the table. A middle-aged man with a round face had his brows tightly knitted. It was clear that he was the leader.

As if sensing the young man's gaze, the leader raised his head vigilantly, but that young man had already disembarked from the train.

The young man wore a black cotton jacket and was carrying a very ordinary backpack. His tall figure was very conspicuous.

But when he got onto the platform, he smoothly disappeared into the crowd without anyone sensing his presence.

If someone on the train thought of this young man again, they would find that they couldn't even remember what he looked like.

\*

Year 1456, Star Era.

[1456.5.13 14:36:40]

When the system projected this time coordinate, everyone's spirits lifted, "He's back! Prepare to establish contact!"

Three seconds later, the capsule carrying Ji Yushi who wore a black cotton outfit from the 90's appeared on the transmission platform.

The robotic arm detected the traverser and it immediately greeted him with a bag of nutrient solution. After crossing through time and space, the human body loses a lot of water and various nutrients also urgently need to be supplemented.

Ji Yushi pressed the safety switch, threw away his backpack and took a few sips of the nutrient solution.

The ordinary face that had no memorable features slowly began to disintegrate, revealing his original face which looked a little pale.

[Congratulations, you have completed a total of 89 B-level missions.  
Current rating: Two stars.]

Ji Yushi glanced at the notice on the transparent panel and emotionlessly walked out of the capsule.

He didn't normally talk much and just directly began to narrate in a calm voice: "Prepare the mission log. Yan Que incident in 1396. The target got onto the train at Huanan County on December 13<sup>th</sup> of that year, passing through Huadong County. Train number X168, number of companions, 4. They are the main people involved in the case and it is quite different from historical records. It is recommended that the records are corrected."

The team members carefully recorded it down.

Not caring that he hadn't had the chance to catch a breath since completing his mission, one of the team members spoke up, "Teacher Ji, Chief Lin is waiting for you outside again."

Ji Yushi held his head. This matter was more troublesome than crossing through time and space, "Here again?"

The team member could neither cry nor laugh, "Knowing that you would be back around this time, he has been waiting for almost half an hour."

When Ji Yushi finished changing in the locker room, the head of the Ning City branch had actually lowered himself and was waiting for him outside.

"Xiao Ji!" Chief Lin came over and patted his shoulder with a big smile on his face, "Congratulations! Another mission completed and another step closer to your goal!"

Ji Yushi politely replied, “Thank you Chief Lin.”

Chief Lin went straight to the main topic, “Young man, you have a promising future! How about it? Have you considered the matter of going to Jiang City as support?”

Ji Yushi: “I told you last time I won’t go.”

Chief Lin’s smile didn’t change, “Hey, why are young people like you so narrowminded? You should know that rumours are rumours. After being passed around a few times, the contents of it change. You don’t have to delay your future prospects just because of a rumour.”

Ji Yushi answered calmly, “No one to help feed the cats.”

Modern people’s addiction to cats hadn’t changed despite hundreds of years passing by. Ji Yushi was a single man, but he was already raising three cats at home.

Everyone in the team were quietly listening from behind the door. They felt that Teacher Ji had a very good reason. Good rejection! Reject him!

They couldn’t be blamed for being so rude. It was because the people from the Jiang City branch were huge bullies!

They were similarly departments under the Tianqiong’s Time Management System, but the matters managed by Jiang City and Ning City were different.

Jiang City had always been responsible for combating various crimes and disasters and are known as ‘Guardians’. They can use extreme combat methods when necessary even if it was just to stifle the evil before it sprouts.

Ning City on the other hand was responsible for recording and restoring historical events both large and small and are known as ‘Recorders’.

This meant that they only record history, never intervening, so they didn’t even need to have a gun.

A week ago, a Guardian of a certain squad in Jiang City who was in charge of the ‘scouting’ task suffered some serious injuries. It just happened that the squad received a new mission soon afterwards, so they are missing a crucial member.

The Tianqiong’s management system had always been rather poor. The other squads were not able to immediately allocate support for the squad and it was almost impossible finding someone who could temporarily take over this important task. In the end, someone at the top racked their brains and remembered that there was someone in the Ning City branch who could be transferred over and a transfer order was subsequently sent.

Ji Yushi was rather famous in Tianqiong and his name was associated with many rumours.

Legend has it that he has excellent memory and is a nerd who is constantly thirsty for knowledge. Even during this age, the four walls of his house are filled with paper and books to the point where there was nowhere to stand.

Legend has it that he has a delicate appearance and is also similarly very weak. Despite being a man, he cannot even unscrew a bottle cap.

Legend has it that he is very timid and doesn’t dare spend the night alone in the department. He even receives special treatment for this and is the only one in the entire Ning City branch who has never been on night duty.

.....

And all kinds of things like that.

And so, the captain of the squad in the Jiang City branch that required support wasn’t happy about it. He publicly refused, “What the hell? Can the people at the top send us a man who can fight? Us brothers are going out there working ourselves to the bone, we don’t need a little genius who can only speedread quantum waves!”

These words quickly travelled over a thousand miles away, reaching Ji Yushi’s ears.



Ji Yushi immediately returned the transfer order he was given and said: Not going.

The chief in turn became extremely anxious.

Chief Lin sonorously said, “Hey, isn’t it just three cats? Bring them over to the department and the people here will help you feed them! Three meals a day of dried fish, I guarantee they will love it!”

The people behind the door: “???”

Ji Yushi: “I cannot adapt.”

Chief Lin: “I’ll arrange for a spacecar filled with Ning City’s specialties! You can request for anything you want!”

Ji Yushi: “I’m not good with strangers.”

Chief Lin: “You just have to worry about the mission. There is no need to worry about that group of condescending illiterates!”

Ji Yushi’s lips moved again, “I’m gay.”

The people behind the door: “!!!”

Chief Lin was struck by lightning, “Xiao Ji, Xiao Ji you…….”

Ji Yushi had calmly unleashed his special attack. He said calmly, “Going to a place where the proportion of men is much higher, I am worried that I may not be able to control my feelings and possibly develop an unsatisfactory relationship which can disrupt the harmony in the Jiang City branch.”

Without waiting for the chief to continue persuading him, Ji Yushi heartlessly nodded at him as a show of respect and turned to leave.

Unexpectedly, Chief Lin spoke up again, “Xi-Xiao Ji.”

Regardless of everything else, the other party was his leader and his father's old friend.

Ji Yushi could only stop in his steps and turn his head back helplessly, "Chief."

Chief Lin's expression was strange but, as expected of a leader who had seen much of the world, he was able to quickly recover: "That's just right. You don't have to worry about this. The captain surnamed Song is.....deeply homophobic. The team he leads.....they're all homophobic."

Ji Yushi: "....."

\*

Ning City's Ji Yushi had come.

This news very quickly spread through the Jiang City branch, causing a large commotion.

On the holographic training field, the squad members in question were nervous.

"He's here?! His psychological endurance is really good!"

"He's really here! I saw him from the distance just now. He does look very good. That face, that temperament, it was as if he was filming a movie."

Everyone exchanged a look. In the end, an embroidered pillow really came. *(KKnotes: Basically, someone who is attractive outwardly but is actually completely useless.)*

The youngest of the squad comforted his teammates and said, "Hey, don't worry. It's fine if we can do the fighting. At most it's just doing a little more protecting. We can still complete the mission and report back."

"You better not say this in front of Cap Song. Have you forgotten Old Yu?" *(KKnotes: Cap, short for Captain.)*

“How can this person be compared to Old Yu?”

“Old Yu is at least someone who has received special training.”

The scout in the squad, Old Yu, had sustained some serious injuries and was still lying unconscious in hospital.

“B-but we shouldn’t be too pessimistic. Didn’t you say it just now? He at least looks good. It’ll be good for our eyes. Isn’t that great?”

“Great my ass. Do you know why he suddenly decided to come?”

“To easily complete an A-level mission by tagging along with us and raise his star rating?”

“Bullshit.” Someone rudely interjected, “We say he doesn’t have the fighting capabilities; he won’t come. We say he’s an embroidered pillow; he won’t come. We say the entire squad is homophobic; he comes. This person may possibly be coming here to either challenge us directly or prove his charm!”

Everyone gasped.

Curses sounded one after another.

To this group of straight-to-the-bone soldiers, the person who was coming seemed extremely dangerous and extremely threatening.

A small-eyed buzzcut man was really worried, “It’s over. This kind of person is generally not very picky. What if he falls for me? My family’s three generatio—”

As soon as he spoke, the back of the buzzcut man’s head received a hard knock.

A familiar male voice then sounded behind him: “Did you forget to look in the mirror when you left this morning?”

The young man who had just stepped into the training room had handsome features and a temperament as sharp as a blade that could cut through ice.

He was extremely tall, and his black combat uniform outlined his perfect figure. Paired with a set of long and straight legs, he naturally gave off an oppressive feeling that couldn't be ignored

The buzzcut man held his head and looked extremely wronged, “Cap Song.”

Everyone laughed.

Song Qinglan's eyes swept past this group of gossipers. His eyes were pitch black, but it also carried undisguised roguishness.

He spoke up again and only asked lazily: “Where is that person?”

**KK has something to say:**

ML is homophobic.....for now 😂

Side note: As usual, feel free to add tags on NU. I've done the very basics but I'm sure I'm forgetting some important ones too....

# Chapter 2: Chapter 2

## Beginning

### Chapter 2

That person was at the Tianqiong base and was being personally received by the chief.

Song Qinglan received the news and turned to head directly to the base. With his height and long legs, it only took a few steps for him to walk through the corridor and into the transmission cabin.

“Cap Song!”

“Ah, Cap Song!”

Everyone he met along the way saw that he looked the same as usual but they all shouted out their greetings one after another. Somehow, they felt that a volcano was about to erupt under that domineering and overwhelming presence.

Not long afterwards, gossip had spread all over the intranet saying that Captain Song was about to officially drive someone out.

A few minutes later, Song Qinglan reached underground.

[Welcome Song Qinglan. Welcome back to Tianqiong.]

The hatched opened on both sides as an electronic female voice sounded. Like those times before a mission started, it was just as gentle.

Twenty something years ago, the Imperial Science Team had made a breakthrough with regards to time travel and it has now developed into today's Time Management Alliance. Although there are branches in various countries, the one here was the main headquarter. At a depth of two kilometres underground, thousands of people toil away. Day and night, this dark underground headquarter is always brightly lit.

Song Qinglan got out of the transmission cabin and stopped before a white wall after walking for a few minutes. He pressed it lightly and an invisible door was pushed open.

“Thud!”

The people in the room were startled. They turned to look at him.

There was someone standing next to the middle-aged female chief.

Outside the floor-to-ceiling window was a large semicircular luminous dome which formed the backdrop. It looked like a galaxy in the vast universe.

The man in front of the window wore an ordinary white shirt and black trouser which accentuated his slender waist. He was tall and refined, reminiscent of a pine tree beside a snowy lake.

The brilliant star lights made this person's complexion appear extremely fair. His tall nose, bright eyes; all his features were just right, especially those beautifully shaped lips. That touch of colour on the elegant and refined face instantly made it appear all the more vivid.

It was unforgettable.

The moment he saw him, Song Qinglan inexplicably remembered the words his squad said in the training room.

“We say he doesn't have the fighting capabilities; he won't come. We say he's an embroidered pillow; he won't come. We say the entire squad is

homophobic; he comes. This person may possibly be coming here to either challenge us directly or prove his charm!”

“Didn’t knock again!” Chief Wang reproached, “I think you are the only one in the entire Tianqiong who constantly ignores the rules!”

Song Qinglan returned from his thoughts and calmly walked in.

He didn’t have any intention to reflect on this and just hooked up the corner of his lips, “I heard the new member is here. Chief Wang, why didn’t you let us know so that we can welcome him?”

After saying this, Song Qinglan finally turned his eyes to look at that person, “Advisor Ji.”

This form of address carried a hint of aggressiveness.

The person before him was from Ning City, a Recorder who has only completed B-level missions. He had been transferred to the Guardian squad with the title of Special Advisor.

Song Qinglan’s disdain, discontent and scrutiny were very obvious.

Ji Yushi didn’t cower or hide from Song Qinglan’s gaze and just quietly looked back as if he didn’t know who he was. The entire time, he didn’t say a single word.

The atmosphere stagnated for a while.

The gentleman’s response was calm and unwavering on the surface, but the undercurrent was turbulent.

How could Chief Wang not know about the disharmony between the two? Before even meeting, that one on her end had already offended the other party. In the end, she as the leader had to clean up after him.

“I brought Advisor Ji here to see the base. I didn’t expect you to be so impatient.” Chief Wang pretended that nothing had happened and gently introduced, “Advisor Ji, this is the captain of the seventh squad and also the

youngest captain under the Tianqiong system with the most potential. At a young age, he has already completed twelve A-level missions, reaching a rating of one star. Let me officially introduce him, his name is Song Qinglan. I don't think you've met before?"

Ji Yushi was slightly surprised. He retracted his gaze and unconsciously repeated those two words, "Song.....Qinglan?"

His voice was very soft, and it also sounded very nice. It was a voice Song Qinglan had expected.

The voices of civilian workers were probably all very similar to this.

Chief Wang smiled, "The sunny 'Qing' and the mountain wind 'Lan', doesn't it sound like a little girl—"

Song Qinglan interrupted, his expression poor, "Chief Wang."

It was as if Ji Yushi didn't notice the teasing in her tone. He quickly loosened his brows and said, "Actually, I have seen Captain Song before."

Chief Wang was interested, "Oh? When was it?"

Ji Yushi's nice voice continued, "Three years ago on October 14<sup>th</sup>. I attended a class organised by Tianqiong in the Jiang City branch and it was also a class taught by you. Captain Song was also in the class at that time, but we didn't know each other then."

Chief Wang was surprised this time, "That's strange, how could I not have an impression of someone like you?"

Not to mention Chief Wang, Song Qinglan himself also had no impression of this matter.

Are you kidding me? Who would have the time to remember the people they met three years ago?

Ji Yushi easily recalled the situation that day as if it had just happened yesterday, "The venue was very big, and my seat was at the back so it's



normal for you not to remember. That day you wore a light blue suit and skirt, had it paired with a pair of Baroque pearl earrings and your hair was a little shorter than it is now. During class, you also accidentally shattered a mug and changed it into a different one. Do you remember?”

Chief Wang quickly nodded her head, “I remember!”

Ji Yishu then said, “Captain Song’s seat was the ninth one from the left in the third row. He slept through two classes and left early in the afternoon.”

Song Qinglan couldn’t help but say, “Do you have a deep impression of me or are you trying to report me?”

Ji Yishu turned to look at Song Qinglan. His eyes reflected Song Qinglan’s figure, “I just happened to remember everyone who was there that day.”

Song Qinglan had almost forgot. This Advisor Ji was rumoured to have excellent memory.

Song Qinglan said implicitly, “Advisor Ji, I heard that people with good memories hold grudges.”

Ji Yushi answered frankly, “It’s alright. Depends on the situation.”

Chief Wang settled the situation down, “It’s good that you’ve met. Xiao Song is a little hot tempered and straightforward and he can be merciless when criticising his teammates. Making people cry in public isn’t something he hasn’t done before. I heard from Chief Lin that Advisor Ji’s personality is very easy going and accommodating. Try not to accommodate Xiao Song too much while you’re a part of the squad though lest you let yourself be wronged.”

Ji Yushi wasn’t the type to put on airs. He answered, “Don’t worry. As long as it’s for work, I will cooperate.”

Song Qinglan chuckled lightly and didn’t seem to care much about this, “That’s good then.”

After a short chat, Chief Wang started to talk about the more serious matters, “The task will be carried out next week. Starting from tomorrow, Advisor Ji should follow Xiao Song and get acquainted with the squad members and the working environment. There are a lot of equipment on the training ground as well as a special simulation combat system. I heard Advisor Ji has also been in the Imperial Army before?”

Song Qinglan raised his brows. He didn’t appear convinced.

Sure enough, Ju Yushi immediately confirmed his thoughts, “I just dealt with paperwork and only stayed for two months.”

That neither humble nor arrogant attitude gave Song Qinglan who had a background in the Special Forces an urge to laugh.

How could someone with such a thin and frail body fight at the frontlines?

Chief Wang nodded, “Although scouts do not require high combat abilities, it is better to train up a little. This year’s new batch of recruitments will have classes every morning. Advisor Ji can attend it if you want.”

\*

“They’re coming!”

“They’re coming out!”

“Hurry, hurry! Have they started fighting?!”

“Has Chief Wang broken a cup yet?!”

There was a circle of heads in front of the monitor and there were also many people loitering around in the corridor.

The transmission hatch opened, and Chief Wang stepped out first with her high heels. She seemed to be heading back to her office.

Then came Song Qinglan who was followed by Ji Yushi.

The height difference between the two was more than half a head. One was valiant while the other was elegant.

Song Qinglan's lack of enthusiasm to welcome this new teammate could almost be felt through the monitor screen. With his tall height, he walked ahead quickly without turning back. As for Advisor Ji who as expected was very proper looking, he walked with large strides behind Song Qinglan and didn't appear to have much trouble keeping up.

The two wordlessly went to the training grounds. Everyone else's heads were filled with question marks.

T-that's it?

Song Qinglan just accepted it?

What happened to the agreed bloodshed and the claim to send him back to when he came from?

Seeing the two return together, the teammates in the training room were also surprised. What was going on?

Song Qinglan strode straight into the open space and clapped his hands to gather everyone over, "Here, let me introduce to you. This is the colleague Ning City lent to us to help us complete our next mission. He will be taking over as the teams scout and is referred to as the special advisor; Ji Yushi, Advisor Ji."

In front of this group of Guardians bursting with male hormones, the white shirt Ji Yushi seemed like a completely different entity.

It was like a small white rabbit accidentally straying into a pride of lions.

But Ji Yushi was completely calm and didn't appear uncomfortable at all. He opened his mouth and said, "Hello."

"This is Duan Wen, Zhou Mingxuan, Li Chun and the twins Tang Le and Tang Qi." Song Qinglan introduced in order, "Respectively they are responsible for control, machinery, logistics and the left and right flanks.

There was a scout in the squad surnamed Yu, you are temporarily taking over his role.”

The unfamiliar teammates were all wearing the same uniforms. Except for their faces, there were no other distinctive differences. What’s more, there was also a pair of twins who looked exactly the same.

Song Qinglan however spoke very quickly. It wasn’t known whether he did it deliberately to make it difficult for Ji Yushi or because he always spoke so perfunctorily.

Ji Yushi just nodded. It wasn’t known whether he could remember it.

Song Qinglan didn’t give him any time to breathe. He then arranged, “Old Duan, your role has some connection with the scout’s role. Take him to understand what a scout’s work involves first.”

Duan Wen: “Huh? S-so fast?”

Usually, wouldn’t you take them around to each of the departments and let them become familiar with the place first?

Song Qinglan: “Time waits for no one. Did you think that it was too fast for the next mission to be assigned?”

Duan Wen: “Yes sir!”

Anyone with a discerning eye could see that Song Qinglan had no intention to give the newcomer Advisor Ji any face.

Ji Yushi didn’t seem to have any complaints. He very cooperatively left together with Old Duan.

Or perhaps he never had any intentions to butt heads with Song Qinglan.

As soon as they walked away, Song Qinglan returned to his usual state. He raised his eyebrows slightly, “What are you looking at? All of your eyeballs are about to fall out. Look at you.”

“Boss, he really is good looking!”

“I used to think that the word beautiful isn’t suitable for describing men but now I think it is quite appropriate.”

“We all eat the same things and we’re all human beings but how did he grow up to be like that? Just now at such a close distance, I couldn’t see a single pore on his face. His skin was amazing.”

The small-eyed buzzcut man who was knocked in the head by Song Qinglan earlier, Zhou Mingxuan, sighed, “Fuck, I feel like an idiot now. Someone like him would definitely not even consider me.”

“You find it regretful?” Song Qinglan lifted his feet and gave him a kick, “No longer worried about continuing your family lineage?”

Zhou Mingxuan let out a small laugh of embarrassment.

“Boss, we’re really going to let him stay?”

“He clearly looks like he can’t fight at all. He’s useless apart from being good looking!”

“I thought you would resist. This isn’t like you.”

Song Qinglan directly explained his plans.

In summary: “The order was already made, and the person has already arrived. Even if we want to change, it’s too late. Over the next few days, just go along with it. If you have anything to say, wait until it’s over. Right now, there is only one goal: Complete the mission safely!”

Everyone shouted in unison: “Yes sir!”

The team members dispersed.

Song Qinglan unconsciously began to recall the class from three years ago but it was to no avail. After all, things like not paying attention or leaving early.....he had done that many times.

That person's memory.....If he really had to say it, it could probably be considered an advantage?

**KK has something to say:**

I have to say, I really like the MC and ML's names. They're really pretty and both are related to the weather.

MC: 季雨时 (Ji Yushi) – Seasonal monsoon

ML: 宋晴岚 (Song Qinglan) – Sunny haze/mist/fog

Also their CP name is super cute: 晴雨 (Qing Yu) AKA sunshower

# Chapter 3: Chapter 3

## Beginning

### Chapter 3

Over the next few days, Song Qinglan never saw Ji Yushi.

According to Duan Wen, these past few days Ji Yushi had been attending class with the new students in the morning and would train alone in the personal training rooms in the afternoon. His entire daily schedule would be completely filled. Chief Wang had visited him once and gave him a lot of praise.

In the eyes of the leaders, these civilian workers probably seem like they're working very hard no matter what they do.

Chief Wang had called Song Qinglan to give him a warning, "Xiao Ji is smart and diligent. When the time comes, you should work as a team. He also has a two-star rating and would reach one star after completing this mission. Don't think that I don't know about your intentions to treat him as a flower vase."

Song Qinglan pretended to not understand, "How could that be?"

The training grounds have personalised training rooms and also a team-based simulated combat system.

Two days before the mission, everyone as usual gathered for team training. After Song Qinglan gathered everyone, he noticed that Ji Yushi was missing, "Old Duan, did you notify him?"

"I thought Li Chun told him yesterday."

“Fuck, why would I tell him? I haven’t seen him the past few days at all!”

“Alright. He probably went to class again.”

“Tang Qi, you organise the training.”

Song Qinglan decided to personally find him lest Chief Wang blames it on him again.

Leaving the training grounds, Song Qinglan went directly to the new recruitment base.

As the youngest captain, the first combat class for these new students after entering Tianqiong was taught by Song Qinglan. Song Qinglan’s close combat skills managed to beat the students from prestigious schools and those with high self-esteem directly into submission so when his face appeared outside the window, those who were slacking off immediately tensed up.

The specially appointed instructor was still teaching at the front. After a brief glance, Song Qinglan very quickly found the person he was looking for.

Ji Yushi was sitting by the window.

“Space constitutes the universe we are in and time constitutes the universe we know.”

The instructor on stage manipulated a holographic image and drew a colourful arc-shaped line. It was unknown where it started, and the end also faded into nothingness.

Some students sighed with praise.

Ji Yushi had his head down and didn’t seem to have noticed this wonderful presentation.

“Time is like a flowing thread. It allows us to have a past and also a future.”



“The past cannot be changed —— A person cannot travel back to the past and kill their ancestor. That is the ancestor paradox. Russian scientist Novikov also suggested the principle of self-consistency. It meant that even if people can go back to the past, they cannot change the course of history. Simple put, our present is the final outcome after countless changes.”

Light flickered in the air.

The instructor continued, “So what about the future? More than twenty years ago, our team invented Tianqiong. They discovered that there was more than one timeline.”

The instructor waved their hand and the arc of light in the air changed.

That light suddenly split, bursting into countless fibres that diverged in all directions.

“The Tianqiong’s powerful computing power can calculate countless futures stemming from our present time. With its existence, humanity for the first time became aware of the existence of parallel worlds. Over the past twenty years, various countries across the world have used Tianqiong and have used the Guardians from parallel worlds in the future to successfully prevent 1771 possible terrorist attacks, 542 riots, 6 wars as well as 3 large-scale natural disasters.

.....

As this was explained, various materials played on the screen.

Song Qinglan walked up to the window: “.....”

Was this the so-called ‘smart and diligent’?

The smart and diligent Ji Yushi was concentrating in class.....playing a black and white handheld console that was popular a century ago.

Under his skilful operation, the Tetris blocks quickly changed positions and fell into position at a very fast speed. Four rows....five rows.....and then six and seven rows. The score continued to skyrocket, and each block

would land with precision every time, making it seem as if the game would never end.

It was undeniable that Ji Yushi is a master of Tetris. If you searched everywhere, you wouldn't find another person who can play better than him.

Because he had his head lowered, Ji Yushi's spine was slightly curved and his thin shoulder blades were faintly visible.

He looked very focused and his long lashes were lowered. His clean profile, long fingers and well-kept nails made it clear that he was someone who had never experienced any hardship.

Song Qinglan thought, perhaps this person never had any intentions to come here to suffer.

\*

In the afternoon before the mission, everyone gathered for a meeting.

Like every meeting in the past, a map of their destination was displayed on a giant screen along with several markings on it.

The third command centre of the Tianqiong headquarters was in charge of organising the mission this time. The conference room was filled with thirty to forty people. Except for the seventh squad, the rest were all internal staff for the mission. The mission commander stood on stage explaining the mission and even Chief Wang was sitting in the audience.

“A month ago, Tianqiong reported that the population of Xijing people had demonstrated drastic changes in Star Era 1460. During this time period, there was a fluctuation of up to 3%.”

The commander enlarged the map and pointed at a flashing red spot.

“According to the report, after excluding natural disasters, bombing and other possible causes, Tianqiong concluded that this mission is likely related to a biochemical terrorist attack. The mission level is A.”

“Biochemical terrorist attack?”

“Haven’t we dealt with it once before?!”

“Easy as a pie!”

“I would like to make a request.” Song Qinglan sat in the corner of the room, the red spot on the map reflecting in his dark eyes, “After successfully completing this A-level mission, I would like to apply for a S-level mission.”

As soon as he said this, the conference room fell into discussion.

As everyone knew, one S-level mission is worth five A-level missions.

Having completed twelve A-level missions successfully, the seventh squad which have only formed two years ago rushed to the top of the charts like a dark horse. However, because they have not completed a S-level mission, they couldn’t squeeze into the top three and could only forever remain under them.

As such, the seventh squad have always been eager to complete a S-level mission.

Ji Yushi had heard about this.

Sitting with his teammates, he could clearly see Song Qinglan’s appearance. Arrogance, conceitedness and desire for victory was clearly expressed in Song Qinglan’s tone.

“Request accepted.” The commander paused and said to Song Qinglan, “After this mission, the command centre will re-evaluate based on your performance. Please be prepared to accept a S-level mission at any time.”

This was something Song Qinglan had heard many times.

He coldly sat there; his face expressionless.

It made people can't help but suspect that this unruly new star would explode sooner or later after being forced to wait time and time again.

At the end of the meeting, there was still a small strategic meeting to be held. Song Qinglan then had a separate talk with Chief Wang and the other leaders for another two hours.

When he came out, his teammates had all changed into civilian clothes and were waiting for him.

“Call the newcomer.” Song Qinglan said offhandedly.

The whole squad was going to have hot pot the night before the mission. This was a custom of theirs to ensure that they ‘eat well before setting off’.

“Called him. Advisor Ji said he won't go.”

“He's still in the training room.”

Song Qinglan thought of the scene of that person playing Tetris in class and found it a little amusing.

He instructed everyone to head off first.

There were hundreds of private training rooms in the training ground and the seventh squad have their own fixed rooms. With Song Qinglan's authority, it didn't take much effort for him to find the person he was looking for.

Ji Yushi had really just finished his training.

He had just got off the simulator and he was still covered in sweat, even the neckline of his grey T-shirt was soaked. Two robotic arms came over, one handing him a towel and the other a bottle of water.

Ji Yushi received the water and was surprised to see Song Qinglan there, “Cap Song?”

Song Qinglan stood at the door for a while with his arms crossed as if waiting for a reasonable explanation.

“Why aren’t you going to the dinner party?”

Ji Yushi took a sip of water. His beautiful features still carried small beads of sweat.

They were clearly all men but Song Qinglan suddenly felt a little strange. It was as if.....appearing in this teammates training room was something on par to overstepping his boundaries.

Ji Yushi replied, “Sorry, I had a prior appointment for a call tonight.”

Song Qinglan, “You can’t take the call later?”

Ji Yushi picked up the towel to wipe off his sweat, “Too clingy. Will get angry.”

Those words had pointed something out, reminding Song Qinglan of a crucial point.

He raised his brow, “There’s someone at home?”

The robotic arm had already cleverly collected the towel and retracted away.

Another drop of sweat however began to roll down from Ji Yushi’s forehead. He subconsciously grabbed the hem of his shirt and use it to wipe off the sweat.

A firm waist and abdomen belonging to a young man was exposed. It was different from those of the Tianqiong’s Guardians: That waist was thin and soft, and the skin was dazzling white. As he moved, a round belly button would reveal itself every now and then by the waist of his pants.

Song Qinglan looked away.

“Cap Song, do you mind?” Ji Yushi clearly understood why he was feeling conflicted, but his words and actions were very natural, “Does the training room I have been in need to be disinfected?”

Regarding the severity of Song Qinglan’s homophobia, Ji Yushi had also heard about it.

It is said that he had been publicly pursued by someone of the same sex and because of this, even the offices where a gay have entered needed to be disinfected.

Song Qinglan didn’t react to the provocation.

Song Qinglan’s then spoke about his real purpose for coming to the training room. It however wasn’t spoken as harshly as how he had originally intended, “I just wanted to tell you that there are many people who want to easily clear an A-level mission by mixing into our squad and they soon realise that they had overestimated themselves because A-level missions are much more dangerous than they had imagined. If Advisor Ji still cares about the people around you, it’s not too late to back out now. I can arrange for your return to Ning City.”

Ji Yushi however acted like he didn’t hear the sarcasm in his words, “But for me, it’s too late to back out now.”

The atmosphere was tense.

Song Qinglan smiled, “Alright, then I only have one request.”

Ji Yushi looked very calm and only met Song Qinglan’s gaze.

Song Qinglan threw out a few words, “Obey the orders, lie down and win.”  
*(KKnotes: Lie down and win basically means do nothing and profit off them without dragging them down)*

# Chapter 4: Chapter 4

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 4

Day of departure.

[1456.5.17 09:51:40]

In the third command centre, a large projection displayed the current time coordinate as people busied about in an orderly manner. It was no different from the countless missions they had done before.

In eight minutes, the mission will officially start. Everyone in the Tianqiong's seventh squad had already put on their Guardian combat uniform and were in the process of having their individual conditions checked to ensure that there would not be any adverse reactions when they traverse over.

Song Qinglan had already completed his check and was as usual checking the rest of the team members.

When he saw Ji Yushi, he frowned and patted the member next to him, "Go and see."

A slender figure was added to this group of strong guardians.

Ji Yushi had a subcutaneous communicator implanted into his neck the day before and the dispatcher was helping him connect it to his bracelet. He was a little taller than the dispatcher, so he had his head lowered. The look in his lowered eyes made him appear cold and aloof.

“The Recorder’s missions are usually solo missions and do not require teammates. Guardians are the opposite.” The dispatched considerably explained to him, “Advisor Ji, you may feel uncomfortable having the communicator implanted for the first time and you may be surprised to suddenly hear your teammates voice but don’t worry, after a while you will forget about its existence.”

“Alright.” Ji Yushi said.

After the dispatched walked away, Ji Yushi heard someone ask him, “Advisor Ji, how do you feel? You don’t look well today.”

The one who asked was one of the twin teammates.

Ji Yushi’s face was pale but his eyes were still bright, “No problem. I just slept late last night.”

“I see.” Because they weren’t familiar, the teammate could only say awkwardly, “Advisor Ji, don’t be too nervous. The transition this time is the same as your previous missions and the mission is also very simple. We should be back by tomorrow.”

Understanding the good intentions of his teammate, Ji Yushi nodded, “Thank you Tang Le.”

When Tang Le returned, his expression was very strange.

Song Qinglan, “What’s wrong?”

“Cap Song!” Tang Le looked like he had just seen a ghost, “He could actually distinguish me from my brother! He called me by the right name! Many people in the department still haven’t figured it out after so many years. Just today, just now, Zhou Mingxuan also made a mistake!”

Tang Qi and Tang Le both had a similarity of 99% in terms of their height, weight and appearance. People who didn’t interact with them day in and day out wouldn’t be able to distinguish between the two.



But Ji Yushi who was only introduced to them once remembered and it was even when they were wearing the same attire. This surprised Song Qinglan.

“Probably a coincidence.” Song Qinglan said indifferently, “He’s okay?”

Tang Le replied, “No problem! Just said he didn’t sleep well.”

Song Qinglan: “It’s good that he’s okay. Didn’t want him to drag us down later.”

The countdown displayed three minutes.

Everyone entered the large transmission platform. Several silver capsules were closely connected, like lotus seeds on a lotus.

Ji Yushi entered his capsule, sat in the seat and closed the door.

[Welcome Ji Yushi. You are about to set off to complete your first A-level mission.]

The noisy sounds in the command centre was completely blocked off. It was so quiet, he could only hear his own breathing and heartbeat.

Ji Yushi allowed the seat to securely bind around his calf, waist, abdomen, shoulder and neck. He then saw the control bracelet on his left wrist glow green.

It displayed the current position and physical condition of the six teammates.

Ji Yishi realised that this time he wasn’t crossing through time and space alone. Beside him were six teammates.

[You are connected to the public channel.]

After a brief reminder, Tianqiong’s law was displayed on the transparent panel.

“I am a witness of time and I hereby swear an oath.”

“Never change the past!”

“Never talk about the present!”

“Never be obsessed with the future!”

Uniform chants of the teammates resounded through the public channel.

This oath was something Ji Yushi was very familiar with but with so many saying it at the same time, it seemed more resolute than before.

There were ten seconds left on the countdown.

Catching Ji Yushi by surprise, a low male voice suddenly invaded his mind, numbing his auditory nerves in an instant.

Song Qinglan’s tone was very relaxed, “Everyone get ready. Tianqiong’s seventh squad, the thirteenth A-level mission, let’s go!”

\*

The pleasant voice still lingered in his ears.

Like the many time travels he had done before, Ji Yushi took a deep breath and about two or three seconds later, the originally calm and silent capsule started to jolt around violently!

【Warning! Warning! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! You have deviated from the destination coordinates!】

The warning light in the capsule flashed nonstop and the transparent panel before him flickered over and over again.

White light flashed in front of him.

A sharp alarm sounded, and dizziness, nausea and a strong sense of weightlessness almost overwhelmed him.

【Illegal transition detected!】

【Illegal transition detected!】

Something went wrong!!

Ji Yushi gritted his teeth and tried to press the emergency button several times but the capsule continued to spin and jolt around violently.

At the prompt, he could only use all his strength to grab the seats armrest, relying on the belts binding tightly around him to keep him firmly in place and prevent him from being thrown around.

After what felt like a century, the capsule gradually stabilised.

As soon as the capsule completely stopped moving, Ju Yushi quickly grabbed the nutrient solution handed over by a robotic arm and downed it in one go. It took him more than ten seconds to slowly recover.

[? ? p0754%\$#37]

[: “”LRR”/’1’89”]

Indecipherable garbled characters were displayed on the panel. It seemed like it had completely broken.

Without the time coordinate, it was impossible for Ji Yushi to confirm what year he was in and what had happened.

But through the glass windows of the capsule, he could see that they had landed inside a forest and through the dense tree canopy, a dark grey sky could vaguely be seen.

Ji Yushi released the bindings from the chair and stepped out.

“Bleagh————”

A teammate was throwing up.

The person who started vomiting as soon as he got out of the capsule was the youngest teammate, Li Chun. He had just been recruited as a Guardian

for less than a year and was a big boy with good physical fitness. He only had one problem: He gets “motion sickness”.

Hearing him vomiting, the teammates who seemed to be well trained in this aspect tacitly scattered away.

Song Qinglan also took back a few steps, “I told you to sit on the pendulum ten times before the next mission. Tell me the truth, how many times did you do it?”

Before Li Chun could finish speaking, he vomited a second wave, “T-twice....Bleagh ——”

The teammates all expressed shock.

“Did you hear that?”

“The break was so long. Did you only use it to flirt with girls?”

“The simulator can’t help you anymore, yet you dare neglect the pendulum?”

Li Chun finally finished vomiting. He said weakly, “.....No, don’t you smell it? The air here smells bad.”

Duan Wen walked over with a bottle of water while pinching his nose, “Chun’er, don’t make excuses. Rinse your mouth first.”

Li Chun: “Thanks Brother Wen.....Huh? Where’s Advisor Ji?”

Ji Yushi’s capsule was closest to Ji Chun. The door to the capsule was wide open but he was nowhere in sight.

Just as everyone was worried that he may have been thrown into some other time and space, a cold voice travelled over, “I’m here.”

At some unknown point in time, Ji Yushi had moved four or five metres away from Li Chin. Under the fluorescent light from the capsules, you could see a hint of discomfort on Ji Yushi’s pale face.

Everyone: “.....”

Was it necessary hiding so far?!

Prim and proper people really love cleanliness!

Song Qinglan glanced at Ji Yushi but wasn't in the mood to care about the new teammate's shallow comradery.

Everyone had encountered a similar situation in their capsule. The transparent panels of all of them showed garbled characters. Song Qinglan turned on the communicator on his wrist and saw that the time had been updated to the current time: [1470.8.05 04:41:31].

This place clearly wasn't the time coordinate for their A-level mission, let alone their original time period.

That strong turbulence just now was accompanied by the report of an “illegal transition”. Song Qinglan guessed that they may have encountered some form of malfunction —This was his first time encountering such a situation in the two years he had been completing missions.

“Duan Wen.” Song Qinglan ordered succinctly, “Check the main control panel and see if there are any data leaks or data hijacking and contact the command centre immediately.”

“Yes.” Duan Wen worked quickly and soon returned to report, “Cap Song, our equipment seems to be locked.”

Song Qinglan frowned: “How is it locked?”

Duan Wen explained, “The main control panel is offline, and the command centre cannot be contacted. The capsules also don't work. It seems to be because of the electromagnetic waves here. The magnetic field here seems a little different but it's still not certain. Perhaps the transition just now had something to do with it. Right now, all that we can use is the communicator. We're basically trapped here.”

Everyone heard the news and one after another they began to cuss.

“What about the mission?”

“I even said that the mission would be over tomorrow and invited a girl out for dinner.”

“You’ve fucking slagged so many. It’s endless.”

At this moment, footsteps could suddenly be heard from the forest.

At four o’clock in the morning, who be in the depths of such a remote forest?

Everyone turned silent.

Adhering to the principle that traverser must remain low profile and shouldn’t be discovered by the original residents of the land, Duan Wen who was in charge of machinery immediately turned off the holographic map on his bracelet and the seven capsules were also changed into a hidden state under his control, turning completely invisible.

Once the last of the light sources were gone, the forest plunged into darkness and silence. It was so quiet; you could even hear a needle falling.

They may have just gone the wrong way.

Everyone remained hidden under the cover of the trees, silently waiting for the other person to leave.

That drifter saw them.

Seeing a group of mysterious figures suddenly appear in the middle of the forest, anyone who was normal would be shocked, but this drifter didn’t appear surprised at all. On the contrary, as soon as he saw this group of people, he suddenly cried out in excitement and sped up!

Li Chin stood closest. After vomiting just now, his mind was still a little hazy.

As the stench approached him, Li Chun responded quickly with a curse and threw the other person onto the ground.

“Grrr!! Grr!!”

The drifter growled strangely and lashed out again.

“What the hell?!” Li Chun didn’t expect the other party to fight back. He only felt a strong stench flash by and then it was followed by a sharp pain in his shoulder, “Fuck!!!”

The drifter had left a vicious bite on Li Chun’s shoulder!

With a ‘thud’, the drifter was kicked three or four metres away by Song Qinglan!

On the other end, Duan Wen supported Li Chun up, “Chun’er! How are you?!”

Li Chun grinned in pain. Fortunately, the Guardian’s combat uniform had armour on the shoulders. That bite just now only left toothmarks and didn’t seem to have pierced through the skin.

If ordinary people were kicked by Song Qinglan, they wouldn’t be able to get up. That drifter however got back up again while continuing to growl.

This time, his target had changed to Song Qinglan.

Seeing that he was about to pounce again, Song Qinglan didn’t panic. In the darkness, his figure moved around like a black panther. In just a blink of an eye, he had appeared behind the drifter, swiftly knocking the other party down and subduing him.

Perhaps it was just too easy going against civilians. Song Qinglan didn’t even break a sweat from this and just raised his chin, “Chun’er, is this someone you have slagged? Seemed to have chased you all the way here.”

The teammates laughed, “Pfft.”

Ji Yushi on the side: “.....”

This squad seems a little different from what he had imagined.

The captain and the team members all don't seem like serious people.

Li Chun who was teased didn't dare talk back. He obediently endured the stench and tied the 'person he has slagged' up. This was his retribution. Who told him to vomit just now, polluting the nose of his teammates?

The drifter was still howling frantically as he struggled about. He seemed to have lost his mind. That coarse and strange cry echoed through the silent forest, clearly not sounding like that of a human but more like a cannibalistic beast.

Song Qinglan noticed something was wrong. He ordered concisely, “Flashlight.”

This order instead brought Ji Yushi over.

Seeing him come over with a flashlight, Song Qinglan finally remembered that the special advisor that was recruited into the squad was actually the scout in their team.

But the new scout's mental fortitude wasn't very good. He only took a quick glance at the drifter and immediately looked away.

It could be seen that the gentle and clean Advisor Ji felt rather sick.

Song Qinglan looked at him, “Can you bear with it? If not, change with them.”

In the dark, Ji Yushi's pale neck was stubbornly tense. It could be seen that he was enduring, “I'll try my best.”

Song Qinglan was noncommittal and warned, “Then you better hold it in.”

In the darkness, the strong light from the flashlight allowed everyone to see the drifter's appearance.



It was an extremely pale face with skin covered in blue-green blood vessels. His eyes were grey and turbid and seemed to have lost focus. What was even more shocking was that the man's mouth and clothes were covered with dark red blood stains as well as several small pieces of flesh!

Not only Ji Yushi, the expressions of the other teammates also changed.

Those pieces of flesh had a certain characteristic. It could vaguely be made out that it once belonged to a human.

Li Chun had a strong desire for survival. He whispered in a small voice, "I told you the air here smells."

That smell came from the blood covered man here.

**KK has something to say:**



# Chapter 5: Chapter 5

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 5

A drifter suddenly rushing into the forest like a lunatic early in the morning was already unusual.

With the addition that the other party probably suffered from some sort of disease and his appearance was too terrible, everyone present was rendered speechless.

Song Qinglan took the flashlight in Ji Yushi's hands and turned it off.

Once again falling into darkness, Ji Yushi heard him say, "Alright, I should've checked my fortune for today before leaving. To think that we broke the record of being discovered by the original residents of the land the fastest. No one is allowed to report about this when we go back. If we get any more points deducted, those bastards in the ninth squad will surpass us."

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan's tone was the same as usual, pulling everyone out of the strange atmosphere.

It was a reminder to them: They are Guardians and are currently in a time and space where they shouldn't be.

"For now, leave that person nearby. Someone will naturally find him and call the police." Song Qinglan said, "We can't see anything in this darkness so we will need to get out of here to find a way to contact the Tianqiong in

this time period. When we go out, pay attention to your surroundings. Be very vigilant as you may come across a murder scene.”

Everyone: “Yes sir.”

Before leaving, they distributed the weapons as per usual.

Zhou Mingxuan opened the storage which carried long and short guns, daggers, sabres, everything. Guardians would always have the most advanced weapons, and everyone has their own preferences. It was necessary to be prepared as anything could happen.

It was Ji Yushi’s first time carrying a weapon during a mission. When it was his turn, he chose a pistol he had often used lately in the training rooms.

The body of the gun was silvery white and the gun itself was small and easy to carry and hide.

“Diamond Bird.” Song Qinglan stood beside him and said the gun’s name, “Designed after the PPK style from the last century, Hitler and Bond have used it. Advisor Ji, you are very retro.”

“What?” Ji Yushi didn’t understand. Just a single gun and he could tell that he’s retro?

Song Qinglan however didn’t explain why he said this. He just said, “If it was me, I would try to choose something that can protect myself better. But it suits you.”

Ji Yushi: “.....” He knows that there are people who call the Diamond Bird a woman’s gun.

Song Qinglan was proficient with close combat and his firm and well-proportioned muscles also proved this point.

He methodically picked up two military knives first, strapping it to his calf, and then picked up a pair of gloves, a pair of fist hooks and a shotgun.

Shen Mian (*KKnotes: lit. God Sleep*)

—— That was the name of this gun. It wasn't light in weight and it has great lethality. Just like the feeling Song Qinglan gives people, it was unruly, domineering and hard to ignore.

After selecting their weapons, Song Qinglan asked, "Weapons should be used when they need to be used. It is best that they don't leave your side, but do you know what you should say if you are discovered by the original residents?"

His dark eyes moved over to Ji Yushi. There seemed to be a hint of teasing in his tone, "Tell them you are the police."

\*

Walking out the forest, everyone saw that the place they had arrived at was a park.

Song Qinglan was right. Just as they reached the main road by the park, they found a corpse under the streetlamp. Although they say that it was a corpse, it actually wasn't a complete one and only half was left. The wound looked like it had been bitten by some animal, which quickly reminded them of that crazy drifter.

Combining this with those pieces of flesh on the drifter just now, everyone felt a little sick.

Could this person have been eaten?

This was not only the first time they were discovered by the original residents so quickly; it was also the most distasteful encounter.

It was a moderately sized forest park located in the middle of the city and surrounded by tall buildings. It was already five o'clock in the morning. There should normally be morning exercisers and elderly people taking walks, but they didn't run into anyone the entire time they were there.

Garbage were scattered about everywhere; on the lawn, the benches, everywhere. It was as if it had not been cleaned by the sanitation team in a

long time. In the middle of the road, there would also occasionally be dry dark red blood stains. It seems that more than one murder had happened here.

Not only that, the windows of all the tall buildings in the distance were completely dark. They stood lifelessly under the dark grey sky.

Without the hustle and bustle of traffic and the familiar noises one would hear early in the morning, the city was terribly quiet, as if it had fallen into dead silence.

What was even stranger was that the further they were from the forest, the more obvious the rancid smell in the air got. It was as if there were more things waiting for them in places they couldn't see.

What on earth happened here?

A wisp of paleness appeared in the skyline. The sun was soon about to come out.

The lifeless park was however still shrouded in shadows, appearing extremely gloomy.

Sensing danger, Song Qinglan silently made a gesture.

Everyone was on guard. They stood in line and looked around at their surroundings.

On Song Qinglan's left was Ji Yushi. His beautiful fingers held the gun and his act of holding it looked very well practiced. With tacit understanding with his teammates, he similarly looked around but, in view of his reaction when they encountered danger in the forest, Song Qinglan tilted his head towards him.

The meaning in Song Qinglan's dark eyes was obvious: Go to the middle of the team.

Ji Yushi however had no self-consciousness of his flower vase identity. As if he didn't understand his meaning, he continued moving forward.

A few seconds later, he said quickly in a suppressed voice, “Cap Song, eleven o’clock, park management office.”

Song Qinglan squinted in the direction he had pointed out. It was completely dark there. He couldn’t see anything.

Ji Yushi again spoke, “There seemed to be lights inside.”

The minimum requirement for a scout was to have good eyes and ears. Song Qinglan regarded the previous scout of the team, Old Yu, as their eyes and never doubted the scout’s judgement.

And so, Song Qinglan said solemnly, “Go and see.”

Turned out, Ji Yushi’s eyesight was excellent.

With his notice, everyone walked a certain distance before finally distinguishing a building hidden by the bushes. A sign hung at the entrance of the building: PU-31 Central Park Management Office.

“What’s PU-31?” Someone whispered, “I don’t remember a place called this?”

Everyone was puzzled. The current time coordinate was Star Era 1470. Although they came from more than ten years ago, they shouldn’t be using something like that as a place name in just ten years?

At such a long distance and such small writing, they didn’t know how Ji Yushi managed to see it.

After entering, Song Qinglan realised that the so-called light was just a lamp sitting on the wooden desk in the corner of the room.

Did this person’s eyes have the ability to zoom in?

The park management office was empty and was completely silent like the outside world. Several teammates started to check the rooms while Song Qinglan picked up the communicator on the administrator’s desk which had turned off because it had run out of power. The desk was also a complete

mess. Keys, newspapers, registration books, takeaway boxes, everything was there.

Very soon, Tang Le appeared, “Cap Song, a body was found in the bathroom!”

The corpse found in the bathroom wore a uniform and appeared to be one of the staff here.

The corpse was lying down facing the floor and there was a large bloody hole on the back of his neck. Through the rotting flesh, arteries and veins were clearly visible. Song Qinglan casually picked up a towel and turned that person over. As expected, this person was just like the drifter and his face was pale, covered with blue and green blood vessels. The only difference was that this corpse had a stiff face and closed eyes, but he still retained the state of screaming. Through his opened mouth, maggots could be seen squirming around, making the onlookers feel disgusted.

There was no airflow in this small space. The smell was very strong and there was even the sound of someone quietly retching.

Song Qinglan didn’t look back, “Li Chun, I dare you to vomit again.”

The group standing in the bathroom turned their heads back angrily. Li Chun innocently raised his hands, “It’s really not me this time!”

Ji Yushi who was standing by the door covered his mouth and quickly walked away.

Finally couldn’t stand it? Song Qinglan thought this.

But, no matter who it was, he didn’t have the time right now to worry about their mental state.

He examined the corpse in thought for a few seconds. Instead of touching it directly, he used a military knife from his calf to pry open the eyelids of the deceased.

Sure enough, just like the drifter, the eyes were grey and turbid. It was even difficult telling where the pupil was.

Li Chun said, “Fuck, the same as that madman just now. What is this? An infectious disease?”

Li Chun recalled the moment he was almost bitten. It basically meant that he was almost infected just now. Li Chun shuddered.

Song Qinglan said, “It’s possible, but we can’t be sure.”

Adding to that the corpse in the park and those other blood stains.....Could a mad drifter cause so many murders? He expressed his doubts.

Ji Yushi didn’t really vomit.

When Song Qinglan returned to the administrator’s office, Ji Yushi was examining a communicator which had no signal. Except for the slightly pale face, he appeared to have mostly recovered.

Seeing them come out, Ji Yushi said, “I found a video.”

“I found the communicator’s charging port in the drawer.” Ji Yushi didn’t seem to be very used to expressing his opinions in front of everyone. He continued to explain without any emotion, “After turning it on, I saw a video that was downloaded a month ago.”

The communicator projected the video.

A man with a pale face and skin covered in blood vessels appeared on the screen. His slightly bulging eyes were grey and at this moment, he was rushing desperately at the camera. The person filming it screamed and the scene shook. The man’s neck had been violently scratched and bloodied but, even so, that man continued to let out growls.

The person filming this scene was female. In the video, you could hear her cries: “Help! Help me.....My husband has mutated! And outside, there are more of them out there! Save me, I don’t want to die! I haven’t been bitten! Someone save me!”



The video ended on the man's grotesque face.

Everyone shuddered.

“Zombies!!”

“If it's really a zombie, how many of them are out there?!”

“Fuck, no wonder it's so weird here!”

“That was a video from a month ago!”

After watching such a realistic horror film, Ji Yushi's expression was also strange: “The communicator has no internet but I just received a message. It was probably sent to us.”

Zhou Mingxuan was confused, “The message was sent to the deceased's communicator, but the message is for us?”

He placed emphasis on the word ‘us’.

That was too ridiculous.

Ju Yushi however affirmed it, “I think so.”

Song Qinglan was calm, “Open it.”

The blue light on the screen flashed slightly and a holographic projection gradually lit up.

[Welcome Guardians from Star Era 1456. Welcome to PU-31.]

The familiar welcoming voice from the Tianqiong system should have made them feel relieved but everyone just felt a chill down their back as they wondered what was going on.

Not only was this message really sent to them, several more lines of words appeared one after another.

[The transfer this time has been locked in. Unlocked after mission is successful.]

[Mission mode: Ouroboros.]

[Mission rule: Death elimination]

“Everyone, look!” Tang Le who was standing by the window suddenly pointed outside and shouted.

Everyone quickly walked over.

They were all left dumbfounded.

A large black wall suddenly appeared, connecting the sky with the ground. It spread all the way from the direction they had just come from.

No, it cannot be described as a black wall.

If it had to be described, it was like a black screen one would see when a game loads. It moved very quickly, submerging everything in sight before finally coming to a stop before the park management office.

“Beep——” The communicator let out a reminder.

The last line of words had appeared in the projection.

[Mission objective: Chaser of darkness.]

**KK has something to say:**

Apologies to those with a weak stomach...

# Chapter 6: Chapter 6

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 6

“Fuck, what the hell is that?? What the hell is PU-31?!”

“Did the command centre do a last-minute mission change?”

“Think with your brain. Those at the top would definitely not do something like that.”

“Did we get mixed up with another squad’s mission? Or is this a prank by that group of people from the ninth squad?”

“And what’s this about the chaser of darkness?! We can’t go back if we don’t finish this mission??”

“Cap Song, have you encountered something like this before?”

Following the chaotic chatter, Ji Yushi’s question made everyone quieten down.

The black combat uniform made Ji Yushi appear even more slender but his tone was calmer compared to his teammates.

“First time.” Song Qinglan answered, “Have you encountered this in your Recorder missions?”

Seeing him remain silent, it was presumed that he had also not encountered this before. Song Qinglan raised a brow, “Why? Afraid?”

Ji Yushi shook his head, “No, it’s enough if I can just lie down and win.”  
(*KKnotes: For those who have forgotten, lie down and win basically means do nothing and profit off them*)

Everyone was shocked: “!!!”

They didn’t expect Advisor Ji to actually say something like that out loud!  
Was it really okay to do this in such a situation?!

Ji Yushi continued to look calm, as if he had no burden whatsoever.

He appeared to be determined to be a salted fish. (*KKnotes: Basically to be useless/to do nothing*)

Song Qinglan: “…….”

Forget it. Everyone has their own ambitions.

Not wanting to speak anymore, Song Qinglan looked around before picking up a broom and going outside.

The black wall was just ahead. He poked at it with the broom and saw that it could go through. It seems that it wasn’t a physical body. The broom in his hands however suddenly became very light. As he pulled it back out, the part of the broom that was inserted into the black wall was gone, as if it had been ‘eaten’ by the black wall.

This terrible scene made everyone sweat nervously.

They couldn’t help but imagine the horrific scene of themselves recklessly touching that black wall and becoming physically mutilated or possibly even split in half.

As they saw earlier, that black wall could move.

Although it was still now, no one knew when it would start moving again. Clearly, they should leave this park management office as soon as possible.

Song Qinglan threw aside the broken broom: “What did the mission rules say?”

“De-death elimination.” Someone answered.

“It’s good that we know.” Song Qinglan turned to everyone and said sternly, “Pick up your weapons and try not to die on me. Since we can’t go back anyway, let’s figure out what this PU-31 is.”

\*

The squad ventured out of the park, reaching a not so spacious intersection.

In Star Era 1470, the building density was much higher than the time and space they came from ten years ago so having a space in the centre of the city to use as a park was already very luxurious and, as a result, the streets near the park were relatively narrow.

The city was barren and emptier than expected. There were no signs of life around.

Wrecked cars were messily scattered by the sides of the roads, various shops appeared to have been smashed and burns and there were also blood stains everywhere along with an occasional mutilated corpse or two. It really felt like it was the end of the world.

The deeper into the city, the more silent it was. The only sounds that could be heard was everyone’s heavy breathing transmitted through the communicator. No one spoke.

The team members bypassed the black wall and continued on while looking around vigilantly.

They didn’t know when that black wall would move again and at times they would look back to check, only to see that it was still sitting there in the distance, having wiped out half the world.

“Wait.”

Song Qinglan's voice sounded in the public channel and he made a fist gesture.

Everyone stopped.

It was already 6 o'clock in the morning.

The late summer sun filtered through the gaps between the tall buildings, casting a golden glow onto the charred asphalt road.

In that blinding light was a group of people.

To be more precise, it was a group of zombies.

There was a pool of flesh and blood in the middle of the road. It could be seen that it was a fresh corpse with all its inner organs scattered outside of the stomach. The group of zombies at this moment were scrambling around the corpse, feasting on the corpse's limbs and internal organs, devouring hungrily.

The sound of chewing mixed with hoarse and low growls could be heard very clearly even at a distance of seven or eight metres away.

Although they had mentally prepared themselves, witnessing the scene of humans eating humans was still too shocking.

Before everyone had the time to digest this scene, they heard a terrified cry from behind.

“Ahhh!!!”

Not far away in the shadows of the buildings was a woman covered in blood. She had just rushed out of a building and closely following behind her were twenty or thirty zombies, frantically reaching out, trying to tear her apart.

On this end, that woman's cry had alerted the group feasting in the sun.

They immediately looked up with their grey and turbid eyes and their bright red mouths. Like demons from hell, they immediately rushed towards the team!

“Fuck!”

Someone cursed and soon following that, someone said, “Save her!”

‘Bang, bang, bang’. Several gunshots sounded. Song Qinglan successfully struck a few of the zombies chasing after the woman and, at the same time, the other teammates had fired at the group of feasting zombies which were rushing towards them, blasting their heads and splattering it all across the ground.

The silence of the city was broken by the sound of gunfire.

“Grrrrr——”

Like they had poked a hornet’s nest, within a few seconds more dormant zombies appeared in all directions. They came out of the shadows, from the buildings and from hidden corners around the street like a tide and rushed over at an alarming speed.

“Go, go, go!!”

“Hurry!!”

Gunshots sounded one after another, resonating throughout the street.

The woman had rushed over to them in a blink of an eye. Ji Yushi was about to pull her over to safety, but his expression suddenly changed.

At a short distance of about ten metres away, that woman transformed from a living human into one of those demons at a speed visible to the naked eye!

“Shoot!!! She’s no longer human!!”

Someone shouted behind him.

Ji Yushi felt like he had just woken up from a dream. He pressed the trigger and the Diamond Bird struck her in the head, scattering her brains in all directions.

The woman instantly fell to the ground and was stepped on by countless other zombies rushing over.

“Behind you!!”

He was suddenly pushed, and he heard an explosion close to his ears. Ji Yushi only felt a warm sensation on his neck. Song Qinglan had blasted off the head of a zombie behind him. With his face covered in blood and brain juice, Ji Yushi’s vision was blurred and his ears still roared from the blast earlier. Song Qinglan said something to him with a frown but he couldn’t hear it.

In a blink of an eye, the streets were densely covered with zombies. It was hard to find an escape route.

“Thud——”

Song Qinglan had already used his long legs to easily climb onto the roof of a car amidst the rain of bullets.

He held Shen Mian and, with full firepower, directly blasted out a ring of bloody corpses with the squad as the centre.

Everyone had a chance to catch a breath.

Li Chun similarly jumped onto the roof of another car and shouted while shooting, “Cap Song, there’s too many!!! What should we do?!”

Song Qinglan had his brows deeply furrowed. His pupils shrank and he commanded, “To the left! Convenience store!”

Most of the shops along the street had already been destroyed and the convenience store with the metal barrier was very conspicuous.



More and more zombies were attracted over by the sound of the gunshots and the zombies close at hand continued to attack the living humans.

Bloody corpses were littered all over the ground. No one paid any attention to what they stepped on and just hurried desperately in the direction pointed out by Song Qinglan.

Tang Qi and Tang Le occupied the left and right flanks respectively while Zhou Mingxuan was at the very front.

Song Qinglan and Li Chun used their height advantage and quickly helped open a bloody path for them.

Ji Yushi wiped away the blood on his face. They had successfully reached the door to the convenience store.

Someone cursed, "It's locked!"

With long-term tacit understanding, Duan Wen didn't hesitate. He raised his gun and directly smashed the shops identification panel, causing it to let out a piercing alarm. The metal barrier outside the glass door was lifted by Zhou Mingxuan who soon managed to open a small gap.

When Ji Yushi turned around, he saw that Song Qinglan had jumped off the roof of the car, tumbled across the ground to dodge the zombies before quickly striding over.

Song Qinglan's face was as cold as frost. He yelled as he fired with his gun, "Li Chun! You fucking haven't played around enough?!"

Li Chun had become too immersed with killing. At this moment, he was cursing as he shot at the zombies constantly climbing towards him.

When Song Qinglan yelled, Li Chun seemed to have returned to his senses. He looked over at his teammate who was rushing to the convenience store, "I'll cover for you! Hurry up and go!"

Song Qinglan reached the convenience store and, with amazing arm strength, he and Zhou Mingxuan managed to lift the barrier high enough for

everyone to climb through.

“Grrrrr——”

What they didn't expect was that almost at the same time as lifting up the barrier, five or six zombies with grey eyes and pale faces suddenly flew out from inside like rabid dogs!

‘Bang, bang, bang, bang, bang!!’

Following the sound of consecutive fires, the zombies all fell to the ground.

Every bullet accurately struck each of their heads.

Everyone was taken aback for a moment: “!!!”

Standing right before the door was Ji Yushi. With his face covered in blood, they couldn't see his expression clearly.

He held Diamond Bird in both hands and his arms trembled slightly from the recoil of shooting consecutively.

The last corpse laid in front of him with wide eyes and a bullet right between his brows.

Song Qinglan was also stunned for a moment. He quickly recovered and commanded, “Clear up the entrance and close the door after going in!!”

Now wasn't the time to gag. Duan Wen immediately dragged the corpses away and rolled in. Following him was Ji Yushi who had changed everyone's impression of him in an instant.

The two didn't dare relax after entering and quickly patrolled around with their guns at the ready.

All they could see was a completely trashed convenience store. Most of the shelves were empty, as if they had just been raided. Apart from that, there were no other zombies, so it looked safe.

Amid the gunfire, Li Chun was the third one to roll in.

And following that was Zhou Mingxuan and Song Qinglan.

Corpses quickly piled up. Song Qinglan kicked away the zombies trying to get in and added a shot for each of them, but the appearance of living humans attracted more and more zombies. These zombies pushed at the door and frantically tried to burrow in. The zombie's blood and brain juices instantly dyed the entrance of the convenience store red and the metal barrier had caved in looking like it was soon about to collapse!

Just as they were at their limits of holding the fort, Tang Le was forcefully pushed into the convenience store by Tang Qi.

Tang Le's hair was wet with blood. He quickly turned back and shouted, "Brother! Hurry in!!"

Tang Qi however remained standing outside with fresh blood stains on his face. After sending Tang Le in, he slammed the metal barrier down and proceeded to shut himself out!

Everyone was shocked!

"Tang Qi——"

Song Qinglan immediately dropped Shen Mian and moved to lift up the metal barrier but at this moment Tang Qi raised his right hand and used it to wipe away the blood on his face.

Three fingers on his right hand were missing and the fresh bite mark was still dripping with blood.

Just like that woman earlier, Tang Qi's youthful appearance gradually turned pale and his bright and determined eyes turned grey and turbid at a speed visible to the naked eye.

Countless zombies appeared from behind Tang Qi, biting and tearing at his flesh.

He remained unmoved.

“Brother!!!” A despairing cry sounded through the convenience store. Tang Le who had witnessed everything rushed to the door like an injured beast.

His teammates held him back, their eyes equally as red.

Tang Qi’s eyes outside the door were completely glazed over. Within a few seconds, everything that belonged to him was gone. He started to let out low growls and started to slap and hit the metal barrier outside like the other zombies.

He had become a member of the zombies now.

“Brother!!!” Tang Le was pressed down onto the ground by his teammates. This one metre eighty man cried with extreme sorrow, “Brother!!!”

Song Qinglan stepped back and slammed his fist heavily on the wall.

His dark hair scattered loosely against his forehead and there were faint veins along his neck. Strong anger and aggression could be felt emanating from his body.

“Are we going to die?! Behind us is the black wall and before us are those zombies!” Li Chun looked around with red eyes, “It hadn’t been long and we already.....There are so many outside. What should we do?!”

The zombies outside rushed over like waves. One wave after another, there was no chance of them breaking through. As shown by Tang Qi just now, once bitten, one would mutate within just a few seconds.

The metal barrier of this convenience store probably wouldn’t be able to last very long either.

As soon as this question was asked, the convenience store fell silent.

Their current predicament was a hundred times more dangerous than expected. No one had expected that someone would lose their lives so soon!

Standing in the corner was Ji Yushi. Sticky blood slowly dripped from the hair on the side of his ears.

The scene of Tang Qi mutating was too terrifying.

The metal barrier creaked. More and more zombies gathered outside the convenience store.

Hearing the growls at such a close proximity while trapped inside a small convenience store, despair enveloped everyone.

But Song Qinglan said, "If we stay, we're only waiting for our deaths. Now isn't the time to give up!"

Ji Yushi raised his head.

He saw Song Qinglan pick up Shen Mian from the ground, no longer looking at the terrible looking teammate outside who had followed him through countless life and death situations.

Knowing that everyone was counting on him, Song Qinglan gritted his teeth and gave an order in a deep voice, "Check and see if there is another exit!"

The teammates started to move but they soon returned to their original positions.

"Cap Song, we made no discoveries!"

"There is a window in the bathroom, but it is only thirty centimetres in size. We can't get out from it."

"There should be an exit in the warehouse."

Ji Yushi's ears were still ringing from the close proximity blast earlier and his eardrums hurt severely so the tone of his voice was a little strange.

After witnessing the death of a teammate, Ji Yushi's pale face that was stained with blood was even paler than before, "But I'm not sure what's outside that exit. It may be even worse."

Everyone was slightly surprised.

This newly joined Advisor Ji who had just revealed his abilities earlier at the door looked extremely fragile at this moment, like a wounded flower in a greenhouse.

Everyone suddenly thought of the zombies that have fallen under his gun.

Duan Wen, “I’ve already checked. The four walls of the warehouse are just walls!”

Ji Yushi said, “Not possible. I remember the layout for this area!”

Song Qinglan asked, “Have you been here before?”

No. Song Qinglan quickly dismissed that thought. They had only just come to this so-called PU-31 and haven’t even had the chance to figure out what this place was so it wasn’t possible for Ji Yushi to have come here before.

Ji Yushi explained, “No! On the way here, I saw a plan of the window layout for the buildings in this area. This place is a commercial district and the buildings have fixed requirements, so the ground floor layout of each building is exactly the same. There should be an exit in the warehouse.”

Someone couldn’t help but ask, “Are you sure you didn’t make a mistake?”

Ji Yushi, “I’m certain.”

Everyone quickly came to warehouse which didn’t have any windows in sight.

If one didn’t have a good sense of direction, it would be difficult to tell where they were facing when in an unfamiliar space.

But Ji Yushi’s mind was like a living 3D architectural drawing. He pointed at a wall and said quickly, “This place here should have a window about 120cm high and 80cm wide. Because this place was planned to be the convenience store’s warehouse and considering issues of theft and

humidity, it was likely sealed up. The shop keeper kept the fake windows outside to keep the appearance of the building the same.”

Everyone was suspicious. Was there really someone who could remember everything they see without a single mistake?

Song Qinglan had now calmed down. He knocked on that wall.

Time was running out. After confirming that it was indeed a flimsy brick wall, Song Qinglan asked, “What’s behind the wall?!”

Ji Yushi could see some trust in his eyes. He calmly said again, “Back alley. But I’m not clear on the situation in the back alley.”

It wasn’t a situation for them to hesitate: “Directly blow it open!”

They did as they were told.

Everyone backed away and, together with Song Qinglan, Tang Le used a high energy gun to blow open that wall.

‘Boom——’

Loud noise travelled in from outside the warehouse!!

That metal barrier at the entrance had finally collapsed! Countless crazed zombies rushed into the store. Their chaotic footsteps and the sounds of shelves being overturned sounded like the death god warning them of their imminent death.

“Quick, quick, quick!!”

“You guys go first!!”

The opportunity was just in front of them, but the warehouse door was just a thin piece of wood and it was very quickly deformed by the zombies.

Zhou Mingxuan leaned back against it, barely supporting it with his body as a shield. He urged loudly, “Go!”

Li Chun followed Duan Wen quickly and hurriedly climbed out of the window which was revealed after blasting open the wall.

But soon, the flimsy warehouse door fell to the ground and countless zombies rushed in. Zhou Mingxuan reacted too late and was instantly overwhelmed by the zombies!

Gunshots sounded and blood splattered.

Tang Le who was already on the verge of breaking down cursed with red eyes, “Fuck you!! This father here will kill you all!!”

Blood and flesh splattered across the warehouse. Song Qinglan’s face was tense. He fired Shen Mian round after round.

After catching his breath, Song Qinglan grabbed Tang Le’s clothes. When he looked back at Ji Yushi, his gaze was filled with force, “Ji Yushi! Take him away!!”

Ji Yushi’s body was completely covered in blood, looking extremely horrible, “There are too many! Let’s go together!!”

Tang Le, whose face was stained with someone’s brain juices, staggered back a few steps from Song Qinglan’s pull.

Song Qinglan killed a new wave of zombies with the gun in one hand while he used the other to push his teammate over, “Didn’t you want to help? Don’t speak nonsense and leave now!! I’ll hold up the fort!”

More and more zombies poured in. There were also zombies attracted to the back alley.

Seeing that Song Qinglan was too busy to take care of anything else, Ji Yushi no longer hesitated. He pushed Tang Le out of the window and closely followed behind him.

Li Chun shouted from a car not far away, “Get in!!”

‘Bang!’



After landing, Ji Yushi killed a zombie rushing over and quickly got in the car with Tang Le.

There were deafening gunshots behind him.

“Where’s Cap Song?!” Ji Yushi heard Duan Wen in the car ask, “Tang Le!! Where’s Cap Song?!”

Intense gunfire in the warehouse stopped abruptly.

Ji Yushi instantly realised something and Song Qinglan’s determined expression floated to his mind.

He immediately turned to look at the window where they had jumped out from. Zombies poured out of it continuously but the domineering Song Qinglan was nowhere in sight.

Duan Wen’s voice changed. It was as if he was crying and also as if he was howling, “Identification card!! Find it!!”

Dozens of zombies surrounded the car, the pounding outside reverberating in everyone’s heart.

In this era, the car had to be unlocked using one’s fingerprint and starting it up the usual way wouldn’t work. Li Chun searched around the car’s storage box while trembling in fear before finally finding a spare identification card.

The car roared and white smoke formed as the tyres spun against the ground. The zombies ahead were hit by the car leaving dark red marks following the collision.

Outside of the back alley, the street as usual was bright and sunny.

The black wall in the distance had become the city’s backdrop.

At this moment, time seemed to have slowed down. Everyone’s faces showed disbelief and their faces were frozen with fear and horror.

Under the sun, a large spacecar suddenly appeared before them.

As soon as they started their escape, they were crushed to pulp and completely wiped out.

**KK has something to say:**

Aaaannnd everyone is dead. THE END! (Just kidding)

# Chapter 7: Chapter 7

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 7

“Everyone get ready. Tianqiong’s seventh squad, the thirteenth A-level mission, let’s go!”

A low male voice sounded in his ears.

It passed through into his mind, numbing his auditory nerves.

【Warning! Warning! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! You have deviated from the destination coordinates!】

The warning light in the capsule flashed nonstop and the transparent panel before him flickered over and over again. White light flashed in front of him and it was followed by a sharp alarm sound.

【Illegal transition detected!】

【Illegal transition detected!】

Something went wrong!!

Ji Yushi gritted his teeth and tried to press the emergency button several times but the capsule continued to spin and jolt around violently. He could only use all his strength to grab the seats armrest to prevent him from being thrown around.

After what felt like a century, the capsule gradually stabilised. As soon as the capsule completely stopped moving, Ju Yushi quickly grabbed the

nutrient solution handed over by a robotic arm and downed it in one go. It took him more than ten seconds to slowly recover.

Wait a second.....

Why did this scene.....give him a feeling of déjà vu?

It was as if he had already experienced it once before.

But that feeling disappeared very quickly. Before Ji Yushi could grab onto its tail, it had faded away.

[? ? p0754%\$#37]

[: “”LRR”/’1’89”]

Indecipherable garbled characters were displayed on the panel. It seemed to be completely broken.

The voices of his teammates could be heard outside the capsule.

Stepping out of the capsule, Ji Yushi saw that the place they had arrived at was a forest. The sky was dark, and the forest was also filled with shadows. Except for the seven capsules which emitted some light, there were no other sources of light here. It was eerie and quiet.

The teammates were complaining about something.

Song Qinglan’s voice sounded, “I told you to sit on the pendulum ten times before the next mission. Tell me the truth, how many times did you do it?”

Another voice answered with some agony, “T-twice....Bleagh ——-”

Turns out, someone was vomiting.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Using the lights from the capsules, he could make out that the person vomiting was Li Chun. Some unknown substances even landed on his

capsule nearby.

Ji Yushi held his breathe and retreated several steps.

He also felt a little sick.

The teammates complaints about Li Chun continued. Ji Yushi stood in the distance, waiting for the smell to dissipate and also waiting for their complaints to end.

Li Chun seemed to have finally finished vomiting. His voice was weak: “.....No, don’t you smell it? The air here smells bad.”

Someone said, “Chun’er, don’t make excuses. Rinse your mouth first.”

“Thanks Brother Wen.....Huh? Where’s Advisor Ji?”

Just as Li Chun asked this, Ji Yushi subconsciously answered, “I’m here.”

He had spoken so quickly it was as if he knew Li Chun was going to ask this.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

That feeling of déjà vu from earlier was back.

Song Qinglan seemed to have glanced in his direction. His expression was cold and then he looked down at the communicator.

Ji Yushi also looked at his communicator.

[1470.8.05 04:41:31]

This clearly wasn’t their intended time coordinate.

Song Qinglan must have also noticed this too. He ordered, “Duan Wen. Check the main control panel and see if there are any data leaks or data hijacking and contact the command centre immediately.”

“Yes.” Duan Wen worked quickly and soon returned to report, “Cap Song, our equipment seems to be locked.”

Ji Yushi walked over.

Equipments are locked?

Song Qinglan’s profile was very attractive. He furrowed his brows, “How is it locked?”

Duan Wen explained, ““The main control panel is offline, and the command centre cannot be contacted. The capsules also don’t work. It seems to be because of the electromagnetic waves here. The magnetic field here seems a little different but it’s still not certain. Perhaps the transition just now had something to do with it. Right now, all that we can use is the communicator. We’re basically trapped here.”

Everyone heard the news and one after another they began to cuss.

“What about the mission?”

“I even said that the mission would be over tomorrow and invited a girl out for dinner.”

“You’ve fucking slagged so many. It’s endless.”

At this moment, footsteps could suddenly be heard from the forest.

Adhering to the principle that a traverser must remain low profile and shouldn’t be discovered by the original residents of the land, everyone quietened down.

Duan Wen who was in charge of the machinery immediately turned off the capsules and changed into a hidden state under his control, turning them completely invisible.

Everyone waited quietly in the forest, motionless.

As the sound of chaotic footsteps approached, Ji Yushi suddenly had a strong hunch.....Sure enough, when he finally adapted to the darkness, he saw that it was a filthy looking drifter.

“Grrr—— grrr——”

The drifter growled strangely and lashed out only to be thrown onto the ground by Li Chun. Soon afterwards, the man lashed out again.

“What the hell?!” Li Chun didn’t expect the other party to fight back. He only felt a strong stench flash by and then it was followed by a sharp pain in his shoulder, “Fuck!!!”

The drifter had left a vicious bite on Li Chun’s shoulder!

With a ‘thud’, the drifter was kicked three or four metres away by Song Qinglan!

Duan Wen supported Li Chun up, asking worriedly, “Chun’er! How are you?!”

Fortunately, the Guardian’s combat uniform had armour on the shoulders. Li Chun hissed in pain. Fortunately, that bite just now only left toothmarks and didn’t seem to have pierced through the skin.

In the darkness, Song Qinglan smoothly subdued the drifter and then raised his chin, “Chun’er, is this someone you have slagged? Seemed to have chased you all the way here.”

Amidst the teammate’s laughter, Li Chun had already tied the man to a tree.

And so Ji Yushi turned on the flashlight and walked over.

Under the strong light from the flashlight, the man’s grey and turbid eyes as well as his pale skin covered in blue-green blood vessels was revealed. There were also blood stains and small pieces of flesh on him which emitted a strong, disgusting stench.

“Grrrr——” The drifter’s expressions were hardly human. He still had his mouth wide open, trying to bite the people around him as he struggled against the rope.

The expressions of the teammates changed.

This scene was too shocking. Ji Yushi however looked on without flinching, as if he wasn’t disturbed by this at all.

Li Chun whispered in a small voice, “I told you the air here smells.”

Song Qinglan frowned. He looked at the man for a while before turning off the flashlight and speaking, “Alright, I should’ve checked my fortune for today before leaving. To think that we broke the record of being discovered by the original residents of the land the fastest. No one is allowed to report about this when we go back. If we get any more points deducted, those bastards in the ninth squad will surpass us.”

He stood up and continued, “For now, leave that person nearby. Someone will naturally find him and call the police. We can’t see anything in this darkness so we will need to get out of here to find a way to contact the Tianqiong in this time period. When we go out, pay attention to your surroundings. Be very vigilant as you may come across a murder scene.”

Everyone: “Yes sir!”

Everyone very efficiently got themselves equipped.

Soon, it was Ji Yushi’s turn to choose his weapon. He chose a pistol he had often used lately in the training rooms.

Song Qinglan stood beside him and said the gun’s name: “Diamond Bird.”

This man was very tall and when he didn’t smile, he would give off oppressiveness that couldn’t be overlooked.

While he was being looked down at like this, Ji Yushi somehow had the urge to continue his words, “Designed after the PPK style from the last century, Hitler and Bond have used it.”



Song Qinglan probably also wanted to say that just now. After being robbed of his words, he raised his brow slightly and appeared a little haughty, “Advisor Ji, you are very retro.”

Ji Yushi was a little surprised: “.....”

What was going on?

Song Qinglan’s words interrupted his thoughts, “If it was me, I would try to choose something that can protect myself better.”

Ji Yushi looked up at him.

“A small suggestion.” Song Qinglan raised his brow slightly and chose a weapon for himself, “But, it suits you.”

Song Qinglan picked up two military knives first. Ji Yushi watched him strap it to his calves. He then watched him choose a pair of gloves, a pair of fist hooks and finally a shotgun. It was all in the order he had predicted.

“Shen Mian?” Ji Yushi spoke up.

Regardless of whether or not he was in the army before, it wasn’t surprising for someone to be able to recognise this famous killing weapon.

Song Qinglan, “Yes, it suits me.”

Before setting off, Song Qinglan suddenly turned around, “Weapons should be used when they need to be used. It is best that they don’t leave your side, but do you know what you should say if you are discovered by the original residents?”

Being looked at by those dark eyes, it was hard not to see the teasing inside.

It seemed to say: You don’t look like a policeman.

Ji Yushi finished his words, “Just say I am the police.”

Walking out of the forest, Ji Yushi discovered that this place was a park.

Along the way, they found a half-eaten corpse under the streetlamp which could explain the blood and the pieces of flesh on the drifter.

Despite the park being in the middle of the most prosperous part of the city, the park at five o'clock in the morning was deserted. Except for the garbage that blew around with the wind and the occasional blood stains on the road, not a living being was seen. There were also no signs of human life in the nearby tall buildings. The entire city was completely dead silent.

Under this eerie atmosphere, everyone lined up and advanced.

“Cap Song, eleven o'clock, park management office.”

As if he was worried about disturbing something, Ji Yushi suddenly spoke up with a suppressed voice.

Ji Yushi had been very quiet the entire time. Song Qinglan looked in the direction he had pointed out.

Ji Yushi wanted to add a line ‘There seemed to be lights inside’ but Song Qinglan spoke first and tilted his head, “Split up. Let’s go and see.”

The teammates scattered around.

Only two were left on the main road; Ji Yushi and Song Qinglan.

A gust of morning wind blew. A few strands of hair on Song Qinglan’s forehead fell loose and his sharp black eyes were slightly squinted.

Ji Yushi was a little nervous. That sense of déjà vu was getting stronger. Could it be that Song Qinglan also.....

He hoped it was the case.

But Song Qinglan went straight to the chase, “Advisor Ji, how is your psychological endurance?”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

His face suddenly turned pale and his heart rate sped up. Like he was seized by a nightmare and trapped inside, he found it difficult to move.

But, it wasn't because Song Qinglan asked that question.

Ji Yushi's external appearance was calm but no one knew that his palms had already turned sweaty. He heard himself answer, "It might not be so good."

Why was this Captain Song who judged books by its cover suddenly starting to care about him?

Was this newcomer treatment?

Song Qinglan looked up at the high-rises in silence and then said, "Being trapped here like this, it's hard to say how long it would take for us to go back. That one at your place might get worried but I hope you can adjust."

Ji Yushi asked, "Cap Song, do you go out of your way to talk to every newcomer during a mission?"

Song Qinglan had no intentions to be polite, "No."

So, it turned out to be a vaccination shot for the 'flower vase'.

Ji Yushi: ".....I understand."

Song Qinglan walked off.

Ji Yushi remained in place for a few seconds, waiting for the chill in his body to fade.

But at this moment, there were still countless noises in his ears. His heart felt like it was about to come out of his throat and for a while he found it difficult to calm down.

"Jian Jian, please wake up.....Do your best. Don't be taken away by it."

"Let's not think about it! Let's not think about it! Jian Jian, look here. These things are new, they have never appeared before. Come, take a look!"

“Ji Yushi, you failed both the image and psychological test this time. Your psychological test results were especially low, and each attempt was worse than the other!”

“Ji Yushi, get a hold of yourself! You must learn to deal with brain overload, or you are not far away from becoming mad!”

“Jian Jian, you have to be able to distinguish between memory and reality. Overlapping memories will not do you any good.”

.....

Park Management Office.

The last one to arrive was Ji Yushi.

Tang Le was reporting: “Cap Song! A corpse was found in the bathroom!”

Song Qinglan found a communicator and was fiddling with it. When he heard the report, he placed it down and went to the bathroom to check.

They turned the corpse over and amidst the rotting stench, Song Qinglan used his military knife to pry open the closed eyelids of the deceased — The physical changes of this corpse were exactly the same as the drifter they had encountered in the forest. Everyone started to discuss about this, and no one noticed that Ji Yushi only glanced at the door before silently walking away.

His eyes scanned over the office. Ji Yushi ignored the messy tabletop, skipped the keys, newspaper, register books etc. and his eyes fell directly onto the communicator.

As if he was guided over, Ji Yushi opened a drawer and found a charger for the communicator inside.

The communicator could finally be turned on.

Ji Yushi only looked at it for a minute or two before suddenly putting it back down!

He quickly scanned the office and found a box of mineral water in the corner.

“What’s wrong?”

Song Qinglan and his teammates returned to the office and just happened to run into this scene.

Ji Yushi held a bottle of mineral water in his hands. His face was extremely pale, his dark eyelashes cast a shadow under his eyes and his entire body was trembling slightly. He looked like he was enduring something.

Little did he know that appearance of his was like a porcelain vase that cannot withstand any hardships and would shatter with a single touch.

In front of everyone, Ji Yushi handed the mineral water to Song Qinglan with no psychological burden. His eyes were clear, “Cap Song, can you help me? I’m feeling a little uncomfortable.”

He seemed to be admitting his vulnerability.

A flower vase needs to be cared for.

Everyone: “.....”

Fuck.

The grass on the grave of the last gay person who did this in front of Song Qinglan has probably started sprouting.

Cannot even unscrew a bottle cap, what kind of man is that?!

Unexpectedly, Song Qinglan just looked at him for a few seconds before unscrewing the lid and handing it back, “Did you find anything?”

Ji Yushi took a sip of water and swallowed a tablet.

“I found the communicator’s charging port in the drawer, and also a video.”

**The author has something to say:**

Ji (weak, cannot unscrew a bottle cap, killing machine) Yushi

Teammates: Damn, so he's really here to seduce Cap Song and prove his charms?!!

# Chapter 8: Chapter 8

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 8

When the video found in the communicator was played by Ji Yushi, everyone shuddered.

The man in the video was also showing signs of change just like the drifter and the management staff just now—— His eyes were grey and turbid, his skin was covered in prominent blue-green blood vessels and he clamoured to tear his wife apart.

“The video was recorded one month ago.”

Unlike the others who expressed shock, Ji Yushi’s tone was calm.

He acted very brave and mature, as if the person who couldn’t unscrew a bottle cap just now wasn’t him.

“Zombies!!”

“If it’s really a zombie, how many of them are out there?!”

“Fuck, no wonder it’s so weird here!”

“That was a video from a month ago!”

Familiar sounding exclamations sounded in the office.

As the teammates discussed, Ji Yushi only silently took another sip of water. Only then did the terrible feeling of powerlessness fade. He spoke slowly,

“The communicator has no internet, but I just received a message. It was probably sent to us.”

“The message was sent to the deceased’s communicator, but the message is for us?”

“Yes.”

“Open it.”

Song Qinglan said.

Ji Yushi turned on the holographic projection.

[Welcome Guardians from Star Era 1456. Welcome to PU-31.]

[The transfer this time has been locked in. Unlocked after mission is successful.]

[Mission mode: Ouroboros.]

[Mission rule: Death elimination]

At this moment, Tang Le shouted, “Everyone, look!”

Outside the window, a black wall suddenly appeared, connecting the sky with the ground. It spread all the way from the direction they had just come from.

“Beep——” The communicator let out a final reminder.

[Mission objective: Chaser of darkness.]

Everyone was horrified.

Amidst all the discussions, Song Qinglan found a broom and poked it into the black wall. When he took it back out, the part of the broom that had pierced through the black wall was completely gone, as if it was ‘eaten up’.



“What did the mission rules say?”

“De-death elimination.” Someone answered.

“It’s good that we know.” Song Qinglan turned to everyone and said sternly, “Pick up your weapons and try not to die on me. Since we can’t go back anyway, let’s figure out what this PU-31 is.”

\*

“What’s wrong with Advisor Ji?”

Duan Wen looked back at Ji Yushi who had already returned to the middle of the team. He stood there, tall and straight, and was very silent. He didn’t look like he was the one who was scared just now by the corpse in the management office.

Through the private communication channel, Song Qinglan suggested lightly, “Ask yourself?”

Duan Wen let out a small sigh, “Forget it. What if he asks me to open a bottle for him?”

Song Qinglan’s tone changed slightly, “So?”

One wouldn’t pluck a hair from a tiger and Duan Wen also didn’t dare joke with his captain, “Uh, I will still help him. It is our responsibility to help our teammates.”

Song Qinglan assessed, “Less useless talk.”

Duan Wen: “In fact, I hope that we can be more friendly by the time we return to write our reports so that our ratings don’t drop because of the team’s disharmony…….”

Duan Wen was still chattering when Song Qinglan suddenly stopped and made a fist gesture.

“Wait.”

His voice sounded in the public channel.

Everyone looked ahead.

On the roads of the deserted and uninhabited city, a group of people appeared.

It was the end of summer. The morning six o'clock sun passed through the concrete forest, casting a golden glow on the charred asphalt road.

The dazzling light was like a dividing line, dividing between the mortal world and hell.

It was a group of zombies.

They didn't notice the small squad quietly approaching in the distance and their attention was on the bloody corpse in the centre. Excited growls emitted from the depths of their throats as they scrambled to eat it like wild beasts.

The flesh, limbs and internal organs were all torn apart and devoured. The terrible sound of chewing could clearly be heard from a distance of only seven or eight metres.

“Ahhh!!!”

A scream sounded.

Behind the squad, a woman frantically rushed out of a building and closely following behind her were twenty or thirty zombies, reaching out trying to tear her apart.

That scream alerted the feasting zombies ahead.

The squad watched those feasting zombies toss the corpse aside and rush over towards them!

“Fuck!”

Someone cursed and soon following that, someone said, “Save her!”

‘Bang, bang, bang’. Several gunshots sounded. Three or four zombies behind the woman fell and at the same time, the other teammates also opened fire at the zombies rushing towards them.

The sound of gunshots echoed through the silent and empty city. Like a drop of water falling into a pan of hot oil, countless zombies emerged from the shadows!

“Go, go, go!!”

“Hurry!!”

The gunfire was deafening.

“Cap Song?!” Duan Wen shouted, “Let’s go!”

Song Qinglan stood in place. He seemed to be waiting for something. His body exuded a compelling aura.

When the woman was just a few steps away, a cold light flashed, and the woman suddenly fell onto her knees, collapsing onto the ground.

With the cover of the teammates, Song Qinglan strode over and pulled out his military knife from the woman’s forehead.

Fresh blood flowed out from the woman’s wide-open eyes. Her grey and turbid eyes were just like those of the zombies that were chasing after her a few seconds ago. Part of her ear was missing and there were also clear tooth marks there.

Song Qinglan stored the knife away. Ji Yushi behind him turned around and accurately shot down a zombie trying to attack him from behind. His actions were smoother and swifter than Song Qinglan’s expectations.

He had thought that he would be more hesitant when shooting down someone for the first time in a real battle.

It was chaotic, like it was the end of the world.

Ji Yushi looked back at the woman on the ground and then looked at Song Qinglan in surprise.

This one look finally confirmed something he had been hesitant about. Ji Yushi's beautiful eyes heated up, as if he finally found some vitality. He shouted loudly, "To the left! Convenience store! Hurry!"

There were more and more zombies. They poured out continuously in all directions.

They weren't too far from the convenience store and could clearly see its metal barrier.

Quickly finding a hideout bought them a lot of time.

Everyone worked together and quickly hurried over to the convenience store under the rain of bullets.

Without even looking, Ji Yushi shot at the shop's identification panel. Amid the harsh alarm, Li Chun and Zhou Mingxuan worked together to lift open the metal barrier.

As soon as it was enough for someone to roll through, Ji Yushi quickly slipped through like a slippery fish.

"Bang, bang, bang, bang, bang!"

Suddenly, several gunshots came from inside.

The gunfire subsided.

Ji Yushi reappeared behind the metal barrier. His pale face was stained with blood and there were even droplets hanging from his eyelashes.

He was panting slightly, and his voice was unstable, "Get in!"

Everyone: "???"

When everyone entered the convenience store one after another, they were met with a pile of fresh corpses. Everyone: “.....”

Was this really the Advisor Ji who couldn't even unscrew a bottle cap?!

The convenience store was a complete mess and the shelves had been ransacked. Besides that, it was safe — The danger had already been single-handedly dealt with in a blink of an eye by Ji Yushi.

That speed and decisiveness, it was almost like he had known about this in advance.

In all honesty, even the best Guardian was at this level at best.

Everyone suddenly felt like they should give intelligence some respect.

“Where's Cap Song?!” Zhou Mingxuan suddenly asked.

Only Li Chun, Duan Wen and Ji Yushi were there. The twins and Song Qinglan were not around.

Ji Yushi frowned, “Open the door and wait for them!”

As soon as he said that, rapid gunfire sounded outside the store.

Song Qinglan pushed Tang Le into the shop under everyone's cover.

Tang Le's expression was dazed while Song Qinglan's was pale. The barrier was once again pulled down with a ‘clang’. Someone shouted, “We still have to wait for Tang Qi!”

“No need to wait.” Song Qinglan stood up, his body covered in blood and dirt, “Tang Qi was bitten. After being infected, the mutation time....took no more than ten seconds.”

Tang Le cried bitterly.

No one knew what happened to them outside. Everyone was shocked when they heard this answer.

Close at hand, countless zombies slapped at the metal barrier, growling loudly with wide open mouths. Their grey eyes stared stubbornly into the store, as if they would suddenly rush into the store the next second and tear them to pieces.

Ten seconds.

The speed of the virus spreading was very fast.

Coupled with the 100% mutation rate after being bitten, no city in the world would have the ability to defend against such a virus.

“We can’t hang around. This barrier won’t last long.” Song Qinglan’s voice was cold, “There is a fake wall in the store’s warehouse. Blast that open and get out from there.”

Ji Yushi sharply turned his head.

The eyes of the two happened to meet.

Now wasn’t the time to chat. The eyes on Ji Yushi’s bloody face was exceptionally bright.

Song Qinglan remained calm and composed but his question carried profound meaning, “Advisor Ji, what’s behind the wall?”

Ji Yushi clenched his fists, his nails digging into his palms.

In front of his ignorant teammates, he also answered calmly, “Back alley.”

Everyone else had no idea what was going on and they didn’t understand what riddle the two were playing, but as long as there was a way out, they shouldn’t waste time caring about anything else.

The metal barrier was on its last legs. It swayed and made some terrible noises. They must race against time to escape from here.

The wall was blasted away with everyone firing at it at the same time. Light poured in.

After the last teammate jumped out, there was a ‘bang’ and the metal barrier finally fell.

Zhou Mingxuan opened fire at the zombies in the back alley, covering his other teammates, “Get in the car!!”

Song Qinglan stuffed Tang Le who was almost on the brink of break down into the back seat.

The zombies rushed into the convenience store and followed them out through the opening in the warehouse they had just escaped out from.

Zhou Mingxuan also got in the car. With six big men suddenly crammed into a not-so-wide car, it was a tight fit.

They could only hear Duan Wen shout, “Identification card!! Find it!”

Tang Le was squeezed between Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi.

But it was close enough for Song Qinglan to see the small baby hairs on the back of Ji Yushi’s neck under the sunlight entering through the car window.

Ji Yushi squeezed over to open the storage box and handed the identification card over, “Here!”

Li Chun in the driver’s seat took the card and hurriedly started the car and drove out.

The car roared and white smoke formed as the tyres spun against the ground. The zombies ahead were hit by the car leaving dark red marks following the collision.

They rushed out of the back alley.

Before they could breath a sigh of relief, Ji Yushi’s expression suddenly changed when they reached a certain intersection. He shouted, “Turn left!!!”

Not far away, a large spacecar suddenly appeared before them.

Ji Yushi had shouted in time and this shout made Li Chun reflexively turn the steering wheel, driving the car into a building.

“Bang bang bang——-!!”

The car braked sharply and the several glass doors that were rammed through trembled before finally stopping.

After a moment of silence, Song Qinglan kicked the back of the driver’s seat: “Chun’er, I don’t seem to remember you getting a driver’s licence.”

Li Chun was helpless, “I’m not talking back boss but now isn’t the time to care about those details.”

Everyone: “.....”



# Chapter 9: Chapter 9

The inside of the building was very dark and there was only light at the entrance.

From the location the car stopped at inside the building, they could make out two words on the wall in the centre of the lobby with some difficulty: Runjin Building. On the left was the layout of the building engraved onto a metal panel. They could roughly guess that this was a building for both commercial and residential use.

The smooth marble floor in the lobby was stained with blood and there were some bloody handprints on the walls. The glass from the glass doors broken through by the car and rubbish were scattered across the floor. Apart from that, there was nothing else.

“How is everyone?” Song Qinglan asked inside the car, “Anyone hurt?”

The front of the car was severely damaged making it even more difficult to move in the already crowded back seats.

Song Qinglan’s voice was very close and it sounded right next to Ji Yushi’s ear, much like the first time he heard it on the public channel.

“I’m fine.” Ji Yushi answered.

Except for Ji Yushi, no one knew what happened before and no one seemed to have memories of their last death.

Just now with the spacecar suddenly appearing and death almost seizing him once again, his adrenaline rose to an all-time high and his heart sped up. Even when the car braked and his head hit the back of the driver’s seat, he didn’t feel it.

“I’m also okay.”

“I’m fine.”

.....

Duan Wen’s voice from the passenger seat was painful, “My....my leg seems to be stuck.”

Li Chun let out a curse, “Hurry and help! Brother Wen is stuck!”

“Grrrr.....”

A faint sound travelled over.

The building was deserted and the dark corridors stretched endlessly. It made it hard to tell which direction that sound came from, but it definitely wasn’t far from them.

The car crashed into the building just now and the commotion was too loud so it must have alerted the nearby zombies. This building may appear deserted but there are many zombies hidden within.

Duan Wen’s left leg was firmly trapped. When his teammates tried to move the part trapping his leg, the pain was unbearable.

“You guys go first. Don’t worry about me!”

The zombie’s sounds were getting closer. Duan Wen panted heavily, and his forehead was covered in cold sweat, “Go!”

“How could we leave you!?”

“Hang in there, Brother Wen!”

Song Qinglan inserted Shen Mian into the gap and motioned for Li Chun to protect Duan Wen’s knee.

Even in a situation like this, he remained calm and decisive. He only said quickly, “Less nonsense. Hang in there. Even if your leg is broken, we’re leaving together!”

The absolute trust developed after going through many missions together made Duan Wen willingly accept his captain’s order. Hearing his words, he gritted his teeth and nodded, “.....Okay.”

“Hurry!” Zhou Mingxuan urged as he looked around vigilantly with his gun raised.

The footsteps in the corridor grew louder and louder and more and more hasty. There were even growls sounding very close at hand.

“Bang, bang, bang!”

Someone opened fire and several zombies fell as blood splattered around them.

But this corridor seemed like it led to hell. Very soon, more growls and footsteps could be heard and the number of zombies that appeared were several times more than it was earlier!

“Hurry up!!” Li Chun was so anxious, his eyes were red. He shouted, “Cap Song!”

The pitch black Shen Mian was used as a lever.

Because of the force he was exerting, blue veins appeared on Song Qinglan’s forehead and the muscles on his arm became more defined. The car slowly began to let out a low groan.

“AHH—”

Along with an uncontrollable cry of agony, Duan Wen’s leg was finally freed. It was completely bloody and the wound was so deep, the bone underneath was visible.

Li Chun’s hand trembled, “Brother Wen!”

Duan Wen face was extremely pale. Li Chun supported him out. Song Qinglan shouted, “Go!”

Five people plus one wounded fought while retreating. When they came, their impact shattered the glass and the corridor on the left was also blocked. Zombies poured in continuously. The squad was like a headless prey thrown into a trap. It could be said that they had just left a tiger’s den only to enter a wolf’s den!

Amidst the gunshots, waves of zombies were shot to death. The building was like a maze with nowhere to escape.

With a thud, someone knocked open the fire door.

Tang Le who had been silent for a long time shouted, “Here!”

Everyone retreated into the emergency staircase. The emergency lights turned on, no one was inside.

But very quickly, there was a commotion below. Everyone’s expression changed. A group of zombies had rushed up from below!

“Grrr——”

“Grrr——”

At this moment, the zombies following them poured through the fire door. Under the orange emergency lights, these pale faced humans looked like they were soaked in blood. Together with the large group coming from downstairs, their paths were blocked!

Gunshots sounded rapidly. Blood, flesh and brain matter stained the white walls.

The group retreated to the second floor. Zhou Mingxuan opened the door and swore, “What the fuck?! It’s an exchange office! Even during this age, there are people fucking coming out to handle that?!”

The second floor was completely filled with zombies who couldn't find an exit. The number couldn't be estimated.

Tang Le and Zhou Mingxuan quickly closed the door again, ignoring the loud banging on the door and then locked it shut with a chain, "Go up!"

"Can't go up!" Zhou Mingxuan multitasked and blasted at the zombies chasing after them from below while shouting, "It might be a dead end!"

"Going down is already not an option!" Tang Le roared, "Now what do we do?!"

Everyone had no choice but to retreat. When they reached the fourth floor, Ji Yushi suddenly said, "Go to the sixth floor!"

Li Chun who carried Duan Wen was almost in tears. He was in disbelief, "Up again?!"

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth and shot. The zombies in front of him scrambled over the corpses that were piling up. There was no end in sight. He shouted, "Go!"

"Clang!"

The fire door on the sixth floor was knocked open. It was quiet.

With the light coming in from the emergency staircase, a zombie was spotted as soon as it rushed out from the darkness and it was shot dead by Zhou Mingxuan who was at the front, leading the squad.

"Close the door!"

"Find something to barricade it!"

A flashlight turned on in the darkness and a noise followed.

Song Qinglan's hearing was sharp and he quickly ordered in a low voice, "Quiet!"

Under the chaotic flashlight beam, a female zombie appeared from around the corner.

“Swoosh——” A hole appeared on the zombie’s head. Her grey eyes widened and she then collapsed onto the ground.

Ji Yushi’s black eyes were bright. In his hands was the white Diamond Bird which had a silencer installed at some unknown point in time.

There were some sounds of impact coming from the fire door behind them which were mixed with the zombie’s growls.

The silencer solution made it difficult for the zombies to find them. They only lingered outside the door for a while before their chaotic and frenzied footsteps quickly moved further up the building.

They were temporarily safe.

The light was bright and a little dazzling. Tang Le had found the power switch on the wall.

The decorations here were very exaggerated; crystal lamps, pink cotton candy-like sofas, marble and glass walls. This group of straight men couldn’t understand what kind of place this was.

“High class beauty salon.” Ji Yushi stored away his gun, “Usually not many people here.”

Zhou Mingxuan suddenly raised his laser gun at him and squinted his eyes. The next second a zombie fell not far behind him.

Ji Yushi looked back and calmly gave his thanks, “Thank you.”

Zhou Mingxuan bowed.

Together with Li Chun, Song Qinglan had already set Duan Wen down on the sofa. Very quickly, the blood soaked through it. Duan Wen had lost too much blood, his legs were bent at an unnatural angle and he was completely unconscious.

Li Chun was in charge of logistics and he was also responsible for simple first aid in the team. Seeing this situation, his eyes couldn't help but turn hot, "The medical kit was lost while fighting against the zombies! I'm really useless!"

Song Qinglan was calmer than Li Chun. He said to everyone, "Stop the bleeding first and find a clean towel! Then see if there is a first aid kit here!"

Everyone: "Yes sir!"

As they busily searched around, Zhou Mingxuan asked, "Advisor Ji, how did you know that this is a beauty salon?"

Ji Yushi said, "There was a floor map downstairs."

As if he wasn't used to taking into consideration whether or not others could understand his words, he paused and added another sentence, "It was next to the building sign."

Zhou Mingxuan also remembered. There was indeed a map next to the two words 'Runjin Building' but ordinary people would only briefly glance at it, let alone remember details of each of the floors.

On their way here, Zhou Mingxuan's attitude towards Ji Yushi had changed considerably. Hearing him say this now, if his mood wasn't low, he would've sincerely complimented him.

They soon found a first aid kit and Li Chun also found a towel.

In a situation like this, Li Chun didn't have a needle to use so he could only temporarily wrap Duan Wen's left leg with bandages and the towel.

Finally having barely stopped Duan Wen's bleeding, Song Qinglan's hands were covered in blood and his forehead was coated with sweat. He looked around for a while before his eyes fell onto Tang Le.

Tang Le sat in the corner, staring dazedly into the distance. It was as if he had only temporarily come alive for a moment earlier.

Song Qinglan looked at Tang Le solemnly for a few seconds and seemed to have something to say but in the end, he only turned and asked, “Where is Advisor Ji?”

Zhou Mingxuan was a little surprised. He pointed in the direction of the bathroom, “Went that way.”

\*

Morning 7:40am.

The bathroom in this high-class beauty salon was spacious and bright with four princess-style washstands arranged in a circle, carpet on the floor and scented candles. You could smell the fragrance as soon as you walked in.

But at this moment, there was a faint smell of blood mixed in and there were a few blood-stained tissues scattered on the carpet.

There was a sound of water.

Song Qinglan circled around the washstands before he found Ji Yushi at the innermost part of the bathroom.

Ji Yushi was washing his face or more exactly, he was rinsing out his entire head.

The water turned pink as it mixed with the blood and it drained out into the basin. The tips of his hair and his eyelashes still dripped with water and his soaked skin looked paler than usual making the raised bump on his forehead appear even more conspicuous — It was from the impact in the car.

Through the mirror, Ji Yushi also saw him, “Cap Song.”

In that fierce battle, everyone had basically rolled around with the zombies. Unlike the Guardians who are a bunch of unruly men, Ji Yushi liked cleanliness very much. This was something everyone could see.



The strange thing was that even after seeing that Ji Yushi wasn't actually useless, let alone a flower vase that had joined to easily clear an A-level mission like he had imagined him to be, this appearance of his still made him look weak and vulnerable.

Song Qinglan pointed at his forehead in the mirror and asked casually, "Are you okay?"

Ji Yushi answered, "I'm okay. How is Duan Wen?"

Song Qinglan, "Broke his left leg and damaged his artery. I'm afraid that leg cannot be saved."

Ji Yushi's actions stopped.

Song Qinglan, "Push through. We will push through no matter what. It's better than not returning."

Too many things had happened, and everything had happened too quickly.

They were caught off-guard and forced into their current situation. First, it was Tang Qi and then it was Duan Wen and now they're in their current predicament.

But if.....

Probably having thought of the same things, the two fell silent at the same time but no one spoke about that uncertain possibility.

Song Qinglan didn't come here for small talk. He soon went straight to the point, "Advisor Ji, how did you know that there is a back alley behind the warehouse?"

Ji Yushi put down the towel, "Then how did Cap Song know where the fake wall is?"

"When that woman suddenly changed in front of me, I suddenly remembered."

“What a coincidence, me too.”

Judging from the current situation, only the two of them remembered what happened last time.

Song Qinglan crossed his arms. He spoke in a casual tone, “If I’m not crazy, I remember you should have escaped with the others in the car.”

Ji Yushi nodded, “Yes but we were unlucky. Not long after escaping, we were hit and killed by the spacecar we just saw.”

It seems that the death from last time was not a good memory for either of them.

Seeing that his sacrifice didn’t help, Song Qinglan let out a low curse, “Looks like we’re both not crazy.”

Song Qinglan opened the faucet and washed away the blood on his hands.

The bones on those large hands of his were distinct and well defined. Blood had even stained his nails. It was unknown if it was Duan Wen’s or someone else’s.

Before going out, Song Qinglan paused. He turned back and his dark eyes were deep, as if he wanted to see through Ji Yushi’s inner thoughts.

“By the way Ji Yushi, do you remember the mission mode?”

“I remember. It’s Ouroboros.”

Ji Yushi suddenly realised something. In western legends, Ouroboros represented cycle.

It was just like their current predicament!

Song Qinglan suddenly brought up this topic and, after seeing Ji Yushi’s reaction, he then gently dropped it and reminded, “We still don’t have any clues. No one knows whether our guess is correct or not. If it is wrong, the

outcome may not be salvageable so I hope it can be kept a secret for the time being.”

Song Qinglan’s black combat uniform was covered with dark red blood stains. As if he was annoyed by Ji Yushi’s dawdling, he said, “Anyway, hurry and gather at the hall so that we can discuss what to do next.”

Two minutes later, Ji Yushi returned to the hall and threw something at Song Qinglan.

It was the famous killing weapon that was used as a lever earlier and then used to hold the fire door in place—— Shen Mian.

The fire door was fastened shut with an axe Ji Yushi later found.

In front of everyone, Ji Yushi didn’t act like a subordinate and his tone was serious, “Weapons should be used when they need to be used. It is best that they don’t leave your side.”

Everyone: “.....”

He had just asked for him to open a bottle cap earlier and now he dared to boss someone around. Advisor Ji was really getting braver and braver.

Those words entering Song Qinglan’s ears sounded familiar, as if he had said it last time at the park management office.

Ji Yushi this person, really was someone who would not let a single grievance go unreturned.

# Chapter 10: Chapter 10

A pocket drone the size of a bee flew out from the window and hovered over the city. During its flight, real-time images were transmitted to Ji Yushi's communicator and then projected as a holographic image to view.

"There are still survivors in the city." Zhou Mingxuan pointed to the image, "Look, there is smoke here!"

On the image, the city's appearance gradually appeared.

Deserted streets and damaged roads, everywhere were signs that civilisation had vanished from this city. Like the place they're currently located, there were only traces of zombies in the other streets.

"There must still be survivors. Weren't we almost hit by that spacecar just now?"

Li Chun said this and was unable to hide his anger and regret.

"Dammit, if it wasn't for that spacecar, Brother Wen wouldn't have been hurt to this extent.....I really should've done better!"

Ji Yushi said, "I was the one who warned you too late."

Li Chun opened his mouth awkwardly for a moment before finally saying, "Advisor Ji, I didn't mean it that way."

"Alright, he also didn't mean it that way."

Song Qinglan looked at the location pointed out by Zhou Mingxuan through a pair of binoculars thought the window. In the scene projected, there were three or four people stacking burnable material into a big blue metal bucket

and a large 'SOS' was painted on the floor with white paint. They were clearly calling for help.

"The survivors also can only wait for their deaths."

Not far away, the black wall that could swallow anything in its path sat there quietly.

They had zombies in front and the black wall behind them. These people were just like them, barely surviving while trapped in the middle, not knowing when their lives would come to an end.

Please read this from kk translates

As far as they could see, countless zombies wandered in and out of various buildings, communities, subway entrances and the likes. When there was no 'prey' nearby, these zombies moved like normal people, neither fast nor slow, and just wandered aimlessly around. As more and more zombies appeared on the streets, for a moment it looked like a lively New Year's Eve day.

Song Qinglan observed the situation for a few minutes and frowned, "These zombies still retain their social habits?"

Zhou Mingxuan received the binoculars and looked. He also noticed this, "That's strange. Are they going home to sleep and then wandering the streets early in the morning?! Do they love daily lives that fucking much?!"

On the black wall end, sunlight filled the city.

Song Qinglan looked at the drone footage from Ji Yushi's communicator and his cold expression turned serious and thoughtful.

When they were at the Park Management Office, Song Qinglan had used his military knife to pry open the eyelids of the corpse in there. That was the moment he got closest to a zombie. As the turbid grey eyes appeared in Song Qinglan's mind, he suddenly came to a realisation, "It's light."

Everyone looked at him.

Song Qinglan said, “We arrived here at 4:30 in the morning. Except for the drifter, we didn’t encounter any large groups of zombies outside at first and it was only when the sun came out——”

Song Qinglan didn’t need to say more.

The first wave of zombies the squad encountered was when the first ray of sunlight appeared in the city.

“Look.” Song Qinglan pointed to the projection, “Zombies like to travel in groups. Many of the places they walk out of are underground passages, subway stations, buildings and the likes. Most of these places are brightly lit all night.”

“I suspect that this virus invades their optic nerves, causing eye damage. They are unable to see things and therefor have a strong reaction to light. In addition to relying on sound and smell, they would follow their shared instinct to chase after the light to go to a brighter place.”

Hearing their captain’s analysis, everyone felt like they were enlightened.

Li Chun looked up at the crystal lamp in the hall and then walked over to turn it off.

Everyone acquiesced to this act of his.

But then, another question came.

Ji Yushi asked, “If these zombies chasing after light can barely be called a chaser of light then what does it mean by the mission objective ‘chaser of darkness’?”

This question was temporarily unsolvable. No one could answer.

Zhou Mingxuan thought for a while, “Then would it be safer to go out at night since these things will go back to their lair at night?”

“Not necessarily.” Song Qinglan said, “Not all zombies will gather underground, there will always be some who stay outside. Compared to

sensitivity to light, those zombies are more sensitive to sound and smell. Did you forget about the struggle we had in the emergency staircase just now?”

Li Chun, “Oh yeah. They may be blind but they’re fast!!”

Song Qinglan said, “The most important thing is, no matter how you look at it, we can’t stay here for long.”

In the hall, Duan Wen was still unconscious.

They had to find a pharmacy to get Duan Wen medicine or, let alone the leg, his life might not be saved.

Song Qinglan was a very practical person. After using a short amount of time to sort out his thoughts, he enlarged the projection of the building they were currently in, “Besides, we are currently in an advantageous position.”

“Yang Le and Zhou Mingxuan looked around earlier. Apart for the out of order elevator, Runjin Building has a total of four emergency staircases.”

“The one on the left corridor is blocked and the one we came up through just now naturally cannot be used. This means there are only two to choose from; northeast or southeast . We may perhaps get lucky.”

“Go down the emergency staircase and it would directly lead you to the underground passage—— Right now, almost all the zombies are outside in the streets so being underground should be relatively safer. The underground passage should be connected to the main road and that should be a groundfloor exit.”

Song Qinglan drew a green line on the holographic map and quickly analysed it.

“According to the real-time situation recorded by the drone, after exiting through that place, we can take the route with the least number of zombies and find a pharmacy or hospital as soon as possible. This was the most ideal way to break through. The only question is: Which staircase to choose?”

Li Chun: “One in two, 50% success rate.”

Zhou Mingxuan elbowed him, “Why didn’t you say that if you chose the wrong one in two chance, you will die?”

Li Chun looked at Tang Le and then winked at Zhou Mingxuan, “Old Zhou, you shouldn’t say that. We should always think positive!”

As he said that, the drone project suddenly flashed and the screen went black.

A notice appeared on the projection: [Warning. Drone offline.]

“Fuck!!! The black wall is moving closer!” Zhou Mingxuan walked to the window and checked himself. He could only let out small curse, “We have to hurry and go!!”

Everyone was startled.

Sure enough, the black wall had indeed silently started to spread at some unknown point in time. Right now, it was almost about to reach the street with the convenience store. Not only did the drone get ‘eaten’, the wall seemed to be about to reach them!

Originally, the images sent over by the drone needed to be synchronised to generate the map so there was a few minutes delay in time difference. They didn’t expect their plan to suddenly go up in smoke so quickly!

Song Qinglan couldn’t help but slam his hand onto the desk.

Please read this from kk translates

Ji Yushi checked the memory storage: “It’s okay, I remembered the road map. I can draw out the map to the closet pharmacy and hospital.”

“The scene was only shown very briefly and there are countless streets out there but you’re saying that you can draw it out?” Song Qinglan suppressed his rage and raised his brow slightly, “Aren’t you being too confident?”



Ji Yushi looked at the black wall and then at the time on the communicator:  
“And if I can draw it out?”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

Knowing that he was in a hurry, Ji Yushi continued, “Won’t need to draw too much, just drawing out the most suitable route should be enough. Give me five minutes.”

Everyone: “???”

Is Advisor Ji crazy?!

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It didn’t even take Ji Yushi five minutes to finish drawing the map.

At first everyone thought he was just spouting nonsense. After all, how could someone remember all those unfamiliar roads and their road conditions with just one glance? But as the map became more and more complete, and the details of the roads in the north, south, east and west directions were drawn out, everyone no longer dared to underestimate Ji Yushi anymore.

When the map was finally complete, Song Qinglan scanned it hastily and then sent it to everyone else’s communicator. He spoke very quickly, “Split up and meet at the agreed place if you get separated. Go to the pharmacy and, where circumstances permit, try to find bandages, anti-inflammatory medications, splints and the likes. If you see the black wall, run. Those zombies are nothing compared to the black wall.”

Everyone: “Understood!”

It was dark outside the window. The black wall covered the sky, looking like it was about to envelop the city.

Zombies were gathered in the building and there were even more outside on the streets. Over the two years since its establishment, the Seventh Squad

had never found themselves in such a predicament where they were pushed into a dead end.

Li Chun: “Tang Le and I will go southeast!”

Zhou Mingxuan said with a gun on his back, “Then Captain, Advisor Ji and I will take Old Duan northeast!”

“Fuck this PU-31, fuck the black wall and the zombies. If I die, remember to burn an address for me!” Li Chun wiped his eyes. The expression on this big boy’s face was resolute, “And burn a couple of girls too!” (KKnotes: Not literally LOL. Li Chun here is probably referring to burning paper offerings. Sometimes people burn paper cars or houses etc believing that it can be sent to the afterlife for the deceased to use.)

“Get lost you. You’re not afraid of embarrassing yourself in front of Advisor Ji?”

Li Chun spat, “Pei. Maybe Advisor Ji would even ask you to burn a macho man for him.”

Everyone pushed and shoved him.

Even at this moment, Ji Yushi didn’t feel that they were being silly.

He raised his eyes and looked at Song Qinglan. How did the other party manage to get these people into his squad?

“Alright, this brother will burn eight for you.”

Duan Wen’s voice suddenly travelled through the public channel.

Hearing that he was awake, everyone quickly returned to the hall but were all left shocked.

Except for the dark red blood stain on the sofa, Duan Wen was nowhere in sight!

Song Qinglan realised something, “Duan Wen!!”

The captain's anger no longer scared Duan Wen. He continued to speak through the public channel, "I have a fever. Only death awaits me even if I go out so it's better to make a contribution instead. What the hell is this damned mission, tsk."

A noise could be heard from Duan Wen's end.

As for what that sound was, everyone knew immediately.

"Brother Wen! Where are you?!"

"Old Duan, where the hell did you go"

Duan Wen said, "Stop chattering ladies. This one here is helping you save time."

"No need to split up."

"Captain, this road is blocked. Take the northeast emergency staircase. Hurry, the black wall is coming."

Chaotic footsteps could be heard through the communicator.

"Grrrrr——"

"Bang!" A gunshot sounded.

# Chapter 11: Chapter 11

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 11

“Grrrr——”

“Bang, bang, bang!!”

The back door of the off-road car opened, and fires were shot from the back seat. The heads of another group of zombies splattered open and their bodies collapsed onto the ground. Bright red blood pooled together, flowing into the sewer.

The underground passage was a complete mess. The various lights scattered around flickered on and off.

The car rushed towards the direction of the exit. It crossed through the darkness, crossed through the depressive gloom and crossed through the group of zombies wandering around the underground passage. Through the sea of stiff and pale hands, it rushed into the blinding sunlight —— Everything brightened up. The sun at 9:30am in summer made the car heat up but everyone’s heart was cold.

The exit of the underground passage was getting further and further away.

“Boom!” The off-road car ran into a zombie. Trails of blood trickled down the windshield.

Zhou Mingxian’s driving skills were top notch.

The main road was filled with zombies and there were also the occasional abandoned vehicle and wreckage. The car suddenly tilted over to an extremely tricky angle to navigate through a difficult corner before speeding on.

Song Qinglan sat in the passenger seat with Shen Mian blasting open zombie heads one after another. Through the rear-view mirror, Ji Yushi could only see Song Qinglan's tense jawline as well as the slender fingers that would pull the trigger from time to time.

No one in the car spoke.

They charged through the thick wave of zombies ahead leaving trails of blood behind and finally managed to lose them behind.

The Runjin Building grew smaller and smaller in the rear-view mirror.

Gradually, it was engulfed by the gigantic black wall, disappearing into the darkness, no longer to be seen again.

Moving away from the prosperous city centre, the number of zombies wandering the roads became visibly less. There were even occasionally traces left by survivors calling for help.

Song Qinglan stored Shen Mian away and then took out a half-finished packet of cigarette from the car's glovebox. He lit it and held it outside the window but didn't smoke it.

In the back seat, Li Chun couldn't help but sob, "Before we set out on this mission, Brother Wen even said he wanted to see what the cigarette would taste like in Xijing City after so many years and see if it has gotten any better."

"But in the end we didn't make it to the Xijing in 1460 and he never managed to try it...."

"It has only been a few hours and we've already lost two people. What is this damned task? Isn't this just sending us to our deaths? So damned

unlucky to end up in this god forsaken place. The A-level mission has turned into hell-level!!”

Although Duan Wen had used his life to exchange for a way out for them, they still had to go through a fierce battle in the northeast emergency staircase. One could only imagine what it was like for Duan Wen on his end. Li Chun was on the younger end. Having narrowly escaped death once again and again losing his teammate, he could no longer control his emotions.

Ji Yushi noticed that Tang Le’s eyes were also red.

Ji Yushi never had any teammates before and had always acted alone so although he wanted to comfort him, he found that he couldn’t say a single word.

He wasn’t very good at expressing his emotions.

“Endure.” Song Qinglan said, “Endure until this mission is over. Don’t let them die in vain. Once we get back, we’ll go find those bastards and figure out why this happened and if it’s a bug or something done deliberately. If they don’t give me an answer, I’ll make the entire group of personnel there take a day trip in those capsules.”

Everyone was silent.

Song Qinglan added, “Also, no matter what happens next, no one is to fucking act on your own. Sacrificing yourself is a foolish act and shouldn’t be done again. There is nothing more important than surviving. There are still many other things our team needs to do, no need to rush to your death.”

Still no one spoke.

Song Qinglan extinguished the cigarette and threw it out the window, “Do you understand?!”

“Yes!”

“Understood.”

“Bang! Bang!”

Zhou Mingxuan ran into another two zombies one after another. As the car drove away, they could see new zombies appear from a shop behind, chasing after the car.

“Fuck——-” He cursed, “A child.”

There was a small figure amongst the group of zombies. That zombie had her hair in a pair of braids and she carried a doll wearing a red dress in her arms.

“.....Such a small zombie.”

Tang Le said, “Zombies don’t care if you’re an adult or a child.”

Just like how the black wall swallows everything up indiscriminately.

“There was an old movie where the heroine’s husband mutated into a zombie and bit his daughter first.” For some reason Tang Le suddenly raised this topic, “Once mutated, there was no reason or humanity left. The plot of that movie is actually a bit similar to our situation earlier, they were also forced to hide in a building but theirs was a shopping mall, so they at least have lots of food. Since they also aren’t in a hurry to do their tasks, they stayed there for several months.”

“Dawn of the Dead.” The one who spoke was Ji Yushi, “But it was the heroine’s daughter who bit the heroine’s husband first.”

Tang Le froze for a moment, “Was it? I just happened to see parts of it because Tang Qi was the one watching. Advisor Ji also watched it?”

Ji Yushi regretted joining the conversation a little, “Classmate was watching it and accidentally saw.”

Song Qinglan picked up a pair of binoculars and looked ahead and then looked at the map, “Advisor Ji, why aren’t we taking the main road?”

Ji Yushi explained. “There is a roadblock 400 metres ahead and there is also a damaged spacecar occupying the road.”

With a rumble, the car soon exited the alley and passed by the main road. Sure enough, there was a roadblock at the intersection.

The drone image was taken from a high altitude and it was also moving very fast. It required very careful observation to see something like this.

Once they passed through an alley, they passed a bridge.

The scenes they saw along the way were all similar, it was either zombies or more zombies.

Speeding across all this way, the car was now almost completely scrapped. Blood and flesh were everywhere on the doors and windows and there would also occasionally be strands of zombie hair still attached to the scalp fluttering in the air.

“Where are we going?”

The silent Zhou Mingxuan finally asked.

This question was a little depressing.

In this world called PU-31, apart from choosing a place with fewer zombies and a little further away from the black wall, they seemed to have nowhere they could go.

Ji Yushi glanced out the window, “Turn left ahead and go down that road for two kilometres. There is a bookstore on the side. It’s on a small slope so it will be good for watching over the situation from there.”

Bookstore?

In an age like this, paper books had long become redundant. Humans nowadays only need to press their communicator to project all the information they needed. Opening a bookstore during a time like this was a



completely crazy idea. It wouldn't even have a big enough niche market to cater for.

Song Qinglan looked at him through the rear-view mirror, "Then to the bookstore."

\*

10:20AM

Sure enough, just as Ji Yushi had said, there really was a bookstore there. Clearly, even during these desperate times, it wasn't a place others considered taking refuge in. From the first floor to the second floor, towering shelves filled with books reached the ceiling. It made people feel like they had gone back to a century ago.

Behind the counter was a dead elderly staff. With wide open grey eyes and a mouth filled with false teeth, even after infection one could tell that he was once a kind, old man.

Song Qinglan turned him over and placed him in a chair.

Ji Yushi saw this scene and then quickly looked away.

The store was very large. The teammates patrolled through the store separately only to report back that there was no one else except for this old man. Their journey had been too smooth. There weren't even many zombies encountered in this block. Having experienced everything that had happened earlier, everyone felt that it was too easy.

"The black wall won't be able to reach us for a while. We can stay here for a few hours." Song Qinglan said, "The second floor has a high view. We will use the second floor as our base. It will also allow us to spot zombies immediately if they break in. We need to find something to eat now."

"I'll go." Zhou Mingcuan carried his laser gun, "Along the way I'll scout out the surroundings. You guys be careful."

"I'll go with you." Tang Le said.

In the end, Li Chun also went. Of the five, two remained. Only Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi were left.

Such an arrangement was rare. Ji Yushi wasn't very accustomed to being alone with another person. Fortunately, Song Qinglan said, "I'll see if I can find anything here."

The two moved separately.

Song Qinglan found some electronic devices. Because there was no internet, nothing was gained from that. When he returned to the original place again, Ji Yushi was already gone.

Bookshelves were arranged row after row.

Ji Yushi stood in the corner holding a bottle of mineral water he had procured from who knows where. His throat moved as he swallowed something.

The next second, Ji Yushi's wrist was grabbed.

"Advisor Ji," Song Qinglan asked, "What is this?"

In Ji Yushi's hand was a small rectangular box of medicine.

Being asked like this, he furrowed his brows and immediately pulled his arms back. Song Qinglan was caught off-guard, allowing him to successfully break free, but he quickly moved in to snatch the box. Ji Yushi felt the movement behind him. He suddenly landed on his knees and bent his back to an incredible angle such that he was almost pressed against the ground as he avoided Song Qinglan's hands.

He knew that he wasn't Song Qinglan's opponent in close combat. After narrowly dodging, he got up and tried to escape but Song Qinglan reacted extremely quickly, grabbing his shoulder with his iron-like grip.

Ji Yushi fought back, Song Qinglan leaned back to dodge. There was another gust of wind and Ji Yushi's fist was intercepted by Song Qinglan.

Relying on his height advantage, Song Qinglan forcefully pulled the person before him closer and used his long arm to take the medicine box from Ji Yushi's left hand.

Ji Yushi reacted quickly, and the box drew an arc in the air.

Contrary to his expectations, Song Qinglan didn't care about that medicine box. He instantly restricted both of Ji Yushi's arms behind his back and pressed his entire body against the bookshelf.

Song Qinglan's tone was very unfamiliar. His cold voice travelled from behind, "Ji Yushi, repeating the same point in time many times can result in confusions with reality and would require medication to keep the mind clear — At least that was what I read in a certain paper."

Ji Yushi was unable to break free. Although there were clothes separating them, it felt uncomfortable being so close to another person, "What do you want to say?!"

Song Qinglan said, "I think you have a lot of things you haven't told me the truth about."

From the convenience store to the beauty salon in Runjin Building and now the bookstore. From his end, it looked very suspicious. Ji Yushi was behaving too familiarly.

Taking a step back, there had never been a case in his past twelve missions where the destination changed during the transfer, resulting in them entering a different time and space. It was only until Ji Yushi was sent over. Song Qinglan couldn't help but be suspicious.

"Can you explain why you came to the bookstore or tell me how many times you have experienced our current situation?"

Ji Yushi instantly understood, "You think I am related to the so-called Ouroboros?"

Song Qinglan: "Correct."

“Let me go and I’ll tell you!”

“Tell me and I’ll let go!”

Song Qinglan had always been a thug like this. Even when he led his squad, he didn’t do it the normal way.

He would do anything to achieve his goal and wouldn’t relent even when faced with the most dangerous threat.

Ji Yushi’s face was pressed against the cold bookshelf, “Hurts.”

Song Qinglan was stunned for a moment. He even thought to use this trick?

“My hand hurts.” Ji Yushi said again, as if begging, “Can you let go first?”

For a moment, Song Qinglan felt like he was bullying the weak.

It wasn’t in line with his usual style. Seeing the colour slowly drain from Ji Yushi’s face and thinking that he wouldn’t be able to escape from him anyway, he released his hold.

Unexpectedly, as soon as he let go, he received a fierce punch in the face.

His cheekbones hurt like crazy.

Song Qinglan was indignant but he then saw that the ends of Ji Yushi’s eyes were faintly red. It was very clear that he was in pain and it wasn’t an act.

Ji Yushi had hit him, but his expression was still extremely cold, “Cap Song, do you know that there is an illness in the world called hyperthymesia?”

# Chapter 12: Chapter 12

Hyperthymesia?

Tianqiong's interpersonal relations were messy and there are also a lot of gossip. As early as two years ago, when Song Qinglan was a Guardian without any major achievements, he had heard about it at the Guardian training camp. At that time, the ranks following a certain exam was released and the teacher with an abundance of knowledge was ranked second. In class, the teacher joked to the students, "Actually, it doesn't count as a loss. Ji Yushi in first place has hyperthymesia. Who can beat him?"

It was a line that sounded like a joke. It sounded like he was using an exaggerated descriptive term to describe how good this person called Ji Yushi's memory was.

In fact, Song Qinglan had also thought it was just a description.

But.....it was an illness?

Standing so close, the dampness around the roots of Ji Yushi's eyelashes were clearly visible.

His skin was extremely pale and when he was angry, his capillaries didn't dilate or flush. He looked like an ice-cold sculpture.

"My caudate nucleus and frontal lobe are a little unusual and will uncontrollably store memories long term. I remember the colour of the socks I wore the first day I went to elementary school, I remember whether it was raining or not on the first weekend after I started working and I also remember whether I stepped into this bookstore earlier with my right foot or my left foot first."

Ji Yushi's eyes were clear and his gaze didn't carry any emotion. He spoke like he was narrating.

“As long as I have seen, heard or felt something, no matter whether it is important or not, I will remember it. There is no screening or filtering process. In other words, I don't have the ability to forget.”

Song Qinglan's frown smoothed out. A hint of surprise appeared in his eyes, “.....”

Don't have the ability to forget?

Ji Yushi continued, “What you think is abnormal is however completely normal for me. As long as it is something I have experienced, it doesn't make any difference whether I have experienced it once or countless times. In other words, I am just like you. I am going through this again after the first time.”

“So the reason you appear to be almost omniscient is because you remember it all?”

“Yes.”

“Anything?”

“Anything. You can test me.”

Ji Yushi didn't look like he was lying.

Of course, Song Qinglan didn't know the other party well enough and he also didn't know if the other person was in any way related to their current circumstance. He just asked, “Then why the bookstore?”

“I saw it on the drone projection.” Ji Yushi seemed to think that this question was very stupid, “With no internet, all the electronics are only there for show. Upon arriving at an unfamiliar place, where would you go if you want to quickly learn about the history of it?”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

Ji Yushi's words carried double meaning, "Cap Song, don't just think about using force."

Please read this from kk translates

Reaching Song Qinglan's ears, that tone was almost as good as saying 'read more when you have time' and 'don't rely on force to bully others'.

Guardians have a clear purpose when carrying out their missions and are required to be fast and accurate. When encountering an obstacle, they are expected to charge on.

This wasn't the first time the two have confronted each other since they've met but for the first time Song Qinglan had to admit that the other party's words were right. In this unfamiliar world, it was impossible to be fast and accurate. Lack of caution had become a Guardian's shortfall. At present, Ji Yushi just happened to make up for it.

"But you are right on one point. My medicine really us used to keep my mind clear and alert." Ji Yushi poked Song Qinglan's shoulder with his finger, "Cap Song, can you move aside?"

Song Qinglan only now realised how ambiguous their positions were.

This scene was fine if it was another person of the same sex, for example, Li Chun. This scene usually meant that Li Chun who had been slacking off with his training was about to get a beating but, with Ji Yushi who was half a head shorter than himself, slender, pale and big-eyed, taking that place, it felt a little strange.

Most importantly, the entire Tianqiong knew about Ji Yushi's sexual orientation: Men.

Cap Song who dared to casually press someone down with his tall stature was finally willing to move aside letting the weak and delicate Advisor Ji out.

It was just that the expression on that handsome face was a bit unsightly.

The small rectangular medicine box was thrown away just now.

With so many bookshelves and books, it would be hard to find the medicine box without seeing which direction it was thrown in. Ji Yushi looked around several times but was unable to find it.

At this moment, the teammates who had left returned.

“Bang, bang, bang——”

Gunshots suddenly sounded outside the bookstore.

“Cap Song!!” Zhou Mingxuan’s sounded, “Close the door, hurry!!”

The three people rushing in were covered in zombie blood.

Twenty or thirty zombies poured towards the door. Seeing the living people inside through the floor-to-ceiling windows of the bookstore, they growled as they slapped at the glass and some used their teeth to gnaw at the glass, leaving behind pieces of flesh and blood stains.

As soon as he was out of danger, Li Chun cursed, “Fuck, all the food was taken. We found a supermarket with nothing but just a couple of these cans. Seeing that there were several of them on the shelf, it seems no one wanted them.”

Zhou Mingxuan thrown over the remaining cans, “Probably doesn’t taste good.”

“How bad can it be?” Song Qinglan picked one up, “It’s the end of the world and people would worry about that?”

As soon as Tang Le entered, he saw a bottle of mineral water on the bookshelf and drank it without another word. He was clearly very thirsty, “There is something wrong with this place!”

Ji Yushi looked at the bottle of water but didn’t speak up to stop him.

He just picked up a can and inspected it.



The can was decorated with green beans and the packaging wrote ‘Kemeng Beans’. It looked no different from ordinary beans. Turning the can around, the ingredients listed also seemed very normal but the small print at the bottom caught Ji Yushi’s attention. There were two lines written in both Chinese and English: PU-31 Golden Crow No. 2’s first batch of organic vegetables since establishment.

From early morning to midday and with the intense scuffles earlier, no matter how physically strong this group of young people are, it was no surprise they’re hungry.

Li Chun who had long emptied the contents of his stomach at the beginning no longer cared about whether the canned food tasted good or not. He pulled out his dagger and began to open the can, “It’s not just this place that’s strange. It’s like this everywhere!”

Tang Le downed half the bottle of water in one go, “I was going to say that I ran into a dog just now but I don’t know if I saw wrong.”

Song Qinglan, “The dog was also infected?”

Tang Le hesitated for a moment with a grimace, “No, it seemed to have two tails. Forget it, take it as if I hadn’t said anything.”

Everyone: “.....”

“Pei——” Li Chin took a bite of the Kemeng Beans and immediately spat it back out, “Fucking hell, it’s disgusting!”

Zhou Mingxuan pushed his head aside, “Having something to eat is better than nothing. Just close your eyes and swallow it. Cap Song and I once had to survive in a rainforest and ate bugs and bark and even almost started eating mud.”

Li Chun opened several more cans and distributed it to everyone.

Ji Yushi gave it a taste. The taste was astringent and bitter, and the texture was also strange, completely unlike the ones grown from the soil, but he

still swallowed it down.

Seeing that even the most 'delicate' Ji Yushi could eat it, Li Chun felt that he shouldn't complain anymore and silently began to eat.

Song Qinglan, "All full? Eat more if you haven't eaten enough. We don't know what the situation will be like afterwards, this may possibly be our last meal."

Please read this from kk translates

The original group of seven had now lost two.

No one felt that those words were too harsh, after all, it was the truth.

Song Qinglan was the squad's backbone. He coldly turned on the communicator projection and explained while drawing in the air, "The problems we are facing now are one, zombies, and two, the black wall. No matter which one we encounter, it's a dead end. Zombies we can kill but we have no information about the black wall. So far we still do not know about the wall's pattern of movement or why it exists."

Song Qinglan marked the current location of the black wall on the map.

It was still more than ten kilometres away from them. Since it would take some time for to reach their location, the bookstore was temporarily safe.

"The mission rules said death elimination." Zhou Mingxuan mused, "I'm guessing that the purpose of the black walls existence is to devour those zombies, not to eliminate us. There is no need for them to give us this rule for the mission we have to do. Our deaths will not help those superiors in any way. That rule is probably a reminder to us that the black wall cannot distinguish between zombies and living humans and that we will die once we touch it so that we can avoid being eliminated."

Speaking of death elimination, everyone thought of Tang Qi and Duan Wen.

With Tang Qi around, Tang Le was responsible for being the carefree one but at this moment, he seemed to have matured considerably. He continued

the conversation without much trouble, “Old Zhou’s words seem possible. But how did the black wall come about? Could the technology in this world have surpassed ours by so much?”

“I don’t think it’s right.” Song Qinglan denied it, “If they had the ability to create a black wall to eliminate the zombies, why not directly blow them up? The result would be the same anyway, why take a detour?”

Ji Yushi’s appetite was the smallest. Having finished eating first, he endured the bitterness in his mouth and had already begun to search the bookshelves.

Seeing that everyone had finished eating, he walked over with a book in his hands, “What if the mission that was sent to us wasn’t from the Tianqiong from our time and space?”

Everyone raised their heads.

Ji Yushi spoke, “I know what PU-31 means.”

A book with an orange cover was thrown over. On the cover was a green planet and there was the writing <Mini World: PU31>.

“PU, Parallel Universe.” Ji Yushi explained, “A small planet with the code name 31. With a diameter of 3696km, it is smaller than Mercury. It is an artificial colony that exists in the crevice between parallel universes.”

Ever since time travel was invented, the Time Alliance formed by the countries have been controlling it very strictly.

But since this technology was invented, it meant that from that day onwards, Tianqiong would exist in every future. In a situation where a similar frequency wavelength was used, Guardians who have travelled to the future may at times experience interference with their communicator and hear information for the guardians from that particular time coordinate.

Everything has a cause and effect. When mankind invents something that surpasses the technology from its times, it was destined to not be

completely under their control.

As such, a vow would be recited before each departure with great sincerity and earnestness.

---

“Never change the past!”

“Never talk about the present!”

“Never be obsessed with the future!”

Everyone fell into thought.

Song Qinglan: “So you mean that when we transferred, we were intercepted by the Tianqiong from this time and sent to their colony?”

Ji Yushi said, “I think it is very likely. It can also explain why it warned us of an illegal transition and why we cannot contact the command centre. Even the mission details were received through the park administrator’s communicator.”

“Pa!”

Outside the window, several zombies could see the living humans in the bookstore from their angle. They slapped at the glass windows repeatedly, their grey and turbid eyes looking up, but no one inside was in the mood to pay them any attention.

This news was more crippling than being besieged by a thousand zombies.

“Fuck.” Li Chun’s heart tightened. His eyes showed horror and his words were filled with expletives, “Then how do we get back? By completing the mission? If we were really sent over by the Tianqiong from this place, can’t the people in the command centre give us more information? What bullshit was that useless mission detail? Would saying a bit more kill them?!”

This angry complaint pretty much summed up everyone’s thoughts.

Zhou Mingxian patted Li Chun on the shoulder, “Brother, keep going.”

Song Qinglan pursed his lips. At this moment, the sharp blade-like atmosphere coming from him was hard to ignore.

“Since this place called PU-31 is an artificial colony, it is very likely that there is no so-called command centre here. The system.....itself is just a machine anyway. What do you expect from it?”

“Then will Chief Wang and them find us?” Li Chun said, “The people in the command centre must’ve realised that we’ve gone missing.”

“Not necessarily.” Tang Le’s eyes were a little dazed and his voice was small, “Parallel universe. Perhaps to them only a second had passed. And my brother and Old Duan are left in this place.....”

The bookstore was silent.

Song Qinglan, “So what exactly is the chaser of darkness mentioned in the mission objective?”

He turned his head and spoke to Ji Yushi, “Advisor Ji, while we still have time can you check a few more books to see if you can find anything?”

Ji Yushi was rather indifferent, “I’ll try my best. After all, I’m not a little genius who can speed read quantum waves.”

Everyone: “.....”

Fuck.

The line Song Qinglan had said before departing was actually returned back to him by Ji Yushi!

Even at a time like this, he held a grudge!!

“Also.”

Ji Yushi stood there and gently pulled up his sleeves, revealing the marks on his wrists.

There were several bruises on his fair skin. It looked like finger marks, as if he had just been abused.

Ji Yushi said slowly and nonchalantly, “Can someone help me find the books? My hands hurt.”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

Song Qinglan: “I’ll do it.”

# Chapter 13: Chapter 13

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 13

As an artificial colony, the bookstore in PU-31 had a vast assortment of books. Books covering anything and everything and catering for all ages and preferences were available and there were also old and new books. It was obvious that they had been procured from different places.

This time and space they were in was far more accepting of parallel worlds than the one they came from. Judging from the number, there were likely more than one place similar to PU-31. Ji Yushi however found that there weren't many books covering this matter in this bookstore. The book found earlier called <Mini World: PU-31> was noticed mainly because it had a conspicuous name. It showed that the people here didn't find something like that novel that important — Of course, it didn't rule out the possibility that all the knowledge was stored in the cloud or in the online library.

But fortunately, there were some gains.

As Ji Yushi walked around and looked, Song Qinglan helped take down the books he needed.

Ji Yushi wasn't someone particularly arrogant and he didn't deliberately use the bruises on his wrist to take advantage of him. He only just pointed it out earlier and along the way forgave him.

With him holding grudges so easily, it's a wonder how he can find a boyfriend.

Song Qinglan took in Ji Yushi's side profile. From his angle, he could see Ji Yushi's focused expression. Those eyelashes of his were like tiny fans.

Probably because he looks good.

Even if they have different sexual orientations, their aesthetics should be similar to what they see in women.

After a while, both returned with a tall stack of books.

"Hurry up." Song Qinglan threw the books onto the floor, "Pick out the useful information."

"I know." Ji Yushi responded without looking up.

With the sun high up in the sky outside, the lighting was particularly good.

The sun shone into the bookstore, casting a golden glow, but no one appreciated its brilliance.

Far in the distance was the dormant black wall.

Up close were the zombies pressed up against the glass windows, letting out growls as they scratched at it.

"Splat." A zombie was squeezed against the window so hard, its turbid eyeball exploded onto the glass, leaving filthy gore trailing down.

Song Qinglan could bear with it well but even he found it somewhat disgusting.

When he turned around, he saw the other three looking at the two of them with intriguing expressions, as if they were wondering what happened after they went out to scout out the area.

Song Qinglan narrowed his dark eyes. Seeing this, the three of them immediately rushed over and divided the books between them.

"I'll also look!"



“Here, here, here. Come help out.”

“Look for place names, people and anything related to darkness!”

The moment Zhou Mingxuan opened a book and saw the words inside, he immediately felt dizzy. He then stood up with his gun, “Um so, someone should be on lookout. I’ll watch over the situation from the second floor.”

Li Chun: “Old Zhou put that down. Let me go!”

Tang Le pulled Li Chun back. He wasn’t in the mood for the tricks and his expression was stern, “Search around properly, in case you find something useful.”

Li Chun obediently sat down.

Song Qinglan thought for a while about the matters they had discussed earlier.

He went back to the counter of the bookstore and found the bookstore’s communicator he had overlooked earlier.

If their speculations were in the right direction, then the Tianqiong system of this era doesn’t have a command centre and even needs to hijack Guardians from another time and space for help. Was the Tianqiong system controlling the mission itself?

Song Qinglan couldn’t reach a conclusion.

This communicator was also the same kind as the one from the park management office. On the screen were the same information.

[Welcome Guardians from Star Era 1456. Welcome to PU-31.]

[The transfer this time has been locked in. Unlocked after mission is successful.]

[Mission mode: Ouroboros.]

[Mission rule: Death elimination]

[Mission objective: Chaser of darkness.]

There was no internet. It meant that the information was sent one-sidedly.

An idea flashed through Song Qinglan's mind but at this moment he happened to spot a small rectangular medicine box through the corner of his vision.

He bent over and picked it up. The box was completely blank, with no symbols or markings on it.

It was Ji Yushi's.

Hyperthymesia.....

Song Qinglan glanced at the teammates sitting in the centre of the bookstore.

Among the three, the only one who didn't look strange in the bookstore environment was Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi naturally wouldn't forget about this medicine box. He was just busy looking for clues and had temporarily put that matter aside. Song Qinglan stored the box in his pocket, not wanting to disrupt the other party's focus.

Unfortunately, there was no information about 'chaser of darkness' or the 'black wall'.

Ji Yushi however found a number of artificial cultivation projects implemented on PU-31, including but not limited to artificial soil, artificial water sources etc. He picked up a book, "<The History of PU Thermonuclear Fusion Experimental Reactor Project>? Is this related to development of sustainable energy?"

"Huh?" Li Chun's expression was blank.

“It’s about energy.” Ji Yushi explained, “It mainly uses deuterium and tritium in controlled settings to carry out nuclear fusion to release energy which can then be used to generate electricity and heat.”

Everyone: “.....”

Ji Yushi: “In other words, the energy for this place may perhaps come from this source. We are also researching into this field in our era, but it hasn’t developed to this extent yet.”

This had no association to what they are looking for.

And so, Ji Yushi placed the book back down.

After the serious atmosphere was interrupted by this conversation, Song Qinglan picked up a half-full bottle of water from the shelf and wanted to give it to Ji Yushi along with the box of medicine.

The area under Ji Yushi’s eyes were a little blue, “No need, thanks.”

The bitter taste of the beans were clearly still there but he wasn’t willing to touch that bottle of water again.

Song Qinglan understood. This person also has a bit of mysophobia.

At this moment, Ji Yushi’s eyes fell outside the window and the expression on his face froze.

Everyone followed his line of sight.

They saw another wave of zombies gathered outside the windows of the bookstore, stacking up layer by layer.

In the last row, there was a tall zombie.

He wore a black combat uniform and there was a large bloody wound on his neck, exposing the arteries and veins inside. His eyes were grey and turbid, and his face was identical to that of Tang Le’s.

“Brother!!!”

Tang Le’s eyes turned red. He shouted this loudly as he got up and hurried over.

Everyone was shocked. The convenience store was at least twenty or so kilometres away. He couldn’t imagine how Tang Qi could suddenly appear here.

Through the layer of glass.

Tang Le’s tears flowed endlessly. On the other end, Tang Qi numbly opened his mouth, exposing his rotten gums. Facing a living human, he was so excited, he wanted to tear him apart immediately.

“Grrrr! Grrrr!”

The zombies started moving.

The originally brightly lit room suddenly darkened and almost at the same time, Zhou Mingxuan’s frustrated voice sounded, “Hurry! The black wall is here!!!”

Everyone’s heart immediately sank.

Zhou Mingxuan had already rushed downstairs, “It can be seen very clearly from the second floor! I was fucking watching it the entire time and it happened almost instantly! And the speed is still increasing!!”

Everyone looked back. The black wall that was originally in the distance had appeared close to them in a blink of an eye.

It had silently reached about four or five kilometres away from the bookstore in an instant and it was currently engulfing the city at an unimaginable speed that was visible to the naked eye!

The black wall covered the sky like a cosmic black hole. Everything it came in contact with was submerged in darkness, disappearing completely. What was even more terrifying was that the large number of zombies in front of

the black wall seemed to be deathly afraid of this dark force. This dense crowd of zombies gathered together, rushing towards the light. One could almost see the dust scattering behind them!

Tang Le was still standing in front of the windows.

Zhou Mingxuan yelled loudly, “Fuck!! Hurry and go!”

Tang Le seemed to be jolted awake by this. The two of them fired with their guns, sending zombie blood and flesh flying outside the bookstore.

The car was stopped outside the bookstore. Song Qinglan strode out with Shen Mian, “Everyone get in the car! Li Chun! Stop fucking picking it up!”

Cans of beans rolled around by Li Chun’s feet.

Gunfire continued nonstop. “Grrrr— Grr—.” The zombies nearby were attracted by this sound and similarly rushed over.

“In the car!!!”

“Hurry, hurry!”

The light inside the bookstore darkened further.

With a dull rumble, the tide of zombies chased by the black wall headed in their direction.

As parts of the zombie tide was swallowed up, new zombies joined in. The rumbling sound was like thunder, it announced the imminent end of the world.

At this critical moment, as if he was being guided, Ji Yushi caught sight of a book by the door that had been knocked down during the panic. Song Qinglan however had already grabbed his shoulder.

He immediately turned his head back and was met with never seen before ferocity in Song Qinglan’s eyes, “Go!!”

Following Song Qinglan out the bookstore, Ji Yushi raised his gun to kill a zombie and followed the bloody path opened up by his teammates ahead.

“Bang, bang, bang, bang!!!”

In the rapidly darkening environment, the sparks from the gunfire were bright. The sky split open in an instant and the darkness was overwhelming.

The zombie tide had come.

“Ahhh!!!”

A scream from an unknown source sounded in the darkness. With the zombies gathered, nothing could be seen.

The car was blocked by the zombie tide. At the very last second, Tang Le killed the zombie stuck between the car door and slammed the door shut. “Grrrrr.” The engine started and the car barely managed to escape out with its remaining energy.

The zombies in front were knocked flying, leaving remnants of rotten blood and flesh behind. The windscreen wiper could barely move. Zhou Mingxuan could only rely in his instincts to navigate out onto the main road.

Darkness chased them from behind, swallowing up the zombies scattered around in the process.

“Grrr——”

In the back seat, Li Chun opened his mouth and made an attempt to bite.

In just a few short seconds, a piece of flesh was missing from his face. His skin was covered with blue-green blood vessels and his eyes had turned completely grey and turbid. He had mutated!

Zhou Mingxuan saw this through the rear-view mirror and almost lost control of the car. Ji Yushi almost fell onto Li Chun in the process.

Tang Le's voice cracked, "Chun'er!"

The two held Li Chun down. Their teammate's voice and smile was still in front of them but he had already become an unrecognisable monster. How could Tang Le kill him?!

The Diamond Bird in Ji Yushi's hands was shaking uncontrollably. He could only hear Song Qinglan yell from the front, "Do it!"

He squeezed his eyes shut.

"Bang!"

The back seat was quiet again. No one moved to check on Li Chun in the dark.

The car had rushed a hundred metres ahead in a blink of an eye. Suddenly, there was a loud noise. With a 'boom', the car had rammed into a wire fence, shattering the windshield in the process. The car rolled across the ground for several metres before finally coming to a complete stop.

The ears of everyone inside the car were still ringing.

Zhou Mingxuan's head drooped. His neck was bent at an incredibly awkward angle.

"Get out of the car!" Song Qinglan's voice carried some pain and he almost seemed to be yelling that out through gritted teeth. He unfastened his seatbelt, fell to the ground and kicked the car door open.

After the car rolled, the back door had deformed.

Ji Yushi, Li Chun's corpse and Tang Le were trapped together. Tang Le: "Cap Song!!"

There were severe pain in Ji Yushi's leg, and his face was pale, "Can't open the door!!"

Song Qinglan grabbed the broken edge of the door, the glass shards cutting into his palms and fresh blood landing on Ji Yushi's face. He however didn't seem to notice the pain and proceeded to pull the door off with gritted teeth!

“Clang——” The door was thrown aside.

Song Qinglan stretched his hand out. Ji Yushi held onto it.

The two hands clasped together.

One was fair and the other was dripping with blood.

That large and firm palm carried strength. That strength came from a captain's sense of responsibility, and it also came from friendship towards a teammate.

Ji Yushi was pulled out of the car.

Next, Song Qinglan pulled Tang Le out.

No sooner said than done, the second Tang Le was pulled out, the black wall was only a dozen metres away from them

At that moment, all the people there felt despaired. No longer caring about whether there were zombies ahead, they used all their energy to escape and there was only one thought in their minds – Run.

Ji Yushi felt that he had never run so fast in his life.

It was so fast, he even forgot about the pain in his leg.

With the sound of wind whistling past his ears, the teammates beside him were, like him, trying their best to survive in this time and space.

After running for tens of metres, a bad feeling formed in Ji Yushi's heart. Together with Song Qinglan, they turned their heads back.

“Tang Le!!”



Tang Le had stopped in place. A zombie was biting at his neck and blood poured out from the wound instantly soaking through his clothes.

Tang Le's lips moved. He slowly spoke up, "Advisor Ji.....We can't go back——"

He couldn't finish his words.

Behind them, the darkness had arrived.

In this world, together with the other survivors, everything was completely submerged.

# Chapter 14: Chapter 14

“Advisor Ji, how do you feel? You don’t look well today.”

Tang Le, a new teammate, one of the round-faced twins.

He looked a little shy. Upon hearing his answer, his reaction was much like that of a straight man.

“I see.” He said awkwardly, “Advisor Ji, don’t be too nervous. The transition this time is the same as your previous missions and the mission is also very simple. We should be back by tomorrow.”

.....

The next second, Tang Le’s neck was bloody, splattering all over his body and flowing down his black combat uniform. The ‘7’ symbol on his chest was stained crimson red.

His eyes were dull, and it gradually turned grey and turbid. Behind him were zombies gnawing at him as well as the seemingly endless black wall: “Advisor Ji.....We can’t go back——-”

The scene shook. Blinding white light suddenly appeared.

The sky and ground cracked, shattered and collapsed.

There was a harsh siren.

【Illegal transition detected!】

【Illegal transition detected!】

Amidst the violent shaking, someone grabbed his shoulders: “Jian Jian, calm down!”

A blank piece of paper and a pencil was tossed in front of him. That person squatted down beside him and said to him, “Here, do as teacher said, okay?”

The room was eerily quiet. Sun shone through the window, falling onto the table. A small hand held the pencil and started to right the first number in the centre of the white piece of paper.

“Look.” The teacher spoke gently, “We start at 1 and slowly write until we can’t write anymore on this paper. It doesn’t matter if it’s wrong, you don’t need to think and you don’t need to remember. That’s right don’t be afraid. Keep writing.... keep writing until you feel better.....”

“Bang, bang, bang!”

Gunshots rang.

Someone fiercely pushed him out the window while blowing off the heads of an oncoming tide of zombies with Shen Mian. When that person looked back, his eyes were furious: “Don’t speak nonsense and leave now!! I’ll hold up the fort!”

.....

In the speeding car, dust scattered up behind it.

“Sacrificing yourself is a foolish act and shouldn’t be done again. There is nothing more important than surviving. There are still many other things our team needs to do, no need to rush to your death.”

“Do you understand?!”

.....

The car rolled over. A large hand reached over.

The palm was pieced with glass shards and still dripping with blood.

He reached out towards that hand.

The moment he held it, the other party's dark eyes narrowed, "Advisor Ji, I think you have a lot of things you haven't told me the truth about.....How many times have you experienced our current situation?"

.....

"Looks like we're both not crazy."

Everything was still.

Before Ji Yushi's eyes was the flawless and white interior of a capsule. The transparent panel in front of him was showing garbled characters and outside the glass window was a dense forest and a dark grey sky.

"Bzz."

With a soft sound, a robotic arm grabbed a bag of nutrient solution and foolishly handed it over.

Badump badump.

Badump badump.

When swallowed by the darkness, what did he think about just before his death?

He couldn't remember.

All that remained was the heart still beating violently in his chest.

Disregarding the dizziness and weightlessness he was feeling, Ji Yushi pressed open the safety lock almost without a second thought and weakly climbed out of the capsule.

Cold early morning wind blew past.

Seven capsule compartments glowed faintly in the middle of the quiet forest.

Three or four teammates stood not far away. They seemed to be talking about something and were a little agitated, as if they were complaining about the wrong time coordinates.

On the other side, the door to the capsule closest to him opened. The young man appearing from it had a poor expression and he had his hand covering his mouth as he tried to clamour out of the capsule.

“Thud!”

The door to the capsule was kicked closed.

“Cap Song!!” Li Chun’s muffled voice could vaguely be made out from the airtight capsule, ““Bleagh——”

“If you want to vomit, vomit in your own home.”

The man passing by wore a black combat uniform which outlined his pair of firm and long legs. His actions were particularly domineering but also reassuring, “Who told you to fucking slack off and only sit on the pendulum twice during this long vacation.”

The three other people gathered not far away initiated their teasing mode.

“Is Chun’er throwing up again? How many times has he been caught by Cap Song now?”

“Can’t blame him. Even the girls are better than him at the thrilling rides in amusement parks. The pendulum only has to go up once to make him vomit three times.”

“No wonder. The simulation can no longer help him.”

On the other end, Duan Wen who was in his early thirties was busy debugging the main control panel. One could tell from his voice that he had

smoked far too many cigarettes, “Cap Song! Our equipment seems to be locked!”

Song Qinglan, “I know.”

He walked over unhurriedly, leaving Li Chun alone in the capsule, suffocating himself with his stench.

When he was about two or three steps away from Ji Yushi, Song Qinglan suddenly stopped and turned his head.

Because of the other party’s height, Ji Yushi felt that the other party was almost looking down at him.

Song Qinglan’s expression was deep and his dark eyes were filled with strong spirit. He said without hesitation, “Advisor Ji, I think this is my first time seeing you smiling.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

He subconsciously looked down.

The fluorescence from the capsule illuminated his face.

Ji Yushi could faintly see from his reflection in the glass a small, almost imperceptible arc at the corners of his lips.

“Looks pretty good.” Said a low male voice.

He looked back with astonishment but the person who had just made that remark had already proceeded on, leaving only a tall and straight back.

“The main control panel is offline, and the command centre cannot be contacted. The capsules also don’t work. It seems to be because of the electromagnetic waves here. The magnetic field here seems a little different but it’s still not certain. Perhaps the transition just now had something to do with it. Right now, all that we can use is the communicator. We’re basically trapped.....here.” Duan Wen finished speaking but he seemed to have noticed something. He frowned, “Did I say this before?”

Song Qinglan patted his shoulder, “You have.”

Duan Wen squatted there racking his brains to remember.

This scene seemed to feel familiar to him but he couldn’t pinpoint why.

“Can’t remember?” Song Qinglan approached Zhou Mingxuan and motioned for him to open the weaponry storage, “Take your time and think.”

The rest of the people: “.....”

Song Qinglan looked at the neatly arranged weapons and proceeded to pick out a military knife.

Please read this from kk translates

At this moment, footsteps sounded in the forest.

In the dim lighting, a cold light flashed across in Song Qinglan’s hands and a dark shadow fell to the ground not far away.

Everyone: “!!!”

Even Ji Yushi was stunned. This person’s accuracy was beyond his expectation.

The teammates used their flashlight to examine the corpse. They quickly fell into discussion about the other party’s blue-green blood vessels, grey eyes as well as his rotting flesh and were inwardly shocked.

This drifter killed by their captain didn’t look human, but didn’t Cap Song kill him too quickly?

When Li Chun finally came out of his capsule, Song Qinglan gathered everyone up.

“Anyone else who has a sense of déjà vu, think over it carefully.”

Song Qinglan's eyes swept across everyone's faces. His tone held rare sternness, "This time, no one should die on me."

"Choose your weapons. Pick the most lethal ones and take everything you can. When we get out, we'll look for a car first."

Li Chun was still a little dizzy after vomiting.

While everyone was confused, he asked first, "Cap Song, where are we going? Is this a new mission?"

Song Qinglan calculated the time difference in his mind and turned to the leftmost side of the squad.

There stood the elegant and handsome Ji Yushi who had been dropped into the team by those at the top.

"Advisor Ji?" Song Qinglan asked, "Do you have any suggestions?"

"Go directly to the bookstore." Ji Yushi's clear voice sounded, "I have a clue I wasn't able to check."

Song Qinglan revealed a short smile.

Then, with a resolute attitude, he said calmly, "Good, I was also thinking that. Go to the bookstore first and check the clue you wanted to look at and then we will work out the black wall's pattern of movement. From that, we find the so-called mission objective."

The two sung in chorus with each other with strong tacit understanding.

Everyone else was at a loss.

Song Qinglan said: "I'll slowly explain on our way there."

\*

Everything in the park was exactly the same as how it was originally; garbage, corpses and bloodstains.



Hearing about the black wall and zombies, some team members were silent while others were in disbelief. For some of them, it seemed impossible to have already happened before. Especially for Tang Qi, most of the things that had happened later did not have his involvement so it was very difficult for him to have a sense of déjà vu.

Duan Wen could vaguely remember some scenes and Zhou Mingxuan also felt a little familiar.

Song Qinglan guessed that this may be related to the training everyone had gone through before.

After the Tianqiong system was invented, many special forces preparing to enter it and become a Guardian was required to participate in a Time Witness Program.

To combat the side effects of forgetting or confusing reality as a result of time travel, they had undergone a very long period of repeated memory training. This was also why Song Qinglan could guess what kind of medicine Ji Yushi was taking.

At present, the people who had some form of impression of their previous two experiences were those who have participated in the Time Witness Program and have received training for it. As for Li Chun, Tang Le and Tang Qi who joined Tianqiong later, at that time the Time Administration Team had already released a new invention; just taking nutrient solution developed by them could give them enough relief from those side effects. As a result, they probably became dull to this and may probably never sense any feeling of déjà vu.

As for Ji Yushi, it was obvious.

He was someone with no ability to forget.

Was this really a good thing, or a bad thing?

“So every time we die, it will start again?” Zhou Mingxuan asked, “This kind of death, is it when a certain person dies or when the whole squad

dies?”

“Should be the whole squad.”

The speaker was Ji Yushi.

Probably because he had constantly been in a highly alert state and not had a chance to rest — From the time they first restarted the mission until now, and the fact that he didn’t have a good night’s sleep before departure, to Ji Yushi who remembered everything, he probably hadn’t slept for almost twenty hours.

The bruised bump on his forehead from the impact in the car when it crashed into Runjin Building was gone with the mission restarting but the faint blue tings under his eyes were still there. Among this group of steel straight men, he looked like he could be blown over by a gust of wind.

“According to the message, the mission rule is death elimination.” Ji Yushi said, “But the Tianqiong system also set up a time anchor for us——“

“Time anchor?” Song Qinglan was surprised Ji Yushi knew about this.

The time anchor was something that had been banned from a long time ago by the research and development team.

It could be used to mark a certain time coordinate as an anchor point and when it detects that the necessary condition is triggered, time would return to that anchored point.

The emergence of this time anchor had resulted in serious time paradoxes; for example, allowing someone to live forever within a certain period of time or making a historical event never happen, eventually resulting in a time bubble to form in that timeline and affecting the normal timeline.

As a result, time anchors were banned in their time and very few people knew about it.

Ji Yushi: “Yes.”

He briefly explained what a time anchor was to the others and continued, “This means that when the timeline restarts, we will always return to the park. I believe the death elimination meant that in each cycle, those who have died become discarded chess pieces and the remaining are to continue with the mission. Once it detects that the entire squad have perished, the mission would restart. This is done in order to ensure that the mission is completed, even if only one person is left to complete it.”

Please read this from kk translates

“Fuck.”

“That’s just too cruel!”

“Does the person who came up with this have any humanity in them?!”

“I don’t know about that.” Ji Yushi said, “But if we don’t complete this mission, the cycle may continue for eternity.”

When he said this, Song Qinglan glanced at him

Duan Wen then spoke up, “Then the mission mode you mentioned. Did that Ouroboros mean this?”

Song Qinglan also thought this.

And he also talked about it with Ji Yushi before.

“It’s possible.” Song Qinglan said, “In any case, it’s okay to get a general understanding of this for now. We need to figure out what this chaser of darkness is.”

Everyone had already reached the location where they found the park management office but this time they no longer needed to go in again.

Ji Yushi however stopped in place, “Cap Song, do you want a car that can crush everything?”

Song Qinglan found that he had already grown used to Ji Yushi's habit of suddenly raising a topic.

With Ji Yushi saying this, there must be one.

Song Qinglan couldn't control his bad-mannered mouth: "I can have it if I want it?"

Everyone: "???"

"Yes." Ji Yushi's beautiful profile was very soft under the morning light, "Park management office. There is a spacecar key on the table."

\*

Sure enough, a brand-new spacecar was parked behind the park management office.

The spacecar key was different from the identification card a small car would need and very easy to identify. They didn't notice it before because firstly, they didn't think about driving a spacecar around the city during the first two cycles and secondly, it was concealed under a pile of newspapers and takeaway boxes.

Song Qinglan didn't remember such details but Ji Yushi remembered it very clearly.

The spacecar was eight metres long and five metres wide and it had an extremely hard metal shell outside. Able to reach a speed of 300km/hr, it was a real monster crushing machine.

This kind of car also existed in their time. After setting it up, it does not require a driver and it takes a special channel to generally transport materials. To put it bluntly, it was a driverless, high tech version of trucks from a century ago. Because of the large space, some also use it as a mobile home and hence the name spacecar.

"Advisor Ji!" Li Chun jumped up and looked around, "I have the feeling of inexplicably winning a big prize! This thing is awesome!"

Tang Le said to Tang Qi, “If there are zombies, do you think it can crush a hundred of them?”

Tang Qi: “Probably.”

Song Qinglan looked at the time on his communicator and ushered, “Hurry up.”

There were also several thick tree trunks in the car.

After studying the controls, Duan Wen turned car on and dropped them out, the trunks making a loud boom as it landed.

In the distance, several zombies were attracted over by the sound and began to frantically rush over.

“Bang, bang, bang!”

Zhou Mingxuan looked through the scope and used his laser gun to shoot several down.

Zombie heads exploded and blood and brain matter scattered across the ground.

Following the gunfire, more zombies rushed out from hiding. The sky had brightened.

Seeing real zombies right in front of them, the teammates were so shocked they temporarily couldn’t calm down. Only now did they realise that how much of a reality Cap Song and Advisor Ji’s words from earlier were.

Throwing all their equipment into the car, everyone got on.

The moment the door closed, a black wall suddenly appeared in the sky.

“Quick!” Someone urged anxiously.

Ji Yushi was very calm. He quickly and accurately entered the destination into the control panel. When Duan Wen saw that it was entered successfully,

he pulled the start valve and the spacecar immediately shot out like an arrow.

The black wall swallowed up the forest, half the park and everything in its path.

The spacecar sped out of the park.

It rushed onto a main road.

It was like an invincible tank, ignoring the obstacles and crushing the zombies swarming on the roads into pulp, spraying blood around it the entire way.

“Yooo!!!”

“Awesome!!”

The group of young men couldn't help but get excited, as if they finally found an outlet.

At a speed of more than 200km/hr, the spacecar approached an intersection. Suddenly, there was a loud bang and the car shook. “Boom——”

A small car had suddenly rushed out from the other end of the intersection and was crushed completely by the spacecar.

# Chapter 15: Chapter 15

Everyone inside the car was silent for a moment. Their eyes fell onto the screen displayed on the control panel.

Although there were many obstacles as the spacecar navigated through the city, its speed was at least 100km/hr. They had only cared about the thrill and no one expected that they would suddenly run into another car, let alone encounter living people. To run into another car and to crush the car completely, anyone with morality and conscience would feel very uncomfortable.

Li Chun was shocked silly. His expression revealed horror, “D-did we just hit someone?”

The faces of the other teammates were also not very good.

Hitting and killing a zombie was one thing but hitting and killing a living person was something entirely different.

Only Tang Qi who was always calm and unwavering answered, “Yes.”

Li Chun hesitated: “What should we do?! Should we go back and take a look?”

Zhou Mingxuan’s tone was heavy, “What point is there? With that speed and that weight, they’re definitely a goner. Have you seen how cars are scrapped in scrap car yards? It’s pretty much like that.”

“PU3K630.” Ji Yushi read out the licence plate number.

That line was very abrupt. All the teammates looked over.

They only saw Ji Yushi lower his eyes and turn to walk towards the back of the car.

There was a small square glass window at the back of the car. It was located quite high and just enough for Ji Yushi to see outside.

The run-down streets shone brightly from the lights coming from the rising sun and even the scattered corpses looked strangely good like this —— The spacecar moved very fast. The completely scrapped small car from earlier had long disappeared into the distance.

This wasn't Ji Yushi's first time seeing that car.

Following his memory, scenes quickly unfolded like a picture scroll.

The gunfire was fierce, and the zombies were clamouring about frantically.

He jumped out from the window of the warehouse. When the soles of his feet landed on the ground, he felt some pain from the strong impact. He didn't have the time to think and quickly raised his gun to kill a zombie at his 10 o'clock position. That zombie was shot in the eye and thick fluid exploded out, splattering onto his hair. With his left hand, he dragged Tang Le who was on the verge of breakdown forward.

Behind him, Song Qinglan was still roaring at them to go ahead first. The sound from Shen Mian was very loud. When a bullet was fired, parts of the wall would chip off and scatter in the air.

There was a small silver-grey car not far away. Li Chun stuck his head out of the driver's seat, his expression anxious. He shouted loudly, "Get in the car!!"

These memories were played in very slow motion, turning into a slow motion movie lasting dozens of seconds long.

—— A not very eye-catching licence plate appeared briefly in his line of sight.



As if he was experiencing it again while recalling that scene, Ji Yushi could clearly see the licence plate.

PU3K650.

Black text on white background

It was exactly the same as the car just now.

Something cold touched the back of his hand.

Ji Yushi looked down and saw a brand-new bottle of mineral water. He then raised his head and saw Song Qinglan.

The other party's handsome eyebrows were furrowed together, "Do you need to take a break?"

The light from the small window was projected onto Song Qinglan's face.

At this moment, having just come out from the mission loop, his face was still the same as how it was when he left the capsule, clean and refreshing.

Song Qinglan's appearance was actually in line with most people's aesthetics. With high brow bones, a tall nose, deep set eyes, extremely dark irises as well as lips that are not too thick and not too thin, he was an embodiment of a very handsome man. He however was born with innate roguishness and he also didn't like to speak or do things the typical way, so he always gave others a feeling of rebelliousness.

"For you."

That bottle of water again touched the back of Ji Yushi's hand.

Probably because he wasn't good at expressing concern, Song Qinglan's tone could not be considered as one that was very patient, "You even went through the drawers."

He was referring to the last time the mission was restarted, when Ji Yushi went to the park management office to find water. Song Qinglan had looked

around for water for some time just now and finally found it in the drawer.

Ji Yushi received the water, “Thank you Cap Song.”

Song Qinglan looked out at the situation outside the window, “Do you have an impression of the car we just ran into?”

Because of the height of the window, the light only shone onto Ji Yushi’s eyes.

His irises turned amber as a result, making people can’t help but wonder how many things the owner of those eyes could remember in his mind.

“Yes.” Ji Yushi said, “It’s the same car we drove into Runjin Building with last time.”

Please read this from kk translates

Song Qinglan remembered that when they drove out of the back alley in the car last time and reached an intersection, a spacecar had suddenly appeared in front of them. The Ji Yushi at that time had shouted “Turn left” and they barely managed to avoid it by crashing into a building.

That location just now happened to be that intersection!

Wait. Song Qinglan suddenly remembered their conversation in the bathroom in Runjin Building.

He had asked Ji Yushi, “If I’m not crazy, I remember you should have escaped with the others in the car.” Ji Yushi’s answer to that was — “Yes but we were unlucky. Not long after escaping, we were hit and killed by the spacecar we just saw.”

Song Qinglan now understood why Ji Yushi’s reaction was so strange.

Without Ji Yushi needing to speak, he spoke with certainty, “It was also the car you were in when the mission failed the first time too, isn’t it?”

A strange feeling surged in an instant.

Both their hearts sank. A chill slowly seized them from behind.

On the other side of the spacecar, the other teammates were completely unaware of the topic they were discussing. They were still busy arguing over checking on the small car and were about to start quarrelling.

Song Qinglan habitually crossed his arms in front of his chest, “The time and space is fixed once the time anchor point is set. I believe some things are set to happen regardless like plot points in a game and different results would come about according to the choices we make. The first two times we went to the convenience store, so we drove that car but this time we made a difference choice and chose a spacecar.....”

“It is as you have said. Some things are set to happen regardless. Since we didn’t take that car, it is possible that other survivors may have taken it instead.” Ji Yushi moved away from the window and leaned against the car wall at an angle where Song Qinglan could no longer see his face clearly, “Didn’t we see the smoke last time from Runjin Building? And the last two times we also ran into that woman who ran out of a building crying for help. They are all living survivors.”

Song Qinglan thought about it for a few seconds. His frown slowly smoothed out, “You are right.”

In any case, nothing could be confirmed right now.

They couldn’t turn back to check on the situation with that small car. The most important thing right now was to find the clues and put an end to this damned mission as soon as possible so that they can return to their timeline.

“If we encounter other survivors, we have to gather information from them.”

When Song Qinglan finished saying that, he was about to walk away but he paused for a moment and stopped.

Ji Yushi’s hands suddenly became empty. Song Qinglan had taken the bottle of water away.

And then, he unscrewed the bottle cap for him.

“We have managed to gain some extra time. We should have much more time this time than last time.”

The bottle was stuffed back into Ji Yushi’s hands.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Was this special treatment? Or did he think that he really couldn’t unscrew a bottle cap?

“Besides, it is safe now. The second attempt will always be better than the first.”

The other party was still standing in a position where the light could reach with slightly raised eyebrows and a nonchalant expression, “Even if you can’t forget, you should throw the not so good ones out and not let it occupy your mind. Don’t think that you can claim something like this as a work-related injury.”

\*

6:52am.

The metal spacecar rumbled along the entire way, reaching the bookstore without much resistance.

When everyone got out of the car, they all felt nauseous.

The originally clean and smooth outer shell of the car was now covered with a thick layer of rotten flesh and there were even intestines stuck to the front of the car. The car looked like it had been smothered with a truckload of pungent, rotten meat from a slaughterhouse and there were all sorts of colours.

Hearing the sound of the car, zombies wandering near the bookstore rushed out whilst growling. The smell of living humans was like a delicious breakfast for them and they were very excited.

For the first time since this mission restarted, the teammates saw those zombies up close. After a quick glance at them, they saw more zombies appear from the streets ahead.

Duan Wen kicked open the bookstore door, “Quick! Get in!”

Everyone filed in.

An elderly zombie behind the counter stumbled out, heading straight for the closest person there, Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi had already expected this but before he could fire a shot, that zombie was shot dead by someone beside him.

The round-faced twin teammate looked calm and composed.

Ji Yushi: “Thank you, Tang Le.”

Tang Le: “.....”

Ji Yushi had already put his gun away and was heading over to a bookshelf.

Tang Le turned his head around looking shocked, “Advisor Ji really can tell the difference!”

His brother Tang Qi rolled his eyes at him, “You think you can pretend to be me? Go and check the back!”

“Oh.” Tang Le hooked his arm around Li Chun’s neck, “Let’s go. Come with this older brother to take a look at the back!”

This chokehold made Li Chun start coughing, “I’m just a damn logistics! Brother Wen, deal with him!”

Duan Wen had just locked the door from the inside and was busy connecting his communicator to a mini drone with the intention to scout out the area, “Your Brother Wen is busy!”

Zhou Mingxuan raised the gun in his hand and said to Song Qinglan, “Cap Song, I’ll check upstairs.”

Song Qinglan curled up his lips, “Go.”

It seems that even if Zhou Mingxuan couldn’t remember the last cycle, he would still choose to go to a high place. Perhaps this was a habit of snipers.

There were seven people in the building.

This team had never been so complete before. Hearing the lively conversations amongst them, Ji Yushi’s originally tense mood relaxed a little.

He then saw the book he wasn’t able to find last time on a bookshelf by the door.

As the only one of the two who has a memory of the previous two cycles, Song Qinglan was very curious about this so-called clue: “<Golden Crow No. 1: Propagation>? What does this have to do with the chaser of darkness?”

Ji Yushi had already opened the book.

Reading at a speed of ten lines at a time and finally finding a certain keyword, he answered without raising his head, “Golden Crow means the sun and it also has the alias Red Crow.”

Please read this from kk translates

Seeing that he has quickly entered a focused state, Song Qinglan still had some questions but he temporarily suppressed them.

They had reached the bookstore ahead of schedule this time. Compared to the time the black wall reached the store last time, there was still about seven or eight hours. This was enough for them to work out where to go next and also enough for Ji Yushi to finish looking through what he needed to look through.

The bookstore was still just like how it was when they first came.

All the books were in their original positions and there were no traces of them being touched. The cans that Li Chun had thrown onto the ground were also naturally not there anymore.

From Song Qinglan's observations, every time the mission is restarted, everything on PU-31 is reset, returning to how it used to be before their arrival. This just happened to be in line with their guess that a time anchor may have been used.

The teammates returned after scouting out the area.

Duan Wen had already flown the drone out. Watching the image sent back by the drone move further and further away, Song Qinglan reminded, "Pay attention to the wall. The drone disappeared after hitting that black wall last time."

Duan Wen was slightly startled for a moment. His expression changed.

Song Qinglan was keenly aware of this, "Remembered something?"

Duan Wen: "....."

This man in his thirties found it difficult to describe what he was feeling right now.

Song Qinglan squeezed the other party's shoulder. There was no need for words of comfort between comrades. He went straight to talking about business, "Look at the map first. After about 2pm, the black wall will come from this direction at a very fast speed. Is it a circle or a cross-section? Because it is too large, we currently have no way of knowing but we know that it will come here so later we will need to move in the opposite direction and to a place with fewer zombies."

He drew a line on the picture sent over from the drone.

"We now have a spacecar. In a situation where we don't have any information on it, we must try our best to keep away from the black wall."

Song Qinglan said, “We might as well hang around here for now and use this opportunity to determine the direction it is moving in and find some locations that may have food or necessities. We will mark them one by one in preparation for the future.”

After saying this, he turned to everyone, “Right now, we have some time. Do you have any thoughts or questions you want to ask?”

Li Chun raised his hand.

Song Qinglan lifted his chin, “Speak.”

Li Chun glanced in the direction of Ji Yushi and whispered, “Cap Song, I just want to ask, what is your current relationship with Advisor Ji?”

Song Qinglan’s dark eyes were deep, “I’m the captain. What relationship do you think I have with him?”

“No, I just felt that after coming out of the capsule, the two of you are somehow a little different? Before setting off, the two of you didn’t talk but now it seems like there are a lot of things only you two know about and us old teammates can’t seem to join in.”

Li Chun bit the bullet and finished saying this. He even copied the girls he had flirted with and let out a few quiet sobs and had his ass kicked by Song Qinglan as a result.

After jumping a few times, he still wasn’t backing down, “I’m not the only one thinking that. Right, Brother Wen?”

Duan Wen remembered more than Li Chun. He hesitated for a moment while fiddling with the drone: “That uh, I saw you unscrewing the bottle cap in the spacecar.”

Zhou Mingxuan added, “And you two talked in secret for a long time.”

Tang Le wanted to join in but he held himself back.



But even Tang Qi who was usually quite indifferent nodded, “That is true, it was a little intimate. Made me a little jealous.”

The others: “+1.”

“+1 my ass.” Song Qinglan sneered, “If you guys don’t fucking die every time and can measure up to an outsider like him, I’ll be intimate with you.”

The teammates quietly scattered.

Only Duan Wen was left to look at the map. He didn’t dare speak.

Song Qinglan stood next to Duan Wen and looked at it for a while. He pointed to a spot, “What is this building?”

In the picture sent back from the drone, a large building with the shape of a round dome caught Song Qinglan’s attention. The metal covering on the surface reflected the sun’s rays.

Duan Wen, “Haven’t seen it before. Probably a factory of some sort.....but also seems a bit too big for that.”

Song Qinglan said: “Note that down. It happens to be in that direction anyway. We can take a look along the way.”

Duan Wen: “Okay.”

Inadvertently, Song Qinglan found something on the bookshelf that looked somewhat familiar.

He walked over and his expression sank.

It was a small medicine box that was completely blank with no symbols or markings on it.

It was Ji Yushi’s.

After he picked it up from under the counter last time, he had originally planned to pass it back to Ji Yushi along with a bottle of water to let him

take the medicine but Ji Yushi didn't take it because someone had drunk from it.

At that time, he just happened to be interrupted by Tang Qi who had appeared outside the window and Song Qinglan at the time placed everything back onto this shelf.

That's right, it was this bookshelf. On the seventh shelf from the bottom.

Song Qinglan didn't have hyperthymesia but he had always been confident with his memory. For the first time, he started to doubt it.

Ji Yushi had his back facing the windows. A new wave of zombies had gathered outside, their nails scratching at the glass, making an unpleasant grinding sound.

This didn't disturb Ji Yushi who was reading intently.

Sensing Song Qinglan approaching, Ji Yushi raised his head. Something flickered in his beautiful eyes, "I know now! PU-31 is actually——"

Being looked at by those eyes and in combination with the teasing from his teammates earlier, Song Qinglan felt a little strange inside —— It was similar to the time he went to look for Ji Yushi in the training room.

He interrupted Ji Yushi, "Advisor Ji, did you take out your medicine box?"

That question cut off Ji Yushi's words. He could only reply, "No."

Song Qinglan handed him the box, "Is this yours?"

Ji Yushi looked at the box and then said, "Yes."

Immediately afterwards, he took out an object from his pocket and placed it in his palm.

The two medicine boxes were exactly the same.

He opened the one Song Qinglan gave him. On the small square packet, two pills were missing.

As for the other one, it was still full.

**The author has something to say:**

Some time later.

Song Qinglan: I admit that we are a little intimate.

# Chapter 16: Chapter 16

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 16

“It is indeed my box of medicine. I always check before going out on a mission to make sure it is full.”

Ji Yushi said this very naturally, as if carrying a box of medicine around with him wasn’t a big deal.

“There are two missing. One was the one I took at the park management office and the other was the one I took after arriving at the bookstore and you tried to beat me up——”

“What a minute, I tried to beat you up?”

Song Qinglan asked incredulously.

Ji Yushi paused and changed his wording a little, “——Alright, it was when you had a misunderstanding. The empty locations of the pills are exactly the same so that is indeed mine. Where did you find it?”

Song Qinglan decided to let him off. He explained the process and asked, “So why are there two boxes of medicine?”

Both thought of the car that was crushed by their spacecar earlier.

What if the people in that car weren’t survivors from this world?

“Cap Song, I have a question.” Ji Yushi was calmer than he thought he would be. He closed the book <Golden Crow No. 1: Propagation>, “The

second time outside the convenience store, you and Tang Le came in last because you tried to save Tang Qi. Was the bitten site the same as the place he was bitten the first time?”

During the second round, Ji Yushi didn't see the mutated Tang Qi.

Song Qinglan was puzzled but he answered, “Yes, it was the fingers on the right hand.”

Ji Yushi, “Any other injuries?”

Song Qinglan, “No.”

Ji Yushi: “Then I can understand how the zombie ‘Tang Qi’ appeared outside the bookstore that is twenty kilometres away from the convenience store.”

Song Qinglan waited for him to continue.

Whenever he talked about things in his memory, Ji Yushi seemed to be like a different person.

He was no longer the Ji Yushi who had no fighting spirit and would attend a class only to play games or just wanted to lie down and win. When he recalled and analysed, there was a strange feeling of fragile tenacity.

“That’s not Tang Qi.” Ji Yushi said, “Although I didn’t see whether that ‘Tang Qi’ outside the bookstore had any injuries to his fingers, he had a bloody hole in his neck, do you remember? Even if Tang Qi can really come this far, the wounds don’t match up. The only thing that matched up was —— Last time when we were swallowed by the black wall, Tang Le’s neck was bitten by a zombie.”

In fact, Ji Yushi had recognised him but when combined with the situation at the time, he was very confused and didn’t put forward this thought of his.

Song Qinglan was surprised, “It’s Tang Le?!”

But Tang Le was still alive and well in the bookstore at the time so even Tang Le himself thought the person who appeared outside was Tang Qi. Putting that aside for the time being, just the fact that two Tang Le's could appear in the same time and space like the two boxes of medicine didn't make sense.

Song Qinglan raised a question, "But after Tang Le was bitten, he was immediately swallowed by the black wall. Theoretically speaking, there shouldn't be a corpse."

For example, the end of the broomstick also disappeared completely.

Ji Yushi nodded, "Similarly, the bookstore was also swallowed by the black wall at that time. Theoretically speaking, the box of medicine left behind last time also shouldn't have existed."

Song Qinglan fell into deep thought. His brows furrowed even more deeply, giving others an urge to smoothen it out.

"Cap Song!!"

Zhou Mingxuan's voice suddenly sounded from the second floor.

Hearing his shout, Song Qinglan's temples throbbed.

Having arrived at this PU-31 and being forced to accept this task, every time Zhou Mingxuan shouted like that, it meant that the black wall must have arrived.

It had to be said, Song Qinglan suspected that he may develop PTSD towards Zhou Mingxuan's shout when he returns from this place.

Zhou Mingxuan moved his face away from his sniper scope and saw the two men downstairs standing close together raise their heads at the same time. His pair of eyes seemed to crinkle up as who knows what thoughts entered his mind.

Fortunately, he was good at pretending to be serious and he immediately talked about business before his captain could get angry, "There are people

outside calling for help. They're civilians."

Everyone downstairs was a little surprised when they heard this. Were there still civilians around in a situation like this?

Song Qinglan also found it strange.

But this time they had arrived at the bookstore much earlier than last time. Perhaps this was something that should originally happen at this time. He went up the stairs in twos and threes and looked through his binoculars.

Zhou Mingxuan asked, "Should we let them in?"

Through the binoculars, at the street corner twenty or thirty metres away from the bookstore, there were two civilians wrapped tightly in clothes looking like Arabs standing on top of a tram waving in their direction. Surrounding the tram was a circle of zombies.

"Let them in." Song Qinglan said, "Go assist them. Be quick."

"Yes."

Guardians are not cold-blooded animals. Zhou Mingxuan had expected this reply from his captain and quickly aimed his sniper rifle at the group of zombies in the distance.

'Bang, bang, bang.' Shots were fired continuously. Almost as soon as the first shot disturbed the silence of the street, the group of zombies surrounding the tram was dealt with.

The two civilians were clearly very excited. They reacted very quickly and slid off the tram and ran all the way over.

Zhou Mingxuan was at ease. He easily shot down the remaining zombies chasing after them.

These civilians had developed their escape skills well and focused on rushing to the bookstore without turning back to look at the zombies who were shot down.

Tang Le and Tang Qi were at the door waiting. The two quickly rushed in.

“Clang!”

Li Chun closed the door to the bookstore.

Not knowing who these strangers were, the team members pointed their guns at them. The man on the left took off his robe and hood, revealing a standard square face, dark skin and an overall simple and honest appearance.

The other person also took off the black robe and hood. It was a woman in her thirties and under the robe was even a child three or four years of age with her arms wrapped around her neck. The cleanly dressed little girl looked at everyone fearfully.

It turned out to be a family of three.

Everyone put their guns away.

The two survivors instantly relaxed and cried out, “Thank you! Thank you for saving us!”

After giving them time to catch their breath, Song Qinglan asked unceremoniously, “How did you know that there are people in the bookstore?”

The dark-skinned man answered honestly, “We were hiding in the small shop on the other side of the street and saw the spacecar come here. We were almost out of food anyway and would starve to death if we stayed and would be bitten to death if we came out so we thought it would be better to come and try our luck.”

The family of three all wore black robes. They didn’t like a whole piece of fabric but one that was stitched together using many pieces of dark fabrics.

Sensing everyone’s assessing gaze, the woman licked her chapped lips, “Can you give me some water. There’s no water over there. The child has been thirsty for several days.”



“I’ll get it.”

Ji Yushi stood on the side.

Strangely enough, as soon as there were more people, his presence was almost non-existent. The survivors didn’t even notice that there was another person over there.

But as soon as he spoke, he immediately attracted attention.

In this group of tall and strong young men, the relatively thinner statured Ji Yushi looked very weak and frail.

Li Chun was curious, “Why are you dressed like this? With the weather so hot, you don’t find it uncomfortable?”

The dark-skinned man had a strange expression, “Used to it. Won’t be easily bitten by zombies like this.”

Li Chun then asked, “How long have the zombies been here? How many survivors are there in this city? Anyone coming to save you?”

The rapid fire of questions asked by Li Chun just happened to be questions everyone else wanted to ask as well.

The dark-skinned man said: “It has been almost a month. I don’t know about the other survivors, our family has always been in hiding. We couldn’t contact the outside so we also don’t know if anyone is coming to save us.....You guys, with such good equipment, are you the police?”

Just as he asked that, Ji Yushi came over with the water.

The bookstore only had one bottle of water, plus the one Song Qinglan found at the park management office that was half drunk by him.

The woman received the water and gave it to the little girl to drink and Ji Yushi gave the other to the dark-skinned man.

But as soon as he handed it over, he felt an attack coming his way. The dark-skinned man's expression suddenly changed, and he pulled him over.

Everyone immediately raised their guns. The dark-skinned man's pocket-sized gun was already pressed against the back of Ji Yushi's head, "Hand over the spacecar key!! Otherwise, I will kill him!!"

"Fuck!"

"Let him go!!"

Song Qinglan raised Shen Mian: "Do you think you can win?"

The woman had already brought the little girl to hide behind the dark-skinned man.

Three against a group, it was unknown why that man had the courage to do this.

The dark-skinned man smiled darkly, "It doesn't matter. I only just met that woman and the little one isn't mine. You can give it a try. At most, I can just drag this guy down with me. There's nothing left to live for in this world anyway."

"Advisor Ji!"

Although Ji Yushi was held hostage and he didn't say anything, his hand was actually silently reaching for his Diamond Bird.

Song Qinglan's expression was tense. He wanted to warn Ji Yushi not to make any rash decisions, but he was also afraid of making the situation worse.

The back of his head was knocked again. The dark-skinned man threatened, "Hurry up. Hand over the spacecar key or I will die together with him!!"

Pointed at by multiple guns, the woman trembled in fear.

The little girl slipped off her and stood in the centre with a look of confusion. She wasn't aware of what was happening and just proceeded to take out a doll to play.

That doll had curly hair and wore a red dress. It was very pretty.

Ji Yushi let go of the Diamond Bird and suddenly said, "Cap Song, give it to them."

Dark-skinned man, "Hear that?!"

Song Qinglan didn't have any intentions to negotiate with the enemy. Seeing his expression, everyone knew that he was internally calculating the best way to attack.

Ji Yushi however spoke up again, "Do you still remember the movie <Dawn of the Dead>?"

Ji Yushi was held in a chokehold and his head was forced back. There were no blemishes whatsoever on his fair skin and his expression was natural. If one looked carefully, you would see that there was no tension in his eyes.

Or perhaps it was because this wasn't his first time, and he was used to it.

The other teammates were shocked. Why was Ji Yushi talking about a movie at a time like this?

Ji Yushi's voice was calm, "Trust me."

Song Qinglan slowly lowered his gun. He then said to Duan Wen, "Give him the key."

"Cap Song?!"

Tang Le exclaimed in disbelief.

But Duan Wen still obliged and took out the spacecar key.

The dark-skinned man grabbed the key from his hands, but he didn't remove the gun. He said in Ji Yushi's ear, "You seem pretty clever, but I'll have to trouble you to accompany us. You people are not good to provoke. As long as no one comes after us once the car is ten kilometres away, I will find a safe place to throw you out."

As he said this, he dragged Ji Yushi towards the door. He was pretty clever, "Open the door. Make sure we get to the car safely or I will blow his head!"

A wave of zombies had just been killed just now and the numbers are currently quite sparse. Hearing the sound of the door opening, the remaining ones rushed over.

"Grrrr—"

Zombies fell one after another.

The woman followed the dark-skinned man. While holding the child, she turned her head back and whispered a small 'sorry'. She also had no choice. It was the unfortunate state she was in right now.

The dark-skinned man dragged Ji Yushi over, the entire time not removing the gun from his head.

Reaching the spacecar and seeing that the zombies were almost all wiped out, the dark-skinned man whistled.

From various places, five or six other people wrapped tightly in patched up robes appeared, all carrying guns.

It meant that as soon as the dark-skinned man entered the bookstore, these people had been hiding nearby. Their original intention was to steal the car and the woman and child was just a bait for them to lower their guard.

With the two sides confronting each other, Song Qinglan suddenly said, "Wait."

Everyone's gaze focused on him.

The dark-skinned man cursed, “You’re changing your mind?!”

Ji Yushi looked at Song Qinglan’s deep eyes which carried emotions difficult to decipher.

Song Qinglan suddenly smiled, “Not changing my mind, just worried about him being thrown out onto the road alone. Why don’t you take along one more and throw them out together? If you agree, I’ll give you this gun.”

Shen Mian’s body was dark and sleek. With one glance, it was clear that it was a good weapon.

But how could there be such a good thing?

The dark-skinned man hesitated.

“Let him come along.” Ji Yushi said, “He’s my boyfriend.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

Everyone, “.....”

Ji Yushi lowered his eyes and said helplessly, “Can’t you see that he’s gay?”

“It’s damn obvious!” The dark-skinned man spat on the ground and ordered his accomplices to take the gun away before signalling to the people behind Song Qinglan, “Tie up that gay guy!”

**KK has something to say:**

I actually laughed out loud HAHAHA

# Chapter 17: Chapter 17

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 17

The two were escorted into the car and the first thing that was done was a body search.

The communicator on the wrist was taken off and thrown out the car and the dark-skinned man also instructed the others to take away Song Qinglan's knives, fist hooks and the likes.

In the twenty-six years of Song Qinglan's life, this was his first time being tied up in such an undignified manner with a gun pointed to his head. And the key point was that it was buy-one-get-one-free; he had suggested it himself.

Next to him, Ji Yushi was also getting searched.

With slightly furrowed brows, he had both his arms raised as a man checked him from top to bottom. They took away his Diamond Bird, box of medicine and the likes and also found a black and white device about one and a half palm in size.

The dark-skinned man was suspicious, "What is this?"

Ji Yushi, "Game console."

'Smack.' All those things were tossed aside.

Ji Yushi looked over. That small game console was broken into several parts and even the battery rolled out. When he restored his gaze, his clear eyes

held no emotions but for some reason the dark-skinned man felt a little uncomfortable. That look of his was a little unnerving.

Song Qinglin felt some pity for the dark-skinned man.

“What are you looking at?! Who knows if there’s a tracker in there?!” The dark-skinned man’s face had completely darkened, and he pushed Ji Yushi back, “Tie this one up too and throw him next to his man!”

This time Ji Yushi also had his arms tied behind his back and was thrown into the corner of the car.

With the two in this predicament, Song Qinglan lowered his head and whispered beside his ear, “Advisor Ji, having fun?”

The masculine voice entered his ears, and his breath could be distinctly felt.

Ji Yushi quivered slightly. He turned back and created some distance between them before whispering back, “I’ll explain it to you later.”

Song Qinglan talked through gritted teeth, “You think I’m asking about that?”

Ji Yushi, “What is it then?”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

Ji Yushi’s beautifully shaped lips gently moved, “Cap Song, homophobia is a sign of a deeply closeted gay. I’m helping you understand yourself better.”

These people probably didn’t have a high level of education. They spent a long time but was still unable to set the spacecar into high-speed mode, so the car wasn’t travelling very fast.

The dark-skinned man was very careful. Once they reached a place, he suddenly called for them to stop: “Those people will definitely come after us. Seal the road here first and then take the other one!”

Three people opened the rear door and jumped out.

Zombies rushed over. Two of them stood guard while the third one acted. He pressed the road closure button on the side of the road, and something appeared from the ground, completely sealing the road.

It was a wire fence.

It was just like the one the car had ran into when they escaped from the bookstore last time.

Song Qinglan looked back. It just happened that Ji Yushi was also looking at him.

The wheel of time turned again and again. The memory of death was just too vivid. The loud noise, the car overturning, the blood on the glass shards and even the scene of Zhou Mingxuan's head drooping down seemed to replay right in front of them.

It was an unexpected gain.

“Bang!”

The door was closed again and nothing could be seen.

\*

There were some equipment the team had originally left in the car and, with the addition of the Diamond Bird and Shen Mian, their harvest this time was quite impressive.

This group of people didn't seem to be people from the same place and are at this moment dividing up their spoils.

The woman with a child had no share or status. She was probably just a chess piece.

The car was sultry hot. She placed the little girl aside and took off her robe, revealing very pale skin. She suddenly heard Ji Yushi ask, “How long have you been away from the sun for?”



The woman glanced at the group of men, hesitating over whether or not she should talk to Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi asked again, “Was it from before the catastrophe?”

Song Qinglan didn’t understand why Ji Yushi was asking this but he knew that there must be a reason.

The woman finally nodded.

Ji Yushi asked very naturally. “Did it start since the launch of Golden Crow No. 2?”

“Yes.” The woman whispered in haste, “Are you police from PU-30? I heard there is no mutation there. Can you take my daughter and I there?”

“No.”

He was tied up but he sat there and spoke like he was a high-ranking judge.

“I’ll find a way to help you!” The woman immediately broke down, “Please, I’m begging you. Can you just take my daughter? Ever since Golden Crow No. 2 was launched, my daughter has not been exposed to the sun. She definitely won’t mutate!

Song Qinglan said: “If you don’t go, the black wall will devour you.”

The woman was stunned, “What black wall?”

‘Bang!’

There was a gunshot in the car. Someone’s head was blown open and blood sprayed onto the walls of the car.

Faced with such good resources including weapons and the spacecar, the men couldn’t come to an agreement and a fight had started.

The woman looked back and screamed in fright.

The little girl remained in her own world, silently playing with her doll.

Ji Yushi wasn't surprised by this, but he whispered, "Soon."

He looked as if he wasn't involved and was just an onlooker.

The person who fired the gun had the gun snatched away. The body laid there with his eyes wide open, but these people turned a blind eye to it.

The argument escalated and they started to get physical. Immediately afterwards, the spacecar made a sharp turn before continuing to drive on ahead at a steady speed.

Someone shouted, "Kill them all and take the spacecar!"

Everyone fell silent for a second and then they all threw themselves towards the pile of equipment.

Gunshots sounded.

The car leaned sharply to the side and the control panel at the front was hit by a stray bullet!

"Ahhhhh!!!" The woman screamed.

The out-of-control spacecar carrying a group of desperadoes shot forward. Song Qinglan used this opportunity to roll forward but a cold muzzle was pressed against his forehead.

He raised his head. The dark-skinned man held Shen Mian with a murderous expression and pulled the trigger.

Song Qinglan hooked up his lips, "It needs fingerprints, stupid."

As soon as he finished saying that, the hands tied behind his back suddenly broke free. When he rolled forward just now, he had at some unknown point in time picked up a knife. His movements were so fast, even Ji Yushi had trouble following. He only saw him leaning to the side and, sweeping his long legs out, the dark-skinned man was thrown onto the ground.

Song Qinglan threw himself onto him, grabbed the man's head and smashed it against the ground. The dark-skinned man cried out in pain and fresh blood coming from his broken nose covered his face.

At the same time, Song Qinglan kicked a knife with his boots, sending it whirling over towards Ji Yushi's direction.

“Fucking kill him!”

“Stop the car!!”

‘Bang, bang!’

Bullets hit the metal car walls. Sparks flew everywhere.

In the dim light, Song Qinglan stepped on the car wall and used the force to propel himself off. As soon as he landed, he broke someone's neck with a loud crack.

“The car is out of control!!”

Ji Yushi shouted this and watched Song Qinglan raise his Shen Mian to kill two survivors in front of him. Hearing the shout, he immediately went to the control panel, but someone rushed over from behind and grabbed his neck.

“Boom!!”

The car made a loud noise and everyone inside was thrown about.

The outer shell of the car grazed against walls outside, only stopping after going through several of them.

“Cough, cough, cough!!” Ji Yushi coughed nonstop from the impact.

The windows of the car were broken. Dust filled the air inside. The car itself had become deformed. Everything was now quiet.

The woman had been shot in the head and blood spilled onto the floor. The ground was littered with corpses and the little girl was also laying there face down with blood flowing from under her body.

Someone grabbed his ankle.

Ji Yushi looked down. The dark-skinned man with a bloodied face wasn't dead yet. His other hand holding the Diamond Bird slowly raised.

Ji Yushi still had the knife in his hands.

“Grrr.”

A dead man stood up.

Following another sound, the little girl also stood up while holding the doll.

Ji Yushi's beautiful eyes looked at the dark-skinned man and he took away his gun from his weak hands.

Following that——

He ruthlessly used the knife to stab his hand to the floor!

“Ahhhh!!!!” A cry that sounded like a pig being slaughtered rang out.

“Hurry!” Song Qinglan pushed away the bricks piled over him. His body was covered in dust and blood, looking very pathetic, “Ji Yushi!”

The two jumped off the spacecar.

Zombies from all directions rushed towards the spacecar which had made a large sound just now.

The two were like a single lifeboat floating among the tide of corpses. It was difficult protecting themselves from the surging tide. Shots were fired non-stop until even their hands felt numb. Even Song Qinglan's Shen Mian couldn't deal with the large onslaught of zombies.

“Grrr!!”

“Grrrr———”

Rotting flesh and heat wave. An indescribable smell filled the nose.

The communicator had been thrown away and the channel in the subcutaneous communicator was still set as public.

Having reached the other teammates communication range, broken voices entered their ears, “Cap Song?! Hello?.....Cap Song? Is it you?! We heard a loud noise nearby!”

It was Tang Qi.

“It’s us!” Song Qinglan replied while shooting, “We’re surrounded by a wave of zombies!”

Tang Qi: “.....Currently locating!.....Be there soon!!”

The connection broke.

On the side of the road not too far away, there was a green mini kiosk that attracted Song Qinglan’s attention, “Go there to hide!”

The two rushed over while shooting.

“Clang!”

Song Qinglan kicked opened the door. The zombies behind them were shot down by Ji Yushi and they both quickly squeezed in.

The kiosk was completely dark, and it was only one square metre in size; very pitifully small.

Song Qinglan panted heavily with his back against the metal door and a few seconds later, he actually laughed out loud, “Advisor Ji, can you change your way of explaining next time?”

Ji Yushi stood face to face in front of him. The darkness made it hard for them to see each other's expressions clearly, "Explain what?"

The growls from the zombies were quite terrible. Scratching sounds came from all four sides of the kiosk and clanging of the metal reverberated throughout. It wasn't hard to imagine what it would be like once the zombies managed to break through.

It couldn't be about explaining homophobia, is it?

Song Qinglan, "Explaining the theory you want to tell us next."

In the last round, they had passed this area.

That blocked road, the damaged spacecar and the little zombie they encountered in the alley, it all coincided with their current situation.

Song Qinglan originally didn't understand what Ji Yushi wanted to do.

It wasn't until Ji Yushi mentioned the movie <Dawn of the Dead> that he remembered what the situation was like when they were discussing about it in the car last time.

It was difficult for ordinary people to accurately recall.

For Ji Yushi whose memories were deeply embedded, even the small zombie that he briefly caught sight of as well as the doll in the red dress in her hands, it was all firmly imprinted into his mind.

Ji Yushi's clear voice sounded, "In fact——"

There was a loud noise.

The little kiosk was knocked down by the zombies!

The two crashed onto the ground. Crushed by Song Qinglan, Ji Yushi let out a painful grunt. The second half of his words were choked out, "Cough, cough——There was no other way to explain it."

Suddenly.

There was a shimmer of white light.

The screen above the two lit up and animation and text appeared. Song Qinglan however was on top so the screen was mostly blocked by his back.

“Grrr——”

The zombies were still pushing this long rectangular kiosk around.

The two piled on top of each other were shaken. Their bodies pressed tightly together, and their warm breathing could be distinctly felt by the other party.

In the dim lighting, Song Qinglan could clearly see Ji Yushi.

His eyes were calm and beautiful, his white cheeks were stained with dirt and his eyelashes were long and dense.

He was clearly a man but for Ji Yushi, even the colour of his lips was different to the rest of the rough men here.

This silence lasted about four or five seconds. Ji Yushi’s eyelashes fluttered, and he turned his head away slightly, his gaze looking elsewhere, “Cap Song, are you really straight?”

Song Qinglan’s elbows were pressed against the ground, supporting him up. He replied with some difficulty, “Advisor Ji, are you trying to slander me again?”

It seems that Song Qinglan didn’t have an excuse.

Ji Yushi said, “That look of yours just now, it was like a pervert staring at me in a bar.”

Song Qinglan had the urge to laugh. He snorted coldly, “At such a close distance and with just the two of us, if I don’t look at you, am I supposed to one-sidedly close my eyes?”

Ji Yushi: “Alright then, your words make sense.”

Song Qinglan wanted to use this chance to gain the upper hand, “And someone like you visit bars?”

Ji Yushi turned his head back, “Of course it’s a gay bar.”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

My bad.

“Grrrr.”

“Grrr!”

Zombies were still pushing the poor little kiosk around. Amidst the shaking, the two of them tacitly chose to close their mouths. If they were to make a strange sound in a situation like this, it would be too embarrassing.

Suddenly, a short and upbeat music sounded from the screen behind them.

A sweet female voice then spoke: “Thank you for choosing this product. I wish you a good time~”

Whoosh! Something fell from below the screen, falling next to them.

The shiny package had writing printed in standard Chinese: [PU-31 Ultra-realistic and extremely satisfying, a replacement for your other half.]



# Chapter 18: Chapter 18

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 18

“What is that?”

The packaging was excessive and exaggerated and it was a rod-like item.

Just as Song Qinglan was about to reach over to check, it was grabbed by Ji Yushi first and thrown somewhere into the darkness.

Song Qinglan lowered his head to ask.

But he saw a layer of red gradually appear on the other party's cheeks. The heat from it was transmitted out through the fair skin.

It was rare for Ji Yushi to show such an expression. He clearly looked embarrassed, but his eyes remained clear and his tone was calm, “Cap Song, did you pay attention to what this is when you entered?”

He was in a haste, so he naturally only rushed to hide in the first place he saw.

Song Qinglan indeed didn't have the time or energy to pay attention to what this green mini kiosk was for. It was different for Ji Yushi. Even if he didn't go out of his way to check, he could remember it clearly.

Having been reminded by Ji Yushi, Song Qinglan understood. Then that thing....As it turned out, this was a self-service adult product kiosk from the future world.

Ji Yushi's reaction was very interesting.

Song Qinglan was used to the teasing and mocking in the team and even in a situation like this, he teased, "It's not like you don't have one, why are you scared to look at it? A replacement for the other half, it can only be for women."

"....." Ji Yushi spoke coldly without an expression, "Cap Song, I now believe that you're straight."

Wait a minute.

Song Qinglan suddenly shut his mouth. Something didn't seem quite right.

From the looks of Ji Yushi, perhaps, maybe, possibly —— it could be used.

The two looked at each other.

The awkwardness was suffocating.

"Clunk!"

The self-service kiosk shook again.

The screen inside dimmed before returning back to pitch black. Neither could see the other person's face anymore. Except for the sound of breathing, the narrow space was very quiet.

Pressed down by Song Qinglan, sweat formed across Ji Yushi's forehead.

This person was too heavy. He was not only heavy, he was also tall and all the muscles on his body were hard like rocks. It made his chest, abdomen and thighs which were pressed down on gradually start to hurt. Shen Mian just happened to have fallen under Ji Yushi and, with the hard body of the gun pressing into Ji Yushi's back, his entire back ached as well.

Song Qinglan smelt of blood. The smell filled Ji Yushi's nose.

Of course, the smell from Ji Yushi's body wasn't any better.

Song Qinglan actually had a hard time supporting. At this angle, he supported with one arm holding himself up and the other arm pressed tightly against the door, preventing it from being opened. As a result, it was unavoidable that a part of his body had to overlap with the person under him.

Being both male and a teammate, Song Qinglan originally didn't think that there was anything wrong with it.

But after that short melody's reminder, in an instant, the warm sensation from every part of his body that was in contact with the other party felt even more distinct. His mind couldn't help but recall the time back at the training room before they departed when he caught a glimpse of Ji Yushi's pale and thin waist.

That impressively flawless face of Ji Yushi's under the lights earlier also left a deep impression. Without even needing to fantasise in the dark, he could imagine what kind of expression the other party must have while being pressed down by him.

Gender awareness as a result of difference in sexual orientation was just this obvious.

Even those dozen or so minutes felt extremely long.

"The drone was originally outside. They would use the drone to follow us." Song Qinglan lowered his voice and used his captain voice in attempt to make their situation feel less awkward, "Plus, our communicator was thrown out nearby. They should find us soon."

The heat from Song Qinglan's breath reached Ji Yushi's ears, sending a numbing sensation through both his ears and his neck. Only then did Ji Yushi speak up.

He just said, "Tang Qi said they heard a loud noise. They should be nearby."

In fact, Song Qinglan also noticed this problem. Reasonably speaking, Tang Qi and the others shouldn't be taking so long to find them.

But fortunately the growls and scratching of the zombies outside seemed to be slowly decreasing. If they really had to, they should be able to get out and put up a fight.

Very soon, a teammate's voice finally travelled through the subcutaneous communicator.

“Cap Song?! Advisor Ji? Hello? Can you hear me?”

It's Tang Qi!

Song Qinglan breathed a sigh of relief and replied, “I hear you.”

Finally.

In the public channel, Tang Le's voice sounded, “But brother, I just searched the area, and I don't see them anywhere!”

“Bang, bang!”

Several gunshots sounded through the public channel and it was also heard not too far away from the self-service kiosk.

Song Qinglan, “Report your location?”

The teammates were running. Tang Qi panted and spoke hurriedly, “We are next to a scrapped spacecar!! There are so many zombies here!”

The battle was fierce. The self-service kiosk was once again surrounded by a wave of zombies and it again started to shake violently.

Amid the sound of gunfire, Ji Yushi quickly reported their current location, “Behind the rear of the car in the one o'clock direction, there is a small green kiosk lying on the ground!”

“I don't see it! Fuck, Tang Le, look out behind you!”

The one who spoke was Li Chun.

It appears that the situation outside was similar to what it was like when they first hid inside the kiosk and perhaps the number of zombies had even increased. Song Qinglan raced against time and spoke very quickly, “The one lying on the ground. Do you see it?! We’re hiding inside the kiosk!”

“Fuck!! They’re behind there!”

“Turn around!!”

“Hurry, hurry!!”

A minute later, gunshots sounded outside the kiosk.

With a ‘bang’, several zombies were knocked into the air, crashing heavily onto the kiosk.

“Cap Song!”

The kiosk door was opened and Li Chun’s face appeared outside. Tang Le and Tang Qi were standing on the left and right firing rapidly at the wave of zombies, splattering blood and flesh in all directions.

Seeing the two in such an intimate position, Li Chun’s eyes instantly widened, “!!!”

Song Qinglan’s expression wasn’t great. He rolled out of the kiosk first.

Tang Qi looked back, “Cap Song!! We drive a car here. Let’s break through from the back!”

Ji Yushi’s entire body was numb. He first threw Diamond Bird over to Song Qinglan who caught it in the air and immediately turned around to shoot down a zombie behind him.

By this time, Ji Yushi had also climbed out of the kiosk. His expression also wasn’t very good, but it wasn’t because of his mood and instead he appeared to be hurt. Holding his stomach, he dragged out Shen Mian.

“Retreat!!”

The group retreated as they shot at the zombies. The firepower of five people was far better than that of two and they managed to break through this chaotic mess.

Song Qinglan yelled, “Ji Yushi!”

Diamond Bird was thrown back again. How could Ji Yushi not understand? This person here is unhappy with Diamond Bird’s capabilities!

He caught it without much thought and at the same time threw back the particularly troublesome Shen Mian.

The recoil from that heavy gun made Ji Yushi’s arms sore.

Song Qinglan however easily caught it and in an instant, unconcealable arrogance appeared in his eyes. That was the look of a man who is confident in their combat abilities.

With Shen Mian joining the battle, the fight fell in their favour.

They forced a gap through the wave of zombies, successfully reaching the car Tang Qi mentioned.

The car door slammed and soon afterwards everyone leaned back due to inertia and the car sped out!

\*

Several zombies were hit by the car and sent flying and there was a wave of zombies chasing behind them.

Li Chun in the co-pilot seat turned his head, “Cap Song! Advisor Ji! How were you two there?! And to even hide in that place!”

Song Qinglan wasn’t very satisfied with that scene just now. He didn’t know how this group of people would add oil to the fire later when they return. He reached over and pushed Li Chun’s head and said in a bad mood,

“Why don’t you talk about yourselves? It was just that little distance, what were you doing on your way here?”

Li Chun felt wronged, “Just that little distance? Boss, you’re so strict! If I didn’t check the location on the communicator when we were around here, we wouldn’t have found you!”

Song Qinglan wasn’t really blaming them for arriving late and was only just saying it.

No longer bothered with watching Li Chun act pitiful, he asked, “Where’s Old Duan and Old Zhou?”

Tang Le said, “Also separated. I thought they were with you.”

Tang Qi was focused on driving. He raced through the dilapidated streets and reassured the others, “It doesn’t matter, those two drive spacecars faster than anyone else. They probably will meet up with us at the bookstore and may even be there first.”

Spacecar? Meet up?

Three familiar teammates but the words spoken made Song Qinglan realise that something was off.

He turned his head, saw Ji Yushi curled up next to him, and frowned.

Then, the two people’s eyes met.

Song Qinglan retracted his gaze and spoke seemingly casually, “On the public channel just now, didn’t Tang Qi say he heard a loud noise? Why couldn’t you find us?”

Tang Qi was confused, “That’s not me. I didn’t hear any loud noise and I also haven’t spoken in the public channel.”

Li Chun, “Could it be Old Duan and them? Should we turn back to take a look?”

“It can’t be?!” Tang Le immediately objected, “Turn back? If we didn’t go back earlier, we wouldn’t have separated!”

Song Qinglan asked calmly, “Where did you get separated?”

Tang Le said, “Just like you, outside the high-rise building. We searched everywhere for you two and decided to go to the meeting point we decided on earlier to see.”

Ji Yushi rarely interrupted when they were talking but at this moment, he suddenly spoke up, “Runjin Building?”

“That’s it!” Tang Le was stunned, “I didn’t pay attention to the building and all that was on my mind was to get into the car. Advisor Ji, you have great observational skills!”

Li Chun said, “Isn’t Ji Yushi famous for his memory?”

Tang Le laughed, “Oh right, I almost forgot.”

This group of people have this magical calming effect. It was as if as long as they are out of danger, they could relax without any worries.

As a result, the three of them didn’t even noticed that Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi had both fallen silent at the same time.

This team was the team Song Qinglan was familiar with in terms of appearance and habit, but it wasn’t the same team from before.

—At the very least, these three teammates here have not been to the bookstore, nor have they experienced the hijacking by the dark-skinned man. They had only just come straight out from Runjin Building.

So then, that would explain why Tang Qi said he didn’t hear any loud noises or speak through the public channel.

What exactly is going on?



Song Qinglan's mood was complicated. The teammates chattered on for another two or three minutes and when they were getting closer and closer to the location of the bookstore, Ji Yushi suddenly shouted out, "Cap Song."

Song Qinglan who was deep in thought looked over.

It was clear that Ji Yushi also realised that the teammates who had rescued them from the self-service kiosk weren't their original teammates.

He said to Song Qinglan, "There is still some time until the black wall reaches the bookstore and the area nearby is suitable for looking for food. I suggest that we go pick up some food before going to the bookstore. Like this, when we plan the next destination, we wouldn't have to worry about not having a way to replenish our energy. This is a long battle after all."

Ji Yushi suggested this very naturally.

Song Qinglan couldn't even tell from his eyes that this was his subtle way of delaying them.

The person in front of him seemed to be calm no matter what the situation was, not even becoming flustered if Mount Tai collapsed. It was in complete contrast to the weak impression he gave off.

The world is complicated and strange. They are currently amid it, being played around by time.

When someone gets a clue, all their understandings of the previous developments are overthrown, dragging them into another situation where the truth is difficult to be seen.

Song Qinglan couldn't deny that having reached this point in the time cycle, even he himself had begun to feel lost.

To sort out the chilling clues from the chaotic mess and distinguish between reality and illusion, it was already something ordinary people cannot do relying on just their intelligence.

If their mental abilities cannot cope, it wouldn't be a surprise if they went mad.

But for Ji Yushi, his endurance seemed to have no limits.

Song Qinglan pursed his lips together tightly. Although he didn't understand why he did it, the calmness and keen senses he had developed over the years allowed him to quickly make a decision.

He turned back and ordered Tang Qi, "Go check the nearby situation and gather up some food."

The team members never questioned their captain's decision.

Tang Qi readily agreed, "Roger."

\*

The greenery at the hillside near the bookstore was very good.

The rays of the morning sun cast been the lush leaves left behind little scattered spots of lights on the ground.

This was a high-class residential area, and the streets were very quiet. Zombies would occasionally appear in groups, but the number was much less than the fierce battle earlier.

The car was stopped in a conspicuous place to allow for quick evacuation should the situation change.

Everyone lined up vigilantly. Not far ahead, Li Chun found a convenience store and whispered, "This way!"

Several zombies were wandering inside the convenience store.

Li Chun pushed open the door with a 'creak' and the zombies rushed over while growling.

Tang Qi and Tang Le pulled out their knives.

The twins had tacit understanding and even their behaviours were very similar. In many cases, they can understand what the other person was thinking without saying much.

In just a few moves, all the zombies in the store were killed.

The shelves in the store were empty. There was almost nothing left after being ransacked except for a pile of cans left on a bottom shelf.

Li Chun picked a can up, “What’s Kemeng beans? Why haven’t I heard of it? It definitely isn’t something good if there’s so many left here.”

Tang Qi: “Don’t worry about that. It’s fine as long as it’s edible.”

The convenience store was quite big. There was even a self-service area on the other end that was a certain distance away from the three teammates.

Ji Yushi whispered, “We can’t go to the bookstore now.”

Song Qinglan could guess Ji Yushi’s intentions, “Because we might run into the teammates in the other squad there?”

Ji Yushi nodded.

“They should’ve chased after us and may have not yet returned to the bookstore.” Song Qinglan was thoughtful, “What is this? Time and space overlap?”

If that was the case, would they not only meet the other teammates, but also meet their other self?

“It’s not just this problem.” Ji Yushi looked around and said, “Cap Song, I need that baking soda over there.”

Song Qinglan passed the baking soda over.

Ji Yushi’s lips didn’t have much colour and his lashes were pitch black. He tore open the baking soda packet and poured it onto the table.

In this era where pen and paper are almost impossible to find and with their communicators thrown out earlier by the dark-skinned man, it seems that Ji Yushi could only use the baking powder to draw a diagram.

Ji Yushi used his index finger to draw a 1. He then said, “This is us from the first cycle. We were killed by a spacecar outside Runjin Building and the entire squad was eliminated. It will be referred to as Team 1.”

Song Qinglan already knew this.

Ji Yushi’s finger was stained with blood. It was probably from the zombies. He didn’t pay attention to it and wrote another 2.

“Because of the existence of the time anchor, we restarted at the anchored point and started the second cycle.” Ji Yushi said, “But because I retained the memory of the last cycle, we successfully avoided the spacecar and entered Runjin building. We then fled to the bookstore and the entire squad was again eliminated near the bookstore. That will be referred to as Team 2 for short.”

That feeling wasn’t pleasant.

Not just the repeated failures, but having it raised as an example again and again.

Immediately after that, Ji Yushi wrote a 3 next to the 2.

“The third cycle, which is where we are now, Team 3 for short.” Ji Yushi said, “We drove the spacecar and hit a small car at an intersection. According to my memory, it is reasonable to conclude that it was us from the first cycle who was hit and killed. That is to say, it wasn’t some survivor who happened to drive a car with the same car plate but that we from Team 3 killed us from Team 1. Isn’t that right, Cap Song?”

Song Qinglan couldn’t deny it because the facts were just that unbelievable.

They couldn’t deceive themselves. They had to face this horrible fact.

Seeing his agreement, Ji Yushi pointed to the '2' and said, "It is known that Team 3 killed Team 1, that is our reality. Team 2 however avoided the collision. Now, there is another question: Who was driving the spacecar that Team 2 avoided?"

The question hit the nail on the head.

On the other end of the convenience store, the other teammates were still chatting with each other.

"The time anchor was originally an infinite loop on a single line and that is why we can repeat it again and again."

Ji Yushi paused and his slender finger drew a line above '2'.

"But in the second cycle, we retained our memories and avoided the collision with the spacecar. From that moment on, we inadvertently created a new parallel timeline. The 'us' in that timeline is like us now, preparing to go to the bookstore using the spacecar but we almost ran into the small car on the way. Seeing the car crash into Runjin Building, we were worried about the survivors in the car and stopped to look around only to encounter a large wave of zombies and end up separating. That will be simply referred to as Team 4, which is Tang Qi and the others we are with now."

"Because the time and space are fixed by the time anchor, then Cap Song, this resulted in the time and space overlap you mentioned just now." Ji Yushi said, "That is also the so-called multiple realities. The current situation is, two Tianqiong Seventh Squads have appeared in PU-31 at the same time. But because it is a parallel timeline, us from Team 3 ran into the group from Team 4. That is why they don't know what happened to us and we don't know what happened to them either."

Song Qinglan thought carefully over those words.

He very quickly understood Ji Yushi's explanation. He reached out and lightly tapped under the number '2'.

But it just happened to come into contact with Ji Yushi finger which hadn't been removed.

The baking soda had stained the warm fingertips. That strange touch slightly startled the two of them.

Song Qinglan retracted his finger, "Not just that. If time and space are fixed and parallel timelines are generated, then there are not only Team 3 and Team 4 existing at the same time. Did you forget? The 'us' in Team 2 should have escaped from Runjin Building by now and is probably on their way to the bookstore."

At this moment, Teams 2, 3 and 4 existed at the same time.

Ji Yushi said, "Correct."

Immediately after saying that, he appeared to be feeling extremely uncomfortable. He suddenly bit his lower lip and grabbed the edge of the table, his face pale.

"Ji Yushi?!"

Song Qinglan reached out to support him and felt something wet.

When he looked down, his palm was bright red.

That shout made the other three on the other end hurry over. All of them looked concerned, "Advisor Ji!"

"Fuck, Advisor Ji is injured?"

Li Chun stepped forward to help. He was in charge of the squad's emergency treatment, "Quickly, lay him down!"

Ji Yushi was placed onto the table. Blood flowed out from his waist and abdomen, staining the black combat uniform. Because the dark red traces weren't obvious against the uniform, the others hadn't noticed until now.

Song Qinglan found a pair of scissors and gently cut away the fabric around his stomach.

Fair skin was exposed.

There was a small bullet hole from which blood flowed out non-stop.

Song Qinglan asked, “When did you get hurt?! Why didn’t you say anything?”

Ji Yushi’s forehead was sweaty, “When the car was stolen.”

He was panting, and his consciousness wasn’t very clear. He had endured that pain until now, but it had become unbearable, “It’s okay, it’s not serious. Even if I die, it can be redone.”

Song Qinglan pressed his hand on the wound. The feeling was warm. It was unknown whether it was the temperature of the blood or Ji Yushi’s body temperature.

Ji Yushi slowly closed his eyes and murmured softly before falling unconscious, “I just.....wanted to repeat it as few times as possible.”

The less it was repeated, the less he would remember.

— “I don’t have the ability to forget.”

In an instant.

Song Qinglan’s hard and indifferent heart felt like it was gripped by an invisible hand.

This guy, he wasn’t a flower vase at all.

If you judged a book by its cover, it would come back to bite you.

He suddenly thought this.

**KK has something to say:**

Alright, so I have both good news and bad news for you guys. ><

Firstly, the bad news. The will be split into three parts because it is actually three chapters in one. As for the good news, I should be able to start updating this novel more frequently soon! (One chapter a week is just too slow so I'm super keen about this!)



# Chapter 19.1: Chapter 19 Part 1

Ouroboros

Chapter 19 (Part 1)

Light rain pattered.

The sky was gloomy. From the corridor, it looked like the sky hadn't brightened up yet.

He closed the door and his two little hands subconsciously pulled on the straps of his school bag as he thought to himself that he should buy a cake from that old shop around the corner so that he wouldn't be hungry if his father forgets to come back tonight because of working overtime.

Under the lights in the corridor, he stepped onto the ninth step and turned around the corner. There, he ran into someone.

He looked up. The other party was wearing a purple hoodie. A hat covered his face.

It was a stranger.

He paused for a moment and the other party also paused. They then passed by each other.

.....

When the light rain stopped, there were police tape put up downstairs.

It was clearly afternoon, but the sky was still dark. The sound of police cars, the sound of an ambulance as well as the sound of chaotic footsteps could

be heard under the flashing red and blue lights.

He stood outside the police tape. Someone rushed over to him and held in him their arms. It was unknown whether their trembling words were used to comfort him or comfort themselves, “Jian Jian, Jian Jian.”

A police officer spoke to that person with a lowered voice. It was a little inaudible, “.....Professor Ji, the child had quite a scare. He may have met the murderer.....”

He lowered his head and saw a drop of water slipping down his yellow raincoat.

.....

It was a warm-toned room. There were a lot of plush toys which made the room feel more comfortable.

The aunty of the Child Welfare Department walked in.

Someone had completed all the formalities. He squatted down in front of him and held his little hand, “Jian Jian, I’m here to take you home. To a new home.”

He nodded.

“Are you afraid?”

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He shook his head.

“Alright. In the future, you will have a mother, a father and a brother at home. It will be very lively.”

He remained silent.

“From today, you will be surnamed Ji.”

.....

“Hey Xiao Ji. You already have 89 B-level missions, you’re really not considering supporting an A-level one?” Chief Lin tried to persuade him, “I have already applied to the superiors. With one A-level mission equalling to 10 B-level missions, you will have a total of 99. Once you return, you just have to go one more time and then you would be able to get what you have always wanted!”

He said, “No hurry. It is the same if I do 10 more B-level missions.”

Chief Lin was anxious, “Goodness, why won’t this child listen to me?! For what reason did you join Tianqiong? Everyone already knows that you want a chance to return to that year. The people at the top say that they want to test you but they’re not that strict. No one wants to put you in a difficult position, you’re only doing it to yourself!”

He responded calmly, “Chief Lin, I can’t work with teammates who are blind, arrogant and hold a prejudice against others.”

Chief Lin, “That Captain Song isn’t arrogant for no reason.....Hey, Xiao Ji, wait a minute!”

A black cat snored on his lap.

He held a book in one hand and used his other to stroke the cat.

This cat was old. He stroked it very lightly, feeling the soft and smooth fur brushing between his fingers.

When the communicator rang, the cat stretched and jumped off his lap. He moved to pick up the video call.

In the call, a grey-haired old professor with glasses appeared.

Another black cat jumped onto his lap and rolled over to reveal its belly. He scratched it as he listened patiently to the other party talk before asking, “Teacher, are you calling to persuade me to go to Jiang City?”

The old professor paused. He then sighed, “Jian Jian, the sooner you reach your goal and go back to that year, the sooner you will be freed.”

He said, “Okay.”

.....

\*

Thick eyelashes trembled and the next second, Ji Yushi opened his eyes.

The source of this content is [lightnovelworld.com](http://lightnovelworld.com)

Pain from his abdomen slowly travelled up to his brain. The pain was so bad, he could hardly support himself up. He could only lie in place, taking small breaths.

Fragmented memories returned with the pain. Ji Yushi remembered that he and Song Qinglan were analysing the current situation.

He was only halfway through his words; he still had many things he wanted to say. He was extremely afraid that he would not wake up again once he closed his eyes.

The person sitting next to him placed down the binoculars and looked over, “Advisor Ji! You’re already awake!”

It was Li Chun.

Ji Yushi was still in a confused state, “How long did I sleep for?”

Li Chun checked the communicator, “It is now 10:42. Since you fell unconscious, you slept for less than an hour!”

Ji Yushi took in his surroundings. He saw that they were currently on a second floor balcony.

The low walls were made of small carved bricks, making it hard for them to be spotted from outside but also allowing them to observe the outside

situation through the gaps.

Ji Yushi had been placed onto a deck chair on the balcony by his teammates. A large parasol blocked out most of the sun for him so that he wouldn't die from heatstroke.

If not for the growls from the zombies, Ji Yushi would have thought that he was taking an afternoon nap at someone's place.

Sure enough, when he turned his head a little and looked through the gaps in the bricks, he saw zombies wandering around in groups below.

If he looked a little further, he could see part of the bookstore on the other side of the street.

“Advisor Ji, you sleep very lightly. You had clearly fallen unconscious, but your eyes were still moving around under your eyelids. You clearly weren't resting well.” Li Chun said this while holding a pair of binoculars. He was talkative, this was something Ji Yushi already knew, “I heard that you usually don't sleep well but you're injured so it's best to rest a little. How could you not say a word and endure it the whole time?”

Ji Yushi had nothing to say in response to that and he also didn't know what to say.

“Shit.” Li Chun suddenly cursed, “I'm so fucking stupid.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Li Chun spoke with embarrassment as he looked out through the binoculars, “It turns out that I have such a bad walking posture. Why didn't anyone tell me?! I thought I was handsome! No wonder I've been so unsuccessful with my relationships and the sisters all fly away. Even Old Zhou walks better than me.”

What?

Ji Yushi suddenly remembered — At this time, Team 2 should have escaped from Runjin Building and, after losing Tang Qi and Duan Wen, the

group of five should have arrived at the bookstore!

He turned to look. He could faintly see several figures in the bookstore. They were from Team 2!

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In just a few seconds, a chill ran down his back.

Li Chun and the others already know?

“Advisor Ji, you don’t have to worry. Cap Song has already told us.” Ji Chun turned around and spoke to him, “Because the mission was restarted, different ‘us’ would appear at the same time. Sooner or later, we will meet, just like you two and us right now.”

Song Qinglan has already told them?

For Song Qinglan to do something like this, Ji Yushi could understand.

But wasn’t Li Chun’s reaction too calm? Why would he still be in the mood to complain about his other self in a situation like this? Shouldn’t he be scared at the thought of it?

Ji Yushi was vigilant, “You’re not afraid?”

“What’s there to be afraid of? I’m not even afraid of death anymore so why would I be afraid of meeting my other self?” The simple-minded big boy thought very simply, “Just like how Advisor Ji continued to push on even after getting hurt and knowing that you may die — Let’s use you Recorders as an example. When you go back to the past to complete tasks, you will always see people and things from the past. If you travelled to a time that is closer to the present time, you may even accidentally run into your past self. Would you be afraid?”

Ji Yushi: “That is different.”

Hearing him say this, Li Chun laughed disapprovingly. That appearance of his was just like Song Qinglan.

No, their entire squad was like this.

“It’s similar.” Li Chun said.

“Look, what we see now is just our ‘past’ self and our other self who has ‘made a different choice’.” Li Chun continued, “But no matter how many of our other selves exist at the same time, the initial anchor point is fixed, just like when you go back to your starting point after completing your task in the past. That is to say, no matter what happens, the me who reappears at the anchor point is still me, and there is only one me. And so, to the me who is at that anchor point, it just means that there were several me’s who once existed at that same point in time. In essence, there is no difference.”

The past self and the self from a parallel timeline, who is the main body?

This was actually a philosophical question. Unfortunately, not many people in the world can answer that.

But because of the anchor points existence, it indeed provided a good explanation.

He didn’t expect Li Chun to choose such a transparent way to understand. Ji Yushi’s pupils constricted slightly, and he suddenly made sense of a few things.

He looked at Li Chun with respect, “You make a lot of sense.”

Li Chun scratched his head with embarrassment, “Actually, this was all analysed by Cap Song! How can I be as smart as you guys! It was only after I sat here and thought for an hour until my mind was about to explode that I managed to figure out what Cap Song meant!”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Alright.

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It seems that no matter which Li Chun it was, his mind was still very simple.

KK has something to say:

I'll be increasing the release frequency of this novel to 3x/week!! Chapters will be released Monday, Wednesday and Friday ^^



# Chapter 19.2: Chapter 19 Part 2

## Ouroboros

Chapter 19 (Part 2)

.....Song Qinglan.

This person was different from what he had imagined.

Ji Yushi had thought that things would become more complicated as a result and everyone would avoid their other selves, creating a chaotic scene where no one knew who was who and whether they were allies or enemies. He had even imagined the scene countless 'him's' appearing at the same point in time and, in order to compete for the so-called main body, a bloody massacre and self-killing would take place. It was simply a nightmare in a nightmare.

What Ji Yushi didn't expect was that, under Song Qinglan's leadership, this squad worked like an arrow, never turning back after leaving the bow regardless of what they were faced with, only advancing forward.

Everyone in Tianqiong's seventh squad were important core players who worked very well together.

They constantly changed Ji Yushi's understanding of them.

From the first cycle until now, no matter who was sacrificed and who was left behind, their goal had never changed.

It was like it was reminding Ji Yushi that everything wasn't a big deal. As long as their will was firm enough, they would not fall into confusion.

No matter what, no matter how many of them there were, there was only one goal.

—— Complete the mission and return to their original world.

This reminder made the heavy rock that had been weighing down on Ji Yushi chest lighten a little.

He was shocked. Could everything actually be that simple?

Song Qinglan's appearance before he fell unconscious appeared in his mind. The other party's brows were furrowed and there was an emotion called anger in his eyes.

Ji Yushi didn't understand it very well as to why Song Qinglan was angry.

And so, where were Song Qinglan and the others?

He voiced this query of his.

Li Chun said, "After you fell unconscious, Old Zhou and Old Duan came —— That is, the team you call Team 4, the ones that we got separated from at Runjin Building. They came on a spacecar, so they arrived earlier than Team 2, but they still don't know about the situation of several of themselves existing. Tang Qi and Tang Le are probably giving them some time to take it in. Cap Song went to find some bandages and so on for you so he should be back soon. Once we gather up again, we will go to our next destination."

Ji Yushi's lips were still pale. He was still quite weak.

"Advisor Ji, the bullet wound on you was from Diamond Bird, you shot yourself with your own gun. Fortunately, Diamond Bird uses energy bullets and doesn't have a physical bullet, so we don't need to look for a bullet inside you. The wound may look large on the outside, but it is small on the inside. Please try not to do something like this next time."

Ji Yushi: "....."

He was probably afraid that he would drag them down.

Li Chun, “Hey, in fact our Cap Song is a pretty good person. That time when Old Yu’s accident happened, Cap Song did everything he could to carry him out of the desert and walked tens of kilometres with him on his back. Although a scout is considered a civilian job, they are sometimes required to be out in the field. After that accident, Cap Song had been blaming himself. He didn’t want you to come so he deliberately said those things. We are at most just a little straight but it’s not to the extent of being homophobes——”

“Whoosh——”

With a soft sound, a grappling hook caught onto the balcony.

Two wandering zombies below turned and started to growl. A few seconds later, Song Qinglan appeared outside the wall and very agilely leapt over.

“You talk too much.” Song Qinglan’s dark eyes were deep. He glanced over at Ji Yushi and continued to say to Li Chun, “I could even hear you bullshit from across the street.”

Of course that wasn’t possible.

Li Chun hehe’d and immediately shut up.

Tang Le also climbed up the rope and joined them on the balcony, “Advisor Ji, you’re awake!”

Ji Yushi nodded at him.

“I’m glad you’re awake! But you should rest more, we still have time!” Tang Le’s reaction was similar to Li Chun’s. His next sentence turned out to be, “Wait a second, let me look. Has the other me appeared?”

Li Chun handed him the binoculars, “He has but he’s not going in our direction. Probably looking for food. Don’t worry, I left some of those Kemeng Beans that no one wants for them.”

Tang Le: “.....Fuck, you would even do something like that to yourself. Are you human?”

Song Qinglan was too tall and almost had to lower his head to get under the parasol.

He threw a bag of things at Li Chun, “I found a bottle of painkillers but no bandages. Found some disinfectant alcohol, suture threads and waterproof plasters. Use those for now.”

Li Chun immediately came over to treat Ji Yushi’s wound.

As soon as he touched it, Ji Yushi let out a small hiss. His pale and flat abdomen rose and fell with each breathe and the bullet wound that was barely concealed with a band-aid was already soaked with blood.

Alcohol was placed around the wound. It was so painful that Ji Yushi couldn’t speak. He bit his lips firmly, not letting out a single sound.

“Tough guy!” Li Chun couldn’t help but exclaim when he was done with the stitches, “Advisor Ji, I underestimated you!”

“More than a tough guy.”

Song Qinglan didn’t look too happy. Ji Yushi noticed this.

But unexpectedly, Song Qinglan said, “Giving you an apology, tough guy.”

Ji Yushi: “?”

He doubted his ears.

He looked over. Song Qinglan however didn’t mention why he was apologising. He just stared at him and said lazily, “If you wanted it to repeat less, you have to live. Don’t endure without saying anything, I’m not going to eat you. You are one of us so should work together as a team and take care of each other. This is Tianqiong’s seventh squad’s custom.”

After saying that, Song Qinglan leaned down and took out a brand new T-shirt from his pocket, “Advisor Ji, your clothes were cut open. This was something I picked up along the way. Can you change yourself? If you can’t, make a sound.”

Tang Le and Li Chun both looked over at the same time. Their eyes both said: “???”

Although there was nothing wrong with the words ‘working together as a team’ and ‘taking care of each other’, but when did Cap Song become so considerate?

Could only smart people get that kind of special treatment?

Were they unworthy?

Song Qinglan gave the two a cold look. The two of them quickly turned around and pretended that nothing had happened.

Suddenly faced with Cap Song’s kindness and also suddenly becoming one of the seventh squad out of nowhere, Ji Yushi couldn’t help but be suspicious.

But he wasn’t delicate to that extent and was even a little shocked, “Thank you, I can do it myself.”

Song Qinglan, “Are you sure?”

Ji Yushi: “I am sure!”

Ji Yushi then held the hem of his black combat uniform and raised it up.

The stitching just now was too painful, and his body was completely soaked. There was still a thin layer of sweat on his pale skin.

As it turned out, he really did require help. The pain from that action earlier had almost made him fall unconscious again.

Song Qinglan didn't just stand by and watch nor did he take the opportunity to laugh at him. He just wordlessly helped him pull out an arm to take off the blood-stained black combat uniform and then helped him put on the clean white T-shirt.

In an instant, Ji Yushi's appearance softened considerably. He looked like a naïve young man who should be holding a book.

When Song Qinglan was done helping him, he said, "You're welcome, Advisor Ji."

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan turned to ask Li Chun, "What is the situation now?"

No one answered.

Li Chun and Tang Le took turns looking through the binoculars. Their expressions were a little strange, "Uh, that, it's hard to say."

Ji Yushi stored the Diamond Bird away and stood up and fixed himself up, "Let me take a look."

Li Chun: "Oh."

Ji Yushi received the binoculars from Li Chun.

In the bookstore, Song Qinglan of Team 2 was currently holding Ji Yushi's arms behind his back and pressing him against the bookshelf. He appeared to be saying something stern while Ji Yushi had no ability to fight back — That was the time when Song Qinglan questioned how many cycles he had gone through and suspected him.

Ji Yushi placed down the binoculars and said to Song Qinglan, "Cap Song, the current situation is, you are wall slamming me." (*KKnotes: wall slamming = kabedon*)

Li Chun: "!!!"

Tang Le: “!!!”

Song Qinglan, “Me, wall slamming, you?”

Ji Yushi’s expression was natural.

Song Qinglan, “.....”

Since Song Qinglan showed kindness this time, Ji Yushi felt that he didn’t need to use the words ‘you tried to beat me up’.

He didn’t always hold grudges.

It was a matter of reciprocation.

\*

When the spacecar reached the building, it became a temporary gathering point.

Ji Yushi was the first to slide down the rope. He was injured and was very quickly caught by Zhou Mingxuan and Duan Wen and was helped into the car.

The appearance in the familiar spacecar was no different from when they set off from the park management office. The pile of equipment there had pretty much all that they needed — Ji Yushi immediately recalled the horrific scene from last time; a woman’s screams, loud curses, gunfire, the sight of a young girl lying in a pool of blood as well as the loud sound of the car hitting against a wall. It was all very clear.

The dark-skinned man held his Diamond Bird and shot wildly during this chaos.

There was no pain the moment the bullet penetrated him, but Ji Yushi could still clearly remember the process of it entering him so much so that the pain from his newly stitched wound grew even more intense.

But this car was still fine.

On another timeline, nothing had happened.

Song Qinglan was the last to enter, “Team 2 is nearby. In order not to be involved with them, has everyone turned off the location of your communicator?”

Everyone: “Turned off!”

Song Qinglan said, “Duan Wen, create an encrypted channel that only the people in this car can use.”

Duan Wen did as he was told.

Song Qinglan said, “There are still two or three hours before the black wall arrives here. Have you all understood the current situation? For those who haven’t, hurry up and ask any questions you have.”

Everyone immediately scrambled to ask.

Song Qinglan felt a headache coming and bluntly stopped them, “One by one!”

The Zhou Mingxuan from another timeline who had been busy driving the spacecar over and hadn’t had the time to process the information asked first, “Let me start first! Cap Song, according to the order of appearance, is this our current situation? So me, Duan Wen, Tang Qi, Tang Le and Li Chun, us five are from Team 4 whereas you and Advisor Ji are from Team 3. So that basically means that you from Team 3 and us from Team 4 have formed a team?”

Although it was a bit convoluted, it was indeed the case.

Zhou Mingxuan then asked, “Then, where did Cap Song and Advisor Ji as well as the rest of Team 3 go?”

Song Qinglan said, “After Advisor Ji and I were hijacked from the bookstore, Team 3 remained. Those people must be looking for us. At that time, I managed to get into contact with Tang Qi through the public channel and Tang Qi said he heard a loud noise so they shouldn’t have been far from



us. The place the spacecar was damaged was also along the way to the bookstore and Advisor Ji and I from Team 4 would most definitely go to the bookstore after separating from you. I believe that Tang Qi who was originally coming to pick us up after contacting me encountered our other selves from Team 4 who was their way to the bookstore.”

Zhou Mingxuan: “Fuck, I understand now. So basically Team 3 and 4 are still the original team and only Cap Song and Advisor Ji were switched!”

Song Qinglan, “That’s basically it. For the sake of distinction, we can call them Team B.”

Tang Le: “What about us?!”

Tang Qi supported his head, “Of course we’re Team A, little brother.”

Tang Le heard tone in his voice, “Sorry.”

Li Chun was stunned again, “They why didn’t Team B go to the bookstore? The reason why we found the spacecar at the park management office was to go to the bookstore to let Advisor Ji check something he didn’t have the chance to check. It stands to reason that even if we have formed two teams, they would definitely go to the bookstore.”

Sitting on a box of equipment, Ji Yushi rested his head against the wall of the car.

He slowly spoke, “Because the me of Team B must’ve also discovered the overlap of time and space.”

# Chapter 19.3: Chapter 19 Part 3

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 19 (Part 3)

Everyone looked back at him.

Ji Yushi's face didn't look too good, as if the smallest wind would blow him over.

The hope of solving this puzzle currently laid with Ji Yushi. Without Ji Yushi, they most definitely wouldn't be in this current situation and perhaps they would've already gone crazy.

Everyone felt bad for him, but they also couldn't do anything for him.

“But the me in Team B isn't hurt and didn't fall unconscious so after discovering the overlap in time and space, they most definitely reached a conclusion before us.” Ji Yushi said, “Team B is the same as us. They also know that if they go to the bookstore now, they would inevitably encounter Team 2 and a paradox would appear.”

This was also what Ji Yushi wasn't able to say to Song Qinglan before he fell unconscious.

Fortunately, Song Qinglan must have also thought of this and chose to remain nearby, observing the situation.

Of the two of them, one stood while the other sat.

But there was an inexplicable atmosphere between them, as if they were real partners, the kind that no one else could get between.

This kind of tacit understanding had at some point in time established between them.

Li Chun, “What paradox?”

It was hard for Ji Yushi to speak and he had to pause a little with each word.

Song Qinglan went on to say, “Because our existence comes from the third cycle and the reason for the third cycle is because all of Team 2 died. As a result, no matter whether Team A or Team B goes, it would most definitely change the fate of Team 3. The third cycle then wouldn’t be like this and we wouldn’t be here anymore.”

Everyone understood.

“So that’s why they won’t go to the bookstore.”

“I see!”

Ji Yushi nodded and then said, “There is actually one more thing. Do you remember the mission mode?”

Everyone said, “Ouroboros.”

“This is the key point to this current situation. I seem to understand it somewhat now.” Ji Yushi said, “Ouroboros holds the meaning of an infinite loop in Western legends. Since the beginning, we only understood the meaning on that level and thought it just meant that everything would restart after death but, in fact, the representation of ouroboros is a snake eating its own tail. It was a case of consuming oneself.”

Ouroboros symbolised infinity, no limit, no beginning and no end.

Ji Yushi picked up a knife next to him, “Cap Song, help me draw a circle.”

Song Qinglan replied and carved a white circle onto the floor of the car.

Ji Yushi took the knife back and used the tip of the knife to mark out a few spots on the circle.

“Look, no matter which point of the circle it is, it can be regarded as the starting point of the circle and it can also be regarded as the end.” He spoke very slowly, leaving time for the others to think and react, “This is similar to our current situation. In the first cycle, we were killed by a spacecar. It was because the people who chose to drive the spacecar was us ourselves. We encountered a roadblock and had to take the alley to reach the bookstore because we were hijacked by people on another timeline which resulted in damages blocking the road. After escaping from the bookstore, we were faced with a wire fence and was swallowed up by the black wall because the people who had hijacked us had raised that wire fence. As if everything was destined, all these incidents are linked, forming a circle on its own.”

“With the time anchor setting in place, time is fixed. That’s why, every trace we leave is like a point on this circle. There is no particular order, only cause and effect.”

Once done with this explanation, the large and complex world setting of PU-31 left everyone in shock.

Even though Song Qinglan had a faint guess, he didn’t analyse it as clearly as Ji Yushi did.

For a long time, no one in the car spoke.

“Older brother, did you understand?” Tang Le poked Tang Qi.

“Yeah.” Tang Qi answered coolly and after showing a slight look of confusion, he answered again as if he needed to confirm it once again, “Yeah.”

Zhou Mingxuan, “I can’t do it. I seem to understand but I also don’t seem to understand. I feel a little dizzy.”

Duan Wen took out a cigarette, “Want one?”

Li Chun, “Brother Wen, me too.”

After giving everyone a few minutes to digest this information, Song Qinglan made them put out the cigarettes.

Tang Le was worried. He asked the most critical question, “Then, Advisor Ji, can we still get out of this loop?”

Tang Qi had the same thoughts as him, “Could everything that we’re doing now also be a cause and effect? But nothing has changed?”

Perhaps the painkillers worked as Ji Yushi’s wounds didn’t hurt as much as before.

He was silent for a moment and answered honestly, “I don’t know.”

Song Qinglan suddenly spoke up, “We can definitely get out of this loop.”

He leaned back against the wall of the car. His posture was lazy, but his expression wasn’t at all relaxed, “Since we know what’s going on, there’s nothing to be afraid of. It’s just a loop. The only way is to not look back and keep pushing forward. Even if we fail, we have to leave a clue for next time. Don’t forget, we are not here to experience anything about cause and effect. Our purpose here is to complete the mission.”

Everyone slowly returned to their senses.

Song Qinglan asked, “Let me ask you. Do you want to go back?”

Everyone, “Yes!”

Song Qinglan nodded and then asked, “Then, are you afraid of death?”

Everyone, “Not afraid!”

“Then that’s it.” Song Qinglan laughed, “Why think so much? It’s enough to just understand what’s going on. Besides, although we don’t know where Team B is hiding, we now have two teams, A and B, which is equivalent to learning the doppelganger technique. Wouldn’t it be easier to complete the mission this way?”

Everyone's spirits were lifted. They even felt a little proud.

Song Qinglan then unceremoniously poured a bucket of cold water onto them, "Of course, the main point is that we have two Ji Yushi's who can analyse the situation."

Song Qinglan had said that without any psychological burden.

It was similar to the time when Ji Yushi said blankly that he wanted to lie down and win.

The situation had reversed.

Everyone: "....."

Suddenly, there was a soft sound outside the spacecar. Zhou Mingxuan threw away his cigarette butt and went out to check with his laser gun.

He only saw a grappling hook with a plastic bag nailed to the door of the spacecar.

Three or four zombies had followed the sound. Afraid of attracting more by making more of a commotion, Zhou Mingxuan pulled out a dagger and dealt with them cleanly with it instead. He returned with the plastic bag, "What is this?! There are people who still send messages like this?"

Song Qinglan seemed to have thought of something, "Open it and take a look."

There was a piece of paper and pen in the bag.

Opening that piece of paper, there was only one book title written in it: <Golden Crow No. 1: Propagation>?

"Let me see."

Ji Yushi reached out.

Song Qinglan handed it over.

“This is my handwriting.” Ji Yushi quickly understood, “This is from me in Team B! As I guessed, they also figured out the problem of overlapping time and space and knew that they couldn’t go to the bookstore to check the clues right now and have been following us!”

Team B’s Ji Yushi remembered that he needed to look for this clue but didn’t have the chance to read the book.

Everyone had goosebumps on their backs.

They were just saying that they didn’t know where Team B was hiding and now, they had appeared.

This was a different feeling from watching Team 2 in the bookstore. Team 2 was their past self while Team B was their present self.

Anyone would feel uncomfortable at the thought of two of themselves existing at the same time.

“Where did they get the paper and pen?” Duan Wen asked, “Should we contact them through the communicator?”

“No.” Song Qinglan stopped him, “Now that multiple timelines have been established, we must try to avoid being discovered by Team 2.”

Ji Yushi wrote very quickly.

He wrote down all the insights he saw from the book <Golden Crow No. 1: Propagation> and as he wrote, he said, “My earlier guesses were right. PU-31 itself is just an artificial colony in a parallel universe. It is located in the crevice, a marginal product that shouldn’t exist. In this universe, the earth’s energy has been exhausted and is almost completely gone and that is why there are many colonies like PU-31 which rely on various artificial energy to run. This also includes the artificial sun that emerged under the thermonuclear fusion project.”

“Artificial sun?” Song Qinglan found it incredible, “Golden Crow No. 1?”

“There is also No. 2.” Ji Yushi said, “I originally thought that cosmic radiation, dark matter or other elements in the artificial sun caused animals and plants to mutate. For example, the strange tasting Kemeng beans that nobody eats, but there were those survivors in black robes as well as that woman——”

“She said that after Golden Crow No. 2 was launched, her daughter has never been in the sun so she definitely wouldn’t mutate.” Song Qinglan immediately understood what Ji Yushi was saying, “That is to say, this zombie disaster is related to the artificial sun.”

“Because of the artificial sun, there are zombies?”

“Fuck, then we’ve been in the sun too. Would we also mutate?”

“This, I understand. It’s similar to a game saving function. As long as we return to the anchor point, it’s equivalent to not being exposed.”

Ji Yushi said, “Not only is it related to mutation, it also must have something to do with the chaser of darkness mentioned in our mission objective. Although I still don’t know what the connection is, there are two Golden Crow bases. We can go separately to find the answer.”

Song Qinglan waited for him to finish writing and then took the pen and signed underneath: Team A.

The two turned back when they were done.

They were met with five confused faces.

Li Chun, “I feel like I’m an NPC who doesn’t understand anything and just follows the protagonist around.”

Everyone nodded, “Aye.”

Zhou Mingxuan repacked everything in the bag and randomly tossed it out.

A group of zombies chased wildly after the bag.



Zhou Mingxuan: “.....”

After a while, there was another soft sound outside.

The bag had returned.

It said: We will go to Golden Crow No. 1.

It was signed below: Team A.

The A was also heavily circled, emphasising that they are Team A.

It was clearly Song Qinglan’s handwriting. He was speechless for a while, “Childish. To us, you are Team B.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Song Qinglan scribbled down the team members on the paper to give them an understanding of their team’s current state.

When the note came back, Song Qinglan frowned.

The current situation of Team B was: Song Qinglan, Ji Yushi, Duan Wen, Li Chun, Zhou Mingxuan, Tang Qi. Only Tang Le was missing.

An explanation was attached below: Remind Tang Le not to chase after a two-tailed dog.

There was even a stick figure drawn at the end and a cross over the neck.

Ji Yushi’s previous analysis in the bookstore appeared in Song Qinglan’s mind. At that time, he had said that the zombie that had appeared outside the bookstore in the second cycle wasn’t Tang Qi but Tang Le. Song Qinglan didn’t understand Ji Yushi at the time but now he did.

It turned out to be Tang Le from Team B.

At this moment, Tang Le was still talking to Tang Qi, alive and well.

More than ten hours ago, he had rushed into the bookstore and chugged down some water before saying to everyone, “There is something wrong with this place!”

Facing his teammates ridicule, he said he ran into a dog with two tails.

What he didn’t know was that ten hours later, his other self would be attracted over for the same reason and would die after trying to go after it.

Song Qinglan turned to the side and looked down at Ji Yushi who sat on a box of equipment.

The other person also happened to be looking at him. There were some doubts written in his beautiful eyes, as if he was asking him what’s wrong.

Time was endless, and the universe was vast.

Only wisdom and knowledge remained unchanged.

If one could find a lighthouse when they are lost, then they will be able to find their way home even if they had to cross the ocean or go over a mountain.

Song Qinglan retracted his gaze.

He scrunched the paper up into a ball and threw it out, “Pack up now. Let’s go to Golden Crow No. 2.”

## Chapter 20: Chapter 20

Ji Yushi had read a brief introduction to the base in the book <Golden Crow No. 1: Propagation> and he also saw a plan for the next stage of Golden Crow No. 2.

“The network here is closed, making it difficult to locate the base directly but we can still find it.” Ji Yushi said, “The base was built to be very large. It is of a hemispherical shape and the two bases are mirror images of each other.”

Song Qinglan thought for a while, “Does it look like an inverted bowl?”

Ji Yushi said yes.

Song Qinglan, “When you were checking the books at the bookstore, Duan Wen from Team 3 and I saw a place like that through the drone but I’m just not sure if it’s Golden Crow No.1 or Golden Crow No.2.”

As he said that, Song Qinglan made Duan Wen fly the drone out again to confirm.

The spacecar started moving.

From the back of the bookstore, they left the small hillside that they had been using as a temporary base.

From the distance, there were many buildings and lush greenery. Even the zombies wandering around aimlessly looked like ordinary humans, giving them a sense of what this world probably looked like if the mutations never occurred.

At this moment, the Team 2 from the second cycle was still searching for information in the bookstore and forming a plan.

They were completely unaware that in a little more than two hours, they would be chased by the black wall's sudden appearance, fail to escape using an old off-road car, and be completely annihilated by the black wall that obscured a large part of the sky.

As for the memory of escaping from the bookstore during the second cycle, all the teammates had no memory of it with the exception of Zhou Mingxuan who was still alive at the time.

Giving Tang Qi control of the spacecar, Zhou Mingxuan who possessed some vague memories felt very complicated inside.

“Advisor Ji, is it quite uncomfortable remembering all the bad memories?”

Zhou Mingxuan also sat on the floor and leaned against the car wall.

Like Song Qinglan, many people have heard about Ji Yushi's hyperthymesia, but they had never taken it seriously until now.

Zhou Mingxuan moved his hand to rub the short hairs on the back of his head, “In fact, I haven't been able to adjust too well. It feels like a nightmare and different point-of-views would appear from time to time. It's a little hard telling what's real.”

When the car hit the wire fence, Zhou Mingxuan who was in the driver's seat had directly died from a broken cervical spine.

What do people think of the moment before their death?

Zhou Mingxuan unfortunately could answer this question.

Ji Yushi quietly looked at him.

The white T-shirt in combination with his small face made him look frail.

Zhou Mingxuan looked in Song Qinglan's direction and said with embarrassment, "I'm definitely not as good as Cap Song but since Advisor Ji you can also do it, I want to ask you how I can adjust to this."

This time Zhou Mingxuan was ready to risk it all.

When Ji Yushi first joined the squad, he had looked down on him. Right now, he had slapped his own face several times.

Fortunately, Ji Yushi didn't put on airs and answered, "Distract yourself."

Zhou Mingxuan was puzzled.

Ji Yushi said to him, "Find something that makes you concentrate and soon you won't have the extra energy to think about the things you don't want to think about."

Zhou Mingxuan, "For example?"

Ji Yushi answered seriously, "For example, joining a new team and going to another world to fight against monsters together."

Duan Wen found the drone and set its position over that giant dome shaped building.

Song Qinglan said, "We have a spacecar. We should arrive before the people of Team B."

At that time it was the other Duan Wen who had discovered the base with him and now, that Duan Wen had joined Team B so Team B would most definitely go there too.

The spacecar rolled over a few zombies, spattering blood across the ground.

This road was outside of the main city so there weren't many zombies, but the road conditions were very bad.

About the time the catastrophe happened, many people probably thought of leaving the city. With many damaged and abandoned cars on the road, the

spacecar couldn't move too quickly.

"If it is determined that it is not Golden Crow No.2, we will need to move to the next base." Song Qinglan planned, "They have fewer people and lack equipment so we should leave some behind for them."

Please read this from kk translates

At some unknown point in time, Team A had become the most complete team and the one that is better equipped.

Except for Ji Yushi's injuries, they were more prepared than when they first arrived in this world.

Duan Wen asked, "Cap Song, do you need to contact them to explain? We are now outside the communication range of Team 2 so we shouldn't be afraid of causing a paradox."

Song Qinglan considered it.

Contacting Team B probably wouldn't cause any paradoxes since they were after all from parallel timelines that had generated at the same time and there was no causal relationship between them.

Furthermore, in addition to leaving equipment for Team B, Team B may also be able to give them something — For example, Ji Yushi's medicine.

When they were hijacked by the dark-skinned man, their communicators, equipment as well as Ji Yushi's medicine were all thrown out.

In addition to that, Song Qinglan also remembered the game console that was broken by the dark-skinned man. With Ji Yushi being so vengeful, he had pinned that dark-skinned man's hand to the car with a fierce expression the moment he broke free. Recalling it now, Song Qinglan even felt that he was rather handsome.

But what he didn't expect was that Ji Yushi would even bring the game console along to his mission. The scene of the other party skilfully handling

the Tetris blocks with his head bowed during class had left a deep impression on him.

Pretty deeply addicted.

Perhaps the game console was gifted by someone important.

Song Qinglan looked back. Ji Yushi was still sitting on a box of equipment like earlier with his back against the car wall and his eyes closed. It was unknown if he had fallen asleep due to fatigue or if he was tired from the pain.

Zhou Mingxuan sat next to him. It was unknown what he was thinking but he seemed to be afraid of Ji Yushi falling over after falling asleep and reopening his wound.

The other teammates were also afraid of disturbing Ji Yushi so they all tacitly kept quiet.

This was already a brand new Tianqiong seventh squad.

The corners of Song Qinglan's lips bent down. He said in a low voice, "Wait first. We can talk about it later when we need to contact them."

\*

The spacecar drove with great difficulty through the obstructed roads for almost an hour. Passing road signs, Song Qinglan was able to confirm that the place they had found was the Golden Crow No.1 base.

They drove through the main gates. The large spacecar looked very small in comparison to the giant circular building.

The scorching sun was high up in the sky at noon.

All their shadows were under their feet.

The metal surface of the building reflected the dazzling sunlight.

Ji Yushi had already opened his eyes. He supported up himself using the wall of the car and took in the scene from the front of the spacecar.

A five-metre-high wire fence surrounded the entire base. There was no greenery around, and the ground was bare. There were many zombies wearing white coats walking around aimlessly on the empty field.

Hearing the sound of the car, the zombies frantically rushed to the wire fence but were immediately shocked by high voltage electricity. The air was filled with the terrible smell of burnt flesh as well as the smell of a wasteland one would often see in science fiction films. It reminded people of the cause of this world's disaster as well as the world's source of light—The artificial sun.

The security equipment at the entrance of the base was still in operation. As soon as the spacecar approached, a warning was issued, "Dangerous zone. Please leave immediately."

The group divided up the equipment. Tang Qi and Zhou Mingxuan were responsible for carrying them off the car and placing it in the nearby security room.

Song Qinglan walked ahead opening the way for them. At this moment, he heard a small noise from above his head.

He looked up and saw a bee-sized drone circle around him.

In the car, Duan Wen also saw it and couldn't help but laugh and curse, "Fuck, this is controlled by the other me?"

Li Chun next to him grinned and urged him, "Brother Wen, hurry and say hello to your twin brother!"

Duan Wen: "Hey, it really does feel like I have a twin brother. If it were me, I would've also sent a drone to follow us. It's tacit understanding!"

Tang Le stared at his brother's back and said meaningfully, "When your older brother wants to beat you up for no reason, you won't like this kind of



tacit understanding.”

Just now in the car, Tang Qi and Cap Song had exchanged a few words before his expression turned ugly. He then came over and started to beat him up, “You sure have strong curiosity, huh? No discipline at all?!”

Tang Le was confused, “What did I do?!”

Tang Qi said as he hit him, “Next time you see a dog with two tails or a cat with three tails, don’t fucking chase after them! You understand?!”

“What dog and cat?!” Tang Le was furious, “Stop finding excuses. You’re just in a bad mood and want to vent by hitting your younger brother!”

Please read this from kk translates

At this moment, Ji Yushi who heard Tang Le complain said, “You’re right.”

Tang Le was happy to have someone who understood him, “Advisor Ji, you also have an older brother?!”

Ji Yushi said lightly, “Yes, but I’m the one beating him.”

Tang Le: “.....”

The drone hovered around until the three of them entered the security room before leaving. It is presumed that the distance between Team B and them wasn’t too far. They were at most half an hour away.

But soon, everyone saw the three of them come back out. They didn’t place the equipment down and just stood there saying something with a strange expression.

Even Song Qinglan’s expression wasn’t very good.

When everyone in the car saw this, they all got out the back door to check on the situation.

On the wasteland not far away, more than a dozen zombies were running towards the entrance of the base.

Gunfire sounded.

Brains exploded, and the zombies fell to the ground.

Ji Yushi had also used Diamond Bird to kill a few, causing the wound on his abdomen to be reopened. When he reached the security room, his forehead was sweaty, “What’s the matter?”

They originally planned to leave the equipment and go.

Ji Yushi had a bad feeling. He had always been very keen in this sense.

Ji Yushi stood in place while Tang Le and the others had already hurried into the room. When they came out again, their faces were all pale.

Song Qinglan had already pulled himself back together in a very short period of time.

Under this heavy atmosphere, he even spoke with a relaxed tone, “Do you want to hear the good news or the bad news?”

“Bad news.” Ji Yushi almost didn’t hesitate.

Under the scorching sun, his brows were wet from sweat, making him look fierce.

“The bad news is that for some reason we once again died.” Song Qinglan looked at them and spoke, “The good news is that the future us seems to be a little smarter and have left a message.”

It turned out that clues had been left in the security room of Golden Crow No.1.

A knife was used to engrave the following words onto the ground, “Turn off energy supply of the two bases.”

Signed below was: Team 5.

From the writing, it was left by Song Qinglan himself.

Team 5 had experienced everything they had and once the cycle restarted at the park, they didn't waste time and rushed straight to their destination.

Then, as Song Qinglan said before, they continued advancing. Even if they failed, they left clues behind for next time.

But no one could be happy hearing this.

Because every time the cycle restarted, it was due to the entire squad in the cycle before that being annihilated.

The so-called death elimination was indeed just as Ji Yushi had said. It was to ensure that the mission could be completed even if there was only one person left.

The emergence of Team 5 meant that whether it was the current Team 3 or the Team 4 from a parallel timeline, they would all die in this cycle, and thus Team 5 was born.

They had clearly just regrouped and pumped themselves up to do everything they could to clear the mission, but this clue was equivalent to leaving them with a death sentence, reminding them they were going to die soon.

In this foreign world established by the time anchor, they felt like fish caught in a net, unable to escape their predetermined fate.

Ji Yushi was shocked. His pupils gradually constricted.

Team 5.

Turn off energy supply of the two bases.

That black wall.....

Suddenly, a slight smile appeared on Ji Yushi's pale face. When he raised his head again, his eyes were bright, "I know how to clear it!"

Everyone: "???"

Although Song Qinglan didn't know what Ji Yushi thought of, a smile also appeared on his face.

He looked at Ji Yushi and asked, "Advisor Ji, is there a prize for guessing right?"

# Chapter 21: Chapter 21

Ji Yushi didn't deliberately keep the others hanging. Of course, there was no reward for guessing right.

“In fact, when we were forced to come to PU-31, the Tianqiong system had already given us a very important hint!” He spoke very quickly, “The focus is still Ouroboros! As I said before, Ouroboros is a circle and the marks we leave on the circle are in no particular order. No matter which points you look at it from, they can be each other's cause and effect, and because of this, we have been unable to find a breakthrough point in the cycle but \_\_\_\_\_”

The hearts of everyone were suddenly raised.

Ji Yushi raised, “What if we make an extension from a suitable point on that circle and cover up those points?!”

He knew that the others didn't understand what he meant but it was something that was very difficult to explain clearly.

Everyone waited for this god to continue talking but this god had instead calmly turned to the person next to him, “Tang Le, let me borrow your communicator.”

Ji Yushi and Song Qinglan's communicator had been thrown away by the dark-skinned man when they were hijacked earlier.

Because the original mission was only an A-level mission that they had done many times before, they didn't prepare many spare communicators. The only spare they had was paired with the subcutaneous communicators on their way here and was now being used by Song Qinglan so Ji Yushi at this time didn't have one.

“Use mine.” As if he had guessed what he wanted to do, Song Qinglan had already handed it over, “You can continue.”

The sun above was scorching.

Everyone returned to the spacecar. Song Qinglan asked Duan Wen to navigate the car to Golden Crow No.2.

On the way, Ji Yushi turned on the projection function of the communicator and planned to draw it out to explain.

Everyone immediately felt that this act of his was him taking their simple minds into consideration.

Ji Yushi redrew a circle.

It could be seen that he was a little excited. The expressive look on his face was so dazzling at this moment, it was hard for others to look away.

“As we already know, the time and space here is fixed because of the time anchor. The only thing that changes is us. We are the variables and will be represented by these points.” Ji Yushi chose different colours and placed many dots along the white circle in the air, “Every time our group is annihilated, another one of us will appear, that is to say, a new point will be created. For example, this green dot, let’s say they are us now.”

“We started off from this small green dot, passed through the red dot — That is, Team 1 which was annihilated in the first cycle, and then passed through the yellow dot — That is, Team 2 which is about to be annihilated outside the bookstore.”

As he said this, Ji Yushi extended the green dot along the circle so that it forms an arc passing through the points representing Team 1 and Team 2 and joining them.

“Look, during this period of time, Team 1 died but Team 2 hasn’t yet so us and Team 2 exist at the same time. This is the so-called overlap of time and space that we have talked about, right?”

Everyone nodded.

“This, I understand.”

“Understood.”

They seemed to be taking a strange class in another world. Everyone was very focused.

Ji Yushi continued, “Not long later, Team 2 will also be annihilated, but we are still moving forward.”

The arc extending from the green dot continued to stretch along the circle for a while before stopping.

Then, he added a blue dot where the green dot started.

“The blue dot represents Team 5.”

Ji Yushi drew a second arc along the circle so that the blue line passes through the red dot representing Team 1, the yellow dot representing Team 2 and the green line representing their current time, until it exceeded the point where the green line stopped.

“Team 5 only exists because we were annihilated so they have absorbed all the memories and experiences left by the previous points. They are now walking in front of us and have lived longer than us so they can leave clues behind for us.”

Song Qinglan understood what he meant, “So you mean, the time and space overlap phenomenon we just discussed may be more than just overlapping once. At the very least in this current time period, there is Team 2, us and Team 5 existing at the same time?”

Ji Yushi nodded. He pointed to the green line and said, “Because we are in our third cycle, we only know the things that have happened along the green line, so we don’t know how many times the group has been annihilated and how many times the cycle has started. It is not within our imagination.”

Zhou Mingxuan couldn't help but say, "Then wouldn't it mean that it is possible for countless of us to exist in this time period, distributed in different positions along that circle? In other words, over the twenty-four-hour time period in a day, perhaps there are three teams at two o'clock, five teams at four o'clock and eight teams at seven o'clock?"

Ji Yushi, "Correct."

The overlapping time and space would continue stacking up.

The more they thought about it, the more terrible it sounded.

Everyone was shocked.

Li Chun raised his hand, "I have a question."

Li Chun had worked very hard this time. He asked the question everyone was most concerned about, "Advisor Ji, didn't you and Cap Song mention earlier that Team 3 exists because Team 2 was annihilated, and that Team 4 was created because Team 2 avoided Team 3's spacecar thus accidentally establishing a parallel timeline? Since the generation of Team 3 and 4 is related to Team 2, Team 3 and 4 can communicate with each other but cannot communicate with Team 2 as it can change their trajectory and obliterate our existence."

Everyone nodded.

They couldn't help but stare at the short green arc on the circle. It was all they had right now.

Li Chun then asked, "Then the formation of Team 5 must be because we were annihilated. Why would they contact us? Are they not afraid that our trajectory would change, causing them to no longer exist?"

"You are right." Ji Yushi said, "After changing our trajectory, the causal relationship will be disrupted. Not only will Team 5 disappear, but all the points on the circle would also change as a result forming a new cause and effect scenario."



Li Chun asked, “But Advisor Ji, if we don’t get annihilated, Team 5 wouldn’t exist and there wouldn’t be clues left behind by them to be seen by us. Isn’t that another paradox?!”

The blind student had finally found the key point. Ji Yushi was very gratified. This was the counterattack of a study slag!

To answer his question, Ji Yushi asked Song Qinglan, “Cap Song, do you remember the two medicine boxes we saw at the bookstore?”

Song Qinglan nodded.

Ji Yushi, “One had been eaten and the other hadn’t, meaning that they are not items from the same timeline. The one that had two missing was probably left behind after I was wall slammed by you, it was just that we had arrived at the bookstore earlier in that timeline so it’s most likely Team 5’s.”

Wall slam?!

Tang Le and Li Chun who saw the scene with their own eyes kept quiet.

The others: “???”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

The topic shouldn’t go off track. Song Qinglan pulled it back, “And then?”

“Two timelines exist at the same time.” Ji Yushi said, “Just like when we met Team 2. As long as Team 2 has not been annihilated, we will be able to see all their traces and they will naturally see ours.”

“I understand now. In the other hand, as long as we haven’t reached the point where we are annihilated and the people in Team 5 aren’t dead, we can receive their messages!”

“Then the paradox Chun’er said hasn’t happened yet!”

“I see, it’s practically a bug!”

Everyone wondered, “But after changing our trajectory, they will eventually disappear. Why would Team 5 do this?”

“Because they want our team to continue.” Song Qinglan understood and said, “It is likely because the energy supplies of the two bases needed to be shut down and they had encountered danger along the way, so Team 5 is now seriously short of hands. To them, we currently have Team 4 from a parallel timeline and can form two teams, A and B. It is the most suitable point on the circle to be ‘extended’.”

“That’s right.” A smile flashed across Ji Yushi’s face, “Like Cap Song said before, even if it seems like an endless loop, as long as we don’t look back and keep moving forward, starting from Team 5 we will continue to search for clues and leave it for the current us. Even if they will disappear, the new Team 6 and Team 7 will also do the same and leave behind clues. With that, even if the future us continues to disappear, the us at this point in time, that is, the green line, would continue to extend infinitely along the circle, covering all the points that have or haven’t appeared — until the task is completed!”

The last line was spoken with passion and it echoed in everyone’s hearts for a long time.

It was hard to imagine how many of their future selves are rushing forward!

They never looked back. Even if they were faced with death or suffering, they desperately left behind valuable clues, just to allow their past self to break through the cycle and clear this!

Song Qinglan faced Ji Yushi. His eyes held unconcealable appreciation, “Advisor Ji, is this what you were talking about earlier?”

“It is just one of it.” Ji Yushi’s black eyes were bright, “There is another point. If we can make it to Golden Crow No. 2 on time, we may get the answer right away.”

\*

Outside the Golden Crow No. 2 base.

This place looked exactly the same as the Golden Crow No.1 base. Except for the enormous dome shaped structure, it was surrounded by wasteland.

The only difference was that a bunch of zombies in white coats had already been electrocuted to death by the five-metre-high wire fence.

Hearing the sound of a car coming, a new wave of zombies gathered in the open space, stepping onto the charred corpses of their own kind and rushing towards the wire fence.

Please read this from kk translates

The security equipment at the entrance of the base was also still in operation but the barrier had been smashed and zombies gushed out from inside. They were very soon crushed into pulp by the roaring spacecar.

The spacecar drove into the dome.

The lights in the large building were dazzling. There were two blood stains on the clean white floor as well as scattered limbs.

More than ten metres in front was another spacecar. The back door was wide open and even from a distance, they could see that the interior was exactly the same as theirs.

Duan Wen, “Cap Song, is that Team 5’s spacecar?!”

Song Qinglan, “Yes.”

Ji Yushi had said that they would get the answer as soon as they arrived. The people of Team 5 are still alive!

“Grrrr——”

From a room one could barely see, a glass door opened, and a group of zombies rushed out.

They rushed over to the front of the spacecar, their pale faces and grey eyes reflected in the glass. Those rotting mouths and blood-stained coats made it easy for them to imagine how terrible and horrifying the situation must've been when the tragedy started.

Song Qinglan, "Everyone get ready to get off."

Everyone moved. Ji Yushi also stood up. He found a bottle of water in the car and swallowed another painkiller.

It had only been a few hours since he was injured. He hadn't eaten or rested and the medicine from earlier may not be much help.

But in this situation, no one asked for the wounded to stay in the car. Ji Yushi also had no intentions to do that.

Ji Yushi checked Diamond Bird and filled it up, "We should go directly to the control room!"

Song Qinglan also replenished his equipment. His pockets were heavy.

"Listen to Advisor Ji. We're blasting our way to the control room." He said solemnly, "Pay attention to clues on the way. Don't shoot at any suspicious people for the time being. Don't accidentally kill yourself!"

Everyone: "Yes!"

Opening the spacecar, the well-equipped team filed out.

"Bang, bang, bang!"

Gunshots echoed in the empty field.

The journey was almost unimpeded. Zombie heads exploded, adding onto the existing corpses. The extremely disgusting smell mixed with air-conditioning was nauseating.

It could be seen that a fierce battle had taken place here before.

Entering a wide corridor, a large glass cabinet on the wall displayed the various achievements since the launch of Golden Crow No. 2. It didn't make them fascinated but instead they felt like they were looking at some abnormal and warped exhibition.

Asexually produced poultry, cloned mammals, eggs that do not need to be hatched.....As well as apples, pears and mangos that could grow on the same tree.

This weird ecological environment and the discomfoting innovations seemed to be inventions the scientists of this colony were proud of.

When they passed by a dark display cabinet, everyone was confused at first.

After looking carefully, they saw long and thick earthworms squirming inside, churning out soil.

It turned out to be artificial soil.

There were many vegetables in the artificial soil that they have not seen before. One was a green bean that split into two. Each of them was covered in a network of veins, much like the blood vessels on the zombie faces. It was particularly grotesque.

“Fuck.” Li Chun wanted to vomit again, “Bleugh, I said I didn't want to eat it.....”

“Shut up!!”

Please read this from kk translates

Everyone cursed.

“.....” Ji Yushi wanted to join in. With a hard-working spirit, he had forced a whole can of that down with great difficulty.

For such a large construction project, there were probably thousands of people working here but at this time it was like a slaughterhouse.

The pungent smelling zombie remains left behind countless dark red footprints on the ground. If they weren't careful, they could slip.

Ji Yushi walked the slowest, but he was very steady.

Song Qinglan turned back a few times and would always see his usual delicate side profile as well as his figure holding Diamond Bird, holding firm like a cypress.

Will he remember all of this?

Song Qinglan suddenly thought of this. He couldn't help but frown.

"Cap Song!" Tang Qi at the forefront shot down a wave of zombies and seemed to have discovered something.

In a large circular exhibition hall at the end of the corridor, everyone was left stunned by the holographic projection.

It was a real-time projection of PU-31.

On the holographic screen, there was a pitch-black crevice.

This small round planet sat next to that crevice, filled with greenery and life.

The artificial sun was diagonally above, simulating the angle at which a sun would illuminate the earth. Hundreds of large energy transmitters located on the surface of the planet was used to generate energy for PU-31.

Golden Crow No. 1.

Golden Crow No. 2.

A false world. Because of their appearance, the beautiful dream of sustaining life had now become a nightmare.

"The Golden Crow project not only provides heat and light, it also provides kinetic energy. Almost all the energy in this colony comes from here." As Ji

Yushi looked at the projection of PU-31, a reflection of it was reflected in his eyes, “The black wall.....is just a crevice between parallel universes. The Golden Crow project plans to obtain energy from this crevice in the universe and distribute it to these energy transmitters so that they can create light like a god.”

Suddenly, the picture before him flashed and changed.

A circle of black suddenly appeared on the surface of PU-31, as if all the energy transmitters where the black circle was had lost control at the same time.

At this moment, the time displayed on the screen was: [1470.08.05 14:32:53].

“It’s Team B. They have shut down the first set of energy transmitters in Golden Crow No. 1.”

Ji Yushi’s voice was a little cold.

“That’s the black wall!!!”

“I know now! I know now!! Brother, this is that damned Ouroboros again!!”

“It’s the one that wiped out Team 2?!”

“The black wall turned out to be something we fucking did to ourselves!”

“Fuck!!”

“Cap Song!” Duan Wen’s voice travelled over. His tone sounded a little strange.

Song Qinglan walked over.

In just a moment, there were only two or three teammates with Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi looked away from the holographic projection and strode over to the place where they found an anomaly. He could vaguely guess what had happened.

Before reaching the place, he could already smell a strong bloody scent.

It wasn't the stench from a zombie's corpse, but a particularly fresh one that seemed to be filled with vitality.

Ji Yushi involuntarily tightened his grip around Diamond Bird.

The cold gun body was just like how his heart was at this moment.

His gaze passed through his tall and strong teammates. He only had the chance to see a pool of blood and a dismembered limb wearing a black boot.

The scene before him turned black. His eyes were gently covered by a warm palm.

He heard Song Qinglan say, "Don't look."



# Chapter 22: Chapter 22

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 22

“Don’t look....at what?”

Under the strong smell of blood, Ji Yushi’s eyes were covered and he couldn’t see anything, but his brain automatically began to replay the scene he saw just now.

It was just a glance.

But his brain had involuntarily noted down all the details.

It was still the same marble-like floor like outside, white and smooth, but blood covered most of his field of vision. Mixed together with that blood was something white and sticky and to the far left of the pool of blood, there was something thin and flesh coloured. It was someone’s right ear.....If he moved his eyes a little, he could see white skin and muscles. That was someone’s thigh.....Following that was a mass of red that looked like intestines as well as scattered teeth and if he looked a little further, there was a calf wearing a black boot.

Ji Yushi only felt a strong bout of nausea.

He couldn’t be mistaken.

That was his own calf.

As for ear and other pieces of flesh in the pool of blood, they belonged to the teammates who were still standing next to him.

In other words, he had almost witnessed the complete annihilation of Team 5.

“Grrrrr!!”

Ji Yushi heard it. It was the sound of a zombie rushing over from the end of the corridor. Before it could reach them, it was killed with a ‘bang!’.

The gunfire came from next to him. Song Qinglan who was covering his eyes from behind had fired a shot with one hand.

The people around seemed to find it unsettling. They all quickly scattered away.

“What is that?!”

“Insect legs?”

“Slimy and sticky, it’s liked a damned spider web!”

Ji Yushi followed Song Qinglan along for a few steps before he finally removed the hand in front of his eyes.

Everyone in the team was pale, their expressions also very ugly.

Even if they knew that their future selves would continue to pave the way for their present selves, seeing firsthand how that path was formed was something they couldn’t imagine.

“Warned you a little too late.” Song Qinglan suddenly spoke, “Next time, I’ll try to be faster.”

Ji Yushi was stunned. It took him a while to realise that Song Qinglan was talking to him.

The other party’s cold and stern face showed sincere concern under the bright lights. It was concern from a captain towards their teammate, but there was also a trace of emotion that Ji Yushi couldn’t decipher — The

same kind of emotion he had seen in his teacher's eyes when he was young. Because of this, he was a little surprised.

"Thank you." He said.

Song Qinglan, "Team 5 split up. Half of them are at the Golden Crow No. 1 base. Don't think too much, there is no 'you' there."

This time Ji Yushi was really surprised.

But Song Qinglan's expression was still natural: "So treat it as if you hadn't seen it."

Duan Wen was still standing at the entrance to that large room. His psychological endurance seemed to be pretty good. He suddenly shouted, "Cap Song! This Old Zhou seems to still be alive!"

Song Qinglan, "Having lasted until now, he must have something to say. I'll go over."

As he said that, he strode over to that room without any hesitation.

One of the teammates couldn't handle the sight and had ran away to throw up. This time it wasn't Li Chun, but Zhou Mingxuan.

Anyone who saw themselves dying so tragically wouldn't be able to stay completely calm.

Ji Yushi wondered: What exactly happened here?

Why was Song Qinglan able to control his emotions so well despite having clearly seen that scene? Was it to comfort him, fearing that he would not be able to complete the next task?

A minute or two later, Song Qinglan quickly left the room filled with blood, leaving a trail of bloody footprints on the floor.

His tone was sharp and cold, "Hurry and move on! Close the corridor gates now!"

No sooner said than done, as soon as Song Qinglan said that, everyone heard noises coming from the direction they had come from. It didn't sound like it belonged to a zombie, let alone the sound of human footsteps!

At the end of the corridor, a black shadow the size of a car had appeared.

It was injured. Covered with brown and black markings and hair as well as possessing eight legs that span almost two metres in length, it faced the crowd and bared its fangs.

“Fuck! A spider!”

Everyone's scalp went numb. Someone yelled this out amidst the confusion and they all quickly turned around and ran in the direction pointed out by Song Qinglan.

The corridor gates were about ten metres away from them. It was just a short distance but at this moment it felt like it stretched endlessly into the distance.

Although that spider was injured, it still relied on the instincts it had been blessed with. It completely ignored the walls and ground and rushed towards them with an unimaginable speed.

“Bang, bang, bang!”

The team opened fire, but the giant spider's abdomen and back were covered with hard armour, making it difficult for the bullets to penetrate.

The giant spider landed to the ground. The ground was covered in blood, making it difficult for it to maintain its balance using its five legs. It suddenly slipped, giving Tang Qi who had already reached the gates the opportunity to push down the hydraulic lever.

“Hurry!”

“Cap Song!”

The moment the last of them rolled past the gate, the giant spider had also reached the gate.

The gate blocked air and sound completely but everyone still seemed to hear a loud ‘bang!’ when the spider rammed itself against the thick glass barrier. Its mouth was wide open and white sticky fluid slid down the glass.

Li Chun cursed, “What the hell is this?! Was this also something they have been researching?!”

“White-tailed spider.” Ji Yushi spoke up, “A commonly indoor spider. Carnivorous. Generally speaking, it hides in dark spaces or in crevices and comes out at night to catch cockroaches, mosquitoes, flies and other insects.”

“How can something so big hide in a crevice?” Tang Le cried out, “I was almost bitten to death by that!”

Ji Yushi was almost all-knowing. His teammates were no longer surprised by his explanations that would appear from time to time.

To put it very simply, this spider had mutated due to some other reason.

Hearing Tang Le mention being almost bitten to death, everyone recalled their future selves — The tragic scene of Team 5. They all thought of a possibility. Could it be that Team 5 was annihilated by these spiders?!

“Clang! Clang!”

The giant spider got up from the ground and proceeded to climb the gate using its five legs. With the abdomen pressed against the glass, a row of densely packed white spheres surrounded by spider thread appeared before them. They couldn’t help but shudder. They very quickly realised that those were unhatched eggs.

“Not just this one.” Song Qinglan said solemnly, “Continue on ahead.”

“Cap Song!” Ji Yushi’s eyes were still looking outside.

He only yelled this out and didn't continue.

Song Qinglan who looked back at him was also startled.

Everyone saw an incredible scene.

Outside the corridor gate, everything had changed right before their eyes.

Those bloody footprints on the ground no longer existed and the zombie corpses and rotten flesh piled up in the corridor had similarly disappeared. At a rate visible to the naked eye, everything had been restored to its original state. More than a dozen zombies wearing white chemical protection clothing wandered aimlessly around the corridor. There was no trace of that giant spider on the opposite side of the glass.

Time seemed to have gone backwards.

All the traces left by Team 5 had disappeared.

Just like Ji Yushi's analysis from earlier, once a paradox occurs, the points that have appeared or have yet to appear on the circle would be covered by this 'extended' timeline of theirs, and the timeline for Team 5 would cease to exist.

Having managed to escape past the gate, they had all successfully survived.

This is was their numerous future self's ultimate objective.

But Song Qinglan had said that there was more than one giant spider.

It must've been a clue Zhou Mingxuan of Team 5 had left for him.

Everyone was still in shock. Before they could mourn for their future selves, they saw three similar sized giant spiders appear on the ceiling in the distance. They ignored the zombies and wandered around, their eight intact legs moving extremely fast. They very quickly concealed themselves in the dark again.

Ji Yushi knew that these spiders are quietly hiding away, using the hairs on their legs to detect vibrations in the air. If anything living came their way, they would suddenly appear and tear up the food that had sent themselves to them.

After a moment of silence, Song Qinglan said, “Let’s go.”

They had already passed through the corridor, reaching another open space.

This dome was more than a hundred metres high. It was too large for them to immediately find the control centre.

At this moment, a green light flashed on Song Qinglan’s communicator.

Duan Wen had at some point in time turned off the silence mode on the communicator.

Immediately afterwards, everyone heard Ji Yushi’s voice coming through the communicator. This included Ji Yushi himself.

“Cap Song.”

A clear and cold voice sounded through the public channel for the first time.

It was Ji Yushi from Team B.

Probably because it felt strange calling out his own name, the Team B Ji Yushi chose to speak to Song Qinglan, “After going past the corridor gate, enter the first gate on the left, go down two floors, and after you follow the path for half a circle, you will see the control centre.”

From what everyone saw from the real-time holographic projection just now, Team B had already found the control centre and turned off the first set of energy transmitters.

The two bases were mirror images of each other. Team B’s Ji Yushi was naturally as meticulous as Team A’s, so he immediately thought of passing on the information to them.

Everyone was surprised.

This kind of experience was too strange. They were clearly standing in front of Ji Yushi who wasn't speaking but they heard his familiar voice travel through from the public channel. Even the tone of his voice was exactly the same.

Song Qinglan also found this experience very novel.

He looked at Ji Yushi who was looking quietly back at him, as if waiting for him to finish talking to 'someone else'.

"How is your situation there?" Song Qinglan asked.

"Everything went well."

Another familiar voice also appeared.

Song Qinglan was startled as soon as he heard it. He almost thought he was listening to his own voice recording.

It was the other Song Qinglan.

The tone was casual and careless, but it also gave those hearing it an urge to beat him up, "Except for a little too many zombies and half of the people from Team 5 disappearing, there were no problems. We're right now waiting for Advisor Ji to work out the order of turning off the energy transmitters. If we're not careful and end up putting an end to our lives, how would we be able to go over and help you?"

Everyone: "....."

Hearing the silence, the other Song Qinglan continued, "It's too much for you to handle on your end, isn't it? It is said that the second base is filled with mutations of SSS-level difficulty."

Everyone: "....."



Sure enough, no matter which Cap Song it was, they all have a knack for making the atmosphere be filled with the smell of gunpowder.

Gunshots sounded and it was followed by the sound of zombies falling. Li Chun of Team B's cursing became part of the background sound.

Ji Yushi of Team B reminded, "Cap Song, fourth row, the sixth from the left."

Song Qinglan of Team B, "Righto, I'm on it."

The call was cut off.

For some reason, Song Qinglan felt that the way the others looked at him was a little strange.

Ji Yushi also retracted his gaze. He seemed to be a little unaccustomed to the way he and Song Qinglan in Team B interacted.

Song Qinglan bent down the corners of his lips, "Let's go. Our side is SSS difficulty."

# Chapter 23: Chapter 23

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 23

Everyone went in the direction pointed out by Team B's Ji Yushi. Their destination was clear.

It seems that the friendship between Team B's Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi had somehow progressed by leaps and bounds after they separated from the original Team 4 members at Runjun Building.

Duan Wen who walked at the front said, "Cap Song, come to think of it, it really is such a coincidence that both you and Advisor Ji in Team 3 and 4 separated from the group. It really must be fate."

Li Chun who was at the back blew away several zombies and rubbed his shoulders that was sore from the recoil, "Yeah, I wouldn't have noticed it if Brother Wen didn't mention that. On both sides, Cap Song and Advisor Ji just happened to be together. It seems that even in a parallel timeline, it is very likely for the same choice to be made!"

No matter when it was, the people in this squad are always ready to talk nonsense.

Even after personally witnessing their own deaths and then fighting a giant spider, and even with unknown danger waiting for them ahead, they were able to quickly talk about other matters.

—This may be Tianqiong seventh squad's way to divert attention.

Only by adjusting their mood and adjusting their condition such that they are ready to deal with the next wave that may appear at any point in time can they be regarded as a squad that advances like a sharp arrow.

Ji Yushi felt that he understood this seventh squad a little better.

The surroundings were empty. Ever since that gate closed, they only encountered a couple of zombies along the way and there weren't any other threats. They were able to solve it with just the use of a knife and didn't need to use their guns.

Tang Le said, "Then what happened after the separation would also be very similar?"

"Probably not." Tang Qi said, "Did you forget? When we found Cap Song and Advisor Ji, they were trapped in that small green kiosk."

Zhou Mingxuan's small eyes carried a hint of teasing, "Oh, that kind of green kiosk. I also saw a few on the way with Old Duan. The people in this area are very open-minded! Did Cap Song reach an enlightenment after being in there? Maybe after going back, we can retire and devote ourselves to this field to earn a living."

Ji Yushi: "....."

What was this? Openly ridiculing your boss or trying to matchmake?

Did this group of people forget that they have a deep homophobic setting?

Song Qinglan carried Shen Mian and didn't relax for a single moment.

His pupils constricted, and he looked around at their surroundings vigilantly. At the same time, he spoke nonsense, "I did reach an enlightenment. It's better than inflatable dolls. Once we're back, I'll give each of you one."

Zhou Mingxuan chuckled.

And then he was kicked in the ass by Song Qinglan. It was just like the scene in the training room before they left.

Song Qinglan, “How about giving you the whole teams?!”

Zhou Mingxuan smiled and moved a few steps away, “That’s not necessary. It’s too much. My body can’t take it.”

“Cap Song.”

Tang Qi spoke up. He was seeking his opinion.

Everyone had reached the “first gate on the left” mentioned by Team B’s Ji Yushi. They saw a password panel on the side indicating that it was a secret passageway.

Behind them was an open field and before them was a gate leading to the unknown. In view of Team B’s Song Qinglan’s “filled with mutations of SSS-level difficulty”, everyone at this moment was a little reluctant to leave the safe zone.

Who knew what they would encounter inside there?

Song Qinglan looked through the glass on the gate and saw that it was another clean and tidy corridor. There wasn’t even a single zombie.

Song Qinglan made a hand gesture.

Everyone raised their guns and aimed them at the corridor on the other side of the gate.

Duan Wen took out a password cracking device and connected it to the panel. With high-speed processing, the password lock should’ve been cracked in ten seconds, but the panel still showed a red light.

This era was far more advanced than the era they came from and it couldn’t be cracked. Duan Wen got ready to try something else.

“Try fingerprint.”

Ji Yushi on the side suddenly said this and handed over a bloody hand.

Everyone looked over, “.....”

Duan Wen received the severed hand, “Advisor Ji, when did you——”

“When you were talking about inflatable dolls.” Ji Yushi spoke calmly,  
“There was a zombie nearby so I cut it off along the way.”

Everyone: “!!!”

So cruel!

If he didn’t see Ji Yushi quietly wipe his hand that held the severed hand on his black combat pants, Song Qinglan would’ve actually thought that Ji Yushi was really that calm.

In the end, for someone who liked cleanliness, just wiping it on his pants was enough to consider it as clean?

Song Qinglan found it a little funny.

“Beep.”

After a short beep, the door quietly opened.

Everyone kept silent.

Song Qinglan took out a small object from his pocket, knelt down, and threw it into the centre of the empty corridor.

That small object that emitted red light fell onto the ground and let out a small explosion which echoed down the deep corridor. The shockwave was enough to be felt by those giant spiders.

One second, two seconds. No spiders appeared.

There were also no other giant mutated insects.

Everyone breathed a sigh of relief, Suddenly, noisy footsteps and growls came from the depths of the corridor. Countless zombies in white coats appeared to gush out from several underground floors at the same time like ants rushing out of their nests. An unimaginable number of them rushed towards them at an incredible speed.

There were no giant spiders, but they were met with the largest group of zombies they had ever seen!

“Fuck, fuck, fuck!”

“Kill them all!”

“Bang, bang, bang!”

With firepower at the maximum, they shot at the large wave of zombies.

They had made sufficient preparations this time. The bombs Tang Qi and Zhou Mingxuan had brought along had not been brought in vain. Just throwing a few of them got rid of a large number of the zombies.

With the additional fact that they were standing at the entrance to the corridor, no one thought about running when faced with this scene before them. Those zombies are just flesh and blood. This time, they had enough ability to beat them all down!

Blood and flesh flew everywhere. The walls, floors and ceilings were all splattered with blood.

Waves of zombies followed one after another, but within a few minutes, the corridor was piled up with zombies. This continued until no more of them appeared.

Having been besieged and chased by zombies the entire time, everyone felt some thrill after crushing this group of zombies with an overwhelming force.

“Awesome!”

“Damned awesome!”

“Go!”

Song Qinglan checked the remaining bullets for Shen Mian and took out a new glowing blue magazine from his pocket. 1024 rounds were used up in an instant.

The seven of them went into formation and advanced ahead.

Ji Yushi was in the centre. This was an excellent safety zone for a scout. He also changed his magazine.

The smell of something rotting filled the nose. Walking through the floor covered in blood and filth and stepping on the innocent mutated corpses that were once the same as them, they successfully reached the core of the building on the second floor.

This floor was the control room. There were countless densely packed control panels. From afar, it looked like there were thousands of them. Those mutant zombies just now were probably staff who had worked day and night here to maintain the operation of PU-31.

“The number isn’t right.” Song Qinglan frowned.

“What numbe——”

Duan Wen’s words were interrupted by a loud shout.

“Ah!!”

Everyone instantly turned their heads and saw Li Chun being swept up by something and dragged into the vent. They were only able to see his shoes and dripping mucous before he completely disappeared inside!

“Chun’er!!”

Everyone shouted. There was rustling in the vent as well as the sound of gunfire. Li Chun who was being dragged away was still shooting!

After about thirty-five seconds, the sound of gunfire disappeared.

“What was that?!”

“I seemed to have seen something like a sucker!”

“That wasn’t another damned spider?!!”

“No! I don’t think it was!”

Song Qinglan immediately cut them off, “Go! Continue onwards!”

As soon as he finished saying this, another thing dropped from the air vent with a ‘clang’. That thing looked like a tongue, but it was covered with suckers. With a ‘whoosh’, it attacked the nearest Zhou Mingxuan!

Zhou Mingxuan immediately rolled away. Soon afterwards, the teammates shot at the ‘tongue’ which had suddenly appeared, only to hear a strange scream sound from above them. That ‘tongue’ suddenly retracted, leaving only a tip of it curled up on the ground like it was still alive.

There was vibration in the vent above them. That ‘tongue’ was probably running away.

Song Qinglan fired a few shots in the direction of the sound with a dark expression but soon lost trace of it.

Ji Yushi had already walked over. With one hand covering his painful abdominal wound and the other holding a dagger, he examined that object.

It was slimy and soft, and it very soon stopped moving.

Ji Yushi didn’t even blink. It was unknown what he was thinking.

“Go downstairs!”

Song Qinglan ordered again.



Everyone went together. This time they walked a lot more closely, ensuring that no one would fall behind.

The so-called mutations didn't just apply to spiders. Li Chun's disappearance cast a shadow of anger and panic in everyone's hearts but there was no time for them to mourn for him.

Unfortunately, before they could reach the end of the corridor, a new wave of zombies appeared from around the corner!

“Grrr——”

Song Qinglan was right. The number of zombies that had been wiped out in the corridor just now really wasn't right.

It was unknown if the commotion from the monster's surprise attack gave away their location. From downstairs and all around them, several times more zombies than before arrived at the same time!

With a 'slap', Ji Yushi arm felt both cold and painful. That 'tongue' had once again appeared from above and managed to accurately wind itself around his arm!

Diamond Bird fell onto the ground as a result of the pain and Ji Yushi was pulled into the air!

“Advisor Ji!”

Amid the gunfire, someone shouted.

The teammates were too busy to even take care of themselves. Ji Yushi pulled out his dagger and fiercely stabbed it into that 'tongue' but this time, that monster seemed to have remembered the failed attempt last time and just screamed and tightened its 'tongue' even more. Ji Yushi could almost feel the bones in his arms cracking under the pressure.

He was about to be dragged into the vent!

At this moment, Ji Yushi heard a roar.

“Ji Yushi!”

He saw Song Qinglan turn his muzzle in his direction in spite of the numerous zombies in front of him and fire at the ceiling. Screams came from the vents and Ji Yushi suddenly found himself falling back onto the ground.

Ji Yushi landed on the ground and was still lying on his side, but he immediately shouted, “Don’t move!”

At this critical moment, his purple hand reached for his Diamond Bird and he fired a few times at the zombies behind Song Qinglan!

This kind of tacit understanding....

The zombies close at hand were shot in the head. Zombie blood and brain matter exploded onto Song Qinglan’s face.

“You’re welcome.” Song Qinglan said, “Thank you.”

Ji Yushi:”.....”

He actually said the lines for both of them himself.

Song Qinglan didn’t even move to wipe away the blood and just took out the only red magazine from his pocket with a calm expression.

The teammates continued to shoot at the wave of zombies. Ji Yushi was lifted from the ground by Zhou Mingxuan.

Thousands of zombies surrounded them. At a glance, it looked endless.

Song Qinglan held Shen Mian and changed the magazine at an incredible speed.

‘Click’. Ji Yushi seemed to hear the sound of it being loaded amidst the deafening gunfire and roars.

“Do you know what Shen Mian’s full name is?!”

Song Qinglan's entire body emitted a thug-like air. At this moment, Ji Yushi saw strong killing intent and wildness on his face.

The teammates next to him seemed to have realised something and gradually gathered to his side.

Not waiting for Ji Yushi's response, Song Qinglan answered, "Sleeping god."

"Boom!!!"

An earth-shattering boom sounded. This level of the base shook violently and shockwaves transmitted to their ears, causing severe pain in everyone's eardrums as well as a sharp ringing sound.

Above them, parts of the ceiling fell, crushing the zombies underneath.

"Cover your ears!!!"

The bombing continued. With three consecutive shots, everyone saw that the entire wave of zombies on the path leading downstairs had been completely crushed!!

At the rear of the building, a large hole had formed and there was a spacecar there. Some zombies changed targets and rushed towards the spacecar instead.

A familiar tall figure stood on top of the spacecar. Standing against the light, he held a pitch-black Shen Mian in his hand and the red light from the magazine gradually dimmed.

Other familiar figures also appeared on the spacecar one after another.

Duan Wen, Zhou Mingxuan, Tang Qi, Tang Le, Li Chun and Ji Yushi. Including the person that led them, it was a total of seven people.

That person was indeed Song Qinglan. His tone was very stern, "When I left, I thought it was an A-level mission, so I didn't bring much equipment.

This is originally very precious. Song Qinglan, you shouldn't be using three of them here in this place."

The two teams looked at each other from afar.

One was clean and tidy, while the other was in a rather pathetic state.

Song Qinglan was covered in blood. The Shen Mian in his hand that didn't have the chance to be used was still glowing with red light.

Everyone behind him were almost at their limits and on the verge of falling into despair.

On the other end, the Song Qinglan standing on the spacecar looked at them with interest and then spoke up, "It is not the end yet. We from Team 6 are here to assist. You're welcome."

The light blurred their vision.

Dust scattered in all directions.

As soon as he finished speaking, the scene before them changed.

Those seven people who had appeared like gods as well as the spacecar suddenly disappeared.

The large hole in the building also began to recover, and the corpses of the zombies beside them that had been blown apart and crushed seemed to be slowly reorganising.

At this moment, everyone immediately understood one thing.

Use this chance and get downstairs!!

# Chapter 24: Chapter 24

One floor.

Two floors.

It was just a short distance of going down two floors, it was clearly very close, but it became a path to survival that almost seemed unreachable.

The respite from their future selves seemed to have given them a chance to breathe.

Time seemed to have slowed down. The wave of zombies resurrected, the building gradually restored itself and the giant spider appeared hanging from a thick spider thread. At this very moment, all the changes that happened were processed in slow motion as a result of heightened senses and pumping adrenaline.

Ji Yushi supported himself using his purple hand and followed the teammate in front to jump down when he suddenly found the floor below him gone.

“Thud!”

As soon as his feet landed, seven or eight pairs of pale hands stretched out from the sides. He looked up and saw several distorted faces with grey eyes and drooling mouths rushing towards him.

“Bang, bang, bang——”

The teammates behind him fired rapidly and a gap suddenly opened before him.

“There is a gate here!” Tang Qi shouted. His gun continued to fire rapidly. The giant spider that was injured by the gunshots staggered and knocked down a bunch of the zombies.

“Quick!”

Zhou Mingxuan cursed. Together with Song Qinglan, they leaned back.

The half-open gate only allowed for them to squeeze through.

After everyone went through the gate, Duan Wen quickly went and pushed the hydraulic level, “Broken! Fuck!”

The gate couldn’t be closed. Zombies madly drilled in.

But at any rate, it was better than having no place to hide. Everyone continued to shoot while retreating. Their goal was the next floor down.

“Slap!!” The road ahead was blocked.

An unknown object had fallen from the sky, blocking their way.

It wasn’t a zombie and it also wasn’t a giant spider. Its slimy body was covered in mucous and it curled up painfully on the ground as if it were a person.

“Chun’er!!”

Duan Wen recognised him first and rushed forward to help him.

“How is he?!”

“Take him along! We have to go!”

Zombies filed in from the gate that couldn’t be closed, and new zombies were constantly emerging from all directions on this floor.

“Boom! Boom!” The gate made a loud noise and the number of zombies suddenly reduced a little. It was the giant spider ramming itself against the

gate. Cracks had appeared on the walls on both sides of the gate, and it looked like it was on the verge of crumbling under the pressure!

Together with Duan Wen, Ji Yushi knelt down and supported Li Chun up.

Li Chun's entire body was covered in mucous, including his nose and mouth, making it hard for him to breathe. He looked like he was about to suffocate. The mucous was extremely slimy and sticky, Duan Wen tried several times but couldn't get it off. He was so anxious, his eyes were red, "What to do?!"

The situation was critical. Ji Yushi threw down his gun and used both hands to pry open Li Chun's mouth, "Hold him down!"

Duan Wen looked at Ji Yushi who was still extremely calm despite the purple arm and bleeding abdomen and watched him grab the mucous layer and, with blue veins on the back of his hand looking like it was about to burst, he cut out a small hole in Li Chun's mouth.

Air instantly poured into the throat and then into the lungs. Li Chun couldn't help but stiffen and then start to gasp for air.

In just those few seconds, there was a deafening 'clang'. The giant spider had already broken through the gate and rushed in together with the wave of zombies!

The giant spider was in front and all around them were zombies.

They have seemed to reach a new crisis.

Everyone froze for a moment.

Even with the existence of a time anchor and the fact that they could be resurrected after death, they were still humans made up of blood and flesh. An unstoppable hero suddenly arriving to save the day like the movies didn't happen, they only had themselves to rely on.

The bombs they had brought along were almost all used up. The assistance from 'Team 6' just now seemed to be a reminder to them of how important

it was for them to be well equipped.

But the next second.

Song Qinglan suddenly spoke, “Team B is here.”

Everyone heard another voice in the public channel. It was their own voice, “Hold it up!!”

“Hold it!!”

“Ten minutes, I’m coming!!”

“Boom——!!”

The sound of the spacecar could be heard through the communicator.

Team B was rushing over to them with great force and great speed!

The spirits of everyone were lifted, “Kill!!”

Replacing the despair from earlier, a fire of hope rekindled in everyone’s heart. Even when faced with such a dire situation, they will open a bloody path up!

The giant spider was at the forefront and was knocked to the ground by Song Qinglan’s energy cannon and its juices splattered all over.

This attack was very emboldening. Song Qinglan had no scruples, “Go!!”

More and more giant spiders appeared. Large and small, it was as if they had smashed open a spider’s nest.

Song Qinglan heard Ji Yushi yell, “Down there, at nine o’clock. The fastest way to the control centre!!”

The base was too large, and the internal passages were also very complicated.



The so-called go down two floors and follow the path for half a circle, if it was a normal person, they would have already lost their way amidst such a fierce battle and chaos, but it wasn't the case for Ji Yushi.

Relying on his strong sense of direction and memory, he managed to perfectly distinguish the right direction.

“Roger.” Song Qinglan carried Shen Mian and fired another shot in the direction pointed out by Ji Yushi.

The entire floor shook.

This time, he had blown a large hole on the floor!!

The grappling hook made its appearance and Tang Qi and Tang Le went down the rope first. Zhou Mingxuan shot down a few zombies and followed and then Ji Yushi and Duan Wen quickly secured Li Chun and went down as well.

Wind whistled past their ears.

As they slid down at a high speed, zombies that chased after them fell down the hole endlessly.

Unlike those crazed zombies, the giant spiders stopped before the hole and no longer chased after them. It was as if the place below was a forbidden zone for them.

The corridor on the lower level was bright, quiet and completely empty.

The ceiling was too high, and the ventilation pipes above criss-crossed through the entire building, forming a system of its own.

Everyone in the squad followed the zipline and stopped on a thick ventilation pipe that was more than ten metres away from the floor above. There was also another twenty or thirty metres below them so even if there were zombies, it was impossible for them to climb up.

They all untied themselves and there was a look of relief on everyone's faces.

Song Qinglan's eyes quickly swept over them, making sure that everyone was still intact.

Tang Qi and Tang Le inspected the surrounding area while Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan helped dig away the mucous on Li Chun's body.

Ji Yushi sat on the side catching his breath.

The white T-shirt on his body had long lost its original colour and his face was unnaturally red. Under his short sleeves, one arm was purple and red, a sharp contrast to the other.

On their way here, Ji Yushi had sustained the most injuries in the team.

What's more, he was also originally wounded.

"How are you?!" Song Qinglan knelt down and asked.

Seeing the concern in his eyes, Ji Yushi didn't hold back, "Help me, take out the painkiller. The wound, opened."

Ji Yushi's spoke unevenly, and his lips were pale from enduring the pain.

His tone and words were less distant than before. It was like it was his first time allowing the other person to get close to him.

Song Qinglan asked, "Where's the medicine?"

Ji Yushi gestured sideways, "Pocket."

His purple arm was trembling, and his other hand was covering his abdomen. It seemed that he couldn't free his own hands to grab it.

Song Qinglan did as he was told and reached into his pant pocket.

In front of everyone, this slightly intimate action was no longer strange. No one was in the mood to tease them anymore, but at such a moment, at a moment where their lives were hanging from a thread, Song Qinglan suddenly felt his heart turn hot. The reason for it was unclear.

The small bottle of painkiller was taken out.

Ji Yushi raised his head, "Feed me."

It could be seen that Ji Yushi wasn't thinking about whether that act was appropriate. Because his hands were still covered in the mucous from Li Chun's body, the fact that he hadn't vomited was already pretty good. It was absolutely impossible for him to use those hands to take out the medicine from the bottle and eat it.

Song Qinglan took out a pill and stuffed it into his mouth.

Ji Yushi vaguely mumbled, "Thank you."

When his fingers touched those hot lips, Song Qinglan asked, "You have a fever?"

As he said this, he reached to touch Ji Yushi's forehead.

It was hot to touch. Ji Yushi really had a fever.

But Ji Yushi wasn't concerned. This place didn't have water and, perhaps because he wanted to make the painkiller work faster, he chewed the bitter pill with a frown, "It may be an infection. We'll worry about it later."

The two talked for less than a minute and during this time, Li Chun woke up.

Duan Wen shouted, "Cap Song!!"

Li Chun was already able to sit up on his own. The mucous on his face was cleaned up and only his body was still slimy. His entire person was still in a state of shock and unable to form coherent words.

Everyone surrounded Li Chun.

“Chun’er, you’re amazing. You’re very fortunate to still be alive!”

“How did you fall back down again? Seeing you swept away, I almost gave you a memorial service on the spot!”

“Tell this brother about your heroic acts!”

Li Chun immediately started to cry with an ugly expression, “I was eaten, and then, and then I didn’t want to die, so I stabbed everywhere with a knife.....I think I was spat back out.....waaaaahhhh.”

Then that mucous.....

Everyone: “.....”

Bleugh.

“To eat you and then spit you back out, how big is that thing? What kind of thing is it?!”

Zhao Mingxuan looked up. Those giant spiders were still wandering around the hole, as if they were reluctant to let their prey go but also as if they were afraid of something.

At this moment, the pipe where they were taking a breather on started to shake violently.

When they were above, they had seen such a sound coming from the vents. It meant that that thing was coming!

“Gecko, mouse, cockroach, snake.” Ji Yushi stood up. His face was still covered in cold sweat but now was not to time to worry about it, “These things like to go through vents. I just don’t know if it’s one of them.....or a mixture.”

Mi-mixture?

Everyone was shocked.

This means that in this base, everything could be mutated?!

Ji Yushi spoke very quickly, “If I am not mistaken, the energy supply point for Golden Crow No.2 is below the control centre. The closer you are to that place, the stranger the sights you will see. Golden Crow No.1 only provided the basic energy supply, and after Golden Crow No.2’s establishment and the energy source was doubled, energy consumption doubled as well. They had no choice but to obtain more energy from the universe so the radiation and subsequent mutation is far worse on this end.”

Humans turned into zombies that no longer had the ability to think for themselves and only knew to eat.

Animals and insects underwent various changes.

This colony named PU-31 had completely collapsed.

There was no command centre for the Tianqiong system in this era. That cold system had hijacked this group of guardians and the aim of this mission was very clear.

Turn off the energy transmitters, let all the energy be released at once and let everything within range be sucked into the empty void.

Once all the energy transmitters are turned off, PU-31 would lose all its energy and no longer be able to sustain itself. In the end, it would be sucked into the crevice of the universe and disappear completely.

The crevice between parallel universes created PU-31.

And it will be the one to destroy PU-31.

When Ji Yushi finished saying this, the pipe shook violently again. The vibration had reached their feet. Everyone had a look of horror, “Let’s move!”

“Boom!”

Not far away, a ventilation duct broke open and a 'tongue' about three or four metres shot out towards them.

The 'tongue' retracted itself again amidst the gunfire.

The grappling hook was only twenty metres long. If they wanted to go down from here, they would still be a few metres away from the ground. It wasn't long enough.

Song Qinglan looked around, "There is a maintenance ladder ahead!"

Sure enough, several metres away against the curved wall of this base was a maintenance ladder.

The pipe shook violently. The thing inside went back and forth and its 'tongue' shot out from another nearby place to attack! This time, everyone saw it clearly. That 'tongue' really made it hard for them to distinguish what animal it was. There were some suckers on the back, but the front was like a normal tongue and there was also a small fork on the tip of it. They couldn't tell if it was a gecko or a snake.

Everyone sprinted over as fast as they could.

They headed straight for the ladder and slid all the way down. No one paid any attention to the pain on their palms.

It may have been a long time since it had eaten something so fresh. That 'tongue' that Li Chun had escaped from seemed very irritated and continued to wave around from inside the pipe. With a 'crash', the pipe about thirty or forty metres long broke off and collapsed onto the ground.

Song Qinglan got onto the maintenance ladder last. He only had time to see a slimy and fleshy mass appear from the pipe on the ground. It was an extremely disgusting sight.

Following this loud noise, the zombies that no longer fell through the hole above them reappeared.

These zombies originally couldn't find their directions and were wandering about aimlessly but after being attracted over by the sound, they started falling through the hole in the ceiling like dumplings.

The lower ground was lively. That 'tongue' swung about furiously, trying to get rid of the bothersome zombies, but those zombies didn't feel any pain. Many of them even had broken bones from the fall but even if they only had an upper body left, they still desperately crawled towards the moving 'tongue'.

The 'tongue' was surrounded. The zombies which didn't care about their life or death surrounded it and started tearing into the 'tongue', forcing it to retreat back into the pipe.

The giant spiders couldn't hold back anymore.

They crawled down along the walls, also wanting to get a piece of the pie.

The giant spiders were afraid of the 'tongue' and the 'tongue' was afraid of the zombies. With the three of them in the same place, they no longer cared about their fears.

For the living, this was hell!

“Ji Yushi!”

Song Qinglan's roar from behind reached his ears. Ji Yushi turned back and saw a large mouth appear behind him. The top closed down and the bottom closed up, it was about to bite off his head in one go.

“Move aside!”

Someone suddenly appeared on a spider's back. It was also Song Qinglan!!

The man's face was serious, and his eyes were indescribably cold. At this critical moment, he shoved a bomb into that spider's mouth.

Instantly knowing what he needed to do, Ji Yushi rolled away. The other person also slipped off the spider's back.

“Boom!”. The sound was deafening. The spider’s innards flew everywhere and its body was blown to pieces.

“Bang, bang, bang!”

Many gunshots sounded. Several familiar figures hung from the hole in the ceiling. One after another, they occupied the advantageous position of being on higher ground and shot at the zombies and spiders below.

There was a total of six people there. Team B was here!

With their fighting power instantly doubled, the situation was reversed!

The two Song Qinglan’s were exactly the same. They didn’t need to communicate at all and turned their heads back at the same time and yelled, “To the control room!!”

Ji Yushi ran to the control room. As he shot down the zombies, he saw his other self.

They were both running through the gunpower smoke.

It was like looking in a mirror.

Ji Yushi saw his other self’s expression suddenly change, “Behind!!”

Accompanying this reminder, the other party threw the gun in his hand over!

The small Diamond Bird was silvery white all over.

It drew an arc in the air and fell into Ji Yushi’s hands.

Without even stopping to think, Ji Yushi caught the gun thrown over by his other self with his left hand, turned his head and saw that the ‘tongue’ and popped out of the pipe again. This time it had split into two and it flew towards him like a snake!



Ji Yushi held a Diamond Bird in each hand and shot with perfect accuracy. He was a perfect double gun wielder. Firing the two guns at the same time, he very easily shot a section off the two 'tongues'.

Immediately afterwards, he continued running and threw the gun back.

The other Ji Yushi was similarly calm. He continued to run after receiving his gun.

One bent down and slid over the pipe on the ground that was blocking his way.

One jumped and landed on the shoulder of a zombie. With a twist of his legs, his perfect Jiu-Jitsu skill broke the zombie's neck in an instant.

Without needing to say anything, the Ji Yushi wearing a black combat uniform and the Ji Yushi wearing a white T-shirt looked like twins.

With thirteen members of the Tianqiong seventh squad, they were currently in their best condition to fight.

# Chapter 25: Chapter 25

## Ouroboros

### Chapter 25

Half an hour later.

There was a total of 176 control panels.

It was exactly the same as the Golden Crow No.1 base.

Ji Yushi frowned. This was much more difficult than he thought.

Every two control panel corresponded to two energy transmitters. They continuously transmitted energy from both ends of PU-31, providing an energy source while at the same time preventing it from being sucked away by the crevice in the universe.

If too many energy transmitters were turned off at the same time at a certain place, PU-31 would then lose its balance and the world and everything would be overturned. Disasters like landslides and tsunamis would be trivial events in comparison to what would happen as a result.

And so, according to the coordinates of PU-31 on the real-time holographic projection, whether it was Golden Crow No.1 or Golden Crow No.2, Ji Yushi must turn off the panels in an accurate sequence to ensure that the balance is maintained.

He knew that after the mission was completed, PU-31 would no longer exist.

Therefore, before the task is completed, they must have someone stay behind to perform the final operation and also plan a route out to allow others to return to their initial starting point while avoiding all the ‘black walls’ so that they can enter their capsules to return to their own time.

Ji Yushi already knew why their future selves continued to choose to extend this point where Teams A and B coexisted.

It wasn’t just because they had more people and was the most promising in finding a breakthrough point, it was also because the birth of the parallel timeline ensured that there would be people who can stay behind to complete the final operation whilst also ensuring that all the team members could return.

Choosing them must’ve been the conclusion their future selves reached after going through countless cycles.

Now then, there was a problem——

The ‘me’ on the two parallel timelines are both the true ‘me’ and both are the ‘main body’, so who should stay behind to complete the task?

The control panel was just a few steps away. The battle was fierce.

The teammates fought a bloody battle. No one considered the option of retreating.

Team A and Team B.

They were fighting side by side.

“Bang!”

Ji Yushi raised his purple right arm and killed a zombie. Under his dark eyelashes, his emotions were unclear, “Have you discussed this issue?”

The other Ji Yushi said, “No.”

Ji Yushi was not surprised.

Because he himself also never thought of making his teammates make the choice.

For one to compete against themselves, it was too cruel.

“There are two possible outcomes.” He asked, “Aren’t you afraid of getting it wrong?”

“I am.” The other Ji Yushi said calmly, “And you?”

“Boom——”

A loud explosion interrupted their conversation.

Song Qinglan’s last energy cannon exploded, the shockwave sending everyone to the ground.

The giant spiders body flew across the room, bursting open when it hit one of the ventilation pipes. Amidst the earth-shattering noise, the mutated species hiding in the pipe that had fallen to the ground finally revealed itself.

A mass of flesh consisting of a mixture of an unknown number of species and covered in mucous squirmed across the ground. Countless ‘tongue’-like tentacles searched around the ground like it was very much afraid of coming into contact with light.

The mass of flesh was very sticky and had no ability to walk independently so it could only hide in the pipes and slide around.

As it squirmed around, human limbs and faces appeared on its back. It was as if they were all alive and each still had their own movements —— It had absorbed the people in the base that had not yet mutated and merged with them into one body.

Li Chun saw this scene and, combining it with the thought of the residual mucous on his body, he started vomiting on the spot.

Although the other Li Chun was unaware of what happened, when he saw himself reacting like this, he naturally guessed a few things and similarly knelt onto the ground and started to vomit.

Everyone: “.....”

At the same time, they shot at the mass of flesh. It didn't take long for it to turn into mincemeat.

Two or three severely wounded giant spiders descended from the sky. They dragged the pile of mincemeat away from the gunfire and ran.

The rest of the zombies weren't much of a threat. Everyone was panting with exhaustion and would shoot at them from time to time to prevent them from approaching. They no longer wanted to move.

“Advisor Ji.” Two Song Qinglan's stepped into the control room, “How are the calculations?”

They spoke in no particular order, but they were surprisingly in sync.

The Ji Yushi in black said, “I have already followed the order and closed a part of the energy transmitters at Golden Crow No.1. We just need to leave a safe return route to the starting point.”

The Ji Yushi in white looked a little paler. As the same person, he looked a lot weaker, “That's right. I will turn off the energy transmitters in order until the very end.”

“You want to stay?” Song Qinglan on the left looked at him. The one on the right also frowned.

Two Song Qinglan's. No one here could tell the difference.

Of course, it was the same for the others too.

The Li Chun covered with mucous and the Li Chun without mucous.

The sitting silent and small eyed Zhou Mingxuan and the standing Zhou Mingxuan.

Duan Wen who a little more blood on his face and Duan Wen with not so much blood on his face.

Tang Qi with an arm injury and Tang Qi with a leg injury.

There was also Tang Le who was alone. As if he realised something, he stood aggrievedly between the two Tang Qi's.

“The task is completed when the last energy transmitter is turned off. When everything is restarted, we have to safely get in the capsule and return to our own original time and space coordinate or everything would be in vain.” The Ji Yushi in the black combat uniform explained, “So someone must stay.”

The expression of the Ji Yushi in a white shirt was very calm. He seamlessly continued his other self's words, “According to the plan, we who stay here will return to the time anchor point after being swallowed by the darkness and at that time, there will already be another ‘us’ at that anchor point, so we will become one.”

Zhou Mingxuan asked, “But the people who return to the starting point after being swallowed by the darkness will be a few hours earlier than us who hurry back to the anchor point.....”

That is correct.

The time they returned to the anchor point after total group annihilation was always at 4:41 in the morning.

It was however already four in the afternoon. The time when the group returns to the starting point and the anchored point was completely out of sync and it was even nearly twelve hours apart.

Ji Yushi wearing a white T-shirt said, “On a normal timeline, there cannot be two of the same individual and memories will be superimposed when the

two become one.”

Ji Yushi in the black combat uniform continued, “That is to say, the moment the mission is completed, we may suffer a wave of memories being injected into our minds. It doesn’t matter who is the one from the ‘parallel timeline’, we will eventually become one anyway.”

Ji Yushi wearing a white T-shirt said, “So it’s the same whoever stays behind. I just believe that it would be more beneficial to have my uninjured self go back to the starting point.”

The sight of the two Ji Yushi’s fighting side by side just now was too dazzling. Right now in everyone’s eyes, they were the only focus.

Following everything they went through in this mission, everyone now believed everything Ji Yushi said.

Very quickly, Li Chun who was covered in mucous chose to stay, “Then I will stay.”

Following that was the Duan Wen who felt more tired and the Tang Qi whose leg was hurt.

There was only one Tang Le so he would need to follow the main group back, “I don’t have a second self....So I’ll have to leave, isn’t that right?”

Tang Qi rubbed his head, “Yes.”

Finally, only Song Qinglan remained.

“I’ll stay.”

The tall man took off the red magazine that had long dimmed back down from Shen Mian and changed it to a new blue magazine.

He glanced at his other self and said, “I’m tired from all the fighting. You can do the running this time.”

The other Song Qinglan raised his eyelids, “No problem.”

After that, he looked around at the teammates who had decided to leave and said in a deep voice, “Don’t be so down, these are all choices you and your other selves have made. Isn’t it the same after you go back to the anchor point? It’s no different to saying goodbye to yourself who has not yet completely woken up.”

The inexplicably sad atmosphere faded. Everyone seemed to have become more spirited.

As the captain, Song Qinglan always had the ability to make his teammates think clearly and become more enthusiastic.

“The spacecar from Golden Crow No.1 is outside. We should return to the starting point as soon as possible.” Ji Yushi in the black combat uniform explained slowly, “We will contact you through the public channel. Please be careful, we still don’t know what other mutants may be in the base.”

“Okay.” The other Ji Yushi agreed.

Without needing to say too much, they all wanted to end this nightmare as soon as possible.

Song Qinglan gave out an order and the seven of them very quickly departed.

The people remaining seemed to be the ‘weaker’ self.

From the moment Teams A and B met up, it was already evident that they would need to part ways very soon.

Was this the end?

They wondered.

They clearly couldn’t continue any longer. Having finally reached the moment of liberation, they suddenly felt that everything seemed unreal.

Was this.....really the end?



Facing the piles of severed limbs and zombie corpses, no one dared to relax their vigilance.

They had advanced all this way from the first cycle until now.

Was this really over now?

The originally bustling base had suddenly turned very quiet. There would be occasionally giant spiders crawling past, but because it was too quiet, they couldn't feel any vibrations and crawled away along the walls.

Li Chun and Duan Wen froze in place, not knowing what to do. Tang Qi was helping Zhou Mingxuan and supporting him over to the side to sit down.

A zombie covered in blood crawled over and was very quickly killed by Zhou Mingxuan with a dagger.

In front of the control panel, Ji Yushi started to turn off the energy transmitters according to the sequence he had calculated beforehand.

176 control panels, 88 pairs of energy transmitters. Every time one was turned off, a disordered energy field would appear outside, turning that part of the world into nothingness. That was the so-called "black wall".

PU-31 was gradually disappearing. Only one route was left for them to escape along. They knew that at this very moment, there was a spacecar outside, racing through the world where zombies were gathered and black walls continued to appear.

Ji Yushi heard someone behind him say in a low voice, "Advisor Ji, you lied again."

Ji Yushi's actions paused for a moment. He turned back, "Why do you say that?"

Song Qinglan's face was stained with zombie blood but his pair of eyes were very bright.

He revealed a rare smile at Ji Yushi. For a moment, Ji Yushi couldn't tell which Song Qinglan had stayed behind.

But soon, he knew.

Because the other party said, "The way you brainwashed everyone just now was exactly the same as that time when you said that I was your boyfriend when you were being kidnapped."

Ji Yushi: "....."

This was the Song Qinglan of Team A who had been with him throughout this entire timeline.

Song Qinglan held Shen Mian with one hand and his entire body relaxed completely, revealing a bit of laziness that wasn't there earlier during the battle. It made people remember that he was also just an ordinary person, and he can also feel tired.

He said, "You're actually not completely certain about whether all our selves from the parallel timelines will merge into one, are you? Just like that lump of flesh formed by various human bodies just now — It wasn't just a mutation but also the consequence of more than one of the same entities, which had appeared in the same world due to parallel timelines, all combining together into one."

That's right.

If their selves at the anchor point and their selves who had returned to the starting point after completing the mission failed to merge into one, it was very likely that something similar to that plump of flesh would happen to them; they would become a deformity or die.

As the experienced captain, Song Qinglan's theoretical knowledge of time and the universe wasn't necessarily worse than Ji Yushi's.

"That is the worst outcome, it won't necessarily happen." Song Qinglan acted like he was talking about something unimportant, "But it is very

likely that the moment the mission is completed is the moment we disappear.”

Ji Yushi lowered his purple arm and stood there quietly, “Then why did you stay?”

Song Qinglan said, “Because I believe you have already prepared a backup plan.”

Ji Yushi’s heartbeat was slightly erratic.

Only the other Ji Yushi knew this. Since he was originally himself, it wasn’t surprising.

The feeling of having his thoughts guessed by another person was very strange. He almost never had such an experience before.

Song Qinglan said, “Regarding the black wall, I remember it first appeared when we arrived at the park management office, around 5:30am, but regardless of whether it was Golden Crow No.1 or Golden Crow No.2, it is impossible for us to turn off the energy transmitter during that time frame. I would like to make a bold guess. There may actually be more than one anchor point set by Tianqiong. After we were swallowed by the darkness, we entered a new cycle, reached a different anchor point and managed to turn off the first energy transmitter at 5:30am.”

“It’s like a bigger circle fitting into this smaller circle.....but we don’t know and cannot be certain.” Song Qinglan then said, “So they are actually the only ones who escaped from this cycle. We must have someone stay behind to complete the new cycle and let the ‘us’ who just reached the park management office after returning to the starting point see the arrival of the black wall. Only then will it become a complete circle and only then will everything ‘we’ encounter afterwards actually happen.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

To return to a certain moment and complete a certain event so that everything in the future may happen.

Song Qinglan had guessed it.

Ouroboros mode.

They created darkness.

And they also became the chaser of darkness.

In a sense, this was the real way to clear through this.

This was also another way to answer the mission objective: They will become the actual chaser of darkness themselves.

“Two possible ways to think of it, two kinds of preparations to complete the task.” Song Qinglan said, “If you guessed wrong, this task is in fact not as complicated as you think and staying behind to do all this is actually unnecessary. After we die, our other selves can smoothly return to the starting point and return to our time.”

“If you were not wrong, then soon we will enter a new cycle after being swallowed by the darkness and go to turn off the first energy transmitter at 5:30am to complete the initial trigger event — Only then will the mission be considered as complete. We will then similarly return to the anchor point from the very beginning and it would be like we had never left the forest in the first place.”

Ji Yishi was stunned.

Song Qinglan raised the corners of his lips and said nonchalantly, “But you have forgotten. Even if you’re wrong, we were the ones who chose to stay. Sacrificing for ourself is not considered a sacrifice. You don’t need to carry the burden all by yourself.”

Ji Yushi was just an ordinary person.

Even if he had superhuman memory and superhuman observation ability, he couldn’t guarantee that everyone in the parallel timeline could return to their world safely and could only choose to do it like this.

But how could Song Qinglan guess all the things he couldn't bring himself to say?

If that was the case, the other Song Qinglan must have also guessed it.

Recalling the words the other party said before he left, it all matched with Song Qinglan's current attitude.

Song Qinglan threw something to him, "Did you really think that those people really didn't know anything and only know to play games in class like you?"

The other teammates all looked in their direction and waved at Ji Yushi to tell him not to worry and that they are fine.

Ji Yushi caught the object and looked at it. It turned out to be his black-and-white handheld game console.

He was stunned, "This?"

"The other you gave it." Song Qinglan said, "If there really is a new cycle, it will go on for a while. You sure you don't want to use it to distract yourself a little?"

Ji Yushi rubbed the console.

He heard Song Qinglan ask, "Gift from a family member?"

Ji Yushi nodded.

Song Qinglan was silent for a couple of seconds. He then said, "Let's make a bet."

Ji Yushi, "Bet what?"

Song Qinglan, "Bet that the second method is the right way to complete the task and the outcome is even better than you imagined. If I win, you stay in the seventh squad."

Song Qinglan looked very serious and the look in his eyes was deep.

It was probably the look a captain who highly regards talent would have.

Ji Yushi asked, “And if you lose?”

Song Qinglan had already found the last control panel.

At this moment, the other Song Qinglan’s voice sounded through the public channel. Everyone heard him clearly, “We have all entered the capsules. Everything is ready.”

“If I lose....”

Song Qinglan spoke in a low voice like he was talking to himself.

But in the end, he didn’t say anything and directly pulled the valve straight down.

The last two energy transmitters corresponding to the starting point and the Golden Crow No.2 base was shut down.

Amidst the bloody battlefield in front of the control panel, inside the large Golden Crow No.2 base, the entire team disappeared into the darkness along with PU-31.

Ji Yushi’s last impression of the world was the game console in his hand which still carried some warmth.

As well as Song Qinglan’s broad back in front of him....

**KK has something to say:**

And that’s the end of this arc! It’s pretty confusing isn’t it? I did my best with trying to keep everything clear but I found that there were times where even I got confused while doing the translation ><

I did a rough diagram based off one that is shared on Weibo to help you guys with understanding what happened in this first arc. The link is down

below. (If anyone has a better diagram or something, feel free to share it too!)

[CLICK HERE FOR DIAGRAM FOR MIST ARC 1](#)

# Chapter 26: Chapter 26

## Transfer Station

### Chapter 26

“Welcome Ji Yushi. Welcome back to Tianqiong.”

Tianqiong’s familiar welcome speech sounded.

A robotic arm delivered over a bag of nutrient solution to let them recover from the sequelae caused by time travel such as dizziness and nausea.

This.....was the cycle starting again?

Ji Yushi received the nutrient solution and drained it in one breath. From the corners of his eyes, he saw his black sleeves. It was the black combat uniform Guardians wore. He was no longer wearing the bloodstained white T-shirt.

No, they didn’t restart again.

Ji Yushi’s memories gradually recovered. He now knew that the second method they had chosen had succeeded.

After the energy transmitters were turned off at the second base, the task was still not truly complete. They had triggered a new anchor point, entered another big cycle, and then created the first black wall that appeared at the park management office at 5:30am and the second black wall that appeared at Runjin Building.....They watched the black walls that had been made by themselves continue to chase after their other selves in the smaller cycle. Rebirth after rebirth, they eventually achieved their goal.



Ouroboros had finally drawn a complete circle with the combined efforts of countless versions of them.

At this point, they truly completed the task.

After completing the task, they fell into the darkness.

When they woke up again, they found that they had returned to the moment when Tianqiong was being hijacked and emitting warning alarms. They had also successfully merged together with their other selves who had returned to the starting point.

As Song Qinglan had said, the outcome was better than expected.

Their selves in the two parallel timelines didn't end up turning into a monster because they had appeared at the same point in time.

Everything in PU-31 was like a nightmare. Zombies, mutants, apocalypse.... Except for having terrible memories of it, they were still their original selves from before any of this happened, as if they had never left the capsule and never visited PU-31.

It was a perfect case of time and space hijacking.

But, what was going on now?

Shouldn't they be on their way to complete their A-level mission?

Ji Yushi opened the door to his capsule. He was met with blinding white light.

After he got used to the strong light, he realised that this place was similar to the command centre.

"Brother Wen! We've completed the task!" Li Chun was almost about to burst into tears of joy. He had his arms around Duan Wen's neck as he exclaimed excitedly, "We won't go back there again!"

"Yes! Never again!" Duan Wen turned and looked over, "Advisor Ji!"

Everyone was a little excited.

Seeing Ji Yushi come out from the capsule, everyone in the squad couldn't wait throw him in the air to celebrate.

But it was too inappropriate.

Even if they have fought side by side and went through life-threatening situations together, the feeling Ji Yushi gave them was still different.

In the other world, the contributions Ji Yushi made was obvious to all of them. He not only far exceeded the work a scout needed to do, but he also demonstrated that he was a Guardian with outstanding fighting capabilities. His calmness and tenacity were in sharp contrast with his own appearance, but it also very strangely suited him. Every action and gesture he made gave off a distant feeling.....how to put it, the feeling of an elite?

In any case, it couldn't be compared to this group of rough men.

For example, even having reached a safe place, Ji Yushi still did not completely relax.

He looked around the place. The things that entered his eyes were bright lights, a huge control panel, holographic projection, and no one else..... wait a minute.

“Cap Song.” Ji Yushi suddenly spoke up, “This place isn't our command centre.”

Song Qinglan also noticed this because Tianqiong's welcoming speech had given it away.

Hearing Ji Yushi's words, Song Qinglan looked at the communicator habitually and said, “You're right. The time format is incorrectly displayed here. The current coordinates of this place cannot be determined.”

Hearing those words, everyone became nervous. Their experiences in PU-31 had left a psychological shadow in everyone. Perhaps this was another place similar to PU-31.

Ji Yushi also raised his arm and looked at his communicator: [xxxx.xx.xx].

No coordinates.

For time and space travellers, time was the only way for them to confirm their current coordinates.

The lack of coordinates was a very serious matter and the traverser may even get lost in time and space, never able to return.

“Fuck.” Duan Wen opened a door and glanced out. He said the word everyone had in their minds on behalf of the squad.

He reported, “Cap Song, we fucking don’t seem to be on the ground.”

Li Chun and Tang Le also opened a few doors and looked down.

“Pitch black outside. It looks empty below!”

“There’s nothing around us too!

Song Qinglan walked over with a frown to check.

“Where is this?”

“Didn’t we break the cycle?”

“No way, after all that hard work, we’re starting again?”

Tang Qi: “Cap Song! Look!”

Everyone returned to the control panel and saw a line of words appear on the holographic screen:

[Congratulations! Guardians from Star Era 1456, you have completed the first Super S-level mission and are about to unlock the next one.]

Everyone’s heart turned cold. What did this mean?

“Who are you?” Song Qinglan faced the projection and asked.

As early as their time, the Tianqiong System had already activated the AI voice system. Sure enough, it was activated as soon as a question was heard.

“I am Tianqiong.”

The system’s voice was very gentle. It was a female voice.

Song Qinglan almost laughed out in anger, “The Tianqiong from which era?”

System: “In a broad sense, I am the Tianqiong of all eras.”

Tianqiong of all eras?

Everyone was confused.

Song Qinglan paused for a second or two, but he seemed to remember something and asked again, “In other words, the Ouroboros mission was one that you had released and us being here also has something to do with you?”

System: “Yes.”

Song Qinglan’s tone was very cold, “Where is this?”

System: “This is my time and space transfer station. You can rest, train and eat here. I have a plenty of supplies here. I suggest that you make use of it before proceeding onto the next mission.”

There’s another mission?!

Zhou Mingxuan who heard this immediately asked, “How do we go back?”

System: “One mission has been detected to be unlocked. Please unlock more to access more detailed information.”

“Fuck!”

“Isn’t this too much?!”

“What the hell is this?!”

“I can’t believe this!!”

The group exploded with anger.

Tang Le said to his brother, “I’m never going to set flags again. Before setting off, I even said to Advisor Ji that we would be back the next day.”

Tang Qi was speechless: “.....”

Ji Yushi who had been silent until now spoke, “Why did you choose us?”

Everyone calmed down. Ji Yushi had asked a very important question.

With his extraordinary memory and observation skills, they had unknowingly at some unknown point in time regarded him as another core to the team.

The system flashed a few times before speaking again, “Following more than 170 million calculations, your squad’s chance of success is higher than the average across all guardian squads.”

Everyone, “.....”

This kind of good news didn’t made them happy at all!

Song Qinglan: “What’s the next mission?”

The system said, “It is recommended that you rest first and then unlock the next mission.”

After that, the holographic projection turned dark and disappeared.

This was a downright case of time and space hijacking.

Everyone had thought that as long as they completed the [Ouroboros] mission, they would return to the moment their capsules were intercepted and successfully arrive at Xijing City in 1460.

Then, they would get in touch with their own Tianqiong command centre, complete the original A-level mission and then return to their own era.

With that, everything was back on track.

But it in fact wasn't the case.

If they wanted to know when they could return, they would have to unlock more missions. Otherwise, they would all be trapped in this transfer station.

Everyone was exhausted physically and mentally, and the current situation had poured a bucket of cold water onto them. They were completely dumbfounded.

Ji Yushi's face was illuminated by the fluorescent lights. He thought for a moment and walked away.

Tang Le asked, "Advisor Ji! Where are you going?"

Ji Yushi stopped and looked at them strangely, "I'm looking for something to eat. You're not hungry?"

Everyone: "....."

So are all highly intelligent people monsters?!

Isn't Advisor Ji being too calm?!

When they were in the big cycle, Ji Yushi was still the same state as how he was in Golden Crow No.1; he was still shot in the abdomen, his arm was bruised, and he also had a fever. Now that everything had gone back to zero, the wounds on his body were gone and he had returned to how he was when he first set off.

But mentally, he hadn't had a rest for a very long time. Ji Yushi at this moment looked extremely tired and he didn't mind showing it.

"I'm too tired." He said in a small voice, "I just want to eat something and then get a good night's sleep."

\*

There was everything in this transfer station, even frozen steaks and fresh vegetables. It was unknown where this gangster system managed to get them from.

Ji Yushi was right. Since they couldn't go anywhere, it was better to recuperate first.

Everyone filled their stomachs, calmed themselves down, and each found a room to rest in.

Ji Yushi who had just finished showering got ready to lie down when he heard a knock on his door.

The one who came this time was Song Qinglan.

He stood at the door and had no intentions to go in, "Advisor Ji, have you ever heard of Tianqiong's self-awareness?"

Song Qinglan had also taken a shower and had changed into a clean grey T-shirt from the training room.

He was very tall, reaching a little more than 1.9 metres and his muscles were smooth and well-proportioned.

It was Ji Yushi's first time seeing Song Qinglan in regular clothes, but he felt that the oppressive gangster feeling he gave off was no less than before.

Ji Yushi said, "I've heard about it."

Strangely enough, the moment Song Qinglan appeared at the door of his room, a memory from his other self in PU-31 suddenly appeared.

As the teammates had said, Team B——that is, himself in Team 4, after separating from the rest of the teammates at Runjin Building with Song Qinglan, their relationship in that parallel timeline had become quite close.

Ji Yushi remembered that when they were on their way to the bookstore, they were left with no other options with the onslaught of zombies and were forced to hide in a small and cramped room. How cramped was it? It was the kind where the two only had enough space to stand firmly if they stood facing each other at close proximity. It was just like their predicament in the other timeline in the small kiosk.

It was also about the same distance as where they stood now.

As long as the two took a step closer, they could immediately reproduce that scene from that time.

Ji Yushi remembered that Song Qinglan's lips almost touched his ears in the dark, and the tone of his words was very calm, "Advisor Ji, you're stepping on me."

The zombies outside scratched at the door. For one to be standing so close such that they were stepping on the other's foot, it wasn't very polite. Ji Yushi felt that he should move away.

But before he could move his foot, he heard Song Qinglan's deep voice sound right next to his ear, "Don't! I'll give you this opportunity to step on me so that next time you can remember something nice. Don't always hold grudges."

Ji Yushi decided not to move, "Oh."

"Having said that," Song Qinglan gritted his teeth, "you're stepping really hard."

The Song Qinglan before him didn't seem to notice that he was lost in thoughts and continued, "It can be proven now that it is true. The so-called Tianqiong of all eras is an indication that it has self-awareness. I just tried contacting our command centre and was intercepted by it. It's probably



saying that if we don't unlock the missions it gives, we won't be able to return to our time."

Ji Yushi: ".....I need to go back. I cannot stay in another era. I still have a lot to do."

Everyone thought the same.

Song Qinglan also thought this, "In that case, we will have to do the next mission."

Ji Yushi nodded.

Song Qinglan lowered his eyes and looked down at him but he suddenly raised another topic, "By the way, I won the bet at Golden Crow No.2, right?"

Bet?

Was he talking about him officially joining the seventh squad if the mission was completed the second way?

Ji Yushi wanted to refuse.

They weren't even able to return even after completing the first mission. This squad probably had bad feng shui and bad luck.

"Give me an answer when we get back." Song Qinglan said, "Don't keep on recalling those horror scenes and have a good rest."

After saying that, he took out a bottle of red wine and a glass from behind him, "If you can't sleep, drink this. Don't let Zhou Mingxuan see it, he will fight you for it."

"Goodnight, Advisor Ji."

\*

"Broom——"

The not so bright car shook violently. Amid the intense gunfire, he was using a knife to cut through the nylon rope around his wrist.

There was an impact in his abdomen. The feeling of an energy bullet entering his flesh was slow and distinct. Two seconds later, that pain began to spread, and it was very intense....

He bent down in pain. The spacecar slammed into the buildings on the side of the street.

The little girl picked up her doll and stood up inside the spacecar.

She turned her head. Her grey and turbid eyes were wide open.

Ji Yushi jolted awake from his sleep dripping with cold sweat.

He subconsciously reached into his clothes and touched the smooth skin of his abdomen....no wound.

This place is the quiet command centre. He is in a clean and comfortable room.

He is safe.

Ji Yushi sat up from the single bed. The mattress under him sank down due to his weight. After being abruptly awakened from his nightmare which was made up of a mixture of his memory and fantasy, all his sleepiness was gone in an instant. His body was very tired, and his head throbbed with pain. He needed to rest.

He dug out his medicine box and swallowed a pill with the help of some water he found in the room. He then tossed and turned on the bed for several hours before his eyes fell onto the items on his bedside table.

A bottle of red wine.

A translucent wine glass.

Ji Yushi didn't drink much.

Would these two things given by Song Qinglan really be useful?

He opened the red wine and poured himself half a glass.

In a short while, drunkenness overwhelmed him and sleepiness returned.

Ji Yushi laid back down on the soft bed and gently closed his eyes. This time.....he no longer dreamed.

Everything in that terrifying world was already over.

**KK has something to say:**

The next arc starts soon!

# Chapter 27: Chapter 27

## Chaos

### Chapter 27

Ji Yushi's heavy eyelids opened a small sliver with much difficulty. Light entered his eyes, stimulating the pupils to constrict.

A brilliant aurora once again appeared. It was breath-takingly beautiful.

Green, blue and purple.

They flashed across the dark sky like waves and disappeared far into the distance.

The surroundings were extremely quiet. It was so quiet, Ji Yushi could almost hear his own heartbeat and breathing.

Where was this place?

That's right, they had started a new mission.

Ji Yushi's memory stopped at the point before they left.

After coming out of PU-31, they had rested for several days, recharged themselves and everyone had recovered to their best state. With everyone's consent, they had accepted their new mission.

Everything was normal until they entered their capsules.

But what happened later?

Ji Yushi's body was frozen stiff. A layer of frost had formed over his dark eyelashes.

He exhausted all his strength, but he could only raise his eyelids slightly. He saw his own capsule stopped not far from him. The silver-white capsule had a large hole and the transparent panel was covered with spiderweb-like cracks. The safety straps were scattered about and there were also exposed wires lying around messily, occasionally emitting small bursts of sparks from time to time.

An accident had occurred during the transition.

“Bzzz.”

The mechanical arm had been squashed into an awkward angle. It seemed to have detected a Guardian's presence and raised itself, wanting to deliver nutrient solution to the living being.

Unfortunately it was too far.

The arm raised and lowered repeatedly, forming the only sound that could be heard here.

Ji Yushi took in his surroundings. He seemed to be in a large garbage dump.

Countless mechanical wreckage and discarded parts formed a high mountain, exuding a strong stench of engine oil and rot. The wreckage here may have been accumulated over a long time and there were vine-like plants growing through the gaps, entwining itself with the various machinery and blooming with transparent glowing flowers.

Where was this place?

Ji Yushi restored his gaze and saw that he himself was lying in the garbage dump in a strange posture. The pain on his body at this moment far exceeded the level he could tolerate, but he couldn't make a single sound.

“Clang!”

A sound echoed from far away at a place that was not visible to Ji Yushi.

“Clang! Clang!” That sound got closer and closer. It was as if someone was stepping through the mountain of wreckage, approaching him step by step.

The night sky before his eyes was blocked.

A shadow suddenly appeared before Ji Yushi. Someone was looking down at him.

Round and plump face, blue eyes, flushed cheeks as well as messy reddish-brown hair and beard. That face came face to face with Ji Yushi.

The heat from the other party’s breathing sprayed onto Ji Yushi’s face. It smelled of alcohol and was very unpleasant.

Ji Yushi couldn’t move. He wanted to speak but he could only blink his eyes.

That bearded man looked at him for a few seconds and then stretched out his hand. Pinching his chin with his rough fingers, he looked at him left and right again, as if confirming that he was alive, before he murmured something under his breath. This voice was hoarse and rough, but it was a language that Ji Yushi didn’t understand.

Immediately afterwards, the bearded man walked away. The wreckage he walked through was kicked everywhere.

After a minute, the bearded man returned.

This time he had an extra thick iron chain with him. He used this chain to tie Ji Yushi up and then fastened a lock onto it.

Following that, the bearded man grabbed on end of the chain and dragged him in the other direction.

Ji Yushi almost clenched his teeth hard. He couldn’t exert any strength to make a sound.

His entire body was in severe pain. The addition of the iron chain made his already sensitive body due to the pain feel worse and the wreckage he was pulled over aggravated that pain further. He was sweating buckets. He felt that the things that would happen next probably wasn't anything good — This man didn't seem to be saving him.

He wasn't dragged for too long.

The bearded man seemed to have noticed something. He dropped the chain and strode off.

Ji Yushi tried to look with difficulty, only to see the other party's giant body blocking his capsule.

“Clang——”

It was another loud sound. The bearded man tore off the robotic arm and threw it into the garbage dump. When he turned back around, he held Ji Yushi's packet of nutrient solution in his hand like he was holding a bottle of medicine.

The bearded man looked very happy.

He examined the nutrient solution, murmured a few words and then stuffed it into his dirty pocket.

Ji Yushi was again dragged away by the bearded man.

The further he was from the tallest peak of that pile of garbage, the wider his field of vision became.

Amidst the excruciating pain, Ji Yushi continued to observe his surroundings. He saw that this was a huge garbage dump, and it was probably as wide as several football fields. In addition to his damaged capsule, there were even satellites, rockets and even space stations, all of which are expensive and advanced items. These were thrown here together with other scraps.

The sky also didn't seem to be the sky he was familiar with.

It was extremely dark and extremely close to the ground, perhaps only a few hundred metres in height. It looked like a thick film wrapped around the world.

And that breath-taking aurora seemed to be a reflection of nothingness.

Apart from the mountain of garbage and vines that grew through it, there was nothing else in his field of vision.

The vitality of those vines seemed endless. It grew tenaciously through every gap, absorbing the nutrients of these wreckages.

From a distance, the entire garbage dump looked like it was filled with transparent glowing flowers. It looked like lights used to decorate trees during Christmas and it created a rather beautiful sight.

Ji Yushi was thrown onto a spacious, self-made, two-wheeled cart that was covered in unknown filth.

Then, he saw the bearded man throw some other things onto the cart.

Dirty blankets, chairs, some copper tableware, a few cans that appeared to have been damaged or expired.

The last item was thrown in.

Clunk!

Ji Yushi groaned internally. His chest hurt from the impact.

— Shen Mian.

It was Song Qinglan's gun.

\*

Ji Yushi who was thrown onto the cart tried to keep himself awake but the unchanging sky above him made him even more tired and the rocking of the cart also made it worse.



Even when he was thrown off the cart, he wasn't fully awake.

The frost formed on his black combat uniform had turned into water vapour. The cold from that reached his skin and drilled into his bones.

Ji Yushi shivered in his sleep. He noticed that he was lying on a cold and hard ground, but he didn't have the strength to curl up and warm himself.

In such a difficult sleeping condition, he didn't sleep well.

Where was he?

What happened to the teammates?

Why was Song Qinglan's gun here?

What did the bearded man want to do?

Those thoughts continued to circulate around in Ji Yushi's mind. They twisted into a tight string, always alert, constantly reminding him not to really fall asleep.

It was unknown how long he had slept when he heard someone talk to him in a low voice. His hearing however was delayed, and he couldn't hear clearly.

Then, his stiff upper body was lifted by someone. Something wrapped him up. He opened his eyes slightly in daze and saw that he was wrapped up in the dirty blanket the bearded man had thrown onto the cart earlier. It was made of wool and it had holes made from cigarette butts as well as old sweat stains. It was unknown what could be infesting that blanket and it clearly looked filthy.

Even if every cell in his body wanted to escape from this filthy blanket, Ji Yushi didn't have the ability to refuse it, nor could he refuse it. With that bit of warmth, his hands and feet gradually regained some of its senses.

He still couldn't sleep soundly.

After a long time, he finally could move his head a little.

The blanket continued to transmit warmth. It was warmth from a human body. It meant that someone was holding him across the blanket.

It didn't feel good. Ji Yushi wanted to struggle. In a daze, he saw before him a face that he recognised, and it was also one that left a deep impression on him.

That face looked a little different, but Ji Yushi at this moment couldn't find the difference.

He was unable to tell whether this was a dream or reality. In any case, seeing that face, all his tensed mood was instantly relaxed, and he was no longer vigilant.

Following that, sleepiness overwhelmed him.

Ji Yushi fell into a deep sleep.

\*

Waking up again.

The body's senses had gradually restored, and the pain had diminished mostly. Apart from the burning sensation on his back — The result of friction from being dragged by someone, Ji Yushi felt a lot better.

He wasn't completely awake, but he opened his eyes.

The first thing entering his vision was the smooth floor and ceiling, as well as the walls and round hatch that appeared to be made of something similar to ABS alloy. Through the small round window on the wall, the sky was still dark outside.

This place was like an enlarged version of the inside of the capsule. To be more precise, it was more likely a small room inside a space capsule.

“Awake?”

Someone asked.

Only then did Ji Yushi realise that Song Qinglan was sitting next to him.

The other party had one of his long legs bent and he had his head and back leaning against the wall in an overall lazy and bored posture.

It turned out that it wasn't a dream just now.

Ji Yushi finally knew why Song Qinglan seemed different.

Although the other party's personality was domineering and like a thug, he paid great attention to his appearance and was the type of person whose appearance blessed other people's eyes. That face that would usually be described as handsome was at this moment covered in stubble, making him look a little sloppy. If one had to put it more nicely, he looked a little more manly.

To Ji Yushi, he had only separated from his teammates not long ago after entering his capsule.

But from the looks of the stubble on Song Qinglan's chin, they must have been apart for a while.

Ji Yushi laid on a small rectangular bed in the room with a dirty blanket over him.

The two of them are separated by a normal distance but Ji Yushi couldn't be less clear about the source of the warmth earlier.

He opened his mouth and spat out a few words, "Just now, thank you....."

It was fine when he didn't speak but as soon as he spoke, Ji Yushi realised how unpleasant his voice sounded. It was dry and hoarse, as if he hadn't spoken for a long time.

"You're welcome." Song Qinglan's tone was the same as before. He raised a brow slightly, "If I didn't warm you up, you would've frozen to death."

Then, he paused for a moment. Seeming to think that there was something inappropriate with his behaviour just now, he then asked unnaturally, “You...don’t mind, right?”

Ji Yushi was confused. Why would he mind?

Shouldn’t it be Song Qinglan who should mind?

Song Qinglan seemed to have thought of something, and the corner of his lips bent.

What don’t mind? He shouldn’t worry about that. In any case, he would do the same even if it was another teammate.

It was just that Ji Yushi this person...Wasn’t his mysophobia pretty severe? He was clearly too sleepy to even open his eyes earlier, yet he didn’t want to be covered by this blanket and even let out a sigh in his sleep.

And that sigh was simply him making a compromise. It was extremely obvious that he didn’t like the blanket.

It was better to skip over this topic.

Ji Yushi had a lot of doubts, “Where are we? And when did you come here?”

He still remembered the bearded man dragging him back

And the mountain of garbage.

As well as the transparent glowing flowers blooming in the pile of garbage.

Song Qinglan answered, “I also don’t know where this is.”

Having said that, Song Qinglan’s lazy expression was gradually stored away, and it turned a little more serious. Following that, he told him everything he knew, “I only remember us entering our capsules. I seemed to have lost consciousness halfway and when I woke up, I was already here.”

It was unknown what went wrong.

When Song Qinglan woke up, he had also found himself lying amidst the large mountain of garbage.

“Maybe the capsule ruptured during the transition, causing the temperature to drop rapidly. The rapid change in temperature may have caused excessive sensory stimulation.” Song Qinglan paused and then continued, “I was in the same situation as you when I arrived here. I couldn’t move and laid in the garbage dump for a long time before I was suddenly dragged back by a big guy — The same one who brought you back.”

“After waking up, I was kept in this small room the entire time.”

“Based on my observations during this time, it seems that this place doesn’t have day and night and I have never seen the sun. That person searched me and took away everything I had. Without a communicator, I also don’t know how long I have been detained in here for. Roughly estimating, I may have been here for at least five or six days.”

Ji Yushi furrowed his good-looking eyebrows, “Has it been that long?”

Song Qinglan nodded, “It indeed has been a long time. It’s just my conservative guess. It may even be longer.”

No wonder Song Qinglan looked like this. But for Ji Yushi, he had only been here for a few hours.

There seemed to be a deviation in time between the two of them, but it wasn’t a problem.

They arrived at the same point in time, but it was just in a different order.

Ji Yushi asked, “And the others?”

Song Qinglan said, “Except for that big red-haired guy, there is no one else here and I haven’t seen any of the teammates.”

No one else?

Ji Yushi thought about it. Could the other teammates have also had something similar happen to them and would arrive later than them?

Seeing him in thought, Song Qinglan also thought of something and said, “I thought only my transition had an issue and that I would need to grow old here with that bearded man but fortunately he picked you up. Looks like the other members of the seventh squad will very likely come here too.”

Suddenly being separated along the long passage of time and space, not knowing what year, what month, and where this place was, and being confined alone in an unfamiliar room with no one knowing of their whereabouts, any ordinary person would have already broken down.

But from Song Qinglan’s tone and from his expression, Ji Yushi didn’t find any trace of fragility or fear.

It was unknown whether Song Qinglan was joking or not, “I have to thank him for picking you up. With this, even if we don’t return, I won’t be bored to death.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Ji Yushi: “No wonder you were afraid of me freezing to death.”

“That’s true. At least I have someone who can talk to me.” Song Qinglan’s lips carried a hint of a smile, “You should know that that big guy doesn’t speak the same language as us. I had to rely on screaming and shouting and doing everything I could to get that big guy to understand what I meant and only then did he reward me with the blanket to wrap you up with.”

So that was how the blanket came about.

Song Qinglan noticed something and teased, “Isn’t it much warmer?”

Ji Yushi had already given up struggling.

After sleeping, his entire body was soft and limp. What was done was done and he no longer wanted to move, “Yes, thank you.”

As he said this, there was knocking on the round alloy hatch about two metres away from them.

A red beard appeared behind the glass on the hatch and then the beard moved down, revealing flushed cheeks and blue eyes.

It was the bearded man who had picked them up.

The bearded man saw that Ji Yushi had woken up and very quickly opened a small rectangular hole at the bottom of the hatch. His blue eyes looked through that grid and he muttered a lot of things. It sounded like interrogative questions.

Song Qinglan seemed to be used to it. He looked coldly at the hatch.

Ji Yushi also didn't understand.

The bearded man spoke to himself for a minute or two, changing the pronunciation of several words and the wording of the question. As if he had run out of patience, he suddenly slammed his fist against the hatch angrily and then threw something into the room through the hole.

A can rolled across the ground. The small hole was closed, and the bearded man angrily stomped away.

Ji Yushi was puzzled. He felt like he was being treated like a pet, "He's feeding us?"

"Probably still wants to communicate with us." Song Qinglan said, "He would come every once in a while. The first few times he spoke to me non-stop just like this but later, probably because he realised that I didn't understand, he only threw food in. Now that you're here, he's trying again."

Song Qinglan stood up and walked over to pick up the can.

The trademark was written in English. They didn't dare think about where it was from. In any case, it looked like spam.

Overall, it wasn't a bad meal.

The bearded man probably didn't learn mathematics well. He right now needed to feed two people, but he only gave one can.

Having not eaten after a long sleep, Ji Yushi was a little hungry. He could only support his sore body up and share the can with Song Qinglan.

"It was nice back at the transfer station. We could eat anything we wanted." Song Qinglan ate very little. Perhaps it was because he was a little dissatisfied with the taste. He eventually gave the entire can over to Ji Yushi, "We should think of something. Can't be locked in here the whole time."

"What do you suggest?"

Ji Yushi had his eyes lowered as he ate. Even if he was very hungry, he ate very sophisticatedly.

Song Qinglan looked at him, "Don't worry, we have two people now. We can discuss it after you're done eating."

**The author has something to say:**

Little Song swallows: Wow, it's spam. It must be New Year.

A while later, little Song thought to himself: Advisor Ji is so frail and he's eating so well. Forget it.....I'm really a good captain.

**KK has something to say:**

A new mission!



# Chapter 28: Chapter 28

## Chaos

### Chapter 28

After finishing the can, Ji Yushi recovered a lot of strength.

After eating, the first thing he did was to rinse his mouth in the bathroom attached to the small room. To be honest, if it wasn't because he had no choice, he wouldn't have eaten canned food. He was a picky eater.

But seeing that Song Qinglan was even more picky than him, and in a situation where they should stay in good condition, he forced himself to finish it.

After rinsing his mouth, Song Qinglan who was pickier than him was already standing at the hatch. He asked, "Advisor Ji, have you seen these words before?"

This small room was very clean. There was nothing on the desks and cabinets. To prevent them from escaping, the bearded man didn't leave anything behind.

The hatch was a style that could be opened and closed from both the inside and the outside. It required a password to be inputted into the touch panel.

Over the past few days, Song Qinglan had tried multiple passwords to no avail.

Ji Yushi walked over to look.

He had never seen those characters before.

It was a familiar password touch panel with a keyboard but there were no number keys. Every one of the keys where the number keys should be had strange symbols written and each and every one of them were different. They probably represent the meaning of a number.

if it corresponded with Arabic numerals 1-9, the remaining keys should be lock, unlock, etc.

Song Qinglan said, “I have been idle these days and have tried many combinations while regarding them as Arabic numerals but firstly, I didn’t know how many digits the password is and secondly, I didn’t know what the possible meaning behind it is, so I wasn’t able to open it.”

Selecting blindly would just be a waste of time.

No matter how intelligent one may be, it was still not possible for them to crack open a code so easily.

At this moment, both started to miss Duan Wen who always carried various high-tech accessories around with him. If Duan Wen was here, they would be able to use a device to directly decode it.

“It may be Big Beard’s language.” Ji Yushi said.

“Big Beard?” Song Qinglan reacted and said, “You mean that big guy? He’s like a savage. If this goes on any longer, I will almost be like him.”

Song Qinglan’s green stubble was fairly obvious. The speed of it growing was indeed quite fast. If it was a year and a half, it would likely become a beard comparable to Big Beard’s.

A man’s physiological structure and male hormone determined the growth of their hair. Song Qinglan originally didn’t care much about it.

But with the two standing side by side at the hatch and looking down from his angle, he happened to see Ji Yushi’s clean chin and delicate skin.....Ji Yushi probably was the type who didn’t grow beards.

Song Qinglan went on to say, “I have never heard of Big Beard’s language before. Advisor Ji, do you have any impressions?”

Ji Yushi shook his head, “No.”

The rapid development of science and technology in their Star Era allowed people to be exposed to all kinds of knowledge and information from all over the world. Some may be noticed by others while others may be inadvertently ignored, but for Ji Yushi, as long as it was something he had seen, heard, or felt, he would never forget.

Because he didn’t have the ability to forget.

That was why Song Qinglan asked.

“According to Star Era 1420’s Earth Language Encyclopedia, there are currently 7000 different languages in our world, many of which are endangered languages.” Ji Yushi recalled Big Beard’s unintelligible words, “So it is normal for me not to have heard it before.”

Having said that, he was puzzled, “But, in order to create a space capsule, technological development must be rather advanced, and it is impossible for just that alone to be developed. Arabic numerals have already been around for many years. Why are they using such an uncommon method instead?”

This was also what Song Qinglan didn’t understand.

Through the glass window on the hatch, Ji Yushi could see a long corridor. Like the small room they were in, the corridor was also brightly lit with white walls and floors. The corridor was quiet. It had a bend at the end leading to another direction.

The marks on the ground attracted Ji Yushi’s attention.

Mottled and continuous friction marks continued from the corner to the front of their small room. It looked like drag marks.

Ji Yushi asked, “He dragged me with an iron chain?”

Ji Yushi asked calmly, but given his superb ability to hold grudges, it was very possible that he had already drawn a big red cross on Big Beard inside.

Song Qinglan made a sound of affirmation. He then also looked outside and comforted him, “I think Big Beard has done that more than once. These drag marks don’t seem to have formed from doing it once or twice. I wonder who those unlucky people were.”

Then didn’t that mean that someone else had been here before they came?

If someone had been here, where have they gone?

Ji Yushi fell into thought.

The two returned to the table. Suddenly, there was a loud noise.

As if thunder blasted right above them or a heavy object fell from the sky, the sound caused even the space capsule to shake.

Outside the small round window on the wall, the sky lit up for a moment and then darkened again.

Song Qinglan looked outside, “Again.”

Ji Yushi asked, “What again?”

“This kind of noise often appears, but it is irregular.” Song Qinglan was also used to this noise now. He told Ji Yushi his guess, “Although for now I don’t know where this place is, but every time that noise appears, Big Beard would push his cart out and return with a bunch of things. Look.”

Ji Yushi leaned over. The two looked out of the small round window together.

After a while, Big Beard appeared pushing the cart.

The ground was stiff frozen soil, and the temperature was very low.

When Big Beard breathed, he exhaled white mist. He was wrapped in a faded padded coat as he trudged forward.

Big Beard was about two metres tall and very burly. The sky above him hung down, and it was so close, it looked like he could reach it. He pushed the cart along, walking through this indescribable world. For some reason, from the perspective of the two, Big Beard's figure showed deep loneliness.

They watched him walk a few steps and then stop by the roadside.

A transparent glowing flower bloomed there. It was bigger than the ones on that mountain of garbage.

Big Beard pulled it out, stuck it to the handlebar of the cart, and continued on.

Very soon, Big Beard's figure disappeared into emptiness.

"Mountain of garbage." Ji Yushi muttered to himself and then turned around, "He's pushing that cart to go to that mountain of garbage?"

Outside the window, an aurora of various colours rippled across the sky.

Blue, green, purple, that aurora lit up his eyes and face and even his individual eyelashes could be counted like this.

Song Qinglan retracted his gaze, "Yes, he's probably going to pick up things again. We were both picked up by him from there."

There was a brief moment of silence.

Ji Yushi whose mind didn't stop working the entire time spoke up, "Cap Song, it may be a magnetic field."

He was very intelligent, and his mind worked very fast, "Those piles of metal equipment and those cans were likely affected by some sort of special magnetic field and attracted here. Our capsules were the same. Every time that kind of noise occurs, it is when foreign objects are sucked in."

“You’re right.” Song Qinglan agreed and then raised his own conjectures. “I suspect that this space capsule and Big Beard was also drawn here by that mysterious magnetic field.”

To be able to suck in a capsule that was in the process of transitioning, what on earth was this place?

The two couldn’t find an answer.

“We should go.” Song Qinglan said, “Next time he comes back, we have to seize the opportunity.”

\*

Big Beard was very happy.

He had a big harvest this time. Not only did he pick up a brand-new pot and a whole box of photo albums, but he also found several boxes of canned beer.

Pushing the cart filled with items, he returned to the space capsule humming a small tune. He then drank a box of beer while looking through the newly picked up photo albums.

When he woke up again, Big Beard had a headache. It took him a long time to remember that there were still two traversers in the small room.

He didn’t want to starve them to death.

So he picked and chose, and saw the cans of spam meat he had picked up together with that beautiful traverser last time and picked up a can to throw into that small room for them to eat.

But just as he opened that small rectangular flap, he saw the taller traverser sitting at the door, looking at him coldly.

That tall traverser had been here for quite some time.

When he first picked him up, Big Beard felt that he exuded a dangerous air. Those firm muscles and strong body as well as the look of determination in his eyes clearly showed that he wasn't an easy to deal with target. And so, even if he managed to lock him up while he was in a weakened state, Big Beard still felt that he was a dangerous lion. As long as he had the opportunity, he would fight back at any time.

That was why Big Beard had only fed him once a day and he only gave him an abysmal amount of unpalatable vegetarian food.

Big Beard wanted to keep that traverser weak.

But even after so many days, that traverser didn't turn amicable.

He still dared to look at him coldly just like now.

Big Beard let out angry strings of curses and then threw in the spam meat.

The tall traverser suddenly stood up.

Big Beard was alert, but he saw the tall traverser use his finger to point to the side.

There was a person lying on the ground motionless with the blanket covering his entire body, including his head and feet.

Only dead people were covered like that.

Big Beard's blue eyes widened.

That tall traverser was expressionless. He picked up the can and with a 'clank', he pulled it open and began to enjoy the food alone — For the sake of having something to eat, the tall traverser may have killed his companion who wore the same clothes as him.

Big Beard was extremely angry.

He smashed his fist against the hatch and then turned and left.

His heavy body stumbled along, and his footsteps stomped heavily with each step. His entire body expressed his anger.

Big Beard returned to the place he usually stayed and circled around. His eyes fell onto the gun he had picked up. The black gun glistened coldly and the magazine with energy bullets was still full. It was an extremely precious item.

Big Beard angrily picked up the gun and quickly strode back to the small room.

He entered the password and opened the hatch.

The tall traverser still had a can in his hand. He sat there on the side, looking at him indifferently.

Big Beard had a gun in his hand, but he hated handling dead bodies and cleaning up blood stains the most. He muttered a lot of curses and intended to take the traverser out and kill him outside.

But the dead body lying on the ground made him very irritable. He cursed as he bent down and pulled away the blanket to check.

But the person under the blanket suddenly opened his eyes.

Ji Yushi's dark eyes were extremely calm. He looked up at Big Beard without blinking, as if he had expected this behaviour of his.

Big Beard's expression changed. He realised that he had been tricked but, in an instant, Ji Yushi had already grabbed his wrist and neatly flipped over onto Big Beard's back, pinning him down to the ground.

Although Big Beard's reaction wasn't fast, he was very strong.

He fiercely shook his back and Ji Yushi soon found himself thrown away, slamming into the wall, "Ugh!!"

"Anfalahagenhe!!"



Big Beard roared. He held Shen Mian's trigger, ready to blast that cunning traverser to death in one shot.

His back hurt badly. Ji Yushi was left in a dizzy state from that impact. His eyes were teary from the pain.

With the muzzle facing him, he didn't hide and instead reminded, "You have chosen the wrong weapon."

Big Beard didn't understand. He cursed and pulled the trigger and then revealed a look of confusion. The gun didn't respond!

No sooner said than done, a gust of wind flashed by behind Big Beard. It was Song Qinglan!

Big Beard slammed his hand holding Shen Mian back. Song Qinglan bent down to avoid it and appeared before Big Beard the next second.

This completely angered Big Beard.

He yelled and waved the gun over madly. Song Qinglan however greeted him with a heavy fist in the face, hitting Big Beard so hard, he saw stars in his vision. The Shen Mian in Big Beard's hand fell to the ground and he staggered back covering his bloody nose.

Immediately afterwards, Song Qinglan held him in a tight chokehold.

Song Qinglan held him in an iron-like grip. Big Beard was choked so hard, his eyes rolled back. He struggled violently and his body continued to retreat, slamming Song Qinglan into the wall.

"Cap Song!!" Ji Yushi climbed up.

Big Beard was more than a dozen centimetres taller than Song Qinglan and his body as like a sturdy bear. All the fighting skills and techniques were nothing in front of his heavyweight body. Song Qinglan was repeatedly slammed against the wall.

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth. He clearly had no intentions to let go and he didn't even make a single sound.

The wall was slammed with so much force, it made a loud noise with each impact. Big Beard's body was filled with brute force but Song Qinglan managed to completely restrain him. Eventually, Big Beard fell onto his knees from suffocation.

Under the suppression of this powerful force, if it was another person, Song Qinglan would have already strangled them to death, but Big Beard still firmly grabbed Song Qinglan's arm, not intending to give up.

This was simply an endurance showdown between two powerful beasts.

“Boom!”

Big Beard suddenly let go and fell limply onto the ground.

It was Ji Yushi who stood up.

With a cold expression, he had knocked Big Beard unconscious with the butt of Shen Mian.

“Damn....Was almost slammed to death just now.” Song Qinglan instantly relaxed his grip and threw the body aside. A thin layer of sweat had already formed across his forehead from the pain, “This person should do sumo wrestling. Can guarantee that he will win.”

This Big Beard couldn't have possibly be a transformed brown bear?

Ji Yushi threw Shen Mian to Song Qinglan. He was still breathing quickly, “Let's go.”

Now wasn't the time for slandering.

Ji Yushi stretched out his hand and Song Qinglan borrowed his strength to get up.

The two hurried out the small room and closed the hatch along the way, shutting Big Beard inside.

They walked through the mottled corridor and then turned the corner. A spacious control room appeared in front of them.

Their earlier speculations were correct. This was indeed a space capsule, but the equipment and layout were different from the ones they were familiar with. They couldn't tell which era this one was from.

The control room was filled with various items including scrap metal, food and alcohol. They occupied most of the control room. In addition to that was a sofa, a TV set that had long become redundant in their time, old and tattered books, as well as a table tennis table. It looked just like a living room that one had used for many years.

Leaving the control room and bypassing many corridors and hatches, the exit appeared before them.

As soon as the door was opened, cold wind from outside rushed in, lashing at their faces like knives.

Song Qinglan slammed the door shut with a bang and then opened the storage box next to them. Inside were protective suits.

These protective suits looked filthy and didn't look like it would help with keeping them warm but Song Qinglan still pulled two of them out.

Seeing Ji Yushi's hesitant look, Song Qinglan found it amusing, "Don't fuss, there is no way to buy you new ones here. I promise on behalf of the organisation that I will buy you as many as you want when we get back!"

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan wordlessly covered the other party with the not-so-dirty one and then wore the other set himself, "Let's go!"

The two opened the hatch and walked out.

The first time they stepped onto the ground outside, they only felt that each step was very heavy.

Ji Yushi guessed that it was due to the magnetic field. The gravity here may be different from their world.

The temperature was lower than expected. They walked for a long time and only managed to move one to two hundred metres.

The visibility here was also very low. Looking back, the white space capsule behind them had already become a vague shadow.

The aurora in the sky appeared again and again. It looked like it would never stop.

Except for their footsteps and breathing, there were no other sounds here, let alone any other people or animals.

When they could no longer see the space capsule behind them, they seemed to have lost their way.

Everything around them looked the same, there was no reference point they could use.

Fortunately, there were marks left behind on the ground from the cart Big Beard used. It at least meant that they were walking in the direction of the mountain of garbage.

That was where they came from.

It took them another half an hour of walking, until Ji Yushi almost couldn't take another step, that they finally saw the tall mountain of garbage. This mountain of garbage was filled with vines and glowing flowers. The glowing spots illuminated the place, making them a beautiful embellishment amongst the ruins.

There was no path here.

“Continue on.” Song Qinglan made a decision, “Do you want to take a break?”

In the low temperature, white mist from each breath made Ji Yushi’s face a little hazy. He panted and shook his head, “No need.”

Ji Yushi was a very stubborn person, but he never minded showing his weak side. If he really couldn’t hold on, he would definitely say something.

Song Qinglan was already aware of this so he didn’t continue asking and just once again continued walking but at a slower pace than before.

He never thought that he and Ji Yushi would end up in such a situation.

Before leaving, the person who he thought would have no connection with him, because of these unimaginable changes, had become someone he relied on in life-or-death situations. It must be said that it was a strange matter of fate at play.

“Look!” Ji Yushi suddenly shouted.

The two raised their heads.

A fantastical and dream-like scene appeared.

A large silvery-white sphere appeared in the sky. Large and small craters could clearly be seen on the surface of that sphere. It suddenly appeared, as if it was very, very close to them, and it was so big, it almost covered the entire place they stood.

It was an image of a planet that looked similar to the moon.

In just ten or so seconds, that image disappeared just like those auroras.

The scene just now was too shocking. The two didn’t speak for a long time.

Everything here couldn’t be explained with common sense.

“Let’s go.” Ji Yushi returned to his usual calmness, the brilliance in his eyes still present.

They lowered their heads and moved on.

It took the two a long time, stumbling along, to finally reach that huge garbage dump.

Looking up, everything was foggy ahead and unclear. It even looked darker than the path they had travelled along.

Song Qinglan held one end of Shen Mian and handed the other end of the gun over, “Hold the gun. We can’t get separated.”

Ji Yushi held the end of the gun and said, “Wait a minute.”

Ji Yushi bent down and, copying Big Beards actions earlier, he picked two glowing flowers by his feet.

These flowers were very beautiful. The petals were transparent and luminous, and one could see the small veins under the petals. As long as you held them in your hands, it was enough to light up each other’s faces.

Song Qinglan understood immediately. It could be considered as lighting.

He took one and casually inserted it into the pocket of his protective suit.

They then used the gun as a rope, each holding one end of it to ensure that they would not get separated.

And together, they stepped into the darkness ahead.

# Chapter 29: Chapter 29

## Chaos

### Chapter 29

It got darker and darker.

Slowly, even the scattered wreckage on the sides could no longer be seen using the glowing light from the flowers.

The two walked through this darkness. They could only feel the presence of each other through Shen Mian in their hands and the faint lights coming from the flowers they had picked.

In this kind of darkness that seemed to stretch on endlessly, it easily made people wonder if they were still alive.

There were no markers in any direction, let alone traces of other living beings. It was as if there was only the two of them left in this world.

After walking for about an hour, they were still in darkness a second ago but the moment they took another step, bright light suddenly filled their eyes.

With that step, it was like they had suddenly stepped into another world.

The blinding light made the two cover their eyes. After adapting to the brightness, the two of them were stunned by the scene in front of them.

They had stepped into a tropical rainforest.

The fresh scent of grass, earth and water filled their noses and lungs.

Dense vegetation filled their entire field of vision. Trees tens of metres high grew in the lake, their roots intricately spreading out like a huge network of veins. All of it could clearly be seen through the surface of the water. There was no fish in the water, nor any traces of other microorganisms. The water was incredibly clear.

Plants resembling plantains were dotted among them. Their thick leaves were moist, and it looked like water droplets would soon drip down from it. Water plants were overgrown across the centre and edges of the lake, thick vines were entwined among the trees and flowers of various colours could be seen everywhere.

But what made them more speechless was that if they looked up along those trees, they would see that there was no end in sight. The world above them was like a reflection, perfectly reproducing the scene on the ground below.

There was no sky here.

Above their heads was a rainforest that hung upside down. It was exactly the same as the one on the ground, with the same greenery and same luxuriant vegetation.

Ji Yushi suspected that this was actually some kind of illusion.

They walked for a while. Ji Yushi reached out and touched the leaf of a plant. The sensation was slightly cool. He knitted his brows, "It's all real."

The temperature and humidity here was high. The two had already taken off and put away their protective suits.

Song Qinglan's sensitivity to the environment was far beyond ordinary people, but he didn't sense any danger here. He stood behind a purple and white flower of an unknown name with his black combat uniform perfectly fitted to his body. Because of his long legs, he looked like a model doing a photoshoot, "Advisor Ji, have you noticed that it is too quiet here?"

There was no hustle and bustle one would normally hear in a rainforest. There were no sounds of animals or birds, or water or wind.



Except for the plantations that thrived abundantly, not even a moth was in sight.

“It’s very strange.” Ji Yushi nodded and then looked into the distance, “Cap Song, should we continue moving forward?”

If they didn’t move forward, they could only go back.

Both were very clear about what the situation was like in the direction they had come from.

“If we want to find out what’s going on here, I think we should go forward.” Song Qinglan held Shen Mian, “What do you think?”

Ji Yushi let go of the leaf in his hand, “I think so too.”

Sogn Qinglan reminded, “But if we continue onwards, we may encounter danger. There are only the two of us.”

Ji Yushi said, “Then we can only go back and make Big Beard our companion.”

Song Qinglan hooked up the corners of his lips and used his gun to push away the plants blocking his path, “Alright, then let’s continue on.”

Ji Yushi didn’t have a weapon on him, and everything here was unknown.

Song Qinglan very naturally walked at the forefront. Ji Yushi had no objections.

The rainforest was hot and humid. As if it had just rained, water droplets still hung from the grass and leaves.

But after a few minutes of walking, their hair and body were wet. Ji Yushi’s complexion was cold and pale. Water droplets slid down his hair to his face and neck. His eyes however were still particularly vivid under all the greenery.

Song Qinglan however felt that if Ji Yushi continued like this, he would get sick again.

Reaching towards a plant with thick round leaves, Song Qinglan used his tall height to easily pull off a leaf the size of a water basin, “Here, shield yourself.”

Ji Yushi received it and held it like an umbrella, “Thank you.”

He had nothing against using it but he teased Song Qinglan, “Cap Song is so considerate, I almost thought I was a woman.”

Song Qinglan still needed to hold the gun with his hands, and he was responsible for opening up a path for them, so he didn’t have time to ‘hold an umbrella’. He casually replied, “I didn’t say that.”

They walked into the depths of the rainforest.

The trees here were even bigger, with trunks requiring four or five people to completely encircle. As a result, the gaps between the trees also increased. Many smaller plants grew on these trees and fruits hung from it. They looked round and alluring, like dragonfruit, but no one dared to rashly give it a try.

The further they went, the larger the plantation in the rainforest became. It eventually became even larger than what they could picture.

They passed a huge colony of fungi.

Light blue, red, white and yellow. All sorts of huge mushrooms grew in the rainforest like individual small houses.

Ji Yushi stood under the cover of a mushroom and observed, “These mushrooms should not be of the same species. The largest mushroom I have ever seen is the Porcini which can grow up to 50cm in diameter or the Armillaria fungus which can spread underneath for a distance of up to 2000 acres. Fungus grows on the roots of trees and would continue to secrete

enzymes to break down the roots but despite so many mushroom here growing to this size, the trees growth doesn't seem to be affected....."

"I didn't expect you to even know about mushrooms." Song Qinglan asked, "Advisor Ji, is there anything you don't know?"

The long journey was too boring. The two continued to move forward.

Ji Yushi said, "I actually saw it in the museum."

Song Qinglan asked, "There is a museum specifically about mushrooms?"

"It's just one of the popular science exhibitions." Ji Yushi said, "I was only five at the time and found it interesting."

People with hyperthymesia rarely found something they remembered very interesting. This was Song Qinglan's first time in a long time hearing Ji Yushi mention a relaxing memory.

Song Qinglan turned and asked, "You could remember everything from such a young age?"

"No, this illness wasn't from birth." Ji Yushi told him, "I only suddenly found that I could remember everything that has happened one day a long time later. Including all the experiences I have had and all the details, I could remember it very clearly and I was unable to forget it."

Not from birth?

Song Qinglan guessed that something must have happened during that time.

Ji Yushi no longer continued talking about this and the two were not familiar enough to have conversations like this, so the topic ended here.

They walked past a huge group of fungi.

They then passed a small stream and finally found something by the stream.

Some tools and packages were scattered there and there was also a rusty kettle. It looked like someone had stayed here.

Ji Yushi opened those packages and saw that there were also some daily necessities inside, including mouldy batteries and a water damaged communicator, all of which could no longer be used. Ji Yushi also found a compass inside. In their era, these things all belonged to a time a dozen or so years in the past. The compass however appeared to be in good condition. The N/S English letters on the dial were still clear but it was a pity that the pointer spun around aimlessly so it was completely useless.

“Advisor Ji.”

Song Qinglan also discovered something. Standing behind a bush, his expression wasn't very good. Ji Yushi put away the compass and walked around the bushes to look. His expression similarly fell.

There were three corpses behind the bushes lying haphazardly together. Most of their bodies were covered by the mud washed ashore from the stream during heavy rain.

These people seem to have been dead for a long time. Except for the hair that was still there, the rest of their body have become bones.

What made them uncomfortable were the clothes on these corpses that were basically still intact — The high strength polymer material that is fire and water resistant, the colour, the style, and the position of the numerical symbol on the left chest, they were exactly the same as the black combat uniform they wore.

Song Qinglan bent down and brushed away the mud on one of the corpses with his hand. The number on the Guardian's chest appeared: 12.

These three corpses were all Tianqiong's Guardians.

“Fifteen years ago, there was a Guardian squad numbered 12 who accepted a S-level mission.” Song Qinglan said, “But 180 seconds after their departure, contact was lost for all eight of the members. Since then, for all

those years, we haven't received any news from them again. The Tianqiong System has checked various times and spaces many times, but no traces of them could be found."

Ji Yushi: "This is them?"

"It should be." Song Qinglan frowned, "I heard about this case when I first joined as a Guardian. According to the experts, they were lost in a certain time and space and hid away."

Whether it was a Guardian or a Recorder, the requirements for one to become one was very high.

Not only were they required to be capable enough, but they also needed to be strong and firm psychologically. Humans after all have weaknesses. Just imagine. Those who go back to the past have the ability to predict the future, while those who go to the future can have an entirely new life....Since the establishment of Tianqiong, because of various human desires, it wasn't that something like that had never happened. It wasn't unusual for one to be unwilling to return to their original time.

During those times, Tianqiong would send out another squad to correct the mistakes. They are referred to as Inspectors. Once they set off, they are tasked with the mission to deal with the deserters and bring them back to their original time for execution.

And the Tianqiong twelfth squad was the only squad that had not been captured by the Inspectors.

Song Qinglan, "Everyone thought they had deserted because of their selfish desires. I didn't expect them to be here."

Deserters.

Ji Yushi stared at the three corpses before him. It was unknown what was going through his mind.

This matter was a secret in Tianqiong, only squad captains knew about it.

Song Qinglan then said, “You may not have heard of this....I feel bad for them. Looks like it was just as we thought, there is indeed a strange magnetic field here which causes those transitioning to be sucked in.”

Ji Yushi said, “If we can’t go back, we will also be treated as deserters.”

Song Qinglan was noncommittal.

Ji Yushi was right. Except for the fact that they were hijacked to that transfer station by the so-called “Tianqiong self-awareness”, their current situation was similar to that of the Tianqiong twelfth squad. If they couldn’t return, as far as the third command centre was concerned, the seventh squad who had lost contact after departing had become a deserter.

But Song Qinglan wasn’t a pessimistic person. The same was true for the entire seventh squad, they wouldn’t succumb to their current predicament.

“What’s the cause of death?” Ji Yushi asked, “Can you tell?”

“There is no visible trauma to the bones...” Song Qinglan examined the corpses, “The clothes are also undamaged. Doesn’t seem to be due to external factors. If it was because of starvation, they wouldn’t all die in the same place. Based on their posture, it was probably due to poison.”

Both remembered the dragonfruit-like fruits and large mushrooms they had passed by.

After burying their seniors, the two continued on.

This time, they walked for a very long time.

Time in this rainforest seemed to be at a standstill. Just like the place where they came from, there was no day or night. It made it difficult for them to feel the passage of time.

But the energy consumption of the human body wasn’t at a standstill. Very soon, they felt hunger and fatigue.

They walked along the stream, into the deeper parts of the rainforest and once again saw huge mushrooms and thick and tall trees.

With lessons learned, even in the case of extreme hunger, they passed through the brightly coloured fruits and resisted their strong desire to give them a try.

After passing by a group of plants with thick round leaves, Ji Yushi stopped, “Cap Song.”

There was a broken off mark on one of the plants. Milky white liquid was still dripping from that broken off part. It was the leaf Song Qinglan had broken off before.

Song Qinglan also recognised it, “Fuck, we’re going around in circles?”

In fact, Ji Yushi had been thinking about this issue for a while now. He pursed his lips but decided to voice his inner thoughts, “I don’t think so.”

Song Qinglan also didn’t think that. He and Ji Yushi had a good sense of direction and wouldn’t going around in a circle, but the situation was just too strange.

It was almost like a ghost knocking on a wall.

After thinking for a few seconds, Song Qinglan made a decision, “It’s easy to know if we’re going around in circles. Let’s continue.”

Then, everything happened very suddenly.

As they walked, one second earlier they were still in the rainforest and the next second, they had stepped into nothingness.

The surroundings became dark again.

The temperature dropped and the dampness from the rainforest on their bodies was still there. Even if they put on the protective suit they had not discarded earlier, they weren’t able to warm up. They could only bite the bullet and move on.

Ji Yushi was so cold, his teeth chattered.

Without the flower's glow this time, he had to hold tightly onto Shen Mian in the cold, trying hard to speed up his pace.

Song Qinglan looked back at him several times, but said nothing.

The aurora in the sky flashed.

In the silence, they stopped in place.

What appeared before them was another mountain of garbage.

No, this was the mountain of garbage they had walked past earlier.

Moving further on, when their hands and feet were almost about to freeze, they saw a familiar space capsule.

Song Qinglan pushed the door open and the two walked in.

Big Beard was sitting on the small sofa, using a towel to cover the bleeding nose Song Qinglan had made.

Seeing the two of them enter, Big Beard immediately bounced off the sofa with anger, "Anfalahagenhe!!"

Song Qinglan sneered. He raised Shen Mian and pointed it at Big Beard. He copied his pronunciation and said, "Anfalahagenhe."

He didn't know what it meant, but he knew that it definitely wasn't anything nice.

Big Beard froze.

It wasn't known if it was because of Song Qinglan's words or because he was afraid of the gun, but the two-metre-tall fool stood there in daze.

Ji Yushi was so cold, his lips had turned pale, "....."



The space capsule was much warmer. He took off his protective suit and tossed it aside and then walked over to the pile of wreckage gathered by Big Beard.

Big Beard returned to his senses and shouted anxiously in fear of Ji Yushi taking away his things.

Ji Yushi however only picked up a retro-looking alarm clock made of metal and said, “Cap Song, it has been less than two hours since we left the space capsule.”

# Chapter 30: Chapter 30

Less than two hours?

Even if the human body's sense of time was prolonged due to the difficult environment, they shouldn't have only been in that rainforest for two hours.

Ji Yushi said, "I saw the time when we left. It was indeed less than two hours ago."

But he quickly remembered the magnetic field here and the compass whose pointer spun around and added, "Could it be a problem with the clock's speed?"

Song Qinglan's nose was tall and lips were thin. He continued to point Shen Mian at Big Beard, "It shouldn't be. Although I didn't hold back when I punched him, it shouldn't be to the extent of still bleeding a day or two later."

Perhaps it was because he understood that the two were discussing the problem of time, Big Beard shouted out some more nonsense again and appeared to be a little anxious.

Unfortunately no one could understand what he said.

After experiencing PU-31 and all the strange happenings there, the two no longer perceived time the way they did before. Faced with this situation, they didn't panic.

Ji Yushi placed the alarm clock down, "I have an idea."

He boldly surmised, "It is very likely that the time flow here is not the same as the time flow in the rainforest. If that is the case....Then it wasn't an

accident that we were sucked here and it is in fact related to the mission.

For the new mission they had unlocked this time, the mission objective was —- Repairer of Time.

In Tianqiong's transfer station, the team had discussed the mission objective and had interacted with Tianqiong's voice system.

But despite the so-called awakening of Tianqiong's self-awareness, it was ultimately still just a system and had its own way of thinking so the information it could give was limited. As a result, they were not able to gain any more useful information.

Please read this from kk translates

Song Qinglan noticed that Ji Yushi's complexion didn't look very good and his body was still wet, so he said, "Let's analyse it later. Advisor Ji, we have now flipped the situation around."

Facing the anxious bear-like Big Beard, Song Qinglan curled up the corners of his lips slightly. He knew that Big Beard couldn't understand, yet he deliberately expressed the meaning of his words clearly, "We can have a hot shower first, warm up our clothes and then comfortably discuss this matter while we slowly eat up Big Beard's stock."

Big Beard's eyes widened with vigilance, "Gulukagajijifalahe?"

Song Qinglan moved the muzzle, gesturing for Big Beard to move.

Big Beard blew away his beard, "Lawukaguda!!"

Song Qinglan ignored him, "I'm sure you know what I mean."

This seventh squad captain who had always been rebellious escorted Big Beard into the corner with his gun like a full-blown gangster. He then found an iron chain like the one Big Beard had used on them and tied Big Beard to a pipe.

Big Beard was almost about to pass out with anger. He almost tore apart the chain!

\*

Song Qinglan's arrangement was right. They really needed to eat and fix themselves up right now.

The structure of the space capsule was almost a hundred times larger than that of their capsule and it had its own self-preservation system. Ji Yushi walked through several corridors and passed through several hatches before he finally saw the tightly shut outer hatch.

The outer hatch seemed to not have been opened in a very long time.

Ji Yushi entered the bathroom, took off his wet black combat uniform and placed it into the steamer to clean and dry.

He then stood under the showerhead and rinsed himself from head to toe with hot water.

Hot steam fogged up the glass. The hot water washed away all the uncomfortable dampness on his skin as well as all the unknown bacteria and filth he may have acquired from the mountain of garbage and the dirty blanket. Water flowed through every part of his body before finally reaching his ankle.

After taking a shower, Ji Yushi wiped himself down.

He put the black combat uniform which had been steam cleaned on again and saw Song Qinglan leaning against the wall in the corridor outside as soon as he walked out of the bathroom. Song Qinglan had his head lowered and was looking down at a small black and white game console in his hands.

It was Ji Yushi's game console.

After he came here, it was taken away by Big Beard along with his communicator. Song Qinglan had clearly somehow managed to get it back.

Although he had given it to Ji Yushi last time in PU-31, they were in a situation where they even had difficulty protecting themselves in the big cycle so it was naturally not possible for Ji Yushi to use it to “distract himself”.

A faint chill could be felt from Song Qinglan’s body. There was even a small blade of grass from the rainforest stuck behind his earlobe.

He seemed to be waiting for Ji Yushi to finish washing up.

When Ji Yushi passed by, the last block on the screen fell and the words “Game Over” just happened to appear.

There was only one bathroom here, but there were many compartments.

Ji Yushi asked, “Cap Song, why aren’t you going in?”

If it was another team member, Song Qinglan would certainly not wait outside. It was just taking off some clothes and having a shower and they’re all rough men so what was there to be shy about?

“Going now.” Song Qinglan however didn’t answer that question and only returned the game console to Ji Yushi, “The high scores on the leader board are all yours?”

It was an unbelievably high score.

Ji Yushi received the game console, “Some were played by others when I’m not at home.”

Ji Minyue especially wanted to beat his score and would never give up even if he was about to die.

When he wasn’t around, it was played by someone at home. It seems that intelligent people all hang around with other intelligent people.

It was hard to imagine how clingy the other person was.

Song Qinglan raised a brow, “Then you’re all very good.”

Song Qinglan entered the bathroom, reselected a cubicle and washed himself thoroughly from head to toe.

During this process, he suddenly understood why Ji Yushi was reluctant to stay in the seventh squad. It wasn't that he was still holding a grudge — It was likely because of his boyfriend. Although Jiang City and Ning City are not too far apart, it was still more than an hour's drive. Guardians are usually busy with their job and with training so commuting from there wouldn't be an option.

Becoming a Guardian would indeed have an impact on one's relationship.

Not to mention Song Qinglan, even Duan Wen who was in his early thirties was still a single dog. Li Chun couldn't be blamed for being such a scum flirting with every girl he meets. Just imagine if your other half is often away for one or two months for their missions. No girl would be able to stand it.

Although Ji Yushi and his partner are both male, it was still no different from heterosexual couples.

With that, it was understandable.

The mission this time came unexpected. They were really unlucky.

As the saying goes, it was better to demolish a temple than destroy a relationship.

Song Qinglan felt that if Ji Yushi was really unwilling to stay when they return, he shouldn't force it.

When Song Qinglan got out after showering, Ji Yushi was already eating canned food.

To Song Qinglan's surprise, Big Beard had already been released by Ji Yushi. At this very moment, he sat opposite Ji Yushi like a small mountain, blowing his beard and gesturing while saying something while Ji Yushi sat

cross-legged on the sofa biting onto a disposable spoon with a trace of confusion in his usually clear eyes.

“What are you doing?” Song Qinglan asked.

Hearing his voice, the two raised their heads.

Seeing him come out, Big Beard immediately staggered to his feet and tried to find something to use to fight the tall traverser again.

Ji Yushi on the other hand was a little stunned.

Song Qinglan had shaved off all the stubble.

After seeing the messy looking Song Qinglan for so long, Ji Yushi seemed to have forgotten that the other party was actually a very eye-catching person so when he saw his original handsome appearance again, he felt like it was his first time seeing it.

Song Qinglan carried his gun with him at all times. As soon as Big Beard found a fry pan, Song Qinglan raised Shen Mian and narrowed his eyes.

Big Beard threw the pan away and sat down in irritation, “~\*@#!”

There was a photo album and a pen sitting between Ji Yushi and Big Beard.

There were some drawings on the photo album as well as some strange symbols. It looked like Big Beard’s writing.

Are these two communicating?

Song Qinglan also sat down cross-legged. He placed Shen Mian on his lap and picked up a can of canned food seemingly casually, but he was in fact always on guard against that big fool.

Ji Yushi was eating canned fruit. He ate very slowly, “He has something to tell us. It should be about this place.”

Song Qinglan took the photo album and looked at it.

It had to be said that Big Beard's drawing skills were simply terrible. The group of suspicious objects were difficult to distinguish and there were a bunch of nonsense symbols written next to them.

Seeing them looking at his drawings, Big Beard pointed at each of the symbols and then at himself. His blue eyes blinked a few times, and he said a few words they didn't understand.

Of course, this exchange was mainly for Ji Yushi.

Big Beard's pronunciation was difficult to understand and difficult to learn.

Ji Yushi swallowed a piece of exceedingly sweet yellow peach and repeated after him.

Big Beard was so excited he almost slapped his legs. He nodded fiercely and then made a series of gestures. Ji Yushi once again revealed a look of confusion.

Song Qinglan found it funny, "Let me try."

It was rare for Ji Yushi to have times where he was confused. Song Qinglan picked up the pen and roughly drew the mountain of garbage in a blank space on the album. He then sketched a cartoon version of the space capsule next to that mountain with a few quick strokes.

Ji Yushi: "You draw pretty well."

Song Qinglan said, "Of course. This one was once the drawing champion for three consecutive years in kindergarten."

Ji Yushi, "I can see it."

Song Qinglan drew another space capsule over the mountain of garbage with dotted lines and another arrow was drawn to indicate that the space capsule was moved from the mountain to the location it was in now. He then let Big Beard look at it.



Big Beard nodded fiercely. He forced himself to give Song Qinglan a good attitude and pointed to himself and said a few things.

Ji Yushi asked, “Is he saying that he and this space capsule were also sucked in?”

“Something like that.” As he ate, Song Qinglan drew a black ball behind the mountain of garbage and then a rainforest behind that.

Big Beard seemed to understand. He nodded.

So Big Beard must have also been to that rainforest.

Ji Yushi had already finished his can of fruit.

He took the pen from Song Qinglan, drew a clock on the space capsule and several others above the rainforest. He was asking about the synchrony of time.

Big Beard drew a cross over the rainforest drawing, “Gulaka.”

“He’s telling us not to go.” Song Qinglan explained concisely, “Says it’s a dead end.”

After speaking, Song Qinglan randomly picked up another can, roughly opened it, and handed it to Ji Yushi, “Advisor Ji, eat a little more.”

Big Beard had quite a large stock. He probably picked up a few the last few times.

The one Song Qinglan ate was a can of fish, but when he grabbed a can this time, he had picked up a can of spam identical to the one they had last time and handed it over.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

So how picky was Song Qinglan? Was he trying to get rid of the things he didn’t like first?

Song Qinglan, “Since the situation is currently unclear, if this really is related to the mission, we should try and maintain our strength as much as possible.”

Ji Yushi only felt that he never wanted to eat canned food again for the rest of his life.

Because it was difficult to swallow, he ate very slowly. He used the pen to add an outer hatch to the space capsule.

That was the one he noticed when he went to the bathroom just now. He originally wanted to ask what was in that direction but, unexpectedly, as soon as he finished drawing, Big Beard who had been staring angrily at the cans in their hands immediately changed his expression and he excitedly said a lot of things.

“Gulaka! Gulaka!”

Big Beard looked very serious. The two understood immediately. He was saying that they shouldn’t go there.

“Going?” Ji Yushi asked.

“If we don’t go and see, we won’t know what’s there.” Song Qinglan thought for a while, “But I can go alone this time.”

“We should go together.” Ji Yushi said.

“Alright.” Song Qinglan agreed, “It would be best to find more clues.”

Please read this from kk translates

They rested for a while. Big Beard sulked on the side.

The two could see that Big Beard didn’t really want to dissuade them. After all, these two ate too much. The cans Big Beard had hoarded was already missing a small corner.

Among the piles of things picked up by Big Beard, they found their other belongings including their communicators, knives and medicine box. In case anything were to happen, they also found some clean clothes picked up by Big Beard as well as flashlights and some food.

\*

Big Beard very reluctantly entered the password for them. After entering it, he muttered a few times. He was probably cursing.

The outer hatch which hadn't been opened in a long time was now opened.

Unlike their journey to the mountain of garbage, there was no need for adapting here. As soon as the outer hatch was opened, they were met with darkness.

Big Beard may seem foolish, but his behaviour was rather shrewd. Fearing that they wouldn't be able to return if he closed the door, Song Qinglan pointed at the door and then at his gun.

After confirming that Big Beard understood, the two turned on their flashlights and walked out of the hatch.

As soon as they stepped out, the darkness disappeared.

What greeted them was a dazzling light.

The sky was clear blue and cloudless.

They stood before a zebra crossing in a bustling city.

The traffic lights were flashing. For a moment, they felt like they had returned to the real world.

The painted surface on the quiet and clean asphalt road appeared to be quite new. There was no one at the intersection, let alone any moving vehicles.

Like the rainforest, it was also extremely quiet here. There weren't any noises or human voices that belonged to a city.

This was an empty city.

The two turned off their flashlights. Ji Yushi said, “Cap Song, look there. The sign on the road next to it is reversed.”

Song Qinglan also noticed that.

They stood at an intersection and could see an English ‘STOP’ sign on the lanes on both sides but the one on the left was reversed.

Not only that, all the scenery on both sides of the road were extremely symmetrical with identical cars parked by the road and exactly the same shops. If one looked up, even the buildings were symmetrical, like mirror images.

This was very similar to the situation in the rainforest. No wonder Big Beard reacted that way.

They understood what the result would be if they continued walking.

That is, no matter how long they walked, no matter what they tried to do to get out of this city, they would only return to the original point in the end.

“Won’t go for the time being. This kind of mirroring makes it easy to get lost.” Song Qinglan said, “Let’s go back first and see if other directions are feasible.”

“Alright.” Ji Yushi also had that intention.

In order to compare the time flow, Song Qinglan had set a timer on the communicator before departing.

He raised his wrist and checked, “It has been less than three minutes since we arrived here. This time we gave up rather quickly. What is this called, cutting short one’s losses?”

Song Qinglan’s tone was helplessly self-deprecating. Ever since they came here, they hadn’t taken another step.

The two didn't have to walk much when suddenly, the light before them dimmed and the city and sunlight disappeared. They had returned back to the space capsule.

As soon as they entered the space capsule, there was deafening music.

They walked through the corridor, enduring the painful vibration in their ears the entire way, and quickly returned to the control room.

There were two people in the control room, each holding a can of beer, shaking their heads and dancing to the music.

One was the red-faced Big Beard and the other wore a familiar black combat uniform.

Ji Yushi: "....."

From the looks of it, not just three minutes had passed.

Song Qinglan walked over and slapped the speaker off. The veins on his temples bulged.

The two stopped with the music and turned their heads and looked over.

Li Chun was frozen for a few seconds before he cried and threw himself over, "Cap Song!! Advisor Ji!!"

"Wait a minute." Song Qinglan poked his forehead with his index finger. His dark eyes were filled with distaste, "How long have you been here?"

Li Chun cried aggrievedly, "It's been six days! What the hell is going on with this mission this time?!"

# Chapter 31: Chapter 31

## Chaos

### Chapter 31

The mission this time.

[Mission mode: Chaos.]

[Mission rule: None.]

[Mission objective: Repairer of Time.]

After being hijacked by Tianqiong's 'self-awareness', they had completed the Super S-level [Ouroboros] mission. That task itself had left everyone in tatters so before they set off this time, Song Qinglan had chosen an A-level mission from the missions that needed to be unlocked. It was enough for them to just get some clues about when they could return.

They had thought that this mission would be very simple compared to [Ouroboros]. After all, an A-level and a Super S-level mission was not the same. This one was so much simpler; the system didn't even specify a mission rule for them.

But no one expected that this damned system had once again thrown them a curveball.

Ji Yushi was pretty certain now that they weren't sucked into this place by accident.

Whether it was that rainforest that was mirrored vertically or the city that was mirrored horizontally, the flow of time on both sides didn't make sense.

These strange phenomena corresponded with their mission objection: Repairer of Time.

To him and Song Qinglan, it had only been three minutes since they left the space capsule, but to Li Chun, it was different.

According to Li Chun, he had arrived here six days ago.

Like them, his capsule had fallen into the mountain of garbage. In his muddled state, he saw Big Beard with his nose stuffed with tissues.

Big Beard examined the clothes he wore and, after confirming that he was still alive, he slowly took away the nutrient solution from the capsule, tied him with an iron chain, and brought him back to the space capsule along with the other materials he had picked up.

“I thought I was going to be cut up and cooked by him!” Li Chun said, “I couldn’t move at all at the time and even thought of what to write in my will. How are we so unlucky? Forget about the fact that we were hijacked by the system on our way out to our mission, we now even have to complete mission after mission and there’s not even a damned bonus! And even despite all this, when I joined Tianqiong, I swore to be a fearless Guardian but if I were to die in this god forsaken place, I won’t be able to rest in peace. The girl from last time is still waiting for me to ask for her number!”

Song Qinglan sent him a look, “After all that chatter, the last line was the key point.”

Li Chun froze for a moment, “That’s just an additional point. In fact, I’m not very afraid of death. I’ve after all already died many times in PU-31. I was just afraid that I would die here alone without seeing any of you one last time.”

With Li Chun the chatterbox here, the space capsule finally felt a lot livelier.

The empty and strange atmosphere from this strange world was gone and even Big Beard didn't pick up a frying pan to fight against Song Qinglan like before.

Big Beard saw that they had returned and blabbered on for a while. He then pointed at Li Chun to express that he had saved him before gulping down the rest of the beer in his hand and falling asleep on the spot. One phrase surfaced to everyone's minds: Large body, large heart.

During those three minutes Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi were away — That is, the six days in the space capsule, Li Chun and Big Beard had already had a deep exchange with each other. The floors, the walls, they were all covered with remnants of their exchanges, and the originally interesting photo album had been drawn all over to the point where it could no longer be recognised.

Ji Yushi listened to Song Qinglan and Li Chun's exchange and then looked around at the 'communication artworks'. Some he could understand, others he couldn't.

"Where are the others?" Song Qinglan asked.

"Don't know." With the captain back, Li Chun no longer dared to indulge and answered honestly, "The communicator doesn't work here so I don't know where Brother Wen and the others have gone. Maybe they are still on their way here."

Like Ji Yushi, Li Chun also fell here the moment he entered his capsule in preparation to leave for the new mission. To him, he had only separated from his teammates not long ago.

It seems that there wasn't just a problem with the flow of time in the mirrored rainforest and the mirrored city. The whole world here had a time difference with the outside world.

Ji Yushi faced a piece of paper on the wall and asked, "Is this a drawing of Big Beard?"



On the paper was a drawing of a space capsule and there were nine people drawn beside it, one of whom was very tall.

The space capsule was drawn in a cartoon style similar to how Song Qinglan had drawn it previously whereas the people next to it were drawn very crudely. It was obvious that it was drawn by Big Beard himself.

“Big Beard?” Li Chun readily accepted this simple title and said, “Yes, this was what he drew of him himself. There should be nine of them when they came but now, he is the only one left. Looking at the uniform and the space capsule, could they be traversers like us?”

Song Qinglan answered, “It’s possible. They were probably also sucked in like us.”

Li Chun remembered something and walked over, “Advisor Ji, there are some words written here that I don’t understand. Can you read it?”

Li Chun pulled out another piece of paper. The Big Beard drawn on it was more detailed, and he was wearing a uniform with some symbols on it.

These symbols seem to be words in Big Beard’s language. No one could understand.

Li Chun however asked the right person.

When Ji Yushi saw those symbols, he immediately remembered the password keyboard in the small room. The symbol on the uniform in this drawing had the same symbols.

Ji Yushi said, “If the symbols on that password keyboard are numbers, then it would correspond to the numbers 1-9. Two of those symbols should be 18.”

Song Qinglan understood, “According to your analysis, if we use the process of elimination, the first two symbols are definitely not numbers.”

“It shouldn’t be.” Ji Yushi looked back at the drawing of the space capsule, “But since they appear on the uniform, even if they are not numbers, it must

represent something like region or their mission. To figure out the meaning, we need to know where exactly Big Beard came from.”

Ji Yushi reached this point and paused, “Nine people.....He’s the only one left?”

There were almost no traces of other people living in the space capsule.

The control room was filled with miscellaneous items. It wasn’t something that could be achieved in a short period of time and instead it was accumulated over a long time. Big Beard’s messy hair and long beard was also an indicator that he had been here for a very, very long time.

So, how long had Big Beard been living here alone for?

The traces by the door of the small room left from repeatedly dragging iron chains also showed that Big Beard had dragged someone back on more than one occasion. In that case, where did those people go?

Why was there only Big Beard here in this place?

Song Qinglan mused, “Could it be like the twelfth squad and they also encountered something in the rainforest or the city or somewhere else?”

Li Chun asked curiously, “Twelfth squad? And what rainforest, what city?”

“I’ll talk to you about this later.” Song Qinglin wasn’t interrupted by him and continued, “Advisor Ji, if those people really entered those places and they end up getting lost because the flow of time in those places are different, then they’re probably unlikely to return?”

Ji Yushi’s mind was always clear.

Even during the extremely difficult mission like Ouroboros, he was able to quickly identify points that had been missed by the others.

The same was true this time as well.

“It’s very simple. We can calculate it.” Ji Yushi said, “We didn’t wear our communicators when we were in the rainforest. According to my guesses, it was probably about two days.”

“Wait a minute.” Song Qinglan objected, “Two days?”

He at most thought it had been a little over a day. Apart from being hungry and tired like Ji Yushi, he didn’t find it especially difficult and long.

“Yes.” Ji Yushi lowered his eyes slightly, “Due to various reasons, I rarely make a mistake with perceiving time, so the time we spent in the rainforest was about two days.”

Song Qinglan understood. It was his hyperthymesia again.

People with hyperthymesia didn’t gradually forget the previous second or previous minute like ordinary people did.

To them, every second spent was still clearly engraved into their minds, including all their senses and feelings at that time. As long as they recall it, it would be as if they were back at that time again and it was also because of this that their perception of time was rarely incorrect.

Ji Yushi didn’t dwell on this matter for long and continued, “But when we returned, we saw that less than two hours had passed. We can round that up to two hours for ease of calculations and here we can reach a conclusion. If we calculate the time flow rate by hours, the time in the rainforest is 24 times faster than the time in the space capsule.

Song Qinglan and Li Chun listened quietly.

“But the city we entered after going out through the outer hatch was completely the opposite.” Ji Yushi said, “It could be said that the time there was unimaginably slow. Let’s compare three minutes with six days and again calculated the time flow rate by hours. In this case, the time flow in that city is 2880 times slower than the time in the space capsule.”

Ji Yushi's mental arithmetic ability was just as good as his memory and he didn't even need scratch paper or a calculator, "Let's use a simple example. If we didn't go to the rainforest first but directly opened the outer hatch and entered the city, we would definitely try to find a way out inside. Even if we only stay in that city for a day, it is equivalent to staying in the space capsule for eight years or so. Just imagine, after staying in the city for a few days and then returning back here, what would happen?"

Hearing this news, Li Chun's mouth opened wide, "Shit. If that's the case, wouldn't I already be old and shrivelled by the time you come back?"

"Something like that." Ji Yushi said, "For us, only a few days had passed but for you, years had passed. If the time flow rate in the space capsule is the constant, then the rainforest and the city are the variables."

"Then I have a question." Song Qinglan asked, "The previous group, whether it is Big Beard's teammates or Tianqiong's twelfth squad, would there still be people in that city now? After all, only a short amount of time had passed for them. It is possible that they are still alive."

Everyone was silent.

That possibility was very high.

The terrible difference in the flow of time made a chill run down everyone's spine at just the thought of it.

No wonder Big Beard reacted so strongly to their decision to leave through that hatch.

Cap Song and Advisor Ji had returned safely, but Li Chun was still afraid. He hurriedly asked, "Then we are sure that the mission we need to complete is here? Repairer of Time. How do we repair it? Is this really an A-level mission?"

"If you didn't make Big Beard drunk, maybe we could continue to communicate and ask him how many people had been here before us."

Song Qinglan crossed his arms, “But this is strange. Why does he get along with you so well?”

Song Qinglan had been detained for five or six days and was left hungry for five or six days.

There was no answer to this question.

Ji Yushi said, “As for how to repair it.....I also don’t know.”

He looked at the drawings and symbols all across the walls and floors and said, “Let me figure out what you two have talked about during those days. When Big Beard wakes up, I may be able to learn his language.”

Song Qinglan, “You can learn his language?”

Ji Yushi said, “Yeah, there are seven languages that I am familiar with but not proficient in. My learning speed isn’t too slow. I can give it a try.”

The other two were suddenly silent.

Ji Yushi looked back questioningly, “What’s wrong?”

Li Chun asked sincerely, “Advisor Ji, do you know the difference between ordinary players and players with cheat?”

\*

The three moved separately.

Song Qinglan went to the mountain of garbage again to look for useful clues amongst the wreckage and along the way check how far away darkness around the space capsule extended for.

Because those drawings were too difficult to decipher, Li Chun stayed to help clarify some of the meanings he already knew for Ji Yushi.

When Big Beard wakes up, they would try to get information out from him.

“This is a drawing of us?” Ji Yushi found a page with numerous scrawls.

Two people were drawn on the paper, one tall and one thin. Both held canned food in their hands and there was a ‘7’ written on their chests.

Li Chun hurriedly nodded, “Yes! He drew it after we gestured back and forth, and it was through this that I knew you were here.”

Ji Yushi found it funny. It seems that Big Beard held deep resentment towards them for eating his canned food.

However, he quickly frowned and pointed at the drawing again, “And what’s this?”

There was a heart drawn between him and Song Qinglan.

“My god!” Li Chun immediately balled the paper up and threw it away, “It was Big Beard’s mistake. He thought you two were a couple!”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Standing from Big Beard’s point of view, he and Song Qinglan indeed wouldn’t have seemed quite right.

It had to be said, they really did give off somewhat gay vibes.

“Fortunately Cap Song isn’t here. Advisor Ji, you should know that Cap Song has PTSD!” Li Chun this chatterbox once again started to show his skills, “If he saw this, I wouldn’t be allowed to live.”

Ji Yushi blinked a few times. He sat down and asked, “Oh, what kind of PTSD?”

# Chapter 32: Chapter 32

## Chaos

### Chapter 32

“Isn’t it all because of that irritating gay from the ninth squad——” Li Chun reached this point and immediately slammed onto the brakes. He hurriedly explained, “Don’t get me wrong Advisor Ji, I didn’t mean it that way. I was only aiming the insult at ‘that person’ from the ninth squad.”

Ji Yush’s expression didn’t change. He only said, “Oh, it’s okay. I’ve heard worse before I transferred over.”

Things like homophobia, embroidered pillow, not accepting him as the new teammate, he had heard a lot of it.

Li Chun wanted to cry without tears, “I really didn’t mean it that way. Advisor Ji, don’t note my name down in your book.”

So why did he have to go and chat with Advisor Ji. He was done for now. Only God knew that he truly admired Advisor Ji very much.

“I know.” Ji Yushi said. Li Chun had said something similar back on the balcony in PU-31.

He repeated what Li Chun said last time, “Since Old Yu’s accident, Cap Song had always been blaming himself. He didn’t want me to come so he deliberately said those things. You are at most just a little straight but it’s not to the extent of being homophobic.”

Li Chun’s desire to live was very strong, “Yes, yes, yes.”

Advisor Ji remembered his words very clearly.

It was unknown if Ji Yushi really believed it. In any case, Ji Yushi reacted very calmly, as if 'gay' had nothing to do with him.

Ji Yushi flipped through Big Beard's drawings and casually urged, "Go on."

"Oh." Li Chun nodded and spoke carefully, "That is, the person I was talking about is Lin Xinlan, the captain of Tianqiong ninth squad."

Tianqiong ninth squad?

Ji Yushi remembered that when they first arrived at PU-31 and saw the mission details on the communicator for the first time, Duan Wen had also suspected that it was a prank by the ninth squad.

Li Chun, "I heard he and Cap Song joined Tianqiong around the same time. When the two were students, they were both often put together as promising students and were known as the Double Lan Duo. Later, Lin Xinlan publicly pursued Cap Song and when he was ruthlessly turned down, he swore that he would definitely make him his. Cap Song was straight and had kept a distance from him since then, but Lin Xinlan continued to persistently chase after him. Not to mention giving him breakfast, he even waited for him after work and all that. There was one time when Cap Song wasn't around, someone saw Lin Xinlan come out of Cap Song's office with his clothes dishevelled. That pervert, who knows what he was secretly doing in Cap Song's office for so long....."

Ji Yushi thought, no wonder it was said that Song Qinglan needed to disinfect rooms gays have been in.

It turned out to be because of this.

"What's even more hateful," Li Chun clenched his fists, "Someone on the Tianqiong internal network drew a gay fanart of Lin Xinlan and Cap Song, and Lin Xinlan openly praised it!"

Ji Yushi: "....."



It turned out to be because of such a ridiculous reason. The other party's behaviour was also very boring.

It was hard to imagine Song Qinglan being overwhelmed by a suitor. The Song Qinglan in his impression should have beaten him up directly.

Unexpectedly, Li Chun continued, "The two later had a fight and now their squad always goes against us and compete with us. They have all along been watching in anticipation after hearing about you joining our squad."

The more Li Chun spoke, the angrier he became, "If we go back, these mission reports would be enough to slap them in the face. And if not for you Advisor Ji, we may still be in PU-31's infinite loop....I dare say that if it was the ninth squad, they would be worse off than us. They not only don't have you, but they are also weak chickens."

"We can definitely go back." There was no conceit in Ji Yushi's calm expression. He just very naturally accepted the praise, "One person can make up for another person's shortcomings. With you here, we now have three people. There will only be more and more clues."

Li Chun nodded and said with some embarrassment, "Actually, I don't think I can be of much help. I'm just a salted fish who doesn't know anything."

Ji Yushi, "How so? At least you and Big Beard get along well. He has already put his guard down around you."

Li Chun hehe'd.

Innocent children are always good at making people lower their guards.

Li Chun had been doing logistic work in the team for nearly a year and had always wanted to contribute to the team somehow. Ji Yushi's words just now gave him a lot of encouragement.

After a while, Li Chun whispered, "If we go back, Advisor Ji, you're really not going to consider joining us?"

At the transfer station, everyone could see that Song Qinglan wanted to keep Ji Yushi on the team, but Ji Yushi's attitude on the other hand wasn't clear.

Everyone thought it was because their captain had offended the other person too much, and that Advisor Ji still held grudges for it.

Ji Yushi hadn't thought about the answer to this question.

The most likely answer however was no.

Li Chun, "Think about it a little. You see, we are now people who have gone through life-or-death situations together, and Cap Song and you can also be somewhat considered as people from the same town."

Ji Yushi, "Same town?"

"Cap Song's mother is from Ning City." Li Chun said, "Cap Song went to kindergarten in Ning City when he was young."

Ji Yushi: "....."

Amid Big Beard's snoring, Ji Yushi and Li Chun had almost gone through everything they had talked about during those six days. Even after reading all that, Ji Yushi still didn't have a clue about the other party's strange language system but after he looked repeatedly at the '18' symbol on the uniform drawn by Big Beard, he had a vague guess in mind.

Suddenly, there was a loud noise outside.

The violent shaking of the space capsule woke Big Beard up.

Li Chun who had never heard of this sound before asked in shock what it was.

Ji Yushi told him, "Something foreign must have been sucked in again."

Whenever something was sucked in by the magnetic field here, it would land on that mountain of garbage.

Sure enough, Big Beard who had woken up glanced groggily at them and then raised his burly body up. As he grunted a few times, he searched for his cart —— He was going to pick up trash again.

This time, Ji Yushi decided to go with him.

Li Chun also followed.

Following Big Beard's actions, they also pulled out warm cotton clothes from within the room and wrapped themselves up before walking out the door.

It was dark outside the space capsule. One could only vaguely see the frozen soil under their feet.

The sky was still very low, and the aurora flashed slowly one after another. It was beautiful and quiet.

Li Chun walked carefully, "Advisor Ji, could it be that Brother Wen, Tang Le and them were also sucked in?! Just like how we came here! With this, we can slowly gather everyone up!"

"It is possible." Ji Yushi said, "Cap Song is nearby. If it was Duan Wen and the others, Cap Song would find them more quickly."

If it was like this, they would also be able to avoid the fate of being dragged away by Big Beard's chain.

Big Beard who was pushing the cart suddenly squatted down and picked up a few glowing flowers from the vines on the side of the road to light up his way. He first placed one on the handlebar and then gave another to Li Chun and finally Ji Yushi.

He was still very drunk. He was like a giant homeless man and his entire body stunk so that action of his gave him some sort of a reverse charm. Ji Yushi felt that he probably wasn't a bad person. At least, he wasn't one when he first came here.

Big Beard led the way for them and the three quickly reached the mountain.

From the distance, they saw a tall figure rummaging in the pile of fresh garbage.

Unfortunately, there was no capsule sucked in this time.

Therefore, they didn't find their other teammates.

Song Qinglan saw that they had come and threw a can over at Ji Yushi, "Advisor Ji, look at this."

Ji Yushi caught the can and looked at it. On the can were the words: Kemeng Beans.

He then turned the can over and, sure enough, he saw the lines: PU-31 Golden Crow No. 2's first batch of organic vegetables since establishment.

So that's it.

# Chapter 33: Chapter 33

## Chaos

### Chapter 33

“Do you remember what we saw on the holographic projection in Golden Crow No.2? That black crevice next to PU-31?”

Ji Yushi asked.

In the space capsule, the three people sat in a circle.

Big Beard didn't understand what they were saying so he sorted out his newly picked up supplies by himself. He was very used to this kind of life.

Li Chun recalled and nodded.

In fact, he never really understood why that crevice had energy powerful enough to sustain PU-31 endlessly but anything regarding the time and energy of the universe was probably something even the top scientists in the world would not be able to answer.

If you don't understand, you don't have to worry about trying to understand it.

Song Qinglan followed up after Ji Yushi's question, “That is, the crevice between parallel universes?”

“Yes.” Ji Yushi said, “About this crevice, we all know that PU-31 is next to it and all the energy it has comes from the crevice. We also know that after turning off all the energy transmitters on PU-31, PU-31 would lose this energy hence affecting its balance and resulting it to be swallowed up by

the out-of-control energy in the transmitters — Which was what we called the black wall.”

Ji Yushi still held the can of Kemeng Beans in his hands. The disgusting taste as well as the plant’s unpleasant appearance had left them with a deep impression. It was the appearance of these beans that opened a way in Ji Yushi’s thoughts and once one path was opened up, many more paths similarly opened.

Ji Yushi said, “Before PU-31 was completely swallowed up, some things were sucked into that crevice, including this can of Kemeng Beans.”

Li Chun was surprised, “Advisor Ji, are you saying that we are currently in that crevice?”

Ji Yushi said, “Correct.”

Li Chun, “The fuck? How can it be?!”

Song Qinglan’s mind also worked very quickly. He thought about what he wanted to say and then voiced it out, “No wonder this mission is called Chaos.”

Chaos.

The first god born in Greek mythology. The literal meaning of it was abyss, a dark endless void.

It was later used to describe ‘mess and disorder’.

Everything they had seen and experienced since they had arrived at this place was consistent with the interpretation of the word ‘Chaos’. The dim sky that hung low as if it wrapped around the world, the darkness around the space capsule, the rainforest and city whose time flowed at different rates and the magnetic field here, they all showed that order and law didn’t exist in this place.

“This may be a breakthrough point.” Song Qinglan’s instincts worked as he narrowed his eyes, “But there is something I don’t understand. Why was it

that we would coincidentally end up with a mission that is connected despite choosing an ordinary task at random?”

Before departing the transfer station, there were many missions waiting to be selected.

What the system said was: Complete more tasks to unlock more information about ‘when they could go home’.

The one who made the decision was Song Qinglan. Taking into account everyone’s state, he only chose an ordinary task that was of A-level.

Ji Yushi also thought of this question. He paused for a moment as he seemingly fell into thought before asking, “Do you remember how the capsule fell after setting off from the transfer station?”

Song Qinglan’s expression changed slightly.

Li Chun was a little confused, “I don’t seem to remember.....I only remember entering the capsule and when I opened my eyes, I was here.”

Ji Yushi asked again, “Then when we arrived at the transfer station, except for the day when we first arrived, can you still remember what you did in the next few days?”

“Eat, sleep.....” Li Chun blurted this out very quickly and then his expression turned into a look of surprise, “No, except for eating and sleeping, I can’t remember anything else I’ve done!”

“I can’t remember either.” Ji Yushi spoke slowly, “If you can’t remember it, it may be because it was a repetitive and boring activity in life and your brain automatically treated it as unimportant information, but that wouldn’t be the case for me. After seeing those Kemeng Beans, I became suspicious of our current situation and unconsciously began to recall everything that happened during this time only to find that I not only didn’t remember how I felt here after entering the capsule, I also didn’t remember what I did while staying at the transfer station. My memory tells me that I had a rest at

the transfer station; I ate and then slept, but as for what I ate and what I did before sleeping, I found that I had no impression of it.”

Ji Yushi had said that he didn’t have the ability to forget.

This meant that even for a simple meal, he would remember clearly how long he took to eat it, how many times he chewed and what the dishes were.

Li Chun, “Yes, yes, yes, me too!”

“I am the same.” Song Qinglan replied and he then looked at Ji Yushi, “Advisor Ji, I think what you are going to say next is going to subvert our understanding of this place.”

That was what he said, but Song Qinglan didn’t show any signs of nervousness or feelings of helplessness. He seemed to be prepared and interested in what Ji Yushi had to say next.

For some reason, Ji Yushi felt a sense of trust from him.

At the same time, his originally slightly overwhelmed mindset settled back down. It was as if no matter how strange and out of the world their situation was, the result would be no more one line: The matter depends on the individual.

“Have you ever wondered why that transfer station looked very similar to the third command centre in our memories?” Ji Yushi asked. “According to the system’s words, it is in a broad sense Tianqiong of all eras but why did it choose to model the transfer station after the ones from our time? And those reserves, since the transfer station is somewhere in time and space, how did it manage to have everything we wanted?”

Song Qinglan thought of the bottle of red wine.

He remembered that he had a similar thought in mind and when he opened the cupboard, he found a bottle of red wine.

It was indeed too coincidental.



Listening to these analyses, Li Chun unconsciously got goosebumps on his arms.

Ji Yushi's next words made all his hairs stand up in an instant.

"I believe that there was no such thing as the transfer station in the first place." Ji Yushi concluded calmly, "The so-called transfer station was just a memory stuffed into our minds when we were in an extremely exhausted and fatigued state. Following the endless cycles one after each other, we had always been in an alerted state and our body reached its limit. This Tianqiong self-awareness needed us to continue completing its missions so it simply created the so-called transfer station for us to rest. As a system, it is impossible for it to fabricate many days of memories in great detail so apart from lowering our guard and entering a resting state on the first day, we don't remember anything else."

Song Qinglan said, "So it's not that the mission I selected is connected to the previous mission, but that we are already in a mission and no matter what choice I make, whether it is simple or difficult, the result would still be the same."

Ji Yushi, "Correct."

What 'correct'?

Li Chun's eyes swirled.

Every time Ji Yushi analysed the situation and Song Qinglan was able to keep up, Li Chun felt that he himself was very ignorant. He had doubted his intelligence numerous times now.

But Li Chun was very used to being a salted fish who would do his best to ask questions and understand the situation. He raised his hand and asked, "Um, Advisor Ji, I have a question."

Ji Yushi's beautiful eyes didn't show any frustration. He just said gently, "Go on."

Li Chun was moved to see that the other party was very understanding of him and quickly asked, “If it is as you had said and there was no transfer station in the first place, how did we end up here?”

Having asked this, Li Chun couldn’t help but shudder. The memories from PU-31 were too terrifying for him. Being bitten by zombies, eaten by mutated beasts, it was basically a collection of a hundred ways for him to die. He asked nervously, “Co-could we still be in some other cycle?”

“No, we have already completed the Ouroboros mission.” Ji Yushi said, “A reasonable explanation for how we arrived here is: After completing the mission and fusing into one with our other selves, we returned to the moment when we were transitioning over to the initial A-level mission and, while the black wall completely swallowed up PU-31, we were sent into the crevice.”

Li Chun seemed to somewhat understand.

If it was him, he wouldn’t have been able to figure any of this out even if you gave him an entire lifetime to think about it.

“In order to destroy the out-of-control PU-31, Tianqiong created a time anchor. After we completed that mission, it sent us back to the moment the capsule was reporting an error and then we were sent here. All those things happened at the same time and similarly ended at the same time. This hijacking incident seems to be far more complex than we initially thought.” Song Qinglan held Shen Mian in his hands and he unconsciously rubbed it with his thumb. His eyes gradually cooled down, “So when would this be over? Or is it not going to end at all?”

Li Chun asked anxiously, “Then Brother Wen, Old Zhou, Tang Qi and Tang Le are still in the capsules?”

Song Qinglan said, “Yes, if this is arranged in accordance with the order of us entering our capsules, the next one should be Zhou Mingxuan.”

Big Beard on the side had already finished sorting out his things and was sitting on the sofa with a can of beer in his hand, gulping down its contents.

Song Qinglan glanced at him and thought of something, “Since this is a crevice between parallel universes, Big Beard may not have come from our world.”

In this way, Big Beard’s incomprehensible language made sense.

Ji Yushi found a picture of Big Beard and pointed at the symbols on the uniform, “I also have a thought about this. I think the place Big Beard came from was called PU-18. They may have been sucked in during a mission.”

In this universe, after the decline of Earth, many colonies similar to PU-31 were spawned. As seen from the number, there should be at least 31 places like PU-31.

Song Qinglan put away Shen Mian.

It is not a difficult puzzle that should be feared, but rather ones that you have no clues about.

After discussing and finally obtaining some clues, Song Qinglan’s entire being seemed more relaxed, as if nothing would crush his mentality.

“Chaos.....crevice between parallel universes...” Song Qinglan mused with his brows knitted, “If this crevice isn’t closed, more people from different times and different parallel universes may be pulled in.”

At the same time, both Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi thought of the three corpses found in the rainforest.

Because of this crevice, their seniors in the twelfth squad were sucked in during their mission and were eventually left with only their bones here.

If the crevice was likened to a loophole in time, then their mission as the ‘Repairer of Time’ was obvious.

The two looked at each other and similarly thought the same thing.

The tacit understanding between them was very mysterious. It was as if as long as the two acted together, any problem could be solved at twice the

speed and with half the effort.

Song Qinglan looked at Ji Yushi's clear yet quiet eyes and felt a strange feeling surge inside him.

Warm heat filled his heart. It was just like the time at Golden Crow No.2 when he helped feed Ji Yushi his medicine.

Inexplicable and ambiguous.

There was clearly three of them sitting there but Li Chun suddenly felt lonely: "....."

He felt like he was not needed.

# Chapter 34: Chapter 34

## Chaos

### Chapter 34

Eat, sleep, think.

The pace in the space capsule had suddenly slowed down.

The four worked hard together. Li Chun used the remaining photo albums and cut them out into cards while Song Qinglan was in charge of drawing. Ji Yushi used these cards and began to learn Big Beard's language.

Ji Yushi indeed had a talent for languages. All the meanings and pronunciations of the symbols only needed to be seen once to be memorised. He was pretty much like a human recorder.

With the efficiency being so high, Big Beard was very excited. Ji Yushi only planned to study two hours at a time, but Big Beard would always deliberately draw it out longer. Every time it happened; Ji Yushi felt that Big Beard was just like his class teacher from high school.

During the rest of the time, Ji Yushi and Song Qinglan would analyse their situation.

Using the time flow rate of known locations such as the rainforest, space capsule and the city, they tried to find a balancing point.

Ji Yushi had many different methods of calculation. Using his communicator to form a projection, the calculations he wrote grew and grew and became longer and longer and very soon, Song Qinglan couldn't keep up.

There was no sun here. Except for the clock which was still running, it was difficult for them to tell when it was time to rest.

Occasionally, Song Qinglan would find Ji Yushi asleep at the table.

Ji Yushi's desire to return back to their time was very strong.

At the 'transfer station', the Tianqiong system once responded to the question of why they were chosen: Their chance of success was higher than the average across all guardian squads.

Song Qinglan knew that this chance of success had a lot to do with Ji Yushi joining their squad.

In the afternoon two days later, Zhou Mingxuan really fell onto the mountain of garbage.

Following the earth-shattering noise, Big Beard got his chain and cart ready in preparation to pick up more garbage.

Song Qinglan went with him. When Big Beard was about to tie Zhou Mingxuan up with the chain, Song Qinglan stopped him, "Don't. I'll do it myself. Anyone who passes through you would have lost a layer of their skin."

Big Beard didn't understand but he could guess Song Qinglan's meaning. He blew his beard and said, "Mengkalawuliqi!"

After saying that, he turned around and left.

Song Qinglan didn't know why this big guy was angry, but he didn't pay much heed to the other party's strangeness. He picked up Zhou Mingxuan and placed him in the cart. On the way back, Zhou Mingxuan opened his eyes in daze.

Zhou Mingxuan's physical fitness wasn't bad. Although he couldn't move at such a low temperature, he could still speak, "Cap Song.....Why is it so dark?"

After speaking, he fell unconscious again.

Aurora flashed. Glowing flowers bloomed on both sides of the road. Song Qinglan suddenly had a thought.

Back at the space capsule, Li Chun excitedly rushed up to settle Zhou Mingxuan down. The big guy however was nowhere in sight.

Ji Yushi was still writing out formulas and there was a pot of coffee next to him.

“Cap Song.” Ji Yushi raised his head, “What’s wrong?”

Song Qinglan was still standing. From his perspective, Ji Yushi’s act of raising his head to look up at him made his eyes even rounder and more vivid.

Inadvertently, Song Qinglan felt a strange feeling inside him again.

He restrained those emotions and sat down next to Ji Yushi, “Our mission is the Repairer of Time. To put it simply, it is to fix the loopholes in time. Is it possible that this mission has nothing to do with the flow of time?”

The two sat side by side. Ji Yushi showed a puzzled expression, “Has nothing to do with the flow of time?”

Song Qinglan curled up his lips, “What I mean is, Advisor Ji, could we have overestimated Tianqiong? Perhaps it isn’t as smart as we thought.”

Song Qinglan believed that the so-called ‘Repairer of Time’ was the same as the ‘Chaser of Darkness’ that they needed to complete in their last Ouroboros mission. They were both in fact very simple and clear.

“The system is just a system after all. Even if it has self-awareness, it wouldn’t play dumb riddles with us for our missions.” Song Qinglan said, “It at best would play some tricks when assigning the missions but it would be in accordance to how a machine would think, not crafty like humans.”

Ji Yushi picked up the coffee on the side and took a sip. He subconsciously licked away the residue on his lips.

Song Qinglan looked away, “When I was looking for Old Zhou just now, I suddenly thought of a question. Why was it so dark around the space capsule? It also didn’t have any mirroring while the other places were the complete opposite.”

With the space capsule as the centre, the surroundings were all dark and there were no mirror projections above, below or on either side.

As for the rainforest and city, they were bright and had mirror projections.

Time flow around the space capsule was normal.

The opposite was true elsewhere.

This question opened up a new way of thinking for Ji Yushi. He let out a soft ‘ah’, “Why didn’t I think of that?”

It was clear that Ji Yushi was a little annoyed. He had his brows furrowed and he even forgot to drink the coffee he had brought to his lips.

Ji Yushi thought for a while, “.....Why is it normal around the space capsule?”

Suddenly, Ji Yushi thought of a possibility. His eyes lit up, “Is it because of that moment of darkness?”

As he said that he raised his hand and closed the diagram projected from the communicator. He once again made some gestures in the air with his hands just like when he explained Ouroboros to help the other understand and also help himself sort out his thoughts.

New thoughts quickly appeared in his mind, “Based on our experience and your observations over the past few days, we can be certain that the space near the space capsule is surrounded by a completely dark matter and when we go to a place with a different rate in time flow, we must pass through that. There are also glowing flowers near the space capsule that are not



found in either the rainforest or the city. That flower emits a special light to illuminate the surrounding environment so the time flow near the space capsule is normal. We can then conclude that the difference in time must be related to the darkness we pass through.”

Song Qinglan waited quietly for him to continue, not wanting to interrupt his thoughts.

Ji Yushi drew a circle on the projection to represent the space capsule and a circle of dark matter was drawn around it. He suddenly revealed a smile, “I think Einstein’s coffin lid might not be able to hold him down.”

He turned around, “Cap Song, the theory of general relativity states that objects of large masses can cause a distortion in time and space. Dark matter is an example of that, but dark matter does not interact with electromagnetic waves and it also does not emit light, so we are unable to use our naked eyes or any instruments to detect it. Of course, that is different from our current situation, but we may be able to borrow such a theory.”

Ji Yushi quickly drew a picture in the air and explained, “Look, the area near the space capsule is very dark and you feel very heavy when you enter it. This is because there are many of such matter contained in there. If this dark circle of unidentified matter really is the culprit affecting the time and space and causing this distortion——”

Using the theory of general relativity to think about this world, Einstein probably really wouldn’t be able to be held down by his coffin lid.

“We have to disperse it.” Song Qinglan understood Ji Yushi’s meaning and didn’t have an issue with such a far-stretched guess, “Just like the places near the space capsule, we should fill the darkness with special light.”

And that light referred to the relatively inconspicuous glowing flowers.

“There are many loopholes,” Ji Yushi said, “but it is worth a try.”

\*

The site to test out was the city just outside the outer hatch of the space capsule. As soon as they stepped out of the hatch, the first thing they were met with was darkness.

Everyone did as they had agreed on earlier and, without waiting for Zhou Mingxuan to wake up, they went out to pick the glowing flowers.

What should've been a journey of solving the mystery behind this mysterious world had turned into picking flowers. Everyone found it a little ridiculous.

But it didn't hurt to give it a try. Very soon, they returned back to the space capsule with the flowers they had collected.

Big Beard had already returned. Seeing that they were going to open the outer hatch again, he was very angry and shouted out a few times.

Ji Yushi had already reached a stage where he could converse with him a little and he was barely able to calm him back down with some simple words. Big Beard decided to stand back and watch.

Li Chun took the initiative to take on the hard work. When Big Beard opened the hatch, he threw out the glowing flowers one after another.

The faint light slowly grew, and it soon illuminated about half a metre of the dark path before them, revealing some of the mirrored city.

Perhaps it was because there was still too little light to illuminate the place completely, the effect wasn't obvious.

Li Chun said, "What should we do? We have already picked all the nearby flowers. Even if we add up the ones on the mountain of garbage, it won't be enough."

Big Beard seemed to understand what they were trying to do. He gestured non-stop to Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi translated, "Big Beard is saying that if we need more, we can plant it."

“Plant?” Song Qinglan who stood in front of the hatch didn’t understand.

“Heavens, how long and how many will we need to plant?!” Li Chun was shocked, “When we’re done, we’ll probably be white bones.”

“Big Beard says that this kind of flower can bloom in a week.” Ji Yushi voiced his own thoughts, “But that is one week near the space capsule. What if we took them to the rainforest?”

The time in the rainforest was almost 24 times faster than the time here.

In other words, they only needed less than a day to be able to harvest more flowers.

“Alright.” Song Qinglan agreed without hesitation, “Chun’er and I will go gather the plants first. We will go together when Old Zhou wakes up.”

Planting flowers in the crevice of time and space — This was something no one would’ve even thought about.

But the people here no longer felt that anything was impossible in this world.

Song Qinglan left while carrying Shen Mian. He didn’t look like someone going to plant flowers and instead looked like he was heading out to fight monsters.

Ji Yushi on the other hand remained and communicated with Big Beard.

He had to figure out why Big Beard and the others came to this place. He intuitively felt that Big Beard still had many clues waiting to be discovered by them.

Big Beard opened a new can of beer, tilted his head back and downed half its contents in one go. There was foam residue on his beard.

This time, they were going to talk about how many people Big Beard had met here and where those people had gone.

“Knock, knock.”

The two paused.

“Knock, knock.”

The knocking still sounded.

They both looked towards the small room. Zhou Mingxuan hadn't woken up yet, so it couldn't be him.

But that knock did come from the space capsule.

Big Beard blinked his blue eyes a few times. Seeing Ji Yushi pull out a silver pistol from under his sofa cushion, he was dumbfounded.

Ji Yushi had already found his Diamond Bird a long time ago.

Nothing Big Beard hid could escape from his eyes.

Ji Yushi made a gesture for him to keep quiet and then very proficiently loaded Diamond Bird up. He clearly came off as a weak person but the moment he picked up the gun, it made it hard for one to look away.

The two slowly moved in the direction of the knocking. It was coming from the outer hatch.

Ji Yushi was on guard while Big Beard opened the hatch.

There was a young man standing outside. He appeared to be about the same age as Ji Yushi.

He wore a black combat uniform with a 12 on his chest. He was slightly taken aback, “Who are you guys?”

Ji Yushi was also taken aback.

At this moment, there were also footsteps behind him. Li Chun hurriedly rushed in, “Advisor Ji! Big trouble!!”

His tone was filled with panic and fear.

Ji Yushi had no choice but to leave that man to Big Beard and quickly returned to the control room.

There, he saw a miniature version of Song Qinglan who looked only about seven or eight years old with a particularly ugly expression.

Ji Yushi had lived for twenty-five years and for the first time, he understood the phrase people would often use to describe his current mood: He felt like his head would explode.

# Chapter 35: Chapter 35

## Chaos

### Chapter 35

Fuck.

Ji Yushi who never swore suddenly had this word which was spoken like a mantra by the other members of the seventh squad appear in his heart.

His mind was a mess, “How did this happen?!”

Li Chun was in complete panic, “I also don’t know! The moment I turned around, Cap Song had turned small!!”

The miniature version of Song Qinglan was still wearing the adult versions black combat uniform so the sleeves, pants and shoes were too big. It looked a little comical. This was especially so when he who looked only seven or eight in age was still carrying his Shen Mian. It gave off a funny feeling of a child carrying a toy gun.

Song Qinglan’s child self was pretty soft and cute. Except for his ugly expression, it was almost impossible for one to associate him with Song Qinglan.

After the accident, Li Chun hurriedly brought him back to the space capsule and he hadn’t spoken a single word the entire way.

Now, he finally couldn’t not speak. He spoke up and explained, “Slipped and fell when collecting the plants and became smaller.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Li Chun: “.....”

“The baby voice is funny?” Song Qinglan said with a cold expression, “If you want to laugh, laugh it all out now. No need to hold back.”

Time had reversed in Song Qinglan’s body, but his child body still contained the soul of an adult. His words, intelligence and personality hadn’t changed at all so when he spoke up just now, it was both funny and strange.

Even Li Chun couldn’t laugh. He maintained a solemn expression.

At this moment, the sound of fighting suddenly came from the corridor. This was followed by incomprehensible curses from Big Beard.

The three of them hurriedly walked over, only to see Big Beard fighting with the young man who had appeared from outside the outer hatch.

Big Beard looked like a bear, and with brute force, he crushed the young man onto the ground. With both hands around the other’s neck, he cursed angrily, “Anfalahagenhe!!”

The young man who was choked until his face was red desperately resisted, “He-help.....”

“Who is this?!” Li Chun was surprised, “Where did he come from?”

Ji Yushi, “Save him!”

Song Qinglan was weak with his small body and could only stand aside.

Ji Yushi worked together with Li Chun and it took them a lot of effort to pull Big Beard away.

Big Beard struggled violently. He looked like he wanted to tear the young man apart.

The young man caught his breath and immediately started coughing violently, “You.....are also from T-Tianqiong?”

With the exception for Big Beard, the people present all wore the black uniforms Tianqiong Guardians wore. The only difference was the '12' on the young man's chest, but this didn't prevent them from figuring out the other person's identity.

"Yes." Ji Yushi answered, "Are you a Guardian from Tianqiong's twelfth squad?"

The young man nodded. He stood up with difficulty and looked at Big Beard, "And who is this person? Why did he want to kill me?"

Song Qinglan originally wanted to say that Big Beard never acted normally but, thinking of his baby voice, he remained silent.

Big Beard was clearly still very agitated and restless. He pointed at the young man while saying something to Ji Yushi.

That young man then saw Song Qinglan, "There's also a child?"

Song Qinglan: "....."

"How did you also end up here?" The young man was surprised by these new faces and asked, "Have you seen my other teammates?"

Li Chun didn't know how to answer and could only say, "Um, that, senior, we are from a different era."

The term senior was a little abrupt.

The young man slowly took in the meaning of those words and then replied, "I am from 1441. How about you?"

The atmosphere stagnated for a moment.

The Tianqiong twelfth squad found in the rainforest was indeed the one which had lost all contact fifteen years ago.

Ji Yushi's cold voice sounded, "We are from 1456."



\*

The young man was called Xie Sian. He was a part of Tianqiong's twelfth squad in 1441 and went to complete an A-level mission with seven other teammates. During the transition, their capsule had encountered a problem and then ended up here, in the process discovering the mountain of garbage and the space capsule. After they rested in the space capsule, they split up and Xie Sian and another teammate entered the city together.

According to him, they had lost their way a day after they entered the city. The teammate with him claimed that he saw human life and separated from him and with the communicator unable to establish connection, he could only find a way out of the mirrored city on his own. After walking around for another day or two, he found glowing flowers piled up on the sidewalk.

This was how Xie Sian found his way back to the space capsule.

For Xie Sian, he was only separated from his teammates for about two days.

Xie Sian was in disbelief. He couldn't accept reality. Even his lips were pale, "So you're saying that 15 years had actually passed?!"

Li Chun nodded, "Yes, we've calculated it. The flow of time in the capsule is 2880 times faster than that city. That is to say, one day in the city is almost equal to about eight years here. That is why the two days you spent in there was actually fifteen years."

Xie Sian's hand holding the can began to tremble.

The news was cruel, but Li Chun had to tell him, "Not only is the rate of time flow different there, there is also another place where the time flow rate is 24 times faster than that of the space capsule. Fifteen years in the space capsule is 360 years there. My teammates saw there.....the remains of several other seniors."

Xie Sian immediately raised his head, "Impossible! How could this be?!"

Song Qinglan sat on the sofa, quietly watching them talk. The expression on his small face was serious. It was the usual look he would have as an adult when he was thinking about something.

He was now also a victim of time. He had nothing to say.

Ji Yushi and Big Beard talked for a while on the side. Through gestures and simple language exchanges, he figured out what was going on and walked over with a piece of paper.

Big Beard had a spokesperson so he wasn't afraid that they wouldn't understand. He very simply plopped his ass down on the sofa.

He was tall and big and weighed about three hundred catties so the moment he sat down onto the sofa, the spring underneath creaked and little Song Qinglan next to him bounced up slightly.

With regard to the matter of Song Qinglan turning smaller, Big Beard showed great interest. With canned food remnants stuck on his beard, he stared at Song Qinglan and wanted to reach out to touch him.

Without even looking at him, Song Qinglan directly picked up Shen Mian and used it to push away the dirty hands trying to pinch his face.

"If you don't believe him, you can look at this." Ji Yushi's slender and tall figure passed before them and stopped in front of Xie Sian, "Do you remember fighting against a red-haired foreigner when you first came here?"

Xie Zian hesitated, "How did you know?"

Ji Yushi handed over a paper with Big Beard's drawing, "It's not that I know. The party involved is right here."

On the paper was a drawing of eight Tianqiong Guardians and every one of them had a 12 written on their chest.

They were all lined up one by one. The one at the front held a gun and seemed to be threatening a very tall person.

“Our capsules were damaged when we arrived here,” Xie Sian looked at the drawing, “and we soon found this space capsule. The engineer in the team wanted to borrow this space capsule to modify and use it to transition again but that red-haired foreigner refused. A few days later, the engineer, the vice-captain and another teammate.....threatened the foreigner but he still refused to hand over the key. In the end, we had no choice but to be a little rough.”

The so-called ‘threaten’ was probably a case of robbery. Xie Sian spoke with much difficulty, “I didn’t participate, but I also didn’t stop them.”

Li Chun opened his mouth wide. He couldn’t imagine what humans would be like when faced with such a situation.

“This was also the reason for you splitting up?” Ji Yushi asked, “Because you couldn’t accept the other’s actions, so you didn’t want to go together?”

“The three of them and the rest of us had a falling out.” Xie Sian acquiesced, “The one in charge of logistics and I went through the outer hatch and the captain and the left and right flanks went in the direction of the mountain of garbage. We agreed to gather up 24 hours later.”

Afterwards, that 24 hours became forever.

Xie Sian asked, “You said the party involved is here?”

Ji Yushi, “That’s right.”

Having said that, Ji Yushi’s tone turned colder, “Your threatening of that person was equivalent to robbery. He had his shoulder blade broken because of you and after your squad parted ways and left, he had lived here alone for fifteen years.”

Li Chun and Song Qinglan both realised that the involved party.....was Big Beard.

Xie Sian immediately raised his head, “I-it was you?”

Big Beard snorted loudly with some scorn, ““Anfalahagenhe.”

Fifteen years. It was enough to turn a tall red-haired foreigner into a scraggly little mound with a beer belly.

There was nothing like the change in a person's appearance to allow one to clearly feel the passage of time. Xie Sian who only felt like two days had passed went through all sorts of emotions in an instant, including guilt, shame, shock and some melancholy.

No wonder Big Beard would use the chain dragging method every time he picked up a human. No wonder he would lock up the seemingly fit traverser and let him starve for several days... This kind of thing may have happened many times already and it was already incredible enough for Big Beard to still continue picking people up and bringing them back in order to try and communicate with them.

Perhaps those with bad intentions were dealt with by Big Beard, or perhaps there were people who had stayed here for a short period of time but couldn't understand his language so they entered another world with a different time flow rate and never returned.

This crevice was like a real transfer station. It sent people from all eras and universes to different places.

Having temporarily solved one problem, Ji Yushi turned around and looked at Song Qinglan who was a few metres away.

This.....was the problem that troubled him the most.

It was also quite hard for Song Qinglan to calm down and sit obediently on the sofa, waiting for them to solve the former problem first.

Ji Yushi felt a headache forming.

What should they do if Cap Song doesn't change back?

"Cap Song, let's go to the place you fell." Ji Yushi walked over to Song Qinglan and bent down to talk to him, "If you really can't change back, you will have to live in the rainforest for ten to twenty years."

Li Chun immediately disagreed with that idea and quickly strode over, “Damn! Advisor Ji, don’t scare me! Wouldn’t that drive him crazy?!”

Song Qinglan’s small face was stiff, “.....”

Ji Yushi blinked a few times, “Just kidding. There must be a problem with time flow at the place where you fell. Chaos, right? Messy and disorderly. As long as we can find a way, any problem can be solved. It wouldn’t be more difficult than fighting zombies and hiding from black walls.”

Li Chun stayed to take care of Zhou Mingxuan and along the way prevent Big Beard from killing Xie Sian.

Ji Yushi on the other hand went with Song Qinglan to the place where he slipped and fell.

“Please, Advisor Ji. Please don’t turn smaller too!” Li Chun cupped his hands together, “Be extra careful!”

Song Qinglan, “Then you come?”

Li Chun immediately turned around, “Let me see if Old Zhou is awake. He really can fucking sleep! He should be better after a day. Brother Wen and the others are also not here yet so I should try calling Tianqiong to ask. What the hell is with this?! I’m filing a complaint!”

\*

Song Qinglan only realised after stepping out of the space capsule, that Advisor Ji just now....was coaxing him?

This feeling was difficult to describe.

After all, he wasn’t a real child.

Ji Yushi was almost 1.8 metres tall, which was very tall for a seven- or eight-year-old child.

It was difficult for the two to keep the same pace. Ji Yushi seemed to have deliberately slowed his pace down to let him catch up and would occasionally discreetly glance over to see how he was doing.

Somehow, Song Qinglan was suddenly able to accept the reality that he had become the weaker one, “Advisor Ji.”

The child’s voice was crisp, but he deliberately spoke maturely.

Compared to Song Qinglan’s usual low and magnetic baritone voice, Ji Yushi wasn’t very used to hearing it like this.

Ji Yushi could still clearly remember the feeling he had when he first heard Song Qinglan’s voice travel through the public channel.

But it just happened to be the same person.

A distant memory came. There once was an even more delicate voice often sounding behind him, passionately and clingingly calling his name.

Ji Yushi wondered if he could be regarded as unintentionally coming to know all the various forms of a certain captain surnamed Song.

Ji Yushi answered, “Mhn?”

Without any hesitation, something soft and warm was stuffed into his palm.

Ji Yushi looked down and saw the little Song Qinglan holding his hand.

It turns out that the warm thing was the child’s hand.

Song Qinglan raised his child-like face, his expression natural and relaxed, “Fuck, these shoes are too big. Can’t walk fast and gets in the way. I’ll need Advisor Ji’s assistance with this.”

Ji Yushi : “.....”

The outer shell had changed but the contents were still the same.

It felt very strange.

Even since Song Qinglan turned smaller, those size 46 short boots had become a burden.

But the frozen soil was cold and there was no other replacement here. He couldn't walk barefoot because he would end up with frostbite within minutes.

Ji Yushi very naturally held the child's hand.

"Let's come to an agreement." He heard Song Qinglan say this, "When we return, can you forget about this part? At least don't tell others."

Ji Yushi wanted to laugh, "I'll try."

Aurora flashed in the sky. The vines by the roadside glowed slightly.

Ji Yushi suddenly stopped in place, let go of the hand and squatted down to look at Song Qinglan.

His clear eyes seemed like it could reflect the Milky Way, "Are the sleeves too long too? Cap Song, I won't laugh at you even if you tell me."

Song Qinglan's cotton-padded jacket was just draped over him and underneath it was the combat uniform which hung past his hands like those Chinese opera singers.

Ji Yushi wasn't very good at taking care of people, but he had seen others take care of children.

Song Qinglan mumbled vaguely, "It's okay. It's not that long."

Ji Yushi lowered his eyes. His eyelashes were long and thick, casting a shadow over his fair skin.

He helped Song Qinglan roll up his sleeves, and then bowed his head and rolled up his trousers.

“You helped me a lot as well when I was injured. You don’t need to feel embarrassed.”

After doing all that, Ji Yushi stood back up. The angle produced from the height difference between the two made him look a little proud.

“Cap Song, I don’t just remember grudges.”



# Chapter 36: Chapter 36

## Chaos

### Chapter 36

Don't just remember grudges. Then it's also remembering the good.

In short, whether it was good or bad, Ji Yushi remembered it all.

“Then thanks for that.” Song Qinglan joked and placed his little hand back into Ji Yushi's palm, “Let's go.”

Ji Yushi's fingers were long and slender, and the temperature of it was slightly cool.

It was just like the feeling he gave others; a little cold and seemingly difficult to warm up.

But once you got to know him, Ji Yushi was like the clear spring water one would find in mountains; clean and easy to see through and in fact very easy to get along with.

The two continued on following the tracks left by the cart from when they went to gather the plants.

This time, Ji Yushi's pace had slowed down even more and, with the abnormal magnetic field and gravity, each step felt heavier and heavier.

Very soon, Ji Yushi could feel the child's hand in his hand becoming sweaty.

He could also tell that Song Qinglan was having difficulty walking — A child's physical strength was very limited compared to an adult and he had

overlooked this point.

He lowered his head and asked, “Cap Song, should I hold you?”

Song Qinglan took another step with difficulty. The big boots dangled from his feet and his small face was flushed from the effort he had to exert, “Is it necessary? I can walk on my own.”

Ji Yushi asked with a strange look, “Then when you returned so quickly just now, did Li Chun carry you?”

Song Qinglan had nothing to say in response to that: “.....”

Ji Yushi bent down to hold him, but Song Qinglan quickly moved away.

He saw Song Qinglan point ahead and for once, he spoke without the usual calm tone of an adult, “If I said I don’t need it, I don’t need it! We’re almost there anyway! Advisor Ji, it’s fine if you just continue supporting me!”

Song Qinglan was right. Very soon, they arrived at the place where they were collecting the plants.

The cart was still there. It was filled with vines with glowing flowers growing from it, waiting to be transported to the rainforest.

There were also some glowing flowers on the ground which hadn’t had the chance to be loaded onto the cart. It was probably because Li Chun was in too much of a hurry earlier.

Apart from that, there was nothing else here.

Ji Yushi asked, “Cap Song, did you slip on this small slope?”

“Yes.” Seeing Ji Yushi walk over, Song Qinglan grabbed his sleeve with a frown, “Don’t go over.”

Knowing that the other party was worried that he might also end up in the same situation, Ji Yushi pointed ahead, “Is there a mirrored world similar to the rainforest and the city there?”

There was a small slope in front of the cart, and further in front of that was a patch of darkness that got darker and darker. The distance it extended was about the same as the distance they had travelled when entering the rainforest.

Song Qinglan wasn't here for the first time but when he checked the situation around the space capsule last time, he didn't find anything here. He didn't know why something like this had happened.

He was in a small body, but his tone was very calm, "No. I didn't see anything after sliding down but I was like this when I got back up."

What was the reason for time to have an effect on Song Qinglan's body?

Even the intelligent Ji Yushi felt that the puzzle was becoming bigger and bigger. In this place where the mission mode is 'Chaos', inside this crevice, everything couldn't be understood using normal means.

"Can I change back?"

Ji Yushi looked back and was met with a young face that showed no fear. There was only some irritation.

Even whilst feeling anxious, Song Qinglan's way of dealing with his emotions was very mature.

Anyone who was in a difficult situation would feel anxious. Recalling the last mission, Song Qinglan had played a very important role. Even if he wasn't as strong as Ji Yushi in the logical thinking aspect nor did he have the ability to remember everything with one glance, his ability to comprehend and his leadership and decisiveness had helped Ji Yushi considerably. They had worked perfectly together to solve the problem at hand.

"Maybe I really will need to live in the rainforest for more than ten years." Song Qinglan said, "I will have to trouble you to wait for me. If you're really bored, you can stay a few hours in the city. We can meet again when it's time."

Time that crawls by in the city.

The normal space capsule.

The rainforest where each day feels like a year.

Ji Yushi's mind quickly grasped the key point. He spoke up, "Cap Song, we seem to be in the wrong direction."

Song Qinglan pulled at the collar of the cotton-padded jacket that continuously slid down, "What direction?"

"No, it should be that I was thinking in the wrong direction." Ji Yushi said, "As for why the time flow rate was normal only near the space capsule and whether our mission had nothing to do with the time flow rate, you had given me a good hint before. I was the one thinking in the wrong direction. It's like the Raven Paradox."

Raven Paradox.

Take the line 'all ravens are black' as an example. If a thousand ravens were observed and it was noted that they were all black, then the confidence in the statement that 'all ravens are black' would increase. As such, the phrase 'all ravens are black' would logically be equivalent to 'birds that are not black are not ravens' and whenever one that is not black is observed, the original statement of 'all ravens are black' would become even more convincing.

There was a big difference between logical thinking and intuitive thinking.

The flowers on the vines in the cart were piled on top of each other. The light from it lit up their faces.

Ji Yushi said, "We thought that since the flow of time was abnormal and there was also a mirrored world after crossing through the darkness around the space capsule, it was all because there was no special light source in the dark. This was where we went astray. In fact, it is very simple. The real problem here are the light sources."

Song Qinglan asked, “These flowers?”

“Yes.” Ji Yushi said, “Rather than a crevice between parallel universes, the place we are in now is probably better referred to as a crevice in time. At the same time, it is also a loophole in time.”

“Time originally runs smoothly and flawlessly. It is just a concept that cannot be touched or manipulated, but one day, humans discovered the laws behind it and after that came traversers. They would travel from point A to point B, leaving behind a trace in this usually flawless operation. The traces left behind took root and bloomed into these small flowers.”

Ji Yushi picked up a glowing flower and carefully examined its transparent petals.

Song Qinglan had a strong hunch that their mission was soon about to be completed.

Ji Yushi said, “Of course, the flowers may just be a form of those traces. As these traces grow more and more, slowly, a crevice in time opened, eventually becoming a loophole that subsequently disrupted its order. These traces in the crevice reacted with the void in time itself, resulting in the appearance of different worlds, or forming chaotic mirrored worlds.”

“So our purpose isn’t to plant these flowers, but to eradicate them.” Song Qinglan understood. His handsome and refined small face showed some contempt, “This system, the missions it releases really only can be taken literally.”

Repairer of Time.

Once the traces are removed and the crevice is closed, the loophole would no longer exist.

Ji Yushi threw away the flower, “When you fell and slid down that small slope just now, the light from the flowers hit you at the right angle with refraction, causing time to flow backwards. This was why only you were affected while Li Chun wasn’t despite the short distance between you two.

However, if I am not wrong, once we fix this loophole and this crevice is gone, time would return to normal, and everything should return to its original state. By then, you should also change back, and we would also return to where we came from, as if we had never appeared here before.”

For example, they would return to their capsules and back to the moment when they were in the middle of transitioning.

This mission was truly very simple.

Song Qinglan raised a brow, “Then could me being like this be considered a blessing in disguise?”

Ji Yushi said, “It is for us, but I don’t know about them.”

Them?

Song Qinglan asked, “Do you mean Big Beard and that Xie Sian?”

Ji Yushi shook his head. His tone was cold, “It should be everyone who has been here.”

\*

Relying on his tall height and long legs, Ji Yushi picked the child up without a word and placed him in the cart which had been cleaned up earlier. As he did this, one of the short boots fell. Ji Yushi picked it up and returned it to Song Qinglan, “Little one, wear your shoe properly.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

The smaller person was very angry.

Ji Yushi suddenly thought of the Song Qinglan from Team 6.

At Golden Crow No.2’s base, that Song Qinglan had appeared with Shen Mian in his hands like a god who had descended from heaven. He stood on the spacecar looking very valiant and with his red magazine glowing, three shots were fired without hesitation at the zombies and giant spiders. Despite

knowing the eventual outcome of him taking such actions, he still led his teammates forward without fear.

Now, he was sitting helplessly in the cart holding his shoe.

Ji Yushi pushed the cart back, “How does it feel to be smaller?”

There was evident stubbornness written on Song Qinglan’s back, “Compared to turning smaller, I feel that I am more willing to fight against zombies. Even those giant spiders are acceptable.”

Ji Yushi, “For children like Cap Song, the teachers must’ve had a lot of trouble.”

“That’s true, I really wasn’t very obedient as a child.” Song Qinglan admitted very quickly. He then looked back at Ji Yushi and wondered, “Is it that obvious?”

How did Advisor Ji know?

As they spoke, there was a loud noise which sounded like it came from right next to them.

Something had been sucked over to the mountain of garbage again.

The two immediately turned around to go to the mountain of garbage. This time they picked up their two long overdue teammates, Tang Qi and Tang Le.

While they were contemplating over how they should bring them back, Li Chun arrived with Zhou Mingxuan in tow, “Cap Song! Advisor Ji!”

Zhou Mingxuan who had just woken up was in pretty good spirits. Seeing Song Qinglan in the cart, his small eyes widened, “R-really turned smaller?!”

Before Song Qinglan could speak, Zhou Mingxuan pinched his face, “Fuck! Actually a little cute!”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

Would it be too late to jump down and give Zhou Mingxuan a kick?

Zhou Mingxuan immediately revealed his mischievous side. Whilst carrying Tang Le in one arm, he took photos with his communicator with the other hand, “Saved! In the case of Cap Song being unable to change back, we will need to start recording Cap Song’s growth!”

Ji Yushi couldn’t bear to remind him that saving it was useless. In any case, it would all be gone.

Tang Le’s head was hanging down. His stomach was pressed onto Zhou Mingxuan’s shoulder, making him want to vomit. When he opened his eyes, he was almost shocked silly, “?”.

Only Tang Qi was unconscious. One could only imagine what his reaction would be if he saw his captain’s current appearance.

This was simply a large-scale execution scene for Song Qinglan. Looking at his expression, it was very likely that he had cursed a hundred times inside.

The six members of the seventh squad had gathered, there was only Duan Wen left.

Seeing there were now so many people gathered in the space capsule, Big Beard immediately gathered the cans up in his arms, leaving none to be touched. This was especially so for Xie Sian, he shouldn’t even dream about getting a single can from Big Beard.

Everyone had their own thoughts after listening to Ji Yushi’s analysis.

Xie Sian asked, “Advisor Ji, according to your analysis, if this crevice is repaired and everyone returns to the moment before we were sucked in, would my teammates also come back?”

This was a question Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi had discussed before. He nodded and said, “In theory, that should be the case.”



Xie Sian was a scout in the twelfth squad.

He was also very keen in this aspect, “Then wouldn’t that produce many paradoxes?”

Li Chun would now get a headache whenever the word paradox was mentioned. He only wanted to hear the result and didn’t want to participate in the discussion process.

Fortunately, Zhou Mingxuan asked for him, “What paradox?”

Xie Sian said, “For example, after ‘A’ was sucked in, the era he was in continued to move forward and everything that happened afterwards had nothing to do with him. With the crevice in time repaired, everything would be restored to its original condition and ‘A’ would return to his original time so everything that happens afterwards would be rewritten. If that were the case, where would everything that has already happened go? This is the paradox.”

Tang Qi and Tang Le had both woken up.

Tang Le leaned against his older brother’s shoulder. Since the twins looked exactly the same, Big Beard continued to look at them in attempt to tell who was who.

Tang Le said, “I know the answer to this. Infinite covering.”

Just like how the seventh quad had extended one point of the circle infinitely to cover the other points in their previous mission.

They were already very familiar with something like this.

Xie Sian came from fifteen years ago. At that time, the knowledge gained from the Tianqiong system and the Time Administration Team was still very limited. It was still a time where all this knowledge was rather new, so he was a little puzzled when he heard Tang Le’s statement.

“Everything related to ‘A’ would be covered over with his return and everything that has happened until now in his era would be rewritten.”

A child's voice sounded.

Everyone turned around and saw Song Qinglan eating from a can of canned fruit.

Big Beard, “???”

But he had hidden them all?

“Here's a simple example. For example, after ‘A’ disappeared and was regarded as missing, his family received some monetary compensation which in turn helped them with treating a serious illness, but because of his return, his family loses such an opportunity and their fate was rewritten, resulting in the seriously ill family member to pass away.” Song Qinglan may be small but he was strong. As he said this, he opened another can of spam and handed it to Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Song Qinglan sat on the sofa with one leg bent and the other leg hanging in the air because it couldn't reach the floor. He continued, “There is also another possibility. Because of their return, a new timeline is created while the old one continues as per usual. These two timelines would run parallel to each other.

Parallel worlds.

Xie Sian immediately understood.

In that case, would it really be considered as returning to their own world?

He was lost in thought.

Ji Yushi lowered his head and looked down at the can. He gave it back to Song Qinglan, “Cap Song, I heard that children will grow taller if they eat more meat.”

Song Qinglan, “I've almost eaten my fill now.”

Big Beard watched the two push the can back and forth, “Suowulalawu.”

Everyone thought Big Beard was cursing again and was unhappy that they were eating his canned food but unexpectedly, Big Beard instead took out another can and gave it to Ji Yushi while saying a few more things. He turned out to be getting them to have one each.

Song Qinglan was curious. He supported his chin and asked leisurely, “Advisor Ji, what is he saying?”

“Actually, I also didn’t understand. It’s probably an endangered language.”

Ji Yushi placed down the can of spam meat and showed no intentions to eat. He changed the topic again and said, “We didn’t have much time and his language is also very complicated so there are still a lot of words I am not familiar with. I’m just wondering how I should explain to Big Beard what he will face next.”

Ji Yushi was already very amazing.

Li Chun and Big Beard had been together for the longest time, but he only understood one line: Anfalahagenhe.

It was equivalent to short insulting words like bastard, motherfucker and dogshit.

Ji Yushi said, “Their PU-18 was destroyed before PU-31. Ten years ago, their team had launched the space capsule in attempt to go to a new colony. If everything were to be restored, they would return to that time and it is still unknown whether their original destination still exists.”

Ji Yushi sat on the carpet in front of the sofa. He was clearly talking about another person’s matter, but the tips of his ears hidden under his black hair were red.

The little Song Qinglan sitting behind him was at a low angle so he just happened to spot it. He subconsciously reached out and touched it with his finger.

Hot.

Ji Yushi turned back, “?”

Perhaps it was because he was currently in a child’s body, Ji Yushi at this moment couldn’t decipher Song Qinglan’s expression.

At this moment, he heard Xie Sian say, “Maybe it doesn’t matter where you are going. What matters most is that there is a chance to see your teammates again.”

Seeing that everyone was looking at him, Xie Sian spoke with more confidence, “Whether it is good or bad, at least they were given a chance to live.”

Time was the only proof that everything existed.

If one could have that time again, they could again exist in this world.

“Boom——”

There was a loud noise.

White light flashed outside the small window and the space capsule shook slightly.

When the shaking eased off, Song Qinglan raised the corners of his lips. His tender voice also carried the tone he would usually have when he was an adult, “Hearing that commotion, it sounds very much like Old Duan. Everyone should eat and rest well. The mission has now officially changed from planting flowers to weeding. Soon, we will start working on this special mission assigned by Tianqiong.”

# Chapter 37: Chapter 37

Duan Wen landed in this crevice last.

While waiting for him to wake up and regain his strength, everyone agreed that they would split up and work on removing the traces left around the space capsule — Those glowing flowers.

It took Ji Yushi a while to explain this matter to Big Beard, but he was still not sure if the other party understood.

Big Beard had been here for a longer time than they initially thought, it was about seventy years — But to Big Beard himself, he felt like he had actually only stayed here for a little more than a dozen years. Ji Yushi learned from him that he was actually the first person to enter the city. Everything Xie Sian had experienced had similarly happened to him; Big Beard had lost his way in the city and it took him six or seven days to get out. Upon returning to the space capsule, the last teammate had died of old age.

After hearing Ji Yushi's explanation which consisted of a combination of words and drawings, Big Beard who realised that he would likely have the opportunity to live a life where he had never set foot in this place was excited. He immediately hugged Ji Yushi in a suffocatingly tight embrace and said a bunch of things no one understood.

Big Beard's body smelt very strongly following long periods of non-bathing. Ji Yushi who especially liked to be clean was held so tightly by this bear-like Big Beard that he couldn't breathe, but he didn't push him away.

When Big Beard let go of Ji Yushi, Ji Yushi saw Song Qinglan's small figure standing on the side.

Song Qinglan's small body had his arms habitually crossed in front of his chest as he watched them

There was a smile in the pair of bright eyes that belonged to a child, "Advisor Ji, what do you think will come to your mind when you think of Big Beard in the future?"

The iron chain used when picking him up, the fight in the small room, or this rough hug?

Ji Yushi also hooked up the corners of his lips, "I'm afraid I will think of the smell first."

Big Beard, "Murihan!"

Ji Yushi replied, "Tala."

Was this the polite expression of thanks and you're welcome?

Song Qinglan couldn't understand it anyway.

Big Beard rubbed the top of Ji Yushi's head with his plump hands, messing up his hair in the process, and then happily walked away. He seemed to be looking for tools in preparation for the weeding.

The other teammates were not in the control room at this time, with the exception for Xie Sian.

Xie Sian was a senior, but he was too young and almost the same age as them. Although they were about the same age, the differences in era, thinking, as well as the warm seventh squad atmosphere made it difficult for him who had split from his squad due to differences in opinions to integrate.

"Speaking of which, Advisor Ji, you remind me of an acquaintance."

Big Beard no longer cared about managing the cans so Xie Sian finally got the chance to eat. As he ate, he said, "You two are very similar."

Ji Yushi turned his head over. His face was clean and handsome, and his features defined.

“It’s not that you two look alike, but you both have high intelligence and strong logical thinking abilities.” Xie Sian said, “That professor was called Sheng Yun. He was involved with the development of the Tianqiong system at a young age and his future was limitless. While I was preparing to become a Guardian, I had the honour of taking his class for a semester. He was a very knowledgeable and humble person.”

Song Qinglan asked, “I haven’t heard of this. Where does the professor work?”

“He’s not working anywhere.” Xie Sian shook his head, “Because.....he committed suicide. That’s why it’s normal for you not to hear about it. For you guys, that was seventeen years ago. I heard that he has made outstanding contributions to the development of Tianqiong. It had to be said that it was a really big loss for us.”

Ji Yushi didn’t speak.

Xie Sian said, “Professor Sheng also had a son who was very young at the time. He should be about the same age as you two now. It was said that he was also very smart. Unfortunately, he was the first person to witness the scene of his father’s suicide and seemed to have received some psychological shock from that. I don’t know how he’s doing now.”

Ji Yushi said, “Is that so? That’s really a shame.”

Ji Yushi didn’t seem to be very interested in this matter. He was originally not someone with very strong curiosity nor did he like to listen to gossip.

But somehow, Song Qinglan noticed that there was something different compared to his usually calm and indifferent expression.

It gave Song Qinglan a feeling that Ji Yushi must’ve heard of this matter before. But why was he pretending not to know?

“I don’t know what will happen after I go back. I hope everything will be back to normal.” Xie Sian finished the can and gained some strength, “Do you still have a Tianqiong twelfth squad? How’s their ranking?”

Song Qinglan said, “Yes, their ranking is not bad.”

Xie Sian seemed to be satisfied with his successors, “Then which squad is the strongest one now?”

“Before, it was the third squad.” Song Qinglan said, “If luck is on our side, perhaps the strongest one in the future will be the seventh squad.”

Xie Sian laughed, “Luck?”

Song Qinglan looked up at Ji Yushi. His small face was serious, “It mainly depends on whether the one at Advisor Ji’s place is willing to let him go.”

Ji Yushi was confused, “?”

Song Qinglan said, “Didn’t you tell me last time that he is very clingy?”

“It’s them.” Ji Yushi now understood and said after some thought, “That is indeed a very important question.”

If he really decided to leave, he would have to move those little masters to a new environment.

“Them?”

There was more than one?

Advisor Ji’s attitude to relationships was this messy?

Song Qinglan: “.....”

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The Tianqiong seventh squad was all present and Duan Wen very loyally didn’t laugh at his captain who had suddenly become smaller. They



distributed the tools Big Beard had gathered and, with Xie Sian and Big Beard in tow, they divided themselves up into three groups.

Aurora gleamed in the sky that was so close it looked like it was within reach.

Before they could reach the mountain of garbage, Ji Yushi, Song Qinglan and Duan Wen once again saw the phantom of a silver-white planet in the sky.

It slowly made its appearance and was incredibly large. The craters on the surface of it were illuminated by the light from the flowers. With it slowly rising up before them, it made everything here look like it was from a dream.

Duan Wen who was in his thirties couldn't help but sigh, "It's so fucking romantic."

Song Qinglan held a small shovel in his small hands, "Why? You want to date now?"

Duan Wen looked down at Song Qinglan and sighed, "Cap Song, I feel that it's inappropriate talking to you right now about adult topics."

Song Qinglan, "....."

Duan Wen added, "Everyone who sees this would want to date. Just think about it. Bringing a girl here to see the aurora and the moon. Even if there are no sparks originally, sparks would form. Don't you think so, Advisor Ji?"

It was Ji Yushi's second time seeing this beautiful scene.

He had once said that it didn't make any difference whether he saw the same thing once or countless times, but he still raised his head and seriously took in the scene.

A huge silver-white star.

Blue and green rippling aurora.

Transparent glowing flowers on the ground.

In the real world, such a scene couldn't be found anywhere.

"I don't know." Ji Yushi answered with his head still raised, "I don't like girls."

When that star was completely gone, they had reached their destination. All the vines here had to be eradicated.

The soil was very hard due to the low temperature. With each drop of the shovel, the palms of the hand would be rendered numb from the shock. Fortunately, the roots of the vines didn't grow too deeply, and they could pull the vines off with enough effort.

Very soon, everyone was sweating.

Since Duan Wen had the best relationship with Li Chun, he was naturally not the type who didn't talk much. As he spoke, white fog was exhaled, "By the way, Advisor Ji, someone like you.....whose that is different, what type do you like?"

As a straight guy, he had always been curious about this.

Do all gays like Song Qinglan's type?

Ji Yushi's thin and pale fingers pulled out a vine from the soil and threw it onto the ground. These vines would later be gathered and destroyed together. He said, "Various types."

Song Qinglan was squatting on the ground and his small body seemed to be in a very difficult position. He was competing with a rather big vine.

Hearing this answer, Song Qinglan didn't pay attention and fell onto his butt as soon as the vine broke off, "....."

Fuck.

So free and easygoing. Was he the one who was too conservative?

Duan Wen's desire to gossip persisted, "Various? Advisor Ji, you're being too vague. Take Chun'er for an example. Chun'er likes big breasts."

Alright.

That is true slag.

Ji Yushi didn't voice this thought of his and just replied, "It's not that it's vague. It's because when you meet the right person, it's the right person. There's nothing specific."

Song Qinglan muttered a few things inside. He suddenly felt lighter. Ji Yushi had helped him up, "I'll do it."

Song Qinglan was still carrying Shen Mian. He didn't let his weapon leave his body. It seemed to be his last show of stubbornness.

He said deeply, "I can do it."

Ji Yushi said, "Yes, I know you can."

After saying this, Ji Yushi grabbed the vine and pulled it out of the soil. Very quickly, it was all pulled out.

Song Qinglan on the other hand didn't voice any objections. He just watched Ji Yushi do it with a solemn expression.

Duan Wen thought: He was only away for those few days but the relationship between these two seemed to have gotten better?

As the small pieces of vines were removed and piled up, the lights on the ground disappeared and the darkness grew. The ground was shrouded in darkness at a rate that was almost visible to the naked eye.

At this moment, all three of their communicator's made a sound, indicating that reconnection was successful.

The subcutaneous communicator started to work and all three heard intermittent noises. The communicators had probably reconnected after some of the lights were removed on both sides.

“Cap Song!”

“[email protected]#\$%”

The first voice was Tang Le and the second was hard to tell, as if an audio segment was played too fast.

Tang Qi, Tang Le and Xie Sian were in one group.

Tang Le: “Cap Song!! My brother has been accelerated!”

Tang Qi: “!#\$%.....&”

Tang Le: “After eradicating some of the vines, the light refracted on him and he’s now moving faster than us. His movements are so quick, it’s unclear and we also can’t understand what he’s saying so he’s at least five times faster! You must be careful!”

It has begun.

Song Qinglan very quickly understood, “The more we eradicate them, the more chaotic time will become. We should hurry!”

Except for his body turning smaller, everyone at this moment still subconsciously regarded him as the Song Qinglan who could shoulder their difficulties. Under his command, everyone quickly dealt with the vines in the area and Duan Wen poured fuel gathered from the space capsule over them. Fire instantly enveloped these vines and they soon turned into ashes.

Everyone had agreed to gather at the mountain of garbage — That was the area hardest hit by those vines and there were also too many wreckages so a part of it must be cleaned first before the vines could be completely removed.

No one knew what would happen with time becoming more and more chaotic. The three of them rushed over and Song Qinglan didn't even say a word despite his feet getting hurt due to his shoes.

“Bang——-”

A sound of gunfire echoed across the empty field.

All three were startled. Who was shooting?

But they had already reached the mountain of garbage. With glowing lights everywhere, their communicators once again lost connection.

Big Beard, Zhou Mingxuan and Li Chun had already cleaned up a part of the mountain of garbage. They saw them coming this way, “Cap Song, did you guys hear the gunshot?”

Song Qinglan, “I heard it. Since it's not you guys, it must be Tang Le and the others.”

Zhou Mingxuan suddenly shouted, “Look!”

A strange scene appeared.

Everyone looked up and saw that the dark sky and aurora above their heads were gone. Replacing it was a vast blue sea.

The sea extended endlessly as it hung upside down in the sky. The water as clear.

It was so close that everyone could see the ripples on the surface as the sea breeze passed by.

Suddenly, a beluga whale emerged from the sea. It stayed on the surface for a short while and then dove back down.

When it did this, water splashed, and cold water rained onto everyone's faces.

This scene was too shocking and much more spectacular than the silver star from before.

Everyone was at loss for words. They found themselves unable to express their feelings at this moment in time.

“There was a new refraction in time and space.” Ji Yushi said, “It must be related to us destroying those lights.”

“Then should we continue?” Li Chun asked, “Would it refract and refract and then end up causing some of us to disappear?”

One should know that this kind of refraction wasn’t just a visual refraction. It also included the involvement of time and space.

In other words, the area they are in right now had not only undergone a visual change, but there was also a change in the flow of time. It was just that they were amidst it all, so they didn’t sense it themselves.

Everyone unanimously looked at Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan’s small face was firm. He uttered a command with a frown, “Continue.”

With this order, no one paid attention to the gunfire.

They knew that, just like their last [Ouroboros] mission, as long as they completed it, everything would return to normal — These two missions were surprisingly similar. Once fired, an arrow does not turn back. They must continue advancing forward.

Ji Yushi raised his head and said something to Big Beard.

Big Beard knocked against his left chest with one hand, let out a loud shout and then overturned a large piece of wreckage in front of everyone.

Although he was injured, he couldn’t care less about it at this time. Enduring the pain, he was as powerful as an ox and was practically a walking excavator.

Everyone started working. The six of them very quickly managed to collect one-fifth of the vines there and destroyed them.

“Bang, bang, bang!!”

A few consecutive gunshots fired. Zhou Mingxuan’s reactions were fast, and he quickly pulled Ji Yushi aside.

Bullets flew through the air.

One, two, three, four. A total of four of them appeared at a very slow speed and then it slowly passed through a mechanical board ahead, emitting sparks and then falling to the ground.

Everyone immediately realised that the time flow in their area had slowed down!

They looked back.

They saw seven or eight unfamiliar faces in the darkness outside the area with the sea. They were wearing clothes from an unknown era. They were clearly traversers from another time.

Having cleared an area of lights, those refracted spaces had disappeared, and these people must have been released from those places. But why were they shooting at strangers?

“Bang!”

Another bullet penetrated this area.

It started at a normal speed and, when it entered the area where time was several times slower, it slowed down significantly. It was destined to never hit the target.

Zhou Mingxuan raised his laser gun and similarly fired a shot. Unfortunately, the opponent was able to easily recognise its trajectory and avoided without any difficulty.

Alright. It was a situation where no one could hit anyone.

That group of people charged into the area.

Li Chun, “Dammit, are these people intending on killing us?”

At this moment, a new pile of vines was burned to ashes.

In an instant, the sea overhead was gone. Replacing it were snow capped mountains that suddenly rose from the sides.

The mountain peaks were sharp and angular and when the tallest peak appeared, it just happened to knock into the group of people rushing in, throwing them into an unknown direction.

Hearing those screams, the people standing amidst the mountains, “.....”

Could this be referred to as self-inflicted harm?

Song Qinglan found a fish who had slipped through the net. That person who had just managed to charge in was lying on the ground, covered in blood.

He walked over, raised Shen Mian with his thin arms, and pressed it against the other party’s forehead, “What did you want?”

The other party was severely injured. Before he breathed his last breath, he said in heavily accented English, “Escape capsule.....”

He couldn’t finish his words. He had died with his eyes open.

Escape capsule?

The snow was cold and wind howled around them. Snow gathered on everyone’s shoulders from time to time.

This person’s words were spoken without context. They didn’t have the time to think about it so they could only get back to clearing out the vines.



Facing a huge satellite part, everyone was troubled. It laid on top of a pile of other mechanical wreckage and it was hard to tell if there were any flowers underneath it. But who could move this giant thing?

Song Qinglan had already taken off the cotton-padded clothes he had wrapped around him. His small figure stood in front of the satellite, “I can crawl into the gap.”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Cap Song!”

Everyone looked at him. They felt like they were abusing a child.

Song Qinglan removed his short boots, revealing his worn feet. He didn’t show any concern about it, “Stop talking nonsense. Who will go if I don’t go?”

After saying that, he threw aside a broken off hatch and crawled into a gap.

Even if they were worried, everyone could only continue working hard.

Ji Yushi’s palm was bleeding from a cut he had incurred while moving a wreckage aside. From time to time, he would raise his head and look over at the place Song Qinglan entered.

He had also taken off his cotton-padded clothes and he wiped away a thin layer of sweat. When he looked up for the third time, he finally saw Song Qinglan’s figure emerge.

There were a lot of vines wrapped around him and his small face was black, like he had just dug up coal. Only a pair of eyes showed spirit belonging to an adult.

Duan Wen was a step ahead of Ji Yushi. He pulled the small captain out.

Song Qinglan let him clean him up, “Hope there are no more gaps to crawl.....Hey, stop. Lightly. I’m still a fucking child!!”

Duan Wen repeatedly promised, “I know, I know.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Big Beard picked up all the newly pulled out vines. The glowing flowers made him look like a giant Christmas tree.

He set the new pile on fire.

The surroundings instantly went dark. In the dimness, someone asked, “There’s only one last group left. Why hasn’t Tang Le and the others come yet?”

Just as that person finished asking that, a dozen or so skeletons appeared not far from the mountain of garbage where there was still a small ring of lights remaining.

No, to be more precise, it was a dozen or so human skeletons heading their way.

The flesh on their bodies were restoring rapidly. From organs to muscles to skin, hair and eyes, they gradually returned to their original living appearance.....They were humans being resurrected.

Among them, three were young men wearing black combat uniforms with a 12 on their chest. It was their seniors from the twelfth squad.

Ji Yushi understood. The rainforest had disappeared. These people came from that rainforest.

The vines Big Beard set on fire turned to ashes.

The snow-capped mountains on the side suddenly disappeared. What appeared now was a city.

Left, right, front and back. Except for the soil and garbage under their feet, this place had become a 360-degree mirror projection.

For a moment, everyone felt like they had entered a kaleidoscope.

“Rumble——”

After the rumble of thunder, lighting flashed, and heavy rain poured down.

Everyone was soaked.

Big Beard suddenly yelled, “Mogulakandaqiongwiqimuhe!!”

Among those people, some of Big Beard’s teammates had returned.

The people from PU-18 held each other and cried.

The three seniors from the twelfth squad came over. The leading one asked, “You’re from Tianqiong?”

The other asked, “Why is there also a child?”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

The thunder rumbled.

“Yes.”

Ji Yushi’s whole body was soaked. His black hair was brushed back, revealing his smooth forehead.

He didn’t explain much and just said, “We are here to save you.”

Having met in another world and having died after spending who knows how long in the rainforest, the people who had just come back to life had a hard time trusting anyone.

Everyone increased their vigilance. The people who had shot at them just now were a good example. But they also came from Tianqiong so they didn’t want to end up in a fight.

Ji Yushi remembered something and took out a compass he had picked up in the rainforest, “I picked this up from one of you. Now returning it to the owner.”

The leading person received it and then handed it to his teammate. The teammate confirmed, “Cap Qi, this is Xie Sian’s!”

Rain slid down Cap Qi’s jawline. His eyes were cold, “That traitor.....where is he?”

At this moment, amidst the thunder, someone was yelling, “Cap Song!!”

Everyone turned their heads.

They saw Tang Le coming over with Xie Sian bound up, and the bloody person on his back was the unconscious Tang Qi.

Coming with them were also twenty or thirty unfamiliar faces. All of them were traversers who had been released from the different refracted worlds. They were dressed in different clothes and all looked very different.

Xie Sian’s face was pale. There was blood on his forehead.

Seeing his teammates alive again, Xie Sian looked like a ghost in the heavy rain.

This crevice had inadvertently become a gathering point for the traversers.

Tang Le brought Xie Sian in front of everyone and kicked him to the ground, “This grandson tried to stab us in the back. He never had the intention to repair this crevice in the first place!”

Li Chun and Zhou Mingxuan took Tang Qi off his back.

Ji Yushi bent down and examined him. Tang Qi was still affected by the acceleration. It was so fast, even the twitching of his eyelids and the rise and falls of his chest couldn’t be seen clearly.

Xie Sian who was lying on the ground laughed.

That laugh was strange and a little crazed. As soon as he got up, something cold and hard was pressed against his forehead.

His captain, Cap Qi, was looking down at him from above.

Xie Sian wasn't afraid, "Did you think that you would succeed after eradicating this last group of flowers? Let me tell you, you will not succeed. I have carefully hidden the last one away. If you want to know where it is, let that Big Beard use his escape capsule to exchange for it."

Escape capsule?

Song Qinglan narrowed his eyes. He seemed to understand where those people earlier who shot at them came from.

This Xi Sian.....cannot be underestimated.

Ji Yushi stood up. He asked coldly, "What escape capsule?"

"Advisor Ji, you are very clever and can communicate with Big Beard without any trouble." Xie Sian said, "Why? Did that good friend of yours not tell you that there is an escape capsule in good working condition in that space capsule?"

## Chapter 38: Chapter 38

Big Beard's space capsule was very large, and they also weren't here for a very long time so not every room had been entered. As a result, they were unaware that there was also an escape capsule in there.

Seeing that something was happening on this end, Big Beard walked over with his teammates. This team from PU-18 was also very young. While Big Beard talked to them, they looked curiously at the man kneeling in the middle. He seemed to be explaining to them what happened to him during this time.

Ji Yushi looked at Big Beard and asked him something.

Big Beard was slightly surprised for a moment and then he nodded and said something back.

Ji Yushi told his teammates, "There is indeed an escape capsule in there which was left by another team previously. It can be used after restoration."

Li Chun was confused. He couldn't help but ask Xie Sian, "But as long as the crevice is closed, everyone will return to their original places. What do you need the escape capsule for?"

Xie Sian knelt on the ground staring at the people in front of him. He didn't answer.

Cap Qi said, "Because he doesn't want to return."

The Tianqiong twelfth squad was sucked into the crevice during their mission and were trapped here, unable to find a way out. While they were trapped, they discovered Big Beard who had been living alone in the space

capsule and with the help of Big Beard, they managed to gather all the parts that were still usable to successfully repair one of their capsules.

There were however many of them and only one capsule, so everyone negotiated and decided to wait until there were enough capsules gathered before preparing to return.

However, this wait lasted several months.

This barren land with no distinction in day and night as well as the limited supplies very quickly made them unable to stay here any longer. As a result, they decided to find a new way out.

One day, several teammates joined together to rob Big Beard — Somehow, they had mistakenly thought that Big Beard would sneak off alone with the capsule and it resulted in a fierce dispute. It was only when Cap Qi and the two other teammates arrived, that they realised that it was because Xie Sian had ‘misunderstood’ Big Beard due to the language barrier.

In such a desperate setting, it was hard for one to differentiate between good and evil. Cap Qi decided to believe him.

This time, in order to avoid a similar situation from happening again, Cap Qi and several of the teammates brought Xie Sian along when they went to scout out the area. Together, they entered the rainforest and were in there for an unknown period of time. After taking a break and eating by a creek, they started to develop symptoms of food poisoning. Only Xie Sian was fine.

It was him who had added poisonous mushroom juice into his teammates food and killed them.

As for what happened to Xie Sian after he left the rainforest, everyone could basically guess it.

Rain poured heavily.

Thunder boomed.

Big Beard stood on the side and muttered a few words. Ji Yushi interpreted at the same time, “Big Beard was hurt during that, but he didn’t hand over the key to the capsule so Xie Sian and the others could only find another way out of this place. As for whether those people got lost or died in a situation similar to Cap Qi’s group, only Xie Sian knows.”

Having said that, Ji Yushi paused, “Big Beard didn’t tell us about the existence of that capsule because he was worried that history would repeat itself and Xie Sian didn’t expect that fifteen years had passed after leaving the city.”

“So he lied to us from the beginning.” Li Chun was miffed, “When we came out of the rainforest, he had clarified the relationship between himself and Big Beard. It was because he wanted to return with a clear conscience.”

Xie Sian’s plans had fallen through.

He didn’t expect that this group of people with Tianqiong’s mission would quickly discover that this was a crevice in time and would treat this predicament as a mystery to be solved. When he learned from Ji Yushi about how they could get out of this place, his surprised expression and passionate emotions concealed the panic inside him.

He must’ve been scared. If all his teammates could really be resurrected and they could really return to how it was before they were sucked in, then it was a dead end for him.

Zhou Mingxuan cursed and then said, “This is what you call you reap what you sow.”

Rain rolled down along Song Qinglan’s small face. His eyelashes were wet, and his dark eyes were bright, “So you deliberately telling those people who had just resurrected that we’re stealing the escape capsule, was it so that you could benefit afterwards or your attempt to stall for time?”

Song Qinglan didn’t wait for an answer and he also didn’t need Xie Sian to answer. He continued, “You want that capsule now because you want to



escape to another time before the crevice is closed but are you not afraid that Inspectors will find you sooner or later after we return?"

Having hit the mark, Xie Sian felt ashamed. He however still gritted his teeth and said, "Escaping to the ends of the world is better than going back to die. Besides, even if I regret it now.....Isn't it too late?"

If he knew that the situation would end up like this, he would've been able to curb those malicious thoughts of his. Unfortunately, it was too late.

Everyone had a chance to redo it all, everyone except for him.

Song Qinglan said, "It's too late."

Xie Sian, "Then exchange for it with the capsule. As soon as I enter the capsule, I will tell you the location of the flower. Otherwise, don't even think about returning."

Please read this from kk translates

Everyone was in an uproar.

There was only a small circle of light left on the mountain of garbage and they were soon about to succeed.

Could it be that they really had to let Xie Sian leave first?

Cap Qi's muzzle hadn't moved. Under the rain, the knuckles of the finger on the trigger had turned white, "Give it to him."

Everyone: "???"

Tang Le refused, "No!"

Tang Qi had been attacked by Xie Sian. If it hadn't been for the accelerated Tang Qi pushing Tang Le away in time, Tang Le would've also been hurt.

Except for Song Qinglan, no one else noticed the frowning Ji Yushi who was deep in thought.

Frame by frame, Ji Yushi's mind played out all the scenes with Xie Sian. His memory was flawless. As long as it was something he had seen, heard or felt, even the slightest of detail wouldn't escape him.

Where would Xie Sian hide the flower?"

Xie Sian entered the space capsule and fought with Big Beard.

Xie Sian sat on the ground and talked to them.

Xie Sian held a can of food and talked to them while sitting on the sofa.....

"Kemeng Beans....." The moment Ji Yushi said those words, Xie Sian's expression changed.

Li Chun was surprised, "Fuck, did he hide the flower in a Kemeng Bean can?!"

In the space capsule, everyone unanimously expressed dislike of those Kemeng Beans. Even if they had to eat the vegetarian canned foods that tasted worse than it, they refused to touch those beans.

The cans of Kemeng Beans were pretty much a garbage-like existence.

Ji Yushi looked at Xie Sian, "No, not the cans of Kemeng Beans."

Xie Sian also looked back at Ji Yushi. His expression was cold, and he didn't speak a word.

What Ji Yushi could guess, Xie Sian could also guess.

This was a confrontation between scouts.

Ji Yushi's words were calm, but it gave people chills, "Cap Qi, you can shoot."

Everyone was shocked by Ji Yushi's words.

Only the seventh team weren't shocked. Their Advisor Ji would always be able to bypass the fog and reach the truth.

Cap Qi was a little hesitant.

Ji Yushi said with affirmation, "The flower is inside Xie Sian."

Zhou Mingxuan immediately stepped forward and ripped away Xie Sian's black combat uniform.

This young body wasn't weak, but it was sickly pale. There was a fresh wound stretching about ten centimetres across the lower abdomen and inside that hid a small plant. Xie Sian had used his body to nourish this plant. To do something like this to himself, it was clear that Xie Sian's determination to escape this place had reached the point of paranoia.

Xie Sian slumped onto the ground, his face ashen, "You....how did you know?"

"You told me." Ji Yushi said, "When you returned to the space capsule, you were choked by Big Beard and as soon as you caught your breath after he released you, you patted your body off first —You dislike his smell. When you sat on the floor to talk to us for the first time, you sat away from Big Beard's carpet because you also didn't like the smell of it. After Cap Song and I left halfway and later returned, you had already taken a shower and whenever Big Beard passed by, you would hold your breath. What was strange was that, although you clearly showed an expression of approval when I replied that Big Beard's smell would be the first thing that I will remember later, you sat on his sofa without a concern and even used his blanket to cover yourself."

Xie Sian, "....."

Was Ji Yushi's memory too good, or was he smarter than he thought?

Ji Yushi continued, "Most importantly, despite not eating for two days in the city, you only ate the can of vegetarian food that I gave you and when Big

Beard allowed you to eat the can of spam meat, you didn't finish it and only ate one third."

Xie Sian sneered. He had admitted defeat, "Don't you think I could be the same as you and just hated the taste of spam?"

Song Qinglan on the side: "....."

Advisor Ji hates spam?

Ji Yushi shook his head, "It's because you had already put the plant inside you at the time and was too weak to stand, let alone eat anything due to the pain, isn't that right?"

Xie Sian stopped talking.

Amidst the silence, Cap Qi calmly spoke up, "Xie Sian, I, as the witness and guardian of time, will give you your sentence."

There were about fifty or sixty traversers present.

Everyone came from different worlds and different times. Those who shared the same language and those who had a different language, they each translated the current situation for each other.

As the witnesses of time who abide by their responsibilities, they looked at Xie Sian with contempt.

"Bang——"

With the sound of gunfire, Xie Sian fell to the ground.

A bloody hole appeared on his forehead and his eyes were wide open and lifeless.

Everyone here knew that Xie Sian would be resurrected and returned to the capsule after the crevice was repaired and he would then be arrested by his teammates and brought back to Tianqiong where he would be sentenced to death again.

This wasn't Xie Sian's final ending.

The heavy rain suddenly stopped.

All the traversers worked together, and they managed to quickly collect the last batch of flowers. These were burned together with the one taken out of Xie Sian.

The kaleidoscope-like reflection of the city was gone.

"Everyone, look!" Someone shouted.

Everyone raised their heads. The gorgeous aurora in the sky had also disappeared along with the city.

Was this the end of the time rift?

Before the light from the last flower was extinguished, numerous loud sounds suddenly came from the sky.

Immediately afterwards, a huge ship belonging to the Middle Ages emerged from the ground, the mast piercing through the bodies of several traversers in the process. It followed a non-existent wave and charged towards the others at an unimaginable speed!!

"Run!!"

With this shouted in various languages, the traversers followed their survival instincts, and all turned to run.

Ji Yushi subconsciously held little Cap Song's hand. That ship however suddenly disappeared as quickly as it appeared.

Precipices appeared. A desert grassland took their place. Planets, polar regions, volcanic hells; it was unpredictable.

In just a few short seconds, hundreds of years of several worlds overlapped.

Please read this from kk translates

The world was chaotic. Time and space were intertwined. There was no way out.

No one ran anymore.

All the traversers stood in place. Standing in the centre of the vortex of time and space, for the first time they realised how small they really were.

Ji Yushi saw the tallest one in the group with a red beard who had returned to his thin and clean youthful appearance wave at him.

He saw Tang Qi slowly open his eyes and his wound heal at a speed visible to the naked eye.

He also saw that mountain of garbage disappear completely, and even more traversers appear.

The light grew smaller.

“Poof.”

The last vine burned into ashes.

Before they fell into complete darkness, Ji Yushi could feel the small hand he held grow at a rapid speed. It very quickly transformed into a large and well-defined hand that contained a lot of power. The joints were slightly rough and there were calluses left from training long term with a gun.

That hand didn't let go, and instead wrapped around his hand.

There was warm heat next to Ji Yushi.

That person seemed to be half a head taller than him.

They were very close.

In the darkness, the adult man's voice was low and pleasant to hear, “Advisor Ji.....”

This sentence was not finished.

A long time later, Ji Yushi continued to wonder what Song Qinglan had wanted to say to him.

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When Ji Yushi regained conscious, he had already returned to the capsule.

【Warning! Warning! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! You have deviated from the destination coordinates!】

The warning light in the capsule flashed nonstop as the warning was made.

As the capsule shook with great force, Ji Yushi saw countless pictures flash across quickly on the transparent panel in front of him. Sharp alarm sounded.

For a while, he thought he had become deaf.

Again.....it was going to start again?

After a short period of silence, the warning light stopped flashing and the capsule stabilised. Another announcement was made.

【Illegal transition detected! Successfully intercepted.】

【Current mission is terminated. You are now set to return.】

Ji Yushi's pupils enlarged slightly. He somehow couldn't believe those words.

Successfully intercepted?

Which Tianqiong had intercepted them?

Did the third command centre finally notice the anomaly and quickly terminated their mission before they could be hijacked, allowing them to finally return?

Ouroboros. Chaos.

The sources of those endless nightmares that made them feel like they were trapped in a bog, was all over?

Very quickly, the capsule turned quiet.

A system prompt appeared in front of Ji Yushi. It was the current time coordinate: [1456.06.15 14:51:40].

A robotic arm very quickly delivered over a packet of nutrient solution. It waited for the human to drink. Noticing that the human wasn't moving, it moved the nutrient solution around in attempt to attract their attention.

[Welcome Ji Yushi. Welcome back to Tianqiong.]

The hatch opened. For a while, the light outside was a little too dazzling for Ji Yushi.

Someone was holding a flashlight and shining it at his eyes while holding his eyes open. They quickly shouted, "Over here! The scout is in a pre-shock state! First aid needs to be administrated immediately!!"

Ji Yushi recognised this voice.

It was the person who had examined his physical condition before they set off on their mission.

They had returned, thought Ji Yushi before he fell unconscious.



# Chapter 39: Chapter 39

## Who Am I

### Chapter 39

When Ji Yushi woke up, a few days had passed.

It was noon. Sunlight poured into the ward through the window, leaving a golden glow across the marble floor and white walls.

The sky outside was blue and cloudless. It was just a typical fine day.

How long had it been since he last saw such a sky?

Ji Yushi thought this, but for a moment he couldn't calculate it.

The air-conditioning in the ward was sufficient. Ji Yushi even had a thin blanket covering him. A needle was inserted into the back of his right hand and fluid slowly entered his veins.

The sequelae of the transition this time was too strong, causing Ji Yushi to be left in a state of shock for a while. Fortunately, his body had undergone many transitions before, and it was able to recover following the administration of first aid. Ji Yushi however found that he was so tired, he didn't even want to lift a single finger while he laid in the soft bed.

[1456.06.15 14:51:40]

Ji Yushi recalled the time coordinates he saw when he returned.

They had set off on Star Era May 17<sup>th</sup>, 1456. He didn't expect that a month would have passed since their departure. During that month where all

contact was lost, it was likely very difficult for the people in Jiang City as well as his family.

The nurse came to check on him and also brought along some food.

Congee that was cooled to the right temperature and refreshing and delicious side dishes. All of them made Ji Yushi's index finger move. Except for the meal he had an impression of at the 'transfer station', he hadn't had hot food in a long time. What's more, that meal also was just an illusion.

His empty stomach was gently soothed by the warm congee and his numb tastebuds were reawakened by the side dishes.

With the sunlight and the blue sky outside the window, Ji Yushi slowly ate and then relaxed completely.

"Knock, knock."

There was a knock on the door.

Ji Yushi said, "Come in."

The door opened a crack. The person who stuck his head in was Li Chun, "Advisor Ji! You're awake!"

Li Chun had already returned to his energetic self. Without the black combat uniform, he looked even younger. He sat on the chair next to the bed without any hesitation, "I guessed that you would wake up around this time. When I asked the nurse just now, sure enough!"

Ji Yushi, "Everyone is okay?"

Li Chun, "They're fine! We all woke up a little earlier than you, but it's also not much earlier!"

Li Chun was in the ward next door. He told Ji Yushi that everyone was suffering from varying degrees of sequelae and were all sent to the Tianqiong Medical Centre.

In addition to the two of them, the other teammates were also staying on this floor, but the nurses didn't allow them to visit at the same time.

Li Chun sighed, "Doesn't seem real!"

He stretched out his arm and showed Ji Yushi his bruised arm, "When I first woke up, I pinched myself hard a few times before I could believe that everything wasn't just an illusion. Fucking felt like a nightmare."

Ji Yushi wanted to say that if it really were an illusion, the pain and the injuries would naturally also be included in that, but he held himself back.

In fact, Ji Yushi also couldn't believe that they could return so easily. Everything however was within reason.

Through his observations, the so-called 'Tianqiong self-awareness' shouldn't have the ability to make the illusions so realistic and humane. Most importantly, the Tianqiong and command centre belonging to their era was in fact far more powerful than they realised. It was only a matter of time for them to be able to find them and successfully intercept their next transition.

If it was any later, even Ji Yushi would think that the command centre was incompetent.

"What Ouroboros, what Chaos." Li Chun said, "If it weren't for Brother Wen and Old Duan comparing their memories with mine, I would have thought that I had gone crazy. The superiors were also worried about that happening, so they even sent over people to do a psychological assessment."

Ji Yushi's pale and slender fingers placed the spoon down. It hit the edge of the bowl, letting out a small clang: "Psychological assessment?"

"Yes." Li Chun said, "We woke up before you, so we have already done it. I heard from the nurse sister that we went missing for almost a month. It scared everyone so much, it almost became a legend. Right now, we are

waiting for our reports to see if we pass. The results will determine when we can go home.”

Ji Yushi nodded.

This was the usual process.

Li Chun suddenly changed the subject and asked, “Advisor Ji, will you go back to Ning City when you are allowed to leave?”

“Yes.” Ji Yushi replied. He then added, “That is, if you don’t need my assistance to complete the A-level mission in Xijing City.”

He had come to this city originally to help complete that mission.

“That probably won’t be necessary.” Li Chun said, “That task has already been completed by another squad.”

Li Chun deserved his reputation as someone who is very talkative and likes to gossip. As soon as he woke up, he managed to get a good idea of everything that had happened after they left.

After the third command centre detected that the seventh squad had not reached the correct time and space coordinates and couldn’t be contacted, they promptly arranged for a search team to search for their whereabouts and the A-level mission was given to the ninth squad to complete.

The rankings of Guardian squads are fiercely competitive. Li Chun was miffed, “They probably still hoped that we won’t return so that they can take over our place.”

The reason for the rivalry between the two squads was probably because of the matter Ji Yushi was told about last time.

After he was done complaining, Li Chun asked expectantly, “Then, since Old Yu will probably need to retire, our squad will still be short of people. If we need help for the next mission, will you come Advisor Ji?”

Ji Yushi said, “Depends on the situation.”

Humans were like this. They would develop feelings after interacting with each other. Ji Yushi found that he couldn't refuse expressionlessly like before.

Li Chun asked, "What kind of situation would it depend on?"

Ji Yushi, "....."

Li Chun rubbed the back of his head, "That, we only just returned so it might be too early talking about this."

Ji Yushi didn't seem to be in good condition.

Even though it has been proven that he wasn't a weakling, the fragile scene of him unable to unscrew a bottle cap was still deeply imprinted in their hearts. After Li Chun talked for a while, he soon left the ward to give Ji Yushi time to rest.

But soon after Li Chun left, the others arrived one after another.

The twins, Zhou Mingxuan and Duan Wen all dropped by. Because it was too rowdy, they were all ushered back to their rooms by the nurse after a while. In general, they all had one thought: They hoped that Ji Yushi could stay.

Ji Yushi felt a little helpless, but he was also a little shaken.

Having experienced such a dangerous and terrifying mission and having experienced such a cruel case of time and space hijacking, it was normal for it to leave behind a psychological shadow. Not to mention those with poor psychological endurance, even normal people would feel a resistance to getting back into the capsules for another transition.

But the Tianqiong Seventh Squad was different.

Of course, they had just returned to reality and it was impossible for them to have another mission so soon, but they were already thinking about their next mission.

With this kind of psychological endurance, they would most certainly pass the assessment with ease.

Unafraid and unable to die; the resilience of the seventh squad was awe-inspiring.

After the teammates left, an expert arrived as scheduled and performed a three-hour psychological assessment for Ji Yushi.

Before it ended, the expert asked three questions.

“Ji Yushi, during the transition error, did your trust in Tianqiong and the command centre waver at all?”

Ji Yushi said, “No.”

The expert asked, “Why?”

Ji Yushi, “Because if you described it as a ‘dimension’, I think that the ‘Tianqiong with self-awareness’ comes from a dimension that far surpasses ours, so this was just an accident that no one could predict. On the other hand, I also believed that Tianqiong and the command centre would be able to find us. All that we had to worry about was how long we would have to wait.”

The expert then asked, “And after the transition went wrong, did you ever think about using the opportunity to transition to another era?”

After asking this question, the pale-skinned expert pushed up his glasses and looked earnestly at Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi lowered his eye. There was a small polygraph attached to his wrist detecting his pulse.

He spoke again with no change to his voice, “No, I have never had that thought because I know the organisation keeps its promises and will give me that opportunity sooner or later.”

The polygraph showed a green light.

The expert packed up the equipment and soon left the room.

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At nine o'clock in the morning of the next day, all the reports for the seventh squad were sent out.

Everyone had passed. They could now leave.

After returning home, each person wrote a detailed report. In addition to that, the branch also granted them a three-month long vacation for them to recuperate. Once they return to Tianqiong, they are to have another psychological assessment.

Duan Wen brought back everyone's personal belongings and gave Ji Yushi his clothes, phone etc

After Ji Yushi got dressed and opened the door of his ward, he was met with Song Qinglan leaning against the wall outside his door, "Advisor Ji."

A familiar low voice.

It was like the first time it reached Ji Yushi's ears through the public channel, catching him off guard.

Even his heart raced a little.

The man's tall figure combined with his pair of long and straight legs gave him a strong presence. Even with him leaning back slightly, it gave Ji Yushi a small urge to retreat — After not seeing him for a few days and with the addition of his final interaction being with the child version of the other party, the current adult version of Song Qinglan felt a little unfamiliar.

Song Qinglan seemed to have been bored waiting for him. As soon as Ji Yushi came out, he said, "You're always so slow."

This scene seemed familiar.

Ji Yushi remembered that when they were taking turns showering after returning from the rainforest, Song Qinglan had also waited for him outside.

Ji Yushi's expression remained unchanged. His beautiful eyes looked at Song Qinglan, "Cap Song, are you here again to throw me an olive branch?"

"That's not it." Song Qinglan answered casually, "It's no use rushing. Even if I throw a branch, Advisor Ji may not catch it anyway."

He stood up from the wall and then curled his lips, "I actually woke up the earliest and wanted to see you before the others to leave myself with a good impression. Unfortunately, luck wasn't on my side and I was hit with a bunch of procedures. The people above really don't want to give me a break."

Song Qinglan was the captain. His circumstances were naturally different from theirs.

That was why Ji Yushi never asked when everyone apart from Song Qinglan visited him. He knew that he wouldn't be able to get away so easily.

Ji Yushi said, "Then when I return, I will write more words of praise for you in my mission report."

"No need to wait for the mission report." Song Qinglan said in a relaxed tone, "Chief Qi wants to invite us to eat so you can just say something nice then."

Chief...Qi?

Ji Yushi frowned, "How many chiefs are there in the Jiang City branch?"

Song Qinglan said, "Only one. Why?"

The look in Ji Yushi's eyes changed, "Then what about Chief Wang?"



# Chapter 40: Chapter 40

## Who Am I

### Chapter 40

Hearing Ji Yushi ask this, although Song Qinglan didn't know the reason for his question, he subconsciously softened his tone, "What Chief Wang?"

Chief Wang of Tiangqiong's Jiang City Branch.

Female, fifty-three years old, gentle temperament, decisive and resolute when making decisions, and often breaks cups when angry.

Ji Yushi clearly remembered her face and her smile, including the perfume she used.

But why was Song Qinglan saying that the Chief of the Jiang City branch was someone surnamed Qi? And there was only one chief?

Ji Yushi had a bad feeling. All kinds of thoughts swirled in his mind. What went wrong? Were they still in a state of being hijacked and hadn't truly returned? Did Tianqiong once again put an illusion into their minds, forcing them to enter a new mission? Or was there something wrong with his memory and everything was overlapping and a mess?

Ji Yushi's expression tensed up. He turned a little paler and the look in his eyes alternated between tension and hesitation. It was Song Qinglan's first time seeing him like this.

Song Qinglan's heart fell slightly. He remembered Ji Yushi's psychological assessment report.

Even people with a strong mind and strong personality would suffer from different degrees of psychological trauma after experiencing something like that. Everyone in the seventh squad more or less had some sequelae. Some they were aware of while others lurked in their subconscious minds. Fortunately, it all could be controlled and that was why they were granted a three-month vacation.

But it was different for Ji Yushi. The expert's assessment result for him was: Perfect.

Song Qinglan was the captain so he was present during the meeting. The expert wasn't very optimistic about the result because Ji Yushi was like a student who could recite the correct answer without much trouble. He scored high in every answer, but it wasn't because it really was the case for him.

The two had interacted long enough to have established tacit understanding. Song Qinglan stepped forward and held Ji Yushi's shoulder. He couldn't help but lower his voice, "Advisor Ji, what did you think of?"

Ji Yushi's lips were tightly pursed. He spoke with difficulty, "I want....to clear my mind first."

With that, he took out his medicine box from his pocket.

Taking too much medicine wasn't good but Ji Yushi's expression didn't look great.

Song Qinglan immediately turned around and returned to the ward with a glass of water. Before arriving, he had already tested the temperature using the back of his hand, "It's warm."

Ji Yushi placed a tablet in his mouth and then received the water from Song Qinglan.

He took a sip, raised his head and the jut on his throat moved as he swallowed it in one go.

His figure was thin and slender, and his complexion was fair. At this moment, he wore a white shirt and black trousers, making him look clean and refreshing. This was also what he wore when he first arrived at Jiang City. When they first met, Song Qinglan felt that Ji Yushi was like a pine tree beside a snowy lake but now, he felt that there was a sense of undetectable fragility to him as well.

Did Ji Yushi often use drugs to keep his mind clear?

Or was it only occasionally?

There weren't many people on this floor and very few people used this corridor.

After taking the medicine, Ji Yushi quietly closed his eyes for a few seconds. The medicine obviously wouldn't take effect so quickly, but it was enough to make him feel better psychologically.

When he opened his eyes again, some clarity was restored in his eyes. Seeing that Song Qinglan was still standing beside him with concern, he said, "Cap Song, do you still remember the person who arranged our mission and the person who transferred me to Jiang City?"

At this moment, someone suddenly shouted, "Cap Song! Advisor Ji!"

The teammates walked over cheerily having finished packing up.

Zhou Mingxuan asked, "What are you two doing here? Waiting for us?"

Tang Qi hooked his arm around his brother's neck and smiled, "Cap Song, weren't you going to go there together with Chief Qi? You specially came to get us?"

Song Qinglan answered naturally, "Specially coming to get you? In your dreams. I'm here to wait for Advisor Ji."

Everyone: "Tsk! Differential treatment!"

As soon as they were no longer performing their mission and placed in a serious and tense environment, this group of tall and strong young men were like ruffians. If they were outside, passers-by would take a detour around them.

Everyone chattered on, but they were all joking around. It was evident that everyone was in a good mood.

“Advisor Ji isn’t from here, so he doesn’t have a car. I’m in charge of picking him up and dropping him off.” Song Qinglan said as a matter of factly, “Furthermore, tonight is not only a meal with Chief Qi, it’s also a farewell party for Advisor Ji.”

After eating, Ji Yushi would return to Ning City. He had booked tickets for the afternoon.

Everyone now remembered the matter of Ji Yushi leaving the seventh squad.

The seven of them entered the elevator noisily.

Ji Yushi stood in the corner. Li Chun sneakily leaned forward and asked, “Advisor Ji, will you miss us when you return?”

“Haa.” Duan Wen said, “Advisor Ji’s skin is too thin. Can’t you see how depressed he is now? He’s clearly already sad about leaving.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Except for Li Chun, the rest of the seventh squad had their own cars. Li Chun had always taken Duan Wen’s car so when they got out of the elevator on the first floor, they all went to pick up their car from the command centre.

Song Qinglan had already gone out a few times before this so his car was parked in the underground parking lot.

After everyone left, Ji Yushi followed Song Qinglan all the way to the underground floor.

The underground parking lot wasn't too cramped. When they reached a certain place, the light above them suddenly flickered. One of it was broken.

Ji Yushi was left stunned for a few seconds.

In the underground passage of Runjin Building, hanging lights, pale hands reaching towards them, and the endless sound of gunshots, all rushed to his mind in an instant.

But it only lasted a second or two, and everything was gone.

Song Qinglan interrupted him.

"Here." Song Qinglan opened the car door, "Get in."

It was a light silver sports car with smooth lines and paint that reflected light brightly. It sat quietly in the middle of the parking lot.

Song Qinglan who wore casual clothes stood next to the car with a hint of a smile in his eyes looking like a car model.

Ji Yushi got on and fastened his seatbelt, "Did you embezzle or are you a rich second generation?"

Song Qinglan wasn't a low-key person in private either. His family background and abilities together formed his domineering personality. He started the car and drove out, "Then it must be embezzlement. See how well we are treated here? Have your thoughts wavered, Advisor Ji? I can give you half of the money I've embezzled."

After removing the captain shell, he was no different from other ordinary young men. That is, with the exception that his conditions were better.

Song Qinglan wore a watch with a simple face design on his wrist. Someone in Ji Yushi's family just happened to also have one like that and the price wasn't simple at all. The big hands that easily welded all sorts of weapons were at this moment holding the steering wheel loosely. Ji Yushi

couldn't help but recall the feeling of his hands when they were being held by them.

His impression of it was that it was warm, and very powerful.

He answered Song Qinglan's teasing, "No thanks, I don't want to go to jail."

Song Qinglan had expected this response. He stopped joking and instead replied, "The captain's annual salary is pretty good, and I also made some investments."

The car drove out of the parking lot, leaving Tianqiong.

Passing by a barrier on the road, Song Qinglan glanced at Ji Yushi who was squinting his eyes in the sun, looking a little lazy.

The morning sun wasn't too harsh. Ji Yushi allowed it to fall onto him as he watched the busy Jiang City streets pass by.

He was very quiet. Probably because the medicine had taken effect, he looked much better than before and clearer minded. That group of people who always got in the way wasn't around so Song Qinglan wanted to use this chance to ask Ji Yushi about the matter earlier, but he was once again interrupted by a phone call.

It was Ji Yushi's.

Ji Yushi had only just received his phone and hadn't had the chance to call home. The people at home had probably just been notified.

He glanced at the caller ID and his brows furrowed slightly before loosening, "Hello?"

Who was it?

Song Qinglan looked ahead.

Ji Minyue took in a deep breath as soon as he heard his voice, “You’re finally back. I thought you really went missing and almost killed myself in apology in front of the old man. Actually, he would be the one killing me.”

Ji Yushi’s tone was also relaxed, “Too bloody.”

Ji Minyue, “Classmate Xiao Ji, don’t be like that. Old Ji would really do something like that for you. After so many years, except for the time when he beat me, he never mentioned anything about me helping you join Tianqiong but I was almost scolded to death by him during the past month. If you didn’t return, I would really die in Ning City. When the old lady tried to help me, he gets even more angry.”

Ji Yushi said, “You should let him win sometimes. Don’t always compete for favour with him.”

Let him win? Compete for favour?

Song Qinglan: “.....”

Song Qinglan was someone who didn’t like to butt into other people’s private matters. He just wanted to focus on driving.

It was fine when the car was moving, but they happened to be at a large intersection with a red light lasting 120 seconds.

Song Qinglan pressed against his temple with one hand and his finger on the steering wheel tapped one after the other as he counted down the seconds.

Ji Minyue briefly talked about a bunch of things happening at home before he asked the question he had been holding back the entire time, “What time is your ticket?”

Ji Yushi said, “Two.”

Ji Minyue calculated it, “Then it should be past four when you get home. You’re resting at home today and coming back tomorrow? I’m afraid that if you come back today, they would nag at you.”

Ji Yushi: “Okay.”

“Alright.” Ji Minyue said, “It’s settled then. I’m going to school tonight, there’s a party. I will send your cat back along the way.”

Ji Yushi missed his cats.

When he left, he didn’t actually bring his cats to the Ning City branch to be fed by his colleagues and instead sent them to Ji Minyue. After leaving for a month, he didn’t know if those little masters missed him. He guessed that they probably did.

There was nothing more relaxing in the world than petting a cat. Just the thought of it made the corners of Ji Yushi’s lips rise a little.

He asked his older brother, “Then what time will you come?”

The light turned green.

Song Qinglan drove out again and turned left to merge into the new traffic.

Ji Minyue said, “Before seven probably.”

Ji Yushi asked, “Bathed?”

“Knowing that you came back today, your sister-in-law brought them to be washed yesterday.” How could Ji Minyue not know him? “Clean freak.”

Ji Yushi was satisfied, “Okay, then I’ll wait for you.”

He then hung up.

Somehow, Ji Yushi felt that the car was strangely silent.

Thinking that he had probably talked too long on the phone with his family, he felt a little apologetic, “Sorry Cap Song for talking on the phone in the car.”

Song Qinglan’s handsome side profile was a little stiff.



Ji Yushi was far beyond what he could imagine. Was only Ji Yushi like this, or was it the same for all of them?

“It’s okay.” He couldn’t hold back and asked, “Advisor Ji, you.....that, how many?”

Cats?

Ji Yushi answered, “Three.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

He already knew what Ji Yushi’s orientation was. When they were inside the kiosk, Ji Yushi even said that he would go to gay bars. A person’s ability and their private life were two separate matters. Song Qinglan knew that while he appreciated Ji Yushi’s abilities, it didn’t mean that he could comment on his private life.

But what was going on with this irritation inside him?

He didn’t want Ji Yushi to have this kind of view on relationships. He didn’t want Ji Yushi.....to date so early on.

Humans should be a little ambitious and focus on their careers first.

When they reached their destination, Song Qinglan stopped the car and continued the previous topic: “Advisor Ji.”

But unexpectedly, when he turned his head over, Ji Yushi just happened to be looking at him.

Those moist almond shaped eyes with slightly raised corners seemed to be very focused. The moment Song Qinglan turned to look over, Ji Yushi moved his line of sight elsewhere, as if nothing had happened.

Song Qinglan’s heart leapt.

That warm and strange feeling came again.

It couldn't be that because he was about to leave and separation was imminent, Advisor Ji suddenly changed his mind and was interested in their proposal of joining the seventh squad but was too embarrassed to say it?

Song Qinglan's palms were sticky. It had sweated a little.

Putting those personal life matters aside, he recovered his usual tone and started talking, "Earlier, you asked if I remembered who transferred you over. What did that mean?"

# Chapter 41: Chapter 41

## Who Am I

### Chapter 41

After taking the medicine and answering the phone, the anxiousness, confusion and panic from earlier had left Ji Yushi and his complexion looked much better.

They came early and the other teammates hadn't arrived yet, so the two had some time to talk.

Ji Yushi said, "I asked you that because in my memory, the Chief of the Jiang City branch was surnamed Wang. She was a very impressive female leader, and it was her who sent us on our mission, and she was also the one who received me when I came. Based on my memory, there was no chief with the surname Qi."

Song Qinglan was startled, "How could it be?"

He had asked this subconsciously, but it wasn't that he didn't believe in Ji Yushi's memory. Instead, it was because he believed Ji Yushi too much, so he found it shocking, "A female leader surnamed Wang?"

Ji Yushi, "Try and remember. When we first met at the Tianqiong base, who was standing next to me?"

Song Qinglan answered very quickly, "It was Chief Qi. He was the one who introduced you to me. You also said that you attended his class three years ago and told him what he wore that day as well as the fact that I left early."

Ji Yushi shook his head, “No. That was also Chief Wang. I remember her dress, her pearl earrings and the cup she broke.

It was noon on a summer’s day. The sun was shining bright.

Perhaps it was because the air-conditioning in the car was too strong, both of them felt a small chill.

But, after having experienced everything in the other worlds, they were able to remain calm — At least no zombies would suddenly appear to feast on their brains.

There was no point pondering over the same question all the time. Ji Yushi asked, “Cap Song, why don’t you tell me about this Chief Qi?”

Song Qinglan said, “In fact, you met him when you were in the crevice. He’s Captain Qi of the Tianqiong twelfth squad that was trapped in the rainforest.”

Ji Yushi was shocked.

The scene of Captain Qi pointing his gun at the traitor in the rain was still very vivid.

“Xie Sian, I, as the witness and guardian of time, will give you your sentence.”

.....

It turned out to be him?

For a long time, Ji Yushi didn’t speak. His mind was working fast. As soon as every piece of the puzzle fell into the right spot, he quickly understood what was going on, “.....It’s him.”

The timeline had changed. From the time the twelfth squad was rescued, everything that had already happened in reality had been changed. The Tianqiong twelfth squad returned to fifteen years ago and, because of his outstanding abilities, Cap Qi was promoted step by step, eventually

becoming the Chief of the Jiang City branch. As a result, Chief Wang was never appointed.

But why did Song Qinglan's memory change, but not his?

“When I saw him in the crevice, I was also shocked.” Song Qinglan said, “During those years I have been in the Jiang City branch, he had always been very strict with our seventh squad and never revealed anything. It turned out that Chief Qi had such an experience when he was young. From Chief Qi's perspective, they were caught in the crevice fifteen years ago and was rescued by a Tianqiong seventh squad from the future. During those past fifteen years, Chief Qi didn't intervene and just watched the seventh squad destined to save his squad form and when Old Yu was injured and you were transferred over from Ning City, he probably knew that we were about to complete the cycle.”

Ji Yushi's eyelashes trembled slightly.

His eyes carried a hint of confusion.

“Chief Qi looked for me recently and we had a chat. Through him I realised that it was actually very difficult tracking us down after being hijacked. It was precisely because of his past that Chief Qi was able to find a loophole and intercept us with difficulty. Without it, we might not have been able to return.”

Song Qinglan said, “It's like a continuous chain. Without us, there would be no Chief Qi and without Chief Qi, we would not have been able to return to reality. Just like what we said in the Ouroboros mission; only after a certain event at a certain moment is completed would everything else happen after that.”

Time operated extremely precisely.

Of course, this was something Ji Yushi could understand with his mental abilities.

But could one really change the past that easily?

Some people have appeared with the change.

Some people have disappeared with the change.

Those who appeared were taken for granted, while those who disappeared were no longer remembered.

It was actually quite sad.

Song Qinglan noticed his silence.

The two sat in the car for a few more minutes until Song Qinglan's phone rang. Duan Wen asked on the other end, "Cap Song, where are you? We can't find you."

The teammates had already gone up.

Song Qinglan replied briefly, "Coming now."

After hanging up, Song Qinglan found that Ji Yushi had already stored away his emotions. He opened the door and said, "Let's go."

\*

The place where Chief Qi invited everyone to eat was a private restaurant.

As soon as you entered, there was a carved wooden screen and behind it were fat fish swimming through clear waters as well as lush flowers and plants decorating the sides. The designer's elegant taste was quite good.

The surroundings were quiet. Someone helped lead the way.

There was a faint fragrance in the cold air. It wasn't oily or smoky.

When they reached the room, chattering and faint laughter could be heard through the door. The waiter opened the door and said, "Please."

Song Qinglan gave his thanks and turned to let Ji Yushi in first.

Familiar faces sat at the dining table. All the members of the seventh squad were there.

When Zhou Mingxuan saw them enter, he joked, “Cap Song, why did you two arrive last? Has it been too long since you’ve last driven?”

How could Song Qinglan not know his thoughts? “I’ll lend it to you tomorrow.”

Li Chun raised his hand, “I want to drive it too!”

Song Qinglan glanced at him, “Bumper cars at the amusement park. This older brother will treat you.”

Everyone laughed.

Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi sat down and asked casually, “And Chief Qi?”

Duan Wen, “Met an acquaintance outside and went to say hello.”

When the team had dinner together before leaving last time, Ji Yushi didn’t join. Sitting with everyone now, the situation was no longer the same as how it was back then.

He found that he was not only casual, but he also felt a little at ease.

Amidst the excitement, even the troubled feeling in his heart dissipated a little.

Tang Le sat next to him. He lowered his voice and asked, “Advisor Ji, my brother and I parked our car behind you two just now and originally wanted to go upstairs together with you. What were you and Cap Song doing in the car for so long?”

Ji Yushi : “.....”

He didn’t know what to say. Should he tell everyone that the timeline had changed?

After Tang Le asked, Tang Qi tapped his head with a pair of chopsticks. Tang Le hurriedly stuck out his tongue and withdrew.

They clearly looked the same, but Tang Qi was a lot more sensible, “It’s none of your business. Anyway, they won’t be flirting.”

Tang Le: “That’s hard to say. Can’t you see that Cap Song has changed with the arrival of Advisor Ji?! Since when has he ever let us ride his car?”

Song Qinglan heard this and answered in a bad tone, “All of you are dirty and smelly. Old Zhou’s three-day old socks can even stand—”

“The fuck?” In private, Zhou Mingxuan didn’t hold back, “You speak like you’ve never done it before yourself. Who the hell would have time for it during special forces field training? You guys.....especially Advisor Ji. Advisor Ji, let me tell you, don’t look at how Song Qinglan is right now, in fact, he wouldn’t even wear underwear in the army in order not to wash it. He doesn’t care if his balls get caught by the zipper.”

Song Qinglan laughed and kicked the other party’s chair, “Fuck! That’s because it felt cool.”

Ji Yushi didn’t seem like someone who would joke but to everyone’s surprise, he glanced at Song Qinglan’s trousers and said, “It probably is quite cool.”

As soon as he finished saying that the door to the room was opened.

Ji Yushi looked up.

The man who entered was in his fifties but one could still see his youthful appearance under that middle-aged appearance. His shoulders were broad and the muscles under his shirt slightly bulged out. It was obvious that he regularly exercised. The hairs on his temples were white and his brows were thick. He clearly was a rather fierce character. He smiled and greeted, “Everyone’s here?”

At that moment.



Ji Yushi's memories underwent earth-shaking changes.

Three years ago, in a class in Jiang City, the speaker was replaced by Chief Qi. His lecture was smooth and concise, and he easily encouraged the audience to think.

When Ji Yushi received the transfer order, the Chief's signature at the bottom were two words: Qi Lang.

When Ji Yushi arrived at the Jiang City branch, the person who received him also changed into Chief Qi. They stood before the window and spoke for a while before Song Qinglan entered the room.

.....

The original memories were still there but new memories appeared to have been born from them.

Ji Yushi was still recovering from the changes when a middle-aged male voice sounded, "Xiao Ji, since you will be going back to Ning City today, this meal is not only a meal to express my thanks to everyone, but also a farewell banquet for you."

Ji Yushi returned to his senses and saw that everyone had raised their glasses.

His glass was also filled. He picked it up and said, "Thank you, Chief Qi."

Everyone took their seats.

As soon as Ji Yushi sat down, Song Qinglan who had been observing Chief Qi since he entered the room turned his head to say something, but Ji Yushi spoke first, "Don't worry, I've remembered it already."

The distance between them was a little close.

Song Qinglan's lips almost touched the other party's face.

Both retreated and no longer spoke.

Song Qinglan held the glass in his hand. He felt a little hot, so he downed it all in one go to cool himself down.

Just now, he had an urge to see what it would feel like if he touched Ji Yushi's face.

As a leader who had gone through countless Guardian missions, Chief Qi wasn't the type who liked to make things too official. This meal also reflected his personality.

As Song Qinglan had said in the car, Chief Qi briefly explained the encounter with the Seventh Squad in the crevice fifteen years ago.

Time was really a very strange existence

Chief Qi sighed, "Over the years, I watched your squad gradually come together and I also oversaw Xiao Ji's transfer. I didn't know what would happen to you, but I was certain of the result. After so many years, the death in the rainforest and the shooting of the traitor in the heavy rain still brings me nightmares. With your squad returning successfully, I was finally able to have a good night's sleep last night. Most importantly, myself and my old teammates had been waiting all this time wanting to personally give you our gratitude. Although they cannot come, I would like to represent them and give everyone a toast."

It must not have been easy keeping a secret for fifteen years.

Now that everything that needed to be completed had been completed, the secret was no longer a secret. After Chief Qi finished drinking from his glass, even the wrinkles around the corners of his eyes loosened somewhat.

Placing down his glass, Ji Yushi asked, "And Xie Sian?"

Everyone was curious about this.

Hearing the name, Chief Qi spoke solemnly, "After being trialled, life imprisonment."

The topic returned to Ji Yushi.

Chief Qi asked, “Xiao Ji, your ability is very outstanding. I had a talk with your Chief Lin and want you to officially join the Guardian squad, but Chief Lin wasn’t willing. I think that your own opinion is more important so how about it? Do you want to consider it?”

One after another, he was asked about this.

The team members, the captain and now the chief.

As soon as Chief Qi finished speaking, everyone looked over with expectation. Ji Yushi: “.....”

Wasn’t this supposed to be a farewell banquet?

In the end, Ji Yushi said, “Thank you Chief Qi, I will carefully take it into consideration.

\*

After the meal, everyone said their goodbyes.

The squad gathered with Ji Yushi in the centre and insisted that no matter what decision Ji Yushi makes, he should look for them whenever he comes to visit Jiang City.

Since he was leaving the Guardian squad, the previously injected subcutaneous communicator had been removed and there was no communicator outside of the mission, Tang Le asked for Ji Yushi’s phone number. Everyone else also insisted on receiving the same treatment and similarly exchanged numbers,

It was Ji Yushi’s first time having so many numbers stored in his phone.

After saving them, Song Qinglan who was waiting by the side said, “Alright, Advisor Ji won’t be able to catch the train if we delay it any longer.”

There was a special intercity suspended train from Jiang City to Ning City which could reach a speed of five to six hundred kilometres per hour and

would only take a little more than one hour to travel from one point to another. It was a ticket covered by the Jiang City branch.

As Ji Yushi put away his phone, he heard Song Qinglan say, “Advisor Ji, I’ll send you off.”

When he turned to look, the other party had his arms crossed habitually. It basically meant that he wouldn’t take no for an answer.

Ji Yushi originally didn’t have the intention to refuse so he nodded, “Then I’ll have to trouble Cap Song.”

The group of people waved as they watched them leave.

The afternoon sun was scorching hot. Cicadas cried unceasingly.

Ji Yushi was about to return to his city. He didn’t belong here.

Ji Yushi didn’t want to remember everyone’s sad expressions as he left, so he didn’t look back when he left. He opened the door and got into the car.

Song Qinglan also got in and silently drove all the way to the Jiang City’s East Station.

“Thank you.” Ji Yushi said, “Then I’ll be leaving.”

He was about to open the door when Song Qinglan suddenly stopped him, “Ji Yushi.”

Ji Yushi’s pale hands trembled slightly. He looked back and was met with Song Qinglan’s dark and deep eyes. He seemed to have wanted to say something, but he just continued to look at him in silence.

It made his heart beat faster for some reason.

He spoke up, “What is it?”

Song Qinglan took out his phone and dialled the number he memorised from just now and spoke very much like a straight man, “You have saved all

their numbers. Save mine in there too.”

# Chapter 42: Chapter 42

## Who Am I

### Chapter 42

Ji Yushi boarded the train and found his business seat.

It was spacious enough and there weren't many people in the carriage, so he threw his bag of clothing and supplies casually onto the ground and took out his phone. As soon as he did this series of actions, he reacted. Since when had he become so casual? It turns out that the seventh squad's habits are contagious.

There was a missed call on his phone. It was the call from Song Qinglan just now.

To Ji Yushi, it didn't matter whether the phone number was saved since he could remember who the number belonged to as long as he saw it once. To him, there was no difference between the person's name and their phone number when they're displayed on the screen.

But, carrying the spirit of treating everyone equally, Ji Yushi decided to still select that string of numbers and then selected New Contact.

He first typed the words "Song Qinglan".

As he typed it in, he couldn't help but notice that the 'Lan' referred to mist in the mountains. If that was the case, did 'Qinglan' mean mist on a sunny day?

After typing those characters in, the bar flashed a few times after the last character.

This name may not have a chance to appear on his screen in the future. After looking at it for a few seconds, Ji Yushi proceeded to delete it and replaced it with “Cap Song”.

But as if to immediately refute him, just as he turned off his phone after saving it, his phone vibrated.

Cap Song: [Advisor Ji, what is the full name of this Chief Wang you talked about?]

Ji Yushi: [Wang Xiaoqian.]

Song Qinglan no longer sent another message over.

It was four o’clock when Ji Yushi returned to Ning City.

Before leaving for Jiang City, he had parked his car in the parking lot of Ning City’s North Station but when he retraced his steps to the place he parked in his memory, there was an unfamiliar car parked there: A black off-road car with 22-inch wheels. There were no extra decorations on the car and there was a thin layer of dust accumulated on the body. It looked like it had been parked there for a long time and hadn’t been moved.

Doubts only lingered temporarily in his heart.

New memories surfaced in Ji Yushi’s mind — When he changed cars a year ago, he had hesitated between this car and another, and finally chose this one.

This was contrary to his original memory because he had given up on this car at the time thinking that it was too big.

Without thinking too much about it, Ji Yushi successfully unlocked the car with his fingerprint and then smoothly drove back home.

After reaching home, Ji Yushi didn’t bother checking for any changes at home and went straight to the bathroom.

Cold water poured over the top of his head non-stop. On a summer's day, it wasn't enough to make people's teeth chatter.

Grandfather paradox, Novikov self-consistence principle as well as other sophisticated theories; Ji Yushi's mind was filled with too many things, making him confused and unable to tell the difference between reality and his memories. Those that are no longer the same and those that are different, memories continued to surface with the changes, mixing with memories of the past. It was somewhat overwhelming for him.

After the shower, Ji Yushi supported himself at the sink whilst still covered in water droplets. Drops of water dripped down his hair, onto his chin, his collarbone and then to the back of his hand.

He opened the mirror cabinet and found a bottle of medicine inside.

He had taken some of it along before he left so there weren't much left at home.

He poured out one into the palm of his hand, placed it in his mouth and then leaned down and drank some water from the faucet.

Except for the initial stage in the Ouroboros mission, it had been a long time since he took medicine so soon after each other.

His reflection in the mirror didn't look too great.

He silently looked at himself for a while and then turned around to find a bath towel and wiped himself down — Ji Minyue would soon be here.

\*

As expected, Ji Minyue was very punctual. He said that he would come before seven, but he actually came before six.

“You've become thinner.” Ji Minyue complained as soon as he entered the door, “One mission and it lasts for a month. What did those people make you do?”



Everyone who works at Tianqiong had signed a non-disclosure agreement. Information that could be disclosed was very limited, so family only knew that they had gone on a mission but nothing about the specifics. When Ji Yushi was transferred to Ning City, the original plan was that he would be back within a week, but it had instead lasted a month, so they were naturally worried, but they couldn't do anything about it. As a result, his family knew nothing about the horrible experience of time and space hijacking, zombies, crevice in time and the likes, and they also naturally wouldn't say anything.

Ji Minyue carried a cat carrier in one hand and some cat daily necessities in the other.

He spoke as he walked in and placed the carrier and other items on the floor.

One person couldn't carry the things for three cats. Ji Yushi asked, "Why didn't you call for me to go down and help?"

"Meow——"

In the carrier, an unfamiliar cry sounded.

"Is it necessary?" Ji Minyue said, "If you wanted to help, why didn't you close the door? What would you do if it escapes?"

Ji Minyue went to close the door. When he returned, he saw Ji Yushi standing there in shock as if he had been struck by lightning and laughed, "Your little master may have gained a little weight but there's no need to be so shocked."

Cats are prone to extreme reactions and the Ji Yushi's cat carrier wasn't transparent.

He opened the carrier and was met with a round faced orange cat meowing at him sweetly. He didn't recognise the cat.

But very quickly, just like when he saw Chief Qi and his car, memories flooded his mind.

Ji Yushi realised that his current self didn't have those three familiar black cats.

One late night two years ago when he passed a garbage dump, he found a pitiful kitten covered in fleas. It was about ten days old and had been discarded by someone. Ji Yushi picked it up and gave it a very uncreative name — Just like Big Black, Middle Black and Little Black, it was very simple.

He named it Little Orange.

Little Orange's body was a lot plumper but the act of jumping out of the carrier was still very light.

“Meow.”

Seeing its official poo shoveler, it immediately started to act spoiled and rubbed its soft body against Ji Yushi's calf. Its tail swept back and forth, trying to hook it around Ji Yushi. It was clearly a little excited.

Ji Yushi bent over and picked it up.

As soon as Little Orange was in his arms, it immediately meowed contently.

“Really a lot heavier.” Ji Yushi asked Ji Minyue, “What did it eat?”

Ji Minyue didn't look like Ji Yushi. He was about two or three centimetres shorter than Ji Yushi and used to be thinner than him when they were younger, so he was always beaten whenever they fought but two or three years of married life had made him settle down and grow more flesh. If they didn't say anything, others would think that he was Little Orange's owner since pets tend to resemble their owners.

Ji Minyue slumped onto his younger brother's sofa, “It steals the dog's food every day so why wouldn't it get heavier?”

Two memories played hand in hand.

The new memory played in Ji Yushi's mind like a movie. He remembered that Ji Minyue raised a corgi.

As in Ji Yushi's original memory, Ji Minyue also taught at a nearby university and needed to attend a school celebration party in the evening. The day before, Little Orange was taken by his sister-in-law to be washed so its body was very fragrant. As Ji Yushi petted the cat, he chatted with Ji Minyue.

Ji Yushi behaved very normally. Except for losing some weight after the mission, his mental state didn't appear any different from before.

Ji Minyue asked, "How did you get along with that especially discriminative Captain Song? He didn't bully you, right?"

He had placed emphasis on the word 'bully'. No one else could be more familiar on how vindictive Ji Yushi could be. There probably wasn't anyone in this world who could bully Ji Yushi.

When Ji Yushi refused to go to Jiang City as support, Chief Lin had called Professor Ji for help and the reason for the refusal was somewhat revealed. As a result, the notoriety of a certain captain surnamed Song was spread throughout the Ning City branch as well as the Ji family. The smear on his name would probably not be able to be washed clean for the rest of his lifetime.

Ji Yushi said, "It was alright. Rumours have become distorted after being passed around. In fact, with his ability, he has the right to be proud."

It meant that he wasn't a bad person.

Otherwise, with someone as vengeful as Ji Yushi, he wouldn't have said anything good about the other party.

Ji Minyue smiled, "What about him being homophobic? Was it just a rumour?"

The deep and dark eyes of the other party appeared in his mind. Ji Yushi commented, “He....is just a straight man.”

Ji Minyue couldn't stay for long. After chatting for a while and confirming that his younger brother was fine, he got up to leave. Before he left, he said, “Go home tomorrow for dinner. Old Ji will probably want to say a few things to you. He will probably talk a lot, so you best be prepared.”

The cat jumped out of Ji Yushi's arms, the soft pads landing quietly. It walked around the house and then returned to Ji Yushi's side and meowed a few times. It was saying that it wanted to drink water.

Ji Yushi stood up to get water from the kitchen. Only then did he notice the changes in his house.

A glass he had smashed was still sitting on the table fully intact, several books he had already read were thrown on the dining table and the black and white photo that was originally hung on the wall was replaced by a family portrait of the Ji family from ten years ago. There was also only one cat tower and similarly only one cat bowl.....

As memories surged in his mind, Ji Yushi's head throbbed with pain. He accidentally knocked the bowl of water onto the ground.

Ji Yushi knelt on the floor, panting slightly.

The cat circled around him nervously, nuzzling his hand with its face as if asking him what was wrong.

He suddenly remembered something and proceeded to turn on his phone projection and typed the words “Sheng Yun” into the search bar.

The search results appeared: “Sheng Yun, male, a famous physics scientist. Born August 2<sup>nd</sup>, 1405 and passed away at home on April 6<sup>th</sup>, 1439....”

Reaching this point, Ji Yushi immediately closed the webpage.

No change.

How silly. That incident had happened far earlier than fifteen years ago where everything changed.

\*

Ji Yushi ordered himself takeaway.

Fortunately, the store he often ordered from hadn't disappeared because of all the changes. After he was done ordering, he found a bottle of red wine Ji Minyue had brought over last time and, just like what he did in the 'transfer station', he drank half a glass.

Late at night, rain slowly started to fall outside.

Ji Yushi got up to close the window and saw that there were no cars outside on the brightly lit streets. While he was surprised, he suddenly noticed that the familiar city before him had changed. The left and right sides were now completely symmetrical, much like a mirror reflection.

At an intersection in the distance, a person appeared on the zebra crossing. They held something that glowed.

Ji Yushi had excellent eyesight. He clearly saw that it was a glowing flower. That person raised their head as if they had noticed his gaze.

Ji Yushi retreated back a few steps in shock, and he reflexively closed the windows with some force.

When he moved to go back to bed, he inadvertently saw a pool of blood behind the door.

And in the middle of that pool of blood was a calf wearing a black boot.

He started to tremble.

A large, warm hand covered his eyes and a familiar voice sounded next to his ear, "Don't look."

.....

Ji Yushi woke up in shock from his nightmare covered in cold sweat.

His chest was very heavy. Something fluffy and soft was pressing down onto him, occasionally tossing around. It was his cat sleeping on his chest.

When Ji Yushi moved the cat away, Little Orange let out a little whiny mew. Perhaps it was dissatisfied, it jumped off the bed.

He turned on his phone to check the time but found an unread message displayed on the screen.

Cap Song: [Have you arrived home yet?]

This message was sent seven or eight hours ago, just when Ji Yushi's train reached Ning City. He hadn't had the chance to check his phone until now.

This message allowed the heart that was suspended in the air fall back down and all his thoughts were pulled back to reality. Ji Yushi replied: [Arrived.]

The sound of rain got louder and louder. Ji Yushi only now realised that he didn't actually close the windows.

Ji Yushi only realised after he returned to bed after closing the windows how inappropriate his actions were just now. It was currently early morning, but he had replied to the other party.

But to his surprise, Song Qinglan also wasn't asleep, and a message was sent back.

Cap Song: [Still awake?]

Ji Yushi could almost imagine Song Qinglan raising his eyebrow slightly to express his surprise.

Ji Yushi answered: [Was tossed awake.]

This time, Song Qinglan took a while before responding.

Cap Song: [Won't bother you then.]

Ji Yushi knew that this meant that the conversation was over. He turned off his phone and got up to find his black and white game console.

In the rain.

When the Tetris score had reached 200,000 points, the phone vibrated again.

Seeing the new message, Ji Yushi's expression revealed some confusion.

Cap Song: [Take care of your body.]

**The author has something to say:**

A long time later, Song Qinglan: It's still early. Once more time.  
(Essentially a slag man with double standards)

# Chapter 43: Chapter 43

## Who Am I

### Chapter 43

Take care of his body?

Did Song Qinglan know that he couldn't sleep well at night?

Or was it because he had showed too much weakness before, and Song Qinglan truly believed that he was very frail?

While Ji Yushi was pondering over the meaning of those words, Song Qinglan instead called directly.

Ji Yushi accepted the call. For some reason, after the call was connected, both of them were silent for a moment.

Ji Yushi didn't know what to say but Song Qinglan seemed to be waiting for something.

After confirming that it was quiet on Ji Yushi's end, Song Qinglan spoke first. His tone didn't sound great, "Advisor Ji, how did your mission report go?"

Ji Yushi: "Mission report?"

Song Qinglan stiffly made a sound of agreement and asked, "Is it inconvenient for you to talk now? I can't remember some details about our Ouroboros mission and want to ask you about it now."

There was only Ji Yushi and his cat at home, so it wasn't inconvenient.



Song Qinglan's attitude however didn't seem like an inquiry at all. If sounded like he would teach Ji Yushi a lesson if he dared to refuse. He right now seemed more like a stern captain than usual.

Ji Yushi, "Now?"

It was early morning.

Song Qinglan said, "Yes, now."

Although he didn't understand why Song Qinglan had to write the report in such a hurry, Ji Yushi couldn't sleep anyway so he agreed, "Alright."

Song Qinglan really began to ask.

Not to mention Song Qinglan, even for Ji Yushi, the mission report was difficult to write. The so-called 'Tianqiong of all eras' was difficult to explain but there were at least several experts in Tianqiong already analysing this. As for the appearance of the zombies and the energy sources, they weren't within their professional scope so there would be experts who would analyse them based on their mission reports.

The first problem facing the seventh squad was how they should describe the concept of a 'time anchor' in the report.

As mentioned before, the time anchor was something that had been banned a long time ago by the research and development team.

A necessary condition was set at a certain anchored time coordinate and once that condition is triggered, one would return to that anchored point in time. This would consequently lead to serious time paradoxes such as letting someone live forever within a certain period of time or letting a certain historical event never happen. It creates a time bubble along the timeline which in turn affects the normal progression of the original timeline.

So how was this banned method developed? How long had it existed for? And what kind of chain reaction will it cause?

These problems required Ji Yushi's memory to reproduce. They had to write every cycle they experienced in full detail.

That was the first problem. The second problem they faced was the countless colonies in the parallel universe.

They had limited understanding of PU-31 and they knew next to nothing about PU-18 except for their encounter with Big Beard. The most important thing the authorities wanted to know was the reason why Earth was destroyed.

Comparing these two problems, the last one about the time crevice was much easier to deal with.

Everyone knew very well that although the three-month vacation was said to be granted to give them time to recover, it was in fact to give everyone enough time to write that massive report.

Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi had to bust their brains to do it so Li Chun and the other study slags would probably end up in tears. If they knew that the two top students in their team had stayed up all night copying homework from each other, they would probably start to doubt life itself.

While conversing through the phone, the two opened holographic projections to make notes.

Even Ji Yushi noted down a few things to help himself sort out everything from beginning to the end. With that, even the most lengthy report in history shouldn't be too difficult to complete.

Song Qinglan stopped midway and asked strangely, "With us talking for so long, we won't affect the others?"

Ji Yushi said they wouldn't.

The phone call lasted for several hours. When they were almost done, it was dawn.

Outside the window, the early morning rays of light had started to peek through.

Looking at the clouds in the distance gradually turning brighter, Ji Yushi finally felt a trace of sleepiness.

Little Orange had returned to the bed. It's fleshy paw pad stepped over the bedsheet one after another, leaving little footprints, and then it rolled over to reveal its snow-white belly.

As Ji Yushi listened to Song Qinglan speak, he reached out and gently scratched its belly. He somehow remembered that Little Orange liked it when he did this.

Perhaps fatigue and sleepiness made it easier for him to talk.

Ji Yushi suddenly spoke up, "Cap Song, many things have changed around me."

Once started, the rest was much easier to say. He continued, "Say, do you think we're still in a time anchor and had never truly escaped from that world? Or are we in a new instance and had in fact never been successfully intercepted?"

After talking for so long, Song Qinglan's voice was a little different and it carried some hoarseness that belonged to the early morning.

He asked, "Why do you think so?"

In fact, Ji Yushi regretted it as soon as he asked.

They already knew that no matter how self-aware Tianqiong was, it was impossible for it to construct a seamless world and he couldn't even prove that the 'original' memory of his was real. If it was real, then everyone else's memories had been overwritten by the new timeline and he was the only one who remembered. He didn't know if he was lucky or unlucky.

Ji Yushi changed the topic and asked, "Cap Song, have you ever heard of 'brain in a vat'?"

Ji Yushi had learnt too many things and read too many books, so his knowledge was vast.

Song Qinglan couldn't keep up and, for a moment, he couldn't answer.

But Ji Yushi didn't seem to be needing him to answer. After asking the question, he didn't stop to wait and just ended the topic, "I'm sleepy, aren't you sleepy? We're almost done with the discussion so why don't we end it here. If you still have any questions or thoughts, you can call me any time."

Before Song Qinglan could say anything, Ji Yushi said "goodbye" and hung up.

Ji Yushi laid back on the soft bed and stared up at the ceiling.

On the other end, Song Qinglan rubbed his temples as he listened to the dial tone. He had no right dictating Ji Yushi's private life and apart from work he had nothing he could talk to him about. Even if it was talking about work, it was his first time talking to someone on the phone until sunrise.

Song Qinglan tapped on the virtual keyboard and searched the words: Brain in a vat.

This was a hypothesis proposed by a philosopher named Hilary Putnam.

Suppose a person had their brain taken out by surgery and is put into a vat that could keep it alive. People outside could manipulate the brain with devices to input the five senses, memories and even arbitrary codes to make the brain think that it was still alive and even feel what the manipulator wanted it to feel.

How would one tell whether they are living in reality or in a fantasy?

This hypothesis was similar to Zhuangzi's 'The Butterfly Dream'. If we delved even more deeply, the question was — Are we actually real existences? (KKnotes: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Zhuangzi\\_\(book\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Zhuangzi_(book)))

Song Qinglan lit a cigarette and took a deep drag. He then extinguished it.

He picked up his phone and was about to call Ji Yushi.

But he can't yet.

Having not slept all night, Song Qinglan went downstairs with bloodshot eyes. Father Song was already drinking morning tea: "Where are you going?"

Song Qinglan walked quickly, "I've been away for a month and haven't seen grandfather yet."

Father Song: "Going to Ning City?"

"Yes."

Outside the window, Song Qinglan strode across the lawn with his long legs, got in his car and drove off.

\*

Ji Yushi slept until the afternoon and then drove his black off-road car to the Ji residence for dinner.

As the familiar villa got closer and closer, the hyacinths and wisteria flowers in the courtyard were no different from what he remembered. There was a hand-carved rabbit placed in front of the porch. The knife skills were awkward; it was something he carved when he was a child. Walking in, the decorations were still on the windows. Those were the work of Aunt Su during Spring Festival. They had pasted them up together on the first day of the new year.

Everything in the house was the same.

Aunt Su walked out wearing an apron. She seemed to be cooking for him upon hearing that he was coming back.

As soon as she saw him, she felt distressed, "Jian Jian, why are you thinner? Did they not feed you at all in Jiang City?"

The familiar show of concern made Ji Yushi's heart soften, "Auntie."

The two embraced. Aunt Su patted her younger son on the back, "Teacher is upstairs. Having been gone for a month, he's not in a good mood. Be good and go and coax him."

Sure enough, Professor Ji was waiting in the study. Seeing him return, he didn't act like what Aunt Su and Ji Minyue had said and didn't talk much. As usual, he closed the holographic projection in front of him and pushed up his reading glasses. His first line was, "I heard Chief Lin say that you were in shock when you returned?"

The seemingly dangerous things the teacher and student pair did behind the backs of that mother and son duo had always been something the two knew very well about.

But this time, Professor Ji probably wouldn't be able to imagine how dangerous the mission was for Ji Yushi.

Of course, Ji Yushi wouldn't tell him either.

"It wasn't that serious." Ji Yushi's expression was calm, "It was just that the intensity was a little stronger and my body couldn't adapt. All the teammates had the same reaction."

"I heard that too." Professor Ji nodded. He didn't ask about the content of the mission and only said, "The people above are always true to their words. They will increase the points for this mission for you....I have received news that your mission may be regraded this time and it should be higher than A-level."

Ji Yushi knew what his teacher meant.

He was originally on 89 B-level missions. With an A-level mission added, it would add up to 99 points which was one step away from his goal. If this A-level mission was to be reassessed, he would easily reach his goal and the thing he had always wanted to do would be possible.

Professor Ji: “The day you go back and untie that knot in your heart, you should withdraw from Tianqiong.”

Ji Yushi was silent.

“Teacher.” After a while, Ji Yushi asked seriously, “If a person accidentally changes the past from a future world and then returns to the present, what will happen?”

Professor Ji wondered, “Without going back to the past, how could one change the past from the future?”

But it really happened.

“For example, people from different time periods were trapped at the same point in time and they unintentionally affected each other’s timeline, ultimately changing the past in a future world, and then they return to the present, “Ji Yushi said, “I know this may sound illogical, but if we assume that it is true — What would happen?”

“It’s too contradictory.” Professor Ji thought for a while and took off his reading glasses. He pinched the centre of his brows and said, “Since ‘history’ has changed, they will no longer be the so-called ‘present’. If it must be established, it will only produce a parallel world as a result of the butterfly effect. It wouldn’t make sense otherwise.”

In the quiet study room.

Professor Ji said, “Jian Jian, never change the past, never talk about the present and never be obsessed with the future; these three Tianqiong laws were something I watched your father write. No one in this world knows their meaning better than you. I hope you can untie that knot in your heart soon. Don’t become a prisoner of time.”

After dinner, he left the Ji residence.

Ji Yushi received a message from Song Qinglan.

Cap Song: [I found some information about “Wang Xiaoqian”.]

Ji Yushi's eyelashes trembled. Almost at the same time, he called Song Qinglan, "Cap Song? What information?"

Chief Wang didn't disappear?

That's great.

Song Qinglan said, "The information is incomplete and I'm not sure for the time being whether she is the Chief Wang you were talking about. Also, while I was reading through the information, I seemed to have also noticed the changes you mentioned."

Song Qinglan also noticed it?

Ji Yushi's grip around his phone tightened, "Then can I take a look?"

Song Qinglan asked for his address.

Ji Yushi subconsciously reported it and then found it strange, "Cap Song, why are you asking me this?"

Song Qinglan seemed to have laughed, "I'm on my way to Ning City."



# Chapter 44: Chapter 44

## Who Am I

### Chapter 44

Ji Yushi asked, “Why are you coming to Ning City so suddenly?”

“It’s not sudden.” Song Qinglan said, “I have been away for a month and should go and visit my grandfather.”

Ji Yushi asked when Song Qinglan would arrive and said, “I happen to be outside right now. I can come to the station to pick you up.”

The information about “Wang Xiaoqian” was very important to the current Ji Yushi. He didn’t think much about it and he also didn’t consider whether or not it was inconvenient for the other party.

In fact, Song Qinglan had driven his sports car at a super high speed as soon as he hung up that morning, so he had already arrived in Ning City. After arriving, he finally realised that they had been up all night and Ji Yushi may still be resting.

Thinking this, Song Qinglan resisted the urge to look for Ji Yushi and went to his grandfather’s place first.

He had also only just received the information and he sent a message to Ji Yushi as soon as he was done glancing through it.

He didn’t expect Ji Yushi to call back so quickly.

After the call connected, in order to avoid seeming too eager, Song Qinglan casually lied and said that he was still on the way.

So when Ji Yushi asked him this, he glanced at the time and lied, “I’ll arrive around eight.”

Ji Yushi started the car, “Then wait for me in the waiting lounge. I’ll head over now.”

After hanging up, Song Qinglan who was still at his grandfather’s place hastily cleaned himself up and drove to Ning City’s North Station.

He rushed the entire way and managed to park his car and reach the waiting lounge just before eight o’clock.

There were many people coming and going from the station, and there were a lot of people in the waiting lounge.

Song Qinglan glanced around and didn’t see Ji Yushi’s figure. Having confirmed that he hadn’t arrived yet, he breathed a sigh of relief. Immediately afterwards, his heart sank, and he quietly let out a curse.

Since when did he deceive others like this?

Was it really necessary?

Song Qinglan had never had this experience in the twenty-six years of his life. He had never felt anxious because of another person and had never felt the need to see someone with his own eyes in order to feel relieved.

Song Qinglan had noticed that Ji Yushi’s mental state wasn’t right.

He didn’t know if people with hyperthymesia have a tendency to overthink but the ‘Chief Wang’ mentioned by Ji Yushi was a discrepancy between his and Ji Yushi’s memory. The calm attitude after seeing Chief Qi, and the ‘brain in a vat’ mentioned over the phone, it was all quite negative. It was completely not like the state a person would be in after successfully escaping and returning to the real world.

For some reason, the scene of Ji Yushi opening the medicine box and taking a pill lingered in his mind.

In the park management office, the bookstore, outside the ward.....The chaos in Ji Yushi's memories were all curbed and controlled by those pills.

The other party's fragile face, his trembling eyelashes, as well as the unconscious groan he let out when the space capsule was sucked into the crevice, it all contrasted greatly with his logical, intelligent and rational appearance.

No matter how perfect the psychological evaluation report was for Ji Yushi, there was a saying that goes 'those that are too rigid, fold easily'. A human would breakdown if they stubbornly persist and endure past their limits.

It stood to reason that after the transfer was over, Ji Yushi shouldn't have any further connection with their squad with the exception for the mission report.

There would naturally be people caring about Ji Yushi's mental state and it was clear that there were no shortage of people who would do that.

But Song Qinglan couldn't help but think.

Since it was possible for him to have several relationships at the same time, it was also very likely that each one of them weren't serious.

So those people, would they really care about Ji Yushi?

“Cap Song.”

Song Qinglan only waited for a few minutes when he heard a calm voice sound in front of him.

He looked up and saw Ji Yushi's face.

They had only been apart for two days so there was naturally no change to Ji Yushi.

A simple white short-sleeved T-shirt that was similar to the one Song Qinglan found for him in PU-31 somehow made him stand out even more.

Just by standing in the waiting lounge, many people's eyes were drawn over.

What Song Qinglan noticed however, were the two faint shadows under the other person's eyes.

Song Qinglan stood up and said naturally, "You came so quickly."

If he drove a little slower, he would've arrived after Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi said, "I was outside when I called you, so I came directly."

The two walked out side by side.

In the hustle and bustle of the summer night in Ning City, cries of cicadas accompanied the intermittent waves of heat.

When the large black off-road car was revealed, Song Qinglan was quite surprised. He couldn't imagine someone like Ji Yushi driving such a domineering car.

Song Qinglan unlocked his phone, opened the information and handed it to Ji Yushi, "Take a look first. I'll drive."

Of course, this was what he had wanted. Ji Yushi had no objections, "Okay."

The car entered the traffic. Neon lights flashed in Ning City. Ji Yushi quietly looked through the information.

Wang Xiaoqian, female, 52 years old. Previously a professor in the Department of Quantum Physics at Capital University. The information reported that she was from the capital and also included some of her papers, essays and teaching subjects. Just like Song Qinglan had said, it was however not complete. Except for these, there were no photos and there was also no information about Tianqiong.

Ji Yushi searched Capital University on the internet. There was nothing about Wang Xiaoqian on the page with faculty staff.

“I have some connections.” Song Qinglan said, “Through the name you provided, I found many women with the same name and surname. After excluding some candidates with too large age gaps and different educational backgrounds, I ended up with this one. If it was really as you had said and Wang Xiaoqian was the chief of the Jiang City branch, this professor who taught quantum physics would probably be the closest candidate.”

Ji Yushi nodded. In this era, privacy was highly valued, so all databases were encrypted. It already wasn't easy getting all this information.

What he didn't expect was that Song Qinglan who had no impression of the 'Chief Wang' he mentioned still invested so much effort to investigate.

“They will send more detailed information later.” Song Qinglan continued, “You can confirm if it is her at the time.”

As he said this, Song Qinglan inadvertently glanced at Ji Yushi and was slightly stunned.

There was a bright red mark on Ji Yushi's neck.

This mark wasn't something Song Qinglan hadn't seen before.

If Li Chun went out to play for a few days before returning to the squad, he would have a few of these things on him too.

He originally wanted to ignore it.

But with that one glance, perhaps it was because the red mark on the extremely fair skin was too eye catching, he couldn't help but notice it.

Song Qinglan gritted the back of his teeth, “Ji Yushi, your neck. Pay attention.”

Ji Yushi was baffled. He pulled down the mirror in the passenger seat and took a look, “Forgot to close the window last night.”

No wonder he was scratching that place today. Turns out he was bitten by a mosquito last night.

Song Qinglan was silent for a while.

Ji Yushi wasn't very good at guessing other people's thoughts, nor was he good at handling interpersonal relationships. Song Qinglan helping him in private with gathering all this information already meant a lot to him.

He withdrew his gaze and gathered his thoughts together before asking, "You said on the phone that you also noticed some differences. What differences were they?"

"The last time I was in the Ouroboros mission, I realised that it was a cycle only when the woman on the street charged over."

Passing a traffic light intersection, Song Qinglan turned the steering wheel. His actions were very smooth, and it carried arrogance and haughtiness. It gave a strong sense that he was the one who suited this car more.

"I didn't remember anything at first and at most just had a feeling. After I realised that everything had happened before, the memory of the last cycle suddenly appeared in my mind. This was something I was very familiar with. When Old Zhou and I were participating in a witness of time program in the army, we had undergone memory enhancement training. It was very similar to having a key to a memory, but it was actually a subconscious hint. That is why, unlike Tang Le and the others, we could more or less remember what happened in the cycles."

After saying this, Song Qinglan's furrowed brows didn't relax. His heroic face seemed to have tightened even more, "I had no impression of Wang Xiaoqian's name before I read through her information but when I read some of her essays, I suddenly had a vague impression. I seemed to remember debating about some of those points and was eventually persuaded but in my current memory, the person I debated with was Chief Qi."

Ji Yushi was stunned, "Double memories?"

Song Qinglan also had double memories?

“One memory is relatively vague and the other is very clear.” Song Qinglan said, “But I don’t believe that we are in an illusion. What we are looking at is definitely reality, but it may not be our original reality.”

Ji Yushi had just left the Ji residence and Professor Ji’s words were still lingering inside him.

Hearing Song Qinglan say this, he couldn’t help but ask, “You also think that we have come to a parallel world?”

Song Qinglan remained silent and didn’t comment on the world ‘also’.

He continued to calmly drive the car, “If this is a parallel world, then there must be another us. Where did they go?”

These words struck Ji Yushi’s heart hard, making him fall silent.

This was a problem that had been troubling Ji Yushi. Coupled with his chaotic memory and the fact that it had only been a few days since his return, Ji Yushi’s state was already very bad and possibly even worse than how he was in the Ouroboros mission.

He was already very overwhelmed.

Song Qinglan, “The ‘brain in a vat’ theory you mentioned made me think about this question for a long time. I’m wondering, did we arrive at a parallel world or is this our original world and have we just acquired memories from another world? In other words, what is happening to us is the sequelae of travelling through time and space and the so-called double memories is actually us going mad?”

Am I the butterfly or Zhuangzi? *(KKnotes: This is another reference to the Butterfly Dream poem mentioned previously where Zhuangzi wondered if he was a man who dreamed of a butterfly or a butterfly dreaming of being a man.)*

How do people tell that something is truly real?

“And I finally reached a conclusion.” Song Qinglan said, “It’s actually very simple if you want to know the answer to these questions.”

The car had at some point in time reached Ji Yushi’s place.

Ji Yushi had originally thought that Song Qinglan would drive the car to his grandfather’s place and then he would drive back home. This would be considered as ‘dropping Song Qinglan off’.

But it seemed that Song Qinglan didn’t seem to have understood his intentions. Looks like he may need to drive out again.

But Ji Yushi didn’t have the time to worry about that right now.

Because Song Qinglan said to him, “The key to solving the problem lies with you. This time, I don’t want to discuss the mission report we need to give to the people above. I want you to tell me everything you remember from the moment you arrived at Jiang City, including Ouroboros, Chaos, and everything that happened after we were intercepted. If we look at the memories from a different angle and peel the skin off layer by layer, we will definitely reach the truth.”

The streetlamp outside illuminated Ji Yushi’s calm face. Only he himself knew how violently his heart was beating at this very moment, “My other memory? What if I make a mistake?”

“Anyone with overlapping memories can make mistakes but you won’t. Whether this is a parallel world or the aftereffects of traversing, Advisor Ji, your memory is the key for us to distinguish between the realities.” Song Qinglan said, “I believe in you.”

In reality and not in a mission. This line was spoken almost too straightforwardly.

The inside of the car was suddenly quiet for a few seconds.

Song Qinglan let out a light cough and said, “You can go up. I’ll take a taxi and go back to my grandfather’s place.”



And he had to also go back to the station to pick up his car.

Ji Yushi however asked, “Cap Song, can you go back tomorrow?”

Song Qinglan almost choked, “Huh?”

Was Ji Yushi inviting him to go up and stay over for the night?

Of course, he definitely didn’t mean it that way but wasn’t it a bit inappropriate for a straight man to stay overnight with a man whose sexual orientation was men?

Perhaps it was because of Song Qinglan’s hesitation, Ji Yushi belatedly remembered that the other party had PTSD towards getting close with a gay and felt that the other person may have misunderstood something. He undid his seatbelt, the red mark on his neck appearing and disappearing at the edge of his collar, “What I meant was———”

“Okay.” Song Qinglan smoothly got out of the car, “We shouldn’t leave it until it’s too late. If necessary, we can video call Old Zhou and the others to see how they are going.”

After he said that, he looked upstairs and narrowed his eyes, “Who’s home?”

Ji Yushi breathed a sigh of relief, “Just a cat.”

# Chapter 45: Chapter 45

## Who Am I

Chapter 45

Cat?

Ji Yushi also raised a cat?

But that wasn't the main point. Song Qinglan didn't want to run into other people. He confirmed it with Ji Yushi, "That's good. No one would come and find you, right?"

Ji Yushi was puzzled, "Who would come?"

Song Qinglan said, "Those three bo——"

He stopped. He felt that it wasn't appropriate using the term 'boyfriend' to describe those relationships, so he changed it to the term 'male friends'.

Song Qinglan originally thought the 'very clingy one at home' only referred to one and that was why Ji Yushi wasn't too keen on joining the Seventh squad. As a result, he didn't want to force Ji Yushi and wanted to let him make his own decision. If he was really reluctant to part and didn't want to join the Seventh squad, then so be it, but ever since he found out that it wasn't one but three, he knew that these relationships weren't healthy. Lin Xinglan from the ninth squad for example also had a very messy private life.

But Ji Yushi was different. With Song Qinglan here, regardless of whether or not Ji Yushi himself felt that those relationships were healthy, he couldn't agree with such a lifestyle.

Ji Yushi's pupils dilated slightly, "....."

Three male friends?

Song Qinglan spoke coldly, "No matter which one it is and how clingy they are, I don't recommend them coming over." After saying that, he glanced at Ji Yushi, "We will be pretty busy tonight."

Wait a minute. Ji Yushi seemed to have suddenly understood something, "Cap Song, did you think that I'm dating three boyfriends at the same time?"

Ji Yushi was shocked.

He recalled the various exchanges between himself and Song Qinglan and realised that some of the conversations may have caused some misunderstandings. But was Cap Song's imagination too good or were all straight men like this?

Did gays really have such a bad reputation?

Song Qinglan felt that this question was a bit strange. What did he mean by 'did you think'?

Ji Yushi stored away his shocked expression. He pressed his fist to his lips and seemed to be a little angry, but he also seemed to be holding back laughter, "Well, there were originally three but I was about to tell you this just now. My three 'boyfriends' have also changed into one."

Seeing Song Qinglan's lips pressed tightly together and expression stiff, his entire being seemed to exude reluctance to hear about homosexuality. Ji Yushi couldn't help but see prejudice on Song Qinglan.

He now believed his so-called homophobia.

"Three changed into one, and it's also a new one." Ji Yushi lowered his hand and spoke slyly, "I was a little unhappy at first and was reluctant to part with the original three, but with the additional memory, I remembered how I met this new one and how deep our feelings run and found that I still

like it/him very much. It/he has a sturdy build, a nice face, pressed down onto me last night until I almost couldn't breathe and would constantly ask for hugs." (KKnotes: Ji Yushi is saying 'it' but it/he/she all sound the same in Chinese.)

Song Qinglan knitted his brows, "....."

The steel straight man Captain Song turned around and left, "No need to tell me this."

Ji Yushi stood in place for several seconds. Song Qinglan however turned around and walked back.

Song Qinglan was more than 1.9 metres tall. With his tall height and long legs, he already gave off oppressiveness.

At this moment, his handsome and heroic face carried a bit of anger. As he walked towards Ji Yushi with a deep look in his eyes, Ji Yushi's heart missed a beat, and he couldn't help but take a step back.

What was Song Qinglan going to do?

Could he have taken it too far and evoked unpleasant memories of homosexual experiences?

In the quiet parking lot, there were only the two of them at this time. As soon as Ji Yushi took a step back, his back met with the door of the off-road car behind him.

The streetlights stretched out their shadows.

Song Qinglan stood in front of Ji Yushi and seemed to be gritting his teeth in attempt to control his emotions.

He lowered his eyes and looked down at Ji Yushi's face, "Can't you take care of yourself more?"

When taking medicine.

And the same goes for love.

He should take care of himself more.

Ji Yushi was speechless.

Before he could speak, Song Qinglan raised his hand.

“Bang.” A soft sound sounded behind his ear.

It was Song Qinglan’s fist hitting the roof of the car, as if to vent. Not much force however was used.

It was like the drum in Ji Yushi’s heart. It beated lightly.

Song Qinglan stood a bit further. The conversation topic had ended with this punch. He spoke impatiently, “Let’s go.”

Ji Yushi’s racing heart gradually calmed down. He heard himself say, “Okay.”

The two went upstairs together and ran into a neighbourhood aunt. The other party greeted them, “Xiao Ji, just returned from your business trip?”

Ji Yushi had moved out of the Ji residence before graduating from university and had bought this place to live in alone.

Although he wasn’t good at socialising, the neighbours’ children would often come to play with the cat, so they were somewhat familiar.

Ji Yushi politely answered yes.

The neighbourhood aunt looked up at Song Qinglan and smiled, “Is this your friend? He’s very tall and handsome.”

Song Qinglan looked at her. Probably because he wasn’t in a good mood, he didn’t lower his head much and answered arrogantly, “Thank you.”

Ji Yushi internally commented: Really not humble.

The neighbourhood aunt covered her mouth, “My, and a very nice voice too.”

Song Qinglan was now very satisfied, “You really can talk. No wonder you have a particularly friendly temperament. Does everyone in your neighbourhood have such good taste like yourself?”

The neighbourhood aunt, “Unfortunately not. Look at the greenery here and the lights. Those were all done by the developers. You get all sorts of people here. But when you look at Xiao Ji, who wouldn’t mistaken him as our representative? Hey, let me guess. Are you Xiao Ji’s boyfriend?”

Song Qinglan curled his lips, “I’m really not.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Alright. Song Qinglan had successfully brought him back to reality from a state of confusion.

Even if he had gone mad, he wouldn’t have imagined a conversation like this.

Leaving the elevator, Ji Yushi scanned his iris at the door to his place.

As soon as the white door opened, there was a ‘meow——’ and a soft orange object jumped down and started to act coquettish.

There really was just a cat.

As soon as Song Qinglan entered, the cat arched its back at him and started to hiss. He found it funny, “Does it mean that I’m not allowed to touch?”

Ji Yushi stepped forward to pick the cat up. He caressed it a few times to comfort it, “I usually don’t have many visitors, so it’s not used to seeing strangers.”

Song Qinglan found it regrettable. It seems that he had never met a cat that liked him.

While Ji Yushi brought the cat to another room, Song Qinglan looked around the house.

He had thought that Ji Yushi's place would be just as cold and distant like his personality or, like how Ji Yushi was in battle, the place would be filled with fierceness and determination.

But in fact, it was quite homely.

Dark brown solid wooden floors, a few hanging lights from who knows what century and, just like the rumours about Ji Yushi, a wall filled with paper books. If he bought any more, there probably wouldn't even be enough space for one to stand.

There was a blanket on a beige sofa and a pillow and the black and white game console which Ji Yushi cared for lying on the ground. It looked like they had been pushed onto the floor under certain circumstances, making a mess.

Combining the scene with the messages the two exchanged the night before, Song Qinglan couldn't help but make an untimely association. He quickly looked away.

Apart from that, there were almost no traces of another person living in this house.

Song Qinglan was reluctant to sit on the sofa and he also didn't want to stand around stupidly, so he walked around and found a picture frame hanging from the wall.

In this era, there were very few things like photos.

But just like the books piled up here, finding outdated things like photos here in Ji Yushi's place was unsurprising — In fact, it also made Ji Yushi's identity as a Recorder clear.

It was said that a Recorder will be rewarded after completing a mission and can make legal transactions to purchase their favourite historical item as

long as it didn't affect history. This was different from Guardians who don't get rewards and it often attracted their envy.

There were four people in the photo. It looked like a family of four.

Ji Yushi appeared to be only about fifteen or sixteen years old. He looked far less cold and indifferent. There were still some youthfulness in his eyes and he appeared quite well behaved.

If he was a little younger, he might've be mistaken for a young girl.

If the person who turned smaller during the Chaos mission was Ji Yushi....

“Cap Song.” Ji Yushi's voice sounded, “What do you want to drink?”

Song Qinglan walked over.

The layout of the place was quite neat, and it was accessible everywhere. It was as if it was designed to cater for cats.

Ji Yushi had managed to shut the cat away and he had also changed into a set of casual home clothes. At this moment, he was standing in the kitchen washing the cups. Because his head was lowered, the back of his pale neck looked long and elegant.

“Coffee, thanks.”

Song Qinglan said.

Ji Yushi placed the cup down and pulled out a grinder. He poured coffee beans in very skilfully.

Song Qinglan sat on a high stool with one long leg resting on the ground, “Let alone a housekeeping robot, there also isn't a robot in the kitchen. Even the coffee machine is semi-automatic, and everything is basically done yourself. Advisor Ji, you are very retro.”

Ji Yushi remembered something, “When we were selecting weapons on the PU-31 mission, you said the same. Why?”



At that time, they weren't very familiar. Ji Yushi had picked Diamond Bird and Song Qinglan had said the same thing.

Song Qinglan said, "Firstly, it was the rumours about the books at your place and secondly.....When I went to find you to train, I just happened to catch you slacking off. During a professional class, you not only didn't pay attention to class, but you were instead focused on playing Tetris."

So when Song Qinglan said that he was very retro back then, he was actually mocking him?

Song Qinglan became alert, "You won't note this down in your book, will you?"

Ji Yushi was speechless. He didn't have the time to go through old debts, "You went to find me to train?"

"Yeah." Song Qinglan recalled what happened at the time and found it very amusing, "At that time, I didn't know you well and didn't know that you needed to distract yourself, so I thought you didn't want to work hard and just wanted to be carried by the team."

Ji Yushi: "....."

So this was how the misunderstanding came about.

Ji Yushi made two cups of coffee.

Song Qinglan picked up one and poured some into the other, "Advisor Ji, it's already late. You should drink less. We need to have you well rested so that your mind is clear."

The shadows under Ji Yushi's eyes were quite obvious. Song Qinglan wasn't any better.

Song Qinglan took a sip. It was unknown whether it was a psychological effect but hand-ground coffee tasted more fragrant, "My highest record is not sleeping for three days. This is nothing."

Ji Yushi, “Four days.”

Song Qinglan, “?”

Ji Yushi tried not sleeping for four days?

Ji Yushi however didn’t continue the topic and similarly picked up his own cup of coffee, “Do you want to eat anything?”

Song Qinglan said, “No need. I had dinner on the train. It just didn’t taste very good.”

The high salaried chef hired by his grandfather would probably cry if he heard this.

Ji Yushi nodded, “Then we can start the discussion.”

Basing off his other memory, Ji Yushi explained in detail Chief Wang transferring him to Jiang City and how they were assigned to an A-level mission but was hijacked and forced to complete the Ouroboros mission and then the Chaos mission before being successfully intercepted by Chief Qi.

Except for the difference between the person who transferred him, another big difference between their memories was the Chaos mission: According to Song Qinglan, the Cap Qi they encountered in Chaos was the Chief Qi in his memory.

It was from here where Ji Yushi’s memories overlapped. It made it difficult for him to tell whether they were in a parallel world or a true reality.

Song Qinglan thought about it and said, “First, start with analysing your ‘original memory’. You said that when we entered the rainforest, we found skeletons of the Twelfth squad by a creek and then I told you that the Twelfth squad had already been missing for fifteen years.”

In his other memory, they had also found skeletons of the Twelfth squad by the creek but Song Qinglan didn’t mention anything about them being

‘missing for fifteen years’ and was just surprised to find the bones of his seniors there.

Ji Yushi’s head hurt a little, “Yes.”

Song Qinglan said, “Then, after destroying the mirrored rainforest world, Cap Qi appeared. Our memories divide here. You knew him as the Cap Qi who had been missing for fifteen years but to me, he was the younger version of Chief Qi.”

This was indeed the case in the overlapping memory.

Ji Yushi pursed his lips. A problem that normally would be easy to analyse and break down was at this moment rendering him confused.

Song Qinglan however was able to accurately sense this and spoke, “Regardless of whether or not there is that ‘missing for fifteen years’ incident in my memory, we can at least be certain about one thing. That is, the person who I believe is the younger version of Chief Qi was indeed once a member of the Twelfth squad, correct?”

Ji Yushi nodded his head like an honest child.

Song Qinglan turned on the holographic projection, “More importantly, there is that Xie Sian. We cannot ignore his existence.”

Ji Yushi watched Song Qinglan stretch out his finger and draw on the projection like he did in the past.

Song Qinglan said, “Xie Sian is the key for us. He wasn’t in the rainforest because he had accidentally entered the city after betraying his teammates and met us after he came out. Through comparing our time and his time, we can calculate whether there was indeed a fifteen-year time difference, yes?”

Ji Yushi replied, “Yes, you can say that.”

The roles of the two seemed to have changed.

This feeling was very strange. For the first time, Ji Yushi experienced the feeling of having his thoughts clarified and sorted by another person.

Song Qinglan may not be as good as him in making bold, unforgettable speculations and perhaps he also wasn't as good as him in terms of knowledge, but his logic was good, and his mental fortitude far exceeded others.

Ji Yushi held no doubts at all. Even if the result of their analysis was that he was experiencing the sequelae of travelling through time and space and were really going mad, he was certain that Song Qinglan would be able to calmly take him to the Tianqiong Medical Centre to receive treatment.

Song Qinglan narrowed his dark eyes, "Then——"

He wrote as he spoke, "Assuming that the time the Twelfth squad disappeared is point 'A' and the point where we arrived at Chaos is point 'B', regardless of whether we were sent out by Chief Wang or Chief Qi to complete the mission, there should be a fifteen-year gap between point 'A' and point 'B'. That is to say, in at least one reality, the 'missing for fifteen years' truly did happen. Now there's a problem. While the Twelfth squad was 'missing for fifteen years' and Chief Qi wasn't around, who was the one in power during that time?"

At this moment, Song Qinglan's phone rang.

He received an encrypted document.

The phone was still on projection mode, so Ji Yushi looked away, "Is it okay to look?"

If it was a private matter, it wouldn't be good.

Song Qinglan didn't have anything he didn't dare show others, not to mention, there was only one person who would send him documents at a time like this.

He spoke naturally, "It was originally sent to be shown to you."

Song Qinglan unencrypted the document and opened it.

On the holographic projection, both of them saw the contents.

It was a middle-aged woman in her early fifties. She wore a pair of pearl earrings and gave off a gentle temperament as she looked at the camera with a smile in her eyes.

In an instant, Song Qinglan frowned and unconsciously answered his own question.

Song Qinglan blurted out, “It’s Chief Wang.”

# Chapter 46: Chapter 46

## Who Am I

### Chapter 46

It was indeed Chief Wang.

The middle-aged woman in the photo was the one who was in power at the Jiang City branch for the past fifteen years.

Ji Yushi was certain of this because he possessed two memories at the same time.

As for Song Qinglan, just like what he said in the car earlier about the woman suddenly charging over being a key to his memory that allowed him to remember the previous cycle, something similar happened.

The moment he saw Chief Wang's photo, Song Qinglan's memories flooded back into his mind and his previously blurred impression of her became much clearer.

Like a slow-moving movie, these memories overlapped with Song Qinglan's current memories frame by frame.

The surge of information gave Song Qinglan a headache. From the moment he joined Tianqiong, another new memory emerged and his experiences over nearly a thousand days surfaced to his mind. All the individuals and events had changed but the opposing, originally existing memories hadn't disappeared.

“Cap Song!”

A distant voice was heard.

“Cap Song!”

The voice gradually got closer until it was right in front of Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan returned to his senses and saw that his elbows were on the table with his fingers supporting his temples and there was also a thin layer of sweat across his forehead. His breathing was light and quick.

He raised his head and was met with Ji Yushi’s concerned look.

“How are you?” Ji Yushi asked anxiously, “Why did you suddenly stop talking?”

As it turned out, this was the kind of pain Ji Yushi would typically go through?

It was worse than the sequelae following his first traversing. This was what it was like when one truly experiences memory overload.

Song Qinglan’s head felt like there were needles stabbing into it, “Fuck, about Chief Wang.....I fucking, remembered it all of a sudden.”

Ji Yushi was stunned, “You remembered?! Did you remember after seeing the photo?”

The pain made Song Qinglan a little irritable, “Yes! As soon as I saw the photo, I remembered everything.”

It was just like when Ji Yushi saw Chief Qi.

The kitchen was quiet for a while.

Having seen and experienced too many incredible things, the two at this time didn’t make a fuss about Song Qinglan’s suddenly acquired new memories and just needed some time to calm down.

If Ji Yushi didn't remember Chief Wang, Song Qinglan wouldn't have specially gone to find this information and they would have never noticed the problem with this world. Ji Yushi however just happened to remember it. Whether it was due to his hyperthymesia or something else, Ji Yushi was like a bug that revealed the discrepancies in this world.

Just imagine, what would've happened to them if there was no Ji Yushi around?

Where would they be?

What was going on?

After Song Qinglan remembered, he didn't waste any time talking about nonsense.

He tried to express his thoughts through his pounding headache, "So, in another reality, Chief Wang has been Chief Wang for fifteen years and was also the same person who sent us out on the mission. This is without a doubt. I believe that we can forget about figuring out which reality we are currently in as that is not the main issue here."

Ji Yushi understood what Song Qinglan meant, "Because no matter which reality we are in, we shouldn't have double memories!"

If it is said that it was due to a butterfly effect, the previous memories should've also been rewritten so no matter which reality they were in, only one memory should be retained. They however retained two.

Understanding this point may allow them to answer the question of why they haven't encountered their other self here if this really was a parallel world.

One self, two memories.

There must be a relationship between this.

Wang Xiaoqian's information hadn't been closed yet.



Song Qinglan scrolled through, “Advisor Ji, look at this.”

This document had more information about Wang Xiaoqian and it included her reason for resignation — Mild schizophrenia.

Ji Yushi was surprised. How could such a smart and wise Chief Wang get something like that?

Without waiting for him to think, the information on Chief Wang’s research project from when she was still working also drew his attention: Investigating timelines, the emergence of the bubble world.

Bubble world.

In the concept of a time anchor, the cycles one after another are the so-called time bubble.

It goes beyond the normal timeline, forming a world of its own, and if it was put into use, it would cause a serious time paradox.

Research into time anchors was strictly prohibited, but Chief Wang had conducted this research.

Ji Yushi’s line of sight fell back onto the word ‘schizophrenia’. A thought suddenly appeared in his mind: parallel world, bubble, schizophrenia....There seemed to be a light at the end of all this mist.

Amidst uncertain doubts, he heard Song Qinglan say, “Do you think Chief Wang also has double memories?”

Ji Yushi: “....I don’t know.”

Song Qinglan rubbed his temples and spoke in a low voice, “We might have to look for her. What do you think?”

\*

Song Qinglan made a few calls and contacted many people before finally finding Chief Wang’s whereabouts.

It was a nursing home in Jiang City. It meant that they had to return to Jiang City.

Having determined their next steps, it was now late at night.

Ji Yushi found Song Qinglan a new set of toiletries and prepared the guest room for him to stay in. This place was close to the school so Ji Minyue would occasionally stay overnight and use the guest room.

Song Qinglan entered the bathroom.

In the clean bathroom cabinet, there was only one toothbrush, one cup and one set of towels.

He couldn't help but wonder, did Ji Yushi not let his partner stay overnight?

He didn't know how the new partner was.

Ji Yushi was rather cold and aloof and liked to hold grudges. He seemed like the type who wouldn't hesitate to cut off relations if anything happened.

Song Qinglan washed his face with cold water. He was clearly lacking sleep, but he was still wide awake because of that cup of coffee. The sequelae of suddenly gaining another set of memories was still affecting him and his head hurt. He inadvertently noticed a basket of dirty laundry on the side.

When one enters another's living quarters, it was inevitable that they would see traces of that other person's life.

There weren't many things in that straw basket, only a set of clothes which had not had the chance to be washed along with a faintly exposed black fabric.

It was a pair of black underwear.

Suddenly, Song Qinglan's heart pounded heavily.

Probably because he had entered the other party's private space and he had caught sight of the other party's personal belongings, he couldn't help but recall the pale and slender waist he saw in the Tianqiong training room before they set off on their mission.

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth and waved away those memories. He washed his face again with cold water.

The feeling he had after hearing Ji Yushi's talk about his love life earlier returned. He felt a little irritable.

Song Qinglan could faintly sense that something was going out of control, but he couldn't put a finger on it.

Travelling thousands of miles from one city to another, was it just to help Ji Yushi clear up his thoughts and along the way figure out whether they were in a parallel world?

If it wasn't, what else did he want?

"Knock, knock."

The bathroom door was knocked.

Song Qinglan wiped his face with a towel and opened the door, "What is it?"

Ji Yushi revealed an awkward expression, "Sorry....."

He reluctantly revealed the truth, "My guest room is gone."

Song Qinglan was confused, "Gone?"

The guest room in Ji Yushi's original memory was gone. It had been vacated and there was nothing in it.

The two stood at the door of the empty room, speechless.

“I only remembered after opening the door. I once wanted to tidy up all the books and put them in this room and use it as a study.” Ji Yushi said, “But I didn’t expect that in this reality, I had already done it. After returning, I haven’t had the chance to check on this room yet.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

He suddenly had a bad feeling.

Ji Yushi, “Cap Song, can you sleep on the sofa?”

That messy sofa.

Song Qinglan’s face darkened several folds.

Ji Yushi thought he was dissatisfied with the arrangement of sleeping on the sofa so he reluctantly took a step back and offered, “Otherwise, if you don’t mind, you can sleep in my room. I can sleep on the sofa.”

He was the one who had invited the other party. Making them sleep on the sofa would be too rude.

But with Song Qinglan’s so-called PTSD, would he really be willing to sleep on his bed? Ji Yushi expressed his doubts.

Room?

That’s not much better.

Song Qinglan really did mind it.

Since he was already here, it was too late for him to leave. Song Qinglan could only compromise, “Forget it, I’ll sleep on the sofa.”

Ji Yushi accepted it and said, “Then, goodnight.”

Song Qinglan, “Goodnight.”

The atmosphere was a little strange.

They had known each other for so long but it seemed like this was their first time being so polite.

Ji Yushi never thought that they would still see each other again after completing the mission and that it would be in a situation like this.

Song Qinglan said, “Can you sleep well tonight?”

Ji Yushi, “Huh?”

What did he mean?

Song Qinglan looked down at him and suddenly smiled, “I didn’t seem to be of any help. I forced you to analyse the situation this time and the analysis was all about things you already understood. At best, it could be regarded as helping you organise your thoughts, but it was probably pointless. The only thing that was useful was that I also remembered Chief Wang, which at least proves that you aren’t crazy,”

Ji Yushi was slightly startled. He didn’t know how to answer, “.....”

Song Qinglan finally said, “Get a good rest tonight. Don’t think about anything. I will go back to my grandfathers place tomorrow morning and then we will set off to Jiang City.”

\*

After more than an hour, there were no sounds in the room. Ji Yushi had fallen asleep.

Song Qinglan laid on the sofa, looking up at the ceiling above him.

He couldn’t sleep. This world was far more complicated than he thought. He even wondered if they are currently in another mission set by another Tianqiong system.

Just the thought of that was scary.

In the darkness, something lightly jumped onto the sofa.

Song Qinglan sat up. He saw that it was Ji Yushi's cat.

It had at some unknown point in time escaped from the room Ji Yushi had confined it in.

The orange cat was hostile to Song Qinglan. It was hissing and baring its teeth and claws earlier but at this moment it just quietly stared at him.

It didn't make a single sound and seemed to be watching Song Qinglan like it would charge over and tear him to pieces the next second.

Song Qinglan sat up and looked at it. He narrowed his eyes slightly and noticed that something didn't seem right.

His tall height seemed to have a deterrent effect. Even the dog at home would tuck its tail in when it saw him, yet this cat continued to stare at him unblinkingly, its eyes glowing in the dark.

At this moment, the light from a tall building outside happened to sweep across the window, filtering into the room.

Song Qinglan noticed a dark shadow through the crack under the living room door.

His sense for danger had been developed over many years. Song Qinglan immediately got up barefoot and silently walked over.

He approached the door and looked through the peephole.

The emergency exit light in the corridor glowed green.

He saw the neighbourhood aunt they met in the elevator earlier standing outside. At this moment, just like the cat, she stared expressionlessly at Ji Yushi's door.

# Chapter 47: Chapter 47

## Who Am I

### Chapter 47

Early morning.

There was no one else in the corridor, and even the hustle and bustle of the city had become much quieter.

The neighbourhood aunt stood there motionlessly staring at the door. She neither spoke nor moved. She didn't look like she was about to knock on the door because she needed something.

But it was so late. Who would stand in front of their neighbour's house so silently at a time like this? Shouldn't they be sleeping?

In the dim light, Song Qinglan stood behind the door and watched the other party for almost five minutes.

He wondered if the other party was sleepwalking.

An unarmed woman wasn't much danger. After confirming that the other party wasn't going to do anything else, Song Qinglan checked the lock on the door and then turned back to the sofa. The cat was still sitting on the arm of the sofa, looking at him with a tilted head.

Song Qinglan reached out to rub the cat's head. It didn't hide or make a sound.

The atmosphere was indeed quite unusual.

Song Qinglan retracted his hand and fell in thought for a while. He then walked over to Ji Yushi's room.

He should check on Ji Yushi.

The handle to the bedroom turned and warm light flooded out.

Song Qinglan recalled that the rumours had not only said that Ji Yushi loved books, he was also very afraid of the dark so he never worked overnight shifts in the Ning City branch.

So did he usually sleep with the lights on?

Sure enough, there was a nightlight by the bed.

Ji Yushi entire body sank into the soft bed and half of his face was buried in the pillow. His expression under the warm light was relaxed and he appeared to be sleeping soundly.

The air-conditioning in the room was very low. Ji Yushi had a thin blanket covering him which rose and fell as he breathed.

The sleeping Ji Yushi appeared very fragile.

Just like how he was in the Chaos mission.

Ji Yushi at that time had been frozen cold and Song Qinglan had held him in his arms for several hours.

At this moment, something fluffy passed by his feet.

The orange cat was fat, but its actions were light and agile. Song Qinglan didn't even notice it coming over and only noticed its presence after it lightly jumped onto Ji Yushi's bed and curled up by Ji Yushi's neck.

It looked like everything was back to normal.

Song Qinglan didn't enter the room. He only stood at the door for several seconds before gently closing it and returning to the living room.



After this episode, the small amount of sleepiness Song Qinglan originally had was completely gone. He browsed through his phone for a while and saw that Li Chun had posted a new status.

Li Chun: [My girlfriend said I was wrong, so I must be wrong. There is absolutely no talking back [Dog head]]

Slag men really have a lot of tricks under their sleeves.

Just as Song Qinglan had this thought, he immediately backtracked — When did Li Chun have a girlfriend?

Before leaving for the mission last time, Li Chun had said that he hadn't had the chance to ask for the girl's number and he had expressed a lot of regret.

Song Qinglan sent a message to Li Chun whose mind was constantly filled with ridiculous thoughts asking him to contact him once he was up.

After thinking about it, Song Qinglan also sent a message to the rest of the squad with the content: [Contact me when you're up.]

These group of bastards all like to sleep in whenever they had the chance. Song Qinglan guessed that they probably wouldn't wake up very early, but he and Ji Yushi were also in a state where they didn't possess many clues, so it was nothing more than asking about the other party's situation.

\*

Early the next morning, Ji Yushi woke up.

There were traces of Little Orange sleeping next to his pillow. It seemed that it had sneaked into his room last night, but he hadn't noticed it at all.

It had been a long, long time since Ji Yushi slept so deeply.

He had clearly discussed a terrifying topic just before going to bed, but he didn't even dream. Could it be because there was an extra person in the house?

But, this kind of situation seldom happened even when Ji Minyue stayed over.

What surprised Ji Yushi even more was, as soon as he walked out of the room, he was greeted with the aroma of breakfast and coffee.

In the kitchen, Song Qinglan was frying eggs.

He was too tall, so the spacious kitchen appeared a lot smaller in comparison.

Ji Yushi was surprised, “You——.”

“Not going to my grandfather’s place for now.” Song Qinglan saw that he was awake and immediately said, “I booked the soonest train ticket. We will go back to Jiang City directly after breakfast.”

Song Qinglan had already washed up. It could be seen that he hadn’t slept well but he was still filled with energy. It was as if he would never be out of energy.

Ji Yushi actually wasn’t asking why he hadn’t left and had wanted to ask why he was cooking.

Song Qinglan poured the egg onto a plate, his movements very skilful. The fried egg was golden brown on the outside. It was clear that it was cooked just right.

Song Qinglan picked up a second egg with one hand and swiftly knocked it against the edge of the pan. The egg fell into the pan and sizzled loudly. The action itself was rather elegant. Despite being a man with such strong, domineering presence, he didn’t look out of place while cooking.

“Oh.”

Ji Yushi didn’t have the heart to tell him that the eggs were probably expired.

Ji Yushi lived alone and didn't normally cook. Those eggs were ones that he had left behind before he went to Jiang City. If you disregarded how long it had been there before he left, just his trip to Jiang City alone was an entire month.

The egg in the pan looked quite normal so as long as it was cooked, it should be okay?

Looking at the egg Song Qinglan had fried already, Ji Yushi found himself craving it a little.

The immunity and intestinal flora of the two full-grown adults should be enough to cope with these eggs. As long as they didn't eat too much, it should be okay.

Ji Yushi convinced himself.

And then.....he saw Song Qinglan fry up another five eggs in one go.

Ji Yushi: "....."

What a joke. Song Qinglan is 193 centimetres tall and weighs more than 90 kilograms. In fact, five eggs aren't enough to even fill the gaps between his teeth. If Ji Yushi's fridge wasn't so empty, he definitely would've cooked some more.

"With the three-month vacation, I originally planned to tour around Ning City when I have time." Song Qinglan chatted with him, "I didn't think that I would go back so soon."

Ji Yushi said, "In fact, there's nothing much to see in Ning City. Cities are all the same."

Song Qinglan, "It's not the same. I went to kindergarten for a few years here. This place has my childhood memories."

Ji Yushi, "Oh, the three-year drawing champion in kindergarten?"

It seemed that Ji Yushi really remembered everything, including his bragging.

Song Qinglan was noncommittal towards this teasing and joked, “Not only were there memories of being the drawing champion, but there was also my ‘first love’. I remember that there as a very pretty little girl in kindergarten at the time and we played really well together. When I left for Jiang City, she even cried.....”

Reaching this point, he looked up at Ji Yushi, “What’s that expression of yours? I can’t be charming as a child?”

Ji Yushi’s beautiful eyes were wide open as if he didn’t believe him at all.

As soon as Song Qinglan said this, he remembered that it wasn’t that he hadn’t turned smaller in front of Ji Yushi. The thought of himself wearing adult clothes and stumbling behind his teammates was so beautiful, he felt embarrassed for a while. He could only cough lightly and say, “Oh and I still remember her name. It seemed to be.....Han Han. I should look for her when I have the chance.”

Ji Yushi spoke mercilessly, “Then you probably won’t be able to find her.”

The eggs were now done.

Song Qinglan didn’t take that comment to heart. It was all just silly talk anyway.

He sat down and passed two eggs to Ji Yushi, “Advisor Ji, does your talkative neighbourhood aunt sleepwalk?”

“Neighbourhood aunt? Sleepwalk?” Ji Yushi placed the eggs back onto Song Qinglan’s plate, “What do you mean?”

Song Qinglan told him about what happened last night.

It sounded quite scary. Ji Yushi was also a little surprised. He had never noticed his neighbour sleepwalking. During those sleepless nights, he had

never thought about looking through his peephole to see what was going on outside.

This matter would be put to the back of their mind for the time being.

Song Qinglan had already checked again in the morning. The neighbourhood aunt was gone.

Ji Yushi asked, “So you didn’t sleep much last night?”

“Yeah, not used sleeping in a new place.” Song Qinglan used his fork to gently tap the edge of his plate. He looked at him with a faint smile, “You don’t even like to eat eggs?”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Song Qinglan pointed out, “You don’t like spam meat and you also don’t like eggs. Advisor Ji, you’re really hard to raise. It looks like no one has told you that if you don’t like something, you should speak up.”

Ji Yushi didn’t speak. It made it seem like it really was the case.

Song Qinglan added, “I’m not picky. I can get rid of anything.”

If he knew earlier that Ji Yushi didn’t like it, he wouldn’t have forced him to eat so much spam meat back at Big Beard’s space capsule.

Ji Yushi however just didn’t have the habit of voicing his likes and dislikes. He didn’t like spam meat, but he liked eggs. He hesitated, “I like it....I thought you were the one who didn’t like spam meat.”

Song Qinglan quickly replied, “I also like it.”

As soon as he finished saying that, the two fell silent for a moment.

It was just a discussion about food in the morning but why did it feel like it was an awkward beginning of the two slowly getting to know each other?

The strange thing was, they had clearly experienced countless life or death situations and have perfect tacit understanding of each other's thoughts, but the moment they returned to normal life, they realised that they actually didn't know anything about the other party. Except for the relationship between a squad captain and a temporary team member, they weren't even at a stage that could be considered as friends. In fact, he and Song Qinglan weren't familiar at all.

Ji Yushi didn't have many friends and he also didn't know how to take the initiative to maintain a relationship.

But he could feel that Song Qinglan was getting closer.

The suspected expired eggs were delicious and Song Qinglan's coffee was also very fragrant.

As he quietly chewed, Ji Yushi suddenly realised something — So in the space capsule, Song Qinglan was giving up those cans of spam meat for him?

No wonder Big Beard misunderstood at the time.

Ji Yushi quietly lowered his eyes. His grip around his fork tightened unconsciously.

These straight men, were they always so direct and sincere in the name of friendship?

\*

After finishing the homemade breakfast and while praying that they wouldn't get an upset stomach, Ji Yushi left his place together with Song Qinglan.

The two went downstairs together but ran into Ji Minyue at the base of the stairs.

Ji Minyue wore glasses and was holding a lead for his corgi.

Just like before, he seemed to be taking his dog for a walk and was stopping by Ji Yushi's place to check on him.

When the three met, Ji Minyue just stood there. He had his back against the sun, making it difficult to see his expression.

"Older brother?" Ji Yushi greeted and then told Song Qinglan, "My older brother."

Ji Minyue didn't move.

Ji Yushi walked over and was finally able to see Ji Minyue's face clearly.

It turned out that Ji Minyue was looking at him. He didn't appear to be curious about who the person beside him was and just said, "Old Ji wants you to go home."

Thinking that they were worried about him, Ji Yushi told Ji Minyue, "Cap Song and I have to go to Jiang City."

Ji Minyue only repeated, "Old Ji wants you to go home."

Ji Yushi for some reason felt a little uncomfortable, "Ji Minyue, what's wrong with you?"

Ji Minyue, "Old Ji wants you to go home."

From their meeting until now, he had repeated it three times. Ji Minyue's voice was very stiff and also somewhat mechanical.

When he spoke, his eyes stared at Ji Yushi and he didn't even blink. He was completely different from his usual demeanour.

Ji Yushi was pulled back by someone. He heard Song Qinglan speak to him, "Look at the dog."

The Corgi stood beside Ji Minyue. As a dog, it didn't have its tongue hanging out to let it cool down and it was doing the same thing as its owner, staring at them unblinkingly and without any other movement.

“It’s not sleepwalking.” Song Qinglan said, “Something isn’t right about your neighbour and the same goes for your older brother. Advisor Ji, have you noticed that your cat hasn’t made a sound at all this morning?”

As the two ate, the cat had jumped onto the breakfast table.

Ji Yushi thought it was interested in the fried eggs but, recalling it now, the cat only sat there and watched them.

Even when he added cat food to the automatic feeder before he left, the cat only sat far away, not making a single sound.

“We should go!”

Song Qinglan said this and the two quickly walked towards where the car was parked.

Ji Minyue led his dog and silently followed behind them. Even when Song Qinglan started the car, he continued to silently stare at them.

The off-road vehicle backed out smoothly. After a short pause, Ji Minyue pounced onto the glass.

With his familiar face close at hand, Ji Minyue mechanically said, “Old Ji wants you to go home.”

Ji Yushi had an urge to open the car door and follow Ji Minyue away.

Song Qinglan returned him to his senses, “Ji Yushi!”

Only now did Ji Yushi realise that he had placed his hand on the door handle. He was startled by this and quickly withdrew his hand. Song Qinglan continued to focus on driving.

As they got closer and closer to the exit of the community, Ji Yushi saw a very shocking scene through the rearview mirror.

Ji Minyue, the corgi, the neighbourhood aunt and her kids, as well as the community administrator, were all standing behind them.



They all stood there expressionlessly, quietly watching the car drive away.

\*

The car drove out of the complex and merged with the early morning traffic.

The city was full of traffic and the sun was bright. Everything seemed to be normal. It was as if that strangeness earlier was just their imagination.

But Ji Yushi knew that it wasn't.

What was going on?

Ji Minyue was his family, the neighbourhood aunt and her children could be considered as close acquaintances, and that community administrator had also once helped him find his cat.....These were all people who have a relationship with him.

"I called my grandfather's place this morning but couldn't get through." Song Qinglan said, "I tried home too, and no one answered. I thought it was just a coincidence but now it seems that something isn't right. I think these abnormalities are not only affecting the people around you, it's also the same on my end."

As if guessing what Ji Yushi was thinking, Song Qinglan who was driving provided information from his end.

Why was this happening?

Both of them were a little at loss.

"Do you still want to find Chief Wang?" Song Qinglan asked, "What do you think?"

Ji Yushi didn't hesitate, "Let's go."

Song Qinglan already anticipated this answer. He continued to drive the car quickly and steadily.

On the way, Song Qinglan received a call from Duan Wen because of the message he had sent last night.

“Cap Song.” Duan Wen’s voice was very low. His tone sounded a little different from usual, “Is it not convenient for you to talk now?”

Song Qinglan said, “I am with Advisor Ji.”

Through the communicator in the car, Duan Wen seemed to be shocked. Why were these two together again?

But knowing that Ji Yushi was also there, Duan Wen opened up and quickly and nervously spoke, “Fucking hell, I think I’m going crazy.”

“Cap Song, do you remember the tree in my backyard? The one I planted on my twenty-fifth birthday?” Because he was too excited, Duan Wen forgot to leave out the profanities, “I made a wish that day that I would get married when I turn thirty-five and by that time, I would be able to put up a swing on the tree for the child. Yesterday, while I was putting up a swing, I suddenly fucking remembered....What child?”

Duan Wen’s voice was trembling, “But I really did have one. It’s a daughter, and very cute. My wife is from the Jiang City branch research team and we’ve known each other for five years but I clearly remember pursuing her only to be rejected and was even later invited to her wedding.....What’s going on? In my current memory, that wedding was for me and her. I’m wondering if I’m going crazy. Did the time and space hijacking leave me with such a serious sequela?”

The expressions of the two in the car changed.

Although it didn’t make sense, it was something they expected.

Song Qinglan comforted calmly, “Don’t panic. We also have similar symptoms.”

Duan Wen was stunned, “This damned thing. It’s not a blessing to share so how can I not panic?”

“Brother Wen.” Ji Yushi spoke up, “Cap Song and I are guessing that this situation is likely caused by the overlapping of two memories.”

Ji Yushi’s voice was cold and clear. Every time he analysed something, the listener was able to quickly settle down and pay attention. Although he and Song Qinglan currently also didn’t have any clues, Ji Yushi was able to use a simple explanation to let Duan Wen understand the current situation.

Duan Wen asked, “Then what do I do now?”

“I have some documents here that I will send to you later. See if you remember anything when you look at it.” Song Qinglan was referring to Chief Wang’s information. He then continued, “You should contact the others and learn about their situation. Advisor Ji and I are on our way back to Jiang City.”

The call ended.

Ji Yushi sent the documents over to Duan Wen.

There was a traffic jam on the road. When they arrived at Ning City North Station, they didn’t have much time.

Fortunately, both of them were tall and had long legs. They headed straight for the station without stopping after parking the car.

There were many people coming and going at the station. Passengers from all over the place gathered there. It was always in a busy state.

Crossing through the parking lot and the lobby, Song Qinglan noticed that there would occasionally be some unfamiliar faces stopping and staring at them.

Ji Yushi quickly retrieved these faces from his memories.

It seemed that these people who had stopped to look at them were people he had at one point interacted with.

There is a term called six degrees of separation.

The meaning for it was that, between two strangers, at most every sixth person would be someone they know. It meant that no matter who it was in this world, they would be no more than six social connections away.

Passing by each other in the same city or catching a glimpse of each other at a certain place, the world was both big and small. Even if it was not as exaggerated as the so-called six degrees of separation, these people here still had some form of connection.

Ji Yushi followed Song Qinglan and crossed through the crowd.

Suddenly, someone grabbed his clothes.

Ji Yushi looked back. It was the cleaning staff.

Having passed through this lobby several times in the past, he had once helped the cleaner pick up rubbish from the ground.

At this moment the cleaner had grabbed him, but he didn't speak. There were no emotions in his dim eyes, as if his task was just to stop him from moving forward.

Ji Yushi only stopped for a moment when five or six people appeared from behind the cleaner.

They stepped out of the crowd and stared at Ji Yushi without blinking, just like how it was with Ji Minyue and the neighbourhood aunt. They approached him silently and seemed to be wanting to encircle and trap Ji Yushi.

The other people passing by seemed to not notice anything.

Facing such a group of people with expressionless faces, it made one feel like they were in a nightmare.

“Ji Yushi!”

Song Qinglan very quickly discovered that Ji Yushi wasn't behind him. He returned and grabbed his hand.

In just those short seconds, cold sweat had formed on Ji Yushi's palms. He suddenly returned to his senses, "Cap Song!"

There were more and more people. From the initial five or six, there were now a dozen or so people.

These people formed a human wall, blocking their way to Jiang City.

Song Qinglan's expression was solemn, "Let's go!"

Ji Yushi followed Song Qinglan out of the encirclement. The two walked very quickly.

Song Qinglan unceremoniously pushed away the people circling them. He was strong and was able to knock them away with ease to create a path, but they still continued to follow them at the same pace.

Their IDs were verified at the ticket gate and the two finally entered the platform.

They had moved swiftly enough. Those people couldn't take the suspended train without a ticket so they could only stand behind the glass windows outside the platform.

Being watched from behind by such a group of people, it felt like even the speed of the train had slowed down.

On the platform, the passengers waiting for the train chatted cheerily, forming a sharp contrast with the strangeness behind them.

Whilst stuck in this reality that didn't seem like a reality, the train finally arrived.

They boarded the train. Because of the angle, those people could no longer see them.

Along with the sound of the wind whistling, the suspended train began to move. Ji Yushi saw from the distance that the people by the window seemed

to have suddenly come back to life. Each of them regained normal, vivid expressions and slowly scattered away.

# Chapter 48: Chapter 48

“What happened to you just now?” Song Qinglan asked.

“I don’t know.” Ji Yushi restored his gaze. His heart was still pounding. He didn’t understand why he had subconsciously followed those people earlier.

If it weren’t for Song Qinglan, he probably would not have been able to board this train.

The two sat down in their seats and the train rumbled on, throwing the strange scene back at the station far, far away.

Song Qinglan had purchased the tickets in a haste so there were only tickets for ordinary carriages available. The carriage at this moment was quite packed with almost no vacant seats left.

People chatted as they stored their luggage away. No one seemed to notice the two young men who were still recovering from a state of shock. There would sometimes be people glancing at them but that was because of their overly eye-catching appearance.

From the neighbour standing outside Ji Yushi’s door early in the morning to Ji Minyue’s appearance and the human wall formed at the station just now, it seemed that a certain part of the world had been touched on by them overnight and it was likely a critical part.

Ji Yushi felt an uncomfortable gaze again. He turned around and saw a male passenger with glasses staring at him.

He looked back at the other person for several seconds, but the other party showed no signs of looking away.

Despite the hustle and bustle in the carriage, Ji Yushi couldn't relax.

It was even like this on the train.

He attempted to recall where he had met this male passenger, but it was to no avail. His mind was blank.

Song Qinglan said in a low voice, "No need to think. He should be looking at me."

Ji Yushi turned back. There was some confusion in his eyes along with some traces of panic — Ever since they met Ji Minyue, Song Qinglan had noticed that Ji Yushi didn't seem quite right and his mental state didn't appear to be very good.

This kind of abnormality, let alone Ji Yushi, even someone as confident as Song Qinglan held doubts about the reality they were in.

The two had originally thought that they had found a key clue from Chief Wang's end but they were now encountering something like this. It clearly told them that this wasn't a simple case of a parallel world or overlapping memories.

Ji Yushi had unconsciously grabbed the armrest until his joints turned white. When he heard Song Qinglan's words, he finally relaxed his grip, "Looking at you?"

Song Qinglan sat to Ji Yushi's right. He was too tall and too conspicuous of a target.

He adjusted his sitting posture and lowered down so that the back of the seat blocked him from the other person's line of sight. Sure enough, the other person immediately turned around and started doing his own thing as if nothing had happened.

"I'm thinking that these people who stare at us must have some form of connection with us. If it's not you, then it's me. This place is the city where



you live so there are more people looking at you.” Song Qinglan said, “I have probably seen this person somewhere before, but I don’t remember.”

Song Qinglan didn’t seem to be affected much by this and the tone of his speech was the same as before.

He was the same when they were trapped in Runjin Building by the zombies and when they were trapped in the space capsule in the crevice. He seemed like he would never be troubled when put into a difficult situation and that his determination would never be shaken.

What others didn’t know was that Song Qinglan was only like this because he didn’t want to make the other people around him feel more at a loss.

He stretched out his arm, “Pinch me.”

Ji Yushi was confused, “Why?”

Song Qinglan said, “Pinch me to see if it hurts. If it hurts, it’s not a dream.”

Ji Yushi told him, “Cap Song, in fact, there is no scientific basis behind tha  
\_\_\_\_”

Song Qinglan just raised a brow. He proceeded to unceremoniously pinch himself and let out a low groan, “Fuck.”

Perhaps it was because he found it childish, even he himself was speechless. He spoke with a straight face, “Hurts. Alright, regardless of whether or not it has any scientific basis, it has been proven that we are currently not dreaming. Just trust me.”

A cabin attendant robot pushing a service cart passed by.

Song Qinglan got a cup of warm water for each of them.

It made sense to drink more hot water.

Ji Yushi recovered after drinking and his mind came online again, “Since our return, this is my first time encountering something like this. What

about you?”

Song Qinglan said, “It is also the first for me.”

Ji Yushi frowned while deep in thought, “You said that the neighbourhood aunt stood outside my door early in the morning, but when we ran into her when we returned, she was still normal. My brother also met me yesterday and there was nothing out of the ordinary. Why on earth——” He suddenly stopped. His eyes moved to look at Song Qinglan, “Cap Song, I think I know now.”

Song Qinglan might have already guessed what he was going to say but he didn’t interrupt him.

For some reason, he looked forward to seeing Ji Yushi brainstorming and sorting his thoughts out. This calm and rational Ji Yushi would often be able to grasp the crux of the problem with one glance.

“It should be related to Chief Wang.” Ji Yushi said, “I was originally the only one who had memories of this, and it wasn’t enough to affect this reality but you managed to find her information and you similarly gained another memory yourself.”

Song Qinglan listened quietly.

Ji Yushi continued, “Last night, we discussed going to find Chief Wang because we found her approximate location —— If Chief Wang also has double memories, then she is a similar variable like us. To us, it would be proof of the two realities co-existing. The closer we get to her, the closer we are to the most contradictory point of the two realities.”

Song Qinglan asked, “That is, since we decided to find Chief Wang, it has resulted in these.....reactions?”

Song Qinglan didn’t know how to describe these strange happenings but it was enough for Ji Yushi to understand what he meant.

The air-conditioning in the carriage was strong, making Ji Yushi a little cold. He held the cup in his hands to warm himself up, “Yes.”

Song Qinglan frowned, “Why is there such a reaction?”

Ji Yushi said, “I don’t know yet, but I have a vague guess. Do you know about the double-slit experiment?”

Song Qinglan nodded, “I’ve heard of it.”

“In the double-slit experiment, a single electron passes through a partition with two slits resulting in an interference pattern on the screen. Just like the single electron passing through the two slits at the same time, some people think that this phenomenon is proof of the many-worlds theory. Suppose a single electron passes through the slit on the left, in another world, the electron passes through the slit on the right. The two worlds could feel each other’s projections and the electron passing through the two slits at the same time interferes with itself, resulting in the interference pattern.” Ji Yushi said, “This is one of many conjectures about parallel worlds.”

Since acquiring time-travel technology, the theory of parallel worlds had been confirmed so Ji Yushi only briefly talked about it and jumped to the main point.

“What I wanted to talk about was something strange about the double-slit experiment. In order to understand how the interference patterns are formed after electrons pass through the double slits, people have tried to use equipment to observe the process of electrons passing through the slit, but when they tried to do it, the interference patterns that appeared on the screen was gone. After electrons passed through the two slits, only two parallel lines were left on the screen. The strange thing was that when the equipment was turned off, the original interference pattern returned. It was as if the electrons have their own thoughts and knows when people are observing it and can change its trajectory at will. In other words, human observation actually affected how electrons moved, changing the results of the experiment.”

So much information required time to digest.

Song Qinglan thought for a while and said, “So, you want to say that our current situation is related to this ‘observation’?”

“It’s just a preliminary guess using the double-slit experiment as an analogy. It might not necessarily be because of this.” Ji Yushi lowered his head to drink. His eyelashes were long and thick. “For example, our act of going to find Chief Wang, would it be considered a kind of ‘observation’? Just like when the electrons are observed, our behaviour affects how this reality works, resulting in self-interference.”

“I think I understand.” Song Qinglan didn’t dare say that he understood well because he felt that he would never understand how much knowledge was contained inside Ji Yushi’s mind, “Those who are in some way connected to us in this reality may all be affected by this interference so when they see us and see that we are ‘observing’, they would interfere with us.”

This may be the reason why they were suddenly encountering such abnormalities.

Right now, they had only made the decision to find Chief Wang and it was only the beginning. If they continued down this path, met Chief Wang and was able to thoroughly understand the contradictions in this world, what would happen then?

Neither of them spoke for a long time.

The world in which they are in, even if it was a parallel world created by a butterfly effect, these people here are all real human beings, not zombies without thoughts and souls. As they get closer and closer to Chief Wang, the interferences will definitely intensify. What should they do when the time comes?

Ji Yushi’s phone rang.

He looked down. The display name was: “Teacher”.

When Ji Minyue appeared in the morning, he kept on saying “Old Ji wants you to go home”. What was this phone call about?

Song Qinglan didn’t like to invade into other people’s privacy and just asked, “Answering?”

Ji Yushi hesitated for a moment. He placed down his cup and brought the phone to his ear after selecting the answer button.

Please read this from kk translates

“Jian Jian.”

It wasn’t the dull mechanical tone he had expected to hear. Professor Ji’s tone was as amiable as it was at dinner last night.

Ji Yushi breathed a sigh of relief, “Teacher.”

Professor Ji didn’t mention anything about him coming home nor did he mention Ji Minyue. He just told him over the phone, “The thing I told you about last night. The result is out. Your mission rating is S.”

So fast?

Ji Yushi was a little doubtful.

They hadn’t submitted their reports yet, but the results were already out?

Song Qinglan next to him noticed that his breathing was stagnant. He used his eyes to ask him what was going on.

Ji Yushi however heard Professor Ji continue on the phone, “With the S-level mission added, you don’t need to work on getting more points anymore. They will give you a physical examination this afternoon. If you have recovered well from the last mission, you can go back to that day tomorrow.”

Ji Yushi, “This.....afternoon?”

Professor Ji's phone was taken away by another person. The other person's voice was very familiar. It was Chief Lin from the Ning City branch.

"Xiao Ji, congratulations." Chief Lin said, "How about it? My suggestion for you to assist the Jiang City branch wasn't a bad one, right? You have now gathered all the points and have passed the psychological assessment. You have proved yourself with your own strength. The people at the top have approved my application. The day you have been waiting for more than ten years is finally here! I will wait for you at the branch this afternoon!"

Ji Yushi: "....."

Even after hanging up, Ji Yushi was still a little lost in his thoughts.

Song Qinglan asked, "What's wrong?"

Ji Yushi turned to look at him. He seemed to be slowly returning back to his senses and proceeded to shake his head, "Nothing."

Song Qinglan was curious, "Why did your teacher call you?"

Ji Yushi, "Just some study matters."

Outside the train, the sky was blue and picturesque.

At a speed of more than 500km/hr, the objects outside passed by as blurry images.

The window reflected Ji Yushi's profile including his long neck and beautiful, clear eyes.

He seemed to be looking outside but he also didn't seem to be doing that.

After a while, he turned around and said to Song Qinglan who was still deep in thought, "I want to go to the bathroom."

The train had already made an announcement that it was about to arrive at a small station between Ning City and Jiang City. There most certainly would

be many people coming and going when the train stops and, perhaps, they would meet people with some form of connection to them.

Song Qinglan felt that now wasn't a good time, "Now?"

Ji Yushi bit his lower lip, "In fact, the eggs this morning seem to have expired. I feel a little uncomfortable."

Song Qinglan, "....."

Ji Yushi stood up and walked towards the bathroom. Before leaving, he even added, "But it was delicious."

Song Qinglan felt a little attacked. This was his first time making something for someone other than his family.

As for expired eggs, why didn't he notice it?

But it was early in the morning and for some funny reason, he was too embarrassed to knock on Ji Yushi's door to ask which ingredients could be used so he acted on his own accord.

Delicious?

Song Qinglan looked out the window and noticed that the corners of his lips were raised slightly.

Quite silly looking.

He fixed his expression. The palms of his hands were a little hot.

A minute later, the train slowly came to a stop.

Ji Yushi still had not returned.

Passengers came and went. Song Qinglan checked his watch. Another three minutes had passed. Ji Yushi seemed to be taking a while.

It wasn't until the announcement sounded that Song Qinglan suddenly recalled something — Ji Yushi's expression when he lied. It wasn't his first time seeing it so why did he fall for it just now?

He stood up and quickly strode over to the bathroom. There was no one inside!

The train door was closing. Song Qinglan hastily reached out to pry the door open. His hand was severely jammed for a moment and a sharp alarm rang. The anti-jam mechanism turned on. Song Qinglan ignored the alarm and the other people's complaints and quickly got out, his eyes searching for Ji Yushi's figure on the platform.

As a Recorder who had travelled numerous times to the past for his missions, even if he does not rely on wearing a mask to change his appearance, as long as Ji Yushi wanted to, he could minimise his presence to an absolute minimum.

Song Qinglan however spotted his thin figure in one glance.

— Ji Yushi was currently striding through the crowd, heading towards the station exit.

“Make way!”

“Make way, thank you!!”

Song Qinglan squeezed through the crowd and chased after him.

Among the crowd of people, several of them paused with a blank expression and stared at Song Qinglan.

But Ji Yushi had no obstructions. As if they knew that he had changed the course of his actions, no one stopped him.

Entering the lobby, Ji Yushi's back figure paused slightly. He knew that Song Qinglan had followed but he didn't look back.



Ji Yushi only continued walking forward. When he passed by an empty seat, he even had the time to throw the empty water bottle on the seat onto the ground.

Song Qinglan's expression was as cold as frost. Relying in his tall height, he walked very quickly.

He pushed the unfamiliar faces that continued to flood towards him as he moved through the crowd with difficulty and very soon, he was about to reach Ji Yushi.

Please read this from kk translates

Suddenly, there was a commotion in front of Song Qinglan.

Someone had stepped on the empty water bottle Ji Yushi had thrown and had fallen, colliding into another person hurrying along with a suitcase in the process. That suitcase had wheels and it lost control as a result of that accident, hitting a garbage cleaning machine and knocking over a cleaner.

It was like Ji Yushi had eyes growing on the back of his head. Relying on his superhuman memory of the environment and precise calculation, he was able to bypass all of this chaos.

He walked very quickly. When he turned a corner, he however found himself suddenly pushed against the wall.

It was a position similar to the last time in the bookstore. Even the angle in which his hand was restrained was similar.

Those big hands clamped down onto his wrists, restraining it behind his back. When the actions of this Guardian reached the eyes of the other passengers, it looked like he was arresting a criminal.

“Advisor Ji.” Song Qinglan behind him almost said that through gritted teeth. He said sternly, “What are you doing?”

Ji Yushi however didn't panic. He only said quietly, “Let me go first. My hand hurts.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

Fuck.

Can’t you use a different trick?

Song Qinglan was the one whose hand hurt. The back of his hand and his palm had turned bruised and swollen from being jammed but he didn’t have the time to worry about that. Right now, he just wanted to know why Ji Yushi did what he did.

Song Qinglan didn’t release his hold of Ji Yushi completely and only loosened his grip. He pressed his hands against the wall to prevent Ji Yushi from escaping, “Care to explain to me what’s going on? Did you suddenly think of something else you need to do but cannot say, or is it because you have another idea?”

Apart from anger, Song Qinglan still did not show any doubts or suspicions towards Ji Yushi.

It was a very rare form of trust.

Ji Yushi turned around.

Song Qinglan’s dark eyes stared fixatedly at his face and he felt his heart in his chest fall.

Ji Yushi’s current expression was one that Song Qinglan had never seen before.

He didn’t joke and say that Song Qinglan was ‘wall-slamming’ him nor did he answer Song Qinglan’s question. He just asked, “Cap Song, no matter which reality we are in, do you think it makes a difference?”

Just now, they were working on putting the clues together and discussing the double slit experiment that he couldn’t understand much of. Why did he suddenly give up?

Song Qinglan didn't understand but his intuition told him that it had something to do with that phone call Ji Yushi picked up, "Of course there is a difference!"

Ji Yushi raised his eyes, their gazes now meeting, "If you can get everything you have ever wanted in this reality, why bother returning to the other reality?"

The two stood very close. It was so close, Song Qinglan could see the colour of Ji Yushi's eyes.

Ji Yushi looked back at him both coldly and calmly. He said, "Since there is only 'me' in any reality, then it doesn't matter who 'I' really am."

For a moment, Song Qinglan felt that what he had said made a lot of sense.

But he quickly returned to his senses and didn't follow Ji Yushi's train of thought, "You're thinking with too much idealism. Of course it is important which reality we are from, it's not enough just doing whatever you want. In our original reality, there are still many people who care about us and love us. Losing us would make them sad. We must return to our real world because that is where we truly should be."

Ji Yushi said, "I don't have that kind of reality."

# Chapter 49: Chapter 49

## Who Am I

### Chapter 49

Ji Yushi's reaction was very weak. He had said that line without any hesitation, as if it was something he had thought about thousands of times inside and there was no burden for him to say it at all.

It was too abnormal.

It wasn't like the usual Ji Yushi.

Song Qinglan's voice now carried a trace of anxiety, "Why don't you? You have parents, colleagues, friends and also your older brother — Didn't we run into him earlier?"

As the two confronted each other, it was like Ji Yushi was caught between something. Every part of his body was stiff and even his breathing was shallow.

Hearing that question, his eyelashes trembled slightly. His expression however remained the same.

He was clearly a little shaken.

Seeing his reaction, Song Qinglan said again, "Otherwise, you also have people you are in a relationship with. If you're gone, what will happen to them?"

Three turning into one, it really wasn't something a straight man could bear to listen to.

Song Qinglan felt that it didn't seem appropriate. This example wasn't good enough.

He paused and quickly skipped over the topic. He tried his best to focus on the main issue, "Everyone has a reality that truly belongs to them and everyone has a life that belongs to them. Think about it, do you really not have a single thing you want to accomplish in your real reality? For example, your dream or something you have been pursuing for a long time? If you give up now, what will become of those years of hard work——"

His words reached an abrupt stop here. Song Qinglan was left stunned because Ji Yushi's eyelashes trembled slightly, and a tear slipped down at an extremely fast speed.

Song Qinglan had never seen anyone's tears fall so fast and so straightforwardly.

Along with the shock, his heart squeezed tightly, sending pain throughout his chest.

Song Qinglan only now reacted. What did he mean by there was no such reality?

Was Ji Yushi's life not as happy as he had imagined?

Such extremely pessimistic words were spoken by Ji Yushi himself. It meant that it wasn't just an emotional outburst and likely a fact.

He had clearly been the one who was inexplicably thrown away and he should be the one feeling angry and wronged but after Song Qinglan realised this, he felt at loss. For the first time in his life, he couldn't form a proper sentence and even felt a little panicked.

He raised his hand and then lowered it back down.

Song Qinglan was frustrated. Dammit, why hadn't anyone taught him how to comfort someone?!

Ji Yushi actually wasn't crying.

Those tears were physiological. Like a handful of snow on a pine leaf shaken off by the wind and disappearing the moment it falls onto the snow below, it was only a drop and that was it.

Compared to crying, it was more like an instinct.

For some reason, despite being so close, Song Qinglan found that he couldn't just reach out to touch Ji Yushi's face and he couldn't wipe away Ji Yushi's tears.

It was as if, as long as he touched Ji Yushi, something would completely shatter.

Ji Yushi's eyes that appeared translucent under the light just continued to look at him.

Those eyes were wet, but they were colder than ever before. Ji Yushi said, "Here, I can have everything I want."

Song Qinglan, "But you don't belong here!"

Ji Yushi, "It doesn't matter which reality I'm in."

He had been bewitched.

"Ji Yushi!"

Song Qinglan couldn't hold back anymore, He wiped away the inconspicuous tears with his thumb. He didn't know why his hands felt hot. Even the tips of his fingers trembled slightly.

He seemed to have understood something but right now wasn't the time for Song Qinglan to think about it. He only said in a deep voice, "It's very important!! Who you are is very important! Even if you don't have that kind of reality like you said, you still have us. Me, Chun'er, Duan Wen.....The six people in the seventh squad are waiting for you. You can't have your heart disturbed by that one phone call, it's all fucking fake——"

One phone call.

Those words entered Ji Yushi's ears.

In an instant, his pupils dilated slightly and, gradually, his entire body visibly relaxed.

“Fake.”

He said.

The tense string in his mind had broken off. Ji Yushi gradually returned to his senses. As if he had lost all strength, he fell onto Song Qinglan's shoulder, “Cap Song, it's that phone call.....”

Song Qinglan who had unexpectedly found himself used as a support froze in place.

The other party was almost completely in his embrace.

There was a faint scent entering his nose. It came from Ji Yushi's hair.

Ji Yushi didn't seem to notice anything wrong about this as he lightly caught his breath. When his mind was clear again, he found himself covered in cold sweat.

He belatedly felt a little afraid.

If Song Qinglan hadn't caught up to him, he might have really fallen for that fatal temptation.

Ji Yushi rested his head against Song Qinglan's shoulder and said both quickly and briefly, “There was something wrong with that phone call. It captured what I desired and after I hung up, that was the only thought left in my mind. Nothing else mattered anymore.”

The crisis was averted. Sure enough, it was the phone call.

Song Qinglan breathed a sigh of relief, “Fuck.”

This position allowed his chin to rest on top of Ji Yushi's head. He didn't know how to respond in a situation like this.

Ji Yushi didn't move so Song Qinglan could only reluctantly raise his hand and pat the other party's back, "It's good that you've returned to your senses. We should let Old Duan and the others know and let them be more vigilant."

Ji Yushi made a sound of agreement, but he still didn't move.

The hand Song Qinglan was about to lower hesitated.

Several seconds later, he changed it into an embracing posture. When his teammate is in a poor mood, he should do his duty as a captain to comfort them.

Gently protecting the person in his arms, Song Qinglan spoke with some complaint, "One moment we were discussing the double-slit experiment and the next moment you turned around and left. You're more of a slag than Li Chun. Advisor Ji, what was it in that phone call that attracted you that much?"

In fact, Song Qinglan wanted to know what Ji Yushi had experienced and what kind of life he had led for him to be able to say such pessimistic words like "I don't have that kind of reality."

But it seems that they had not yet reached the point where they could tell each other everything.

Ji Yushi only replied in a muffled voice, "It's something I have been pursuing all my life."

The heat from the other person's breath sprayed onto his neck, creating an itchy sensation.

When a person sobers up, they still remember everything they had done when they were in a confused state. Song Qinglan's heart felt like it was tickled by a feather and he found it a little funny, "What is it?"



As soon as he finished saying this, Song Qinglan was pushed away by Ji Yushi.

“Thank you.” Having recovered, Ji Yushi ruthlessly became distant again. He had already returned to his usual calmness, “It may be those three boyfriends or something. If I don’t return, won’t they die of sadness?”

In Song Qinglan’s words just now ‘You also have people you are in a relationship with. If you’re gone, what will happen to them?’, the word ‘them’ was spoken very carefully.

Ji Yushi didn’t expect Song Qinglan to be so persistent with this misunderstanding.

Feeling insulted, Ji Yushi who liked to hold grudges and couldn’t be bothered arguing with a straight man deliberately said those words to block him.

Song Qinglan frowned, “You.....”

“I cherish myself very much.” Ji Yushi returned to the main topic after successfully making Song Qinglan unable to speak, “Chief Lin told me in the phone call that the results are out, and the mission rating was very high.”

Feeling a little empty inside, he felt a little unhappy.

Song Qinglan crossed his arms in front of his chest and said arrogantly, “It’s fake. The results won’t be out this quickly.”

Ji Yushi, “I also know it couldn’t be this fast.”

\*

The two walked inside. They had to buy tickets again.

Passengers around them were hurrying about. Occasionally, unfamiliar faces would look over at them.

After that commotion, Song Qinglan wordlessly kept a close eye on the person he had just managed to capture. Right now, they were certain that this reality was a lot more complicated than they had initially thought.

If they didn't pay attention, the other party may be drawn away by something else again.

Song Qinglan, "The reason you were bewitched was because of the mission rating?"

"Yes." Ji Yushi explained as he walked. He seemed to hesitate for a moment before continuing, "After including the last mission rating, I can get the reward I deserve."

What kind of reward could be so tempting to even make someone like Ji Yushi waver? He even no longer cared if it was real and threw his teammate away like he was bewitched.

Tianqiong had a point system.

In Tianqiong, the accumulation of points not only meant a higher rating, it also brought along greater glory and these points could also be exchanged for more advanced tasks and access to Tianqiong's core which was extremely important for future career development.

A Guardian with a personal rating of greater than one star could be promoted to an Inspector, holding the power to inspect any time and space.

As for a Recorder with a personal rating of greater than one star.....There had never been one in Tianqiong's history.

Although a Recorder's job was relatively safe, it was very tedious and lacked room for advancements. Facing the mistakes and suffering from the past and being unable to do anything, only playing the role of a bystander, it tested one's endurance and perseverance, so there had not been many people promoted to one star.

Before leaving for the mission, Song Qinglan knew that Ji Yushi would soon be promoted from two stars to one star. Although it wasn't greater than one star, he would still be rewarded. Song Qinglan didn't know what a Recorder's reward would be, but his good training prevented him from asking directly.

Ji Yushi was different from the other members in the seventh squad. He wasn't one to easily confide in others. Even when analysing and sorting out his thoughts, he would only do it when he was completely confident.

Back in the Ouroboros mission when he spoke in front of everyone, it was also a matter Ji Yushi had to overcome first.

The two walked towards the ticketing machine.

Ji Yushi gave Song Qinglan his ID card to purchase the tickets with and suddenly caught a glimpse of the other party's bruised and swollen hand.

It was like Song Qinglan didn't notice it. His slender finger quickly selected options on the transparent panel, but it could be seen that his actions were a little stiff.

Did it hurt?

It must hurt.

Ji Yushi suddenly realised that, from the moment he left the train carriage until he was found by Song Qinglan, the other party hadn't placed any blame on him.

Their current situation was completely his fault.

Regardless of what the current reality was like, at least for Song Qinglan, this was his reality after being intercepted and brought back from the Chaos mission.

It was him who raised the suspicion first and it was also him who worked hard gathering information before coming to Ning City to discuss countermeasures with him — In a situation where nothing was certain, the

other party did all that. In addition to that, Song Qinglan was forced to remember his other memory, overthrowing everything he originally thought was his reality yet when they left together to try and find a solution to their situation, he was almost left behind.

All this time, Song Qinglan didn't show any panic or consider the option of retreating.

But did he really not panic at all?

No one in the world knew about the feeling of memory confusion and being unable to distinguish between reality better than Ji Yushi. No matter how firm his heart was, Song Qinglan was still just a normal human.

After purchasing the ticket, Song Qinglan asked, "If you need this reward, you could earn the points faster as a Guardian. Why did you choose to be a Recorder?"

"Because the condition for me to get my reward was to complete 100 Recorder missions as a Recorder so I could only be a Recorder."

As soon as he said this, Ji Yushi realised that he had actually answered Song Qinglan's question.

Trust was mutual.

It may not be so difficult opening one's heart.

A train passed this small station.

Amid the noise, Song Qinglan turned his head and looked over.

"I was adopted." Ji Yushi lowered his eyes, his eyelashes casting a shadow, "I want to go back to more than ten years ago to see my father's scene of murder."

## Chapter 50: Chapter 50

There was still about half an hour before the next train to Jiang City.

With the rush to Jiang City interrupted, the two found a secluded place, avoiding those who would appear from time to time to stop them from proceeding with their plans.

The tightly closed heart had quietly opened a small gap, and the past which had gathered dust was revealed.

“April 6th, 1439 Star Era. It was a very ordinary morning. Spring had arrived and rain was plentiful. It had rained from early morning till dawn.” Ji Yushi slowly spoke up, “I didn’t get up too early because my father was always the one who got up the earliest. As he worked, he made breakfast for me as usual. It was a very crudely made egg sandwich paired with a glass of slightly sweet hot milk. The table was outrageously messy, filled with formulas I couldn’t understand at the time. Even after I pushed away those papers and finished my breakfast, he didn’t notice. It was only when I was about to leave that he caught up to me with a raincoat and apologised saying that he would have to work overtime again.”

Those fragmentary details may not be important to the case, but it was Ji Yushi’s final interaction with his father.

Song Qinglan listened quietly without interrupting him.

Ji Yushi continued, “He didn’t go to work after I left that day because he had died at home. He was stabbed in the chest with a knife.”

That simple line brought the scene from seventeen years ago before Song Qinglan’s eyes.

Ji Yushi said, “Based on his time of death, he had died shortly after I left. The police investigated the case and checked all the recordings in the community that day and found a suspect from that.”

Suspect?

Hearing this, Song Qinglan couldn’t help but ask, “The case wasn’t solved?”

Ji Yushi nodded lightly to confirm this. He was a little dazed, as if he was immersed in his memory.

He then turned his head and said to Song Qinglan, “That morning, the murderer and I passed by each other in the corridor.”

Song Qinglan’s breathing stopped. He suddenly felt his chest tighten, “.....”

In 1439, how old was Ji Yushi?

Probably only eight years old.

Ji Yushi didn’t speak too excitedly or sadly. He just spoke as a matter of factly, “I was too young at the time and didn’t see the murderer’s face. Even after suffering from hyperthymesia and becoming able to recall many things, I could only remember the murderer’s clothes and walking posture that day, not his face. It was because I didn’t see it that day.”

Ji Yushi’s hyperthymesia.

Song Qinglan remembered that Ji Yushi had mentioned that his hyperthymesia wasn’t something he had from birth when they were in the rainforest. It was something he had acquired one day and he suddenly found that he could remember all his experiences and all the details.

Well then, was Ji Yushi’s hyperthymesia because of this?

A childhood trauma. Despite desperately recalling and being able to recall all the details, he was unable to change that fact.

How despairing must that have been?

Unable to imagine how a child could handle something like this, Song Qinglan finally understood why Ji Yushi grew up to become what he is today.

Not having the ability to forget.

It was a very cruel thing for people with great pain.

“Later, I was adopted by my father’s friend, who is my current teacher.” Ji Yushi said, “He is a very excellent psychologist. It could be said that without him, there wouldn’t be the me now.”

Song Qinglan, “That’s the person who called you just now?”

Ji Yushi nodded, “Yes. With the help of my teacher, I joined Tianqiong and became a Recorder.”

Song Qinglan understood.

Only after performing 100 Recorder missions, passing the test of time and becoming a Recorder who can be truly indifferent in the face of history, could Ji Yushi be allowed to return to that day to face his father’s death. The reward he wanted was to remember the murderer’s appearance. Even if it was more than ten years too late, he still wanted justice.

For all his life until now, this had been Ji Yushi’s goal. He was clearly suffering from hyperthymesia, but he would continue to go back to the past again and again, filling his mind with irrelevant scenes, only relying on that small source of hope to endure through the pain.

When a person’s life goal is too heavy, one would become very lonely, as if apart from this goal, there was nothing else in life that mattered.

In the terrible world filled with zombies and black walls, Ji Yushi didn’t give up.

In the crevice of time where everything didn't make sense, Ji Yushi didn't give up.

But this time, he almost gave up.

Song Qinglan understood how tempting that call just now must've been for Ji Yushi.

At the same time, he seemed to understand what he meant by 'I don't have that kind of reality'.

Although Ji Yushi had already returned to his senses, Song Qinglan was certain that he had seriously thought about giving up when he received that phone call, and he must have seriously considered the idea of staying in this reality.

It was because Ji Yushi knew. The reality here was only different starting from fifteen years ago. For Ji Yushi, as long as they could return to 1439 to complete his goal, it didn't matter to him which reality he was in.

What was it that made Ji Yushi change his mind?

Song Qinglan couldn't guess, but he was glad.

He tried to keep the atmosphere from becoming too heavy, "Advisor Ji, if I knew you earlier....."

Ji Yushi's clear eyes looked over at him, "?"

Ji Yushi's momentarily stunned look was actually a little cute. Song Qinglan for some reason felt his heart soften inside.

In fact, his next line was 'I could accompany you sooner', but just as it reached his lips, he felt that it wasn't appropriate, so Song Qinglan cleared his throat, "If I knew you earlier, I would've asked them to transfer you over to the seventh squad earlier. That way, you would be able to complete your task earlier and go back to that day sooner, and not be stuck waiting around here with me. In summary, it was my fault."



Ji Yushi: “.....”

This form of consolation was too clumsy.

\*

As they spoke, Song Qinglan’s phone rang. It was Duan Wen.

Ji Yushi had almost been abducted by this reality just now and they hadn’t had the chance to contact their teammates to tell them to be vigilant yet. This call came just in time.

On the way to the station earlier, Ju Yushi had used Song Qinglan’s phone to send information about Chief Wang to everyone. It was unknown whether everyone managed to recall their other memory just like them.

The two looked at each other. Song Qinglan picked it up, “Old Duan.”

Duan Wen spoke hurriedly, “Cap Song, I’m currently with Tang Qi and Tang Le. Where are you two?”

In the corner of his eyes, he saw Ji Yushi rub his earlobe. That small action made the corners of Song Qinglan’s lips curl up slightly. He didn’t mention the matter about Ji Yushi and just said, “We were delayed a little on our way back and are now waiting for the next train. We should soon arrive at Jiang City. Have you guys looked through that document?”

“Yes!” Duan Wen seemed to be smoking. He took a long drag, “One question. Is this damned world our original world or not?”

Song Qinglan answered, “I’m afraid not.”

Duan Wen, “.....Damn.”

Old Duan couldn’t be blamed for being unable to accept this. What should he do about his wife and daughter?

The phone was taken by Tang Le. Tang Le exclaimed through the phone, “Cap Song, we have a little sister now. Can you believe it?”

Song Qinglan narrowed his eyes, “The legendary Tang Rongrong?”

The twins were called Tang Qi and Tang Le.

The two boys often fought when they were young and every time they didn't like each other, they would urge their parents to give birth to a younger sister and call her Rongrong. Together, it would become QiLeRongRong. (KKnotes: Something like joy and harmony)

When Tang Le was being scolded by Tang Qi, he would always make something out of nothing and say that his younger sister was better.

Unexpectedly, they really did have a younger sister in this reality.

Once their double memories overlapped, this younger sister also became real in Song Qinglan's memory. She was a lively and lovely girl and very good at acting coquettish.

Tang Le exclaimed, “Yes! And she's really called Tang Rongrong!”

The voice on the phone changed. This time it was Tang Qi, “Chun'er's phone is off. Old Duan called him but no one answered so we don't know what's happening on his end. Cap Song, what should we do now?”

Please read this from kk translates

The team members had deep trust for each other. After learning about the truth, their first question wasn't whether or not they should return or why this happened. Instead, they asked ‘what should we do now’.

Even Song Qinglan as the captain was a little touched.

But rough men like them don't dwell on emotional matters for too long. He said, “We can only take one step at a time and act separately. Old Duan, go to the nursing home.”

This world interfered with ‘observing’ behaviours at an astonishing speed. Before they even arrived at Jiang City, a phone call had grasped Ji Yushi's weakness and almost made him stay behind.

As such, one cannot rule out the possibility of Chief Wang's end being interfered with. Duan Wen right now needed to hurry over to ensure that something like that did not happen.

Song Qinglan continued and said to Tang Qi, "You two go find Chun'er and Old Zhou. As soon as Advisor Ji and I arrive, we will meet at the nursing home."

Everyone: "Roger."

"Wait!!" Song Qinglan said, "Along the way, you may meet people you know or don't know trying to make you do something. Take care of yourself and.....don't follow them."

The phone call ended.

An announcement sounded on the platform, reminding them that the suspended train bound for Jiang City East Station was about to arrive.

Song Qinglan, "We should go now."

Ji Yushi nodded.

The two strode over to the platform.

As soon as they appeared, people sitting in the waiting room reading books, drinking water, chatting or just passing by started to look at them. These people placed down everything in their hands, stood up with blank expressions and hollow eyes, and proceeded to chase after them.

Ji Yushi walked very fast. He followed behind Song Qinglan and was more nervous than ever before.

His phone continued to ring but he subconsciously knew who the caller was.

Song Qinglan noticed this and turned around, "Give it to me."

Ji Yushi took his phone out of his pocket somewhat hesitantly.

Song Qinglan grabbed it and saw the word ‘teacher’ displayed on the screen. Ji Yushi’s interference was here again. As he walked towards the train, he threw the phone into the bin without batting his eyes.

Ji Yushi looked back, “!”

He almost couldn’t stop himself from going to that bin.

But Song Qinglan grabbed his wrist to stop him and pulled him over to the platform.

When the suspended train arrived, the two randomly boarded a carriage.

Some got out of the carriage, some got on.

Some left their seats like zombies, following behind them or blocking them.

Song Qinglan ignored them all, bumping them into disarray and attracting complaints from the normal people in the process.

Please read this from kk translates

They walked to the carriage at the end of the train and the sound of the suspended train setting off sounded. Song Qinglan opened the door to the bathroom and pushed the other person in.

Those who interfered with them lost their targets and gradually dispersed.

The bathroom was clean and tidy, but the space was small. With two full-grown men with long legs inside, it made it even more cramped. This scene was quite familiar. Ji Yushi remembered that there was probably a time when the two of them from Team B separated from the rest of team at Runjin Building in the Ouroboros mission and hid in a small room. He had stepped on Song Qinglan’s foot at that time.

The difference this time was that as soon as the door was closed this time, a cold object clamped onto Ji Yushi’s wrist.

There was a ‘click’.

Ji Yushi looked down. There was an additional handcuff around his wrist. He went through his memories very quickly and the details of the carriages they had passed by came to his mind.

When they passed a certain carriage, they happened to encounter a police officer on duty.

Ji Yushi was shocked, “Cap Song?!”

Song Qinglan had no plan on negotiating with him. He then proceeded to handcuff himself with a ‘click’.

He raised his hand. The shiny handcuff completely bound the two together. His expression was even a little content, “Took it from the police officer just now.”

Ji Yushi was speechless, “I won’t be able to escape that easily anyway.”

Song Qinglan leaned against the washstand. He seemed to be able to finally breathe a sigh of relief now and said lazily, “Who knows? Don’t worry, Advisor Ji. Now you won’t be able to escape no matter what.”

Outside the small bathroom window, the scenery blurred into a haze. In a short time, the suspended train had reached maximum speed.

Suddenly, the carriage slammed to the right and a strong sense of weightlessness struck. The two subconsciously grabbed the objects beside them to stabilise themselves and heard the cries of the other passengers outside.

“What’s going on?!”

“I don’t know!!”

Before the two had the time to speak, they heard a loud noise accompanied by a sharp screech. The carriage flipped over and was thrown in a certain direction!

“Ahhh!!!!”

More screams filled their eardrums.

After the carriage overturned, it overhung from a height. The alarm sounded endlessly. The bullet-proof glass shattered and fell off.

Under the hole that had suddenly appeared was a lake 100 metres away from them. Passengers and objects fell from the carriage windows, falling into the water below.

Ji Yushi's entire body hung from the window. The toilet rolls in the bathroom rolled about chaotically.

Even if it was water, falling from such a high point would undoubtedly result in death.

“Ji Yushi!!”

Song Qinglan grabbed his hand.

Thanks to the handcuffs, it gave Song Qinglan time to react.

The young and tall man had amazing arm strength. In this case, he had grabbed another adult male with one hand. Veins bulged out from his arm.

Ji Yushi grabbed Song Qinglan's hand back. His body was like a roll of paper, as if he would fall with just a soft blow.

Song Qinglan used his other injured hand to grab onto the shelf in the bathroom. He could only rely on this alone as support. If the shelf broke off, they would die together on the spot.

“Ahhhhh!”

People fell out through the windows.

“Don't look!” Song Qinglan's face was turning red. He squeezed out a few more words through his teeth with much difficulty, “Grab onto me!”

Ji Yushi looked back with a pale face. He drove the scene just now out of his mind and used his other hand to grab onto Song Qinglan.

In a situation like this, the Ju-Jitsu Ji Yushi had learnt came into use. He curled up his body and reached towards the washstand with his long legs, managing to find another point of support for himself.

With his life hanging by a thin thread, Ji Yushi successfully opened the bathroom door.

The train had completely overturned and was hanging upside down on the tracks in the air.

The hot steam beside the tracks made Ji Yushi sweat endlessly. Song Qinglan raised his handcuffed hand to help facilitate his movements. He crawled out and managed to pull Song Qinglan out with difficulty.

There were many passengers already standing on the track.

Some were standing there dumbly. Some were crying.

The two who had managed to escape from such a dangerous situation didn't even have the chance to feel scared. The scene before them shocked them.

On the tracks in front of them, a phantom of a suspended train appeared.

The colour was exactly the same as the overturned one behind them, as if their train had been pushed aside because of its appearance.

The beginning and the end of this phantom train couldn't be seen clearly. It was clearly running at high speed, but at this time it was as if the pause button had been selected. There were no sounds at all.

Song Qinglan randomly picked up an item scattered on the ground and threw it at the phantom,

The item bounced away.

The phantom actually had a physical body.

A large tear had formed on Ji Yushi's clothes. Following that incident just now, he was in a rather sorry state, "It's an overlap....."

His brain worked quickly, and his eyes suddenly brightened, "Cap Song, the two realities have overlapped — We must have encountered something crucial!"

Song Qinglan looked at his phone, "Old Duan found Chief Wang."

As soon as he finished saying that, their surroundings suddenly turned quiet.

When they turned their heads and looked over, they saw all the surviving passengers on the tracks looking back at them.



# Chapter 51: Chapter 51

## Who Am I

### Chapter 51

What did it feel like being stared at by more than a hundred living people?

—It was on par to what they felt when they first ran into a group of zombies.

If they didn't move, those people didn't move either.

With the scorching sun above, the temperature was hot.

They stood on the air tracks a hundred metres above a lake. The railing that had broken off from the impact of the train swayed precariously. Light wind blew through their clothes and the ends of their hair. It was as if as long as they weren't careful, this gust of wind could push them off.

The two faced the large crowd. For a moment, the world was completely silent.

Ji Yushi moved his foot slightly back.

The passengers began to move. They wordlessly started to move towards them.

The back of his waist was supported by someone's hand. It was Song Qinglan who had reached over. He spoke with a subdued voice, "Get ready. We have to run."

When Ji Yushi stopped, those passengers also stopped.

There was only a short distance between them. Their eyes remained fixed on those two people. All the panic, despair and crying from earlier was gone and they just stood in place, completely expressionless.

Run?

Ji Yushi clenched his fist. Yes, with the current situation, they had no choice but to run.

“Let’s try it first. Run in the opposite direction and go down when you see a construction barrier.”

As if he had given Ji Yushi enough time to prepare, Song Qinglan lowered his voice and counted down from three, “Go!!”

The two immediately set off.

The handcuff between them clattered along.

With footsteps sounding behind them, more than a hundred people chased after them.

The narrow air tracks couldn’t accommodate so many people at the same time. Amidst the running and pushing, there would from time to time be sounds of something falling into the water below. Humans fell from the tracks like dumplings.

“Give me your hand!!”

Song Qinglan shouted as he looked back. He grabbed Ji Yushi’s hand, their fingers interlocking. Without the pulling of the handcuff, they quickly sped up.

The crowd behind them continued to chase after them. It seemed like they would soon be able to catch up.

Ji Yushi felt that his legs were no longer his own. The tracks the suspension train had just travelled over at a high speed were still hot. They sweated profusely. It was as if they were in a sea of fire.

Song Qinglan's explosive power and endurance were several times more than Ji Yushi's. As they ran, Ji Yushi was practically being dragged along. He could only desperately try to keep up with Song Qinglan's pace. The other party's tall back was right in front of him, and his broad shoulders gave him a sense of security, as if as long as he was there, they would definitely be able to break through.

His palms were sticky and sweaty. Ji Yushi could only feel sweat dripping from his face.

He had never ran so fast in his life.

But the people behind them didn't seem to feel tired at all. It was only a couple hundred metres, but those people had managed to touch the back of Ji Yushi's clothes several times.

“Fuck!”

Even Ji Yushi couldn't help but throw out a profanity.

Without weapons, with the road ahead unknown and also being unable to do anything to those people, their current situation was completely outside of their control.

There was no end to the air tracks and human energy was limited.

During this silent chase, Song Qinglan quickly thought of a second method. They couldn't keep running like this!

Song Qinglan stopped abruptly, making Ji Yushi almost run into him. Before he could speak, Song Qinglan held his waist, “Go up!”

Ji Yushi immediately understood. Relying on their height advantage, Song Qinglan wanted them to climb onto the train's phantom!

The phantom was about 1.3 metres high from the ground. Ji Yushi managed to find the train window from the blurred image and grabbed hold of it with Song Qinglan holding him up.

The handcuffs that saved their lives just now had now become a burden. The two were handcuffed together, making it almost impossible for Ji Yushi to use both hands.

The crowd surged over and surrounded them. Arms reached out and grabbed at their clothes and limbs in attempt to pull them down.

Song Qinglan's face and arms were covered in bleeding scratch marks. He could only grit his teeth while supporting him, "Pull me!"

Ji Yushi managed to find a foothold. He bent down to pull Song Qinglan up.

The two cooperate like acrobats and managed to both climb up. There were however countless hands grabbing at their ankles, trying to drag them down. Song Qinglan kicked away a few and finally managed to climb onto the roof.

Song Qinglan flattened himself against the edge of the carriage roof. Behind him was the clear sky.

Before Ji Yushi could see his face clearly, his body suddenly lifted up. He was suddenly pulled up by Song Qinglan!

With the people below temporarily unable to get up to where they were and the two with nowhere else to go for now, they laid down on the roof to catch their breaths.

Song Qinglan cursed, "Dammit, my shoes....."

Ji Yushi was also breathing heavily, "M-mine too....."

Funnily enough, with that terrible chase just now, the only thing they managed to lose were their shoes!

The most frightening thing was that the moment they stopped running, the chasing passengers also similarly stopped.

Ji Yushi looked out and saw them surrounding the phantom of the suspension train with their heads raised. They looked like a group of

zombies waiting for the best opportunity to strike.

In this silent yet eerie environment, the two who were covered in sweat stood up, but just as they did that, Song Qinglan's phone rang. He took it out and knitted his brows, "Advisor Ji——"

"Boom——"

Following a loud sound, their vision turned dark. They suddenly found themselves falling!

\*

As if falling from a great height, severe pain struck their entire body and stars appeared in their vision.

"Ah!!!"

A woman screamed.

Ji Yushi sat up. The scene before him shocked him.

The clean and tidy suspension train carriage was full of passengers who looked at their phones, drank water, chatted or slept. At this moment, they were all looking at the two people who had suddenly appeared in surprise.

The place the two of them had suddenly appeared in was the aisle inside the carriage. A familiar train announcement reached their ears. Everything was neat and orderly.

This was a suspension train in operation.

But, wasn't the earlier suspension train overlapped with?

What was going on?

Song Qinglan also sat up. He had also fallen quite heavily. As soon as he recovered from the fall, he found that they were like animals in an exhibit.

The phone in his hand continued to ring. The caller ID displayed was: Grandfather.

Song Qinglan answered the phone and stood up, “Hello?”

There was no sound from the other end.

Ji Yushi also stood up. The two standing in the middle of the isle with their messy appearance made the other passengers vigilant. They began to whisper to each other and some even said that they would call for security.

But more of them were curious. An old man asked, “Young men, where did you come from? How did you fall from the sky?”

Ji Yushi scanned his surroundings.

When he saw the electronic display screen inside the train, he was stunned. Unexpectedly.....

His shirt was tugged at. Ji Yushi looked down. It was a four- or five-year-old child.

The child’s round eyes were filled with innocence as he asked, “Big brother, why aren’t you wearing shoes?”

Ji Yushi who stood in the middle of the aisle with only socks on, “.....”

But despite seeing the handcuffs binding the two of them, the child wasn’t afraid of him. He instead asked, “Big brother, are you catching bad guys?”

Ji Yushi smiled at the child.

In PU-31, someone had told him what to do if he was discovered by the original residents.

He answered, “Yes, big brother is a policeman.”

At this moment, Song Qinglan’s phone call ended.

\*

Everything was dark again. Soon following that, dazzling sunlight entered their eyes.

It was hot. In a blink of an eye, they had actually returned to the roof of the phantom suspension train.

Shocked, Ji Yushi opened his mouth to speak, “I——”

Unexpectedly, Song Qinglan was also about to speak, “Just now——”

“You go first!”

Song Qinglan held his phone in one hand and stretched his other hand out towards Ji Yushi.

With the two handcuffed together, they were like conjoined twins. Anytime and anywhere, they had to hold onto each other to make it easier for them to move.

Ji Yushi held it and stood up with Song Qinglan’s support.

His sweat dripped down his chin and his pale face was flushed. He looked like he was on the verge of headstroke.

Finishing his words, Ji Yushi said, “Cap Song, I think the carriage we were in just now was the carriage below us!”

“The carriage below us?” Song Qinglan asked, “Did we go to another reality just now?”

As Ji Yushi had said, the two realities were now showing signs of overlapping. The suspended train they were currently standing on was proof of another reality emerging.

Ji Yushi nodded, “Yes!”

Even though they had already experienced the strangeness in two other worlds, the two still found it unbelievable — Just now, they had travelled back and forth between two worlds in just a few seconds.

This situation was unprecedented but with the overlapping reality right in front of them, they had no choice but believe it!

Ji Yushi's tone was excited, "I think I know where we are now!"

Song Qinglan looked at him with his pair of dark eyes. He waited for him to continue.

"When we fell into the carriage in the other reality just now, I noticed the time on the train's electronic display screen."

Ji Yushi's observation ability was as good as his memory and he managed to remember useful information in a very short period of time.

"The time was: 1456.05.17 10:00:03."

Hearing the time, Song Qinglan immediately caught onto the important point, "This was the time when we set off for the A-level mission from the third command centre."

He paused and added, "No, shouldn't we be in our capsules at that time? Still in the middle of traversing?"

Ji Yushi's thoughts were always clear. He calmly analysed, "Correct. We indeed should be in the middle of transitioning to our mission. Because of this, I have figured out what is going on!"

"The Grandfather Paradox states that a person cannot travel to the past to kill their own grandfather. Even if they really managed to do this, it will only create another parallel timeline without the existence of them or their grandfather which is the so-called parallel world. This parallel world is different from the parallel worlds in the usual sense — because we have not crossed into the past, let alone changed the past."

Didn't change the past?



Song Qinglan understood the meaning of this sentence.

“Like your previous example, let’s suppose that the point where the Tianqiong Twelfth squad disappeared is point ‘A’ and the point where we arrived at Chaos to rescue them is point ‘B’.” Ji Yushi used Song Qinglan’s method to explain, “Having closed the crevice in time and space and allowed Cap Qi to return to point ‘A’, a new timeline was derived. This can be referred to as point ‘C’.”

Song Qinglan nodded to express his understanding.

Ji Yushi continued, “And this point ‘C’, after Cap Qi was in power for fifteen years, it has progressed to point ‘B’ where we rescued the Tianqiong twelfth squad.....”

On the point ‘C’ timeline, after the twelfth squad was rescued by the future seventh squad, Cap Qi became the Chief and then sent out the seventh squad to rescue the twelfth squad — Only like this could the timeline form a complete circle.

Song Qinglan suddenly understood, “I understand what you mean. Following this train of thought, the timeline of the two points ‘A’ and ‘C’ will both inevitably progress to point ‘B’. Then, at point ‘B’, there should’ve been two of our squad rescuing the twelfth squad but in fact, when we really reached point ‘B’ .....there was only one!”

In the Chaos mission, they didn’t meet their other selves and point ‘C’ was also caused by them closing the crevice in time and space so regardless of which timeline it was, there should only be one Tianqiong seventh squad.

Ji Yushi’s eyes were bright, “Correct! At first, I also thought that this place here was a parallel world following the butterfly effect, but I couldn’t be certain because there was neither another me here nor another you. Now I understand. It is because we are unique existences in the two realities and that is why we have the double memories!”

The double memories now had an explanation but what about the overlapping of the realities?

Song Qinglan remembered that Duan Wen had made contact with Chief Wang.

The overlap of reality was caused by Duan Wen's actions.

Everyone in the Seventh squad had undergone different changes in this reality. Except for Ji Yushi with hyperthymesia, the others had no memories of their other reality until they saw Chief Wang's photo.

This change started from Chief Wang. The root cause of it was the twelfth squad's return.

As a squad that exists in both realities, Chief Wang was a common variable that allowed the seventh squad to be able to distinguish between the two realities. It helped them discover the existence of the two realities.

Song Qinglan was thoughtful, "In the other reality, right now is the third second after we set off for our A-level mission but in this reality, it is already one month later. Why are the two staggered timelines overlapping?"

"It's a bubble world." Ji Yushi said. "Like the time paradox produced by the time anchor, this place is actually a bubble world. It starts at point 'A' and ends at point 'B', forming a large time anchor. The time derived from point 'C' is a bubble in the timeline that shouldn't exist and is extra, an additional existence."

Below the carriage, more than a hundred passengers did their own things. Some cried, some called for help.

But as soon as they saw Song Qinglan or Ji Yushi, those people immediately stopped still. It was as if they had been cursed. They stood motionlessly in place, staring unblinkingly up at them.

Under the sun, it looked like a sea of expressionless faces.

Bubble world.

Cap Qi in power, overlapping memories.....Everything seemed to have an explanation.

“This is also the reason why the suspension train in the other reality is at a standstill. Because to the other reality, we are still at point ‘B’ and time hasn’t moved forward. It is just like in the Ouroboros mission where we will return to the same point in time every time we die.”

Ji Yushi said, “But in this bubble, time continues. Our ‘observation’ and awakening was likely something similar to trying to burst the bubble. It’s still like the previous Ouroboros mission. If we leave this reality, the time here will stop moving forward and would return to the moment where it started. In order for it to continue progressing and for the bubble to continue existing, the world will inevitably try to stop us.”

There were still many questions that needed to be answered but the two of them needed some time to digest this new discovery.

After a short period of silence, Song Qinglan said, “Then I may know now why we entered the other reality just now.”

Ji Yushi raised his head, “Why?!”

“Because of my phone call.” Song Qinglan said, “That call was from a month ago.”

Ji Yushi didn’t understand. His eyes showed confusion.

Song Qinglan looked down at him slightly, “After coming back this time, my grandfather said that he called me the morning I set off for my mission. The call connected but I didn’t say anything.”

During the phone call just now, Song Qinglan also didn’t hear the other party’s voice. It was probably because of the effects of the overlapping of reality.

“However, we would need to spend at least a few hours beforehand just to prepare before leaving for a mission and personal items such as phones must be turned off and turned in. It was impossible for me to have received that call.” Song Qinglan said, “I thought he remembered wrong.”

“Looks like he didn’t remember wrong. Advisor Ji, there is a high chance that people’s behaviours in the two realities would be the same, right?”

Ji Yushi had a vague guess about what he was about to say, “Yes.”

Song Qinglan, “Then in our original reality, my grandfather might have also made that call. When the two worlds overlapped, it was this call from a month ago that pulled us into our original reality.”

# Chapter 52: Chapter 52

## Who Am I

### Chapter 52

Two realities, one Song Qinglan.

One reality was from one month ago and the other was one month later. When these two realities began to overlap, the call from one month ago was received by Song Qinglan from a month later. It had accidentally connected the two realities, pulling them back briefly, but the moment the phone call ended, the link was broken, and they were pulled back to the reality one month later.

Both knew very well that even if Song Qinglan called back immediately after the link was broken, the person picking up on the other end would only be his grandfather in the current reality and they would no longer be pulled back to their original reality.

It was like there was a thin film separating them from their original reality.

Can see and touch but cannot truly enter.

Song Qinglan pondered, “Say, do you think anyone else will call me over that month?”

Ji Yushi, “Even if they did, it won’t be now.”

The other reality was currently at point ‘B’ and, to them who are in the bubble world, it was at a standstill. The phone call just now happened to be made at point ‘B’ but how could there coincidentally be so many phone calls made at point ‘B’?

As for phone calls for Ji Yushi, that was even less likely.

Firstly, it was because his phone had just been thrown away and secondly, his social circle was pretty much limited to the three members of the Ji family.

Not to mention, whenever he goes on his missions, he would completely disappear from that reality and probably no one would care about it except for those in the Ji family.....Thinking this, Ji Yushi was surprised. Those negative thoughts had somehow invaded him again. If not for his quick reaction, he might have had another case of thinking that the other reality was ‘not worthy to feel attachment to and since it was no different from this place, it didn’t matter if he stayed here instead’.

The weather was hot, but a chill ran through Ji Yushi.

The influence of this world was almost inescapable. He lowered his eyes and looked at the handcuff binding himself with Song Qinglan and quietly breathed a sigh of relief.

It’s alright.

The handcuff was still there.

Like Song Qinglan had said, he at least wouldn’t be able to escape again.

His thinking became complicated again. Ji Yushi raised his hand and grabbed Song Qinglan’s wrist.

His line of sight fell onto the other party’s watch. The second hand was still moving at a regular pace.

Song Qinglan asked, “What’s wrong?”

Ji Yushi’s expression changed in an instant, “We have to get out of here immediately!”

Memories from when they bought tickets at the small station earlier quickly returned to him — After Song Qinglan asked him for his ID card, he had

used his injured hand to select options on the screen to purchase their tickets and the information with the train schedules were displayed very briefly before it changed after Song Qinglan selected the next train. It had only appeared very briefly, but it was deeply engraved into Ji Yushi's memory.

Soon after their train, another train would also pass through this track! At that time, just like this train, the next train would also collide with the phantom train from the original reality!

Standing on the train tracks like this, the outcome would be unimaginably dangerous!

As soon as he said this, Song Qinglan's expression also became tense, "How long do we have?!"

Ji Yushi's mental arithmetic skills were excellent, "No more than three minutes at most! Let's go!"

Song Qinglan stood on the roof of the carriage. His eyes locked onto a place in the opposite direction of where they were running. About a hundred metres behind them was a maintenance bridge. They had to go there immediately!

There was no time to worry about the passengers following behind them. The two immediately started to sprint over.

On top of the carriage, the two ran desperately towards the bridge.

Below the carriage, the passengers followed after the sound and chased after them like zombies without consciousness.

This scene was astonishingly similar to when they were at the Golden Crow No.2 base. At that time, they were running desperately along the ventilation pipes while zombies below and behind them chased after them with their mouths wide open.

They were always put into desperate situations like this.

“Go down!”

Song Qinglan slammed onto his brakes. They were already close to that bridge.

With experience from earlier when they climbed to the carriage roof, the handcuffs didn't get in their way this time. The two cooperated well and quickly jumped off.

More than a dozen passengers who caught up to them stretched out their hands in attempt to hold them in place. For a moment, the two were surrounded and unable to escape. It resembled a silent horror movie.

Ji Yushi was anxious, “The train is coming!”

Song Qinglan, “You go down first!”

The two quickly descended the ladder. Some passengers similarly followed behind them.

More and more passengers charged over but the narrow ladder couldn't accommodate that many people at the same time. When Ji Yushi looked up, he was met with more than a dozen faces quietly looking down at him.

These people were completely unaware that death was imminent.

When they were halfway down, there was a faint sound of wind rushing by.

It was the sound of a suspension train travelling at high speed. From far to near, it arrived in a blink of an eye!

“BOOM——-”

Along with a loud earth-shattering noise, the new suspension train was pushed off by the phantom train, colliding with the original train that had overturned and breaking apart in an instant.

Large pieces of steel flew out, slashing off the heads of the people staring down at them from above!



Blood and brain matter flowed out. Headless corpses fell from above.

It seemed that someone that returned to their senses. There was a loud scream.

The two didn't stop moving. Ji Yushi didn't even have the chance to look down when something large appeared in his line of sight — It was a broken off section from the train! It smashed into the tracks, creating an opening in an instant!

With the bridge losing its connecting point, it let out an uncomfortable creak and looked like it was soon about to break off. If it fell off, they would fall and directly smash onto the concrete floors below!

“Jump into the water!” Song Qinglan shouted.

They were no more than five or six metres away from the water. Ji Yushi showed no hesitation. With Song Qinglan holding his hand, the two jumped off.

“Splash!”

A large splash followed.

As the two fell into the water below, they could vaguely hear the sound of the steel ladder and bridge collapsing and falling onto the hard concrete floor. There were other things that also fell together with it including train parts, glass and half a human head.....Everything could be seen clearly from the lake.

Having fallen into the lake at a wrong angle, as he sank to the bottom of the water, severe pain surged through Ji Yushi's ear and chest and he almost spat out a mouthful of blood.

The grip around his waist tightened and Song Qinglan next to him turned him over.

Air bubbles rose in the water.

Both saw each other's faces clearly.

Song Qinglan held his breath and held the other party in this face-to-face manner and relied on his strength to bring them both back to the surface.

The handcuff had become an obstacle for them once again. Ji Yushi could only curl his handcuffed arm behind his back so that Song Qinglan could hold his waist, but that wasn't enough. His instinct to live was very strong and he quickly hugged Song Qinglan with his other arm.

Under the water, their bodies were very close to each other.

Ji Yushi didn't move an inch. He tried to minimise any form of resistance to make it easier for Song Qinglan.

“Pah!”

After what seemed like a century, the two finally reached the surface. Fresh air instantly poured into their lungs and both breathed heavily.

“Cough, cough, cough!!” Ji Yushi choked on some water and coughed heavily.

The water level around him kept dropping. Song Qinglan had managed to get a foothold and was walking towards the shore.

When his lower half was completely out of the water, it was only then that Ji Yushi realised that his legs were wrapped tightly around Song Qinglan's waist. It almost looked like a koala clinging onto a branch for dear life.

This position was very awkward.

The sun shone brightly on them.

Song Qinglan's soaked shirt clung tightly to his skin, highlighting his gorgeous tanned skin and muscle lines.

Ji Yushi could distinctly feel every part of their body that was in contact. Whether it's the back where his hand rested, the shoulder against his chin,

or the waist in which his legs were wrapped around, he could clearly feel the explosive energy that belonged to a young man.

With every step that was taken in this position, Ji Yushi's thoughts were tainted further.

But after choking on water and with the additional pain in his chest, Ji Yushi really couldn't walk on his own.

Besides, the other party didn't seem to be struggling at all.

So he simply hung on Song Qinglan, pretending not to know anything.

It was naturally awkward.

No straight man would like this kind of 'reliance'.

Perhaps it was because he was too straight, when Song Qinglan placed him down after going ashore, he helped support him.

He was clearly holding him like how one would hold a child but when his hand touched a soft and elastic part and his fingers sank in, both of them froze.

Ji Yushi, "...I'm awake."

Song Qinglan, ".....Sorry."

Ji Yushi's throat was a little hoarse and his ear and chest still ached.

Song Qinglan placed him onto a big rock. He himself wasn't any better. His handsome face was paler than usual and even his lips were white, as if he was enduring something.

Ji Yushi quickly discovered the problem.

Song Qinglan's arm that rested on him was hanging limply. It didn't look right.

He immediately understood — Song Qinglan had asked him to jump off first just now and they had handcuffs binding the two together. Although they were both jumping, but because of their position, his own weight when jumping down was bound to bring harm to the person jumping off after him. As a result, Song Qinglan's hand had dislocated.

Ji Yushi was stunned, "Cap Song, your hand....."

"It's nothing."

When he finished saying that, Song Qinglan had already popped it back in place. He gritted his teeth tightly and his entire body trembled slightly in pain.

Along the way, Song Qinglan seemed to have suffered the most injuries.

The right hand that was jammed by the train door, the scratches on his face and arms from when he was chased, and the left hand that had dislocated from the jump....After the wrist was popped back in place, it took another ten more seconds before Song Qinglan opened his eyes again.

Those dark eyes had already recovered its previous composure. Not mentioning anything about the injury, he just asked, "Advisor Ji, can you still walk?"

Ji Yushi didn't answer so Song Qinglan continued, "If you can't, we can rest for five minutes. If we follow this path here, we will see the highway after about two kilometres."

Ji Yushi said, "I can."

Song Qinglan looked at him but he instead sat down and looked at his watch, "Forget it. Even if you're not tired, I'm tired. I need time to catch my breath. Let's rest for a while before continuing."

\*

The road to Jiang City couldn't be any simpler in their minds but in reality, it allowed them to experience what it meant by a frustrating journey.

Fortunately, the two men who only had socks on their feet managed to reach the highway after taking that long two kilometre journey.

The soles of their feet hurt when they walked and the sun had almost dried them completely.

Neither of them had been in such a sorry state in their entire life.

The scene on the road was horrific. There were constantly areas of wreckage and blood covering the ground. Sirens would sound from time to time and smoke and fire could be seen in all directions.

Like the air tracks, phantoms of countless vehicles suddenly appeared out of thin air on the originally orderly road and the overlap of the two realities made them push away the vehicles that were originally moving along the road.

The two stopped moving forward and found a cool place near the road to hide.

About an hour later, a bright red sports car sped over.

That sports car was covered in traces of scratches. It seemed like it had encountered its fair share of accidents today.

The sports car braked sharply in front of them, the tires making a loud screech. With a beautiful turn, the car came to a halt.

In the driver's seat, Li Chun whistled at the dirt and dust covered captain and Advisor Ji. He took off his sunglasses, "Hey handsome, would you like a ride?"

The two got onto the car.

They didn't want to speak a single word.

The handcuffs were very eye catching under the sun. Li Chun was speechless at the sight of it but because of Song Qinglan's dark expression, he didn't dare ask about it.

His family's captain really knows how to play!

While in shock, Li Chun drove the car out again. He fumbled around with one hand for a while and threw water and food to the back seat, "I also brought shoes. Size 46 for Cap Song and 42 for Advisor Ji! Look, I did three things at the same time all by myself. Look at this damn speed of mine. Amazing!" Song Qinglan gulped down half a bottle of water in one go, "Does Tang Le know about you playing with his car like this?"

Li Chun: "....."

Li Chun, "Boss, don't worry about those details!"

## Chapter 53: Chapter 53

While they were resting just now, the person Song Qinglan had contacted was clearly Tang Le and the other party had said that he would wait for them near the highway, but unexpectedly, the one who arrived was Li Chun.

Song Qinglan had briefly explained the current situation on the phone but Li Chun who had almost lost half his life understanding the concept of a time anchor didn't understand anything anyway. What 'double slit interference experiment', what 'bubble world'? In any case, he just needs to do as Cap Song and Advisor Ji says and they will be able to return to their original reality!

It seemed that it was always the three of them reuniting first.

Li Chun didn't notice his captain's disdain and began his chatter, "I've always thought that something wasn't right. How could that girl be so unreasonable? Turns out, this wasn't our original world! I had to practically act like a dog the past few days just to coax her!"

Ji Yushi: "....."

"Fortunately, I fucking remembered everything the moment I saw Chief Wang's picture!" Li Chun continued, "In our world, I never even got that girl's number so how did this world become like this? They just gave her to me?! Before two people date, shouldn't they get to know each other first?!"

Song Qinglan finished an entire bottle of water. He noticed that Ji Yushi was taking off his socks as he got ready to put on the shoes.

The soles of both their feet had sustained quite a few scratches and this was especially the case for Ji Yushi. There were not only cuts, but there were also blisters caused by the scalding tracks. The socks were stuck to the skin

so when he watched him peel the socks off, Song Qinglan couldn't help but wince at the sight and have the urge to give him a hand.

Ji Yushi however didn't flinch. He was completely expressionless.

This person, when other people touch him, he would say that it hurts but whenever he himself is injured, he wouldn't say a single word.

Song Qinglan wondered whether he should make Advisor Ji change this bad habit of his.

No one in the Seventh squad liked to endure through pain.

For example, Li Chun at this moment was still complaining, "She kept on making a fuss last night, so I called out some friends for a drink and when Tang Le came in through the window in the morning, he almost pinched me to death. Haa, if I knew this would happen, I wouldn't have drunk. Anyway, it's not good delaying things. We can still be friends after breaking up."

Song Qinglan had to interrupt the slag man's chatter, "Watch the road."

Li Chun driving into Runjin Building in PU-31 had left them with some lingering fear.

Song Qinglan right now was too tired to speak, and he also wasn't in the mood to care about the fact that the driver was driving without a licence.

Li Chun glanced at the rearview mirror. Cap Song wasn't in the mood to bullshit with him, and Advisor Ji was also leaning back against the seat in exhaustion.

He no longer gossiped and immediately settled down, "Alright, I actually have a question....."

Song Qinglan, "Speak."

Li Chun asked, "How can we return to our original world?"



This question hit the nail on the head. It just happened to be the question everyone had been troubled about.

The realities had overlapped, and phantoms of the other world could be seen everywhere. It however could only be seen and touched, and they couldn't truly join it — They had no idea what they should do now.

Li Chun then asked, “Then, if we leave, what will happen here? Will it disappear?”

The car sped the entire way and the scene along the way was shocking.

Not only were there phantoms of cars appearing on the road, the closer they got to the city, there were more phantoms of humans as well. The bubble world was derived from the original world and is as such similar in all aspects except for small differences in the details.

In other words, the people and objects here were all real, and the people in this bubble world have their own lives.

“I don't know.” Ji Yushi said, “It may disappear, or it may repeat itself like Ouroboros starting from the point where we left.”

“Fuck....” Li Chun couldn't hold back, “That would be too pitiful.”

Ji Yushi, “In fact, it's not bad.”

Song Qinglan turned to look at Ji Yushi. He was a little confused. He felt that Ji Yushi wasn't one to have no empathy.

But Ji Yushi calmly explained, “Just like the survivors in PU-31, the people in the bubble world will never feel that they are in a repetitive cycle. What they consider as their ‘present’ will always be their ‘present’. In a sense, it's actually no different from us. In fact, even we cannot be certain whether the world we live in is real.”

Li Chun felt a chill run down his back when he heard this, “Advisor Ji, that's a terrible thought.”

Again.

That pessimistic ‘brain in a vat’ thought again.

Song Qinglan raised his hand making Ji Yushi’s hand to also lift. The handcuff between them rattled, “Real? This is real. Even if we’re afraid of one of us succumbing to temptation and escaping, except for you, I cannot think of myself being bound together with another person.”

Song Qinglan’s wrist had just been dislocated so it was still red and swollen. It was quite a scary sight. As he said this, his heroic eyebrows raised slightly, “If it was Chun’er instead.....”

Li Chun was indignant, “What about me?!”

Song Qinglan was heartless, “Knock you out instead.”

Li Chun once again became animated, “Am I not worthy?!”

Song Qinglan leaned back lazily against the seat and began to banter with Li Chun.

Listening to their chatter, Ji Yushi turned his head and looked out the window, corners of his lips slightly upturned.

\*

Overtaken trains, plane crashes and car accidents, it was chaotic everywhere.

The news reported the overlapping phenomena happening all over the world. The city was filled with the smell of smoke and gunpowder. Phantoms of humans, animals and all things living had appeared out of thin air and even landmark buildings had been replaced by phantoms of another building.

In a blink of an eye, this world was nearing its end.

Please read this from kk translates

Holographic screens, radios and online. Information about this phenomenon was everywhere.

Less than two hours after this phenomenon of world overlap appeared, Tianqiong issued an emergency order — The Time Management Alliance in each country had defined this incident as a ‘parallel world overlap’. For the people in this reality, they never thought of the possibility of the world they are in being just an extra bubble in a time anchor.

On the way, Song Qinglan also received a transfer order on his phone ordering all Guardian squads to immediately return to the Jiang City branch.

But after he hung up, he and the two other teammates drove to the nursing home where Chief Wang was.

To them, returning to their own reality was the real emergency.

The red sports car raced through the chaotic city. It passed bridges which had fallen to the ground, collapsed buildings and countless abandoned cars. Very soon, it was smashed beyond recognition.

The streets were filled with phantoms of people from another reality. The people in this reality were all panicked. Everything that they knew had been overthrown and their current world was falling apart.

“Tianqiong destroys the world!!”

“Illegal transition!!”

“Stop interfering with time and space!! Shut down the Tianqiong system!!”

“Down with the Time Management Alliance!”

A crowd appeared on the road passionately shouting slogans while holding signs in opposition.

As early as two decades ago when the scientific team first started to study the Tianqiong system, such protests had been held — As a young man, it

was Ji Yushi's first time seeing such a scene.

Song Qinglan saw him frequently turning his head and said, "When they protest like this, they actually have no idea how much Tianqiong has done for them."

As a Guardian, Song Qinglan knew very well about how hard it was to maintain a safe world.

Just like the short composition about the positive social impacts: There is no stability in this world, but there are countless nameless people working in the background helping the world move forward.

Ji Yushi said, "Perhaps the scientists didn't expect it to develop into something like this when they invented Tianqiong...."

He had said this very softly so Song Qinglan didn't catch it.

In a blink of an eye, the car managed to turn onto a different road. It had taken them two to three times longer than expected to reach the nursing home.

Before getting off, Song Qinglan used the tools in the car to pry open the handcuff. The two were finally freed.

Ji Yushi flexed his sore wrists, "Not binding me to you anymore?"

The handcuffs were thrown onto the seat. It had brought them both love and hate as they made their way here.

Song Qinglan glanced at it and said coolly, "No more. But you still cannot leave my line of sight. Advisor Ji, don't forget that you have a previous record against your name."

Li Chun turned his head back from his driver's seat and said with amusement, "Hey boss, you're speaking like a tyrant. If Advisor Ji was a girl——"

Ji Yushi helped him finish his words, "I would stay away from you."

Li Chun: “?”

Inside the car, Song Qinglan knocked on a certain someone’s head, “How does he look like a woman?”

Li Chun for some reason felt that there was something wrong with that last line.

Cap Song’s eyes were deep and his rebuttal seemed a bit strange....Why did he feel that Cap Song was even a little reluctant when he removed the handcuff?!

Wait a minute, didn’t Cap Song have PTSD towards that?

Was this world crazy or was he crazy?

\*

The three got out of the car.

As if some mysterious power took control, all the people on the road stopped one after another.

The people outside quietened down in an instant and they all turned their heads and stared at them.

Soon afterwards, they began to mechanically walk over.

Li Chun was terrified, “The fuck, again?!”

The three slowly backed away but those people didn’t slow down like before. On the contrary, the moment they saw that they had stopped, these people sped up their pace instead.

The closer they got, the faster they were and eventually they were practically running towards them.

“Run!”

“Let’s go!”

The three reacted at the same time. They shouted this out and started to run.

There was a crowd gathered behind them rushing towards them like a tide and there were also people charging towards them from the front.

They ran through countless phantoms, pushing down living humans who looked like rigid stone statues in the process. Amidst all the chaos, they were soon scattered.

Due to the crowd, Ji Yushi was forced to the end of the street and was completely surrounded.

Please read this from kk translates

“Ji Yushi!”

“Cap Song!!”

Song Qinglan and Li Chun’s voice sounded, but they could only be heard in the crowd and couldn’t be seen.

Ji Yushi looked up. He was met with unfamiliar faces all around him. They either stopped in place without moving or stiffly walked towards him. He couldn’t tell which ones were the static phantoms from the other world and which ones were living human beings.

These faces filled his brain. His mind once again uncontrollably started to search through his memories and the large influx of information pouring in brought about a dull pain to his head.

In just a few minutes, cold sweat dripped from Ji Yushi’s forehead.

Suddenly, someone pushed in from amidst the crowd.

It was a featureless face that couldn’t look any more ordinary.

Like the other humans who came over, Ji Yushi also didn't recognise this face. He looked up blankly and was met with a pair of deep, black eyes.

The man was very tall. He raised his hand in the crowd and used the advantage of his long arms to stick a disc behind Ji Yushi's ear, "Don't move."

A small sound came from behind the ear and then a familiar sensation spread from that point to the rest of his face.

His face had been covered with a new face.

89 Recorder missions, 89 times pretending to be non-existent.

The mask that had been skilfully used by himself 89 times.

No one knew the purpose of it better than him.

With it, Ji Yushi became another person.

The people surrounding him gradually returned to their senses. Vivid and lifelike expressions returned to their faces and their previous looks of shock and panic were restored. Very soon, they dispersed as quickly as they came.

Ji Yushi panted lightly. His figure was enveloped by another tall figure.

Song Qinglan spoke under his artificial face, "I told you. If you don't leave my line of sight, you won't be abducted by them. What are you afraid of?"

Ji Yushi, "I-I wasn't afraid."

Song Qinglan laughed softly.

The other three came over. They all similarly had plain faces.

The round face was hitting the square face, "I just went to the black market to buy some equipment and when I come back, the car is like this?! Like this?! You better fucking pay for the repairs!"

The one with the square face cried, “Hey, this is just a fake world. Why take it so seriously!!”

The other round face spoke. It seemed to be Tang Qi from the voice, “Advisor Ji, I didn’t expect us to team up again so soon.”



## Chapter 54: Chapter 54

When they parted, they didn't expect that it in fact wasn't the real end let alone that they would team up again so soon.

The five people from the seventh squad had gathered together. Only Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan were missing.

Duan Wen was one step ahead of them and had already reached the nursing home. Song Qinglan asked, "Where's Old Zhou?"

The five hurried to the nursing home.

Whether it was six degrees of separation or interference as a result of their 'observation', as soon as they put on their artificial face, they seemed to have instantly disconnected from this world's consciousness.

Everyone else on the street was rushing around so they didn't attract anyone's attention despite their hasty footsteps.

With Song Qinglan's question, the other three fell silent.

Ji Yushi sensed that something didn't seem right.

"What is it?" Song Qinglan's tone turned a little more serious.

No one in the squad knew Zhou Mingxuan better than Song Qinglan. They had enlisted together, became special forces together and they also became Guardians together. Zhou Mingxuan usually just liked to play around but it could be said that besides Duan Wen, he was someone who could see the whole picture the best.

Striding down the steps, they passed by several phantoms of people.

The group went through a side street. Protesters continued to march onwards and there were police cars patrolling around. Screams could be heard in all directions.

Tang Qi said, “He may not go back.”

Song Qinglan’s footsteps stopped.

Unlike Ji Yushi, they were all ordinary people. Once they have two overlapping memories, it was easy to overlook one of them. Song Qinglan recalled his memory from the bubble world — Zhou Mingxuan’s life here had also changed a lot compared to his original reality and it was also an important change for him: In this world, Zhou Mingxuan’s only relative, his grandmother, was still alive.

Song Qinglan still remembered that in the original reality, due to a Guardian’s training schedule, Zhou Mingxuan would return home at irregular times. After a three-day long training session, he returned to find that his grandmother had already passed away. This was something that had weighed heavily on his mind all this time, but he had been reluctant to talk about it. This world however had given him a new possibility.

In the bubble world, it wasn’t the changes that were scary, and it wasn’t the fact that they had attained things that they originally didn’t have that was scary. For example, Li Chun and his girlfriend, Tang Qi and Tang Le and their younger sister, and Duan Wen with his wife and child.

What was really scary was when a person’s most precious thing was taken away by fate and the bubble world allowed you to experience the feeling of regaining something that had been lost.

The situation Zhou Mingxuan was facing now was like that of Ji Yushi’s.

Even the extraordinarily calm Ji Yushi who had been involved with countless Recorder missions found it difficult to resist the temptation. It would’ve been a very strong temptation for the hot blooded and impulsive Zhou Mingxuan.

“We went to Old Zhou’s place to get him.” Tang Le continued his brother’s words, “His grandmother’s legs aren’t well and needs someone to take care of her.”

“But it’s all fake!” Li Chun was anxious, “Why can’t Old Zhou understand?! Dammit!”

“It’s not that he doesn’t understand.” Song Qinglan suddenly spoke up, “It’s just too difficult to let go. He needs someone to give him a hand.”

Ji Yushi turned his head. He unconsciously clenched his hand.

Song Qinglan wasn’t looking at him but he could still feel the sensation of a strong and powerful hand holding his hand.

He had truly been ‘given a hand’.

Song Qinglan said, “Let’s leave it for now. We can talk about it later after meeting with Old Duan.”

Everyone soon arrived at the nursing home. The situation there was shocking. Patients were running wild around the nursing home, carers were chasing after the patients and family members were also hurrying around picking up their family member. It was a complete mess.

There were phantoms from the other world appearing here as well but compared to the ones outside, the phantoms here were clearer — Those phantoms were still, allowing people to clearly see their facial features and expressions. Some patients had even found their other self and were shouting at them while in a mentally unstable state.

What convinced everyone in the seventh squad even more that everything was related to Chief Wang was that not only were there phantoms in the nursing home, but the small details could also all be clearly distinguished. Rather than a phantom image, it was more like a real existence.

This place was the central starting point of the overlap of the two realities and from here it had spread across the entire world.

Song Qinglan checked his watch and urged, “Let’s go!”

Everyone increased their speed.

Ji Yushi knew why Song Qinglan urged them.

The Tianqiong in this reality must have already discovered that the source of the overlap was this place. Song Qinglan had checked his watch and calculated how long it would take for Tianqiong to reach this place starting from the moment he received the urgent order from Tianqiong.

“Cap Song!” Ji Yushi asked, “How long do we have?”

With no time to wait for the elevator, everyone strode up the stairs taking two or three steps at a time.

Song Qinglan said, “At most ten minutes!”

\*

“Bang——”

The door to the ward was slammed open. Duan Wen who was waiting in the room immediately raised his head, “Cap Song! Advisor Ji!”

Everyone entered the room.

Ji Yushi immediately spotted Chief Wang sitting on the edge of the bed.

The female leader who had always been kind and wise was no longer dressed or made up exquisitely.

Her hair was left unbrushed and she wore a hospital gown as she looked blankly at the phantom in the room. The phantom was of a grey-haired old man drinking tea as he sat on a single person sofa. Because time was at a standstill, the teacup was pressed against his lips and he didn’t move at all.

“Chief Wang!”

Song Qinglan strode over and squatted down in front of Chief Wang. He tried to make her return to her senses.

Chief Wang didn't respond.

Duan Wen told them, "It's useless. I have been here for a long time and she has always been like this. Fuck, the so-called treatment for schizophrenia here probably made it worse."

Song Qinglan pressed his finger behind his ear. The artificial face began to disintegrate, revealing his original handsome appearance, "Can you recognise me?"

Chief Wang finally looked down at him, but her expression remained unchanged.

Please read this from kk translates

Having finally reached this point and having arrived before what they thought was the key to everything, apart from confirming that the overlap of the realities was related to her, they didn't manage to get any other clues.

"Fuck!" Li Chun couldn't help but curse, "What did the people here do to Chief Wang? She was even a university professor before she came here. What is this?!"

This line reminded Ji Yushi of something.

On the document Song Qinglan had with Chief Wang's information, it had mentioned that she was a professor of quantum physics in this reality and her research project even involved bubble worlds.

Ji Yushi looked around the room.

As a prestigious university professor, there were many of Chief Wang's personal belongings as well as some paper books. Ji Yushi's gaze fell onto a thin transparent panel. It was Chief Wang's computer. He picked it up, unlocked it with Chief Wang's face, and then skipped through the private contents to find useful information.

“Cap Song!” Ji Yushi spoke up, “Look at this!”

A holographic projection was activated.

Song Qinglan frowned, “This is?”

Everyone in the squad looked. They didn’t understand what they were looking at.

There were many formulas and figures scribbled on the projection. Page after page, it was filled to the brim.

For a moment, it was like they were back in Chaos when Ji Yushi was writing formulas. Everyone had a look of confusion.

Sure enough, the only one who could understand was Ji Yushi. As his mind worked very quickly, he explained to the others as simply as possible, “Chief Wang seems to be calculating the difference between the electromagnetic waves of the two worlds.....”

“Electromagnetic waves?” Song Qinglan soon thought of the communication devices, “She was studying this?”

Ji Yushi went through the holographic projection. Two wavy lines appeared in air.

The two wavy lines appeared to be almost exactly the same with the same thickness at first glance but if you looked carefully, you could see that they were slightly different. There was too much data recorded and it took him a while to reach the end. According to the time markers, Chief Wang had been recording them for more than fifteen years.

In other words, it was very possible that Chief Wang had accidentally monitored the electromagnetic wave frequencies from another world during her research and thus started her other research on bubble worlds.

“No....not only that....” Ji Yushi’s expression was serious. His dark eyes reflected the projection light, and his tone held some tension as well as

some excitement, “We were right. To a certain extent, Chief Wang may really have two memories.”

Duan Wen: “But wasn’t the reason why we have two memories because we are unique in the two realities? Because there’s only one of us? Is that the same for Chief Wang?”

“No, only the seven of us are like that.” Ji Yushi said, “We created the bubble world after we rescued the Twelfth squad and even if Captain Qi didn’t become the chief, too many elements in this reality had changed. Even a small error would prevent Chief Wang from becoming the Chief. She is special because she is a common variable for the seven of us. When we get close to her, this reality becomes unstable.”

They had saved the twelfth squad and, in the process, inadvertently created a fifteen-year duration time anchor from which a bubble world formed.

Because of them, a bubble world had formed.

It was very fragile and attached to the real world. As long as they leave it and return to the anchored point in time, it would collapse and another bubble world would form, unable to truly continue existing.

Ji Yushi continued, “Chief Wang’s two memories are not like ours. Rather than calling it a memory, it is more like her learning about herself in another reality. The research subject Chief Wang chose to do it on was herself. She not only monitored her other self, but she also recorded the differences in frequencies between the two of them in detail. Perhaps this was the reason for her mental instability.”

In those messy formulas, Ji Yushi found one that seemed to be recorded regularly.

Chief Wang had noted in detail the similarities and differences she had detected each time and tried to put them together to establish a consistency or pattern.

“The other me.”

Suddenly, a female voice sounded.

Everyone turned their heads. It may be because those words had touched on something but the Chief Wang who was originally nonresponsive had suddenly turned to them and said, “That’s not the real me. I can prove it.”

A quiet room. Motionless phantoms. A mentally unstable woman.

This moment sent a chill through everyone present.

It turns out that not only them, but the people in every world would think that they are the true existence.

Time was running out. Song Qinglan turned on his artificial face before turning around and asking, “How can you prove it?”

Chief Wang turned and looked back at the phantom figure sitting on the sofa, “Find the key point.”

Everyone, “.....”

This answer was equivalent to not giving them an answer!

The silence didn’t last very long. Ji Yushi immediately said, “I know.”

Except for Song Qinglan, the other people in the room were shocked.

“You know again?!”

Li Chun was about to go crazy.

“Cap Song and I were briefly pulled back to our original reality by a phone call not long ago.” Seeing Song Qinglan nod, Ji Yushi continued to explain. He swiped through the holographic projection so that the two previous wavy lines were showing again, “If you use an electromagnetic wave simulation program to simulate an electromagnetic wave that synchronises with the ones from our original reality from a month ago, and then....”

He paused and seemed to be a little hesitant.



“And then call someone who would answer the phone from that day.” Song Qinglan seemed to be able to read Ji Yushi’s mind and helped him finish his words, “The person called must also be a unique person in the two worlds.”

Tang Qi, “But Advisor Ji just said that only the seven of us are like that. How can we make this call?”

Tang Le also nodded. He was eager to know the answer.

“The so-called ‘unique’ doesn’t necessarily have to have the same meaning as our ‘unique’. As long as the lives of the two people in the two realities are completely different and they wouldn’t use the same number, it would be fine.” Song Qinglan said, “We have to make sure that we are not interfered with while we make the call, right Advisor Ji?”

Ji Yushi nodded.

Please read this from kk translates

Duan Wen quickly thought of something, “Then we should call Chief Wang.”

Li Chun, “Brother Wen, do you remember Chief Wang’s phone number?”

Everyone looked at each other. Let alone the Chief’s number, they didn’t even know the numbers of their closest friends and relatives.

Ji Yushi said, “I remember.”

Everyone, “!!!”

How could they have forgotten that there was Ji Yushi in their squad who would never forget anything he saw. There wasn’t even a need for a phone book!

As soon as he finished speaking, sounds of cars and human voices could be heard downstairs.

Song Qinglan quickly approached the window and looked out the blinds, “Tiangqiong’s here.”

“Then let’s go!!” Tang Le said, “Let’s go and find Old Zhou and then use a simulator to call!!”

Song Qinglan released the blinds, allowing them to bounce back in place. A few seconds later, he said, “No need for that.”

“Bang——”

The door to the room was kicked open.

Zhou Mingxuan appeared at the door pointing his laser gun at them.

Everyone was stunned. What was the meaning of this?

Facing the gun, Song Qinglan didn’t move let alone show any fear. He just continued looking at his most trusted teammate with that pair of dark eyes of his.

They heard Zhou Mingxuan speak with a small voice, “Cap Song, I’m sorry. I don’t plan to go back.”

He moved his gun to the side and motioned, “While they’re not here yet, I’ll cover for you. Hurry and go.”

## Chapter 55: Chapter 55

Zhou Mingxuan didn't have the will to leave this world and so this world didn't interfere with him. Everyone in the seventh squad had received an urgent transfer order but it seems that only Zhou Mingxuan had returned to Tianqiong.

There were chaotic sounds of footsteps outside. Tianqiong had dispatched a specialist team and they were currently searching around the nursing home for the cause of the world overlap. Only Zhou Mingxuan knew that the cause was the variable, Chief Wang.

No one in the room moved. Everyone looked at Zhou Mingxuan and Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan, "Do you think we will let you stay here?"

"Yeah!"

"Old Zhou, are you stupid?"

"This place is just a bubble. I don't know how to explain it exactly but anyway, Advisor Ji knows. Don't you believe in Advisor Ji?"

The teammates were all talking in a hurry. They were anxious. It was impossible for them to give up a teammate.

Zhou Mingxuan was silent for a few seconds, "I know."

He looked at Ji Yushi and asked, "Advisor Ji, Cap Song said in the message that if all of us return to our original reality, this place will restart. It's like the loop in Ouroboros. Then if I stay, will this reality continue?"

Although Ji Yushi had an artificial face, he was still very easy to distinguish from the rest of the squad.

Despite the face concealing his real expression, he was too empathetic with Zhou Mingxuan's situation at this moment, so he couldn't lie.

The teammates all looked at him with hopeful eyes, hoping that he could destroy Zhou Mingxuan's ridiculous fantasy. Ji Yushi however answered his question truthfully.

He said, "Yes."

Everyone was speechless.

There was a possibility for this world to continue?

"But," Ji Yushi spoke calmly and quickly, "if you don't return, then we will be missing one person when we return to that 'B' point. Your friends, comrades, and the rest of the people in your life, everyone would lose you. Tianqiong seventh squad will lose a Zhou Mingxuan and the squad will no longer be complete. This is an even more scary outcome than the team's scout 'Old Yu' getting injured because the guilt from allowing you to stay behind as a result of momentarily feeling soft hearted will follow the rest of the Seventh squad for the rest of their lives."

Ji Yushi said, "A bubble is just a bubble after all. After that regret of yours is satisfied, it would eventually fade away, but your life won't. What would you do alone here when the time comes? Unless of course the purpose of your life is just for that one thing."

Apart from the times when he had to analyse the situation, this was Ji Yushi's first time speaking so much in front of everyone.

Even Zhou Mingxuan was surprised.

Only Song Qinglan knew where those words came about.

But what Song Qinglan didn't expect was that the person 'giving Zhou Mingxuan a hand' wasn't him but Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi had said those words to Zhou Mingxuan but he was in fact also telling himself that. They both had experienced the temptation of this bubble word and he knew how to pull Zhou Mingxuan out.

The sound of the search was getting closer.

Song Qinglan took a step closer and snatched away Zhou Mingxuan's gun, "Stop those damn useless thoughts of yours. It doesn't matter whether or not it continues because you don't belong here. You must go with us, right now, immediately!"

Zhou Mingxuan hesitated, "Cap Song, I...."

Tang Qi walked over, grabbed Zhou Mingxuan's neck without saying a word, and stuck a small disc behind his ear. A new artificial face covered Zhou Mingxuan's face and, pushed by the others, Zhou Mingxuan was pushed out the room.

The group of people left in the opposite direction of the people conducting the search. As soon as they left the door, the people conducting the searches called out after them, "What are you doing?! Come and register!"

They didn't stop. They silently turned down several corridors before reaching an emergency exit. As Song Qinglan pushed the door open, he said, "Old Duan, do you know how to operate an electromagnetic wave simulation program?"

As a technician, Duan Wen answered, "Yes!"

Song Qinglan, "How long will it take?"

Duan Wen received Chief Wang's transparent panel which had the data he required and replied with confidence, "Just a few minutes."

Reaching the next floor, they ran into searchers dispatched by Tianqiong coming from downstairs.

Both sides stopped in place.

It turned out to be Guardians from the Third squad in this reality. They happened to all be familiar faces.

The other party saw the gun in Song Qinglan's hand, and the leader of the squad shouted, "Stop there!"

"Fuck!"

Someone swore. Everyone immediately turned and ran.

The Third squad also weren't people that could be underestimated, and their skills were not inferior to theirs.

In the not-so-wide emergency staircase, the two sides started a chase. They crashed through doors one after another only to find that every floor had been taken over by the people of Tianqiong within a short period of time.

Fortunately, no one fired their guns. Song Qinglan however knew that the Third squad had already notified all the other squads during the pursuit, intending to catch this group of suspicious people in one fell swoop.

"I fucking knew it. I shouldn't have made fun of their equipment last time!" Li Chun cursed, "It's coming back to bite me now!"

"Then spit out your share when you go back!"

"Fuck! No way!"

Duan Wen: "It's a different reality but why do they always get dispatched out?! It's too excessive!"

Complaining was just complaining. Everyone knew very well inside that probably everyone in the Jiang City branch had been dispatched. Not only were there people from Tianqiong, but from what they saw outside the window — Many ordinary people had also been attracted over to this place as a result of the overlapping of the worlds and the ruckus made by Tianqiong. This place was completely surrounded.

It was noisy with the sound of sirens, human voices as well as helicopters flying overhead. It made it difficult for the Seventh squad to do anything.

“Split up?!” Tang Qi asked, “Find a place to gather!”

“Don’t split up.” Song Qinglan pushed open another door, “All of you follow me!”

Please read this from kk translates

This was the entertainment room in the nursing home. Except for several motionless figures who looked like the pause button had been pressed for them, there were no living people in this room.

Song Qinglan, “Here!”

The teammates locked the door and Duan Wen immediately took out the transparent panel and placed it onto the table without Song Qinglan’s order. He quickly started up the program.

Only a few minutes. He only needed a few minutes.

Everyone was quiet. In the room there was only the electronic sound of Duan Wen hitting the holographic keyboard — He didn’t even have the chance to mute the system. Everyone knew that as long as Duan Wen is done and makes the call, they would be able to return to their original reality.

The six people surrounded Duan Wen, their expressions tense. Their fates rested on this.

\*

“Wait a minute.” Tang Le suddenly spoke up in the silence, “I want to give my little sister a call.”

Everyone’s actions stopped.

Tang Le's eyes turned red, "Even if I don't belong here and this is a bubble, I want to give her a call.....After this, we won't have a little sister."

Tang Qi stroked Tang Le's head like he was petting a dog. His eyes were also red, "....."

Li Chun had already pulled out his phone, "I also....that, it was a relationship after all. Breaking up without saying anything would really make me a scumbag."

The program was already set up.

Duan Wen typed in the last word and then leaned back in his chair and covered his eyes.

This man in his thirties also couldn't bear to leave his daughter in this world. After this, he would never see her again.

Even if he had children in the future, it wouldn't be the same one now.

Zhou Mingxuan sat alone in the distance. It was unknown what he was thinking as he rubbed his phone, his expression gloomy.

Ji Yushi leaned against a table by the window.

Sunlight entered from his side, making his skin appear almost transparent. He didn't have a phone and there wasn't anything that tied him down here, so he just lowered his eyes. It was unknown what he was thinking inside.

"Cap Song." Li Chun asked, "What changes did you have here?"

Everyone raised their heads and looked at Song Qinglan.

With the overlapping of the two realities, everyone had double memories, but they couldn't remember what changes Song Qinglan had.

Song Qinglan had his arms crossed as he leaned against the wall.



His handsome eyes were deep as he spoke, “Eight in the morning, my father didn’t take the plane to attend a meeting and was instead sitting at home drinking tea. Does that change count?”

Ji Yushi also looked at Song Qinglan.

He didn’t seem to have heard Song Qinglan mention anything about changes.

In other words, Song Qinglan’s life had hardly changed in this reality. He had no regrets and there was nothing he wanted to change. He had controlled his life perfectly.

A person with no desires and no regrets was practically invincible.

Song Qinglan’s strong mentality and strength may have come from this.

A short reminder sounded.

On the holographic projection, the program was ready.

The simulated electromagnetic wave frequency was completely synchronised with the other reality. As long as they connect the phone and dial the number, everything would be over.

Ji Yushi moved away from the window, took the phone from Song Qinglan and got ready to enter the number.

At this moment, there was a loud ‘boom’ outside.

Everyone’s expression changed.

The door to the room shook violently. It was the people in this world trying to break through. Just one more hit and the door would probably collapse!

“Come here! Gather around!”

“Hurry!!”

There was another loud boom. Even the floor shook.

That second felt extremely long. After Duan Wen turned off the projection, Song Qinglan's 'don't move' seemed to have been spoken at the same time as the loud noise.

The heavy door fell to the ground with a loud clang. A layer of dust scattered through the air.

Dozens of Tianqiong Guardians stood at the door, loaded with guns and live ammunition. They looked around at the still figures inside the entertainment room.

With the nursing home being the starting point of the overlapping of the two realities, the phantoms here could no longer be described as phantoms. All the people from the other reality looked no different from the people here with the exception that they were at a standstill.

To the Guardians, it looked like there were no living people in this room.

"Next room!" Someone said.

They filed in, set up the equipment as required according to the regulations and then quickly glanced around before getting ready to go to the next place.

A voice spoke, "Wait."

Among the Guardians wearing black combat uniforms, someone walked out.

It was a very young man with the number '9' written on his chest. He was thin, fair-skinned and he had a pair of peach blossom eyes. On his back, he carried a shotgun similar in style to Song Qinglan's.

The voices of the people outside were loud. The Guardians running in the corridor, the shouts from the crowds outside as well as the sirens blaring all indicated how chaotic this world had become.

This young man stopped in front of Song Qinglan.

His peach blossom eyes stared at the unfamiliar, ordinary face for a while and then a smile appeared, “Tell Chief Qi that our Cap Song is naughty and likes to play hide and seek. Should he be left off lightly?”

In that instant, even the sound of a pin dropping could be heard.

Three more steps to go.

Ji Yushi pressed the last number key on the phone inside his pocket.

The young man raised his hand and reached towards the small disc concealed behind Song Qinglan’s unfamiliar face.

Two more steps to go.

Ji Yushi, “Cap Song.”

Everyone in the Seventh squad moved at the same time. They held each other’s hands one by one.

The young man stepped back.

“Whoosh!” The Guardians surrounding them immediately raised their guns.

One more step to go.

The guns were pointed at them. Ji Yushi pressed the call button.

“Brrring——”

The Guardians got closer.

“Brrring——“

While they were surrounded, Chief Qi who wore a combat uniform strode in. The hairs on his temples were white but his appearance was almost unchanged compared to how he looked when they first met in Chaos.

“Brrring——”

The nursing home began to shake. From the ceiling to the walls, more phantoms appeared. The world was beginning to collapse.

Everyone was shocked. There was however a big gap between realities. All the sounds could no longer be heard.

Please read this from kk translates

Everything was set.

“Hello?”

A familiar middle-aged female voice sounded through the phone.

\*

【Warning! Warning! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! You have deviated from the destination coordinates!】

As the capsule shook violently, Ji Yushi gripped tightly onto the armrest. Even his lips had become pale. Red light flickered on and off in front of him nonstop. Ji Yushi knew that he had returned to the moment of transition, back to the so-called point ‘B’.

Back to the reality where they belonged.

Back to [1456.05.17 10:00:03], the third second after they set off from the third command centre.

—And also back to that perfect case of time and space hijacking.

【Illegal transition detected!】

【Illegal transition detected!】

The deafening sounds didn’t elicit any reaction from Ji Yushi. He simply closed his eyes and waited for the dizziness and ringing in his ears to go so

that he wouldn't vomit inside his own capsule.

It was unknown how much time had passed. Perhaps it was only a few seconds, but for Ji Yushi, it felt like several hours.

The landing of the capsule didn't happen as he had expected. When everything was calm and he opened his eyes again, what greeted him was a clear blue sky.

The sun was just right.

A damp breeze scattered leaves around. There were sounds of laughter.

Ji Yushi sat up and found that he was lying on a sun lounger by a beach with the blue sea about ten metres away from him. The sea was beating against the fine sandy beach. Occasionally seagulls flew over and there were children picking up shells on the beach as well as tourists in swimsuits coming and going.

For a while, he was in a daze.

It was very similar to the beach he had visited alone when he graduated high school.

No, this is that beach.

He lowered his head and saw that he was wearing clothes from that time. There was however a black communicator on his wrist that didn't belong to that time which helped remind him that this wasn't a dream.

There was an unread message on the communicator.

Ji Yushi turned on the holographic projection.

[Welcome, Ji Yushi. Welcome back to Tianqiong.]

Without even thinking about it, Ji Yushi knew that this message came from the 'Tianqiong of all eras'. Only it had the ability to create seemingly realistic things like this.

[Congratulations, you have completed the new A-level mission:  
【Chaos】.]

Ji Yushi frowned. So this meant that.....The Chaos mission hadn't been completed until just now?

[Congratulations, you have triggered a side mission. The rating is: S.]

[Mission mode: 【Who am I】.]

[Mission rules: None.]

[Mission objective: None.]

[Congratulations, you have completed the side mission: 【Who am I】.  
Now unlocking the next one.]

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Was it taking the bubble world as a side mission and combining it together to settle the accounts?

“Where is this?” Ji Yushi asked.

The voice system was turned on.

Tianqiong's gentle female voice sounded, “After system upgrade, this is a time and space transfer station tailored for you. You can rest, train and dine here. I have everything you need. I suggest that you make the most of it before proceeding to the next mission.”

Ji Yushi, “Where are the others?”

Tianqiong, “The others are also in a time and space transfer station tailored for them. Do you wish to transition to another person's transfer station?”

Ji Yushi, “Yes.”

Tianqiong, “Please select the transition target: Song Qinglan, Zhou Mingxuan, Duan Wen, Tang Qi, Tang Le, Li Chun.”

The sea breeze was calming.

Ji Yushi laid back in the chair and thought for a long time before speaking again, “Song Qinglan.”

# Chapter 56: Chapter 56

Blue sky, the sea and the beach.

All of this turned into threads and slowly scattered away.

Everything before Ji Yushi was reorganising. Wall lights, artificial landscapes, a small brook and a bamboo forest....He had arrived at a Chinese-style courtyard filled with heavy cultural atmosphere.

Ji Yushi stood on an exquisite stone bridge. Except for the sound of water, the courtyard was very quiet.

Ji Yushi guessed that, based on the beach he was at just now, this cunning Tianqiong system had probably created exclusive transfer stations for each of them based on information it had obtained from their subconsciousness. The command centre they had stayed at last time was too simple and crude because Tianqiong at the time only wanted to unify everyone's senses and didn't want them to realise that it was all just an illusion when they had in fact never left their capsules.

It was different this time. They had seen through the secret behind the transfer station so it had decided to choose a place from their subconsciousness where they could feel most comfortable to rest.

It could be said that this tailored fantasy world was the most relaxing place in the hearts of the people in the seventh squad.

There was no one in the courtyard.

Ji Yushi crossed the bridge and randomly chose a path paved with stones. Very soon, he reached an area with green lawn.



The facilities here were incompatible with the surroundings. There was a sandpit, castle shaped slide, colourful jumping castle and also a swing. At first glance, it looked like a small playground.

Was this.....the transfer station Tianqiong had tailored for Song Qinglan?

Ji Yushi walked over but he still didn't see anyone.

Not sure about whether he should continue walking, Ji Yushi pulled the swing over and sat down.

The weather was fine, and the temperature was just right.

The refreshing smell of the grass filled his nose, calming Ji Yushi's slightly anxious mood down. It seems that even if Tianqiong had no plans to send them back, it would try to let them get their rest.

Sitting on the swing, Ji Yushi started to have nonsensical thoughts out of boredom.

He thought, since this was the place that makes Song Qinglan feel comfortable, then it must exist in reality, just like his beach which was from his high school days. As a result, he was also wearing clothes from that time. With this children's playground.....could Song Qinglan have become a child again?

An immature face that still had baby fat appeared in Ji Yushi's mind.

The child was younger than the one in Chaos and his chubby arms were like lotus roots. Just a single poke was enough to poke a dent. He clearly looked well-behaved, but his personality was very overbearing, insisting on playing with whoever he wanted to play with and constantly running over to cling onto him whilst calling out his name.

A certain someone's younger self relied on their weight to win and was practically a demon king in kindergarten.

“Whoosh——-”

Something flew through the air.

A short red arrow appeared on the swing's wooden support. The suction cup at the tip of the arrow couldn't hold on so it very soon fell to the ground.

“What are you thinking about?”

A mature male voice sounded from not far away.

Ji Yushi's heart skipped a beat. He looked over.

Song Qinglan was wearing a simple T-shirt and sneakers. He held a pitiful looking children's bow as he strode over.

The short red arrow was shot by Song Qinglan. An adult doing this kind of childish behaviour should've looked funny but, because of his long legs and strong temperament, Song Qinglan's aggressiveness couldn't be concealed.

“Cap Song.” Ji Yushi asked, “This is your place?”

“It's my grandfather's place in Ning City.”

Song Qinglan said this as he reached the swing. He bent down and picked up the arrow before looking down at Ji Yushi who sat on the swing, “Advisor Ji, I was just about to go look for you when Tianqiong notified me that you came to find me.”

Please read this from kk translates

Song Qinglan's features were deep. When he lowered his head to look down, his gaze also deepened.

The illusionary worlds created by Tianqiong was different for everyone. After receiving the explanation from Tianqiong, everyone quickly thought of looking for their teammates but Song Qinglan made it out to seem like the two had strong tacit understanding.

Ji Yushi looked away. His tone was the same as usual, “This was the place where you stayed when you were a child?”

Song Qinglan had already told Ji Yushi that he had lived in Ning City when he was a child, so he answered, “Yes. these were all things my grandfather got someone to make. After my parents separated, my father got custody of me but even after I left Ning City for several years, these were still kept around. They were only removed when I was in middle school when it could no longer be used.”

Song Qinglan was also originally from a single-parent family?

Ji Yushi didn’t know this.

“I didn’t expect to be able to experience my childhood again like this.”

Song Qinglan sounded a little nostalgic, but that was soon gone.

He started to talk about business, “I thought we would be able to return to the real world after the call was made — But after some careful consideration, it made sense. The so-called point ‘B’ happened to be the third second after we set off, that is, it should be the moment we were hijacked.”

The third second after setting off.

After the three missions 【Ouroboros】 , 【Chaos】 and the side mission 【Who Am I】 , they would always return to this moment in time, as if they were constantly trapped in this cycle.

Ji Yushi nodded.

Song Qinglan said, “I was just surprised that the bubble world was classified as a mission.”

At least they now understood one thing and it was that only until the so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ is satisfied with the missions they have completed will this case of time and space hijacking would come to an end.

Anger, disappointment, exhaustion; nothing can change this fact.

The only thing they could do was accept and move on.

Ji Yushi was calmer than Song Qinglan at this very moment, “But overall, it is better than being trapped in a bubble world.”

The tension from the second before the call was answered by Chief Wang was still lingering in Ji Yushi’s heart. No one knew how sweaty his hands were when he pressed the call button on the phone inside his pocket.

If that call didn’t connect, the seven of them would’ve definitely been taken away. Leaving aside what they would face next after being taken away, the bubble world would most definitely not give them another chance.

Everyone felt that Ji Yushi was sensible, knowledgeable and logical. Only he himself knew that he was actually making a dangerous bet.

If they lost the bet, everyone including Song Qinglan would be completely lost in the bubble world.

And the person who almost made it happen was——

“Cap Song!”

“Advisor Ji!”

“Damn, this place is amazing!”

The peaceful world with only the two of them was interrupted. The other five from the seventh squad have also appeared in Song Qinglan’s transfer station. They were all wearing regular clothes. Li Chun was even wearing slippers and only shorts without a top, revealing his strong chest muscle in the process.

They were all men, so no one minded. Duan Wen even had his arm hooked across his shoulder. They were true rough men.

“I knew that either you would be with Advisor Ji or Advisor Ji would be with you.” Li Chun said, “Anyway, I knew you two would be together!”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

“Put a shirt on.” Song Qinglan glanced at Li Chun, “What are you doing dressed like that?”

Li Chun felt very wronged, “Boss, I was just sleeping at home. The bed is the most comfortable place in the world for me. Since it’s already tailored for me, can’t I get comfortable?”

Please read this from kk translates

Although he said that, when Li Chun’s eyes met with Ji Yushi’s, he suddenly felt that it was inappropriate.

Ji Yushi’s sexual orientation was different. He as a straight man shouldn’t walk around like this in front of him. What’s more, Advisor Ji was very proper and very likely slept neatly dressed. Him like this was practically on par to an uncivilised barbarian.

More importantly, he felt that his current state seemed to make his captain unhappy.

Song Qinglan’s dark eyes at this moment were unfathomable. Li Chun trembled and pictured something in his mind. Very quickly, a flowery shirt appeared on him.

He lowered his head and thought of something else. This time a can of beer appeared in his hand. He was excited, “Fuck, this is so convenient!”

Everyone curiously also followed suit.

Tang Qi circled the lawn with sunglasses on, “Where is this? Why is there a children’s playground?”

Zhou Mingxuan who stood at the back spoke up, “It’s Cap Song’s grandfather’s place. I went with Cap Song once when we discharged from the army. The old man was a man of literature and his garden was famously beautiful. It’s normally not open to the public. If I’m not mistaken, these were probably from Cap Song’s childhood.”

Li Chun, “So childlike. Makes me want to play as well!”

Having not returned to reality after leaving the bubble world, Zhou Mingxuan's mood was still low. He said, "It's perfect. It just so happens that it's most suitable for children like you."

Li Chun exploded and sent over a kick, "Fuck! Old Zhou you're no fun. We finally managed to escape and we still don't know when we can return. Can't you be nicer?!"

Zhou Mingxuan, "We almost couldn't come back. What be nicer."

Tang Le sat cross-legged on the lawn and slapped his thigh, "Speaking of which, how did Lin Xinlan recognise Cap Song? So perverted. He could still recognise him even with an artificial face!"

Song Qinglan also couldn't figure it out.

At that time, they were all wearing artificial faces. When they were still, they looked no different from the other phantoms in the room. Even if he was a little taller, the other party shouldn't have been able to pick him out so accurately.

Song Qinglan recalled the scene with some lingering fear, "Fortunately he didn't have time to take off my artificial face or I would have had to take him as hostage."

"Lin Xinlan?" Ji Yushi knew this name. It was also within his expectations.

In a situation like that, if Ji Yushi didn't get the phone in time, the next best course of action was to hold a person hostage to ensure their safety. He turned and asked Song Qinglan, "You didn't want to do that?"

Before Song Qinglan could speak, his teammates answered for him.

"Too disgusting!"

"Who would want to touch him?!"

"Might get infected with mad dog disease!"

“After Cap Song fought against him in the fighting tournament last time, he almost washed off a layer of skin.”

Ji Yushi let out an ‘oh’.

He understood. It was Song Qinglan’s PTSD towards homosexuality.

Everyone chattered on about nonsense again. Ji Yushi had to be called a few times before he returned to his senses. He saw that everyone was walking into the house with the plan to use this place to have a good rest.

Tang Le asked, “Advisor Ji, what were you thinking about? I called you for a long time.”

Tang Qi and Song Qinglan were still waiting for them a few steps away.

Ji Yushi stood up from the swing. Knowing that Song Qinglan was looking at him, he said lightly, “Suddenly miss my boyfriend.” (KKnotes: Chinese doesn’t have a system like English where ‘s’ is added at the end to suggest plurals so the ‘boyfriend’ here could refer to one or multiple.)

# Chapter 57: Chapter 57

## Transfer Station

### Chapter 57

*(KKnotes: Chinese doesn't have a system like English where 's' is added at the end to suggest plurals so the 'boyfriend' here could refer to one or multiple.)*

Hearing Ji Yushi say this, everyone was taken aback.

Ji Yushi had never talked to them about his personal matters. This was his first time talking about it.

Tang Le asked, "Advisor Ji, you have a boyfriend?!"

Ji Yushi nodded and smoothly admitted to it, as if he wasn't embarrassed about his sexual orientation in front of this squad known for their homophobia.

Ji Yushi usually behaved cold and dignified. His bookish atmosphere was something only top intellectuals would have. When faced with danger, he could always get through it without bullshitting and his fighting abilities weren't inferior to that of Guardians. On top of all that, his appearance was too outstanding. It made everyone regard him as a dazzling and magical existence. The Lin Xinlan who everyone in the squad was disgusted with couldn't even be compared with him.

If Lin Xinlan was the mud that people didn't want to come into contact with, Ji Yushi was the untouchable cloud in the sky. They were on two completely different levels.



Tang Le was curious, “What does Advisor Ji’s boyfriend do?”

Everyone walked across the lawn together.

Song Qinglan and Tang Qi walked ahead. It was unknown if they were paying attention to their conversation.

As for what kind of person Ji Yushi’s boyfriend was, it wasn’t just Tang Le who was curious. In fact, everyone else was curious what kind of person someone like Ji Yushi would like and what kind of person would match with him.

What did his boyfriend do?

Faced with this question, Ji Yushi thought for a while and said, “Tabletop cleaning master.”

Tang Le scratched the back of his head, “Tabletop cleaning master?”

Song Qinglan paused and asked, “What else?”

Of the three boyfriends, one was a table cleaning master. What did the other two do?

Tang Qi and Tang Le didn’t understand but Ji Yushi immediately understood the meaning behind Song Qinglan’s question. He lightly answered, “Same field.”

No one had heard of this profession and just felt that the conversation between the two didn’t seem right.

Song Qinglan didn’t speak anymore and just turned back and continued walking.

Tang Qi wasn’t a talkative person but Tang Le happened to be the opposite. Very often, Tang Le would help him ask the questions he wanted to know the answer to. As they continued walking, Tang Le chatted with Ji Yushi.

Tang Le, “How did you meet?”

With all the workload from Tianqiong, it wasn't easy for one to cultivate feelings. The entire Seventh squad were single dogs because of this. Even if it was a different sexual orientation, Tang Le was eager to learn from those with experience to escape from his single status.

Ji Yushi, "Looked pleasing to the eye and we both had favourable impressions, so I brought him home." (*KKnotes: The 'him' here could refer to one or more*)

Tang Le was shocked. This was something he couldn't do, "S-so fast?!"

Ji Yushi just answered faintly, "Yeah."

Tang Le, "Was it love at first sight?!"

Ji Yushi, "I guess so."

After going up the stairs, they walked along a wooden porch with intricate carvings. Song Qinglan's back was right in front of Ji Yushi.

Song Qinglan's shoulder blades could be faintly seen under the white T-shirt and the outlines highlighted his powerful muscles. Walking through this courtyard filled with cultural vibes, Song Qinglan's aggressiveness didn't fit in at all.

Somehow, Ji Yushi could tell that the other party was in a bad mood.

It was as if the more they spoke, the hastier Song Qinglan's steps became.

He probably couldn't stand listening to it.

"Love at first sight." Tang Le sighed, "Then your boyfriend must be very good-looking! I feel that Advisor Ji's standards must be very high! What type is he?!"

Ji Yushi didn't deny the 'good-looking' description, "Type.....Cute, I guess?"

None of his three cats were cold or aloof. Even Little Orange in the bubble world was the clingy type. He probably attracted those types of cats.

Tang Le was speechless.

Cute? Tang Le started to doubt life itself. Could Advisor Ji be the one who tops in a relationship?

It was not only him. All the others in the squad probably also thought that Ji Yushi was the one on the bottom. It looks like their understanding about this matter should be changed.

“When acting spoiled and clinging to me, it’s very cute.”

Reaching the door, Song Qinglan’s back figure stopped.

Ji Yushi lowered his eyes thus ending this topic.

\*

The inside of this courtyard was completely different from what everyone imagined.

As soon as they entered through the door, they were met with smooth and clean floor and walls, all sorts of black coloured equipment, as well as bright lights — This wasn’t a comfortable and elegantly decorated living room. It was their combat training ground in Tianqiong.

Li Chun almost fell, “Fuck! Cap Song, why do you have a place like this in your transfer station?”

Tang Le, “Damn, it’s really the training ground?”

Wasn’t the transfer station tailored by Tianqiong supposed to generate a comfortable environment for the individual? Everyone should be eating and drinking and having fun. Why did such a perverted set up appear?

Song Qinglan’s expression changed slightly.

In fact, when he first came here, this place was indeed a living room but somehow after going out and then coming back, it had changed into a training ground. Only he himself knew that he currently had the faint urge to exchange a few blows on the training ground. It was as if there were some frustrations inside that he needed to vent.

Song Qinglan walked to a sandbag without looking back, “This place makes me feel relaxed and comfortable. Why? I can’t?”

Duan Wen approached the ring and smiled in Song Qinglan’s direction, “Captain, go for a round?”

Song Qinglan, “I won’t go easy on you.”

Duan Wen, “If you won’t then you won’t. I’ve fucking always wanted to go against someone strong.”

After finally successfully closing the crevice in time and space and escaping from the indulgent bubble world, they had still returned here, unable to escape from Tianqiong’s control.

This group of men felt that rather than being depressed, it was better to pass time happily without worrying too much.

Song Qinglan found some black bandages and slowly wrapped it around his hand.

He took off his shoes and jumped into the ring barefoot. He had already used his thoughts to change his clothes. Grey t-shirt and black shorts. It was the most commonly seen Guardian training attire.

The two faced each other. Duan Wen had also changed into the same clothes, but his appearance paled considerably compared to Song Qinglan.

Since becoming a fighting instructor for the Guardians, Song Qinglan hadn’t had much of a chance to exchange blows with his teammates.

Except for Zhou Mingxuan, everyone else in the team pretty much just got beaten up.

In this illusionary space, Duan Wen had actually taken the initiative. All his teammates watched from the sidelines with excitement.

“Brother Wen! Get him!”

“Don’t hold back!”

“Cap Song, don’t hit Brother Wen’s face!”

Song Qinglan added another strip across his forehead and tied it behind his head to prevent sweat from dripping down. Standing on the ring, Song Qinglan appeared even more aggressive.

His nose was tall and his eyes were sharp. He hooked his right hand at Duan Wen, “Come.”

The two circled around for half a circle. Duan Wen threw out a right uppercut which Song Qinglan avoided by moving to the side.

Without giving Duan Wen a chance to react, a gust of wind swept through and Song Qinglan landed a punch on his stomach.

Duan Wen grunted in pain. He knew that Song Qinglan had always been steady and ruthless and would definitely not give him an opportunity to fight back. He could only silently curse and sweep his leg out. Song Qinglan however seemed to have already expected this. He grabbed Duan Wen’s right leg and pulled. As Duan Wen fell, he quickly flipped, barely allowing him to stand firm.

Both were very powerful and each of their actions were sharp and precise. Just those few blows were enough to make everyone eyes shine with enthusiasm.

It could be seen that neither went easy on the other person.

But Song Qinglan was quite patient this time and he didn’t end the fight so quickly. He instead waited for Duan Wen to strike and would then retaliate without giving the other party a chance to fight back. It was as if he was playing around with Duan Wen.

This angered Duan Wen and his original composure disappeared. His moves soon became messy, and each blow was quick and ruthless.

Amid the sound of fists hitting flesh was the sound of applause and cheers. The two were covered in sweat. In that short period of time, nearly fifty or sixty blows had been exchanged.

Duan Wen was soon pressed down onto the ground. He gasped for air and his face was littered with bruises, “N-no more.”

“How many times have I told you that you shouldn’t become agitated?”

Song Qinglan was also beaten by Duan Wen such that there was a bruised patch at the corner of his lips. He reached out, “After becoming agitated, you lose composure and will surely lose every time.”

Duan Wen grabbed his captain’s hand and stood up. The bruises on his face slowly faded. He wiped away the sweat on his face and swore, “Fuck, you think this is because of my inability to maintain composure?”

After Duan Wen got off the ring, another person came up.

This time it was Tang Qi.

The audience below cheered.

“Go Tang Qi!”

“You can do it, brother!! Beat Cap Song up!”

Song Qinglan glanced down from the ring and saw that this group of people had even pulled out beers and dared to treat him as a free-to-view TV program.

Even Ji Yushi held a can and stood among the teammates with a look of great interest.

Tang Qi was in high spirits, but he followed after Duan Wen’s footsteps and was soon pressed to the ground.

Li Chun climbed up onto the ring. Song Qinglan admired his courage very much and then refused, “Go down.”

Li Chun, “The hell? Am I not worthy?”

Song Qinglan looked down at him from above, “Don’t want to play with you. Let Old Zhou come up.”

“Old Zhou!”

“Old Zhou!”

Amidst the cheers, Li Chun cursed and walked off the ring.

The small-eyed Zhou Mingxuan narrowed his eyes further. As Song Qinglan’s comrade in the army, he was someone who knew Song Qinglan’s fighting abilities the best and as another fighting instructor, Zhou Mingxuan and Song Qinglan were equals.

His interest had been aroused long ago and he had been waiting for this moment.

Zhou Mingxuan passed the beer to the side, “Hold it for this brother.”

Tang Le immediately received it and cheekily exclaimed, “Old Zhou, I’m on your side! Beat that Cap Song down!”

Li Chun also leaned forward and massaged Zhou Mingxuan’s shoulders, “Good luck brother. I’m also on your side. Cap Song is too arrogant. You must avenge your brothers and show him who’s boss.”

Zhou Mingxuan calmly accepted it all, “Of course, of course.”

On the ring, Song Qinglan had already emptied an entire bottle of mineral water. With his head raised, sweat rolled down his neck. His originally orderly black hair had also become messy, giving him a wild and dangerous vibe.

Only Zhou Mingxuan was able to put up a fight against him so Song Qinglan had left him till last.

Song Qinglan, “Are you done playing around? If you’re done, come up.”

Zhou Mingxuan shrugged. He worked his wrists and walked onto the ring.

At this moment, a cold voice sounded, “Wait a minute.”

Everyone looked over. The one who spoke was Ji Yushi.

The beer in Ji Yushi’s hand disappeared and it was replaced with bandages. He started to wrap them around his hand.

Everyone: “???”

No way. Could Advisor Ji be thinking of doing what they’re thinking he’s going to do?

Ji Yushi’s figure was the thinnest among the people here and in terms of fighting skills, he also didn’t have much skill. Song Qinglan’s brute force alone was enough to make the situation bad for Ji Yushi. Everyone was shocked and wanted to dissuade Ji Yushi.

“Advisor Ji!”

“Listen to me Advisor Ji. Don’t fight against Cap Song.”

“Yeah, you don’t have to be involved!”

Ji Yushi had already finished wrapping the bandages around his hands. Under the eyes of everyone present, he lightly jumped onto the ring.

He stood in front of Song Qinglan, his body firm and tall. He was refreshing and clean with not a single drop of sweat on him.

“Cap Song, coming?” He hooked his hand and asked.



# Chapter 58: Chapter 58

## Transfer Station

### Chapter 58

It wasn't like the two had never exchanged blows before. For example, at the bookstore last time, Song Qinglan had achieved overwhelming victory over Ji Yushi in a very short amount of time.

But it was as if Ji Yushi had completely forgotten about that. Not only did he challenge Song Qinglan in front of everyone, but his expression was also very calm, as if he really had a chance at winning.

Such a behaviour from Ji Yushi was undoubtedly a form of provocation for Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan's handsome brows furrowed, "I won't go easy on you."

Ji Yushi copied Duan Wen's words, "No need. I've also always wanted to go against someone strong."

The provocation was even stronger.

With this, even the rest of the audience stopped trying to dissuade Ji Yushi and started to cheer.

"Ohhh!!"

Song Qinglan really didn't want to fight against Ji Yushi but he didn't say anything and just raised his chin, "Come."

Both barefoot, they circled around each other.

The atmosphere suddenly became tense and even the teammates in the audience were silent.

Rather than the fight itself, it seemed that they were more concerned about whether Song Qinglan would actually throw his fist at Ji Yushi —— Based on how the two usually interacted, it didn't seem possible.

Song Qinglan may be a little wild, but it wasn't to the extent where he would attack Ji Yushi.

What's more, Ji Yushi likely wouldn't be able to take more than a few of Song Qinglan's punches.

Sure enough, Song Qinglan didn't take the initiative to attack.

Although he had said that he wouldn't go easy on Ji Yushi, compared to the ferocity when facing his teammates, his current attitude could be considered as indulging.

After a short while, Ji Yushi's expression changed, and he threw a hard right fist out.

Song Qinglan responded by tucking his abdomen in and quickly shifting his centre of gravity back. At the same time, he used his right hand to deflect Ji Yushi's punch. What everyone didn't expect however, was that Ji Yushi didn't retreat and instead switched to using his elbow. It hit Song Qinglan's chest heavily and he then grabbed his wrist and exerted a powerful force, "Bang——"

Song Qinglan was mercilessly thrown over Ji Yushi's shoulder, falling heavily onto the ground!

"Ugh!" Song Qinglan let out a low grunt and quickly jumped back up.

The two confronted each other again.

Ji Yushi again hooked his hand at him. It wasn't difficult to see a trace of glee in his beautiful eyes.

Those set of moves had exceeded everyone's expectations. Everyone immediately applauded and whistled.

“Wow!! Advisor Ji is awesome!!”

“Woah!!!”

If the enemy doesn't move, I'll move.

Ji Yushi firmly abided by this train of thought. Regardless of whether Song Qinglan would go easy on him, in short, he threw out several consecutive fierce blows in a row. Song Qinglan however reacted fast. As long as he wanted to, Ji Yushi wouldn't be able to land a single punch on him.

One fought while the other blocked. In a blink of an eye, more than a dozen blows had been exchanged.

Every time a punch was blocked by Song Qinglan, Ji Yushi's arm felt like he was hitting an iron plate. Rather than hurting the enemy, he was hurting himself instead.

Ji Yushi changed tactics. After a punch, he spun around and swept his leg out— Everyone was anxious. This was a trick Duan Wen had used earlier. Ji Yushi would most definitely be caught! Sure enough, Song Qinglan grabbed Ji Yushi's calf and pulled back.

Wait a minute!

Ji Yushi had practiced Jiu-Jitsu just for this very moment!

In that posture, the moment his body touched the ground, Ji Yushi exerted force at his waist and relied on his extremely flexible body to flip onto Song Qinglan's back. From there, he locked his arm firmly around Song Qinglan's neck!

“Fuck!!!”

“Get him! Get him!”

The two fought with their bodies pressed closely together.

When Ji Yushi was pushed to the ground by Song Qinglan, he had almost vomited out blood. His grip loosened and the two separated.

“Advisor Ji.” Song Qinglan also wasn’t in good condition. Sweat dripped endlessly, “You’re for real?!”

“Of course.” Ji Yushi, “This is called respecting the opponent.”

Song Qinglan hooked up the corner of his lips.

Following that was a show that far exceeded the imagination of the teammates. Song Qinglan finally faced his opponent squarely and for the first time, he made the first move. Sweeping his leg and hitting with his elbow and fist, Song Qinglan was so fast, Ji Yushi almost couldn’t react in time. Ji Yushi began to lose ground. Song Qinglan’s attacks were both powerful and fierce. No matter how agile Ji Yushi may be, he wasn’t able to overcome this oppressive force. Each time, he was only able to barely escape from being hit.

The situation had reversed. Ji Yushi could only try and find a chance to fight back. Using the Jiu-Jitsu he had practiced, he would stick himself firmly onto Song Qinglan, but Song Qinglan didn’t give him an opportunity for it.

“Come on!! Advisor Ji, you can do it!”

“Take him down!”

“Fight back!!”

Ji Yushi had just watched two rounds earlier as an audience. Song Qinglan’s habits and moves had all been clearly recorded into his mind.

Faced with a new round of attacks, Ji Yushi bent over to avoid Song Qinglan’s hook and then turned around and landed a punch on Song Qinglan’s face.

Song Qinglan was hit. The corner of his lips immediately began to bleed. The desire to win in his eyes grew stronger. Ji Yushi intuitively sensed that it wasn't good. Suddenly, his body became lighter and he was thrown to the ground by Song Qinglan.

The two were pressed face to face together. Ji Yushi's body was dripping with sweat and even his eyelashes were wet. His skin was so pale, it made it hard for one to look away, and at this moment he was panting heavily.

Song Qinglan was slightly stunned. This situation reminded him of that time when they were in the kiosk. It was just that it was so dim at that time so he couldn't see Ji Yushi clearly and the other party also wasn't sweating this much.

"Let me go." Ji Yushi said in a small voice. It was so small, only the two could hear it.

Was this begging for mercy?

After Song Qinglan was hit, the corner of his lips still hurt a lot, but he immediately remembered that the other party was actually very fragile. Last time he hadn't used all his strength, but it had left Ji Yushi with a bruise around his wrist.

Ji Yushi's clear eyes that seemed to be coated with a layer of clean spring water looked back at Song Qinglan. He looked calm and his rosy lips opened and closed, "Cap Song, don't you find this kind of physical contact uncomfortable?"

Song Qinglan reacted instantly.

Based on Ji Yushi's vengeful character, did he choose close combat as a way to get back at him for their contemptuous attitude earlier when they were talking about Lin Xinlan?

But, he had never regarded Ji Yushi as the same type of person as Lin Xinlan.

While Song Qinglan was thinking his, he had lost his usual vigilance and very soon his world spun around. Ji Yushi had exerted some force and managed to flip the situation around. With him straddling on Song Qinglan's back, he used his hands and knees to press him down.

The other teammates excitedly started the countdown, "Five! Four! Three! —"

Song Qinglan internally cursed. These bastards. Why didn't they countdown earlier when he was winning?

Having landed a hit on Song Qinglan, Ji Yushi had vented his anger and no longer wanted to fight. Even if he continued, he would lose anyway.

And so, he twisted Song Qinglan's arm back, "Cap Song, do you admit defeat?"

Song Qinglan slackened completely and slumped on the floor. He let out a long sigh, ".....Mhn."

The sound wasn't very willing. It meant that as long as Ji Yushi was done venting, he was willing to surrender voluntarily.

Ji Yushi understood.

"Cap Song, what do you mean by mhn?!" Li Chun gloated mischievously and insisted that he made it clear, "Say it quickly. Did you lose?"

Song Qinglan gave up his dignity, "I lost."

Although Ji Yushi didn't win because of his abilities, he wasn't unhappy. After standing up, he even gently kicked Song Qinglan, "Cap Song, next time don't underestimate your opponent. Thank you for going easy on me this time."

The crowd laughed mercilessly, "Hahahahaha!"

Ji Yushi got off the ring. The other teammates all rushed over and chattered humorously. Several even grabbed Song Qinglan by his limbs and tried to

throw their captain off the ring like a sandbag.

Song Qinglan knew that this was only for fun. No one, including Ji Yushi, would take the victory or defeat here seriously.

The fight not only did not allow him to vent, but it also seemed to have made his mood worse.

Song Qinglan laid flat on the ground amidst the mocking and didn't want to move a single finger. From the corner of his eyes, he saw Ji Yushi change into a clean set of clothes and walk towards the water station.

Kind of handsome. He thought.

\*

There was pretty much everything in the illusion. As long as they thought about it, anything could appear.

Time passed by normally in the simulated world.

In the evening, Tang Qi proceeded to make a whole roasted lamb while Tang Le sorted the drinks out. After a round of eating and drinking, Li Chun even took them to disco.

The music was deafening. The courtyard filled with cultural air was at this moment filled with colourful and vulgar lights.

The group of people rocked their heads back and forth. If anyone else saw this scene, they would have thought that this was a gathering of madmen.

"I wonder what's going on with Big Beard." Li Chun spun around, ".....Damn that Tianqiong! Anfalahagenhe!"

Everyone, "Anfalahagenhe!"

Song Qinglan stood away from these group of madmen. He turned and clinked glasses with Duan Wen who sat next to him and drank. Since time

wouldn't change in this case of time and space hijacking, Song Qinglan as the captain allowed his teammates to indulge themselves.

Not long afterwards, he noticed that a certain someone was missing, "Where's Advisor Ji?"

Duan Wen was lying on the bench. Probably because he was remembering the wife and daughter in the bubble world, he had already drunk until his mind was no longer clear.

After thinking for a while, Duan Wen finally spoke, "Oh, I think he said he was going for a walk?"

"Walk?"

Song Qinglan didn't understand. The outside of this courtyard was all dark. What walk?

Song Qinglan raised his head and gulped down the rest of his alcohol. He still felt that the number of people here didn't add up, "And where did Old Zhou go?"

Duan Wen looked like he had aged, "Went with Advisor Ji."

With Duan Wen saying that, Song Qinglan could basically guess where they had gone. The transfer stations set by Tianqiong was different for everyone so they were either at Zhou Mingxuan's or Ji Yushi's transfer station.

What were they doing together?

Could Zhou Mingxuan talk to Ji Yushi? With Old Zhou's mouth, surely he wouldn't accidentally offend Ji Yushi?

Song Qinglan placed down his bottle. Duan Wen glanced over, "You're going? I'll help you watch over them."

These young ones can go quite wild. Duan Wen thought Song Qinglan was probably worried about leaving them unattended.



Song Qinglan, “Not going.”

Since the two had left together, they must have made a prior appointment. The one who had persuaded Zhou Mingxuan to leave the bubble world with them was Ji Yushi. Perhaps Zhou Mingxuan wanted to thank Ji Yushi. That guy may act tough, but his heart was soft. He was actually a pretty good person.

Moreover, in the bubble world, Zhou Mingxuan had to some certain extent faced the same decision as Ji Yushi. This was a situation where people can only get comfort from those with similar experiences.

What’s more, Zhou Mingxuan was a straight man. Ji Yushi also has his boyfriends.

But.

Song Qinglan’s expression turned cold.

As for Ji Yushi’s attitude towards relationships, it probably didn’t matter.

Song Qinglan immediately stopped his thoughts from straying too far. When did he start using such thoughts to assess another person?

But that single tear Ji Yushi had shed when he was bewitched by the phone call in the bubble world once again surfaced to his mind — When facing others, for example people who have shared similar experiences or lovers, would Ji Yushi entrust them with his trust and tell them the secrets and concerns buried deep in his heart? Would he also reveal his helpless and fragile side to them?

Song Qinglan couldn’t imagine what it would be like if those tears were wiped away by another person.

To him, Ji Yushi was different.

It was like there was something ready to burst out from his heart.

The belated answer made Song Qinglan very irritated. He combed through his hair with his fingers and his eyebrows twisted together in annoyance.

Ignoring those noisy teammates, Song Qinglan strode into the house.

He passed by the training room and walked deep down the corridor. He wanted to go back to the room he used to stay in as a child to rest and along the way calm himself down a little.

But the moment he opened the heavy door, he was left stunned in place.

Floor-to-ceiling window. Soft curtains.

Wooden bed. White and fluffy bedding.

There were some paper books scattered across the floor and there was a warm night light on the bedside table.

He had clearly only seen it once, but that warm, quiet and peaceful scene had remained deep in Song Qinglan's subconscious.

He had never imagined that the place that would allow him to calm down and relax, was actually Ji Yushi's bedroom.

# Chapter 59: Chapter 59

## Transfer Station

### Chapter 59

The bed was empty. The night outside could faintly be seen through the curtains.

The blankets on the bed was messy, as if someone had just slept in it. It even made one feel that if they reached over and touched it, there would still be some lingering warmth.

Everything had remained just like how it was when Song Qinglan saw it in the bubble world.

Song Qinglan stood there, his heart beating violently.

In an instant, his ears were filled with the pounding of his heart. Blood seemed to rush from the soles of his feet to the top of his head. He was hot all over. He finally figured out what was going on.

His heart had never been moved in his entire life.

The first time he felt this, the other party turned out to be completely different from what he had imagined when he was younger. Regardless of whether it was the appearance, personality or gender, it was all different.

However, as soon as he received this signal from his heart, the feeling surged inside him like a tide. It was so turbulent that he was caught off guard, but it was also something that he felt was normal. What different? It clearly was something that should've been like this in the first place.

As it turned out, the irritation and dissatisfaction he felt towards Ji Yushi as well as the trust and concern, it wasn't without reason.

Fuck.

Song Qinglan was annoyed by how slow he was. At the same time, he felt a stronger kind of irritation.

Unable to say it, unable to do anything; just standing there was enough to make his body numb and his palms hot.

“Cap Song.”

Ji Yushi's voice travelled over.

Song Qinglan froze for a moment. At almost the same time as the moment he heard the voice, he had reflexively closed the door with a 'bang'.

All those shameful hidden desires had been concealed away. The blood that had rushed to the top of his head seemed to have started to flow back.

Reality had pulled his senses back in an instant.

Song Qinglan calmly turned his head. He pretended that nothing had happened.

He saw Ji Yushi come over from the other end of the corridor. The two were only a dozen of steps apart.

It was unknown if it was because of the impact of his realisation just now but his thoughts became clearer. The Ji Yushi at this moment reminded Song Qinglan of the moment he first met him at the Tiangqiong Jiang City branch.

At that time, Ji Yushi stood before a floor-to-ceiling window. With his back against the dazzling lights, that calm and cold look of his was difficult to forget.

But at this moment, even in the dark corridor and without any proper lighting, Ji Yushi's cold temperament still made it hard for one to look away.

Reaching Song Qinglan, Ji Yushi stopped, "What are you doing standing in front of the door?"

Song Qinglan, "....."

The difference between them was half a head. Song Qinglan was too tall and once closer, Ji Yushi could feel a sense of oppression.

The same was true this time too.

Song Qinglan's expression at this moment was still the same but Ji Yushi somehow felt that the oppressiveness was stronger than usual. Compared to before, the current Song Qinglan seemed a little daunting. It was quite confusing.

Since he already knew the other party's behaviour and habits, Ji Yushi didn't step back and just calmly stood in place with one hand in his trouser pocket, "Is there anything inside?"

Song Qinglan answered faintly, "Nothing. Just the room I used when I was a child."

Ji Yushi's eyes moved slightly. He asked curiously, "Your room as a child? Can I take a look?"

"....." Song Qinglan spoke stiffly, "There's nothing to see. It's all toys."

He appeared expressionless but internally he was trying to figure out what he should do if Ji Yushi insisted on going in.

Wait a minute. Since this Tianqiong could change the place according to one's thoughts, it shouldn't be too difficult to change the illusion in that room. Song Qinglan however wasn't sure what they would see if they opened that door again.

If it didn't change, then the situation would be interesting — Seeing your own bed and your own bedroom appearing in another person's subconscious, it was impossible for someone as intelligent as Ji Yushi to not be able to guess the reason.

Song Qinglan absolutely didn't want that kind of situation to occur.

The two stood face to face like this in silence for several seconds.

Song Qinglan: "If the enemy doesn't move, I won't move."

Fortunately, Ji Yushi didn't seem to have noticed anything and didn't mention the room again.

He instead took out something from his pocket and gave it to Song Qinglan, "I picked it up just now. For you."

Song Qinglan curiously received it. Ji Yushi had given him a white starfish. The small starfish was still a little heavy and it carried along with it the subtle smell of sea water. His heart felt like it was tickled by a feather, but Song Qinglan spoke coldly, "Starfish? You two went to the beach?"

Intuitively sensing that the other party was a little upset, Ji Yushi was confused.

Could it be that men can also have those days of the month?

"Yeah. The transfer station on my end happened to be the beach I visited when I was seventeen." Ji Yushi said, "Kado. Have you been there?"

Kado was an island with crystal clear waters and white sandy beaches. It is currently a popular travel destination but back in those days, Kado was just one of the many small islands attached to the country.

"I've heard of it, but I haven't been there." Song Qinglan said, "I was already enlisted into the army the year you went."

After enlisting, he had spent a bloody career in the special forces and when he retired, he directly joined Tianqiong as a Guardian.

Time was precious and there was a lot to do at work. Even during his vacations, Song Qinglan didn't have enough time or energy to organise a relaxing trip for himself.

Song Qinglan held the starfish in his palm and could feel it's somewhat wet and rough texture, "I picked up a lot of shells when I went to other beaches as a child, but I've never seen a starfish."

Ji Yushi said, "I have also never picked one up before."

Song Qinglan glanced at him. It was as if he was asking 'didn't you pick one up this time?'.

Ji Yushi said, "Perhaps as long as you subconsciously want something, Tianqiong would give it to you. Desires cannot be hidden from it, there is practically nowhere to hide."

Song Qinglan's expression suddenly became a little strange, "....."

Song Qinglan felt uncomfortable everywhere. At this moment, Ji Yushi ended the topic, "When you have a chance to in the future after going back, you can go and have a vacation at Kado. You might be able to pick one up there."

After going back?

The thought that had been pushing everyone through was the thought of going back.

That real reality was different from the bubble world. Everyone's life would be restored to its original state and there would be no more Chief Qi that would make Ji Yushi enter a state of confusion. It was just that Song Qinglan didn't know if they would still be in contact after they return.

This topic was suddenly being touched upon because everyone knew that they couldn't stay in the transfer station for long.

Only after completing the missions arranged by Tianqiong could they return, so no matter how comfortable the transfer station may be, it was

only an illusion in the mind. A short mental break was enough. The most important thing was returning to reality.

Ji Yushi only now talked about the reason why he came to find Song Qinglan, “Cap Song. Everyone wants to invite you over to have a small meeting.”

Song Qinglan was surprised, “So fast?”

That group has played enough?

Ji Yushi said, “It’s all just an illusion anyway. They’re not really drunk.”

Song Qinglan would rather that they were really drunk. He didn’t really want to have a meeting right now and just wanted some time alone.

If Ji Yushi was willing to chat with him, then the two of them alone was fine too.

Song Qinglan’s heart was still beating haphazardly. He both wanted his time alone with Ji Yushi to continue and to end.

\*

The two talked as they walked out. The teammates were still creating a ruckus while drinking. Zhou Mingxuan had also returned and was leaning back in a chair, drinking. Seeing that Song Qinglan had arrived, Zhou Mingxuan picked up a can of beer and tossed it at Song Qinglan, “Cap Song!”

Song Qinglan received the beer and glanced at him.

That glance made the hair on Zhou Mingxuan’s back stand. It reminded him of the time when Song Qinglan caught him stealing someone else’s steamed buns back in the army.

After Zhou Mingxuan’s hair fell back down again, he belatedly realised that he hadn’t done anything wrong though?



Song Qinglan cracked open the can and downed half of it in one go, “Speak. What are your plans moving forward?”

Everyone gathered around. Sure enough, they were each more sober than the other. Not one of them were drunk.

Having had their fill, it was time to discuss when to start the next mission. It wouldn’t be good indulging endlessly in the illusion.

Li Chun was still holding a hookah in his hand and was sweating profusely, “Although continuing to play like this is fun, it just doesn’t feel right. I want to suggest that we set a time, such as playing around for another ten days —”

Everyone looked over.

Li Chun quickly stopped talking and changed his words, “Such as playing around for another seven days! After seven days, we can set out and do whatever mission is thrown at us. Like this, we can indulge ourselves over the seven days without a worry! What do you think?!”

“You still want seven to ten days?” Duan Wen knocked onto the back of his head, “I’ll give you half a month and even give you a beauty as a treat for your eyes, how does that sound?”

Everyone laughed.

“Don’t insult beauties!”

“Believe it or not, even if there are no beauties, Li Chun can still play!”

“How about I bring out bars and nightclubs for you too?”

“Then how many days?”

Li Chun threw away the hookah which disappeared as soon as it hit the ground. Here in this place, they were like gods or even magicians.

Li Chun held up three fingers, “How about three days?! Is three days alright?”

Three days. It sounded like a good number.

But except for Tang Le who was a little moved, no one else responded.

“No way?!” Li Chun wanted to cry without tears, “You even think three days is too much?”

Song Qinglan took another sip of his beer, “What are everyone’s opinions?”

As soon as he said that everyone no longer kept to themselves. Anyone could tell that Song Qinglan’s tone was serious.

“After sleeping for a night, it should be enough.” Duan Wen said, “I want to get out of this as soon as possible. Regardless of how much time has passed for me in the real world, I just want it to be over soon.”

Tang Qi, “I agree.”

Tang Le, “.....”

Zhou Mingxuan was chill, “I think staying another day or staying another three days makes no difference to me so of course the sooner the better.”

With this, the only one left who hadn’t expressed their opinion yet was Ji Yushi.

Sensing everyone’s gazes, Ji Yushi calmly spoke, “Why don’t we first take a look at what the next mission is?”

“I agree.” Song Qinglan’s used his slender finger to wipe away the beer stain on his lips, “It would be better to be more prepared this time.”

After saying that, Song Qinglan who was standing in the centre turned on the communicator.

“Next mission.”

He spoke coldly, omitting even the title.

Tianqiong's voice system soon appeared, "Detected that you have already completed a Super S-level mission 'Ouroboros', an A-level mission 'Chaos', and an S-level side mission 'Who Am I'. You currently have the ability to complete Super S-level missions. As such, the next mission is Super-S level. It is recommended that you rest well before unlocking the next mission."

Those words were very familiar.

When they first arrived at the transfer station last time, Tianqiong had said something similar before disappearing, not giving them an opportunity to control how long they could rest for.

Everyone's expression was poor. Song Qinglan spoke, "If you shut off, I will reject the mission. Tell me what the next mission is."

Everyone, "....."

Tianqiong kindly explained, "Your next mission is 'Rubik's Cube'."

As soon as it finished saying that a prompt appeared on the holographic projection.

[Mission mode: Rubik's Cube.]

[Mission rule: Death elimination.]

[Mission objective: Joining.]

Death elimination.

Ji Yushi's pupils instantly constricted. The scenes from the Ouroboros mission surfaced to his mind.

Tang Qi who was bitten to death by zombies, Duan Wen who sacrificed himself, Zhou Mingxuan who died in the car....The deaths of his teammates

as well as himself played over and over again. That terrible world where there was no end in sight, could it be that it was about to start again?

Seeing those two words, all the teammates were silent.

Song Qinglan, “Is there a time anchor in this mission?”

Having a time anchor meant that they could be reborn indefinitely.

Tianqiong, “Unfortunately no. A time anchor cannot be set for this mission.”

“The fuck?”

“Dammit. Can we just not do the mission?”

“How on earth are we going to go back?!”

Outbursts sounded from the crowd. If Tianqiong had a physical body, it would most definitely be rendered into dust in an instant.

Unfortunately, it was just a system. Hearing the question, it just answered mechanically, “You are already very close to the objective.”

It was another ambiguous answer. The group cursed angrily but no matter how they asked and no matter how they threatened, the system was unwilling to say anything else.

The teammates couldn’t be blamed for getting angry. Even Song Qinglan wanted to explode, but he said calmly, “Mission objective: Join. What does it mean? Be more detailed.”

In the first few missions, a lot of time had been lost due to the ambiguity of the mission.

If they could figure out the objective faster, perhaps they could avoid too many losses and also complete the mission faster.

Tianqiong, “I do not understand what you mean.”

It was just a system.

It seems that asking it to be clearer on the objective was too much for it.

Ji Yushi asked, “Are there any other information you can give us?”

As soon as he spoke, everyone quietened down.

It was as if Ji Yushi had become their anchor. As long as he could solve a problem, it wasn't a problem.

Tianqiong said, “In this mission, you will meet other squads that I have recruited. It will be a multiplayer mission.”

# Chapter 60: Chapter 60

## Transfer Station

Chapter 60

Other squads recruited?

“There are others?”

Tang Qi couldn't help asking.

Several parts sympathy, several parts disbelief as well as several parts anger. Everyone was left speechless by the Tianqiong system's shamelessness.

It even dared to call it recruiting? It was clearly a case of hijacking and threatening. How could anyone in this world take the initiative to risk their lives just to complete some unknown missions?

“Yes.” Tianqiong said, “In other time and spaces, there are many people like you who work on maintaining peace in their time and space. According to their evaluated skill levels, the mission level unlocked by each team is different.”

Zhou Mingxuan snorted. He then asked, “Let me ask, are there any rewards for completing the missions assigned?”

He was only asking that casually. He had never expected anything from this cheating system anyway.

None of them expected any rewards.

But surprisingly, Tianqiong actually answered, “After completing the missions I have prepared for you, you will receive rewards from me.”

The Tianqiong system was involved with the management of time and space so the reward from it would naturally be related to time and space. Hearing it say this, Ji Yushi’s expression changed slightly and even his eyelashes quivered a little. His expression however very soon settled back down again. He had always been good at hiding his emotions. Calm and self-sufficient, not showing any of his emotions. It made it hard for others to know his inner thoughts.

Song Qinglan however knew.

In front of everyone, Song Qinglan didn’t direct his gaze at Ji Yushi and just asked, “What reward? Travelling through time and space? Or living in another time and space? Or.....are you going put us in another illusion?”

Tianqiong, “On the premise of the timeline not being affected, I can give you any reward you request.”

In other words, not only those mentioned by Song Qinglan were an option, but Tianqiong could even give them more than that.

For those who have something they desire or something they regret, this was extremely tempting, but for those who have no desires and are satisfied with their real life, this reward was very pointless. However, human desires have no limits. In any case, it was better than nothing.

Everyone’s anger subsided somewhat.

Tianqiong continued, “After completing the mission, you can choose to redeem the reward immediately, or you can choose to stay and continue unlocking more missions to get more rewards.”

Zhou Mingxuan who asked the question spoke, “Forget it. Who the fuck would want to continue unlocking your missions?”

Song Qinglan directly turned off the holographic projection and together with it the Tianqiong system was also turned off.

“Why don’t.....we rest for a few more days.” Li Chun suggested weakly, “Rubik’s Cube. Just the sound of it scares me.”

“There is no way to prepare for this mission.” Tang Qi said, “We’re going to have to deal with it sooner or later anyway.”

Everyone began to discuss.

Tang Le was speechless, “I also think that. It was okay when we didn’t know what the mission was but now that I know, I don’t think I would be able to play with my heart at ease.”

Zhou Mingxuan grunted in agreement.

Duan Wen asked, “Advisor Ji, what do you think?”

The one who had suggested that they check the mission was Ji Yushi. He sure was clever. With this, everyone would naturally consider the pros and cons once they knew about the details of the mission.

Ji Yushi thought for a moment, “The mission this time is more dangerous than the others. I’m currently thinking, what does the so-called death elimination mean?”

He flipped over his hand to reveal a piece of chocolate sitting in his palm. He peeled off the foil wrapping and placed it in his mouth, his cheek bulging out as a result.

He seemed to be slowly savouring the bitter taste of the chocolate which helped him with clearing his mind. He spoke slowly, “In the Ouroboros mission, the deaths we faced were scary but because of the existence of the time anchor, we were able to resurrect every time. In Chaos, although there wasn’t a time anchor there, everything would return to how it was originally once the crevice in time and space was closed. As for the bubble world, it



was a larger time anchor and, after we leave, the cycle would start again and the dead would come back to life.”

With Ji Yushi’s calm analysis, everyone gradually calmed down and followed his thought process.

Song Qinglan also had some new thoughts, but he didn’t interrupt him.

Everyone in the seventh squad had grown used to a scene like this where Ji Yushi guided everyone through as he brainstormed.

“I’m thinking that in this case of time and space hijacking, a time anchor may not be a necessary condition for resurrection.” Ji Yushi said, “Like Chaos, as long as we complete the mission, we would be able to return to the moment we were hijacked, that is, the third second after we set off.”

Seeing the changes on everyone’s faces, Ji Yushi paused for a moment and added, “This is just a guess. I am not certain.”

Song Qinglan continued, “I understand what you mean. You’re basically saying that in the ‘Rubik’s Cube’ mission, the so-called ‘death elimination’ doesn’t necessarily mean a real death but rather being eliminated from the mission. When someone dies in the mission, they would be forced to terminate the mission, unable to continue.”

“Yes. I think that if this was the case, then the person who was forced to terminate the mission would not be able to receive the reward regardless of whether his teammates completed the mission.” Ji Yushi looked at him, “Tianqiong had specifically mentioned that it is a multiplayer mission. My guess is that there is likely a competitive relationship between each of the squads and there will only be one squad who can complete the mission. The squad with more people and less damage have a relatively higher chance of completing the mission.”

“Fuck.....”

“It turned out to be like this.”

“I get it now. As expected of Advisor Ji!”

“With just that little information, you managed analyse so much useful content!”

As the teammates praised him sincerely, Ji Yushi lowered his head slightly. His expression was calm but something flashed through his eyes.

Since when did he get used to expressing himself in front of everyone like this?

This feeling of being trusted was great. He actually liked it very much.

Everyone was still chattering. Song Qinglan digested this information and spoke after some careful consideration, “Take a rest and we’ll set off tomorrow.”

He scanned across his other teammates with his eyes, “Those who haven’t mentally prepared themselves, prepare yourself well tonight. Everyone will need to think twice during the mission tomorrow. This time, we are not representing ourselves as an individual but all of us as a team. The death of one person would not only make themselves unable to finish the mission, but it will also affect the entire team’s progress and chance of success, so——”

Song Qinglan changed his tone. It became more serious, “Tianqiong seventh squad. Not one should be missing.”

Everyone, “Roger!!”

\*

Meeting over.

For their final night, everyone returned to their own transfer stations; they returned to the place they subconsciously found most comfortable.

Li Chun shamelessly claimed that he didn’t dare sleep alone and went with Duan Wen.

Zhou Mingxuan had always done things alone, so he naturally returned by himself while the inseparable twins Tang Qi and Tang Le left together.

The courtyard was quiet in an instant.

With everyone gone, only leftover alcohol bottles, food, light decorations and the likes remained.

Ji Yushi was still standing in place. He was the last to leave.

He raised his wrist and turned on his communicator in preparation to leave. He said to Song Qinglan, “You should rest early. Goodnight.”

“Wait.” Song Qinglan blurted out, “I’ll go with you.”

Ji Yushi raised his eyes, “What’s wrong?”

Song Qinglan didn’t know what to say, “.....”

How could he tell Ji Yushi that there was a room here in this courtyard resembling Ji Yushi’s bedroom?

Although there were plenty of other rooms here and he could completely sleep in another place, but as long as he was aware of the existence of that bedroom, Song Qinglan wouldn’t be able to sleep peacefully. Moreover, he would only think about it more and more if he stayed near that bedroom. Perhaps Tianqiong would even once again enter his subconscious mind and produce something else.

As soon as Song Qinglan said those words, he belatedly felt that it probably wasn’t a good idea.

Leaving with Ji Yushi and going to Ji Yushi’s transfer station wasn’t a good idea for him.

It was okay with the others around but only God knew how chaotic his heart was at this very moment.

But he also couldn't take back his own words. Song Qinglan tried his best to look natural, "That, since there is a chance, I want to take a look at the Kado Beach you mentioned."

Kado had hotels and guest houses. Even if ten seventh squads came to Ji Yushi's transfer station, there was enough room for them all.

Through Tianqiong, the two returned to the beach.

The time here was also night.

In the night, the sea was a dark blue that looked almost black, and the sky was dotted with stars that resembled small diamonds.

There were tourists frolicking on the beach. It was the scene Ji Yushi saw eight years ago.

Accompanied by the sea breeze, the two walked along the beach. There were already two distinct series of footprints on the beach.

Song Qinglan recognised it. They clearly belonged to Zhou Mingxuan and Ji Yushi. He wondered, when Ji Yushi was seventeen years old, did he also have someone walk along the beach with him like this?

Ji Yushi walked ahead.

The sea breeze blew at his shirt, outlining his thin waist.

Someone as frail as him, wandering time and time again into the depths of the past, alone suffering from the pain that came with his memories.

And this time, what kind of unknown journey would they take?

If possible, Song Qinglan hoped that this could end immediately.

But at this time, for the first time, he had the thought that staying here wouldn't be bad. At the very least—

A child holding a crab in his hand was chasing after another child.

They shouted loudly as they ran over. Seeing that they were about to run into Ji Yushi, Song Qinglan deftly pulled him away, "Careful!"

Ji Yushi took a step back. He turned his head back, "I'm fine."

With that step back, he found his back pressed against Song Qinglan's chest.

With the two at such close proximity, they could almost feel each other's breath.

Ji Yushi's beautifully shaped full lips were very close.

It wasn't that they hadn't been this close before.

But this time, Song Qinglan's heart was beating violently. As if he was burned, he quickly retreated.

The emotion that had just barely calmed down had returned. It made it difficult for him to remain indifferent.

Ji Yushi noticed this abnormality, "Cap Song."

Song Qinglan, "Mhn?"

Ji Yushi spoke meaningfully, "If I didn't know you well, I would've almost thought....."

Song Qinglan said with a cold face, "Thought what?"

Thought that, he liked him?

The mood suddenly become tense.

It was a one-sided kind.

When Song Qinglan wasn't smiling, because of his deep and sharp appearance, he looked quite intimidating.

Probably unaware of this fact, he even raised his eyebrow, making people feel that if they dared to guess his mind, he wouldn't go easy on them.

Who knew that Ji Yushi was just joking?

Just like the time in the kiosk in PU-31, he also had a playful side, "I almost thought that you were unhappy with Old Zhou and I coming to the beach and wanted to come too."

Song Qinglan's eyelid twitched, "Hah, am I a child?"

Ji Yushi turned around, lowered his head and continued walking. The blowing wind made his next words almost inaudible.

Song Qinglan didn't hear clearly.

"Of course not." He spoke a little regretfully, "You were....much more honest and cute as a child."

# Chapter 61: Chapter 61

A sleepless night.

The sound of waves could faintly be heard from outside the window and the air carried over by the sea breeze was moist. Ji Yushi had difficulty falling asleep.

Before the mission, his thoughts were disordered, and he also couldn't control the various memories constantly surfacing to his mind. It wouldn't be good if it continued like this. He must get back into good condition.

Ji Yushi got up from the bed and took his medicine. He didn't know if the medicine in the illusion would have any effect on him but he did feel better.

By himself, it was difficult distracting himself.

So, without turning on the lights, he took out his black and white game console and played it for several hours by the window. He only managed to fall asleep in the early hours of the morning.

The dream was repetitive and filled with illogical scenes from his memories.

When Ji Yushi opened his eyes again, he had already returned to his capsule.

The violent shaking and bizarre displays on the transparent panel no longer surprised Ji Yushi.

When he heard the familiar, "Warning! Warning! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! You have deviated from the destination

coordinates!”, he even felt a lot less dizzy and just quietly waited for the shaking to pass.

【Illegal transition detected!】

【Illegal transition detected!】

A few seconds later, the capsule quietened down. It meant that he had already arrived at his new destination.

The Tianqiong system didn’t even do its usual processes at face value. All the superfluous things had been stored away.

Ji Yushi undid the safety belts and, while receiving the nutrient solution given by the robotic arm, he looked at the transparent panel in front of him.

Please read this from kk translates

The string of garbled characters displayed on the screen had been replaced by the mission information from Tianqiong.

[Mission mode: Rubik’s Cube.]

[Mission rule: Death elimination.]

[Mission objective: Joining.]

It was already enough seeing this information once before.

Ji Yushi turned off the screen and then opened the door of his capsule and got out.

\*

The light was blinding. Ji Yushi used his hand to block some of it from his eyes.

After he got used to the light, he finally saw where the blinding lights came from — What entered his eyes was a white expanse. It was like a field of



untouched snow. It made it difficult for one to find a point to focus on.

Not far ahead was a red ball about the size of a baseball. It was only because of its existence that Ji Yushi was able to barely tell that this was a square room.

The ceiling, walls and floor were all pure white.

For some reason, there was a red ball floating in the centre of the room.

Ji Yushi looked back behind him. The capsule he had clearly just gotten out of just now was gone and replacing it was a snow-white wall.

Was this the mission destination?

At this moment, someone appeared beside him.

Like some kind of loading animation being played through holographic projection, black boots appeared from the snow-white wall, followed by a black combat uniform and then their face.

Li Chun stepped out with his left foot looking like he had just walked out of a capsule.

He asked, “Advisor Ji! Where is this?”

Ji Yushi shook his head, “I don’t know yet.”

As soon as he finished saying this, a round-faced teammate appeared. He was taken aback by the scene he saw, and he quickly looked back behind him.

Li Chun also did the same. He was horrified, “Holy shit. Where’s the capsule?!”

Just like Ji Yushi’s, their capsules had disappeared. Or to be more precise, the moment they opened the door of the capsule, they had already entered this place. It was like that time in Chaos when they stepped into the mirrored city.

“This is practically stepping into another world. Could this be another crevice or something? Why else would they ask us to join it?” Li Chun examined the room, “Death elimination? There’s nothing here so how could we be eliminated?”

The room was a little quiet. Li Chun turned back and smiled, “Le Le, don’t be afraid! There are no two tailed dogs this time!”

Ji Yushi had already examined the room. As he looked around, he corrected Li Chun without raising his head, “The one who entered was Tang Qi.”

Li Chun, “?”

Tang Qi has had enough. He complained unhappily, “You have already been in this squad for more than a year. How many times has it been now?”

“Fuck. With the uniform on the two of you are just copies of each other.” Li Chun defended himself, “I’m fucking not Advisor Ji who can tell the two of you apart despite looking exactly the same.”

What the twins hated the most was being mistaken as the other twin.

Tang Qi wasn’t happy, but he wasn’t Tang Le who would loudly voice his complaints, so he just kept silent.

For now, this room appeared to be safe, and with the three people around, no one panicked.

The most eye-catching object in this room at this moment was the red ball floating in the centre of the room.

Tang Qi walked over. He raised his hand to try touching it but was stopped by Ji Yushi, “Don’t move!”

Tang Qi immediately withdrew his hand, “Sorry.”

He was indeed being too reckless.

Li Chun on the other end asked, “Advisor Ji, could this be a killing mechanism?”

“Probably not.”

Ji Yushi had already examined that ball. It had a smooth surface and looked very much like an ordinary ball, but he would need to touch it to know more.

He continued, “The Tianqiong system has no reason to send us into a place like this to die and death elimination shouldn’t be this simple. I’m thinking that there must be a reason for this ball to be here.”

“What reason?”

Li Chun followed this train of thought and asked.

Ji Yushi answered him, “There is no way out here. We definitely have no way of completing the mission trapped here. If it was like this then the mission assigned to us by Tianqiong would be meaningless. My guess is, if it is a mechanism, it should be for activating or connecting something. Right now, not everyone is here so let’s not touch it. We can talk about it once we’re all gathered.”

Tang Qi agreed, “You’re right.”

Li Chun, “Sounds good. I almost touched it just now too. We could’ve accidentally separated.”

After briefly expressing his thoughts, Ji Yushi walked around the room again.

Based on his rough calculations. Each step of his was about fifty centimetres and it took ten steps for him to walk along one wall.

In that case, this room was five metres by five metres, a total of twenty-five square metres.

He looked up and visually estimated that the height of the room was about the same as the width. It should be a cube.

Rubik's cube.....

Ji Yushi recalled the mission mode. Could this room be a part of the Rubik's cube?

Everything was still unknown.

Ji Yushi raised his hand and checked his communicator. It had been more than five minutes since the three of them entered this room but no one else had come.

He was a little anxious.

After Ji Yushi finished saying that, Tang Qi tried to connect to the public channel, "Advisor Ji, the public channel cannot connect. I can't contact Cap Song and the others."

"I also noticed. Probably related to the signal." Ji Yushi nodded and frowned slightly, "Do you still remember which wall we came from?"

This seemingly simple question surprised both Tang Qi and Li Chun.

They wouldn't have noticed it themselves if Ji Yushi hadn't asked. After entering this room, they had all moved around and were no longer in their original positions.

The four walls were exactly the same. There was no reference to help distinguish between them. Even Ji Yushi couldn't rely on his memory to do that — None of them were certain which wall they had entered from.

Tang Qi, "I don't remember. Damn."

Li Chun, "Me too!!"

The two subconsciously touched the walls in attempt to find a difference but all that they could feel was a smooth surface.

There were no doors on any of the four walls and no other exits.

The two were at a loss.

What they didn't know was that this was also Ji Yushi's first time where he was unable to rely on his memories.

After Li Chun touched every one of the walls, he gave up completely. The more he thought about it, the more he felt that this mission had its difficulty setting set to max. He simply sat down onto the floor, "Forget it. Let's wait a little more. We'll know which one we came from when Cap Song and the others come."

Ji Yushi didn't speak.

He appeared to be in thought.

Please read this from kk translates

"Let's wait. They will come." Li Chun said again, "It's definitely just small delay. Didn't the same thing happen when we got sucked into the mountain of garbage in the crevice?"

That was a possibility.

Tang Qi expressed his agreement, "That's true. We just don't know how long the wait would be."

Li Chun still remembered the instructions they had received before setting off for this mission, "Let's just wait then. We shouldn't be rashly going around anyway. If any of us die, we would be dragging down the squad's chance of succeeding."

With Ji Yushi around, the two other teammates weren't very worried.

But as for their motivation to take action, they still needed their captain Song Qinglan. One was the brain, and the other was one who took action. The two of them were simply a golden combination in the eyes of their teammates.

Moreover, for some reason, they felt that when Song Qinglan wasn't around, Ji Yushi seemed to be colder and more distant. He wasn't as lively as he was when Song Qinglan was around.

The two were looking forward to Cap Song's arrival more than ever before.

\*

An hour later.

In the empty sealed room, the seemingly endless wait had made their uneasiness worse. The three gradually became a little anxious.

Li Chun was the most talkative. At the beginning, he still chatted with them every now and then.

Tang Qi however was more introverted, and Ji Yushi was also one who didn't like to gossip. After Li Chun talked for a while until his mouth was dry, he gave up and stopped.

"Still waiting?" Li Chun couldn't stand it anymore, "Why does it seem like they're not coming?"

Ji Yushi sat in the corner. He was originally playing Tetris on his game console. The clean, white walls made his features stand out all the more. Hearing that question, he stored away the game console, "It's possible that they have gone to another place."

Tang Qi, "There are other places?"

Ji Yushi said, "There must be. Tianqiong said this is a multiplayer mission so there must be more than just our squad here. We however haven't met anyone else. This means that they must be somewhere else."

This was a so-called 'Tianqiong of all eras'. Since it was responsible for setting up a mission like this, the participants should have arrived in no particular order to ensure fairness.

After waiting for such a long time, it was enough for them to rule out the possibility of Song Qinglan and the others coming.

It was time to act.

Tang Qi walked over and decided to try touching the red ball.

Tang Qi's stature allowed him to reach it easily. As soon as he touched it, he felt some weight. The ball had actually fallen into his hands.

Everyone in the room held their breaths, fearing that something was about to happen.

Fortunately, nothing happened.

This thing seemed to be just an ordinary ball.

Ji Yushi stood up from the corner and walked towards the centre of the room.

“Let me see.” Li Chun stood next to Tang Qi and took the ball. He turned the ball around over and over again, “It seems a little loose here——  
Fuck!!”

“Beep——”

Following a soft sound, a round hole suddenly appeared on the ground. Tang Qi and Li Chun who were standing in the middle of the room were caught off guard and immediately fell in.

Ji Yushi's expression changed instantly. He leapt forward but wasn't able to reach them in time.

“Fuck!”

Ji Yushi couldn't help but throw out the profanity commonly used by the seventh squad. Before he could see the scene below clearly, there was another ‘beep——’ and the round hole closed again.

At the same time, the red ball bounced back to its original position like a spring.

It returned to that place mid-air, floating steadily.

With the fate of his teammates uncertain, Ji Yushi broke out in cold sweat. He immediately retrieved the ball and took a few steps back before examining the loose spot pointed out by Li Chun.

There were indeed some well-hidden buttons there. There were not one, but six.

Ji Yushi randomly pressed one of them. Following a ‘beep—’, he saw a hole about one square metre in size appear on the wall in front of him.

The six buttons represented the six sides of the room.

Turns out, it really was the key to opening an exit.

Ji Yushi tried another two times and managed to make the round hole on the ground reappear.

“Are you alright?!”

He looked down anxiously.

Just as he had imagined, there was also a room below. The walls and ground were similarly pure white.

But the room was empty.

Li Chun and Tang Qi who had fallen earlier had disappeared into thin air.



# Chapter 62: Chapter 62

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 62

From the time Tang Qi and Li Chun fell in through the hole until the time Ji Yushi reopened it, it had taken a dozen of seconds at most.

It was impossible for them to reopen a door and leave in such a short period of time, let alone leave Ji Yushi behind. But where did they go?

Ji Yushi thought of the mission mode — Rubik's Cube.

He scanned through the room below and saw that there was also a small ball floating in that room. It was the same colour as the one in his current room; red. In addition to that, a silver-white ladder had also appeared under the opened hole to help people go to the room below. Tang Qi and Li Chun had directly fallen through because they hadn't had the chance to react.

To go or not to go?

After some thought, Ji Yushi bit off the zipper handle from his clothes with his teeth.

He had nothing on him, let alone a pen. This was the only method for him to leave a mark behind. Holding onto the small zipper handle, he forcefully carved a '7' onto the ground.

In the unlikely event that his other teammates would come to this room after he left, they could at least know that they were here before and wouldn't waste time here.

After he was done, Ji Yushi stored the zipper handle back in his pocket and then climbed down the ladder into the new room.

As soon as he stepped onto the ground, he heard a ‘beep——’.

Immediately afterwards, a circular hole and a ladder appeared on the wall to his left. A new entrance had opened in this room.

Someone was coming.

Could it be Tang Qi and Li Chun?!

Ji Yushi’s pupils constricted.

The first person to appear was a woman.

Caucasian, blond hair, blue eyes. Her hair was cut very short, and she wore black and gold tight fitting clothes. She climbed down from the ladder and very soon reached the ground. Her height was actually a little taller than Ji Yushi. Her entire being looked very cool and handsome — That is, if she wasn’t pointing her gun at Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi took a step back and raised both his hands.

A man appeared behind the woman.

This was a black-haired young man with oriental features. He wore a uniform similar to theirs, but the style was different. The young man’s face and hair was stained with blood that was now almost dry.

The black-haired young man was startled the moment he saw Ji Yushi. He didn’t seem to expect seeing another person here.

“Search him.” The woman spoke. The language used was English.

“Okay.” The black-haired young man said.

The two wore different uniforms. They didn’t seem to be teammates. The black-haired young man didn’t have any weapons. One could tell from his

tone that he had no choice but to listen to the woman's instructions.

The black-haired young man first apologised before searching Ji Yushi from head to toe. All that could be found was a box of medicine and a game console. That was all.

“Check complete. Safe.” The black-haired young man said.

The woman stored away the gun and began to check the room. She seemed to be looking for something.

Ji Yushi lowered his hands, “Can you return the things to me?”

“Huh?” The black-haired young man raised his head, his eyes meeting with Ji Yushi's.

It was a pair of very beautiful and clear eyes with long eyelashes half obscuring the emotions in the eyes. Paired with a particularly outstanding face, it was something that should have left the black-haired young man in awe but somehow, he also felt a chill through him.

“My things.” Ji Yushi repeated himself, “Could you return it to me?”

“Ohhhh!” The black-haired young man quickly returned the items in his hands back to Ji Yushi and apologised again, “Sorry. Really sorry about that!”

Ji Yushi stored away the medicine box and his black and white game console. He placed them back in their original positions like someone with an obsessive-compulsive disorder.

“No mark.” The woman said as she stood not far away, “We haven't been here before.”

After saying this, she took out a small dagger from the strap on her leg and carved a mark onto the ground.

From where Ji Yushi stood, he saw that she had carved the number 8.

Because of the identical room structures, it was difficult for one to tell where they were inside the Rubik's Cube. Let alone ordinary people like them, even Ji Yushi couldn't distinguish between the rooms relying solely on his memory. Humans tend to share the same thoughts. Ji Yushi was able to quickly think of leaving markers behind for his teammates so others naturally would have thought of doing the same to at least leave a reminder for themselves.

The black-haired young man said, "I saw your game console. I've seen it on the internet, but it is something difficult for anyone to buy in reality. What era did you come from? Could time travel have been invented that early on?"

Ji Yushi who had his belongings returned was no longer as cold.

He answered the black-haired young man's question, "When asking where others are from, you should introduce yourself first."

The black-haired young man let out an 'ah'. Knowing that he was in the wrong because of the body search, he repeatedly apologised, "Sorry, my mistake! My name is Morita Yu, from 2140 AD. I joined Tianqiong this year and have been working as a Guardian for three months!"

After saying that, he took out a necklace to prove his identity, "Nice to meet you!"

A simple pattern was engraved onto the necklace. It was the symbol of Tianqiong.

Morita Yu?

Ji Yushi spoke in Japanese, "My name is Ji Yushi, from Star Era 1456."

To reciprocate, he also pointed to the sign on his chest.

Under certain special lighting, the '7' on the black combat uniforms would show marks to indicate their guardian identity.

Both parties had confirmed each other's identity.

Morita Yu repeated, “Star Era 1456?”

After saying that, he belatedly reacted to something else that surprised him, “Senior, you can speak Japanese?!”

“Yes.” Ji Yushi had worked in Tianqiong for three years so he could be regarded as a senior.

But 2140 AD? That era was completely different from their world. It meant that this Morita Yu in front of him came from a completely different time and space.

However, Morita Yu’s focus was on the game console. “Senior, what kind of game consoles do you have in your era?”

Even after mastering time travel, he was still playing a game console like this. Morita Yu cared very much about this disparity in technological development.

Before Ji Yushi could answer, the woman interrupted them, “Speak English.”

She scrutinised them and took an issue at them communicating in a language she couldn’t understand, “Since you can all speak English, use it here. It’s fairer communicating in English.”

She seemed to have forgotten about the fact that she had pointed her gun at Ji Yushi earlier and was now brazenly demanding fairness.

Morita Yu hurriedly explained to her, “Zoe, this traverser is from Star Era 1456. The era sounds the same as yours. Could you two have come from the same time and space?”

“1456?” The woman looked at Ji Yushi. She was shocked, “A traverser from seventy years ago?”

In her shock, she raised her sleeve.

On her skin was a glowing symbol of Tianqiong.

Ji Yushi frowned.

He now understood. This tall female traverser called Zoe had come from Star Era 1526. It was the same time and space as his but seventy years later.

\*

As expected, the so-called recruitment referred to by the ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ was really just a case of hijacking.

It had gathered together Guardian squads from different times and spaces and had stuffed them all into this mission. Without regard for their own opinions, they were forced to continue until someone completes it.

Casting the net widely to catch more fish in hope to reel in the best.

It was a very typical, machine-like thought process. Icy cold and indifferent.

What Ji Yushi couldn’t comprehend right now was that he had originally thought that since there is a competitive relationship between the squads in this mission, all squads would start at the same time, but at this moment, the three people in the room were all from different squads.

“From the moment I was hijacked, I have been here for four or five hours and have enter four rooms.” Morita Yu was very amusing. He spoke in English, but he used Japanese when referring to Ji Yushi, “Senior, you?”

Ji Yushi said, “One hour and twenty-three minutes.”

Zoe with the handsome short haircut said, “About a day.”

Zoe had been here the longest.

According to her, since arriving here she had entered twelve rooms including this one. As for the number 8 she had just carved onto the floor, it was the eighth room she had been to after running into Morita Yu and started leaving marks.

After being here for a day, she only went to twelve rooms?

It looks like Zoe has had her fair share of experience here.

Ji Yushi asked Morita Yu, “Why are there so much blood on your face? Are you hurt?”

Having mentioned this, Morita Yu’s face suddenly paled considerably, “I-is there a lot?! God, I thought I cleaned it all up.”

Zoe’s original stiff expression had turned even more ugly.

Morita Yu spoke as he wiped his face, “It’s not my blood, it’s someone else’s.”

He talked about what happened just now.

It turned out that there was a reason why they pointed their guns at Ji Yushi as soon as they arrived. After Morita Yu separated from his teammates, he wasn’t the only one to run into Zoe. At that time, there was another teammate called Chuck with Zoe. The three travelled together and, after entering a room, they met another traverser.

That traverser had been here for two days and looked very tired.

In the new room and faced with six options, that traverser suggested that they choose the wall in front of them as that was where his teammates had gone through earlier and he wanted to catch up to them.

Chuck climbed up the ladder first with Morita Yu behind him but when Chuck leaned into the room, a tragedy occurred: His upper body was crushed on the spot and his blood and flesh splattered onto Morita Yu’s head and face. Morita Yu was so scared by this, he almost cried out.

Zoe jumped off the ladder and saw that the other traverser had quickly gone through another door — It was clear that he knew about some pattern of some sort but was unable to choose between two doors, so he had waited for their arrival and used them to test it out. In the end, Chuck became a sacrificial victim.

Bloody and tragic scenes like this was something Ji Yushi had seen plenty of but even he couldn't help but be shocked when he heard this.

He tried to push aside those scenes from his mind. Sensing that Zoe's mood seemed to have improved slightly, he asked, "So, what was different in that room?"

"The ball in that room was yellow." Morita Yu said, "We followed that murderer into the other room and saw that the ball in that room was red. Coincidentally, all the rooms we had gone through before that were also red. My guess is that rooms of same colour are safe? But there are still four rooms in that room where the tragedy occurred that needed to be verified. The bad news however is that even if I want to go back, I won't necessarily return to the original room."

Because of this, they started to leave marks.

"If it was something like this....." Ji Yushi thought about it and said, "Like the six colours on a Rubik's Cube, there are rooms with balls of six different colours. Suppose a person goes to a room with the same colour and a room with a different colour. Nothing happened in the first scenario, but something happened in the second case. This however wasn't enough for one to form the guess that 'rooms of the same colour are safe' because the sample size was too small and there are six different colours. For one to have that thought, they would need to repeat that situation at least once more. My guess is that he may have been to at least four rooms before this guess of his formed and he was waiting for you to help him verify it."

The two looked over at Ji Yushi. They seemed to be surprised by his meticulous and fast thinking abilities.

Ji Yushi belatedly fell silent.

This analysis of his wasn't enough to help the other party obtain the information required to complete the mission. In fact, he also had no clue, so he wasn't afraid of the others being one step ahead of him.



He was only surprised about the fact that he was no longer as closed off as he was at first.

He continued to ask, “How many teammates does your squad have?”

Morita Yu, “Four.”

Zoe wiped her face, “Including Chuck, six.”

Ji Yushi, “Did you run into other squads along the way?”

Both said they didn’t.

“Our squad consists of seven members.” Ji Yushi said, “Estimating conservatively, assuming that that traverser was from a five-person squad and assuming that they’re all alive, there may be twenty-one traversers here in this place at this very moment. According to the number of rooms experienced by the three of us and the traverser, let’s assume that we already know about twenty-one of the rooms. Now using the simplest calculation and assuming that the twenty-one rooms are arranged in a parallel line and by calculating the six faces.....Excluding the connected sides, there are eighty-six. But we came to this room from different directions and haven’t seen our teammates again after separating. The rooms seem to be moving. I think the number of rooms here may be a lot more than that.”

Here in this place, how likely was it for one to meet their teammate again?

Ji Yushi didn’t know.

Morita Yu was left speechless by Ji Yushi.

Knowing multiple languages and those analytical skills. Such a clever and extraordinary person must not have an ordinary background.

“That.” Morita Yu spoke up, “Senior. With you being so strong, you must be the captain, right?”

Ji Yushi looked over. His eyes were calm and quiet. He just replied faintly,  
“No, our captain.....is someone much more capable than me.”

# Chapter 63: Chapter 63

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 63

Someone more capable than Ji Yushi?

This made Morita Yu sigh. It seems that the Star Era time and space was a lot more developed than his time and space. There was quite a large gap in technological development.

However, apart from exchanging information about this Rubik's Cube, the three didn't go into too much detail about where they're from.

In order to maintain the stability of time and space, they refrained from interacting too much with those from other times and spaces.

Regardless of which time and space they're from, the three Tianqiong laws have been engraved into their bones: Never change the past. Never talk about the present. Never be obsessed with the future.

“The rooms here are indeed moving.” Zoe spoke up, “Whenever someone opens a door and enters, the original room would be changed and replaced by another room when that same door is opened again. Perhaps there are sensing mechanisms installed in the rooms.”

She clearly had to have experienced a situation like this several times while she was here to be able to say something like this with so much certainty.

Ji Yushi nodded, “It's possible.”

Zoe began to think, “In that case, it would be hard for us to find a pattern. There are too many rooms here. What does ‘Rubik’s Cube’ want us to do? What does it want us to join?”

Everyone wanted to know the answer to this question. It could only be answered through experimentation and exploration. If you remained in the same room to be safe, you would never be able to reach the answer.

After the three spoke briefly, they decided to move on.

Zoe removed the red ball floating in the air.

The three then checked the rooms in the order of top, bottom, left, right, front and back. The colours of the balls in the six surrounding rooms were different. There were two blue, one yellow, one green, one purple, and one red.

According to Morita Yu’s guess from earlier, everyone chose the room with the red ball and moved on.

Along the way, Zoe continued to use her small dagger to carve numbers onto the floor.

Pure white rooms appeared one after another. It made it easy for one to feel isolated from the outside world. In actual fact, it was really like that for them.

Morita Yu would try to find topics to talk about, but he wasn’t like Li Chun the chatterbox. Although he spoke a little more than the rest of them, he always talked about useful information.

“Senior, you estimated that there are at least twenty-one people active here and that helped me figure one thing out.” Morita Yu said, “When I waited in a room after separating from the rest of my squad, a door opened suddenly but I didn’t press a switch. That door opened for a second and then closed on its own.”

He spoke very grimly and continue to gesture, “I thought that if it was my teammate, they would definitely call out to me so when I saw that there was no one behind that door, I thought it was a ghost. Now that I think about it, it was actually quite simple. Someone from another squad must have found me but didn’t want to work with me so they left. It might’ve been a teammate of yours.”

If there really were only three Guardian squads here, Morita Yu’s chances of running into the seventh squad was quite high.

Ji Yushi however felt that there may not only be three squads here. They may probably encounter more traversers like them from other crevices in time and space from now on.

“It probably wasn’t my teammate.” Ji Yushi said, “If they found you, they wouldn’t just leave.”

Even if they were competing against each other, the seventh squad wouldn’t do something like that.

An effective but reserved exchange of information was the way for him to find his teammates in this Rubik’s Cube as soon as possible.

Morita Yu smiled, revealing his white teeth, “Ah, senior is confident in your captain and your teammates. I really envy that.”

Zoe didn’t like to speak much, and she also felt that Morita Yu spoke too much. She just wanted to quickly get out of this place, “It’s not like that in your squad?”

“It’s not that, it’s not like that.” Morita Yu scratched his head and spoke with some embarrassment, “I have always been dealing with administrative work before and originally wanted to be a Recorder, but I signed up as a Guardian because they were short in people. In terms of combat power and experience, I’m still very inadequate so I’m not very close with my teammates.”

Zoe didn’t feel sorry for him.

Every Guardian would need some time to adjust after joining a new squad. If one could adjust, they could stay but if they couldn't, they would leave. She had seen that too many times in Tianqiong.

Hearing Morita Yu's answer, Ji Yushi seemed to be a little moved.

He turned and said to Morita Yu, "Those doing administrative work have their own strengths. After a few more missions, you will gradually become familiar with them."

They arrived at a new room.

Up, down, down.

This was the third room. All of them had red balls.

Ji Yushi remembered the direction of each of the rooms they had entered. The layout of the rooms that was originally set up as a parallel line in his mind had begun to change and reorganise. The arrangement here was many times more complicated than he had anticipated. It had far exceeded his rough estimate earlier of 86 rooms.

Joining.

What exactly did it mean?

Zoe continued to remove the balls. After she pressed the switches, Morita Yu and Ji Yushi would respectively check the colour of the ball in the other rooms.

Morita Yu checked the room on the left, "Red!"

Ji Yushi climbed up the silver-white ladder on the right wall and checked, "Red....wait."

The scene in that room was reflected in Ji Yushi's eyes. There was a large pool of bright red blood on the floor and there was a decapitated head facing away from him in the corner of the room.

Sensing his abnormality, the two asked him what was wrong.

Ji Yushi climbed down the ladder. Being exposed to such a bloody scene after such a long time, nausea and discomfort surged from the depths of his stomach. He barely held it in and said, “There is a human head inside.”

Morita Yu was surprised, “Human head?! A dead person?”

Ji Yushi made a sound of affirmation. He didn’t want to continue this topic.

Zoe expressed her doubts, “You said that the ball is red. Why would there be a dead person?”

This couldn’t be considered as her not trusting Ji Yushi. After all, they had only met by chance and there was no tacit understanding or emotional connection between them. Regardless of how logical Ji Yushi’s analysis was just now, Zoe felt that she should check it herself.

Zoe climbed up the ladder to check. Her expression changed, “What happened?”

Hearing that there really was a dead body and it was also just a head, Morita Yu didn’t even want to go up the ladder himself to check and even stayed away from that wall. He didn’t want to stay here any longer, “Let’s go and stop worrying about it. It might have been done by the man who killed Chuck. He’s a murderer! He will definitely get his retribution!”

The Super S-level mission had been turned into an enclosed room homicide case by Morita Yu. He reacted passionately with a sense of righteousness much like a second-year middle school student.

As he complained, Morita Yu climbed up the left ladder, “Let’s go, let’s not waste our time. People normally become unable to even move after starving for three days. I’m right now feeling very weak. We should hurry!”

Ji Yushi followed behind Morita Yu. He got ready to climb the ladder.

Zoe also jumped off the right ladder.

Ji Yushi looked up and could only see the soles of Morita Yu's feet. He climbed up two steps before seeing Morita Yu lower his head and look down at him from above, "Senior, be careful. Don't let me step on your hands."

As soon as he finished saying that, Morita Yu entered the hole. Soon afterwards, his feet shot outwards and something heavy fell with a loud thud. There was no longer any movement.

Ji Yushi was doubtful. He went up another two steps.

Once he saw the situation, all the blood in his body seemed to flow backwards, "Morita!!!"

That shout was particularly frightening. Even his voice trembled a little.

Zoe was still standing on the ground. She raised her head and shouted, "What's wrong?! What happened?!"

Ji Yushi still had Morita's words 'Senior, be careful' lingering in his ears when he saw Morita fall to the ground. He had died on the spot. Blood spattered out from his neck and the wound was cut neatly as if it was cut by a knife —

His head was gone.

Ji Yushi suddenly thought of something. He quickly got off the ladder.

"Give it to me!"

He grabbed the ball in Zoe's hand and quickly found the switch for the room on the right.

He swiftly climbed up the ladder and looked into the room on the right. That head in the corner of the room now had a source....It was Morita Yu's head!

Zoe had already climbed the ladder on the left and saw Morita Yu's body, "W-what?! Why?!"



She couldn't accept it. Why was a person who was alive just a moment ago suddenly dead, and it was also without a single sound?

In a situation like this, anyone with emotions would feel sad. Not to mention, she had also gone through so many rooms with Morita Yu. The rims of her eyes reddened, and she stepped off the ladder.

“How could this happen?! What went wrong?!”

According to their previous theory that ‘same coloured rooms are safe’, they should be able to continue without any problems.

They had gone through many rooms relying on this theory. Morita Yu's death was completely outside of their expectations.

Could it be that same coloured rooms aren't safe?

Then what was safe?!

Zoe circled around the room in frustration a few times before slamming the butt of her gun against the wall, “So that head in the other room is Morita's?! But how could that be possible? He was here just now, and that head was already there when we arrived. How do you explain that? It doesn't make sense!”

She finished her words angrily and turned to look at Ji Yushi who stood next to the ladder on the right. He had his eyes closed and seemed to be thinking about something.

During this short period of time together, this young man from the East from seventy years ago had left her with a calm impression.

Apart from his beautiful appearance, his calmness seemed to be the next most alluring trait of Ji Yushi's.

But at this moment, she saw that Ji Yushi's face was extremely pale and covered with cold sweat.

Ji Yushi couldn't control himself.

After seeing Morita's corpse and head, all kinds of messy memories surfaced uncontrollably in his mind.

Blood splattering after Tang Le was bitten by a zombie, brain pulp exploding as a bullet from diamond bird bursts through Li Chun's head, the rotten flesh on the windshield, the calf wearing short black boots.....and also that rainy day, the knife plunged into a certain someone's chest.

He didn't want to see it.

He didn't want to remember it either.

But there was no one here telling him not to look.

He opened his eyes. As he tried to suppress the turmoil in his eyes, he quickly took out his medicine box.

A small piece fell into the palm of his hand. It soon entered his mouth.

"How are you? Are you okay?" Zoe asked, "You seem unstable."

With no water around, he crushed the medicine with his teeth. His mouth was filled with a bitter taste.

Ji Yushi chewed it slowly and seemed to be taking in the bitterness. He wiped away the cold sweat and, as if nothing had happened before, he said, "Two minutes."

Zoe thought he was asking for a two-minute rest. Seeing that he wasn't in good condition, she temporarily put aside her doubts and fear and proposed, "No, you should rest more. Half an hour. You will at least need half an hour. We can't leave now anyway. We can't choose the room with a red ball. That theory isn't right....."

"From the moment we found the head until Morita's death, it was about two minutes." Ji Yushi spoke concisely, "That is to say, the time in the room with the head is two minutes in the future. There is a time difference between the two rooms."

His thoughts were a little messy. After saying that, he corrected himself, “No, it should be that there is a time difference between the three rooms.”

They were all traversers, so they have naturally learned a lot about time and space.

But Zoe wasn't like the seventh squad who had faced all sorts of strange situations. She was shocked, “How could there be a time difference in the same time and space? It makes no sense.....”

The situation here was similar to the city and rainforest and surrounds in the Chaos mission.

If it was Song Qinglan, he would be able to immediately follow his train of thought.

In many cases, Ji Yushi didn't need to say everything for Song Qinglan to fully understand what he wanted to convey and they could analyse the situation together. The other teammates also only needed to ask questions and they could solve it together.

Ji Yushi didn't have the time to explain to Zoe his adventures with the time anchor and the crevice in time and space. He could only go straight to the main topic: “You are right. Under normal circumstances, there shouldn't be a time difference in the same time and space. Conversely, you can think about it another way. What if these rooms are not from the same time and space?”

Zoe was stunned by Ji Yushi's bold speculation. It was temporarily difficult to accept.

Ji Yushi had already swallowed his medicine completely. Only the bitter taste remained in his mouth.

Perhaps it was just a psychological effect, but he was considerably better, “Do you have anything unimportant on you that you can lend me? We can throw it in to confirm this speculation.”

Zoe took out a packet of gum from her pocket. When Ji Yushi received it, she felt that it had appeared at the right time and chuckled, “Want one?”

In a short amount of time, he had readjusted his mental state.

It looked a little unbelievable to Zoe, but she just attributed it as a skill possessed by everyone in the seventh squad.

Ji Yushi gave Zoe one and ate another one himself. Much of the bitterness in his mouth was gone.

The two chewed gum to relax.

It was actually rather strange situation.

Zoe, “You’re not throwing it in?”

“No need.” Ji Yushi held the packet of gum, “Just the thought of throwing the packet of gum in is enough. Zoe, can you check the room on the right for me?”

Zoe climbed up the ladder suspiciously. Her eyes widened in shock, “There’s half a packet of gum!”

This was something Ji Yushi had expected. He threw the gum back to Zoe, “Compare it. Is it yours?”

After confirming that it was her gum, Zoe’s mind was a mess.

The courses she had studied, the practical experience she had gained, and her experiences after being hijacked, it all spun around in her mind.

Ji Yushi gave her time to think and didn’t interrupt her.

It took Zoe a full minute before she could speak again, “Could it be that the time in this room is two minutes in the future and it would show what might happen in two minutes?”

After entering the room, they had discovered Morita Yu’s head.

Two minutes later, Morita Yu did just that and his corpse also appeared in the room on the left.

Zoe said, “If I don’t throw the gum in and don’t fulfil that possibility?”

Ji Yushi stood in the middle of the room. He raised his arm to check his communicator, “It has been two minutes now. Check again. Is the gum still there?”

Zoe looked back and was surprised, “It’s gone!”

That half packet of gum had disappeared like a ghost.

After Zoe got off the ladder, Ji Yushi told her his thoughts, “If we really threw in the gum, the room on the right should be the same as the room on the left; both would have a half packet of gum.”

In this case, the order of it happening would be exactly the same as what happened to Morita Yu.

After experimenting, this idea of Ji Yushi’s was proven.

Those three rooms indeed had a time difference, and they couldn’t directly cross over.

Ji Yushi was still in thought. Chuck’s death mentioned by Zoe and Morita Yu earlier also happened the moment he entered a room. Was there a time difference between only some of the rooms or was there a time difference between all the rooms? Could it be that their safety actually had nothing to do with the colour of the rooms?

Ji Yushi asked, “Zoe, Morita said that the ball in the room where Chuck entered and died in was yellow?”

Zoe said, “Yes. Did you think of something?”

Ji Yushi shook his head, “Not yet. I need more information.”

The theory that they could go to rooms of the same colour had been overturned. It seems that there was still a possibility of death even if they did that. They searched around. Except for the two strange rooms with red balls, the rest were one yellow, one green and two blues.

Zoe thought of a way. She threw a piece of gum into each room to observe the consequences, but they all fell quietly onto the floor without any interference. Ji Yushi also checked the room that was two minutes in the future. It didn't seem to be affected by the other coloured rooms.

It seems that there was no time difference between the remaining rooms, but even so, they didn't dare haphazardly make a selection.

They seem to be trapped here.

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The Tetris blocks changed quickly. It fell down at an almost unimaginable speed, clearing row after row.

Ji Yushi sat on the ground, his slender and pale fingers controlling the black and white console in his hands. His expression was focused and he appeared to be fully engaged with the game. The points accumulated rose extremely quickly. If he were to participate in a Tetris tournament, there was no doubt that Ji Yushi would come first.

In a setting like this, Ji Yushi sat there for two hours.

There was no doubt that even if he stayed there longer, he wouldn't be bored.

Zoe was able to remain calm at first but after some time passed, she started to pace around the room anxiously. She had been here longer than Ji Yushi so her mentality was naturally also different. Seeing that Ji Yushi was still playing his game, she even considered the notion of leaving on her own.

She couldn't wait any longer.

“Really not going?” Zoe picked up her gun and decided to choose a random room to enter.

Green or blue are fine.

As long as it wasn't the yellow that killed Chuck or the terrible red rooms on the left and right hand side, she could give the other rooms a try.

Ji Yushi didn't look away from his game and just said, “Like I said, I need more information.”

Zoe said, “Ji, you have just been sitting there and doing nothing. Even if you want more information, we don't have any.”

Ji Yushi said, “Firstly, we are not the only traversers here. Secondly, every time someone enters a room, the room they were originally in would move. The movement of that room is not independent and would definitely cause the surrounding rooms to similarly move. Why don't we wait a little first? Perhaps the surrounding rooms would be different the next time we check.”

Zoe was almost convinced by this. She was dumbfounded for half a second before she quickly retorted, “So what if the surrounding rooms change? Can you choose which room to go into?”

Ji Yushi said, “When the surrounding rooms change, we can test it out again. That way, we can collect more information. There is no useful information for us for the time being, but it is at least safe here.”

Zoe messed up her hair anxiously. Ji Yushi's words were not just nonsense.

She calmed herself down and waited with Ji Yushi for another three hours.

Except for the sounds of the two of them breathing, these labyrinth-like rooms fell into dead silence.

They took turns to check the surrounding rooms several times and saw no changes.

Zoe couldn't wait any longer, “We need to get out of here!”

Ji Yushi looked at her.

Zoe said, “Look. If there are really a lot of rooms here, perhaps too many to count, even if we wait here until we die, the surrounding rooms won’t move. Why don’t we choose between the blue and green? Perhaps we may end up picking the right one and getting more information from that.”

Ji Yushi asked, “Which one do you want to choose?”

“It’s very simple. There are two of us.” Zoe said, “Why don’t we flip a coin? The one who loses will go first. You can choose any one you like. If it is the right one, we can go together. If it is the wrong one, the other person can survive and move on. It’ll be fair like this.”

Zoe liked it to be fair.

But Ji Yushi didn’t agree, “What if both are wrong?”

Zoe, “So what? It’s better than sitting and waiting.”

Although she would never do something like that, she kind of understood what kind of mentality that person who had used them as a test subject had.

Ji Yushi continued to sit there. He shook his head, “Sorry, I choose to stay.”

Zoe bent down next to him and spoke earnestly, “I really hope the right one is chosen. This is a mission and that Tianqiong said there are rewards. Even if it’s risky, it’s creating an opportunity for the other person, isn’t that right?”

Ji Yushi’s expression showed no changes. His dark eyes looked at her calmly, “I’m sorry. It’s because I want to succeed so I won’t want to take risks. If you want to leave, you can go ahead.”

Zoe was stunned.

She suddenly realised that besides being calm, this beautiful black-haired young man was also very ruthless.



She angrily huffed, “If I left the room, the rooms would move the moment the door closes, and you get the information you want without needing to do anything. It’s not fair!”

Ji Yushi, “Then you can choose to stay.”

Zoe was left speechless. She could only mutter, “Ji, you’re too terribly calm. There is no warmth from you. You probably don’t have a girlfriend with you like this.”

Ji Yushi said, “Oh, I like men.”

Zoe had already taken down the ball, “Whatever. It doesn’t matter if it’s men or women. You give off a feeling like you don’t need anyone.”

She opened the door to the room with the green ball. A hole appeared on the ground. The gum she had thrown was still there and it overall looked rather safe. While preparing to do down, she said, “If I succeed, I succeeded because of my courage — It will prove that a Guardian 70 years in the future is stronger than 70 years ago! If I die in the green room, you must remember that I created this opportunity for you. You owe me one, Ji.”

After saying that, she disappeared into the hole.

“Beep——” Following that sound, the door closed.

However, at the same time.

“Beep——” With that sound, the moment that door closed, another door opened.

From that door, Zoe entered.

Behind her was the alive and well Morita Yu.

They seem to be unable to see Ji Yushi and was completely unaware of his existence.

He watched Morita Yu jump off the ladder and say, “I have always been dealing with administrative work before and originally wanted to be a Recorder, but I signed up as a Guardian because they were short in people. In terms of combat power and experience, I’m still very inadequate so I’m not very close with my teammates.”

Following that, Ji Yushi saw ‘himself’ appear and similarly climb down the ladder.

He silently opened his mouth and mouthed along with his ‘other self’, “Those doing administrative work have their own strengths. After a few more missions, you will gradually become familiar with them.”

# Chapter 64: Chapter 64

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 64

Zoe in front of him took out her dagger and got ready to carve a number onto the ground.

But there was already a mark on the ground.

The three people who entered couldn't see Ji Yushi, nor could they see the mark that was already carved onto the ground.

Ji Yushi stood behind Zoe and could clearly see her carve the number 11 over the already existing mark on the ground with her dagger.

Following that, Zoe stood up. Just like before, she took down the red ball floating in the air and pressed the switch.

They began to check the colour of the rooms surrounding this room.

After Morita Yu checked two, he went to the ladder on the left and shouted, "Red!"

Ji Yushi stood in place and watched 'himself' walk through him as he approached the ladder on the right.

He was like a ghost that shouldn't exist and couldn't be perceived. He turned and watched 'himself' climb up the ladder, "Red....Wait."

They had discovered the head in the room on the right.

They then chose to go to the room on the left.

The actions and dialogue of the three of them had replayed once again. Morita Yu had once again died in the room on the left.

Ji Yushi watched the chaos that followed; Zoe's disbelief and his own face turning pale. He watched 'himself' take his medication and then saw them test out the rooms with gum.

They were trapped in the room.

Ji Yushi was like an outsider as he watched everything replay. He then saw 'himself' walk over to the corner, sit down and start playing on his black and white console. Zoe on the other hand paced around the room before stopping and sitting down in daze with her eyes vacant.

What was going on?

After having so many bizarre and unbelievable experiences, Ji Yushi was able to remain calm while facing a situation like this.

The room he was in seemed to start from the moment they entered and end at the moment Zoe left, and everything was replayed. If that was the case, what happened to the rooms with the red balls on the right and left side?

Ji Yushi took down the ball in the room — After removing it, there was still another one floating in the air. It was the one from several hours ago. He tried to touch it, but his hand just went through it like how 'himself' went through him.

This meant that they didn't exist at the same time.

Carrying the ball, Ji Yushi climbed up the ladder on the left.

He opened the hole leading to the room on the left and saw that Morita Yu's body was still lying there. Morita Yu's head was also still there in the room on the right. The yellow ball in the room above however had changed into a room with a green ball.

Ji Yushi checked all six rooms.

From the order of top, bottom, left, right, front and back, it had changed yellow, green, red, red, blue and blue to blue, blue, red, red, green and blue. That is to say, except for the two rooms on the right and left, all the other rooms had changed to blue or green.

This change had occurred because Zoe left the room. Every time someone went from one room to another, the original room would move.

And so, the rooms around the one Ji Yushi was in had undergone some changes.

Ji Yushi noticed that, of the six rooms around him, except for the red rooms on the right and left, all the other four rooms had changed.

He stopped in place and his mind worked quickly as he tried to put the pieces of the puzzle together.

Ji Yushi noticed that if he put the unchanged rooms; left room, the room he was in and the right room, into a line, the current situation was like the entire line he was on had advanced a step to the left or right.

Sure enough, in Rubik's Cube, just as he had said to Morita Yu and Zoe before, each time they moved, it wasn't just a single room moving, but rooms that are connected to the room either vertically or horizontally moving together.

But what was the law behind this movement?

Ji Yushi for now wasn't sure.

But this change in the rooms had given Ji Yushi a clue.

The so-called 'joining'. Could it be referring to joining these rooms together by making use of the way it moved? If he understood how these rooms moved, it shouldn't be too difficult putting together rooms of the same colour.

But there was a time difference between rooms of the same colour. If one entered a room of the same colour but with a time difference, the same thing as what happened to Morita Yu could happen to them. If that was the case.....Did they have to put the rooms of the same colour together in a certain order?

A new problem had come up.

He had enough patience. He needed to continue thinking.

Ji Yushi stayed in the room alone. Apart from the sound of Zoe from several hours ago fiddling with her dagger, there were no other sounds in the room.

His 'other self' was still sitting against the wall, playing Tetris.

Perhaps it was because the time in the room was fixed within a certain period of time, Ji Yushi didn't feel tired or hungry. In this room, it was as if his bodily functions and state was fixed.

Nearly five hours later, Zoe opened the door to the room with the green ball below and left.

When she opened the door, Ji Yushi watched another door open at the same time and then saw a second group of them come in.

He subconsciously looked towards the corner of the room. His 'self' from the first group was gone.

His new 'self' jumped off the ladder.

The new Zoe began to carve the number '11' onto the floor.

The new Morita Yu was decapitated in the room on the left.

As someone who had completed 89 Recorder missions, Ji Yushi was a perfect bystander. He watched the second group of them like a bystander watching history replay and he could remember everything they did as well as every word they said.

Ji Yushi wasn't able to reach a conclusion despite all that pondering.

He didn't know how long he had been here. After the second group was gone, he saw a third group and then a fourth group.

The numerous repetitions. The seemingly endless wait. It wasn't because of Ji Yushi's cowardice.

He just really wanted to win.

The so-called 'Tianqiong of all eras' had said that after they completed all the missions it had prepared, they not only would be able to return to their own time and space, but they would also be given a reward so as long as it didn't affect their timeline.

Of course, when they return to their own time and space afterwards, Ji Yushi would also be rewarded for his accomplishments as a Recorder. Ji Yushi however wasn't certain whether everything that happened in the hijacking would be recognised by the Tianqiong in his current era. If everything that had happened couldn't be recognised, he would need to complete the A-level task again and then wait for evaluation — With all the procedures, it would be a long and tedious process and there would also be a lot of conditions that needed to be met.

As such, Ji Yushi not only wanted to return, but he also wanted this reward.

The Zoe in front of him left the room.

At the same time, a new group of them arrived.

Ji Yushi calmly watched them repeat the death and panic as he performed his calculations on the holographic projection from his communicator.

When he was very young, Ji Yushi had experienced a wait much longer than this.

He had a lot of patience. Just like that time when he wrote Fibonacci sequences from the ceiling to the floor for two days straight, he drew diagrams, wrote formulas, and listed out several possibilities.

This new group of them tested the rooms with gum.

His 'other self' asked, "Zoe, Morita said that the ball in the room where Chuck entered and died in was yellow?"

Zoe said, "Yes. Did you think of something?"

Hearing this exchange, Ji Yushi's act of writing on his holographic projection stopped. He looked at the drawing of a Rubik's Cube drawn by him on his left.

The room where Chuck died in was yellow.

Before Zoe left, there was a room with a yellow ball above, but it had now become blue.

Ji Yushi clearly remembered that they had also encountered rooms with yellow balls surrounding the rooms they walked through. As they moved, it seemed to be decreasing and at present, there were no yellow rooms around him.

The Rubik's Cube drawn on the holographic projection had six faces. If the colours of each face are different, he had seen a total of five different colours now. The colours were: red, green, blue, purple and yellow. The last colour was unknown.

He retraced their steps: purple was only seen once, yellow was becoming fewer, red was always around, and there were more of green and blue. Right now, all of his surrounding rooms had become blue or green.

These changes, coupled with how they had advanced and the law behind the rooms moving, allowed him to reach an important point: He was approaching a point where blue, red and green existed at the same time, as if approaching the place where three sides of the Rubik's Cube met, and he was getting further and further away from the yellow rooms.

Ji Yushi marked these colours on the Rubik's Cube.



He was surprised to discover that — The yellow side of the Rubik's Cube and the unknown-coloured side, one of the two faces must not be adjacent to the red side.

Entering the yellow room would lead to death.

Did that mean that because the yellow and red faces are not adjacent to each other, one cannot cross through between the two rooms hence the consequence of death?

Zoe had chosen to go through the green room. Was she still alive?

Ji Yushi stood up. He retrieved the ball again.

He currently only had two choices; blue or green.

Even if he continued to wait around, those two colours would not change. He could only make his choice now.

Both the blue and green were adjacent to red.

Ji Yushi opened the door to the blue room

He climbed up the ladder step by step and entered the hole.

He glanced back into the room and saw that his 'other self' had returned to the corner of the room and was playing on his game console while Zoe paced around the room.

They would repeat endlessly in this room where time was fixed.

Ji Yushi went into the room. The red ball in his hand seemed to be attracted by a strange force. It immediately bounced back to its original position and the door closed behind Ji Yushi. He had arrived safely in the room with the blue coloured ball.

Just as he was about to remove the blue ball to check the colours of the surrounding rooms, Ji Yushi heard a 'beep——' behind him.

Someone jumped off the ladder.

Before Ji Yushi had the chance to see who had arrived, he found himself pushed back a few steps and his entire body collided against the wall.

A familiar scent reached him. For a moment, he was in disbelief.

A deep voice was fierce, “Ji Yushi!”

He looked up.

As if a long time had passed, the Song Qinglan in front of him had some stubble on his chin and looked a little unkempt.

Song Qinglan looked down at him. The emotions in his dark eyes were unclear. Seemingly out of frustration, he asked, “Where have you been?”

# Chapter 65: Chapter 65

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 65

Ji Yushi's heart which had been hanging from a thread seemed to have fallen in place as soon as he saw Song Qinglan.

It felt great reuniting with his teammate again. Ji Yushi almost forgot how he used to prefer acting alone.

"Cap Song?" Ji Yushi's back hurt but he wasn't angry, "I've always....been here?"

It wasn't Song Qinglan but Cap Song.

His tone wasn't especially warm but those who are more familiar with Ji Yushi could tell how happy he was to finally reunite with his teammate.

Despite being pressed against the wall, Ji Yushi didn't struggle. He answered the question and then proceeded to comment on Song Qinglan's appearance, "You've grown out a lot of stubble again!"

Just like in the Chaos mission, Ji Yushi was still neat and clean while Song Qinglan was the opposite. Tianqiong probably had a special liking to send Song Qinglan to a different distribution of time and it seemed to be particularly inclined in letting him develop a rough, manly appearance regardless of whether he himself liked it or not.

Song Qinglan hadn't looked in the mirror for quite some time. His expression sank when he heard the comment.

Ji Yushi's gleaming eyes fell onto Song Qinglan's chin. He asked with confusion, "Have you been here for a long time?"

This distance allowed Song Qinglan to feel the warm breath from Ji Yushi. It made the gaze on his chin feel almost tangible.

Song Qinglan's throat bobbed, "I've fucking been here for more than a week."

When he was done saying this, his grip on Ji Yushi's shoulder loosened and he took a few steps back.

"Advisor Ji!"

Song Qinglan was taller than him. As soon as he stepped aside, Ji Yushi only now saw that another two people had entered the room together with Song Qinglan.

One was Duan Wen with a stubble who was just as happy about the reunion while the other was — Tall and fair, with a pair of peach blossom eyes, he wore the same black combat uniform they wore and there was a number '9' written on his chest.

The young man nodded at him gracefully, "Hi."

Ji Yushi, "....."

This person was———

Ji Yushi knew who it was. He wasn't too surprised or in too much disbelief seeing him here. Tianqiong had hijacked Guardians who were in the middle of traversing to complete this multiplayer mission. It wasn't a surprise to seeing other Guardians gathered here.

There was a saying that enemies meet on a narrow road. (*KKnotes: One can't avoid one's enemy*)

Ji Yushi just felt that, wasn't it too much of a coincidence for them to run into the captain of the ninth squad?

The other party briefly greeted Ji Yushi.

What was suffocating was, although they weren't in the same squad, they were Guardians from the same Jiang City branch, but neither Song Qinglan nor Duan Wen showed any intentions to introduce the two of them.

The other party didn't feel embarrassed. He just stood there casually and allowed him to take him in.

Ji Yushi didn't know him personally. His only knowledge of him came from Li Chun's enthusiastic gossiping and most of it was bad talk about the other party. Ji Yushi felt bad staring at him, but he also didn't know if he should greet him back.

Fortunately, before Ji Yushi could feel awkward, Duan Wen stepped forward, his figure blocking Lin Xinlan from his field of view.

Duan Wen's eyes welled up, "Advisor Ji, do you know how much of a hard time we've had looking for you just because we caught a glimpse of your back view?"

Ji Yushi, "What back view?"

Duan Wen explained, "I actually didn't see it with my own eyes so I'm not sure about the specifics. It's just that in one of the rooms, just as we were going from one room to another, Cap Song said he saw you leave from that room. He called out but you didn't look back. When we chased after you, you were gone."

Ji Yushi expressed his doubts, "I haven't heard anyone calling for me."

"My guess was that you must not have heard." Duan Wen sighed, "With your good memory, even if you didn't recognise other people's voices, you will definitely recognise Cap Song's. I suspected that Cap Song may have been mistaken. Why wouldn't you have responded otherwise?"

No wonder Song Qinglan asked 'Where have you been'. Could they have been looking for him all this time?

Ji Yushi explained, “Ever since coming to this place, I have only gone through a total of five rooms, and that’s including the one we are in now.”

Duan Wen was surprised, “Only five rooms?”

It had been so long, but Ji Yushi only went to five rooms?

Everyone was shocked.

Song Qinglan asked, “Is it like that crevice and there is a problem with the flow of time here as well? To us, a week had passed, but for you it had only been an hour?”

“Not exactly.” Ji Yushi said to him, “I didn’t spend much time in the first few rooms and I had also spent three or four hours waiting for you guys together with Li Chun and Tang Qi.”

Duan Wen, “You met Chun’er and Tang Qi?!”

Ji Yushi nodded, “Yes, we arrived here together. After separating from them, I ran into other Guardians. One died as we made our way through and because the reason for it was unknown, we were trapped in that room for a while. About five hours later, the other Guardian chose to leave. I didn’t dare take the risk, so I stayed in that room for more than ten hours before arriving here.”

Hearing that Ji Yushi had separated from Li Chun and them, and then hearing about the other Guardian dying, Song Qinglan’s brows furrowed even further.

Ji Yushi thought he was going to raise an important point he had observed but he instead heard him ask, “After everyone left, you stayed in that room alone for more than ten hours?”

Ji Yushi didn’t understand why Song Qinglan asked that question again, “Yes.”

Song Qinglan, “Next to a corpse, you didn’t feel uncomfortable?”

Ji Yushi, “No. If I didn’t reach a breakthrough point, I would’ve stayed there even longer.”

Song Qinglan didn’t ask further.

Ji Yushi belatedly realised something. Was Song Qinglan worried about his hyperthymesia?

As the captain, Song Qinglan always cared about his teammates.

But perhaps it was because of the presence of others, despite the fact that everyone was standing in the same room, Ji Yushi felt that the concern that was shown towards him was a little too obvious.

The three of them had been together for more than a week. He who suddenly appeared was more like an intruder.

“I’ve noticed that some of the rooms have a time difference.” Ji Yushi tried to focus on the key points, “The other Guardians and I went through rooms of the same colour thinking that it was safe but after that incident happened, I realised that this theory wasn’t absolute. These rooms have different time differences. It may be because of this time difference that our perception of time is different. In these rooms with time differences, if you make the wrong move, you will die on the spot. Relying on whether or not the colours are the same is too risky.”

He recounted Morita Yu’s distressing death and then asked, “Have you encountered something like this on your end?”

“No.”

Someone spoke up. It was Lin Xinlan.

Song Qinglan and Duan Wen turned back at the same time. They saw that Lin Xinlan who was sitting with his back against the wall had naturally joined their conversation.

Duan Wen’s forehead twitched.

“I’ve already told Cap Song and Old Duan. I have also met another traverser here, but the situation was different from what Advisor Ji described just now. After that traverser entered a room with a different colour, his entire body disintegrated and turned into dust...”

He spoke slowly, giving off a laidback vibe, “Let me introduce myself. My name is Lin Xinlan, captain of the Tianqiong ninth Guardian squad. Ji Yushi, I have heard of your name.”

As someone with numerous rumours circulating around, it was hard for one not to have heard about Ji Yushi.

“Hello.”

Ji Yushi just nodded at him. He didn’t show any surprise and tried to stay as calm as possible.

After carrying out the social etiquette of exchanging greetings, Ji Yushi felt more comfortable to ask, “Captain Lin, when you encountered that situation, it was from what colour to what colour?”

Before Lin Xinlan could speak, Song Qinglan answered first. He spoke coldly, “Green to purple.”

Despite having his answer stolen, Lin Xinlan wasn’t angry. The expression on his face didn’t change.

He seemed to have a good temper and also a high tolerance.

Ji Yushi asked, “What colours have you encountered until now?”

Song Qinglan, “Yellow, blue, purple, green and red.”

It was the same as what he had seen. Were there only five colours?

Ji Yushi thought for a moment before asking, “Which colour appeared the most?”



This was a question Duan Wen could answer, “Green and blue the most. We only recently started to see red.”

Ji Yushi turned on his communicator and drew a cube in the air. He then chose a red pen, “The traversers and I ran into red rooms the most at first and then green and blue slowly appeared before we met here. This shows that we are near a point of intersection, and we just happen to have advanced to the same point.”

Ji Yushi first coloured one side of the cube red. He then coloured the two adjacent sides blue and green.

Everyone quietly watched him analyse the situation. Different colours were projected onto his face.

This was the Ji Yushi everyone was familiar with.

Ji Yushi’s thought process was very clear. As he coloured it, he said, “It is known that going from red to yellow will lead to death and going from green to purple will also lead to death. Assuming that the side opposite red is yellow and the side opposite green is purple, this should be how the layout is now.”

The cube in the holographic projection had been coloured.

Apart from the side opposite blue whose colour was still unknown, the layout was clear.

“My guess is, just like the Rubik’s Cube in reality, it is impossible to go between colours on opposite sides.” Ji Yushi explained, “From one adjacent colour to the other adjacent colour is safe. If we want to move around safely here, we will need to avoid going to rooms with colours on the opposing side of the cube.”

Duan Wen was shocked, “How do we choose?”

Song Qinglan mused, “So you’re saying that we need to exclude rooms with the same colour but with a time difference as well as rooms with

opposite colours?”

Ji Yushi was glad there was someone who understood him immediately, “Yes.”

The three of them didn’t speak.

Ji Yushi gave them time to digest this information.

In the silence, Lin Xinlan once again spoke up, “Then having gone through rooms of the same colour this entire time and not encountering the time difference mentioned by Advisor Ji and even coming out unscathed, we must have been really lucky.”

Everyone could tell that this was a kind of euphemistic questioning.

For those who didn’t understand Ji Yushi, Ji Yushi hadn’t been here for long and had also spent more than ten hours in one room. For him to boldly make such a conclusion, it did indeed seem unreasonable.

Lin Xinlan, “Let me ask, how can we complete the so-called ‘joining’ while avoiding those two possibilities?”

Ji Yushi, “Firstly, by figuring out the rules behind the movement of the rooms.”

Lin Xinlan, “How to figure out?”

Ji Yushi, “Whenever someone leaves the room, the room will move. It’s very simple. Before leaving the room, we remember the colours of the surrounding rooms and under the premise that it is safe, we test them out one by one to see what direction the colours change.”

Lin Xinlan, “And then?”

The two asked and answered back and forth. Somehow, there seemed to be some tension in the air.

Duan Wen was confused.

What was going on here?

Song Qinglan had already walked over. He stood in front of Ji Yushi, blocking him completely.

Song Qinglan habitually crossed his arms. His handsome face looked a lot more mature with the stubble, but he still looked unkept and distant.

He spoke coldly, “And then it would be cleared. Cap Lin, our Advisor Ji telling you how to go through this cube safely is already more than enough. You should use your own brain to figure out how to clear the mission. Don’t forget, we are opponents in this mission. Don’t think about trying to get the answer out from him.”

Lin Xinlan smiled, “Oh no, you saw through me.”

Song Qinglan, “If you have doubts about the analysis just now, you don’t have to come with us.”

Lin Xinlan, “Forget it. I’ll trust him and follow you guys.”

Song Qinglan was noncommittal. He didn’t want to talk to him anymore.

He turned around and saw Ji Yushi take something out of his pocket and carve something onto the ground.

Ji Yushi was using the zipper handle he had taken from his clothes. The mark he left was strange. It wasn’t a number nor a letter.

When he got back up while patting his hands, Duan Wen and Song Qinglan recognised it.

Song Qinglan had a small urge to laugh.

Little classmate Ji held grudges. Having almost been tricked into giving out the answer, he didn’t want to disclose anything else to Lin Xinlan.

What he had written on the ground was Big Beard’s language, something that no one else would understand.

“Let’s go.” Ji Yushi’s expression was the same, “Let’s check the colours of the surrounding rooms first.”

They chose to advance into a green room. It was on their left.

Duan Wen climbed up first. He waited at the entrance to prevent the door to the room from closing and causing them to separate again.

Everyone climbed up the stairs one by one.

“Song Qinglan.” Lin Xinlan suddenly shouted out.

Ji Yushi looked back and saw Lin Xinlan sitting on the ground with his hand stretched out, “Lend me a hand. My legs are numb.”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

He simply continued climbing.

Behind him, Song Qinglan spoke heartlessly, “Get up by yourself.”

Lin Xinlan could only sigh regretfully, “Haa, we’re friends though. How did I offend you?”

The ambiguous atmosphere was strong.

Ji Yushi remembered what Li Chun had said about Lin Xinlan. His words didn’t seem too exaggerated.

He reached the new room and continued to mark the ground with his zipper handle. He turned a blind eye to the things happening behind him.

A pair of black boots appeared in front of him.

Song Qinglan squatted down beside him. He coughed dryly and then whispered to him, “That uh, that Lin Xinlan came from a year ago.”

A year ago.

Ji Yushi's hand stopped. He didn't raise his head, "From the time he confessed to you which resulted in you developing PTSD?"

PTSD?

Who gave that mess a name like that?

The timing and occasion wasn't right. Song Qinglan didn't know how to explain the matter, "....."

Ji Yushi finally looked up.

He looked at the unshaven Song Qinglan. His eyes were very calm, "Don't change the past, don't talk about the present. Don't worry, I won't tell Cap Lin about this."

# Chapter 66: Chapter 66

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 66

No wonder Lin Xinlan asked Song Qinglan 'How did I offend you'. Turns out, he was from a year ago. He had no knowledge of what happened a year later.

A question very quickly surfaced in Ji Yushi's mind — Since they had met here, the Lin Xinlan from a year later must remember what happened in this 'Rubik's Cube'. Lin Xinlan who was temporarily hijacked and then returned to his own time and space, apart from writing about his experience in the mission report, he probably didn't mention anything about it to anyone.

To Lin Xinlan, the encounter with the seventh squad here was the future and also the past.

After returning, he knew that the seventh squad would be hijacked a year later, but the concept of time and space was too complicated. Even a small change could cause a change in time trajectory, thereby affecting the integrity of this time and space.

And so, what Lin Xinlan did after returning was very good.

How to interact with people from different points in time was a compulsory course for them.

Song Qinglan also knew this so he couldn't face Lin Xinlan with the attitude from the future and could only let him tag along with them.

After saying those words, Ji Yushi calmly added, “But you have to bear with it. Although us gays may be a little messy, we are very disciplined when confessing to a straight man.”

Song Qinglan subconsciously muttered, “No, I wasn’t fucking talking about that.”

Ji Yushi asked, “Then?”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

At this moment, Duan Wen had already fixed up his attitude and helped clean up the situation after his own captain, “Cap Lin, I’ll help you up!”

Lin Xinlan, “Thanks Old Duan.”

Lin Xinlan was the last to reach the new room.

“Beep——”

The hole behind him closed.

“What were you doing? Badmouthing me?”

Lin Xinlan tapped his knee in attempt to make the blood in that area circulate faster. He said this half-jokingly before asking, “Ah, if I follow along until the problem is solved, would the system count it as a success for me?”

Lin Xinlan was pretty good looking, and he gave off a rather refreshing vibe.

In fact, he wasn’t the annoying type. No one would’ve thought that such a person would later become such a clingy spirit. What gave him the confidence that Song Qinglan would be bent?

Song Qinglan stood up. His slightly unkept face looked particularly straight at this moment, “From blue to green. Safe.”

He looked at Lin Xinglan indifferently. Faced with the mission, he didn't mind making the other party feel left out.

The adjacent colour theory had been confirmed. Song Qinglan spoke, "Old Duan, open the door."

Duan Wen took down the green ball floating in the air and pressed a switch.

The door on the right opened. Song Qinglan relied on his long legs and managed to reach the top of the ladder in just a few steps. After uttering the word 'blue', he jumped back off.

Duan Wen, "And this one?"

On the other end, Lin Xinlan wasn't idling around. As soon as the door in front opened, he climbed the ladder, "Red."

With four people cooperating, the check was done very quickly.

After the colours of balls in the six surrounding rooms were checked, Ji Yushi had already marked the ground and turned on the holographic projection.

Song Qinglan, "How about it? Any thoughts?"

Ji Yushi said, "A little."

"Before we came, in the room with the blue ball just now, in the order of front, back, left, right, top and bottom, the colours of the surrounding rooms were yellow, red, green, red, yellow and green." Ji Yushi said. "We have now entered the green room to the left of the blue room from earlier, correct?"

Everyone nodded.

Ji Yushi drew an arrow to mark the direction and then turned to point at the wall in front of him, "We came from this room. As soon as we entered, the original blue room moved and had turned into a yellow room."



“The movement of a single room would drive together with it the movement of an entire or column of rooms.” Song Qinglan said, “So this yellow room may be the one we saw from the blue room just now.”

Ji Yushi’s drew cubes of different colours on his holographic projection.

He coloured those cubes in to make the yellow cube connect with the green cube and added, “Yes, but there were two yellow rooms seen from the blue room just now; one above and the other in front.”

Replacing the blue room they were in earlier, was it the yellow room above or the yellow room in front? Determining that would help determine the trajectory of the original blue room.

“I understand now. After we left the room just now, it could only move backwards or downwards so that we can see this yellow room.” Song Qinglan said, “Did I get it right, Advisor Ji?”

Ji Yushi nodded.

Duan Wen looked at Ji Yushi’s holographic projection and also tried to fiddle with the cubes, “Fuck, then how do we determine whether the yellow room we are seeing now is the one above or the one in front?”

“Unable to confirm.” Song Qinglan raised a brow, “So we’ll need to continue on.”

As soon as Ji Yushi was found, their wander through these rooms was no longer aimless.

Even if they had some clues before, it was far from how it was now.

What Ji Yushi didn’t know was that before they found him, the three of them were already very exhausted.

In this ‘Rubik’s Cube’, they would not feel hungry or sleepy. Except for the change in physical appearance due to time passing, they didn’t need to eat or drink. As such, this exhaustion was mental. It made them feel hopeless and overwhelmed.

With the exhaustion swept away, Duan Wen was a little excited, “Damn, we might even clear this mission soon.”

Clear the mission?

It was unknown if the outsider Lin Xinlan followed their train of thought. He just stood on the side in thought.

Duan Wen asked, “Which room now?”

Song Qinglan said, “In order to avoid the time difference, we cannot go to rooms with the opposite colour as well as rooms of the same colour. We can only choose from the remaining rooms with colours adjacent to this one....Blue and yellow are adjacent, we can just enter this yellow one here.”

What was said was done.

The four quickly entered the room behind them with the yellow ball and then proceeded to check the other rooms.

They saw that the green room they were in had changed to red. That is to say, the red room that was originally above had now replaced the green room. The trajectory of that room seemed to be downwards.

There was still not enough information.

Along the way, Ji Yushi left marks in every room and he added cubes of different colours to his holographic projection.

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The four continued on uninterrupted.

This time, they entered a room with a blue ball.

“Beep——” After that sound, the round entrance behind them closed.

As soon as Ji Yushi reached the ground, he noticed that something wasn't right.

Everyone's movements became very, very slow, but before entering this room, everyone's movements were normal — There was a time difference in this room. As they didn't enter from a same-coloured room, this time difference did not harm them.

“Time——diff——erence——!”

Ji Yushi slowly opened his mouth. Like a slow goldfish, he spoke with difficulty but he didn't hear any sound.

Song Qinglan in front of him was looking back.

A simple movement had been dragged on to a few seconds. Starting from the back of Song Qinglan's head, first it was his graceful chin line, his tall and straight nose bridge, his handsome brows, and then his face.

Ji Yushi had never looked at the other party's face for such a long time. He was forced to have the other party's expression completely imprinted into his mind.

Song Qinglan's lips opened and closed. He uttered a few words very slowly. His expression slowly changed — He couldn't make any sounds either.

Duan Wen raised his hand. He slowly approached the blue ball in the centre.

From that distance, even ten seconds wouldn't be enough for him to reach it.

Lin Xinlan's raised leg had not yet lowered back down. Maintaining the posture of stepping over the hole, he slowly turned his head back.

Everyone had noticed the abnormality in this room.

The flow of time was slow, and there was no sound.

In this extremely quiet environment, their movements had slowed down considerably. It was so slow, even the hair floating in the air hadn't fallen back in place.

What was strange was, the speed was clearly very slow, but their speed of thinking hadn't slowed down as a result.

Everyone was trying to talk.

Ji Yushi saw their mouths open and close, but he couldn't lip read and couldn't tell what they wanted to say. He laboriously turned his gaze. It was so slow, it was as if he could feel the movement of his eyeballs in his eye sockets and slow to the point that he could almost see the eyelashes that were usually overlooked.

In this room with a blue ball, there was already a trace of someone else's presence.

There was a big '24' drawn onto the wall. It was unknown which team had been here.

Since they didn't seem to be around, they must have already left.

Ji Yushi's act of leaving marks was to confirm whether he had been to the room before. Since this room already had a mark and he wouldn't forget what it looked like, he didn't need to mark it again.

He turned his gaze again and saw that Duan Wen had finally reached the green ball floating in the air.

Lin Xinlan's foot on the other hand had also finally touched the ground and Song Qinglan had turned around completely and was slowly reaching out towards Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi just happened to be standing above the point where the entrance to the room below would open.

Song Qinglan appeared to be afraid of Duan Wen accidentally selecting the wrong button and wanted to pull him away from that spot.

Ji Yushi raised his hand and let Song Qinglan give him a hand.

It was like the four of them were in a slow-motion film. Restricted movements but no change to their thoughts. Anyone who lacked patience would be frustrated to death by this situation. It took them a dozen more times longer than usual to figure out the colours of the surrounding rooms and just the act of climbing the ladder was frustrating.

To their surprise, they finally found the final unknown colour: Grey.

Because there were no sounds and their movements were slowed down, the act of checking the surrounding rooms was considerably slower. This was also the same for opening the holographic projection and adding colours to it.

Ji Yushi had now seen colours in all six directions.

They were: Front grey, back red, left blue, right blue, top grey, bottom grey.

The red room at the back replaced the green room they had arrived in.

And this was their first time encountering the colour grey.

In other words, what they have encountered now was the same blue, the opposite gray and the adjacent red.

If there was a time difference between rooms of the same colour, it would lead to death.

Opposite colours also wasn't an option as it would also lead to death.

The red room behind them was their only option.

Song Qinglan expression was as cold as frost. He wrote two words on the holographic projection and he also mouthed, "Go—back—!"

At this moment, there was a "beep—"

Someone had opened the door to the red room behind them.

Everyone was startled. They all looked over.

An unfamiliar face appeared at the entrance of the hole. He appeared to be a Westerner and his skin was rather tanned.

The movement and speech of that person was normal. He seemed to be laughing at the scene before him, as if he was gloating at their misfortune.

His voice came from the room next door but when it reached their room, it became very, very slow. It broke the silence in the room.

He revealed his teeth and said something while looking down. He probably had a companion.

As soon as he was done, he backed away.

Ji Yushi's pupils constricted. This person was about to leave the room with the red ball!!

Song Qinglan next to him had clearly also thought of the same thing. He was already running towards that wall but unfortunately, he was too slow.

Seeing Song Qinglan's actions, how could Lin Xinglan and Duan Wen not understand? — If those people left the room with the red ball, that room will immediately move and be replaced by a room of another colour. With this, there was a high chance of their only way out being cut off.

Before his foot could land onto the ground, there was another 'beep——' and the round entrance closed.

Everyone's expression changed.

The delayed words of that traverser finally reached everyone's ears.

Song Qinglan had used almost all his effort to climb up the ladder and stop the other party.

But it took several minutes before he could finally reach the round entrance Duan Wen had managed to reopen.

It was too late.

There was no one in the room.

The original red ball had also become grey.

Those people had left.

What was strange was, a burst of laughter sounded in this silent room. It was that man's laughter from before he left.

Song Qinglan's heart turned cold. He hadn't even had the chance to tell the others that their escape route was gone. He felt like they had not only been played with, but they were also mocked.

He wrote on the projection, "What did he say just now?"

From the tone, it sounded like French. No one understood it.

After Song Qinglan was done writing, he raised his chin at Ji Yushi indicating for him to translate.

Lin Xinlan was curious. Ji Yushi could understand that?

Ji Yushi slowly raised his hand. He wrote the translation onto the holographic projection.

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"Hahahaha, a group of idiots have also entered the room we were in just now! Let's let them play in there for a while!"

It took a lot of time to write that line. He didn't even leave out the hahahaha.

Ji Yushi's expression was indifferent.

Everyone cursed inside at the same time: Damn it.

# Chapter 67: Chapter 67

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 67

What to do? The red room that was originally their the only way that would ensure their safety was gone.

This situation was very frustrating.

“What—to—do—?”

Duan Wen opened his mouth and mouthed those words. Those three words were easily understood by the others without needing the transmission of sound.

Everyone knew very well inside that their only two options left were the blue rooms on the left and right sides.

The grey rooms were definitely not an option because grey was on the opposite side of blue.

And as for the rooms with the blue balls, it was the same colour as the room they were in now — Not every same-coloured room had a time difference. They had managed to enter same coloured rooms safely purely based on luck before.

With the current situation, the chance of entering a blue room with a time difference was fifty-fifty.

Their delayed movements made them irritable.



In this room where speed had slowed down, every attempt to move or talk was slow and awkward.

There was no need for pointless talk.

Duan Wen slowly untied the necklace around his neck. It was something issued internally during Tianqiong's ten-year anniversary. Duan Wen had used a bit of effort to find this one. Right now, he wanted to use it to test the blue room and see if it would be cut into two pieces as a result of the time difference like how it happened to Morita Yu.

Duan Wen threw the necklace at the tallest Song Qinglan who stood in the centre holding the blue ball.

The necklace flew through the air, the ten-year anniversary commemorative symbol shone brightly under the bright lights.

Song Qinglan caught the necklace. With a 'beep—' a round hole on the right wall opened. Song Qinglan climbed up the ladder and threw it with great strength into the blue room on the right.

The trajectory of the necklace through the air was extremely slow.

Everyone looked over. They only saw it fall at a speed that was difficult to see as soon as it passed through the hole.

The crisp sound they were expecting to hear when it hits the ground wasn't heard.

Song Qinglan frowned.

As soon as the necklace entered the blue room on the right, it had disintegrated into shiny powder before disappearing into the air.

If anyone rashly entered the room, the consequence was unimaginable.

He got off the ladder and shook his head at the others, "No——"

Everyone opened their mouths slightly. Micro expressions that were typically difficult to detect normally had been slowed down by time so everyone could see each other's true reaction at this very moment. Including Ji Yushi, none of them didn't feel fear facing such a situation.

There was still a room with a blue ball on the left.

They had to use something to test it out. Duan Wen shook his head to indicate that he had nothing on him that could be thrown.

Unlike other countries, guns and knives were controlled in their country. Even Tianqiong's Guardians were not given weapons until they reached their mission destination. After they got out of their capsules, they had entered Rubik's Cube directly without bringing any of the weapons they had brought along with them so none of them had things that could be thrown away.

Throw the communicator? Or their shoe or clothes?

Ji Yushu took out his box of medicine from his picket.

There was also a game console but it was impossible for him to throw that. He could try it with the medicine.

Everyone watched him throw his box of medicine to Song Qinglan.

The medicine box spun slowly in the air before it was received by Song Qinglan.

The moment it reached Song Qinglan's hands, he noticed that the weight of it didn't feel right. In the bookstore in PU-31, he had held the medicine box when it was still full.

Song Qinglan climbed up the ladder on the left wall and opened the box of medicine with his back towards the others.

He glanced at it and then turned back.

Like Duan Wen and Lin Xinlan, he saw Ji Yushi standing below looking up at him. His eyes were calm and as usual he seemed to be the calmest and most sensible one.

In the medicine box, three neatly arranged pills were missing. Sure enough, just as Song Qinglan had expected, those twenty or so hours spent alone in the red room wasn't as simple as how Ji Yushi had made it out to be.

Song Qinglan took out a pill.

He threw it into the room with the blue ball.

The pill was very small. His eyes locked onto it tightly. He watched it fall to the ground — It bounced off the ground a few times but it was still intact.

Song Qinglan returned to his senses and gestured to everyone that it was okay.

The people here however didn't breathe a sigh of relief. Medicine pills were not living while people were living beings. Would the time difference affect them differently as a result of this? They couldn't be certain.

The blue ball bounced back to its original position. It floated in the air, waiting for everyone to make their decision.

In that case, who should they send into the room first?

Lin Xinlan took out a dice from his pocket: "This——"

Song Qinglan narrowed his eyes.

This person, why didn't he throw something as useless as a dice if he had it on him?

Everyone negotiated slowly and succinctly. By throwing a dice, the person with the smallest number would enter the room first.

Lin Xinlan threw first. He threw a four.

It wasn't too large or too small. It was relatively safe.

Lin Xinlan smiled.

Immediately after him was Duan Wen. Duan Wen threw a 5, a very safe number. He however didn't act very pleased and just threw the dice to Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan casually tossed it. The dice fell into his palm. It was a 2.

Lin Xinlan stored away his smile. Duan Wen frowned. This may probably be the smallest number.

The last person was Ji Yushi.

The speed of the dice falling was very slow. The numbers constantly changed, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1....Because of the height, the dice not only flipped once, it continued to change. The moment it fell back into Ji Yushi's hand, Song Qinglan next to him had already stretched out his hand to cover it.

Ji Yushi was surprised.

Song Qinglan hooked his lips. He took the dice.

"3——" Song Qinglan mouthed, "I'm——the——small——est——"

"Cap——Song——" Duan Wen called out to him. He probably thought that Song Qinglan was more valuable as a captain and wanted to volunteer himself.

Song Qinglan motioned for Duan Wen to take the ball and open the door.

He didn't seem to accept any complaints. Duan Wen had no choice but to oblige.

Song Qinglan climbed up the ladder and moved towards the round entrance.

Ji Yushi watched him without blinking. With the scene of Morita Yu's death replaying in his mind, his palm and forehead was sweaty.

The moment Song Qinglan's upper body leaned into the room, he subconsciously closed his eyes.

“Come——here——”

A familiar voice sounded. Originating from the other room, it slowly reached their ears.

Ji Yushi opened his eyes. He saw Song Qinglan appearing at the hole completely unharmed. His movements had returned to normal.

That room was safe!

As if they had won the first prize in a lottery, everyone came back to life in an instant. One by one, they climbed the ladder and left the damned room.

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The moment they stepped into the new room and landed on the ground, everyone's first thought was: Too fast!!

Having experienced time that was slow to the point that it was infuriating, as soon as they returned to a place where speed was normal, they were a little caught off guard. The old man Duan Wen was so uncoordinated, he almost faceplanted onto the ground!

The sound and speed had all returned to normal.

Duan Wen cursed, “Fuck, fuck fuck! We're finally out!!”

Lin Xinlan supported himself against the wall as soon as he landed, “Wait a minute, I need time to adapt. This place isn't accelerated, is it?!”

Duan Wen, “Advisor Ji, how are you?”

As if popping out of a vacuum, everyone collapsed onto the ground and caught their breaths.

Ji Yushi said, “I'm fine.”

Song Qinglan seemed to have adapted to the change without much trouble. He had already circled around the room once and had even picked up Ji Yushi's pill from the ground. He however just looked at it before throwing it away again. There were no marks in this room. It looks like no one else had been here before. There were no abnormalities.

“The appearance of that group of idiots reminded me of a problem.” Song Qinglan said. “It was something that we probably thought of before but had overlooked.”

Having reached this point, Song Qinglan threw the dice in his hand to Lin Xinlan.

The dice fell smoothly into Lin Xinlan's hands without much trouble. It was clear that the other party was a little dissatisfied with Lin Xinlan not taking his dice out earlier.

Lin Xinlan tightened his grip around the dice. A smile holding unknown meaning lingering fleetingly at his lips.

Duan Wen asked, “What's the problem?”

Song Qinglan said, “Advisor Ji must've already thought of it.”

Ji Yushi who was suddenly pointed out raised his head. His eyes met Song Qinglan's and his heart pounded lightly inside.

The emotions in the other party's dark eyes were still the same as usual. It was the look a captain should have when facing their teammate.

However, only Ji Yushi knew what happened just now.

When it was his turn to throw the dice, the moment the dice fell into his palm, he had clearly seen that the side facing up was 1.

Ji Yushi was actually the one who had rolled the smallest number.

He should've been the first to enter this room to determine whether it was safe for the others.

Why did Song Qinglan do that?

Why lie to everyone?

Could it be that he felt that him staying behind was more meaningful than himself? If anything were to happen, he felt that Ji Yushi could lead everyone to complete the mission?

This matter was like a secret only the two knew. Song Qinglan didn't seem to have any intentions to mention it so Ji Yushi also didn't say anything. It was just that if something like this was to happen again, he didn't want it to be like this. He didn't think that he was someone that needed to be protected.

Ji Yushi stood up. He naturally patted off the non-existent dust from his hands and said, "Yes, I've thought of it."

Duan Wen was confused, "What is it?"

Lin Xinlan also looked over at them.

"In addition to the four of us, there are not only our teammates who have separated from us, but also other Guardians." Ji Yushi explained, "We already know that every time someone leaves, the room they were in would move. If that was the case, even if we figure out the laws behind how the rooms moved, we may still encounter a situation where the room is moved by others."

Duan Wen belatedly realised that this was indeed the case, "You're right! Fuck, that really is a big problem!"

Lin Xinlan said, "So you're saying that even if we want to join the rooms, there is a chance that the arranged rooms would be disrupted by others."

The three of them fell silent for a while.

Lin Xinlan was a smart person. Even if they didn't directly explain that the so-called 'joining' meant arranging the rooms in order, it was something that he would discover sooner or later.

“You don’t have to have your guard up against me.” Lin Xinlan said, “As long as I can get out, I don’t mind not completing the mission. The reward doesn’t interest me, isn’t it the same for you guys?”

Except for the seventh squad, the rest of the traversers were only temporarily hijacked to make up the numbers.

Lin Xinlan was unaware of the seventh squad’s predicaments and thought that they were in a similar situation and would hence share the same thoughts.

Song Qinglan didn’t answer this question directly and just said, “Yes, when there are multiple squads here at the same time, arranging the rooms in order is close to impossible.”

Duan Wen, “Then what should we do? Find them one by one and get them to stay where they are?”

Ji Yushi shook his head, “It won’t work. It is impossible to know how many traversers are here in total.”

“Don’t worry about this problem for the time being.” Song Qinglan said, “When you have no idea, it’s best to just keep doing what you’ve been doing. We will follow the original plan. First, figure out the law behind the movement of the rooms. At least with this, we won’t be going around like headless flies.”

Everyone regained their spirits.

Duan Wen once again grabbed the ball floating in the air. The others checked the colours of the surrounding rooms.

Song Qinglan returned after checking two rooms and saw that Ji Yushi was making a mark.

This time, Ji Yushi didn’t use Big Beards unknown language and just wrote a large ‘2’ on the wall.

Song Qinglan asked, “This is?”



Ji Yushi answered as he wrote, “I have a general idea of the pattern of movement. From leaving to moving, the changes of the rooms should correspond to: top – right, bottom – left, left – back, right – front, front – bottom, back – top. The six directions of movement corresponded to each other and still needed to be verified but based on the movement of those people just now, they should still be nearby.”

Song Qinglan now understood why Ji Yushi did that and his mood suddenly improved.

Sure enough, as soon as he was done with the ‘2’, Ji Yushi began to write a big ‘9’. The writing looked very familiar, “If they come to this room, they should be no more than five rooms away from the room just now.”

The room just now was marked ‘24’. It was left by that group of people.

If they came to this place and saw the ‘29’ that looked extremely realistic, what would their reaction be? If Ji Yushi was a little more ruthless, would he leave 25, 26 etc in the rooms they visit afterwards to mislead them?

Ji Yushi stepped back. He appeared very satisfied with his masterpiece.

Though his expression was serious. and nothing was revealed externally.

“Let’s go.” Ji Yushi was done paying them back, “Let’s go to the next room.”

They chose a new room with a red ball and got ready to use it to check out the grey rooms.

While climbing the ladder, it occurred to Ji Yushi that Song Qinglan hadn’t returned his medicine box.

He stopped and said to Song Qinglan below, “Cap Song, where’s my medicine box?”

As the captain, Song Qinglan would work behind the scenes to ensure everyone’s safety.

Upon hearing this request, he was unmoved and he even said to Ji Yushi as if he had heard a joke, “Advisor Ji, on behalf of the organisation, I have to tell you that your mental state has been overstimulated. The medicine box will be temporarily confiscated.”

Duan Wen’s voice sounded from the other room, “The organisation also deals with this?”

Song Qinglan found it amusing and bluntly answered, “Yes. The organisation also thinks that since you’re always so lifeless, you should take one.”

# Chapter 68: Chapter 68

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 68

The four of them went through another three or four rooms. Ji Yushi left marks in each of them.

While climbing up, Lin Xinlan asked, “Advisor Ji, can you estimate how many levels this Rubik’s Cube has?”

Enthusiasts would be familiar with 3x3x3 through to 9x9x9 Rubik’s Cubes. If you went even further, there was also the 17x17x17, but perhaps it was one even greater than that.

Ji Yushi who followed closely behind answered, “I can’t.”

Lin Xinlan seemed to be surprised by this answer. He looked back at him.

Ji Yushi wasn’t omnipotent. Those closely involved cannot see clearly. Moreover, as they passed through the rooms one after another, there was still a question of whether the mission’s Rubik’s Cube was the same as the Rubik’s Cube they were familiar with in reality.

He couldn’t be certain. More and more, he started to feel confused. He however didn’t show anything on the surface.

Everyone’s mental state was important. It was too early for him to tell the others this.

This was especially so while everyone was very eager to solve the mystery ahead.

They reached a room with a grey ball.

Duan Wen retrieved the grey ball and repeated what he had done countless times before. To avoid accidentally falling through when the hole opens, everyone immediately moved away from the place where the entrance to the room below would appear as soon as they entered the room and got ready to check the rooms.

This time, as soon as everyone moved away, they heard a ‘beep—’

Immediately afterwards, something fell from the round hole above. Accompanying it was a strong bloody smell as well the sound of blood and flesh splattering.

Duan Wen had pressed the switch for the room above.

Everyone dodged to avoid it.

Several human bodies had fallen from the hole above. No, they should be referred to as severed body parts. Half bodies with intestines hanging out, severed limbs, blood mixed with different clumps of flesh, severed fingers....it was like a scene of massacre.

What was even more terrifying was that they were still squirming around. They seemed to have only just died.

Faced with a scene like this, Ji Yushi felt nauseous.

He reflexively turned around and leaned against the wall. He breathed lightly to calm himself.

“Damn!”

“Fuck!”

Everyone had been splattered by the blood. Song Qinglan brushed off the bloody flesh from his clothes with a poor expression.

He looked at the round hole above, “Grey!”

There were likely a lot of grey in this area. What they had probably encountered was the consequences of entering a room with a time difference.

“I recognise them.” Ji Yushi turned back. He had already readjusted his state, “After I separated from Li Chun and the others, I met their teammate Zoe. Their squad had also separated. I didn’t expect them to go the opposite direction.”

The black and gold uniform as well as the symbol on the arm that could be faintly distinguished. It was clear that they were Zoe’s teammates.

This scene reminded the members of the seventh squad, and it also reminded Lin Xinlan.

In this Rubik’s Cube, it was purely luck that they had survived. Something like this may have similarly happened to their teammates.

Lin Xinlan asked, “Are we going to continue?”

He sounded like he was starting to disagree with the seventh squad’s approach.

Ji Yushi didn’t speak.

Song Qinglan glanced at him and he spoke in his usual tone, “Regardless of whether or not we’re continuing, we should leave this place for now.”

\*

Everyone entered a new room. The colour of the ball here was purple which was adjacent to grey. That bloody scene earlier that been too stimulating. Their relaxed atmosphere from earlier had once again become tense.

Duan Wen asked, “Cap Song, should we try and find a way out?”

Song Qinglan took off his blood-stained black combat uniform, revealing the grey tank top underneath. He used his top to wipe away the blood on his face.

He had stood the closest just now and was hit the hardest. Not to mention Ji Yushi, even Duan Wen who was similarly bloody moved away from him.

In a blink of an eye, they were all in a rather sorry state.

After Song Qinglan was done cleaning his face, he tossed his shirt aside, “Haven’t we always been finding a way out?”

Duan Wen froze.

That’s right. Even if Lin Xinlan didn’t know, how could he not know?

In the missions arranged by this damned Tianqiong, there was no such thing as not completing it or abstaining. The only way out was to complete the task.

Lin Xinlan had also taken off his top. He shook it off and then put it on again.

He was different from Song Qinglan who appeared slim with clothes but was quite muscular without. Although he wasn’t considered skinny, he was quite thin, “It’s time for us to stop and think about what we should do from now on. Since the movement patterns are almost the same, there is no need for us to walk around like headless flies. Besides, as I had said before, there are still many other squads here. Even if you start joining them, their movements will disrupt it. Continuing like this is pointless.”

Lin Xinlan’s words weren’t unreasonable.

Song Qinglan however turned around and looked towards Ji Yushi.

He was waiting for Ji Yushi’s opinion and, along the way, he also had an urge to wipe off the blood on Ji Yushi’s face.

Ji Yushi didn’t have much blood on him but because of his obsession with cleanliness, his expression didn’t appear to be all that good. His face was as cold as ice.

He said, “This is the seventeenth room we’ve been to.”

Duan Wen was surprised, “It’s already the seventeenth?”

Lin Xinlin, “Yes, it should be about that.”

No one noticed that Song Qinglan had at some point in time quietly placed his hand back inside his pant pockets.

Ji Yushi for now didn’t pay any attention to the filth on him, “Have you noticed that we appear to be approaching the centre of this Rubik’s Cube?”

More and more greys, interlaced with blues, reds, greens, purples as well as the occasional yellow. The six colours gathered in this vicinity.

With this reminder, everyone seemed to realise it too.

“We’re approaching the centre? It really seems to be like that!”

“What would be there?”

“I don’t know.” Ji Yushi’s expression didn’t change, “In fact, I have been thinking about it along the way. Using the usual Rubik’s Cube as an example, it only has six faces and the centre part is fixed. Inside the cube is a central block which acts as the pivot in which the other blocks rotate around. Except for those six faces, there shouldn’t be any colour the more you advance towards the centre but as we approached the centre, we still encountered rooms of different colours. It seems that this place is made up of countless cubes, not just the outer layer forming the six faces.”

Ji Yushi rarely said that he didn’t know.

As soon as he said this, everyone was a little worried, but they were then relieved after hearing his analysis.

“Based on how the rooms moved, it appears to be different to how a block in a Rubik’s Cube would move.” Ji Yushi said, “Top – right, bottom – left, left – back, right – front, front- bottom, bottom – top.....When the room moves, every direction is the opposite. No matter how many levels this Rubik’s Cube has, this method of movement cannot be applied to it.”

Song Qinglan thought of something, “Could it be like ‘Chaos’? The so-called mission should only be taken literally and doesn’t really have any special meaning to it. As you know, it is an artificial intelligence, it’s not that clever.”

Duan Wen threw out some profanities, “Yes! Isn’t this also the same as that ‘Ouroboros’? What a fucking scam. Let’s not be led into another ditch and try something else?!”

Ji Yushi didn’t speak.

If they really were thinking in the wrong direction, then all the records they made as they went through those seventeen rooms would have been completely meaningless.

What Chaos, what Ouroboros? Lin Xinlan didn’t know what they were talking about, but he wasn’t curious and he didn’t ask.

He was a qualified Guardian and was particularly concerned about the integrity of time and space. He just asked, “What about the time difference? Does the time difference in the different rooms have any meaning?”

This could be a breakthrough point.

“I don’t know.” Ji Yushi once again shook his head, “Sorry.”

Lin Xinlan only raised the question for everyone to think about together. He didn’t mind Ji Yushi’s answer, and just said thoughtfully, “It’s okay.”

This was Ji Yushi’s second time saying ‘I don’t know’.

After speaking, he lowered his head and turned on his communicator. He seemed to be wanting to sort out the current situation using the drawings on the holographic projection.

He however heard Song Qinglan’s slightly irate tone, “Why are you apologising?”

Everyone was taken aback. They all looked over.



Ji Yushi raised his head. His eyes met with Song Qinglan's.

Song Qinglan wore a tank top, revealing his bare sturdy arms and broad shoulders. Coupled with his tall height and slight stubble, he looked very much like a thug.

It was a little like when they first met, a little aggressive and overbearing.

Ji Yushi felt like he had returned to that moment.

But Song Qinglan said, "It is not your responsibility to connect the clues and complete the mission. Who said that those who are smart and have good memory must be responsible for solving the problem? Ji Yushi, you are human, not a supercomputer or a god. There is no need to apologise for not being able to answer a question no one else knows."

Ji Yushi's eyes revealed some surprise, "But....."

Song Qinglan cut him off, "You're thinking that you wasted everyone's time?"

Ji Yushi, "A little."

Song Qinglan wasn't frustrated when he heard this, and he also didn't seem to mind the fact that they hadn't made any progress. He just lightly chuckled.

Duan Wen was embarrassed. Even Lin Xinlan reacted. They had unknowingly placed all the responsibility onto Ji Yushi alone.

Probably because he had gotten used to it in the previous missions, even Ji Yushi himself didn't notice anything wrong.

He didn't expect the captain Song Qinglan to say something like this.

Yes, he has hyperthymesia and his intelligence was high, but it didn't mean that he was responsible for figuring out the way to clear the mission in every mission.

“Even if the thought process was wrong, it can’t be regarded as a waste of time. At the very least, we now understand how the rooms here move and how to move around the rooms safely.” Song Qinglan continued, “Staying behind now, is it because those couple of corpses scared you?”

Duan Wen refuted immediately, “That’s not it, that was just disgusting. How could I be afraid of that?”

Lin Xinlan who didn’t want to continue, “.....”

He felt even more like an outsider.

Song Qinglan said, “Since we are already close to the so-called centre, why don’t we continue? If this is really a super cube made up of countless rooms, have you thought about what colour the middle piece could be? Would it have all six colours or would it be a plain white block? In case there is some sort of secret hidden there, wouldn’t it be too early giving up now? Or do you plan on staying around here waiting for the eggs to hatch by itself?”

He clapped his hands, “Get up and liven up! Let’s take a look at this central block.”

Sensing Ji Yushi’s gaze, Song Qinglan asked, “You have something to say?”

Ji Yushi said, “.....I want to rest for ten minutes.”

Song Qinglan looked at his watch, “Alright. Then everyone can rest here for twenty minutes.”

Duan Wen: “.....”

Lin Xinlan: “.....”

# Chapter 69: Chapter 69

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 69

Everyone was tired. Although they said that they were going to take a twenty-minute break, the break ended up lasting for almost two hours.

Even Song Qinglan sat on the floor leaning against the wall with his eyes closed.

They couldn't say that they weren't tired. Song Qinglan's mental state had been tense for a long time and, now that he had the chance to relax, he casually rested an arm on his knee and rested like a big cat entering a pseudo-asleep state.

Duan Wen simply laid down and fell asleep. He even started to snore slightly.

Lin Xinlan on the side fiddling with his dice. He similarly had his eyes closed.

The room became quiet.

Ji Yushi played his game console for a while. He seemed to be infected by this relaxed and seemingly hypnotic atmosphere and started to feel a little sleepy. He put away his black and white game console and his eyelids began to feel heavy. It wasn't long before he fell into a dark and sweet dream.

It had been a long time since Ji Yushi had such a dream.

He returned to his younger years; it was when he hadn't yet entered elementary school.

It was still raining outside. He moved a stool and stood on it to look for books to read from his father's bookshelf. There was a book just out of reach from his small body. It was a book titled "Time Traveller", a science fiction novel that stood out from the rest of his father's academic books.

He had read this book many times. Although there were a lot of words in it that he didn't recognise, the pictures were very attractive: It was a picture of a traverser passing through a wormhole and subsequently seeing numerous different worlds.

Just as his hand was about to reach the book, his body suddenly felt lighter and he found himself carried over to the sofa.

His father bent down in front of him and took out a box with a bow on top. He asked gently, "Jian Jian, guess what this is?"

He asked, "What is it?"

Every time his father went on a business trip, he would return with an antique he had never seen before. At times it was a tin frog that jumped with a press of a button and other times it was a small train that ran on batteries. There was also once where he brought back a wind-up music box.

What could it be this time?

He opened the gift expectantly and found a colourful cube inside.

His father told him, "This is a 3x3x3 Rubik's Cube. A commemorative souvenir from my research."

He took it out curiously and saw that it was bigger than his small hand, "Commemorative? Commemorate what?"

His father said, "To commemorate....something meaningful."

His father randomly messed up the Rubik's Cube and then quickly restored it back to its original appearance in less than ten seconds in front of him. He exclaimed in surprise.

His father rubbed his head, "Give it a try."

He took the Rubik's Cube and tried messing it up and then restoring it like his father did.

It was however much more difficult than he had imagined.

He played with it for a long time but was unable to return it back to its original appearance, let alone solve it in less than ten seconds. It was unknown how long he had played with it for but when his father returned to check on him again, his tone was a little helpless, "Sheng Han."

On the sofa, the Rubik's Cube had been completely disassembled.

He was starting from the centre block, piecing it together block by block.

"Look, you can put it back together like this too." He held up the half complete cube and appeared to be a little pleased.

"Take it apart if you can't restore it?" His father couldn't help but laugh, "Why are you just like me when I was young?"

"Daddy was also a fool when you were young?" He asked.

"No." His father said, "When I was young, I was very smart, just like Jian Jian."

\*

"Advisor Ji."

When Ji Yushi opened his eyes, his teammates had already packed up and seemed to be ready to set off again.

Song Qinglan was checking the surrounding rooms for changes. Lin Xinlan stood in place, exercising his arms and legs while Duan Wen was responsible for waking him up.

After resting for a while, everyone was full of energy.

His dream was still vivid in his mind. Ji Yushi pondered for a few seconds before finally getting up.

Seeing that he was awake, Song Qinglan asked, "How was your rest?"

Ji Yushi, "Not bad."

Song Qinglan nodded. He stepped back and easily jumped off the ladder, "The grey room on this side earlier is gone. It's now yellow. Someone may have passed by. Right now, we are surrounded by grey, yellow, red, blue and blue. If we want to go to the centre block, it should be nearby.

Duan Wen asked, "There weren't many yellow rooms earlier. Should we try the yellow room?"

Lin Xinlan said, "There's no green here. If green and blue are adjacent to red, I think we can try those two colours."

Those three discussed their options. Their thoughts were clearer than before they took a break.

Ji Yushi pulled up the drawing on his communicator. He had already drawn the direction they had been moving in on the holographic projection. He said, "This room is currently purple. We already know that the colour opposite purple is green. We can try going down, that is, we can try the blue room."

Everyone felt that it was a good suggestion. Lin Xinlan laughed, "Your thoughts aligned with mine."

Before the break, Lin Xinlan was still skeptical about continuing but after the break, it seems that he had changed his mind.

It wasn't difficult understanding this change in attitude. No one would want to move around these rooms alone.

It was time to set off.

After Song Qinglan retrieved the purple ball, he waited until everyone entered the blue room below before releasing the ball and allowing it to return to its original position.

They hadn't been in this blue room before. As usual, Ji Yushi marked it.

“Cap Song!”

Lin Xinlan shouted. He was holding the blue ball while standing on the ladder on the right.

Song Qinglan, “What?”

Lin Xinlan had clearly found something in the room there and subconsciously called out to Song Qinglan.

Duan Wen shrugged.

“There's someone here!” Lin Xinlan reported, “Come and take a look!”

Song Qinglan was a man. He naturally wouldn't have any scruples towards someone who would only pursue him a year later. Hearing this, he walked over to take a look. Lin Xinlan had already come down to make way for him.

What happened?

Ji Yushi and Duan Wen looked over to the right.

Song Qinglan called out a few times towards the room on the right but there was no response from the other side. He turned around and said, “That person can't seem to hear us.”

When Ji Yushi went to take a look, Song Qinglan showed no intention to come down. He instead helped pull him up.

The two of them stood on the one ladder. It was too narrow so Song Qinglan had no choice but to turn his body to the side.

When Ji Yushi saw the situation inside, his expression changed, “Morita!”

Morita Yu who had died in front of Ji Yushi more than twenty hours ago had appeared in the room.

From their end, Morita Yu was kneeling on the ground mumbling something. Just as Song Qinglan had said, Morita Yu couldn’t hear their voices and was unaware of their presence.

Ji Yushi stared fixatedly at the young man who had ‘resurrected’.

A few seconds later, Morita Yu suddenly raised his head and looked to the side. It was as if he had heard something.

The two followed Morita Yu’s line of sight. There was nothing there but a pure white wall.

Morita Yu stood up and shouted at the wall, “Who is it? Wait! Don’t go!!”

After shouting, Morita Yu immediately grabbed the red ball floating in the room, opened the door on that wall and hurriedly climbed up the ladder.

Song Qinglan asked, “Do you know him?”

“Yes.” Ji Yushi answered. He didn’t understand the current situation, “He was the traverser I told you about, Morita Yu.”

Looking at the alive and well Morita Yu, Song Qinglan frowned. How could someone come back to life after being decapitated?

Was the death elimination Tianqiong mentioned for this mission not what they thought it was?



“Beep——”

Morita Yu disappeared through that hole, and it soon closed behind him.

“Beep——”

At the same time as the door closing, there was another sound.

Another door opened. Morita Yu who had just left earlier had entered from another direction!

This scene made everyone almost suspect their eyes. Ji Yushi however noticed the red ball once again floating in the centre of this room.

He immediately understood, “It’s a record!”

The two were still looking into the room.

Watching the strange scene of Morita Yu entering the room again, Song Qinglan asked, “What record?”

“This room is making a recording!” Ji Yushi said, “Do you remember what I told you before? After Zoe left, I stayed in the room alone and watched the repeated process of us entering and leaving the room?”

Song Qinglan, “Of course I remember.”

Ji Yushi continued, “Morita told me before that when he was alone in a red room, someone had opened a door but left without showing themselves. He was a little disappointed when that happened.”

Morita Yu at the time had comforted Ji Yushi saying that it could possibly be his teammate.

The scene before them was a recurrence of what Morita Yu had described.

The Morita Yu before them went to the centre of the room again.

He squatted down and muttered to himself for a while before raising his head as if he had just seen something and getting up and shouting, “Who is it? Wait! Don’t go!!”

Morita Yu once again opened the door and left the room.

Immediately afterwards, a new Morita Yu entered the room.

Again and again, the scene before them replayed.

Ji Yushi climbed down the ladder first. Song Qinglan followed after him.

Both Duan Wen and Lin Xinlan could hear their exchange from below. Before asking anything, Duan Wen first climbed up the ladder to check the room.

Ji Yushi told them his thoughts, “The Morita in this room, just like how I saw ‘us’ entering the room repeatedly at that time, doesn’t really exist. It was a trace left behind by him.”

Song Qinglan, “So you’re saying that these rooms record down everything after we enter the room?”

Ji Yushi, “Yes.”

Lin Xinlan was curious about this bold speculation. He asked, “If this was the case, why didn’t we see those idiots in the super slow room earlier?”

That was indeed questionable.

“I’m not sure if all the rooms are recorded or only certain specific rooms are. Since the original room moves every time we leave it, we cannot go back to check.” Ji Yushi said, “But I have a guess.”

After saying this, he looked at Song Qinglan. He seemed to be asking if he could say it.

Song Qinglan nodded at him.

Ji Yushi continued, “These rooms have a time difference, and the time differences are also different. They could be regarded as very short worlds. It would record everything that happened after someone enters the room until they leave and would not be refreshed until someone enters the room again. When Zoe alone left at that time, she theoretically completed the process of ‘entering and leaving’ so I was able to see the repeated recording over and over again as I remained in the room.”

Lin Xinlan said, “I get it. You’re saying that the room may have originally recorded those idiots in that room, but it was refreshed when we entered.”

Ji Yushi, “The time flow in that room was very slow. If it was really recording, we probably would have been able to see the scene recorded if we watched the room from outside a little longer.”

Lin Xinlan didn’t ask any further.

He knew that Ji Yushi was still keeping something from them. It was probably the key point — The time difference.

If these rooms really recorded everything like Ji Yushi had said, then it would be a important hint for working out the time difference and for the so called ‘joining’.

When Duan Wen got off the ladder, Song Qinglan said, “Let’s go.”

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This time, they chose a room with a green ball.

After entering the room, they found Zhou Mingxuan in the room below. It was also a recording.

Zhou Mingxuan was like a wolf who had been captured. He had his arms restricted behind his back and a gun pointed to the back of his head.

With him were three or four Caucasians. They wore glossy cyan uniforms and would curse in some strange language at Zhou Mingxuan every few steps they took.

They saw Zhou Mingxuan stop. He seemed to be unwilling to give in but he was forced to continue on. They forced him to enter the room first — They seemed to be using him to check and ensure that the room was safe.

In this repeated recording, every time Zhou Mingxuan passed the centre of the room, he would raise his head.

They who were in the room above met his eyes.

Duan Wen was so angry at the sight of this that he cursed. Song Qinglan also lowered his eyes. There seemed to be a storm brewing in him.

In this giant Rubik's Cube, it was unknown how many rooms had the same thing happening. Traversers were like ants trapped in a sandbox. They couldn't find a way out no matter what they did.

Top, bottom, left and front.

Whenever they entered a room with recording, those recorded scenes would disappear instantly, leaving no trace behind.

The colours of the surrounding rooms changed. They were clearly approaching the centre block but at the same time they seemed to be a step away from it.

“We seem to be going around in circles.” Duan Wen said, “Why aren't we getting anywhere like this?”

“That only means that this place is bigger than we thought.” Song Qinglan replied, “If we're really going around in circles, we should be seeing rooms with marks left by us.”

Song Qinglan's words were not unreasonable. Duan Wen was speechless. How big was this place exactly?

Except for the impatient Duan Wen and Lin Xinlan who didn't speak much the whole time, Ji Yushi seemed to be very patient.

As long as it was safe, this was like a maze game he had played when he was a child. He could go on like this forever.

“To the left, the yellow room.” Song Qinglan looked at his communicator. Ji Yushi had already sent him a copy of his drawing, “If I am not wrong, it should be a purple room above.”

There were people in this yellow room.

Two unfamiliar traversers were holding half a corpse. They sat on the ground blankly and seemed to have broken down mentally.

When everyone silently entered the room, they realised that it was just a recording — The two unfamiliar traversers disappeared, leaving only half a corpse and a few miscellaneous items scattered across the ground.

Ji Yushi kept his gaze still. He tried his best not to look in the direction of the corpse.

They again left the room in silence and went to the purple room above.

After they left, the room with the yellow ball moved to the right and the room changed to a green room. Now they were surrounded with blue, purple, grey, red, green and blue. The centre block however still could not be seen.

“I wonder how it is for Chun’er and the others? Could we have gone in the opposite direction as them?” Duan Wen wondered, “Fuck, whenever I think, I feel the need for a smoke.”

The old smoker’s addiction had reared its head again.

Ji Yushi added, “Whenever I think, I feel the need for some medicine.”

He wanted to take his medicine.

Everyone, “.....”

Ji Yushi spoke expressionlessly, “Just kidding. I am feeling very energetic right now.”

Song Qinglan completely had no intention to comply to this request. He just continued the point raised by Duan Wen, “If we’re really going in opposite directions, they may have reached the edge of this cube. It’s better than circling around the centre block.”

After saying that, he suddenly paused for a moment, “If there is nothing in the centre block, we can also try going to the edge to take a look. It’s unknown what may be there. If the capsules are still there....”

Duan Wen became spirited, “That makes sense!”

Advancing ahead again and again, the location of the centre block became even more of an enigma.

Based on how the rooms moved, Ji Yushi marked their routes on his holographic projection, and then calculated their next route. The colour distribution and movement of the rooms was too complicated. It was more difficult to calculate than he had initially imagined.

While in thought, Ji Yushi subconsciously reached into his pocket only to find it empty. He belatedly remembered that his medicine box had been confiscated by Song Qinglan.

He was dependent on the medicine. He actually wasn’t joking earlier when he said he wanted to take his medicine, but he didn’t plan to ask Song Qinglan for it. He just bit his lip and continued to examine the colourful cube on his hologram.

As the others separated to check the surrounding rooms, Ji Yushi felt something poke his arm. He raised his head and Song Qinglan placed something in his hand.

Ji Yushi spread his hand open. It turned out to be a piece of chocolate wrapped in golden foil.

Where was this from?

Song Qinglan glanced at him from the side with an unreserved look. He raised his index finger and made a 'hush' gesture. His eyes seemed to say 'A reward for you'.

Ji Yushi's heart trembled slightly. He quietly peeled off the foil. He was a little hesitant about whether he should put this piece of chocolate of unknown origin into his mouth.

"Picked it up just now. Only have one. It's very clean." Song Qinglan said in a low voice, "Now you can think without a problem."

After saying that, he walked away and ordered Duan Wen to climb up a different ladder to check another room.

Ji Yushi ate the chocolate.

The bitter taste lingered at the tip of his tongue. After it melted in his mouth, he was left with faint sweetness which completely interrupted his thoughts.

"Here."

On the other end, Song Qinglan raised his chin having already decided on the next room.

\*

The tacit understanding between the men made each of them take turns entering the rooms first. This time, Lin Xinlan was first followed closely by Ji Yushi.

After confirming that it shouldn't be dangerous based on the rules they had confirmed, this kind of repetitive routine of entering room after room had made them become less vigilant.

As soon as Ji Yushi reached the ground, he heard Duan Wen shout from above, "Advisor Ji!!"

Before Duan Wen could finish speaking, there was a “beep——” and the hole above had actually closed!

Both Lin Xinlan and Ji Yushi were shocked. The ladder had disappeared, indicating that the room above had now moved. Ji Yushi quickly grabbed the green ball, reopened the door and climbed up the ladder.

The original room was replaced. There was no one in the room.

“Where are they?!” Lin Xinlan looked up at Ji Yushi, “Are they still there?”

Ji Yushi climbed down the ladder, “The room moved. They went to another room.”

Ji Yushi’s tone didn’t sound anxious, and he looked rather calm. This was outside of Lin Xinlan’s expectation. He had thought that Ji Yushi would panic after separating from his teammates. After all, no one would want to go around this place alone.

The four-member team had suddenly become two and it was the two who were most unfamiliar with each other.

As the captain of the ninth squad, although he didn’t have much experience in a different time and space, Lin Xinlan was at any rate an elite Tianqiong Guardian. He thought about what happened, “This means that there was someone who just happened to be moving between rooms near us and their movement moved our original room, yes?”

“Yes.”

Ji Yushi answered.

Lin Xinlan was tall and slender, and he had an attractive face. The blood stains on his black combat uniform had already dried up. There was only a spot on his neck, which made him look even more alluring.

The two stood facing each other. The atmosphere was a little strange.



Ji Yushi didn't talk much but he took the initiative to say, "It doesn't matter. We already know how the rooms move so we should meet up again soon."

Lin Xinlan also wasn't in a hurry. He asked, "Should we find them or will they look for us?"

If the two sides acted together, the chances of not meeting up would be higher.

"They will come find us." Ji Yushi said, "We can just wait here."

That line was quite simple, but it wasn't difficult for one to tell from it the tacit understanding and trust between the members of the seventh squad.

Or to be more specific, it was the tacit understanding and trust between Ji Yushi and Song Qinglan.

Seeing Lin Xinlan lower the corners of his lips slightly, Ji Yushi added, "Before we came down, they saw the colour of the new room. As long as we don't wander around, the chances of them finding us is high."

The two stood in place for several seconds before they each found a place to sit.

If they didn't talk in a situation like this, it was really suffocating. Ji Yushi originally wanted to take out his game console and play Tetris but Lin Xinlan started the conversation.

"Advisor Ji, I heard that your memory is especially good." Lin Xinlan said, "Is it because of this that you can speak so many languages?"

Ji Yushi replied, "Not at all. Some of it was learnt from university and foreigner friends."

Lin Xinlan suddenly realised something, "Boyfriend?"

Before Ji Yushi could speak, he added, "Sorry, I don't know if you mind talking about sexual orientation."

“I don’t mind.” Ji Yushi said, “But not a boyfriend.”

Someone once said that the fastest way to learn a language is to fall in love.

This however wasn’t the case for Ji Yushi.

Lin Xinlan’s question didn’t make him feel uncomfortable, nor did it have any other meaning. It sounded just like idle chat. He took out a dice from his pocket and as he played with it, he asked, “Then you’re single? With such good qualities, how are you still single? If not for us being the same, I would have gone after you.”

Probably because he had many suitors before and was used to this question, Ji Yushi said straightforwardly, “I have someone I like.”

Lin Xinlan asked, “Why don’t you pursue him?”

There was still a faint taste of chocolate in his mouth.

Bitter and slightly sweet. Ji Yushi answered flatly, “He’s straight.”

# Chapter 70: Chapter 70

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 70

“Straight?” Lin Xinlan was a little surprised. He immediately commented, “That is indeed tricky. I would never touch a straight man.”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

It seems that Cap Lin has a deep misunderstanding of himself.

Lin Xinlan ended the topic of sexuality and changed it to something else, “You’re getting along pretty well with the seventh squad, especially with Cap Song. It reminds me of that time when I went out with him for missions.”

From Lin Xinlan’s end, the scout in the seventh squad should be Old Yu.

What had happened over that year for Old Yu to change to Ji Yushi and for Song Qinglan’s attitude towards him to change so drastically? Lin Xinlan was very curious, but he didn’t dwell on this issue.

“At that time, we were still in training. We cooperated very well; anything I thought of, he also thought of, and we managed to complete a lot of missions together.” Lin Xinlan said, “In the student rankings, we were always tied. Some called us the Double Lan Duo.”

Ji Yushi had heard about this from Li Chun.

As Lin Xinlan talked about this, he seemed to be really aggrieved.

“Old Song is a cold guy and more capable than me. I originally thought that I would be assigned to the same squad as him after finishing training and wanted to be his left and right hand. Who knew....Tianqiong had been established for so many years and had been gradually expanding but it was seriously short-handed. Even someone like me became a rookie squad leader and like this, the Double Lan Duo was separated.” Lin Xinlan’s focus wasn’t this. He quickly went straight to the point, “Advisor Ji, say, why do you think we were still forced into this mission despite how powerful Tianqiong has become?”

Ji Yushi shook his head, “I don’t know.”

That was the truth.

That cunning so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ had said that their squad was the squad with the highest chance of succeeding so it needed their assistance with completing the mission. But why was something like this assigned by a system with self-awareness and what went wrong in the middle? That all still needed to be verified.

Lin Xinlan told him, “There is a conspiracy theory that there are holes in time and space because Tianqiong had interfered with the natural state of time and space. Not long ago, an anti-time management alliance was established on the dark web. Many people think that our work is meaningless because time is continuous; even if Tianqiong fixes a loophole, another loophole would inevitably replace it.”

Ji Yushi remembered the protest he saw in the bubble world.

“Tianqiong destroys the world!!”

“Illegal transition!!”

“Stop interfering with time and space!! Shut down the Tianqiong system!!”

“Down with the Time Management Alliance!”

A large-scale protest like that would appear in the bubble world because it was based on the original world. Sooner or later, the situation Lin Xinlan mentioned would be exactly the same as what he saw in the bubble world.

“Our current situation.....” Lin Xinlan reached this point and looked around the room, “Might be explaining this.”

Ji Yushi didn’t speak.

Lin Xinlan turned around and finished his words, “Perhaps time travel shouldn’t have been invented.”

As one whose job was to travel through time, he had even dared to say such words denying his occupation. Lin Xinlan was very bold.

Ji Yushi again didn’t speak.

It was because Ji Yushi wasn’t an ambitious Guardian who wanted to make a career out of it. He wasn’t in the position to express his opinion.

“Don’t worry. I don’t really mean it.” Lin Xinlan laughed, “Based on your reaction, it seems that I haven’t resigned yet a year later.”

Ji Yushi said, “Yes.”

Lin Xinlan put away the dice he was playing with and spoke meaningfully, “Besides....I like the feeling of chasing after Cap Song’s team in terms of points.”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

\*

The two stayed in the room for a while but Song Qinglan and them didn’t arrive.

Ji Yushi checked his communicator, “Twenty minutes have passed.”

Could it really be just as Lin Xinlan said and they had separated again? He didn't think that Song Qinglan would take such a long time.

Lin Xinlan circled around the room. He held the blue ball in his hand and wanted to check again to see if the colours of the surrounding rooms had changed.

While Lin Xinlan was checking the rooms, there was a 'beep——' and a circular hole opened on the wall at the back.

One cannot avoid one's enemy. The person who appeared was the man who had laughed at them earlier when they were in the super slow room.

It was the dark-skinned traverser. The moment the two parties saw each other, they were both stunned. The other party exclaimed, "You're out?! How come you're missing two people?"

Ji Yushi remained expressionless.

The other party then said, "Hey! Help us check. Are there any marks in the room you're in?"

Ji Yushi replied in French, "What number?"

Other party, "32!"

Ji Yushi, "No."

The other party clapped his hands in annoyance and said to his teammate below, "These traversers said there are no marks, but we've been going around in circles! Why?!"

"Beep——"

This group seemed to be very casual and impolite. They actually closed the hole immediately afterwards and disappeared again.

Lin Xinlan didn't understand what they were saying so he asked Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi briefly explained to Lin Xinlan, “They’re going around in a circle.”

Lin Xinlan remembered the ’29’ Ji Yushi wrote and couldn’t help but laugh. Immediately afterwards, a round hole opened above them.

“Beep——”

The two immediately looked up.

The people who appeared above wasn’t Song Qinglan and Duan Wen, but new, unfamiliar faces.

A red-haired female traverser leaned against the entrance of the hole and looked down. She said in English, “Safe!”

Lin Xinlan and Ji Yushi took a few steps back.

That red-haired woman and four other teammates climbed down from the upper room.

These people seem to have only just arrived and each of them had excited expressions like they were clearing a dungeon. The red-haired woman even greeted Ji Yushi and Lin Xinlan in the room, “Hi.”

In the twenty or so square metre room, an additional five people had appeared. With seven traversers in the same place, it suddenly felt a lot more crowded.

A traverser asked Lin Xinlan, “Mind if I use the key?”

Lin Xinlan, “Key?”

The five of them looked at the blue ball in Lin Xinlan’s hand.

They wanted to check the surrounding rooms and leave through a suitable one — They were just passing by.

Lin Xinlan readily agreed and gave them the ball. Along the way, he asked, “Excuse me, have you met our teammates on the way here?”

Ji Yushi and Lin Xinlan both wore black combat uniforms that belonged to their era. Although the squad number on their chest was different, one could still tell in one glance that they were from the same place.

These people denied it and proceeded to choose a new room.

“Goodbye, friends from a different era!”

“Perhaps we can meet again somewhere in time and space!”

With optimistic parting words, this group of traversers left.

They seem to have come from a very happy and well-off era.

Having met two groups of traversers, Ji Yushi said, “Cap Lin, let’s go.”

Lin Xinlan, “Not waiting for them?”

“Not waiting.” Ji Yushi reluctantly accepted the fact that even if he understood the rules, he couldn’t continue waiting for his teammates. As more and more people understood the rules, more and more people would try moving from room to room. “Have you noticed that there are now more people nearby?”

Lin Xinlan said, “Yes, it is a bit strange. Are they all going towards the centre block?”

Ji Yushi continued, “Even if we don’t move in this situation, we would be forced to move with the others moving around. As a result, we should do as discussed earlier and perhaps we can find each other again....”

It was time to set off.

Ji Yushi’s tone didn’t sound disappointed. In a short amount of time, he had made a second decision.

Lin Xinlan admired his ability to remain calm.

The centre block was a mystery.



Why weren't the rooms here like what they had imagined where it would have two colours at the same time if it happened to be where the two adjacent sides joined?

Could the centre be empty, or did it have something else?

As they advanced ahead while still clueless, reaching the centre block had become the driving force for them.

They went through another two rooms. Ji Yushi walked ahead constantly leaving marks behind.

Yellow, blue, purple, red, green and green. Those five colours had gathered in one place again. It made them gradually become more and more irritable.

When they reached a new room, Ji Yushi stopped just as he was about to make a mark. ".....How can this be?"

Lin Xinlan came over, "What did you find?"

When Lin Xinlan saw what Ji Yushi saw, his tone also changed, "We've been here before?!"

There was a symbol carved onto the ground that could only be recognised by Ji Yushi.

There were even two of them.

But Ji Yushi hadn't made his mark yet.

Lin Xinlan asked, "Did those people notice that we had tricked them and deliberately left marks behind to mislead us?"

Apart from this, Lin Xinlan couldn't think of anything else that could explain this phenomenon.

If they had already been to this room before, how could there be two identical marks on the floor?

“No.” Ji Yushi rubbed the mark on the floor with his hand and said, “This was done by me. I’m certain.”

Lin Xinlan, “Are you sure? Maybe they imitated your writing.”

Ji Yushi said it again, his tone was confident, “I’m certain.”

This strange scene made both of them feel a chill run through them.

How could something like this be explained?

“This was the ninth and tenth room that we’ve been to.” Ji Yushi pointed at the two symbols and said, “This was the blue super slow room and this was the blue room next to it that we entered after rolling the dice.”

Lin Xinlan, “Two blues? You mean the two blue rooms have overlapped?”

“I don’t know.” Ji Yushi lowered his eyes. He spoke as he made a new mark between the two symbols.

If it was because there were more people passing through causing the room they had originally passed by to move to this place, it still couldn’t explain the overlap.

\*

After entering a new room again, Lin Xinlan’s voice disappeared from behind him.

Ji Yushi looked back. He saw Lin Xinlan maintaining a bending posture at the entrance of the round hole. His entire body was motionless and seemed to be at a standstill.

“Cap Lin?!”

Thinking that he had entered a slow-motion room again, Ji Yushi subconsciously called out. He then reacted — Time difference!

Although the colours of the balls were different, the time in this room was not in line with the time in the room from which he had come from. Just like how Song Qinglan felt like a week had passed before he found Ji Yushi, the time difference caused the people in the two rooms to be separated.

“Beep——”

The round hole in the room closed.

There was only Ji Yushi in the room now.

Ji Yushi retrieved the purple ball suspended in the air and checked. Sure enough, Lin Xinlan wasn't there anymore.

Lin Xinlan's room had moved.

Ji Yushi was silent.

All of this was far beyond his expectations. Everything was completely out of his control.

Ji Yushi alone checked the colours of the surrounding rooms. When he reached the room in front, he was stunned.

A new room had appeared before him.

It had never appeared anywhere else before.

Pure white walls and blinding lights.

Unlike what they had imagined, this place wasn't empty nor was it colourful.

There was a black ball quietly floating in the centre of the room.

Ji Yushi had reached the centre block.

He took out his zipper handle and tossed it in.

There was a crisp sound. The small zipper handle was difficult to follow but Ji Yushi had excellent eyesight and good concentration, so he was able to accurately follow its trajectory. It fell into the centre of the room completely intact.

Ji Yushi stepped onto the ladder and climbed up.

There was a voice inside him telling him not to go in.

That was his sense of reason as well as his cowardly side.

If he was wrong, he would completely fail the mission. He would face death and elimination and be unable to continue.

If he died in the centre block, his teammates would lose his assistance and would perhaps also lose traces of him. Would Song Qinglan continue to look for him?

But Ji Yushi still went through the hole.

He turned around and stepped onto the first step on the ladder inside.

\*

“Beep——”

The moment he stepped into the centre block, the purple ball in his hand returned to its original position and the round hole on the wall closed.

Ji Yushi’s vision suddenly darkened. The surroundings were also extremely quiet. He didn’t know where he was.

No light, no sound. Everything was dead silent.

Ji Yushi couldn’t even hear himself breathing.

Am I dead?

— As soon as he wondered this, a ray of light appeared within the darkness.

Suddenly, the entire place brightened up.

Ji Yushi felt like he was in the middle of a vast universe. The sky stretched endlessly in the distance, as did the ground. He on the other hand was standing in the middle of a bright galaxy.

He saw it now. Those lights were actually countless different coloured cubes.

They glowed six different colours. It was like there were six rays of lights crisscrossing each other.

A distant memory surfaced in Ji Yushi's mind.

In the Tianqiong training camp, the instructor on the stage gave a simple demonstration.

She drew a flowing ray of light in the air, "Our research team invented Tianqiong. They were the ones who discovered that time wasn't just a straight line."

Then, countless thin lines stretched out from it.

That scene gradually merged with the scene before him.

Ji Yushi walked through these lights. With every step he took, his surroundings would flip. Up, down, front and back, it was hard to distinguish which direction was which.

These lights seem to cut off. Red embedded into blue, yellow embedded into purple.....Countless cubes of different colours were the sources of those lights. They sat along the interlacing light rays interrupting the continuity of these rays.

Ji Yushi stopped in place.

The cubes flickered. Round holes constantly appeared on different sides of it.

He saw traversers of different skin colours and from different eras walking through them.

He saw someone dying, someone break down, someone circle the cube again and again and someone leave their capsule and enter a new room.

He saw the cubes move, constantly changing the way it was made up.

Just like the picture he saw in the book “Time Traveller” he read as a child; he saw countless different worlds through the wormholes.

As the traversers crossed through the cubes, some colours increased in the light rays while other colours gradually decreased. It continuously changed in a way Ji Yushi had never seen before. The traversers walked through these fragments of time and space, attempting to join them as Tianqiong had advised.

Mission mode: Rubik’s Cube.

Mission objective: Joining.

Someone had said to him, “Could it be like ‘Chaos’? The so-called mission should only be taken literally and doesn’t really have any special meaning to it. As you know, it is an artificial intelligence. It’s not that clever.”

Someone had said to him, “Take it apart if you can’t restore it?”

He suddenly understood something.

There was a weight on his shoulder. Someone behind him called out his name, “Ji Yushi.”

Ji Yushi was startled. After turning around, the first thing that caught his eye was a stubble. Raising his head slightly, his eyes met with a pair of calm eyes.

Behind Song Qinglan was Duan Wen and also a Zhou Mingxuan who was covered in blood. The three of them had also arrived at the centre block.

The sight before them made them unable to speak. They didn't say anything and just looked around at their surroundings.

The lights were reflected in Ji Yushi's eyes. Song Qinglan seemed to have quickly lost interest in the brilliant surroundings and just subconsciously stood beside Ji Yushi. He similarly looked up into the distance.

"It's pretty." Song Qingly spoke lazily, "How does it compare to the crevice of time and space in Chaos?"

"Not the same."

Ji Yushi replied.

In the crevice of time and space in Chaos, he once stood under an aurora and had his breath taken away by the appearance of a large silver-white planet passing by a mountain of metal garbage. The sea in the sky, getting wet from the water splashed by a whale, the sideways snow-capped mountains as well as the heavy rain.

Just like that time, the same person stood beside him.

"Our job may be the only job where you can see a sight like this." Song Qinglan said, "Premium sightseeing ticket, and it's also limited edition."

Ji Yushi looked over, "I know what's going on here."

# Chapter 71: Chapter 71

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 71

Song Qinglan didn't seem to be surprised when he heard Ji Yushi say that.

He just raised a brow and said, "I would like to hear the details."

"What we have always thought about was how we should move and join the coloured rooms without being affected by the movement of others." Ji Yushi explained, "That was impossible, so we were stuck in a dead end."

Seeing them talk about serious matters, Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan also fell back.

The four of them gathered together. Just like how it was many times before, they listened to Ji Yushi explain.

"We are in a 'wormhole' that is within Tianqiong's control. I don't know if it was due to the multiple travels or because of something else, but in any case, as you can see, time and space had been disrupted. Loopholes had appeared in many timelines, crisscrossing with each other, making them unable to continue on smoothly." Ji Yushi spoke slowly, "It was just as we thought. Tianqiong had used colours to mark the different disrupted timelines to make the fragments more identifiable and made it into a Rubik's Cube for us to restore. But as Cap Song had said, Tianqiong is only a system and can only use the simplest and most direct way to express itself. Rubik's Cube....Think about it. If a Rubik's Cube has already fallen apart, what should you do to restore it?"

Everyone thought of the answer immediately.



“Piece it together!”

“Damn, isn’t that joining the pieces?!”

Song Qinglan was in thought. He didn’t interrupt Ji Yushi.

He intuitively felt that Ji Yushi had something to say.

“The chances of us encountering other traversers got higher and higher. It was as if there were somehow more and more traversers all of a sudden. My guess is that it’s because the number of rooms had decreased.” Ji Yushi told them about the room he saw after separating from them where he saw two of his marks, “Time is continuous. With the people travelling through the rooms as a carrier of constant time, after they pass through two rooms on the same timeline in the correct order, the rooms would be joined together; two into one.”

Duan Wen looked at the changing cubes in the sky, “I see. The rooms won’t become visually larger after merging into one because it was originally from the same timeline. Strickly speaking, only time became longer. That was probably why we felt like a week had passed.”

Ji Yushi revealed a look of praise.

Duan Wen smiled shyly. His face flushed red.

Zhou Mingxuan didn’t have a pleasant experience here. After reuniting with his teammates, he was still in a poor mood. He asked, “Then the rooms we have gone through that have the same colour have all merged?”

Having gone through rooms of the same colour without encountering a time difference, it meant that they were originally in consecutive order along the timeline.

Having safely passed through the rooms, these rooms should have theoretically merged into one.

“It is possible.” Song Qinglan answered, “These fragments of time and space can only rely on us to move. There are advantages and disadvantages

to that. The advantage is that we know that they can only move according to certain rules. The disadvantage is that we cannot look back so even if they have merged, we wouldn't have noticed."

With the answer revealed, everyone was silent for a few seconds.

In the countless rooms around them, countless figures belonging to other traversers were still tirelessly walking around.

And they, who were in the centre block, were the lucky ones with the trump card. All they needed to do was to complete the last few steps.

Why was this a multiplayer mission? Everyone now understood how cruel it really was. Tianqiong had hijacked these traversers without regard for whether they would be able to truly clear the mission. Its goal had only been one thing – To let these people walk through these rooms and, whether consciously or unconsciously, they would use their bodies to join the same-coloured fragments of time and space.

This was to continue until the last piece falls into place.

The so-called "Tianqiong of all eras", even with self-awareness, it was nothing but a ruthless, cold-blooded system.

Zhou Mingxuan, "So now we can directly choose a colour and let it join."

Ji Yushi nodded, "Yes."

Duan Wen, "Then what are we waiting for? Shit, we should hurry and end this!"

They looked around and were surprised to find that there was no way out.

From the moment they entered the room with the black ball, they seemed to have entered another high-dimensional world. They could only sit there and watch.

Song Qinglan thought for a while and said, "Since it's the centre block, it makes no difference which one you choose. You can start anywhere."

He pointed at the closest cube, “Advisor Ji, can we choose this one?”

Everyone was shocked. Was it so casual?

Unexpectedly, Ji Yushi smiled slightly, “Yes.”

The four of them walked towards the cube.

Countless other cubes surrounded them, making them seem insignificant under all the lights.

In the darkness, Duan Wen asked, “Speaking of which, where’s Cap Lin?”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Who?”

Duan Wen, “Ninth squad, Lin Xinlan.”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Him? Why the fuck is he here?”

The two chattered on. Duan Wen began to explain in a low voice to Zhou Mingxuan what happened after he and Song Qinglan ran into Lin Xinlan. Zhou Mingxuan was so angry, he cursed their bad luck.

Song Qinglan walked slightly slower. He was tall and well built and his strong presence made Ji Yushi next to him feel some pressure.

For some reason, Ji Yushi’s eyelid continued to twitch.

He suddenly had a very bad feeling.

Song Qinglan said, “When I went back to find you two, I saw you two talking in that room.”

**KK has something to say:**

Anyone missing my usual daily updates? With more free time (thanks to COVID lockdown and having my work hours cut down....😞), I’ve been able to translate a few more chapters! I’ll now be updating ‘Mist’ daily~ ^^

# Chapter 72: Chapter 72

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 72

After they left the room, Song Qinglan really went back?

What did Song Qinglan hear?

Would he ask about it? Or would there be more misunderstandings like the misunderstanding with the three boyfriends?

His eyelids still twitching, Ji Yushi's heart raced chaotically.

The fingers hanging by his side quietly curled up, but his expression was the same as usual. He responded calmly, "Oh."

"Thanks to the recording function, I managed to learn that you decided to continue towards the centre block. We would've wasted a lot of time otherwise." Song Qinglan quickly continued, "Got separated from Lin Xinlan?"

Ji Yushi: "....."

He and Lin Xinlan had waited for Song Qinglan in that room for at least twenty minutes. It was only when more and more traversers were moving around them did they decide to leave.

It turned out that the situation in the room Song Qinglan saw was just before he and Lin Xinlan left, not when they first entered the room.

The curled fingers slowly relaxed.

Ji Yushi was relieved inside but there was also a faint sense of disappointment.

Fortunately, he was someone who knew what he could and couldn't do. He replied as usual, "Yes. We encountered a time difference and got separated."

Song Qinglan declined to comment on this. Lin Xinlan getting separated from them didn't affect their mission.

"These recordings can help us distinguish the time sequences. Coupled with the rules behind the movement of the rooms, we can go to each room with different time differences and leave traces behind. It shouldn't be too difficult putting them together." Song Qinglan said, "We should be able to get out of this mission soon."

Ji Yushi: "Yes."

Song Qinglan raised his lips and smiled handsomely, "Looks like Tianqiong was right about us having the highest chance in succeeding."

After saying that, he glanced at Ji Yushi again. His eyes were deep, "Because we have Advisor Ji."

Ji Yushi turned away and caught up with the two people gossiping ahead.

Compared to chatting with a steel straight man, he would rather listen to gossip.

The lights shone brightly in the dark. The cubes of different time and space fragments merged and recombined with the movement of countless traversers, changing nonstop.

Everyone walked towards a large purple cube. Duan Wen reached over.

The walls seem to have no physical body. Duan Wen's hand didn't touch anything.

Following that, Duan Wen lifted his leg and stepped in through the wall just like how he did when he first came out of his capsule.

The others also followed after him one after another. It was as if a game was slowly loading characters on a screen.

The surroundings became bright again. Everything was pure white except for the purple ball floating in the centre of the room. They retrieved the purple ball and opened the hole on the wall they had just entered from.

What they saw on the other end was no longer the darkness from earlier. It had instead changed back to the normal centre block with a black ball suspended in the air.

This mission was too abstract. Everyone who had gone through several fantastical journeys still couldn't help but express their surprise and awe.

"Someone has been in this room." Ji Yushi saw the strange marks on the floor, "It is already an integrated room."

Duan Wen bent down and counted, "Nine. Does it mean that at least nine rooms have been joined?"

Ji Yushi: "Something like that."

"Haa, the people crossing through the rooms have just been busy doing nothing. They probably would have never imagined that it was referring to joining like this." Zhou Mingxuan sighed, "We must have also unknowingly joined quite a few rooms ourselves."

Everyone nodded in agreement.

"The people who completes this mission may not be us but someone else." Song Qinglan was thinking in a different direction, "With the colours joining, the rooms are becoming fewer and fewer, and the overlapping marks are increasing more and more. They will discover this sooner or later and the competition towards the end will be rather fierce."

As the captain and as someone who often competed with others, Song Qinglan was very competitive.

He was able to keenly identify the current issue. Towards the end, the mission would be mainly about the confrontation between the traversers instead.

Duan Wen slapped his thigh, “Cap Song is right!”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Then should we do it or not?! The more rooms we join, the greater the chance of them noticing something, but if we don’t do it, we would be wasting a lot of time!”

Even Ji Yushi couldn’t help but frown.

Song Qinglan said, “Do it. Since we’re already here, why would we be afraid of making the first move?”

Song Qinglan stood on the side of the room, but he was the focus of everyone’s attention.

His eyes narrowed slightly, and his body gave off a fierce and domineering aura. It was clear that he had no intentions to lose.

He didn’t shrink back, nor did he hesitate when facing the challenges that were thrown at him.

“Starting from this purple room, we must win.”

“Beep——”

A hole appeared on the wall in front of everyone.

\*

“Yellow!”

“Red!”

“Grey! Blue!”

“Green!”

The four people in the seventh squad worked separately.

Every time they arrived at a new room, Duan Wen, Zhou Mingxuan and Song Qinglan was responsible for checking the colours of the surrounding rooms while Ji Yushi was responsible for the calculations.

“There’s also a grey here!”

Zhou Mingxuan jumped off the ladder.

“Yellow, red, grey, blue, green, grey.....” Ji Yushi figured out the direction they were going using his holographic projection, “The right side of the previous room was purple. We’re moving forward. Forward and then down. It is currently to our bottom right. We will need to circle back and then take the right. Forward and then right. The right is green which we can cross through and then we go back and then up before continuing down to enter a new purple.” (*KKnotes: ????*)

Everyone’s eyes spun.

Duan Wen, “Huh?”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Old Duan, don’t worry about it too much. Just do as he says.”

This was the fourth purple room they entered. After some comparisons, there was a time difference between two of the purple rooms. The earlier purple room was in the correct order and adjacent to the one at the beginning. If it doesn’t get moved, they should be able to join it together without much trouble.

Even if it was moved by the others, it didn’t matter. They could just choose another colour at random and start over — Sooner or later, these colours would all need to be joined together to form a continuous timeline.

Unlike earlier when they were going around blindly, this time they walked through the different coloured rooms with a purpose. They were the first among the countless traversers to figure out the situation.



Purple, yellow and then blue.

The target changed several times as they moved on, but Ji Yushi was still able to clearly figure out that they should do next.

In these intricate fragments of time and space, Ji Yushi was like a bright guiding light.

Song Qinglan was the helmsman in charge of the ship. Following Ji Yushi's instructions, he lead the group forward.

A room with slower time and a room with faster time could be joined together. A room two seconds behind and a room two seconds ahead could be joined together.

Two hours, two seconds, no difference....Careful analysis and testing was required every time in order to allow them to figure out the exact time difference.

In order to test out the time sequence, the four of them separated several times.

In rooms with different time differences, they once just went in and then went out. To successfully join the rooms, they were at times separated for up to two days.

For a while, they seemed to back in the Ouroboros cycle. They had to go around and around and find the one path that would lead them to success in the constantly changing environment. "Rubik's Cube" really deserved its reputation as a Super S-level mission.

As they went around, they left behind marks.

As the numbers increased, they encountered several groups of traversers along the way. The number of traversers they met had grown to more than a hundred. They had also ran into themselves several times. These rooms had recorded their journey through the rooms, so they were able to clearly

figure out the time difference between rooms of the same colour by taking advantage of it.

The rooms were constantly decreasing.

Mental stress also continued to build up in Ji Yushi.

\*

“Beep——”

They reached a new room.

As soon as Ji Yushi stepped down from the ladder, Song Qinglan grabbed his wrist and stopped him from opening his holographic projection, “Ji Yushi.”

“Cap Song.”

Ji Yushi’s face was a little pale, and there was a thin layer of sweat across his forehead. Although he still looked spirited, it was purely from stubbornness.

The behaviour of the two attracted the attention of their other teammates.

Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan stopped and looked back at them.

“Rest in this room for a while first.” Song Qinglan said firmly, “We will continue after a break.”

“Successfully joined 37 blue, 23 purple, 16 green, 5 red, 2 grey and 15 yellow.” Ji Yushi objected, “The success rate is only half. We still don’t know how many are left for us to join.”

Song Qinglan said, “Those are just what we have done. There are still many others done by the other traversers. Having done so much already, there is no need to rush.”

Ji Yushi looked straight into his eyes. His gaze was very calm, “I just want to quickly go home.”

Quickly go home.

Hearing those words, Song Qinglan seemed to have thought of something. His grip around Ji Yushi’s wrist loosened.

“We all want to quickly go home.” Song Qinglan stepped back a little, “No, you must rest. Give your mind a break first before we set off again.”

“No need.” Ji Yushi, “You don’t have to worry about me.”

Song Qinglan laughed in anger when he heard this, “I don’t know if there is anyone at home who worries about you but here, I am the captain. If I don’t care about you, who will?”

This wasn’t Song Qinglan’s first time asking him to rest but this time he seemed to be extremely determined.

Knowing that there was no room for negotiation this time, Ji Yushi lowered his eyes to express acquiescence.

It couldn’t be considered a quarrel nor a confrontation but for some reason the atmosphere was a little tense.

“After walking through more than two hundred rooms, even I am a little tired.” Zhou Mingxuan added in due course, “It should be time to rest.”

“Let me take a look at the surrounding situation first.” Duan Wen said.

Ji Yushi found a place and sat down.

He then pulled out his black and white game console.

His way of resting was still the same. He didn’t sleep nor did he need it. Playing Tetris was the best way for him to relax.

Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan checked the colours of the surrounding rooms while Song Qinglan stood in place, watching Ji Yushi. The other party's beautiful profile and quiet temperament was no different from the past, but Song Qinglan could sense his impatience.

After completing the missions set by Tianqiong, they would be able to go home and also get their reward.

And it wasn't any reward.

He knew exactly what Ji Yushi wanted.

Song Qinglan hesitated. For the first time, he felt that he couldn't control himself.

He circled twice and then finally gritted his teeth and walked over. But before he could speak, Ji Yushi stopped playing his game and spoke, "Why do you care so much about me?"

Song Qinglan was stunned.

Ji Yushi's voice wasn't loud, and the other teammates were still talking so they probably didn't hear him.

"From the moment we departed till now, you have been expressing more and more concern towards me." Ji Yushi's eyes were clear, "It's easy to misunderstand."

Ji Yushi always spoke very bluntly. Every time, Song Qinglan would be caught off guard.

He was different from the other members of the seventh squad. He had not yet officially joined the seventh squad and his sexual orientation was different. He was also different from everyone else in other aspects; he was frank and open, never ashamed to say that he liked men. This was the one and only Ji Yushi.

And it was also the Ji Yushi who was not single.

This time, Song Qinglan couldn't even say the words 'I am the captain'.

Unabashedly reminded by Ji Yushi, he found that he couldn't answer, as if his throat was blocked.

Ji Yushi lowered his head back down after saying that and restarted the game, "I will also misunderstand."

Song Qinglan's expression changed a little. His mood was in turmoil.

Some words seemed to be hanging from his lips.

At this moment, "beep——".

A hole opened.

Everyone looked up at the same time.

Someone looked down from the ladder and shouted, "Blue! There are people inside!"

Another person's voice sounded, "Then go down!"

The familiar Chinese made them almost think that they had met their other teammates or perhaps the members of the ninth squad.

Slowly climbing down the ladder was a chubby middle-aged man. He looked like an otaku. The one who came down behind him was a younger man. He wore a pair of silver-rimmed glasses and a white shirt. Without even needing to speak, he gave off an intellectual air.

They didn't look like traversers.

Unnoticed by the others, Ji Yushi's entire body stiffened up. He was frozen in place.

# Chapter 73: Chapter 73

## Rubik's Cube

### Chapter 73

The origins of the two were unknown so everyone raised their alertness.

Upon seeing this, the chubby middle-aged man smiled, “Are you Guardians from our country’s Tianqiong?”

Song Qinglan asked back without any politeness, “You are?”

The middle-aged man said, “Don’t be nervous. We’re just passing by.”

In this ‘Rubik’s Cube’ which connected various times and spaces, talking about the era in which they came from was something unavoidable.

It was just that, as Guardians, no matter which era or world they came from, there was something that they shared in common — They were all hijacked by Tianqiong to complete its mission.

But these two seemed to be different.

Different from the trained and fearless Guardians, their temperament seemed to be more peaceful, making people feel less nervous. It was as if this place wasn’t a dangerous place for them.

The gentleman with glasses saw the marks on the ground and asked, “I noticed that the rooms are decreasing and marks like these are increasing. Are you joining it?”

Those marks were made by Ji Yushi. Except for himself and Big Beard, no one else should understand it.

It was unknown what the stranger's intentions were so no one spoke.

The unfamiliar gentleman didn't mind their attitude. He just smiled gently, "If it's you, then you are really amazing."

His gaze passed through the people standing in the room and stopped at Ji Yushi who was sitting on the floor.

Song Qinglan followed his gaze and proceeded to frown deeply.

Ji Yushi's face was extremely pale, and he appeared to be in a state of panic. For some reason, his condition appeared to be worse than before. He sat on the floor and didn't even make an attempt to stand as he stared at the two strangers.

No, he was more precisely staring at the bespectacled man.

Ji Yushi was rarely like this. He even belonged to the socially inactive type.

Not only Song Qinglan, even Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan noticed that something wasn't right with Ji Yushi.

"Advisor Ji?"

The stranger was almost middle-aged and appeared to be well educated.

Despite the stare and his expression, he nodded politely at Ji Yushi.

Seeing the black and white console in Ji Yushi's hand, he even said, "What a coincidence. My son also has a similar game console to the one this young brother has."

Ji Yushi's game console was already very old.

It didn't belong to his time. It was a product from the past.

Did these two strangers come from a long time ago?

Everyone guessed inside.

“It really is.” Ji Yushi spoke up.

For some reason, there seemed to be a thick film covering his originally cold voice. It didn’t sound bad, but it made it sound indistinct.

Ji Yushi continued to stare at the other party in complete daze.

He resembled the people who had lost their way in this ‘Rubik’s Cube’; mentally exhausted to the point of almost collapsing.

The two had said that they were just passing by, and it really seemed to be the case. They had no other purpose, and they also didn’t have anything else to say to the four Guardians.

They retrieved the blue ball floating in the air and, after checking the colours of the surrounding rooms, they eventually picked one to leave through.

The chubby middle-aged man left first. He climbed the ladder with great effort and moved rather slowly.

The gentleman with glasses waited patiently.

As if noticing something, he looked back at Ji Yushi in the corner.

Ji Yushi had his head lowered. His thin profile was straight, he was no longer looking at the man.

It was just that he was still gripping tightly onto his game console. It was so hard, the tips of his fingers turned white.

The gentleman’s companion called out, “Old Sheng! Come over!”

The man said, “Coming!”



“Beep——“

The round hole closed.

The two outsiders disappeared behind the wall.

“What were those two doing?” Duan Wen was puzzled, “Why are they wandering around like they’re window shopping?”

“I don’t know.” Zhou Mingxuan also found it strange. He joked, “Maybe they’re some commoner traversers. Haven’t you heard? Our mysterious profession is actually a dream job for many people. There are many who illegally traverse in private.”

Ji Yushi spoke, “Let’s go.”

Ji Yushi’s voice seemed to be better than before, but it still sounded different.

When he raised his head, everyone saw that his face was so pale, it was almost transparent. If not for the redness at the corner of his eyes, he would’ve looked calmer and saner.

Duan Wen: “Advisor Ji, you don’t look very good.”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Didn’t we only just get here? Let’s rest a little longer.”

“How are you feeling?”

Song Qinglan asked. He clearly didn’t agree with leaving with Ji Yushi in his current condition.

They had just argued about this issue not long ago.

“I’m fine.” Ji Yushi answered as per usual.

Song Qinglan watched him stand up and retrieve the blue ball that had returned to the centre of the room.

He suddenly felt that the back of the bespectacled man in the white shirt looked familiar — If Ji Yushi was still wearing the same white shirt he wore when they first met, that is.

Song Qinglan was keenly aware that something was off.

Ji Yushi's reaction just now may be related to that person. That person possibly came from a time earlier than theirs. Could Ji Yushi have met the other person during one of his missions as a Recorder? Song Qinglan wanted to ask but Ji Yushi had already opened a new door.

Despite Song Qinglan's strong request for him to take a break, Ji Yushi showed no signs of relenting.

He just said to the others, "Go this way."

Song Qinglan lowered his eyes to cover the emotions in his eyes and said to his other teammates, "Let's go."

\*

Setting off again this time, their process of joining the rooms was clearly a lot faster and more efficient than before.

Apart from performing his calculations, testing the rooms and talking about the mission, Ji Yushi almost didn't say anything else.

Everyone noticed this change in him and thought that it was because he was too eager to complete the mission. Only Song Qinglan noticed that Ji Yushi seemed to be suppressing the urge to turn back despite that room already having moved to who knows where.

"Yellow." Ji Yushi said mechanically, "Twentieth."

They left the yellow room that had been successfully joined with twenty rooms and got ready to enter a new blue room.

The blue room before them was densely filled with marks left by different people. The blanks were almost completely filled up by them.

“Beep——”

Someone on the other end also opened a hole on the wall.

It was a group of unfamiliar traversers. They looked at each other from opposite ends with the blue room between them.

With the rooms becoming fewer, every one of the rooms filled with numerous marks may possibly be the last room. The seventh squad found themselves facing their very first competition.

The blue room still had the recording from before playing.

The team standing in the room seemed to be the very team looking at them from the other hole across the room.

“You should give up!” someone yelled in English, “We have already figured out the time difference in this blue room, so we specially came back. We have a better chance of succeeding than you!”

Duan Wen replied, “Why should we give up?!”

The other party took out a gun, “Please?”

Duan Wen: “Fuck!”

“Let them.” Ji Yushi said, “This is not the last one.”

Song Qinglan asked, “What did you see?”

Ji Yushi said, “The ‘29’ mark inside, it was the one I wrote last time to confuse the other group. It definitely isn’t the last blue room.”

They had been tricked once in the super slow blue room and Ji Yushi at the time had retaliated a little against them.

It was just two ordinary numbers but when Ji Yushi wrote it, he had specially imitated the other groups handwriting. At the very least, for people other than him, there was no difference at all.

But if Ji Yushi said it wasn't, then it most definitely wasn't.

Duan Wen immediately turned around and told the group, "You can have it!"

Ji Yushi had already chosen another route, "It's purple here. The total number of rooms joined together is only second to blue. We should hurry."

Everyone immediately followed him.

Following this, the seventh team experienced several similar incidents.

They gave up red, yellow and then another yellow. Every time they gave in, Duan Wen and Zhou Mingxuan became more and more anxious. Ji Yushi's expression however remained calm the entire time. After walking a few laps, just when it was very obvious that the number of rooms had become much fewer, they ran into Lin Xinlan again.

The ninth squad had all gathered together. Their luck wasn't just a little bit better than theirs.

"54 red!" Lin Xinlan shouted to them from the room below, "Cap Song, between you and me who do you think will complete this mission?"

Lin Xinlan's teammates seemed to have been wandering around the red area the entire time.

It seems that Lin Xinlan had also been to the centre block. Although he didn't understand the principles behind it, he managed to make a few guesses based on the information he got from Ji Yushi's analysis and the rooms becoming fewer and fewer.

Song Qinglan looked down at them and said coldly, "Not me, it's us. We will be the ones to complete the mission."

Lin Xinlan laughed, "Is that right? Why don't we make a bet?"

These words sounded familiar.

As expected of the Double Lan Duo. Song Qinglan had also said something like this to Ji Yushi before.

Lin Xinlan: “If you lose, you promise me one thing. If I lose, I’ll tell you a secret.”

Song Qinglan, “Not interested.”

Lin Xinlan was unconcerned about his attitude and just said, “Say hello to Advisor Ji for me.”

Everyone: “.....”

Ji Yushi stood up, “Let’s go.”

The round hole closed.

On the other side, another round hole opened. Two identical faces appeared, “Cap Song!!!”

It was Tang Qi and Tang Le!

The moment Tang Le saw his captain and everyone else in the squad, he almost burst into tears. He quickly climbed down the ladder.

Tang Qi followed closely behind but he instead asked, “Where’s Li Chun?”

Song Qinglan’s expression was serious. He seemed to have noticed that something wasn’t right, “Advisor Ji said that he was with you.”

Tang Qi gritted his teeth, “Dammit. He went out of his way to help an injured girl and we got separated!”

Everyone: “.....”

As expected of Li Chun.

Everyone scolded and cursed Li Chun out. Even Song Qingan was a little angry—They were just about to complete the mission. If it was according

to the rules given by Tianqiong, those who were eliminated would not be considered as having successfully completed the mission.

Ji Yushi turned on his communicator and looked at the simulated cube he had drawn on the holographic projection. He then interrupted their complaints, “We now have six people. We can move separately.”

Song Qinglan, “Move separately?”

“Move separately?!”

“It might not be a good idea?”

“What if something happens? How would we get back together?”

“I will send everyone a copy of the diagram.”

Ji Yushi was anxious. Everyone could see this, and they could tell that his condition was quite bad.

But they also knew that Ji Yushi wasn't the irresponsible type of person who would make rash decisions.

Ji Yushi told everyone calmly, “We have already analysed that this is a multiplayer mission and that teams with a larger number of people have a higher chance of succeeding. There are too many rooms and too few people. Now that we have six people, we can have each of us follow each route separately. There are very few rooms left around us so we can separate and scout out the routes separately to save time.”

“Alright.” Song Qinglan pondered for a few seconds, “Different from the other groups, there is no need to compete between us. There is only one goal and that is to join the rooms together. Don't worry if your path is blocked, safety comes first. You can always give up the current path and go to another.”

The longer they delay it, the more likely they would lose.

Moving separately was undoubtedly a risky move.

No one in the seventh squad was a coward. For the sake of succeeding, for the sake of being able to return home, they had already sacrificed too much.

Ji Yushi sent a copy of his diagram to everyone's communicator. The colours around the rooms were different. They first divided into two groups and separated.

They said goodbye to each other in this room.

Duan Wen, Tang Qi and Tang Le formed one group.

Zhou Mingxuan, Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi formed the other group.

After entering the second room, Zhou Mingxuan separated from them.

Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi separated at the fourth room. After going through three rooms alone, they met again before once again separating in the new room.

The reduction in the number of rooms made it easier for them to meet up again.

Once, Duan Wen said, "Those ninth squad bastards. I've already encountered them twice, but why haven't I encountered those other two?"

He was talking about the two men who didn't look like traversers.

Song Qinglan glanced at Ji Yushi. The latter had already recovered his usual calmness, "You won't see them again."

They continued with their mission, repeating the process of separating, meeting and then exchanging information.

They would meet different teammates in different rooms, and they would also run into more and more traversers.

Finally, they noticed that the blue rooms had disappeared.

On the six sides of the cube, one side had a dark void appear and that side soon turned into dark nothingness. At the same time, Duan Wen who joined the blue rooms disappeared.

Before Ji Yushi entered the last room with the red ball, he ran into Song Qinglan again.

The room had recorded an earlier traverser's death process.

She knelt on the ground, her skin slowly peeling from her body until her bones were revealed underneath.

She cried out in agony. The short blond hair falling from her scalp and the gun in her hand.....all of it allowed Ji Yushi to recognise her.

After Zoe separated from him, she had chosen a red room again.

She was bold and courageous, but she had failed to make it to the end.

The two stood together on the ladder. Song Qinglan was able to take in Ji Yushi's reaction.

Song Qinglan grabbed his shoulder and said in a low voice, "Don't look. I'll go this way."

Ji Yushi however didn't mind.

The two stood very close. He spoke up but what he said was, "Cap Song, I have already reminded you earlier."

Song Qinglan found breathing difficult.

The other party's state wasn't good. It could be said that it had worsened considerably in a very short amount of time.

Song Qinglan took in the other party's pale face and sweaty forehead as well as the slightly quivering eyelashes and unwavering resoluteness.

"Ji Yushi!"



Without giving him a chance to stop him, Ji Yushi quickly climbed down the ladder and entered the room.

“Beep——”

The round hole closed.

The ball that was originally in Ji Yushi’s hand returned to its original position.

With Ji Yushi gone, Song Qinglan could only watch himself be moved in another direction together with the room: “.....”

In this labyrinth-like cube, he could no longer see Ji Yushi’s figure.

\*

In the darkness, a new figure emerged.

The teammates in the centre block waited eagerly for their comrade who managed to successfully join the rooms.

The man was tall and straight and his skin was pale. His appearance easily attracted everyone’s attention.

“It’s Advisor Ji!” Duan Wen shouted, “Only Cap Song is left.”

In addition to Duan Wen, Tang Qi, Tang Le and Zhou Mingxuan were all there. There were also more than a dozen unfamiliar traversers.

They were all people who had completed the joining.

Ji Yushi walked over. There was still some doubt in his expression.

He already knew that as the rooms moved, there would be people dying due to a calculation error in the time difference between the rooms and that some traversers would cooperate and form a team to complete the mission. The chances of all six timelines being completed by the seventh squad was very small. With so many people here, he didn’t understand how Tianqiong

would calculate the completion of this so-called Super S-level multiplayer mission.

Groups of people whispered to each other in twos or threes.

Every time a traverser entered the centre block, their expression would change.

Everyone stood together and waited for a while before Song Qinglan finally emerged from the darkness — He had successfully joined the very last colour.

“Congratulations, you have completed the new Super S-level mission, 【Rubik’s Cube】 .”

Unpretentiously, Tianqiong’s gentle female voice sounded. When it reached their ears, it automatically switched to their language.

All the traversers stopped talking.

“Guardians from Star Era 1456, congratulations on completing the multiplayer mission together with traversers from other times and spaces. You have completed the Rubik’s Cube mission outstandingly and are the winners of this mission.”

At this very moment, everyone felt emotional.

It turns out that the squad who joined the most room wins. Only they will be given the credit.

Those unfamiliar traversers around them disappeared one after another. They were sent back to their original time and space by Tianqiong.

The seventh squad was extremely envious of this.

What they wanted wasn’t the reward, but to return to their own time and space, just like those innocent traversers who had been unfortunately implicated.

But Tianqiong's words following this left everyone in disbelief.

“You have completed all the missions that I have prepared for you.”

“You have the right to save your reward and continue to the next mission or return to your time and space and use your reward immediately.”

Everyone in the seventh squad was stunned.

They can.....go home?

\*

The silence lasted for several minutes.

Fantasy, lies, reality, no one was able to truly believe in those words.

But, going home. It was like hanging a plump pancake in front of a starving man. It was something they truly desired.

Would it be true this time?

Would they finally be free?

As if it knew what they were thinking, Tianqiong said, “This time you will truly return.”

After the emphasis, everyone couldn't help but believe.

Could they finally return back to the third second after setting off, back to their original era?

Tianqiong continued to clear up their confusions, “Unfortunately, because a time anchor could not be set for the ‘Rubik's Cube’ mission and in order to ensure the integrity of time and space, the return time will be adjusted to 17 March, 1456. Furthermore, because a teammate of yours failed to complete this mission, you will not be able to return to your original transition time together as a group. You will have to return separately.”

Someone failed to complete the mission?

Duan Wen's expression changed, "Li Chun?!"

Tianqiong: "Yes, but don't worry, he just needs to complete a simple B-level mission to make up for it and then he can go back home."

"Dammit!! What kind of rule is that?"

"Do you think you're the teacher who wrote the test and can change it just because you want to change it?! You're just a damned system!"

"Can I swap my reward in exchange for Li Chun's return?"

Tianqiong, "Sorry, I cannot do that exchange. The mission is not dangerous, please rest assured."

Everyone cursed.

What missions could Li Chun complete alone?

Sure enough, Tianqiong continued, "In order to ensure that the new mission is successfully completed as soon as possible, you can choose to leave a team member behind to assist him in completing the mission."

Everyone, "....."

What a damned scammer!

How shameless could this broken system get?!

"At most we can just all stay behind." Tang Qi said, "It's just one more mission."

"I will definitely beat him to death this time."

As the rest of the squad chattered, Ji Yushi didn't speak.

“Alright.” Song Qinglan interrupted them. His eyes swept across them, “You can all go back. I’ll stay behind.”

“If we’re staying behind then we will all stay behind.”

“The sooner it’s done, the sooner we can go home!”

“No, if you’re staying, we’re staying too!”

Song Qinglan raised his eyes and once again looked at Ji Yushi, “It’s just a B-level mission, me alone will be enough. You all have things you want to do. The sooner you return, the sooner you will finish the report and psychological assessment.”

Song Qinglan said, “Or are you saying that I can’t even complete a normal mission myself? I’m not reliable?”

Everyone was silent.

Zhou Mingxuan immediately said, “Then, since I have nothing much for me when I go back anyway, I’ll go with you.”

Song Qinglan hooked up his lips, “Okay, Old Zhou can stay. The rest are not needed.”

Tianqiong spoke in due course, “Song Qinglan, Zhou Mingxuan, you are welcome to stay and complete the B-level mission. Your rewards will be saved.”

Very clearly, this was what Tianqiong wanted. Everyone began to curse.

The group surrounded Song Qinglan and Zhou Mingxuan.

With the two of them together, they should be able to somehow complete the B-level mission with Li Chun.

From the beginning until now, 【Ouroboros】 , 【Chaos】 , 【Who am I】 and 【Rubik’s Cube】 , everyone went through these difficult missions as a united team.

Every one of them had a strong desire to return home. Tang Le had an urge to cry and was comforted by Tang Qi who embraced his head.

Even Duan Wen's eyes had reddened.

“Control your tears. Maybe we'll be back just a few seconds after you return.”

Song Qinglan threw this out casually. His ruthless words successfully contained the emotional scene.

And then, in front of everyone, Song Qinglan turned to Ji Yushi and said, “Advisor Ji.”

For Ji Yushi, more than ten hours had passed since he and Song Qinglan separated.

Song Qinglan's words made his heart skip a beat. He looked up and was met with the other party's eyes which held some difficult to describe emotions. He seemed to be angry, or even frustrated, but in any case, that look of his made Ji Yushi feel that something about Song Qinglan had changed during those few hours.

“After I return, I have something to say to you.” Song Qinglan spoke a little fiercely but his words didn't contain the commanding tone that belonged to a captain, “There is something I hope you can consider very seriously.”

Everyone was confused.

Cap Song didn't sound like he wanted to ask Advisor Ji again to stay in their squad.

On the contrary, there was a sense of burning all his bridges as well as resoluteness after having made up his mind. The teammates couldn't help but exchange looks with each other.

Ji Yushi: “.....I don't know where I will be then.”

Song Qinglan almost immediately understood what he meant by that.

Ten years ago.....that incident.

Song Qinglan said bluntly, “Don’t go back yet.”

The bright lights forming the timelines made Ji Yushi’s pale complexion appear very cold, just like how it was when they first met.

He didn’t directly answer and just said, “I miss my cat(s).”

There were four capsules not far away faintly emitting a glow.

Ji Yushi wasn’t able to take more than a few steps before Song Qinglan grabbed his shoulder.

The handsome young man’s face was covered in stubble, giving off a ruffian-like air. That oppressiveness made it difficult for others to look at him in the eyes for more than a few seconds.

Ji Yushi wanted to avert his , but he heard him say, “Wait for me. I will go with you.”

Ji Yushi’s heart pounded very rapidly.

He knew that his teammates were watching them, but Song Qinglan didn’t seem to care.

He didn’t know what this situation looked like to them. Before he could speak, Song Qinglan forced through gritted teeth, “Ji Yushi, do you hear me? That year, I will go with you.”

Ji Yushi didn’t answer.

Those few seconds of silence seemed like it lasted for several years. It was so long that Song Qinglan thought that Ji Yushi would refuse, so long that Song Qinglan almost wanted to harden his heart and make Ji Yushi replace Zhou Mingxuan to accompany him through the next unknown mission instead.

But Song Qinglan couldn’t do it.

It was too cruel for Ji Yushi.

At this moment, Ji Yushi raised his beautiful eyes and said something:  
“Hasolamu.”

The strange pronunciation surprised Song Qinglan, “What does it mean?”

He very quickly realised that this was Big Beard’s language.

Ji Yushi blinked a few times and said, “I hope everything goes well for you in the B-level mission.”



# Chapter 74: Chapter 74

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 74

The parting was a lot more hurried than expected.

No one expected that this case of time and space hijacking would end like this.

As the returning teammates sat in their capsules, every one of them felt strong unease inside —This was something they had earned through hard work but for some reason they felt that it came too easily.

Every time they thought they could return home, they had found themselves sent to an even more difficult situation.

Especially the bubble world which made it difficult for one to distinguish between reality and fantasy....Was this so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ really going to give them what they want so easily?

The seventh squad shouldn’t be separated like this.

What they wanted wasn’t to return like this but to return as a group with all seven of them.

However, Song Qinglan was right.

He was the captain. He had the ability and the power to order everyone.

Everyone had things they wanted to do. If they got back and finished their reports earlier, they could reunite with their family and loved ones earlier

and realise their wishes earlier.

Ji Yushi had already fastened the safety belt. His hand however stayed on the buckle as if the next moment he would unbuckle it again.

He was the only one there so there was no need for him to conceal his emotions. Confusion and hesitation were written all over his face.

If he hadn't ran into that person just now, he would've definitely chosen to stay. His current condition however was no longer suitable to stay and continue with the mission. He moved his hand away and his calves and the rest of his body was strapped in.

The communicator on his wrist glowed green. It showed the positions and physical states of the teammates in the three capsules nearby.

It was a sign that the equipment was working normally again.

When he entered the capsule last time, he had heard Song Qinglan's voice for the first time through the subcutaneous communicator.

““Everyone get ready. Tianqiong's seventh squad, the thirteenth A-level mission, let's go!”

This time, his mind was completely silent.

Tianqiong's voice sounded, “Ji Yushi, before returning to your era, you have a reward that can be redeemed. Would you like to redeem it now?”

Ji Yushi closed his eyes.

Unsurprisingly, all the thoughts in his mind had been read by Tianqiong through the subcutaneous communicator.

Tianqiong's female voice asked, “Would you like to be sent back to April 6, 1439, 7 o'clock in the morning?”

Ji Yushi opened his eyes. His eyes were dark.

Tianqiong's female voice continued, "It has been detected that you have already accumulated enough points in your time and space to redeem this wish, so using the reward to redeem it now is not recommended. If you insist on it, you need to agree to these conditions: You can only return to that time as a bystander and cannot directly intervene——"

"Redeem."

Ji Yushi cut off Tianqiong's words.

His tone could be regarded as calm and his eyes had gradually regained clarity.

For some reason, as soon as he said those words, Ji Yushi's originally silent heart began to beat harder and harder.

Tianqiong: "Please confirm again."

Ji Yushi said: "I choose to redeem the reward immediately."

His heart pounded even more quickly.

The expectations he originally had gradually faded away, along with the illusion of a new start to his life.

He didn't lie to a certain someone. After all, he hadn't promised.

Ji Yushi's heart raced faster and faster. It was almost throbbing with pain now.

It was his strong desire for liberation.

"Understood. Your reward will be redeemed immediately."

"You will be separated from your teammates and will return to your time and space after completing the reward. Now setting the new time and space coordinate for you."

"Please wait."

“Connection successful.”

The lights in the capsule gradually went out.

A second later, a familiar dizzy sensation started.

A strong sense of weightlessness surged. Ji Yushi held tightly onto his seat as the capsule shook violently before falling into darkness.

\*

[1439.04.06 06:00:21]

The transparent panel lit up.

Immediately following that, all the lights in the capsule turned on.

Under the slightly dazzling light, Ji Yushi saw the robotic arm hand over a bag of nutrient solution. He received it and took a few sips and was able to barely suppress the nausea incurred from the transition.

Six o'clock.

Tianqiong had given him an hour of preparation time.

The capsule had landed in an unmanned warehouse nearby.

Ji Yushi got out of the capsule. Using the communicator on his wrist, he made the capsule turn invisible.

Rain was pattering down from the sky.

Ji Yushi turned around a street corner and saw that the old cake shop in his memory had already opened.

The early spring morning was very cold, and the light rain had dampened Ji Yushi's hair and clothes.

“Would you like to buy a cake?”

A plump female owner walked out of the shop and asked with a smile.

She was just like how he had remembered; wearing the flower apron she most often wore along with the sweet aroma of cake lingering around her.

Ji Yushi said, "I don't have money."

The boss from more than ten years ago continued to smile, "It's okay. Seeing how friendly you look, I'll treat you."

Caught unprepared, the enthusiastic boss had stuffed a piece of hot honey cake into Ji Yushi's hands. The boss said, "Hurry and eat. It just came out from the oven so it's still hot! Eat something to warm your stomach in the morning. If you like it, you can come and buy it next time!"

Ji Yushi gave his thanks.

Step by step, he walked to a residential building not far away.

Rain continued to fall.

At this moment, the early risers in the residential building had turned on their lights inside. Those lights looked foggy in the rain.

Every house seemed to contain life.

Ji Yushi didn't waste too much time. He stood outside the community and slowly came to a step. He found a street bench nearby and sat down. Lowering his eyes, he looked down at the small cake in his hands.

One hour later, the number of people hurrying to work will increase.

One hour later, a child will pass by wearing a yellow raincoat.

One hour later, someone would die.

Ji Yushi took out the black and white game consol from his pocket.

Something fell to the ground as he did that.

It was a piece of golden foil.

“Picked it up just now. Only have one. It’s very clean.” A voice said to him,  
“Now you can think without a problem.”

The memory allowed him to recall the taste.

The taste of the bitter chocolate seemed to still linger at the tip of his tongue.

Ji Yushi picked up the golden foil. Twisting it lightly with his fingers, one could faintly smell chocolate coming from the wrapper.

# Chapter 75: Chapter 75

## Our Reality

### Chapter 75

[1456.06.17 03:30:21]

Three white capsules suddenly appeared on the transmission platform.

The hatches opened. Three figures in black combat uniforms with the number '7' written on their chests exited from the capsules.

In the quiet but busy third command centre, someone let out a scream high enough to shatter glass.

Immediately afterwards, all the people working there swarmed over and exclaimed happily.

“It’s the seventh squad!”

“The seventh squad is back!!!”

“Ahhhh!!!! The seventh squad is back!!”

“Why are there only three?”

“Hurry and notify the commander-in-chief and Chief Wang!”

Two minutes later, amidst the fuss, three more capsules quietly appeared on the transmission platform.

Inside the capsule, the transparent panels lit up.

In this slightly dazzling light, Song Qinglan saw the robotic arm pass over a bag of nutrient solution. He received it and took a few sips. Before the nausea could fade, a notice appeared on the panel.

[Welcome, Song Qinglan. Welcome back to Tianqiong.]

[Congratulations, you have completed 13 A-level missions, 21 B-level missions, 2 Super S-level mission and one S-level mission. Current rating: \*\*\*.]

The rating was displayed as garbled characters. The system seemed to be having difficulty calculating it. The screen then changed: [Current rating: To be determined.]

After looking at those numbers, Song Qinglan allowed the robotic arm to take the nutrient solution away and then proceeded to remove the safety belts and open the capsule hatch.

“Cap Song!”

“Cap Song!!”

Teammates and staff hurried over one after another.

Li Chun and Zhou Mingxuan who had arrived together with Song Qinglan also came out from their capsules.

Everyone’s excitement was rather overwhelming. The staff quickly arrived at the scene and began to do preliminary physical checks on them one by one.

Wearing a tank top, Song Qinglan lowered himself slightly for them to measure his blood pressure and pulse and swept his eyes across the crowd. He saw Li Chun and Zhou Mingxuan who came back with him as well as Tang Qi, Tang Le and Duan Wen who came back earlier than them. All that was missing was a certain tall and slender figure.

His heart sank. Song Qinglan checked the room again and then looked back at the transmission platform.



Six capsules sat quietly on the platform.

Zhou Mingxuan also noticed this, “Where’s Advisor Ji?”

Duan Wen: “Advisor Ji?!”

Tang Le said, “Fuck, didn’t we come back together? Where did Advisor Ji go?”

“Hurry and check! Is he still on his way here?”

“Reporting! It is found that the seventh squad is still missing a member!”

“Entering search mode. Time coordinates of the last transition is required!”

“.....”

Ji Yushi however did not return.

\*

The seventh squad which had disappeared for an entire month had returned. It caused a great ruckus throughout Tianqiong.

This was especially the case after the news that only six of the seven teammates returned spread like wildfire. It resulted in an unprecedented amount of discussion.

Where the seventh squad went, why only six returned, and what happened to Ji Yushi who was recruited from Ning City....These topics were all being discussed amongst the people in Tianqiong.

Unlike last time when they were intercepted and returned to the bubble world, this time they were sent back by Tianqiong so the physical conditions of the members of the seventh squad were still good. After they completed their preliminary checks, they were asked to return to their respective rooms to rest.

Everyone understood that this process was just like how it was in the bubble world. This arrangement also had another meaning: They had the right to go home only after they cooperate and explained everything they had experienced, and also complete a psychological assessment.

As the leader, Song Qinglan wasn't allowed to rest. As soon as he returned to Tianqiong, he was forced to have a three-hour conversation with the Inspectors.

In the Inspector's office.

After Song Qinglan finished his fourth glass of water, the sky outside was already completely bright.

The blinds were opened by an assistant, sending blinding rays into Song Qinglan's eyes.

It had been a long time since he saw the sunlight in the real world. It was dazzling but he didn't make any attempt to block it.

The Inspector had rushed over early in the morning. He clearly hadn't had enough sleep but because the seventh squad's return had helped set down a stone that had been weighing on their minds, his attitude was a lot more amiable than usual. He even wanted to let Song Qinglan return to rest as soon as possible.

Just before the conversation was over, he asked Song Qinglan, "Do you know why we discovered your disappearance so quickly?"

Generally speaking, Inspectors would only intervene with the investigation when Guardians lose contact more than twenty-four hours since the anticipated mission completion time. Song Qinglan however knew that their disappearance was discovered on the day of their departure on May 17<sup>th</sup> and the third command centre had since been working hard trying to locate them.

But perhaps it was because they were successfully intercepted once by the bubble world, the so-called 'Tianqiong of all eras' had changed a few things

up and concealed their coordinates, making it difficult for the Inspectors to find anything.

The room was well air-conditioned. Song Qinglan wore a dress shirt given by the Inspector.

He hadn't had the time to shave, and this kind of top didn't help soften the sharp and unruly air he gave off.

Hearing this question, Song Qinglan narrowed his eyes in the dazzling sunlight. His expression showed no signs of fatigue.

One would even believe that he would be able to win easily if he went straight to the combat arena after completing all those missions.

"Relax." The Inspector laughed. He then gave him the answer, "We discovered your disappearances so quickly because of your phone call."

Song Qinglan remembered.

"No more than a few seconds after you set off, Chief Wang who was still in the command centre received a call." The chief Inspector said, "The caller was you."

In the bubble world, at the very final moment before they were able to escape....

Ji Yushi had dialled Chief Wang's number.

The Inspector said, "We searched your locker but found that your phone was still turned off. How could someone in the midst of traversing make a phone call? Fortunately, this was nothing compared to all the other strange things that have happened since the establishment of Tianqiong."

Time and space.

The era where Tianqiong was brought to the world and the era where humanity mastered the art of traversing through time and space. It was also the time where people like them who work for Tianqiong started to appear.

“So we firmly believed that we will be able to find you sooner or later.” The Inspector asked his final question, “Cap Song, where do you think Ji Yushi went?”

Song Qinglan crossed his arms and answered calmly, “I don’t know.”

The Inspector said, “Then let me tell you this. Ji Yushi joining Tianqiong was something he had aimed for since a long time ago. He came here with a purpose but unfortunately, he didn’t have enough points and also didn’t pass the psychological evaluation. Of course, his performance had always been very good, but it doesn’t rule out the possibility of him forcibly staying in another time and space. If you know what is going on, we hope that you can cooperate so that we can get him to return as soon as possible.”

This was an indirect warning.

No matter how Song Qinglan answered, Tianqiong would still send out Inspectors to that year to track Ji Yushi down.

If Song Qinglan could tell them earlier, they would be able to stop Ji Yushi before anything happened.

“You should have already seen the mission rating notice? After completing the missions, each of us receive a reward. The reward is to go to any time and space with the condition that the timeline is not affected.” Song Qinglan said, “That is a reward given to us by a Tianqiong with a higher authority.....Perhaps the people above should spend some time understanding its authority and not let it continue hijacking people since we don’t need such rewards.”

To the people here, they had only disappeared for a month.

But for the seventh squad, their real time experience far exceeded that.

Song Qinglan spoke politely but also not very courteously, “But don’t worry. I believe Advisor Ji will not do anything that will disturb the timeline.”

\*

Leaving the Inspector's office, Song Qinglan's expression was dark.

He passed by the brightly lit Tianqiong base, passed by the transmission cabin and passed by many offices.

With his long legs and tall height, he walked at a quick pace. Along the way, he ran into many colleagues.

Those who liked to gossip quickly retreated when they saw his unpleasant expression. Knowing that the seventh squad had returned with one member missing, they only dared to briefly give him a greeting.

Chief Wang stood at the end of the corridor. Wearing a pearl-white coloured suit and a pair of heels, she clearly had been waiting for a while.

“Xiao Song!”

Seeing him come, Chief Wang stretched out both arms.

Song Qinglan leaned down and hugged her, “Chief Wang.”

Not Professor Wang in the bubble world, but the real Chief Wang.

For a moment, Song Qinglan felt like a lifetime had passed.

Chief Wang comfortingly patted his back. When they separated, her eyes were already red. It was unknown if she was comforting Song Qinglan or comforting herself.

The sentimentality of this middle-aged female leader made Song Qinglan's heart feel warm. His tense expression relaxed considerably.

“Thanks for your hard work. After hearing the news of your return, I rushed to Tianqiong to see you.” Chief Wang said, “This is the first time you needed to deal with the Inspectors after all this time. They are all like this. Regardless of whether or not you need to rest, they will insist on following the set protocols before letting you go.”

Song Qinglan nodded, “I understand.”

Chief Wang had watched over Song Qinglan’s growth for many years and knew his temper well. She had rushed over early in the morning because she feared that he wouldn’t cooperate.

But it seemed that so far everything was going well especially since Song Qinglan was let out.

Chief Wang gathered herself up and spoke gently, “The news has already been sent out. Your family will be notified separately. There are however a lot of matters that will need to be dealt with in the coming days. You will be able to go home after everything is done.”

This was the usual procedure.

Song Qinglan also understood this.

But Chief Wang continued, “It’s just that from Xiao Ji’s side....We are unable to explain this matter to his family for the time being. It’s a bit difficult to explain.”

Chief Wang wasn’t Ji Yushi’s direct superior, nor did she manage the Inspectors, so she didn’t know anything about Ji Yushi’s private affairs let alone his wish to return to that year.

For her, she was more worried about something happening to Ji Yushi or him becoming trapped in a time and space somewhere.

Song Qinglan was silent for a while. He then said, “I’m here to contact Chief Lin.”

Chief Wang nodded and said, “When Old Lin heard you returned, he called to check. He had asked about him several times saying that his cat(s) are almost about to develop depression. Xiao Ji’s family are all scholars. His father is a professor at Ning City University and his older brother is a teacher. His major is even somewhat related to ours. It wouldn’t be difficult letting them understand the situation——” (*KKnotes: Again, there is no*

*plural form in Chinese so they could be talking about one or more cats. Chief Wang is technically talking about the three cats but Song Qinglan still thinks that he only has one)*

“Ji Yushi’s cat?”

Song Qinglan remembered that Ji Yushi had mentioned that he missed his cat(s) before he left. It seems that he probably didn’t miss them all that much since he still ended up running off.

“Yeah.” Chief Wang accompanied Song Qinglan to the stairs, “Said he raises three of them but due to some family matters, he couldn’t take care of them and sent one to Chief Lin’s place.”

Ji Yushi’s adoptive father was Chief Lin’s friend. Doing something like this wasn’t surprising.

But Chief Wang’s words made Song Qinglan feel that something didn’t seem right. This feeling however was only very fleeting.

After conversing a few more times, Chief Wang patted him on the back, “Shave your beard and rest up. You can head back.”

Why was everyone paying attention to his beard?

Song Qinglan didn’t have the time to take care of this. He strode straight to the seventh squad’s training ground. The five other teammates were also sitting there. It seemed that none of them were asleep.

“Cap Song.”

“What did the Inspectors call you to talk about?”

“Damn, why haven’t they gone to find Advisor Ji?!”

Everything they had experienced together made it seem like they had known each other for years.

None of the teammates weren't worried about Ji Yushi. This was particularly so for Li Chun who was typically quite heartless. After knowing that it was because of himself that everyone had to return separately, he felt extremely guilty. Even if the difference between the two groups returning was only two minutes, he still felt that he was at fault — It was as if as long as Advisor Ji didn't separate from Cap Song, something like this wouldn't have happened.

Song Qinglan briefly gave everyone an idea of what they talked about and chose to leave out the part about Ji Yushi's choice.

The small eyed Zhou Mingxuan who hadn't spoken a word until now finally asked, "Cap Song, do you know where Advisor Ji may have gone?"

Everyone was surprised. Song Qinglan knew?

Song Qinglan didn't deny it, but he also didn't admit to it.

The others could tell from his expression that they shouldn't continue asking about it but being someone who knew him too well, Zhou Mingxuan wasn't afraid of him.

"When parting in the central block, you asked Advisor Ji to wait for you and said that there was something important you wanted him to consider seriously." Zhou Mingxuan said, "If it weren't for you saying 'That year, I will go with you', I would have thought that there was something going on between the two of you."

"Fuck, the mood at that time did seem pretty gay." Duan Wen commented, "I can't believe I didn't notice it."

"Plus one." Tang Le raised his hand.

"It didn't seem like talking about business matters and instead more like pursuing someone." Even Tang Qi thought so, "I've seen Li Chun flirt with chicks. It was similar to that."

Song Qinglan: "....."



The corners of Zhou Mingxuan's lips twitched and he let out a laugh. He asked, "So did Advisor Ji redeem his reward and go to another time and space?"

Everyone quietened down.

Regardless of what choice Advisor Ji made, once the doors are closed, it was a matter that involved the seventh squad.

As long as Song Qinglan wanted to, he could deal with this group of people.

But none of them were idiots and they were also genuinely concerned about Ji Yushi. Song Qinglan could only vaguely let out a grunt.

Tang Qi said, "That can't be. I thought Advisor Ji agreed to wait for Cap Song?"

Having mentioned this, everyone present recalled the moment before the parted.

Tang Le shook his head, "He didn't agree at first, but it seemed like he later agreed."

Duan Wen, "Said something like, hasolamu?"

Tang Le, "Yeah, that's the one. Didn't it mean something like hope everything goes well?!"

As everyone discussed noisily, Song Qinglan's temples throbbed.

"You guys must have heard wrong." At this moment, Li Chun who was squatting on the ground weakly raised his hand, "It's just that.....Hasolamu, it means I like you."

Everyone, "!!!"

In an instant, the training ground became so quiet, the sound of a pin falling to the ground could be heard.

Song Qinglan lowered the hand massaging his temples and stiffly turned his head, “What did you say?”

Li Chun looked at Song Qinglan and, recalling his captain’s PTSD, he said with a guilty conscience, “I was bored as hell back in the space capsule and I couldn’t spend the entire time partying, so I learnt a few words from Big Beard to use to flirt with chicks when I return.”

He then quickly added, “But how could Advisor Ji say that! I wasn’t there and I’m also a study slag....Your pronunciation isn’t accurate either so I’m sure I made a mistake!!”

**KK has something to say:**

!!!

# Chapter 76: Chapter 76

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 76

“Haa, then you’re definitely mistaken.” Tang Le was very confident with his understanding of the situation. He continued, “Advisor Ji has a boyfriend and it was even love at first sight. How could he casually say something like that?”

In the transfer station, in Song Qinglan’s illusory realm, he had personally talked to Ji Yushi about this matter.

In addition to Tang Le, Tang Qi and Song Qinglan were also present.

Duan Wen was someone who wasn’t there. He was a little surprised, “Advisor Ji has a boyfriend?”

Tang Qi testified, “Yes. I also heard him talk about it.”

Li Chun was even more embarrassed when he heard this. He wished that he could take back what he said just now, “Ah, then I definitely made a mistake! Please don’t let Advisor Ji find out about this or he will definitely hold a grudge against me!”

Tang Le: “And you wanted to use this to flirt with chicks?”

Everyone ridiculed Li Chun, making Li Chun put on a bitter expression. He however had no way of clearing his name.

This study slag had no confidence in his learning abilities and after all that questioning and doubt, he became even more certain that he was the one

who had made a mistake.

Probably because Ji Yushi was the only person in the squad with a different sexual orientation, the conversation changed into a discussion about whether or not he had a boyfriend.

Who said straight men didn't gossip? The straight old man Duan Wen commented, "How strange. I've always thought that Advisor Ji was single. When we were in Chaos, I even asked him what type he likes."

"I also thought Advisor Ji was single. If I knew, I wouldn't have joked with him so casually." Zhou Mingxuan had a look of amusement in his eyes, "Back at the transfer station, Advisor Ji even taught me a few things."

At that time, while Li Chun was busy preparing an outdoor party, Zhou Mingxuan and Ji Yushi had indeed disappeared for a while. Song Qinglan later found out that they had gone for a walk along the beach but no one knew what they had talked about.

Zhou Mingxuan continued, "After Advisor Ji convinced me to leave the bubble world, we had a chat. I asked him if there were any changes around him and he said that except for his three cats changing into one, everything was the same with his family and he still didn't have close friends. It seemed like there was nothing to feel an attachment to. He didn't seem like someone with a partner at all."

Song Qinglan's expression sank. His hand which was clenched into a fist knocked onto the table next to him.

The training ground quietened down considerably because of this action of his. Song Qinglan proceeded to turn around and leave.

The teammates were surprised, "Cap Song, where are you going?"

"Finding someone."

Song Qinglan's tone was very cold. He walked out the training ground without looking back.

Song Qinglan walked very quickly. It was even several times faster than when he came to the training ground.

He had withheld information from the higher ups because he trusted in Ji Yushi's ability to hold himself back and wanted to give Ji Yushi some time. Ji Yushi had already completed 89 B-level missions and that time in the bubble world where he lost control was because he was too impatient so even if Ji Yushi didn't listen to him and didn't wait for him to return to that day together, he felt that Ji Yushi needed some time alone. Thinking this, he had pushed back the negative feeling of being left behind. In any case, he was in no position to demand that from him.

But right now, Song Qinglan's heart was filled with rage.

What time alone? This was basically Ji Yushi's way of saying goodbye to him.

What "I hope everything goes well for you in the B-level mission"? That was all a lie.

Ji Yushi's expression when lying wasn't something Song Qinglan saw for the first time, but he just happened to have missed it this time. Was it because he had been seen through too many times and even his lying abilities had evolved? With Ji Yushi's learning ability, this was a piece a cake.

Unable to read, unable to warm up and unable to control.

Ji Yushi may seem harmless outwardly, but he was in fact extremely unpredictable.

He had never truly lowered his guard around anyone or anything, nor had he ever formed a true bond or attachment with anyone or anything. Just as he had told Song Qinglan, he had joined Tianqiong as a Recorder solely because of his desire to return to that fateful day.

He had never promised Song Qinglan that he would wait for him.

Because no matter how many B-level tasks he had completed, he had no confidence on whether he could just stand by and watch when he returns to that day.

So he had said, "...I don't know where I will be then."

The more he thought about it, the angrier Song Qinglan became.

This kind of anger made his brain swell up but for some reason, he felt a coldness on his back and his chest felt like a part of it was dug out. It hurt so much, it was hard to breathe.

He strode into the chief's office and pushed the door open with a loud 'bang'.

Chief Wang who was still on the phone was taken aback by this loud noise. She looked up and asked, "Why did you suddenly burst in?"

It was unknown how many times he had heard this accusatory and helpless tone. Song Qinglan didn't even bother apologising.

"Chief Wang." Song Qinglan placed both hands on the desk, "I would like to apply for time and space traversing!"

Chief Wang said to the party on the other side of the phone, "Wait a second."

She then pressed mute and asked, "You only just returned. What are you on about?"

Song Qinglan clearly didn't look like he came to put in an application and instead looked like he was here to wreck the place up. It was as if as long as Chief Wang refused, he would resort to force.

The last time Chief Wang saw Song Qinglan like this was when he first left the special forces. At that time, he was still stubborn as a bull and his entire being gave off the air of a thug, making it easy for one to forget about his handsome appearance.

“The time coordinate is April 6, 1439.” Song Qinglan said, “I would like to redeem my reward for this or you can even use my points. If I don’t go now, I’m afraid that Ji Yushi would do something wrong. You should know, he \_\_\_\_\_”

Chief Wang interrupted, “I was just about to tell you this. Xiao Ji is back!”

Song Qinglan was shocked. He thought he had heard wrong.

“I told you not to be so prejudiced against others. Why can’t you change that part of you?!” As Chief Wang muttered this complaint, she turned around and turned on the holographic projection, “See? He just returned. He’s currently getting examined.”

The projection was of the third command centre.

A single capsule sat quietly on the transmission platform.

There was a man standing in front of the platform wearing a familiar looking black combat uniform.

The figure was tall and slender, and his pale face carried a hint of coldness. He was surrounded by five or six staff and he had cooperatively stretched his arms out for them to better examine his physical condition.

\*

Ji Yushi returned about four or five hours after the other six members of the seventh squad.

The system detected that his capsule had traversed to another time and space, so he wasn’t sent back to the training ground like the others after completing the necessary procedures and was instead sent to the Inspectors like his captain Song Qinglan.

The Time Management Alliance had always been very strict about these matters. Even the slightest change could result in time and space becoming chaotic.

An Inspector had a chat with Ji Yushi for about an hour. No one knew what they talked about.

When Ji Yushi left the office, he was given permission to return to the seventh squad's training ground and wait together with the others for their psychological assessment.

After being escorted back, as soon as he opened the door to the training ground, he was surrounded by his excited teammates.

“Advisor Ji!”

“Advisor Ji, you scared me to death!”

“Where did you go?”

“You’re finally back!!”

Hearing those words which carried some blame but mostly concern, Ji Yushi's ears couldn't help but turn hot.

He knew that his wilfulness would make his teammates worried and he also had never been very good at dealing with situations like this, but his teammates concern warmed his heart greatly. This feeling of being cared for and valued was more precious to him than he had ever imagined.

“Damn!” Tang Le cursed, “We all agreed to return but you suddenly went and disappeared!!”

Duan Wen cursed at Tianqiong, “Is it that damned Tianqiong? Did it made you do another mission?”

Tang Qi and Zhou Mingxuan who stood a little further away also said, “Alright, alright. With Advisor Ji back, our squad is complete now.”

“It feels like it has been forever since I last saw you!” Li Chun cried, “Advisor Ji, I haven't seen you for so many days and when I got back, they said something about the possibility of you not returning. Where on earth did you go?”



Ji Yushi who was surrounded by the others spoke in his usual tone, “You didn’t redeem your reward?”

Everyone: “.....”

“Fuck! How could we have known that we could redeem it on the spot?!”

“I never took it seriously. I thought we had to come back and get everything settled before we could think about it!”

“Fuck that Tianqiong. It never told us anything!”

Amidst the commotion, someone pushed open the door.

Ji Yushi stood there without moving. His heart trembled slightly, but he didn’t look back.

“Everyone go back to your room and rest. Take a shower and clean yourself up. After all these days, you aren’t tired?” Song Qinglan’s voice sounded from behind, “Since we’re all back, we will write our reports and complete the assessments tomorrow. Once that’s all done, you can go home.”

Everyone had already gone through this process once in the bubble world. Just the thought of them needing to do it again made their heads hurt.

As they complained, Song Qinglan continued, “Advisor Ji, come with me.”

Song Qinglan’s expression probably wasn’t very good. Ji Yushi noticed that everyone had suddenly quietened down.

He answered, “Okay.”

Song Qinglan left first. His tall back figure passed by Ji Yushi and entered his private training room.

Li Chun shrank back, “I have a bad feeling.”

Tang Le: “Advisor Ji, good luck.”

Everyone watched Ji Yushi follow after Song Qinglan. Recalling their terrible experiences being reprimanded by their captain in his private training room after they made a mistake, they all lit a candle in their hearts for Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi entered Song Qinglan's private training room.

The door closed automatically behind him.

Despite not seeing him for a few hours, Song Qinglan looked no different from when they separated in the centre block.

But Ji Yushi knew that Song Qinglan had completed a B-level mission together with Zhou Mingxuan and Li Chun. Just as he had said before, he returned soon after the other teammates returned.

In a space that wasn't too cramped, Song Qinglan's presence was very strong.

His handsome eyes were very attractive, but it was obvious that he was in a bad mood. He however just asked, "Saw what you wanted to see?"

Ji Yushi said, "I didn't go upstairs."

Like an Inspector, Song Qinglan asked his second question, "You went back to that day but didn't go upstairs. So what did you do during those few hours?"

Ji Yushi's mental state seemed to be pretty good.

His thoughts were clear and he also didn't hide anything, "In daze."

Song Qinglan, "In daze?"

Ji Yushi answered calmly, "Yes."

Song Qinglan, "Why?"

Ji Yushi was silent for a long time. When he finally spoke, he said, “I didn’t have confidence in myself.”

Song Qinglan didn’t speak.

Ji Yushi had his head lowered so he couldn’t see his expression. He just continued, “I thought I could do it. In fact, I was prepared to interfere, but in the end I realised....I couldn’t do it. So I didn’t go upstairs.”

“Prepared to interfere.”

His low voice rolled out from the depths of his throat. He approached him step by step and seemed to be holding back anger, “So you didn’t plan on returning?”

Ji Yushi, “Mhn.”

Song Qinglan was right in front of him now. He stared fixatedly at the other person’s cold expression and asked hoarsely, “Then why did you come back?”

Ji Yushi’s eyelashes trembled slightly. His lips moved, “Suddenly didn’t want to go alone.”

He seemed to have some difficulty speaking but he eventually managed to utter his next words, “Wanted to try what it feels like going with someone.”

It was unknown if Song Qinglan understood. He didn’t give any response.

Ji Yushi suspected that this steel straight man before him might not understand what he meant even if he spent his entire lifetime thinking about it. Fortunately, he had never expected a response from him anyway. In the end he added, “The feeling of having a friend accompany me. Didn’t you say that you would go with me?”

Song Qinglan still didn’t speak. Only his chest rose and fell.

With him not speaking, the atmosphere in the training room became somewhat strange.

“Cap Song, are you taking it back now?” Ji Yushi asked. “If this is over, I would like to go and rest.”

He turned and walked towards the door.

A strong force came. He was unceremoniously grabbed by the wrist and his entire person was pulled back a step.

Song Qinglan almost enveloped him. With his expression deep, his deep black eyes seemed like it could drown the other person. Ji Yushi didn’t dare look straight at him.

“Advisor Ji.” Song Qinglan spoke, “Before we returned, I mentioned that there was something important that I would like you to consider seriously.”

Ji Yushi could only look into his eyes, “What is it?”

This kind of proximity between them made his heart race crazily. He just wanted to quickly leave this place.

Song Qinglan’s next words however left Ji Yushi speechless.

He was stunned in place and for the first time in his life, his mind was blank.

“No one can be committed having three relationships at the same time. I originally wanted to ask if you could seriously consider the possibility of leaving such a situation and starting a new, one to one relationship where you only have each other?”

Ji Yushi’s beautiful cat-like eyes widened.

Coupled with his indifferent expression, it made one understand what it meant by contrasting cuteness.

Song Qinglan’s throat bobbed. His cheeks became uncontrollably hot.

He had thought about this for a long time. Morality, bottom line....He had thought about all the reasons why he shouldn’t say something like this, but

all those scruples were cast away as soon as he saw Ji Yushi walk through those coloured rooms again and again.

He even thought that if Ji Yushi was unable to give it up, he would be willing to wait until he could.

What Song Qinglan didn't expect was that those thoughts that had been swirling around inside him all this time would actually be spoken in a situation like this.

He wasn't afraid, and he didn't step back. He just said, "Perhaps you don't need to do this anymore. I only just found out that although your 'three boyfriends' are clingy and would press you down at night making it difficult for you to breathe, they can fortunately change from three to one from time to time. I think it's something you can handle."

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan however wasn't saying this to settle accounts with him, let alone hold a grudge.

"I just wanted to ask....."

Song Qinglan's voice was lowered. The low male voice that resembled the voice that travelled through the public channel for the first time made Ji Yushi's ears itch.

At this moment, the door to the private training room was knocked open with a bang.

The teammates who were listening outside because they were worried about Ji Yushi being reprimanded too harshly but were instead unexpectedly subjected to hearing a conversation that seemed to be sounding more and more gay felt like their worldviews had completely shattered.

Due to too much excitement, someone accidentally slipped.

And they all exposed themselves.

“Please continue!”

“We’ll leave at once!”

“Continue, continue!!”

Facing their captain’s dark expression, the five lightbulbs covered their heads and didn’t dare make a sound.

**KK has something to say:**

Yasss Cap Song! Tell him how you feel!!!

# Chapter 77: Chapter 77

The silence lasted for more than ten seconds.

After interrupting the strange scene, the teammates tried to quietly slip away.

But there would always be someone who couldn't read the mood. The silly and naïve Tang Le at this moment didn't forget to ask Ji Yushi, "Advisor Ji.....You actually have three boyfriends??"

Everyone: "!!!"

How could this be asked so directly?!

Tang Le had already asked the most difficult part so Duan Wen now dared to speak, "And the three boyfriends can change to one?"

Zhou Mingxuan, "Three into one, aren't they Advisor Ji's cats?"

Tang Qi, "No, I remember Advisor Ji saying that his boyfriend is a tabletop cleaning master."

Tang Le, "I remember too. A tabletop cleaning master."

Li Chun, "Damn, it really is a cat! A cat's profession is to clean the tabletop! Whatever it sees, it would push it off!"

Everyone: "....."

Cat?!

Seeing their reaction, Song Qinglan knew that he wasn't the only idiot in the squad.

His temples twitched faintly. This realisation didn't bring Song Qinglan any comfort. In Ji Yushi's eyes, their squad probably looked like it was made up of a bunch of idiots.

Ji Yushi's mysterious relationship status had become the centre of attention.

His expression however was calm and emotionless. He just quietly stood there, as if the current situation didn't make him embarrassed at all.

But everyone could see that his ears had betrayed him.

The earlobes were extremely red and even the skin around his neck was hot. With that calm face, the contrast was very strong.

The calm and self-sufficient Advisor Ji, his heart at this moment was a mess.

Li Chun continued to wonder, "So does Advisor Ji have a boyfriend or not?!"

Please read this from kk translates

"I'm going to rest first."

Ji Yushi didn't answer this question and instead threw out an excuse in attempt to escape the current situation.

"Advisor Ji?!"

"Don't!!"

Ji Yushi didn't even look at Song Qinglan's expression nor did he think about what Song Qinglan was trying to say just now. He immediately raised his leg in attempt to leave the room.



Song Qinglan's expression became more and more unsightly. It was now as dark as the bottom of a pot.

Seeing that Ji Yushi was about to leave, Song Qinglan chased after him and grabbed his shoulder in front of everyone without a second thought, "Wait a minute."

"I haven't finished saying that I wanted to say." Song Qinglan grunted, "With so many people here, you thought I wouldn't dare say it?"

Ji Yushi: "....."

Ji Yushi, "It's probably not appropriate."

Everyone, "It's appropriate! Very appropriate! Say it! Hurry and say it!!"

Song Qinglan had already cursed at this group of idiots a hundred times internally. These words however were something that had to be spoken sooner or later anyway.

"Since everyone is here, it saves me the effort of having to tell you one by one." He changed his tone and it immediately became more serious, "Advisor Ji, the reason why I said all that just now was because I wanted to ask — Can you consider me?"

Those in the training room who still couldn't figure out the situation like Duan Wen and co didn't understand what he meant. Those in the training room who understood like Zhou Mingxuan and co held their breaths and cast their excited eyes at Ji Yushi.

Everyone at this moment held the same thoughts. They were all excitedly watching the show play out before them.

Everyone was thinking inside: It wasn't interrupted!

There was even a follow up!

Ji Yushi froze for a moment. It was unknown if he was asking despite already knowing the answer but he asked very naturally, "Consider

you.....for what?”

Everyone now looked at Song Qinglan with glowing eyes.

Song Qinglan ignored them, “One to one, a relationship where you only have each other, can you consider me?”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth and made it even clearer, “Consider dating me.”

Ji Yushi: “Why? Aren’t you straight?”

“You were right. I’m afraid I was a deeply closeted gay.”

“After meeting you, I can no longer be straight.”

He didn’t care if he was made fun of, and he didn’t care what others said about him. He went straight to the point, “I fucking....I wanted to tell you this in the bubble world. I don’t want to be your friend, let alone your captain. I want to be able to care about you without anything holding me back, tell you not to be too rash, not to carry everything alone. I want to be with you, hold you, have——”

The words were rough and becoming more and more explicit. It made the onlookers have an urge to scream when they heard it.

Ji Yushi’s entire face turned red hearing this.

Realising that the next words were probably not too appropriate, Song Qinglan paused. His originally ruffian-like expression became even more fierce.

He revealed seriously, “Ji Yushi, I like you.”

“Ahhhhhhhh!”

“Cap Song, amazing!!!”

“Ahhhhhhhh!”

The two men stood in the centre of the group of teammates. It looked like a proposal scene.

With his confession being disrupted like this, Song Qinglan’s face was faintly red. He stared fixatedly at the back of Ji Yushi’s neck.

All of them were still wearing their black combat uniforms which they hadn’t had the chance to change out of. This was even more the case for Ji Yushi. Against the dark combat uniform, his pale and slender neck had become visibly red. His entire body was stiff, and his shoulders trembled slightly. These subtle changes were all taken in by Song Qinglan.

His tolerance and calmness prevented him from reacting immediately.

Please read this from kk translates

Hasolamu.

I like you.

Song Qinglan didn’t know if Li Chun had made a mistake.

He just wanted to confirm one thing at this very moment. He asked in a deep voice, “I have been bent into a mosquito coil already. Can I be your boyfriend?”

“Answer him! Answer him!”

“Fuck, fuck, fuck, hurry and answer him!!”

“Hurry and speak Advisor Ji!”

Ji Yushi turned around and spoke, “I’ll think about it.”

Ji Yushi valued his face and also held grudges. Song Qinglan originally held no expectations towards him giving him his answer immediately.

Such a situation was something he had expected but the follow up question still had to be asked. Song Qinglan immediately asked, “How long will you need? I’m still waiting in line right now and there are three ahead of me. You need to give me a chance.”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

“Advisor Ji, no need to think about it!”

“Don’t keep the good parts to yourself! Let’s settle things once and for all today!”

“Cap Song is still a virgin!”

“He’s worth it! You won’t be losing out!”

Song Qinglan’s gaze turned cold, “All of you get out.”

Everyone immediately understood. Saying that he had no experience despite his age, weren’t they just making him lose his face?!

They quickly got ready to scramble out the private training room.

Zhou Mingxuan kicked the asses of these people who were too busy watching the show instead of reading the room, “Go! Give them some space, alright?”

Li Chun complained, “Old Zhou, what are you doing? Did your feet slip just now?”

Zhou Mingxuan’s voice from behind was cold and suppressed, “Less nonsense talk. Go, go, go!!”

With some pushing and shoving, the group left.

Only two people were left in the originally noisy training room.

“Virgin?” Ji Yushi looked up at Song Qinglan. His eyes seemed like there was a clear stream inside it, “A virgin dared to fantasise about others doing

4P? Cap Song's level of acceptance is very high.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

This grudge. It was something that Ji Yushi had probably noted down in his notebook since a long time ago. Why else would he have continued to mislead him and watch him make a fool of himself every time.

But, it could be considered as something he deserved.

Who asked him to be prejudiced against Ji Yushi in the first place?

Song Qinglan got a little closer, “So you deliberately played me.”

It was clearly not their first time being alone together, but the atmosphere right now was more ambiguous than ever.

Under the scorching gaze, the temperature on Ji Yushi's face was unable to cool down. He changed the subject, “About that, I will properly think about it.”

Hearing this, Song Qinglan only raised an eyebrow slightly. He revealed a somewhat stern expression and asked, “I'll give you a day. Will that be enough?”

Being looked at like this, Ji Yushi could only avert his gaze, his long lashes casting a shadow over his eyes.

His heart raced crazily, “Enough.”

# Chapter 78: Chapter 78

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 78

How could one day be enough?

It definitely wasn't enough.

Ji Yushi calmly returned to his private training room and, after closing the door behind him, the robotic arm proceeded to scan his body.

It then glowed red and very soon brought over a bottle of water as well as a towel.

This was because it had detected increased heartrate as well as perspiration on his body and had assumed by default that the human had just trained and undergone strenuous exercise. It would have never guessed that this reaction was because the human had just received a confession.

Ji Yushi received the bottle of water and downed half of it in one go but Song Qinglan's words still lingered in his mind.

He clearly didn't see Song Qinglan's expression earlier when he said those words but at this moment his mind was able to automatically generate the scene and he could vividly imagine the other's appearance.

“I don't want to be your friend, let alone your captain. I want to be able to care about you without anything holding me back, tell you not to be too rash, not to carry everything alone. I want to be with you, hold you, have —”

Have what?

Ji Yushi's grip around the bottle tightened and his face once again became hot.

Even if he had 'bent', those words were just too straight!

Ji Yushi wanted to calm down. He raised his head and emptied the remaining half of the water in one go before allowing the robotic arm to take the bottle away.

Calming down attempt failed.

That straight man was too reckless.

Ji Yushi took off his black combat uniform and entered the shower.

As he showered, water vapour filled the air.

Whilst he was coated by clean and warm water, the scene from when they jumped off the tracks in the bubble world and fell into the water below surfaced to his mind.

The water muffled his hearing and countless bubbles rose through the water before his eyes.

He was turned around by Song Qinglan and then a pair of strong arms wrapped around his waist, and he was held tightly in an embrace. The handcuffs pulled at their hands. Although the metal was cold like the water, his chest was warm.

He had clung tightly onto Song Qinglan and was carried out of the water.

With every step, he could distinctly feel the explosive power in the other person's muscles.

Ji Yushi shook off the water from his hair and pressed both arms up against the wall to support himself. He allowed the water from the shower to run down his forehead, eyelashes and chin.

Even after standing under the water for such a long time, his thoughts were unable to settle down.

He turned off the shower, wrapped himself in a large bath towel and then left the bathroom barefoot.

Another scene appeared.

It was outside the bathroom in the space capsule.

His body still exuding cold air, Song Qinglan leaned lazily against the wall. There was a blade of grass from the rainforest stuck behind his ear and in his hands was a black and white game console. Hearing the sound of him coming out, his pair of deep dark eyes looked over, “The high scores on the leaderboard are all yours?”

As Ji Yushi dried his hair, he returned back to his training room.

It didn’t take long for his hair to dry. He pressed a switch and said, “Resting mode.”

The robotic arm moved aside.

The wall was lit up and a small bed that looked quite comfortable was slowly lowered down.

Ji Yushi climbed onto the bed and laid on his side in a not so relaxed position.

“Zii.”

There was a faint sound.

The air-conditioning in the room was adequate. The robotic arm checked his body temperature and then proceeded to pull over a blanket and gently cover him up.

“It’s me.” That person wrapped him up in a very dirty blanket and held him tightly in his arms. He spoke warmly, “Don’t be afraid.”



Ji Yushi opened his eyes. He gently blinked a few times.

His heart rate was still very disordered and his thoughts were messy. He closed his eyes again.

After going through Rubik's Cube, after returning to that year and after being questioned by the Inspectors, Ji Yushi's body was exhausted. He originally thought that he wouldn't be able to sleep but he had actually managed to fall asleep in a situation where his cerebral cortex worked actively.

He was running in the dream.

There were countless monsters chasing him.

He was stuck inside a crushed car. The scent of blood filled his nose, He saw a large, well-defined hand reach towards him.

They were running together.

Suddenly, the ground below was gone. His entire person seemed to be falling.

Together with the sudden feeling of weightlessness, Ji Yushi woke up with a start. He then found that he was so hungry, his stomach had started to cramp. He felt like his chest was about to stick to his back.

He had slept for almost ten hours.

Ji Yushi sat there for a while, slowly sobering up.

In the overturned train, Song Qinglan had used one hand to grab a shelf in the bathroom and, with his face flushed red from effort, he held firmly onto Ji Yushi with his other hand.

Ji Yushi's fingers slowly sank into his hair.

He let out a sigh.

It wasn't much better after sleeping.

\*

“Advisor Ji, have you thought it through?!”

As soon as he left his private training room, Zhou Mingxuan squinted his small eyes and asked with a grin.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

“Don't think about it for too long. Our Cap Song is very popular!” Zhou Mingxuan said this and then took off his wristband and said, “Come, let's go eat.”

Ji Yushi looked around. His expression was the same as usual, “And the others?”

Zhou Mingxuan explained, “Everyone already went. Thinking that it was about time for you to get up, I stayed behind to wait for you.”

The Tianqiong Jiang City branch could be regarded as the country's Guardian headquarters. In addition to more than 100 official guardians, there were also hundreds of staffs and hundreds of trainees and students so there would be more than a thousand people in total. To operate such a large system, not only was the command centre split into multiple ones, but there were also even four dining areas.

Guardians would typically dine in the dining area specifically for Guardians but when Ji Yushi first came to Jiang City to study and when he was first transferred here, he had gone to dine at another place with the trainees and students, so he hadn't been to this one before.

As the two left the training ground, Ji Yushi noticed that there were many people looking at him.

“We had an A-level mission but came back after a whole month, so we have become a little famous.” Zhou Mingxuan explained, “You were also the last to return, so they are even more curious about you.”

Don't look at how high tech this Tianqiong research institute may be. Even if this place didn't excel at anything, it excelled in its ability to generate gossip. Why else would gossip about Ji Yushi be able to travel from Ning City to Jiang City? Everyone probably still thought that he and Song Qinglan got along like fire and water.

Ji Yushi's late return this time had resulted in many guesses and speculations and, in turn, he received a lot of attention.

As they made their way over, they passed several Tianqiong departments.

Zhou Mingxuan introduced them to him along the way, "When you came here before, this should've already been done but.....haa, it was all a misunderstanding!"

Ji Yushi, "I also didn't want to get close with you guys at the time."

Zhou Mingxuan rubbed the back of his head, "Haa, thinking back now, we were really silly back then!"

Ji Yushi didn't give him any face and even nodded to express his agreement, "Yeah."

"Fuck!" Zhou Mingxuan laughed and proceeded to push open the door, "This way!"

Only at this moment did Ji Yushi truly feel like he had returned to his original time and space.

The huge dining area was surrounded by glass walls, resembling a neatly cut diamond.

In the evening when the sky was burned red, a magnificent orange-red glow would be able to be seen close at hand through this dome. From the glass walls, one could also see the tall buildings in the city as well as the traffic shuttling through the city main roads.

In an instant, the scene changed. The tall buildings were gone and replacing them were numerous low-rise buildings, wide roads and a clear blue sky —

This was Jiang City from about a hundred years ago.

The so-called glass wall was nothing but a holographic projection that simulated the backwards flow of time.

Unlike all the Guardians who turned a blind eye to this, Ji Yushi stared at it in daze for several seconds. He was somewhat surprised by the difference in treatment between Guardians and Recorders. The two were on completely different levels. He didn't know if this was also the case in other countries.

Dining hours had already passed so there were very few people here.

The seventh squad had selected a large table that extended about three metres and they each occupied one side. They were all tall with big builds and they sat there leisurely chatting with each other like they were on vacation.

“Advisor Ji!” Noticing them first, Li Chun immediately shot up and used his hand to clean the chair, “Sit, sit, sit!”

Zhou Mingxuan pushed Li Chun's head aside, “Suck-up!”

Li Chun glared back, “What do you know!”

“Advisor Ji!” Duan Wen who sat on the other side tossed something over, “Catch!”

Ji Yushi easily caught it. When he looked down, he saw that it was a bottle of sweet and sour nutrient solution.

They needed to replenish themselves with these kinds of things for a few days after traversing.

Duan Wen said, “Pad your stomach with that first!”

Ji Yushi accepted it, “Thank you.”

There were only five people present. Song Qinglan wasn't around. After Ji Yushi sat down, he heard Tang Le asked, “Advisor Ji, have you thought

about it?”

The table became silent in an instant.

Everyone was looking at Ji Yushi.

“It should be about time!”

“Hahahaha!! I knew it!”

“This isn’t something we should ask about. We should wait for Cap Song to ask this!”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Maybe he shouldn’t have gone out to eat today.

Tang Le didn’t seem to care much about the answer to his question. He just giggled and continued talking about other nonsense with the others.

This was the case for the others too.

Despite their captain becoming gay and passionately confessing in public, none of these teammates showed any difficulty accepting the possibility of a couple forming in their squad. Apart from a few joking words, these people were just like adolescent high school students.

After finishing the nutrient solution and curbing his hunger, Ji Yushi felt a lot better.

Everyone was already about to be done with their meals. Just as he considered getting up to get something to eat, his eyes met with Song Qinglan’s who had just sat down.

He had shaved and cut his hair.

Song Qinglan’s clean and handsome face was revealed again. Despite his fierce and overbearing temperament, his tone was lazy, “Take a look. Don’t need to eat anything you don’t like.”

“Hey! How could there be anything he wouldn’t like?!”

“Like, like, like! Anything Cap Song picks, Advisor Ji likes!”

Everyone immediately regressed into primary school students and started to tease the two of them.

Turns out, there was a reason why the seat next to Ji Yushi was left empty.

A tray was pushed over in front of him. It contained all sorts of snacks, congee, macaroni, vegetables and meat, all served in small delicate bowls. It was clear that a lot of thought had been put into it.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

He really shouldn’t have come out to eat!

Under everyone’s watchful eyes, Ji Yushi picked up his utensil and said calmly, “Thank you. I can do it myself next time.”

Song Qinglan said okay.

He didn’t do anything after that and just joined everyone else’s conversation allowing Ji Yushi to fill his stomach without feeling uncomfortable.

Just as he thought he could go back after eating, he seemed to hear Song Qinglan say, “Thirteen hours left.”

Ji Yushi: “?”

Song Qinglan didn’t look at him and he also didn’t do anything. His expression remained the same.

“There are still thirteen more hours left for you to think about it.”

A pleasant male voice travelled through the subcutaneous communicator, entering Ji Yushi’s mind.

Ji Yushi immediately understood. Their communication channel had not been closed. This was Song Qinglan's first time speaking to him through this private channel.

He used a way that could only be heard by the two of them.

He saw Song Qinglan pick up a bottle of water on the table, unscrew it and take a drink.

The low male voice sounded in his mind again.

“Advisor Ji, time is so slow.”

# Chapter 79: Chapter 79

## Our Reality

### Chapter 79

Time was really a strange thing.

It relied on changes in things to prove its own existence and it is used as a constant parameter to describe a process, but the passage of time could change depending on one's mood.

To Ji Yushi, after just one night's sleep, there were only thirteen hours left. He still hadn't figured out what he should do.

To Song Qinglan, every second felt like a day.

After he said those things to Ji Yushi, he didn't actually sleep much: at best only four or five hours. Song Qinglan didn't need to think too much, and he also faintly knew what feelings Ji Yushi had towards him and knew that Ji Yushi had no way of escaping.

But for the first time Song Qinglan realised that he was quite impatient.

He still had a lot of things he wanted to say but he had to wait until Ji Yushi gave him his answer.

Song Qinglan didn't know how to flirt, and he had also never pursued anyone, so he just did what he wanted to do and said what he wanted to say. After he said that phrase 'time is so slow', he saw Ji Yushi's hand holding the fork freeze and understood that he shouldn't push the other person too much.



Just a reminder was enough. Song Qinglan didn't say anything else to Ji Yushi through the private channel. In any case, there would be plenty of time later.

“Nine o'clock tonight, everyone will need to complete an individual video report.” Song Qinglan checked his watch and spoke to everyone at the table, “As for things that needed to be said, I have already explained it to the Inspectors earlier. This video report just requires you to tell them everything that you've experienced and as for whether a detailed written report would be required, the people above said it would depend on the situation.”

Zhou Mingxuan found it strange, “Just that? We don't need to write a written report?”

“Really? We just have to dictate?”

“So good?”

Everyone was relieved.

In the bubble world, they had to work their asses off to write reports that were more than a dozen pages long.

“On one hand, it is of course because I fought for it.”

Song Qinglan calmly explained. In order to achieve this, he had actually worked quite hard. It was fortunate that he had a plausible reason to use to convince the superiors — Tianqiong had never made anyone perform so many high-level missions in succession. With strong focus on their mental and physical state, the people above relented and allowed them to just submit a video report for now.

“On the one hand, it's because the situation here is different from the bubble world.”

He told everyone what he had learned, “The ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ has officially connected to our Tianqiong system and has integrated with it such

that it is now the parent system and our system is the subsystem.”

Everyone at the table looked at each other.

A strange feelings rose inside them. It wasn't fear, but it made them uncomfortable.

Everyone knew that this 'Tianqiong of all eras' was a Tianqiong system with self-awareness. Humans regard themselves as creators but when they create things far beyond what they had imagined and end up being controlled by them instead, they would be afraid.

“After it connected to our system, all the missions we have completed were automatically settled in our accounts. Our mission experience, time and space coordinates reached and mission objectives that were completed were all recorded in detail so there is no need to explain each of them one by one.” Song Qinglan finished, “I believe you saw the notice with your evaluations when you returned.”

Everyone nodded.

Indeed, they saw it.

“Then it can now directly control our system?”

“It's a little scary. In the end will we be in charge of the system, or will the system be in charge of us?”

“Has no one else discovered its existence before?”

Song Qinglan leaned back against the chair. There seemed to be no room for his long legs. His expression sank, “I still don't know the specifics. The people above are also suffering from this incident, so they don't have time to make things difficult for us. They just need us to retell our experiences in the missions through our own perspectives and it doesn't matter how you do it. But based on the current situation, it doesn't seem to have the intention to go beyond its existing authority....”

“Intelligent system.”

Ji Yushi suddenly spoke.

Everyone looked up.

The Ji Yushi who had tried to minimise his presence earlier: “.....”

He tried his best to ignore the strange way the others were now treating him and said while finishing his fruits, “That Tianqiong has self-awareness. I feel that it not only wanted to hijack us to complete its planned missions, but it also wanted to intervene with our current missions and decide whether the missions should be carried out based on data analysis from various times and spaces.”

Zhou Mingxuan asked, “So that is to say, it wants to help maintain time and space stability?”

“That is just my guess.” Ji Yushi continued, “We don’t know when it appeared. Perhaps it had witnessed the various outcomes of our actions far into the future.”

In the bubble world and also in this world, there were quite a few people who opposed traveling through time and space.

Large-scale protests and demonstrations would not only occur at the beginning. Perhaps it was just as Ji Yushi had said and mankind really ended up with devastating results in the future as a result of tampering with time and space. Those things such as PU-31, Chaos and the bubble world, they were things that shouldn’t happen.

However, it was also very obvious how much contribution Tianqiong had brought to mankind. It helped with avoiding wars, predicting natural disasters and it also stopped numerous terrorist and violent attacks before they could actually happen. It had allowed this originally precarious time and space to continue indefinitely.

As such, it was impossible for humanity to abandon Tianqiong. They believed that someone would definitely find a good way to keep time and space transitions in check.

Duan Wen remembered something, “I remember when I first joined Tianqiong, I seemed to have heard people talk about this. It was said that there were people who had proposed something similar when the Tianqiong system first started but they were the science obsessed madmen and those whose thinking was too extreme. Their final outcome wasn’t very good.”

“Old Duan, what other old gossip do you know?” Zhou Mingxuan was quite interested.

Duan Wen had been with Tianqiong the longest so, regardless of whether it was true or false, he knew some things: “Then let’s talk about it amongst our squad only. If others hear about it, we might need to write a reflection report.” He lowered his voice, “It is said that.....those researchers mainly researched the stability and continuity of time and space, and they even proposed the possibility of an intelligent system rather early on. Of those people, those that went mad went mad and those that fell sick fell sick. There was even one who committed suicide.”

Everyone revealed a look of surprise. Song Qinglan thought of something, “I seem to have heard Xie Sian mention it.”

Back in the space capsule, Xie Sian had once mentioned a professor surnamed Sheng who was said to have made great contributions to Tianqiong but he unfortunately committed suicide at a young age.

As he recalled, Song Qinglan then remembered that of the two people passing by in the Rubik’s Cube, one seemed to also have the surname Sheng—

“So.” Ji Yushi interrupted his thoughts and pulled the topic back onto its tracks, “This so-called parent system may be something that came about at some point in the future in order to keep everything in balance.”

Humans never stopped thinking about time and space.

And as Guardians, it was even more so.

Song Qinglan had been thinking about this problem ever since they were hijacked. Seeing that everyone's expressions weren't too good, he knocked on the table, "Whether or not you want to maintain stability in time and space or control Tianqiong, the World Time Management Alliance will find a suitable solution. This isn't something we can control. What we need to do right now is to finish the video report, go home, rest and toss all these things to the back of our minds."

Tang Le was the first to return to his senses, "Then this time will we be getting a three-month long vacation?!"

Li Chun was excited, "That's right! We were given a three-month vacation in the bubble world last time. Would Chief Wang cares less about us compared to Chief Qi?"

Duan Wen, "Not necessarily. We saved Chief Qi's life. It's different."

Tang Qi poured cold water on them, "Wake up. The psychological evaluation determines how long our vacation is."

The topic quickly changed.

From the vacation, everyone moved on to talking about the reward from the system as well as the reward for their new mission ratings.

Ji Yushi's eating speed slowed down.

Perhaps because he was very hungry, he finished more than half of the food Song Qinglan got for him.

Song Qinglan glanced at the plate and the corners of his lips seem to raise slightly.

He understood. The remaining food were things Ji Yushi didn't like to eat.

"Let's go."

When Ji Yushi was done, Song Qinglan finally said this.

Everyone stood up.

The chairs were pushed into a mess, and they were then rearranged neatly before they left.

Bringing along Ji Yushi who was rumoured to be at odds with them, the group returned to the lounge talking and laughing.

\*

At nine in the evening, everyone gave their video reports in their private training rooms. Their recordings would then be transmitted to the Inspectors, their superiors as well as the Global Time Management Alliance centres.

Thanks to his experience completing the 89 B-level missions previously, Ji Yushi was already used to recounting everything he experienced in his missions clearly and accurately. In just one hour, he was done with his report.

When he left his private training room, the doors to the other rooms were still tightly shut.

The empty training ground was like a large mirror. It reflected Ji Yushi who stood alone in this large space.

At ten, Ji Yushi left the training grounds. He got ready to go to the balcony outside to get some fresh air.

Song Qinglan's voice no longer sounded through the private channel.

There were ten hours left.

Ji Yushi rested his elbows on the railing. The night wind blew through his black hair, messing it up slightly. His pale complexion seemed to glow in the night.

“Advisor Ji.” Someone called out from behind him.

Ji Yushi turned around and leaned against the railing.

The lighting here wasn't great and there usually wouldn't be people around, so he squinted his eyes slightly to confirm the identity of the other party.

A group of Guardians passed by the corridor. There were about seven or eight of them and they all wore black combat uniforms. From the looks of it, they must have just returned from a mission. Lin Xinlan stopped, said some words to his teammates and then walked over to the balcony.

Running into Lin Xinlan in the Tianqiong Jiang City branch wasn't something strange. Moreover, the training grounds for the ninth and seventh squads were also on the same floor. Although both squads would usually be out completing missions, they would still run into each other quite often.

Ji Yushi just didn't expect to see him again so soon.

Lin Xinlan approached, "As soon as I finished my mission, I heard you guys returned. I thought it was you from afar and turns out I was right."

Ji Yushi only nodded at him.

He internally thought that this Jiang City branch really didn't suit him. Even if he wanted to be alone, he was never given the chance to.

The wind on the balcony was pretty strong. It may rain soon.

Lin Xinlan's hair was also ruffled into a mess by the wind. It looked different from 'Rubik's Cube'. A year later, he had changed his hairstyle and now gave off a different feeling.

"It feels very strange." Lin Xinlan's peach blossom eyes curved as he smiled, "To you, you only saw me yesterday but to me, one year had passed."

Ji Yushi however said directly, "Cap Lin, you lost the bet."

Back in 'Rubik's Cube', Lin Xinlan had made a bet with Song Qinglan over who would complete the mission first. If he lost, he promised that he would

tell Song Qinglan a secret. A year ago, he didn't think that he would lose but a year later, he already knew of the outcome. He probably also figured out why everyone on the seventh squad, including Song Qinglan, had such an attitude towards him a year ago.

Keeping a secret was very hard. He was unable to tell the seventh squad what would happen a year later and also unable to do anything to change this 'past that will inevitably happen'. Except for the higher-ups, no one knew that Lin Xinlan had once completed a Rubik's Cube mission with a certain seventh squad.

Lin Xinlan's clothes were stained with blood. It was probably from his mission.

He laughed wholeheartedly. He didn't expect that Ji Yushi's first words to him would be this, "Thank you for the reminder but I have already fulfilled the bet. The result however wasn't very good."

"Fulfilled the bet?" Ji Yushi thought for a moment and then understood what he was referring to, "I thought you said you never touch straight men?"

"It's okay to give yourself a chance. At least I gave it a try." Lin Xinlan shrugged, "Moreover, Cap Song....isn't as straight as one would imagine."

Ji Yushi: ".....How did you know?"

Lin Xinlan thought he didn't believe him. He leaned back against the railing and said slowly, "Just a feeling, I guess."

Seeing Ji Yushi fall silent, Lin Xinlan continued, "You know, those rooms have a recording function. After separating from you, I went through a few rooms alone and saw some traces left behind by you and Cap Song."

He fell into his memories from a year ago and commented slowly, "You two were arguing, the tone seemed a little agitated. He was nervous and angry, but it wasn't because of the argument."



Lin Xinlan was probably referring to the last stage of ‘joining’.

Ji Yushi had witnessed Zoe’s death and Song Qinglan wanted to change routes with him, but he didn’t oblige and instead resolutely climbed down the ladder, throwing Song Qinglan away. At that time, Ji Yushi had nothing else on his mind. He just wanted to get out of this mission and quickly return to that year as soon as possible.

Lin Xinlan said, “I don’t know if it was the heavens joking with me, I later saw more traces of Song Qinglan. He was constantly looking for you.”

Every time Song Qinglan encountered a teammate, he would instruct them, “When you see Ji Yushi, stay with him as much as possible and follow the same route. It doesn’t matter if the speed of completion is slower.”

Zhou Mingxuan asked, “What’s wrong?”

Song Qinglan answered, “His condition isn’t good.”

“Song Qinglan was distressed.” Lin Xinlan seemed to sigh, “I have known him for a while now and it was my first time seeing him put his mission aside just because his teammate wasn’t in a good condition. You don’t know how harsh he can be with his teammates. I have never seen Song Qinglan look at another person like that, but I know what it’s like when someone looks at someone they have feelings for.”

Ji Yushi didn’t know about these things.

Perhaps he actually did know, but because he hadn’t been in a relationship before and he also had no plans on bending a straight man, he just regarded Song Qinglan’s reaction as one a captain would have.

Lin Xinlan didn’t ask him how he felt towards Song Qinglan nor did he ask if the straight man he mentioned last time was referring to Song Qinglan.

“Since Song Qinglan had that possibility and I also had a year to try, it didn’t hurt to give it a chance. How could there be fairness in matters like love?” Reaching this point, Lin Xinlan took out a dice from his pocket,

“This was something he gave me when we were playing a game back when we were completing our training at training camp. After an argument, I wanted to give this back to him by putting it back on his desk but I accidentally knocked over his glass of water and this resulted in unpleasant rumours. I originally wanted to explain but from that encounter in Rubik’s Cube, it seems that he has already forgotten what this was.”

Ji Yushi looked at the dice.

He finally understood why Lin Xinlan refused to use it to test out the rooms in ‘Rubik’s Cube’.

Lin Xinlan put away the dice, “However, I am also quite pleased to see his feelings unrequited.”

Ji Yushi: “?”

Lin Xinlan returned to his original tone, “He offended you quite badly before you even came. I can see that you don’t like him very much. You probably don’t even want to be near him?”

Ji Yushi: “.....Mhn.”

“I knew it.” Lin Xinlan cast him a glance and suddenly winked his peach blossom eye, “Speaking seriously Advisor Ji, these stinky straight men can’t be bent for long. Why don’t you consider me? I am willing to change for you.”

A layer of goosebumps immediately formed on Ji Yushi’s arms. He didn’t accept this offer and just asked expressionlessly, “You’re not throwing away the dice?”

Lin Xinlan, “Why throw it? Save it as a memento.”

Ji Yushi suggested, “If it bothers you when you see it, it’s better to throw it away.”

Lin Xinlan thought about it and felt that his words made sense. He proceeded to take the dice out of his pocket again and threw it from the

balcony into the distant woods.

The dice drew an arc in the air before disappearing completely.

Lin Xinlan was relaxed after throwing the dice. After chatting a little longer with Ji Yushi, he finally left to change his clothes and write his report.

\*

Ji Yushi stayed outside a little longer before returning to the training grounds.

Almost everyone was done with their video reports by now. When they asked him where he went, Ji Yushi just said that he went for a walk outside.

The psychological evaluation should be the next day. Their current state was like they were suffering from jet lag; they had rested enough and as a result weren't sleepy. Li Chun proposed playing a game to pass the time.

Song Qinglan was wearing a grey T-shirt and was the last to come out from his private training room, "What game?"

Everyone quickly suggested a few.

Like the others, Song Qinglan sat cross-legged next to Ji Yushi and listened with interest with his hand supporting his chin.

He heard Ji Yushi ask, "Are there any dice games?"

Song Qinglan turned his head. His dark eyes were especially bright under the bright lights in the training ground. He gently asked, "You want to play that?"

Ji Yushi made a sound of affirmation.

Tang Le immediately jumped up, "We can! With so many people, we can play Aeroplane Chess. We played it during our training camp before. We have all the things needed for it too!"

When it came to games, Tang Le and Li Chun were more excited than anyone else. They quickly dug out the necessary items from inside their lockers and spread them out onto the floor.

Song Qinglan supported himself with one hand and fiddled with the dice with his other hand, “Let’s talk about punishment and rewards. What do the winner and losers get?”

When everyone heard this, they all excitedly thought of a number of evil ideas.

Song Qinglan felt a warm touch on the back of his hand.

He looked down and saw Ji Yushi’s finger touching the back of his hand. It was thin and slender, and the nail was clean and neatly trimmed.

Seeing him look over, Ji Yushi retracted his finger and said, “If I win, give me the dice.”

There was a customary rule for this game amongst the trainees when they played it during training camp. If someone wins first, they could request for the right to cast the dice and determine the fates of the remaining players.

Everyone thought he was talking about this.

Song Qinglan agreed without hesitation, “Sure.”

# Chapter 80: Chapter 80

## Our Reality

### Chapter 80

Aeroplane chess was generally a four-player game. The seven people in the seventh squad was divided into four teams. Li Chun was in a team by himself while Ji Yushi was naturally put together with Song Qinglan.

Once all the conditions were decided, they started the game. Ji Yushi however didn't win a single one of them.

Fortunately, the game followed the points system used when they were trainees and only the team with the lowest score would be punished.

Li Chun truly deserved the title of a slag man. He thought of a particularly terrible punishment: With your back facing us, use your butt to write the words "I am a pig".

The first loser Tang Qi wanted flip the table and storm off: "Fuck."

Tang Le who was in the same team as his older brother also yelled, "Chun'er, just you wait! You will be next!!"

Under everyone else's roaring laughter, the pair of twins stood up and turned their backs to everyone.

The two big men really couldn't do something like twisting their ass around in front of everyone.

Zhou Mingxuan clapped his hands, "Raise your shirt and reveal your ass!! Let this lord see if your ass is perky or not!"

Everyone: “HAHAHAHAHA!”

Even Ji Yushi laughed along. He didn’t expect these straight men to be like this. It was very amusing.

The twins stood in a line, pulled up their shirts to reveal their lower bodies and then twisted their butts up, down, left and right to write in the air ‘I am a pig’. Every twist of their waist left the others roaring in laughter.

“Work it more!!”

“The one on the left, your ass is not drawing round enough!”

“It’s the butt of the butts!”

The two cursed loudly as they completed their punishment. Li Chun almost ended up in tears from laughing too hard.

Intelligence and hyperthymesia didn’t work in games like this. Everything was completely random and relied on luck.

Their luck wasn’t too good nor was it too bad. After Duan Wen had to pretend to drink Zhou Mingxuan’s milk, Tang Qi and Tang Le had to blow balloons and pop them using their bodies and Li Chun had to drink water while doing a handstand, it was finally their turn to come last place.

Li Chun’s aeroplanes had already reached the goal. Song Qinglan could only ask, “What’s the punishment this time?”

Despite the fact that he had asked with a smile, Song Qinglan’s deep look along with his usual image that was deeply rooted in their hearts made Li Chun afraid.

“Huh?” Li Chun spoke weakly, “T-then you can just do a hundred push-ups!”

Everyone: “.....”

“Fuck? Chun Chun, are you even human?”

“It’s just a game, it’s not like Cap Song will eat you, you coward!”

“I don’t accept it! Why?! Why do they get special treatment?! Is it because I don’t look as good as Advisor Ji?!”

Everyone cried out in dissatisfaction.

Song Qinglan however had already stood up. He patted his hands and got ready, “A hundred push-ups?”

Ji Yushi also stood up.

Zhou Mingxuan, “Wait a minute!”

Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi paused.

Ji Yushi saw Zhou Mingxuan’s small eyes flash and had a bad feeling. With their level of immaturity.....

Sure enough, Zhou Mingxuan pretentiously proposed, “Push-ups are okay, but it’s an easy feat for Cap Song and it is something Advisor Ji can do too so it would be letting you two off too easily.”

Song Qinglan, “Then?”

“Change it to push-up with weights.” Zhou Mingxuan demanded, “Advisor Ji sits on Cap Song’s back with both feet off the ground and he must stay like that until Cap Song finishes the set.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Everyone, “Carry him! Carry him!”

Li Chun cowered, “That....I wasn’t the one who said it, it was Old Zhou!”

Duan Wen elbowed him, “Then do you want to see it?”

Li Chun immediately nodded, “I do!”

“Boring.”

Song Qinglan tossed this word of mockery out and then proceeded to remove the communicator on his wrist.

Seeing him get ready, the crowd got even more lively.

Song Qinglan placed his communicator aside and got down.

He was tall, and his build was big. When he did this, all the muscles on his back tightened, looking visibly strong and firm. With his arms supporting him, he looked like a flat iron plate. He raised his chin at Ji Yushi, “Get on.”

Ji Yushi stood beside Song Qinglan. Everyone thought he would definitely not do it.

But contrary to their expectations, as soon as Song Qinglan was done speaking, Ji Yushi looked at the crowd and said, “Actually, I thought you would make me lie under Cap Song.”

Everyone: “???”

Everyone: “Then go and lie down!”

Ji Yushi’s tone was light, “Too late.”

Everyone: “Fuck!”

With Advisor Ji being able to play so well, they felt like they had just missed out on a hundred million bucks!!

While they were regretting their decisions, Ji Yushi had already walked over and sat down on Song Qinglan’s back with his legs crossed.

Ji Yushi had his palms resting on Song Qinglan’s back. Through the thin fabric, Song Qinglan could feel heat from Ji Yushi’s palm.

No one knew that Ji Yushi was actually very nervous.



“Sit tight.”

Song Qinglan said.

All the muscles worked at the same time and were as hard as iron. The body of a mature man moved slowly and steadily, and a standard push-up was completed without even making Ji Yushi lose balance. Amidst the cheers, Song Qinglan had already completed almost thirty of them.

Ji Yushi may appear rather thin, but he was still over sixty kilograms. Unless one trained for a long time, very few could be able to support so much weight while doing push-ups.

Song Qinglan’s movements grew slower and slower. Very soon, sweat dripped from his forehead.

He gritted his teeth and the veins at his temples bulged out. Ji Yushi noticed this change.

“Advisor Ji is feeling distressed!”

“Hahahahaha. Lie on Cap Song instead!”

“Sixty! What a badass!”

Ji Yushi only had his eyes lowered and he didn’t make any movements or say anything. He did his best to try and not make it too difficult for Song Qinglan.

By doing this, it also prevented the others from getting too excited. Ji Yushi had a talent for this.

The more he didn’t speak, the less they could joke around.

A hundred weighted push-ups were finally done.

Ji Yushi got off from Song Qinglan’s back and Song Qinglan collapsed onto the ground. Turning around and catching his breath, he threatened, “Old Zhou, just you wait.”

Song Qinglan was sweating profusely. His sweat glistened like honey under the light. A bottle of water was passed over.

Song Qinglan thought it was the diligently working robotic arm and only realised when he heard the teasing from the others that it was actually from Ji Yushi. He sat up and drank half the bottle in one go before smiling, “Thanks.”

Ji Yushi, “You worked hard.”

Everyone: “Oh!!!”

Ji Yushi turned away: “.....”

A group of straight men couldn’t really play that long and there was also no alcohol to drink here.

After having some fun with Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi, everyone was no longer interested in embarrassing the other teammates and most of the subsequent punishments were related to physical strength.

Everyone played for more than two hours before they finally lost interest.

“When we are allowed out, let’s go for a drink.” Li Chun suggested, “Before I left, my friend was preparing to renovate their nightclub. Since a month has passed, it should already be open again.”

“That one again?” Tang Le was beginning to feel tired. He let out a yawn and asked, “Aren’t you afraid of meeting that girl again?”

That girl. He was referring to the girl Li Chun mentioned time and time again because he was not able to get her phone number before they set off.

But in the bubble world, they had already interacted and found that they weren’t suitable for each other. Li Chun quickly denied it, “No, no. We aren’t fated. Let’s go have fun at another place!”

As they discussed where to go, Duan Wen said, “Just choose somewhere normal. Places that are noisy and smoky, do you think Advisor Ji would

go?”

Ji Yushi expressed, “I can. You can just call me when the time comes.”

Tang Le: “Really? I was afraid that you would find it very boring.”

Nightclubs were noisy and filled with all sorts of people. Someone as elegant and refined as Ji Yushi didn’t look like someone who would go to nightclubs to party.

Of the people present, only Song Qinglan knew that when they were in the roadside kiosk in PU-31, Ji Yushi had once said that his gaze looked like the gaze from a pervert in a gay bar. They weren’t familiar with each other at the time, so Song Qinglan didn’t take this matter to heart but now he recalled it again.

Song Qinglan looked at Ji Yushi and said to the others, “We can talk about it then. I will decide on the place.”

Everyone, “Cap Song!!!”

Li Chun was so excited, he almost jumped up, “Did I hear wrong?! Cap Song is also going to a nightclub!! You never went no matter how much I asked you before!!”

Tang Le: “Hehehe, I know the reason why!”

Li Chun, “I also know!! Hahahaha!!”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

If it continued like this, he should just stop speaking for the rest of his life.

Song Qinglan grabbed the cushion nearby and threw it at them, “Scram! Haven’t you had enough?!”

It was late now, and everyone still had their psychological evaluation tomorrow. The others returned to their rooms in a good mood.

The game scene was a mess. The cleaning robot and robotic arm slowly moved over to clean it up.

Song Qinglan stood up first. He looked at Ji Yushi who was still sitting on the ground, “What are you looking for?”

Ji Yushi didn’t look up, “Dice.”

Song Qinglan asked, “Still want to play?”

The dice Li Chun held was gone. It was unknown if Li Chun had accidentally pocketed it or if it was swept away by the cleaning robot.

Ji Yushi couldn’t see it anywhere, but he didn’t say anything. He just said lightly, “No.”

Song Qinglan stretched his hand out, “Get up.”

Ji Yushi raised his head. Just like what they did before, he very naturally held Song Qinglan’s hand and stood up.

Song Qinglan then let go of him.

The cleaning robot seemed to have not expected Ji Yushi to stand up and just happened to be cleaning the area behind him. At this moment, it gently touched Ji Yushi’s heel.

Ji Yushi subconsciously took a step forward, almost running into Song Qinglan in the process. He was only able to stop with Song Qinglan supporting his shoulders.

With the distance suddenly narrowed and the two standing so close together, the two were left stunned for a while.

Since that conversation, their relationship had reached a stage where it was more than friends and even their teammates had acquiesced that they were a pair. They however were still not official lovers.

As for the twenty-four hours of wait, Ji Yushi still hadn't given his answer and Song Qinglan was still waiting.

The natural actions between them in the past had now become a little ambiguous in this period of time that felt both extremely long and extremely short.

Secretive, heart racing.

Only they were clear.

Song Qinglan moved aside a little, but he then heard Ji Yushi speak, "Cap Song, I am a man."

Suddenly mentioning this, Song Qinglan was confused, "Huh?"

He saw Ji Yushi look straight at him and speak calmly word for word, "I am twenty-five years old and physically fit. Although I don't grow much hair, I would still occasionally grow a stubble. I like guns, fighting, am proficient at Jiu-Jitsu and can climb rock walls barehanded. My body has masculine features and I would similarly have a morning wood reaction in the morning."

Song Qinglan understood what he meant. He raised his eyebrow slightly, "Are you suddenly doing a self-introduction or are you challenging me?"

Ji Yushi shook his head, "I just wanted to remind you that I am different from what you imagine."

Song Qinglan asked in return, "How do you know what my imagination is like?"

Ji Yushi didn't speak.

Song Qinglan's tone carried some anger, but he also found it a little funny, "Are you thinking that what I said wasn't direct enough? Or you thought that I haven't imagined doing anything to you?"

Ji Yushi's ears were hot, ".....No."

Song Qinglan said, "If you want to know, I can tell you."

It could be seen that Ji Yushi had rested well this time.

The shadows under his eyes were mostly gone and the fragile feeling he gave off during the missions had also disappeared without a trace.

Someone who is too smart and has a tendency to silently endure would typically have poor sleep quality. Song Qinglan was originally worried that he would have difficulty falling asleep with all the things he had to consider but he was relieved when he saw this. He felt that he shouldn't say too much lest it becomes counterproductive.

There were only a few short hours left so he should bear with it. As such, he said to Ji Yushi, "If I was too sudden, then I'm.....really sorry. But you don't need to think over it too much. Have a good rest tonight and give me your answer tomorrow."

Ji Yushi: "Okay."

Song Qinglan said, "Good night."

Ji Yushi responded, "Good night."

Before returning to their rooms, Ji Yushi handed over something, "Your communicator."

Song Qinglan stood in place and placed the communicator back on his wrist.

When they were playing the game just now, he had left it on the ground and had almost forgotten about it. Fortunately, it wasn't taken away by the cleaning robot.

The screen automatically lit up after sensing his actions and it displayed the time and date.

The time on the communicator was incorrect.

It had been changed to tomorrow morning which was nearly seven hours from now — It was the twenty-fourth hour since his confession to Ji Yushi.

Song Qinglan's movements stopped. He suddenly understood something.

Ji Yushi was given a day to think it over.

And that time had been intentionally pushed ahead.

\*

Closing the door, Ji Yushi's heart was racing.

His private training room was brightly lit and the mirror in the room reflected his current appearance. It was an appearance he had never seen before.

All that had to be said had been said, and all that had to be reminded had been reminded.

Ji Yushi wanted to drink some water to calm himself down but just as he unscrewed the cap, there was a knock on his door.

As soon as Ji Yushi opened the door, Song Qinglan unceremoniously pushed in.

His arrival was fierce. Male hormones as well as a strong oppressiveness emanated from his body as he approached step by step. He confined Ji Yushi between the wall and himself.

Ji Yushi had no way of escaping. Unable to see his expression clearly, he was anxious, "Wha—"

Song Qinglan had already bowed his head and kissed him.

**KK has something to say:**

Can I just say how much I loved how time was incorporated in their confession/answer? SO SATISFYING

# Chapter 81: Chapter 81

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 81

There was a warm sensation on his lips. Ji Yushi's breathing stopped and the bottle of water in his hands fell to the ground.

Clear water spilled all over the ground, gurgling out through the opening of the bottle. With the appearance of a large wet patch on the floor, the robotic arm immediately moved to get a towel.

But the humans paid it no attention.

It was just a light kiss.

So light, it was as if it had never happened.

The lips were reluctant to part. It lightly pressed down before slowly separating.

Song Qinglan had only lightly touched Ji Yushi's lips. It was like he was touching a cherished treasure.

It felt like an electric current ran through the place that was kissed. The lingering touch on his lips was still very vivid. It was soft, hot and slightly wet.

Ji Yushi was completely stunned.

Song Qinglan's voice was hoarse, "You agreed."



His breath was hot.

Ji Yushi's face was also hot.

Song Qinglan had used a declarative statement.

As for the question that was given twenty-four hours to think about, it had already been answered when Ji Yushi specially introduced himself to Song Qinglan again. As such, he had moved the time forward, implicitly giving Song Qinglan the 'okay'.

Ji Yushi was trapped and had no way of escaping. With everything having developed to this point, he could no longer implicitly express himself and could only reply as straightforwardly as possible, "Yes."

The tips of their noses touched. The breaths of the two entangled such that it was no longer clear which belonged to who.

Hearing this, Song Qinglan's grip around Ji Yushi's wrist tightened further. He turned his head sideways and leaned down again, "Why did you adjust the time?"

After asking, he once again lightly kissed Ji Yushi.

His tone was still the same as usual, as if he couldn't help but suddenly have an urge to do something like that in the middle of his questioning.

Ji Yushi could hear his own heart pounding loudly, reaching his eardrums.

He said four words, "Time is so slow."

His lips were warm.

This time, Song Qinglan kissed him heavily. Unscrupulously and unskillfully, he fiercely covered Ji Yushi's lips.

Caught unprepared, Ji Yushi let out a short gasp which was blocked in his throat by Song Qinglan.

In an instant, it was as if thunder had struck, setting off sparks.

Their lips were closely connected. From the lower lips to the upper lips, the angles changed as they tried to get closer to each other.

Streams of electricity surged through each other's spines during the kiss, reaching their brains. Ji Yushi's mind was a complete mess, and he couldn't think at all. He only knew that he was starting to run out of air and couldn't help but try to breathe.

As soon as his lips parted, Song Qinglan's breathing grew heavier. The moment fresh air poured into his lungs, the original kiss had also turned into a deep kiss.

The grip around his wrist loosened.

Ji Yushi who was no longer supported and had lost his strength started to slip back.

Song Qinglan noticed this and very quickly wrapped one arm around his waist while the other supported the back of his head. He held him in his arms in a gentle but possessive manner.

The tip of his tongue tasting something sweet. Song Qinglan wanted to explore the entirety of Ji Yushi's mouth. He relied on his instincts and chased after the tip of the other person's tongue.

Ji Yushi's entire body trembled. He was completely unaware that kissing could make him feel like this.

His eyes were half-closed, and he didn't know how to respond. He could only grip tightly onto the sides of Song Qinglan's T-shirt while he was forced to endure his lips and mouth being plundered. Such a position could be considered as an embrace.

He felt like he was drunk.

And Song Qinglan was the one making him drunk.

By the time the hot and humid kiss was over, the temperature in the air had silently risen.

Both were slightly sweaty as they gasped for air.

Song Qinglan's arms around Ji Yushi didn't loosen. He pressed his forehead against Ji Yushi's, "What should I do? Advisor Ji, I still want to kiss you."

The tip of Ji Yushi's tongue was bleeding a little. He didn't really want to talk, "Mhn."

He felt it.

Song Qinglan lowered his head and proceeded to kiss him again. The kiss this time was much longer than the last one and he could also feel the changes in Song Qinglan's body.

When it was over again, Song Qinglan said, "How about counting this one as our first kiss? I think I performed better this time."

Ji Yushi's heart was still pounding madly, "Why?"

"The first time, I hurt you." Song Qinglan said honestly, "It's all because I have no experience."

There were too many ambiguities in that line. It was awkward no matter how you listened to it.

Ji Yushi didn't remind the Cap Song who was still a steel straight man in his bones. He just asked, "Didn't you have a 'first love'?"

The implication was how could you have never kissed if you have had a first love?

"Isn't my first love you?" Song Qinglan said, "That group of bastards have already told you everything about me. What first love could I have had?"

Song Qinglan, the only virgin in the seventh squad.

Single since birth for twenty-six years.

Ji Yushi's beautiful eyes looked at him as he pointed out, "Your 'first love' in Ning City. The one called Han Han that cried when you left and looks very good."

Song Qinglan's lips rose. His eyes bent slightly, and deep laughter sounded from his chest. It made Ji Yushi a little annoyed inside. He didn't understand what made Song Qinglan laugh.

When Song Qinglan had laughed enough, he stopped and said, "Advisor Ji, you're so cute every time you hold grudges. You even remember what I said back then?"

Ji Yushi who was called cute, "....."

Song Qinglan defended himself, "Isn't it too unfair? How could things in kindergarten count?"

Ji Yushi turned away, "You said you would find her when you have the opportunity. Now you're going back on your words?"

"I admit that I only did that to show my charm and make you spare me a few more looks." Song Qinglan forced his face back, "Would I really dare go find her? The moment I don't pay attention, you run away. I don't even have enough time to keep an eye on you."

What was going to come would still come sooner or later.

Ji Yushi knew that Song Qinglan would be waiting to talk about this after the twenty-four hours were up.

Dating was dating but accounts that needed to be settled still needed to be settled. The time he was given was just for him to prepare himself.

He didn't speak.

He also didn't know where to start.

Song Qinglan stored away his gentle expression and became sterner. The heavy emotions in his dark eyes made Ji Yushi dare not look straight at him, “You said you originally didn’t plan on returning.”

The situation had returned back to the moment Ji Yushi returned from year 1439.

Over the past day, Song Qinglan’s anger had not diminished at all. As long as he thought about the thoughts Ji Yushi had at that time, he couldn’t help but feel a chilling fear.

Song Qinglan resolutely wanted to settle the accounts. He asked darkly, “What did you originally plan to do? Stupidly try and change the past or become a traitor?”

With each of the words hitting the right mark, Ji Yushi couldn’t help but want to defend himself: “I——”

“What does hasolamu mean?”

Song Qinglan interrupted him.

Ji Yushi immediately froze. The blush that had not yet completely faded from his face had returned. He revealed a look of disbelief as if he had been seen through by someone.

Before he could speak, Song Qinglan accurately accused, “Thought that I wouldn’t understand and dared to confess to me in front of so many people? Advisor Ji, you are pretty brave. Were you thinking that you didn’t want to have any regrets since you didn’t plan on returning?”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

“Let me tell you, you were wrong.” Song Qinglan stared at his face closely, “If you didn’t return, you would have never known that I have already fucking fallen for you a long time ago.”

Hasolamu.

I like you.

Ji Yushi's vague confession had already been seen through by Song Qinglan. In fact, the entire squad knew. After Ji Yushi returned, no one asked him about this and they also didn't ridicule him because Song Qinglan had already taken control and confessed to him in front of everyone.

Song Qinglan wanted to let everyone know — Ji Yushi was originally the object of his ardent pursuit.

Warmth filled his heart.

Ji Yushi spoke up, "I thought you would never like the same sex."

So he never held any hope.

And decided to leave.

Seeing that he was behaving a lot more honestly, Song Qinglan's anger subsided. He asked, "If I didn't like the same sex, what were you going to do after you returned? Continue to get along with me using a friend status or go back to Ning City and never see me again?"

Just the thought of something like that happening made Song Qinglan feel very distressed.

Ji Yushi was someone who liked to silently endure through things, and he also wasn't good at expressing himself. Something like this was commonplace for Ji Yushi. Even if he was misunderstood by the person he likes who thought that he had three boyfriends at the same time, he didn't make any attempt to explain. In any case, nothing would change.

Ji Yushi however said, "No."

He denied Song Qinglan's statement and then said, "It's the opposite. I returned because I wanted to give it a try."

Song Qinglan coldly snorted, "Try what?"

Ji Yushi: “Pursue you.”

His beautiful lips that had been kissed until it was gorgeously rosy gently uttered some extremely moving words, “Song Qinglan, I seem to be.....rather successful.”

\*

“It’s almost half past eight. Why isn’t Cap Song up yet?”

In the morning, everyone gathered at the training ground.

Tang Qi said, “Old Zhou go and check. See if he overslept.”

“You must be joking.” Zhou Mingxuan added, “When have you ever seen Cap Song oversleeping?”

“Fuck, were the weighted push-ups too much last night? He couldn’t have exercised too much and can no longer get up?” Li Chun suddenly realised this. “But the psychological evaluation is at nine. Is Cap Song planning on skipping it?”

“Wait a minute, Advisor Ji also isn’t up yet!”

As the group discussed back and forth, the door to the training ground was kicked open.

Song Qinglan strode in with his pair of long legs. He carried a paper bag in one hand and coffee in the other, “Why are you so noisy for?”

“???”

“Cap Song, you’re bringing us breakfast?”

“Fuck, it’s omelettes! Smells so good!! Why is there only one serving?”

Everyone gathered around.

With Song Qinglan's tall height, he raised the food above their heads and easily avoided their hands. He stared at them coldly, "Wake up if you haven't woken up yet. The things in my hands have nothing to do with you."

The door to a private training room opened.

Ji Yushi walked out from within.

He had changed into a new grey training outfit, and he wore white sneakers. His hair seemed to have just been washed and it was still steaming slightly. Seeing everyone present, he calmly greeted them, "Morning. Sorry, I overslept. Let's go."

"When I left, you were still sleeping soundly so I didn't wake you." Song Qinglan spoke very naturally, "Rest early next time. Don't sleep so late anymore."

Those lines contained a lot of information.

Everyone's minds were filled with question marks and shock. They didn't understand what happened to the two of them last night.

Wait a minute, wasn't it about time for Ji Yushi to give Cap Song his answer to his confession?

Ji Yushi nodded.

Song Qinglan handed him the breakfast and carried the coffee for him.

Following that, Song Qinglan glanced at the other single dogs before him and said with great satisfaction, "Eat something first before leaving, boyfriend."



# Chapter 82: Chapter 82

## Our Reality

### Chapter 82

The single word ‘boyfriend’ had given the single dogs in the seventh squad a critical blow.

Knowing that their steel straight and homophobic captain had suddenly turned gay was one thing but seeing the two together with their own eyes was another thing. They were able to joke around before but now they could really sense the ambiguous atmosphere between Cap Song and Advisor Ji.

The two clearly hadn’t done anything excessively intimate and they also looked no different from before but just the sight of the two standing there made it difficult for the others to ignore the fact that they were truly a pair.

Tang Le felt dizzy, “How is it a boyfriend?”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Advisor Ji, you really don’t need to think about it a little more?!”

Ji Yushi slowly ate the hot omelette and answered between bites, “Didn’t you guys remind me that Cap Song is very popular?”

That line was light and very casual.

Ji Yushi spoke so naturally, it was as if he was saying ‘I heard the price of the vegetables would rise so I stopped by and bought some’.

Song Qinglan crossed his arms, revealing an arrogant attitude, “Thank you for your assistance.”

Everyone, “Dammit!”

Only saw the beginning and didn’t see the process. This was the damned fate of wingmen.

Li Chun defeatedly cried out, “What did we miss?! Didn’t he say that you had a day to consider it?! It was still fine when we were playing games last night. What did you two secretly do while we were asleep?”

Escaping single status was a good omen. It meant that the seventh squad’s curse had been broken. He had even specially prepared a love diary to record Cap Song’s journey of escaping singlehood.

That final question happened to be the question everyone was curious about.

Just now, Song Qinglan had said, “When I left, you were still sleeping soundly” and “Rest early next time”. They were words that couldn’t help but make the others start to use their imaginations.

Everyone’s expressions were very interesting, as if they were internally thinking that gays were truly different. Despite only bending recently, they were able to reach the next base so quickly.

Song Qinglan was without a doubt. If it wasn’t because Ji Yushi was too refined, these rascals would have already asked the question directly. Song Qinglan coldly snorted, “What else? Spending a night in a public space like this, would I disrespect Ji Yushi so much?”

Everyone’s hearts stabilised somewhat. It seems that the two hadn’t progressed at rocket speed. Song Qinglan was still a low-ranking virgin.

They activated their taunting mode.

“If you can’t, then you can’t!”

“Hah.” Song Qinglan’s temper was better after escaping singlehood, “It was just because it was too late. I only stayed in my boyfriend’s room and slept with him in my arms for the night.”

Ji Yushi finished the omelette and added with the right timing, “Single bed. A little tight with two people.”

Song Qinglan comforted him, “It’s okay. It’ll be fine when we get home.”

Everyone: “???”

Everyone, “Fuck!!!”

Despite everyone’s nonstop curses and complaints, the two were speaking the truth.

The private training rooms only had single beds so it would indeed be a tight squeeze for two big men. With Song Qinglan’s big build, any careless movement would result in him falling off. Song Qinglan however didn’t mind it and didn’t plan on leaving. He simply held Ji Yushi tightly in his arms and managed to spend the night like this.

He couldn’t sleep at first.

Ji Yushi’s sleep quality had always been poor and it as even more difficult for him to sleep peacefully with another person on the bed.

Song Qinglan on the other hand was hot-headed. What was that saying again? — With the warm and soft prize in your arms, who can still remain upright? What’s more, the person in his arms was the seemingly cold and refined but warm and soft Ji Yushi.

He restrained his excitement and quietly watched Ji Yushi’s sleeping appearance in the dark. He only fell asleep in the latter half of the night.

As such, one reason was that it was the beginning of love, and the other more important reason was because they were inexperienced.

Although there wasn’t much to worry about after the two shared their feelings, the two of them were actually much more innocent than their teammates thought.

It was about time. The group headed towards the medical centre.

Walking along the spacious corridor, the group of tall and strong Guardians pushed each other back and forth playfully. It resembled a group of school tyrants arrogantly sauntering through the corridors during high school.

When passing the balcony, Duan Wen Suddenly commented, “Aren’t they those bastards from the ninth squad?”

Everyone stopped in place and looked over.

In the woods outside, they saw the members of the ninth squad scattered around. They appeared to be searching through the bushes looking for something.

As if sensing their gaze, Lin Xinlan straightened up and looked over.

With this look, he happened to see Song Qinglan, the tallest among them. Lin Xinlan then proceeded to bend his eyes and smile at him. It was unknown if it was done deliberately or not but he even sent finger hearts at Song Qinglan from where he stood.

Everyone, “.....”

It had been a while since they returned. They had almost forgotten about this.

Seeing the captain of the ninth squad express love towards the captain of the seventh squad was already commonplace in the Jiang City branch.

No wonder everyone would mention PTSD when talking about Cap Lin. Lin Xinlan was far more expressive and forward in this respect than Ji Yushi.

Tang Le, “What are they doing?”

Tang Qi, “Don’t know.”

The group continued on.

Ji Yushi said, “Searching for a dice.”

“Dice?” Song Qinglan found it strange. Someone last night was also searching for a dice, “How did you know?”

“You gave him a dice during training camp as a trainee.” Ji Yushi continued looking ahead as he answered lightly, “While we talked here last night, I suggested that he throw it. Probably regretting it now.”

After imagining what happened, everyone laughed loudly.

Ji Yushi was probably paying Lin Xinlan back.

The two of them getting together was a matter that would be made public and spread through both the Jiang City branch and the Ning City branch sooner or later. With Ji Yushi who had a tendency to hold grudges, he would ensure that everything had been sorted out properly. This personality of his was truly amazing.

\*

All the members of the sevenths squad had returned.

The medical centre had specially gathered experts to personally conduct their psychological evaluation and along the way they also gave them some psychological counselling.

This went on all morning.

At the conclusion of all this, they were notified that they were allowed to return home to rest, and the length of their vacation would be determined after their reports are out.

This meant that this mission that seemingly had no end to it was truly over.

There was no Ouroboros, no Chaos, no bubble world which made one have difficulty distinguishing between reality and illusion, and no mind-boggling Rubik’s Cube. Despair, pain, blood and confusion, they all seemed to be something from another time and space. They had returned to their own time and space. They had returned to their safe haven.

Chief Wang came to the seventh squad's training ground and sincerely praised them for their hard work.

Once she was done praising them, Chief Wang asked Ji Yushi, "Xiao Ji, have you considered transferring to Jiang City and officially becoming a member of the seventh squad?"

Old Yu who was previously in the seventh squad had retired, leaving an opening in the squad. For Chief Wang to suggest this, it was in fact something everyone had expected.

Unlike Chief Qi in the bubble world, Chief Wang's approach was much gentler, and she didn't give Ji Yushi any pressure.

Chief Wang said, "If you decide to come to Jiang City, I believe you will be able to get along well with your teammates. You should know that Xiao Song's mission report was filled with praise for you. It was a world of difference compared to his attitude when you first came here!"

Everyone heckled.

Even Ji Yushi couldn't help but raise the corners of his lips. His appearance was particularly eye-catching among the crowd.

Chief Wang still didn't know the truth yet, so she continued to tear down Song Qinglan's platform, "Before you came, his was a real rascal. He insisted that Records who only do administrative work are useless and that you're just an embroidered pillow! He also said that if you were really transferred to the squad, he would leave immediately!"

Song Qinglan was losing his face, "..."

"Haaa, but I know he was just worried that the same thing would happen again." Chief Wang continued, "He has a strong sense of responsibility, and he blames himself whenever any of the team members are injured. He was afraid that he wouldn't be able to protect the new member and result in sacrifices. Facts however have shown that his worries were not unreasonable. If it wasn't for your amazing abilities, with how dangerous

the mission was this time, the outcome would have probably been quite bad.”

In fact, everyone understood.

As the ‘squad with a higher-than-average chance of succeeding’, they had been selected by Tianqiong because of the additional Ji Yushi.

Chief Wang said, “When the strong meets the strong, one plus one is greater than two. If the seventh squad has you, it would be even more powerful and may become the strongest squad in Jiang City and even in all the Time Management Alliances. Your squad can become the sword guarding time and space.”

The female leader’s impassioned speech made everyone in the seventh squad store away their comfortable and contented smiles.

They were Guardians of time and space.

Their job is to guard the peace of time and space.

This belief had never changed since they joined Tianqiong.

Ji Yushi said, “I will consider it.”

He could feel everyone’s eyes focused on him. There was one in particular that was especially piercing and hot.

Everything was different this time.

Ji Yushi officially responded to this invitation, “When I have finished sorting out my personal matters, I will be happy to join the Guardians and become a part of the Seventh Squad.”

\*

The two brothers Tang Qi and Tang Le were responsible for retrieving everyone’s belongings including their phones, clothing and the likes.

Ji Yushi changed into the normal clothes he had brought over when he came to Jiang City and heard a knock on his door.

Song Qinglan pushed the door open and entered.

The scene before him was quite familiar.

Ji Yushi wore an ordinary white shirt as well as a pair of ordinary black trousers. With the shirt tucked into his trousers, his thin waist and straight back were accentuated.

Under the light in the training room, his fair skin and lustrous eyelashes revealed a hint of coldness which made him feel a little distant. It was reminiscent of a pine tree beside a snowy lake.

It was just like when they first met.

“What’s wrong?” He asked Song Qinglan. There was intimacy in his tone that others couldn’t detect.

But it was also completely different from their first encounter.

Song Qinglan walked over, grabbed his arm and pulled him into his embrace. He took a deep breath and said, “Don’t want you to go.”

Song Qinglan had also changed into regular clothes. Contrary to his usual arrogant and domineering image, he now looked like an unrestrained rich kid. Without the identity of the captain of the seventh squad, he was just an ordinary twenty-six-year-old young man.

Ji Yushi was surprised. It turns out that this was what one would call farewell.

He had never been used to the feeling of reluctance. Even when he moved out to live alone when he got into university, he didn’t feel reluctant.

At this moment, even despite knowing that they would meet again soon, he finally understood this emotion.



After disappearing for a whole month, it was time for them to go home.

After Ji Yushi turned on his phone, there were many missed called and unread messages. All of them were from his family.

Some of the messages were the same as the bubble world, but there were also many differences — This time, Ji Minyue had taken leave and driven directly to Ning City to pick him up.

Ji Yushi leaned against Song Qinglan's shoulder. He grabbed the other party's clothes and said, "I'll wait for you."

This tacit understanding made Song Qinglan smile. He deliberately pretended to not understand, "Wait for me for what?"

Ji Yushi followed the flow, "Wait for you to come to Ning City to see your grandfather."

Song Qinglan laughed out loud, "Damn."

The two embraced for a while. Before the parting emotions grew stronger, Song Qinglan asked, "Advisor Ji, can I stay over at your place this time too?"

Ji Yushi agreed, "Yeah, you can."

"You better think it through." Song Qinglan said lowly, "I'm talking about sharing a bed this time."

**KK has something to say:**

Cap Song going for the kill!!

# Chapter 83: Chapter 83

## Our Reality

### Chapter 83

Ji Yushi had been transferred from Ning City to Jiang City to complete an A-level mission and went missing for a full month, and when the entire squad returned safely, he was also the last to return. All this time, his family had been worried about them. As soon as they heard that he had returned, the Ji family couldn't wait any longer and Ji Minyue drove directly to Ning City to pick Ji Yushi up.

Ji Yushi opened the back seat door, threw his belongings in and then sat in the front passenger seat.

Ji Minyue had already talked to him through the phone earlier so when he saw him, his first words were: "You've lost weight!"

This was just like the bubble world. Ji Minyue had gained weight himself so he would pay more attention to whether another person had lost weight.

Ji Yushi calmly said to him, "I wish I could say something like that when I see you."

Ji Minyue who had sworn countless times that he would start exercising but was always too lazy to start almost spat out blood, "...Little classmate Ji, can't you be a little more affectionate?"

"Of course I can." Ji Yushi proceeded to change his tune, "Brother, thank you for coming to pick me up."

His younger brother was still a younger brother who held grudges.

It seems that despite going missing for a month, he wasn't left with any psychological shadows.

Ji Minyue was satisfied when he saw this. He started up the car and drove out, "Didn't you say earlier that you would be out soon? Why did you take so long?"

Ji Yushi froze for a moment and then said, "Said a few words to Cap Song."

When Ji Minyue heard this, he frowned, "Why? Does he have a problem with you? Even if he has his prejudice, this mission is already over. Why is he still making things difficult for you? I can't believe he still won't let you off even when you're about to leave. I don't think you should agree to transfer over in the future even if they're lacking in people. Look at what a mess this one became..."

The window rose.

The car drove out of the Jiang City branch.

As Ji Minyue's voice got angrier and angrier, the large silver-white building grew smaller and smaller through the rear-view mirror.

Ji Yushi rested his head against his seat. The air-conditioning in the car was quite refreshing.

But his ears were still hot.

Song Qinglan's words were of course not what he thought he meant but this straight man who had only recently become bent seemed to have a special ability to say things too ambiguously, making others start thinking too much.

"I've escaped singlehood." Ji Yushi suddenly said.

"What?" Ji Minyue was caught by surprise so he didn't hear him clearly, "What did you say?"

Ji Yushi, "I'm dating."

Ji Minyue almost ran a red light when he heard this. He changed the car into automatic driving mode and then turned to ask, “You? Dating? When did it happen? Is the other party in Ning City? Would they be worried after you disappeared for a whole month?”

“It’s Song Qinglan.” Ji Yushi said, “The person you were talking about earlier, captain of Jiang City’s seventh squad.”

Ji Minyue recalled, “But wasn’t he a homophobic straight man?!”

Ji Yushi, “Bent.”

Ji Minyue was dumbfounded for a few seconds. He slapped his thigh, “You have skills!”

\*

The car that Ji Yushi had used to come to Jiang City had already been driven back by Ji Minyue so they went straight to the Ji residence. Along the way, Ji Minyue picked up a call from home. Aunt Su had personally cooked up a table of food in order to welcome Ji Yushi’s safe return.

Just like last time when he returned to the Ji residence in the bubble world, the courtyard was filled with flowers.

Just like when he was a child, Ji Yushi passed by the hand-carved rabbits placed on the front porch. This place was filled with memories.

For the people here, they were only gone for a month.

For the people in the seventh squad, it felt like a lifetime.

Ji Minyue walked ahead with Ji Yushi following him.

Aunt Su came out of the kitchen wearing an apron. When she saw Ji Yushi, she was distressed, “Jian Jian, you’ve lost weight! Has it been difficult for you this past month?”

“Auntie.” Ji Yushi stretched out his arms and took the initiative to embrace his adoptive mother.

“It’s good that you’re back.” Aunt Su patted his back. Her voice was a little choked. She had always been the emotional type. She hurriedly suppressed her emotions, “Teacher is upstairs. Having been gone for a month, he’s not in a good mood. Be good, go and coax him.”

Familiar words. The scenes that had already happened once in the bubble world played again. It was different but there were also similarities.

That world was derived from their real world so encountering something like this was something Ji Yushi had expected.

He closed his eyes and didn’t say anything. He took some time to digest it all.

This time, Professor Ji was also waiting in the study. Seeing Ji Yushi knock and enter, he turned off the holographic projection and pushed up his glasses, “I heard you violated the regulations and acted on your own?”

Chief Lin and Professor Ji were good friends, so it was natural for Professor Ji to be well informed.

A father knows their son best. As soon as the news that Ji Yushi returned later than the others reached Professor Ji’s ears, he didn’t have to think to know where he must have gone.

Ji Yushi stood before the table with his eyes half lowered. He clearly knew that he was wrong.

But Professor Ji knew that although this child may know that he was wrong, he wouldn’t necessarily correct it, just like when he went behind Professor Ji’s back to join Tianqiong as a Recorder and even incited Ji Minyue to help deceive him.

Sure enough, Ji Yushi said, “It’s not entirely a violation of the regulations.”

Professor Ji placed the transparent panel aside, “Tell me.”

Ji Yushi, “You may have heard about the Tianqiong parent system?”

Professor Ji nodded.

Ji Yushi continued, “In addition to declaring itself as the parent system, it also claims to be the ‘Tianqiong of all eras’.”

Professor Ji waited for him to continue.

“We completed a lot of high-level missions it had prepared.” Ji Yushi only briefly touched on this and then moved onto the main point, “After achieving the objectives, it gave a reward. Perhaps the association itself had not yet recognised Tianqiong’s ability to give rewards but it indeed has this authority so it cannot be considered as going completely against the regulations. It’s just a matter of time before they recognise this.”

Professor Ji finally spoke, “But you wasted this reward.”

He had returned to that year where the nightmares began but hadn’t done anything.

All those years of hard work may have all become nothing, but he chose to let go.

Ji Yushi was silent.

“You must have found a more suitable method.” Professor Ji said, “Jian Jian, I’m very happy to hear this, you are stronger than I thought. These shackles of yours cannot be removed by others, but by yourself. You haven’t become a prisoner of time. I am glad.”

Ji Yushi said, “I still have to go back.”

Professor Ji nodded, “Of course. I just don’t know if your actions would affect the points you had gathered until now....”

“It’s okay.” Ji Yushi raised his eyes, “If it’s affected, I can just start again.”

Since he was a child, Ji Yushi had always been introverted and calm. He almost never had a child's naivety, and it was also rare seeing him passionate about something. His visit to Jiang City this time had brought about a lot of changes. The look in his eyes was something Professor Ji had never seen before. Professor Ji's eyes couldn't help but dampen with relief.

Not noticing the other person's emotional changes, Ji Yushi pulled over a stool and sat down, "Teacher, let me borrow your pen."

Professor Ji took out a pen from his drawer and gave it to him, "Why?"

"A pen and paper is safer." Ji Yushi received the pen and then found a notebook on the table, "When I was completing a mission, I met someone."

The pen made a few swishing sounds as it slid across the paper.

In a few strokes, Ji Yushi managed to draw out an outline of someone relying on his memory. With the addition of some details, the picture of a middle-aged man appeared on the paper. His face was round, slightly chubby, and he looked rather gentle.

When he was done, he tore it off and gave it to Professor Ji, "Look, have you seen this more than ten years ago?"

More than ten years ago? Professor Ji fell into thought.

Ji Yushi had gone to complete a Guardian mission this time so he should be travelling ahead in time and space, but he had met someone from more than ten years ago. This goes to show that time and space of different points had intersected at some point.

This matter involved the stability of time and space. Even if he was curious, Professor Ji didn't ask about it. He just received the paper and carefully recalled.

After a while, Professor Ji shook his head, "I haven't seen him. Do you have any other information?"

Ji Yushi said, "He may be my father's colleague."

Professor Ji frowned and tried to remember, but it was to no avail, “Back then, the small group fell apart and several of them lost contact. My specialty was also different from your fathers so there are many of his colleagues that I have never met before. I can however save this photo and let Old Lin take a look. Perhaps he would know something.”

“Okay.” Ji Yushi was a little disappointed, but it was very fleeting, “Thank you.”

Having met his teacher, Ji Yushi got ready to go downstairs.

After reaching the end of the corridor, he suddenly stopped in place.

This was the room he had stayed in from when he was a child until he became an adult. It had been a long time since he entered.

Opening the door, a familiar calming scent entered his nose.

When he was away, Aunt Su had continued to keep this place clean, hoping that he could stay here when he returns.

The room faced south, and the lighting was very good. Outside the balcony was a lush forest — When he first came here, the Ji family had left the best and most comfortable room in the house for him.

The four walls were densely covered with numbers.

When he was a child, he had written an endless sequence of Fibonacci numbers in order to calm himself down.

Standing on the wooden floor, countless afterimages of himself in this room appeared.

The him hunched up and curled up in the corner, the him lying on the floor staring up at the ceiling all night, the him who finally fell asleep in Aunt Su’s arms on a rainy night, the him suffering from memory overload, no longer able to distinguish between memory and reality and no longer able to speak.....



Those young figures walked back and forth around him. Ji Yushi who stood in the centre allowed the memories to travel through time.

Nothing had changed.

But at the same time, everything seemed to have changed.

Ji Yushi walked over to the balcony. He looked up and took in the light breeze and sun.

He still had many things he had to do but at this moment, there was a strong emotion surging inside him, making him want to express it.

Ji Minyue happened to be passing by under the balcony. He shouted, “Hey, Xiao Ji, missing your boyfriend?”

Ji Yushi opened his eyes. Seeing Ji Minyue carrying a cat carrier, he smiled and turned around and went downstairs.

There was a black cat in the cat carrier.

Ji Yushi hesitated for a moment, “This is Middle Black?”

Ji Minyue, “Don’t tell me you can’t recognise it! They’re just a little fatter!”

The black cat looked at him through the mesh, letting out soft mews. It was clearly acting spoiled.

The three cats were all black. He really had some trouble recognising it despite being someone who could tell Tang Qi and Tang Le apart accurately. He wondered, “How come all the cats you raise become so fat?”

“What do you mean all?! You’re body discriminating!” Ji Minyue was done, “This wasn’t raised by me. It was under the care of Chief Lin and was only just sent over. I was also shocked when I saw it. Chief Lin probably spoiled it too much and gave it too much dried fish.”

Ji Yushi was surprised, “Why did Chief Lin help raise the cat?”

Ji Minyue announced proudly, “I got a new corgi.”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

Even this point was the same as the bubble world?

“Middle Black didn’t get along with the dog and I originally planned to send it home for Old Ji to raise but when Chief Lin saw it, he took it home instead. When he heard that you came back, he couldn’t bear parting with it.” Ji Minyue said, “Big Black and Little Black are still with me. Your sister-in-law has already taken them to be washed and will bring them over after work later today.”

When Ji Yushi opened the cat carrier, the cat immediately cried sweetly and jumped into his arms.

It was fragrant and warm. The black cat’s shiny hair brushed against Ji Yushi’s clear face, making him reveal a rare gentle look.

Ji Minyue watched them act intimate and added, “Actually, it might not be Middle Black. You should check the chip and make sure there isn’t a mistake.”

Ji Yushi who was cuddling the cat, “?”

Ji Minyue complained, “Speaking honestly, your three cats all look exactly the same. Except for you, the only ones who can distinguish between them must be gods!”

## Chapter 84: Chapter 84

After having dinner at the Ji residence, Ji Yushi took along Middle Black as well as Big Black and Little Black who had been brought over by his sister-in-law and drove back to his place.

The three cat carriers were placed on the back seats and the cats would from time to time let out soft meows. Every time Ji Yushi went out with the cats, it was like he was dragging along with him an entire pet store.

Parking the car in the underground parking lot, he carried one bag on his back and one in each hand.

Ji Yushi entered the elevator and just happened to run into the neighbourhood aunt who had returned from a walk.

“Xiao Ji!” The other party greeted him enthusiastically when she saw him, “Got back from a business trip? You’ve been away for a long time!”

Ji Yushi nodded politely, “Yes.”

The neighbourhood aunt kindly helped him hold one of the carriers and waited until Ji Yushi was done opening his door before leaving.

Ji Yushi released the cats from the carriers. All three cats ran to every corner of the place with little strides. Small purrs could be heard coming from their throats.

Ji Yushi endured for a few seconds but couldn’t help but get up and look out through the peephole on the door.

The lights were still on in the quiet corridor outside but there was no one standing in front of his place staring at his door. The corridor was

completely empty.

He let out a long sigh of relief.

The cats were hungry.

Just like usual, Ji Yushi cleaned three cat food bowls and poured cat food into them before moving on to pour out new cat litter. Once he was done, he entered the bathroom and took a bath to relax.

Reason, fear and panic. It all gave Ji Yushi a headache.

Since returning to Ning City, various sensory, psychological and physical sensations had made him confused and at loss. He soaked in the bathtub, immersed in warm water. Even after more than ten minutes, his thoughts were still unable to turn for the better.

Fortunately, after more than ten years of this, he had become very used to this feeling.

With the splashing of water, Ji Yushi got up and took out the medicine he had prepared from inside the mirror cabinet.

There wasn't much left.

Before leaving for Jiang City, he had filled his medicine box and taken it with him. As for that medicine box.....it was still with Song Qinglan.

Perhaps their hearts were linked, just as Ji Yushi took out a pill, a phone call came.

The display on the mirror cabinet showed a string of numbers — Although he had only seen it once, Ji Yushi remembered that this string of numbers was Song Qinglan's phone number.

The two hadn't contacted each other after saying goodbye at Jiang City and it had been a whole day since then. Despite just confirming their relationship, Ji Yushi didn't have the self-consciousness to be clingy with

the other party. Even if Song Qinglan contacted him a few days later, he probably wouldn't have minded.

But the moment this number appeared, he once again realised that he had started a relationship. His heart felt warm inside.

Ji Yushi: "Hello?"

Song Qinglan's voice came from the other end. It was only three short words, "Open the door."

The pleasant male voice echoed in the bathroom. Through the phone, it travelled across from Jiang City to Ning City.

Ji Yushi wasn't able to react, "What?"

Song Qinglan seemed to have laughed. He then said, "I ordered takeaway for you. It should be almost there. You should open the door to receive it."

Ji Yushi was stunned for a moment. He answered 'okay' and then hung up and quickly dried himself.

Not wanting the other person to wait too long, he put on his bathrobe and quickly walked over to the door. He habitually looked through the peephole to confirm the identity of the visitor.

Please read this from kk translates

His view however was blocked by a pile of boxes and bags. The visitor was patiently waiting while holding the pile of items.

Ji Yushi immediately opened the door, "Sorry for the ....."

"Sorry for what?"

The familiar voice that was heard through the phone earlier sounded, cutting off his words.

The person holding the boxes and bags was tall and his features were deep.

Ji Yushi this time was completely stunned.

Song Qinglan's dark eyes stared at Ji Yushi, "Sorry for hanging up on your boyfriend and captain when you heard about the takeaway?"

Ji Yushi couldn't hide the surprise on his face, "Why are you here? Weren't you going to see your family?"

Song Qinglan strode in, "Just showing my face is enough. They're all busy flying around the world, why would they need me to accompany them?"

Ji Yushi closed the door and quickly followed behind Song Qinglan. He helped him set the things down onto the ground.

"What's more, I also feel uneasy at home." Song Qinglan continued the topic from just now. He spoke in a playful tone, "I always feel that if I don't come and check, a certain someone would run away."

Ji Yushi, ".....It's not to that extent."

With a previous record next to his name, he knew that his words were not convincing.

"Who knows?" Song Qinglan was still wearing the same clothes he wore when they parted this morning and hadn't had the time to change, "You ran away last time in the span of two minutes. It has been more than ten hours now so I have to hurry over to show my presence so that you would want to stay with me."

The air-conditioning in the room was sufficient.

When Song Qinglan came, he seemed to have brought along with him the hustle and bustle outside as well as the hot summer heat.

His unconcealed and innate overbearing presence made this place and made Ji Yushi's world, feel a lot livelier.

It didn't feel like anything when they parted.

But after more than ten hours and now finally seeing the other person right before their eyes, they only now realised how much they missed each other.

Ji Yushi was only wearing a bathrobe with the belt loosely tied around his waist. He had a towel draped across his shoulders and his hair was still wet. It was clear that he had just taken a bath. His eyes looked like they had just been immersed with water, it was particularly clean and clear.

His entire being appeared defenseless.

Song Qinglan's throat bobbed. He suddenly said, "I'm dirty."

These words that spoken without context left Ji Yushi confused, "Huh?"

"I want to hug you." Song Qinglan looked down at him. His tone was very forbearing, "But I went to a lot of places today."

Ji Yushi liked cleanliness. He was even unhappy when he was wrapped in a dirty blanket despite almost freezing to death. Unbeknownst by others, the moment he heard the words 'want to hug you', his heart started beating chaotically inside.

"Shoosh——"

A soft sound attracted Song Qinglan's attention.

He looked over and saw a black shadow lightly jump onto the cat tower. It was a completely black cat. Looking more closely, there were two more bright eyes glistening under the cabinet. At some point in time, these cats had quietly come out of their hiding places, secretly observing the stranger.

Something brushed against his calf. Song Qinglan looked down and saw that there was another black cat by their feet.

The cat was completely black with no other colour mixed in. It was the type that could perfectly conceal itself in the dark. Its two eyes were large and round and looked amber under the lights. At this moment, it was using its tail to gently brush against their calves in attempt to get their attention and to also keep an eye on this human who had just entered its territory.

The three cats and Ji Yushi seemed to match very well.

“I seemed to have entered a cat nest.” Knowing was different from seeing it with his own eyes. Seeing these ‘three boyfriends’, Song Qinglan was both angry and amused, “Three boyfriends?”

Song Qinglan picked up the black cat by his feet. It didn’t move nor did it struggle. Instead, it let out a meow like it was acting coquettish.

“Not afraid of people.” One human and one cat assessed each other. Song Qinglan grumbled, “Which one is the one that would often press you down all night, making it difficult to breathe?”

Big Black was usually the timider one. When it saw Song Qinglan, it however became very intimate, surprising even Ji Yushi, “If I don’t close the bedroom door when I sleep, all three could do it.”

Big Black seemed to be very comfortable receiving Song Qinglan’s pets. Song Qinglan had only petted it a few times and it had already let out a comfortable purr. It was sure clingy and cute.

The big guy’s loving heart was instantly activated. Song Qinglan opened the cardboard box he had brought over and pulled out some snacks for Big Black, “What number is this boyfriend?”

“Number one.” Ji Yushi said, “It’s called Big Black.”

“What, are the other two Middle Black and Little Black?” Song Qinglan asked. Seeing Ji Yushi nod, he laughed, “You named them too casually.”

“Names are just a title.” Ji Yushi answered, “Doesn’t matter what they’re called.”

Inside the cardboard box Song Qinglan brought over, half of them were toys and snacks for the cats. According to him, he should give his ‘predecessors’ something for their first meeting. The rest of the box as well as the bags were things he had bought for Ji Yushi.



Song Qinglan sorted everything out and then packed them away as directed by Ji Yushi.

The normally domineering Cap Song didn't seem to have any awkwardness when doing the housework and even seemed to be pretty good at it. He filled Ji Yushi's fridge and arranged everything neatly.

"Why did you buy so much?" Ji Yushi asked from behind him.

"Your fridge is the most pitiful fridge I've ever seen." Song Qinglan said, "Don't you remember the expired eggs last time?"

Ji Yushi: "....."

How could he forget.

These things were bought in Jiang City and then brought over by Song Qinglan. Although they could actually be bought here in Ning City by Ji Yushi, he knew that this was different.

Something like this usually happened when Ji Minyue or Aunt Su came.

Ji Minyue was someone with OCD (obsessive-compulsive disorder). When he left the Ji residence today, he had even said that he would send over supplies for Ji Yushi so that he wouldn't starve to death at home.

While Song Qinglan sorted everything out, Ji Yushi sent a message to Ji Minyue: [No need to send food over tomorrow.]

Ji Minyue: [Why? You want to starve?]

Ji Yushi couldn't be bothered typing it out. He directly took a photo of the kitchen.

Under the warm-toned light, a man much taller than the fridge held the fridge door with one hand as he checked to see if anything was missing. The fridge was clearly a rather big one, but it looked like a toy next to him. The light reached his side profile, accentuating his firm outlines. Any photo

taken at this moment would be a perfect front cover photo on a lifestyle magazine.

Ji Minyue: [My bad.]

Ji Minyue: [Wait a minute, are you two going to sleep together tonight?! Can you do it?]

After sending the photo, Ji Yushi promptly saved it as well.

After saving it, he saw Ji Minyue's message and expressionlessly responded: [Already slept.]

Following that, he turned off his phone and no longer looked at Ji Minyue's yellow messages. (KKnotes: Messages of an erotic/sexual nature)

With everything sorted, he approached Song Qinglan, "Do you need to shower?"

\*

The sound of water stopped.

Song Qinglan left the bathroom while drying his hair. The towel in his hand was pulled and his head was suddenly pulled down.

Ji Yushi directly kissed him.

Song Qinglan almost didn't hesitate. He immediately turned the situation around and pressed the other person against the wall.

There was no hesitation or shame. Unlike the state ordinary young couples would be in when they first get together, when two men are together, they are rather direct.

The kiss was somewhat intense and filled with male hormones.

Please read this from kk translates

“Tongue, covered in taste buds, an organ humans use to taste and form speech. At the same time, it is also the most powerful muscle in the whole body.” This line made a rather untimely appearance in Ji Yushi’s mind. As if it was being demonstrated to him, it stimulated all his senses. He responded desperately to the other party’s invasion.

Song Qinglan became more and more fierce. The arms around Ji Yushi’s waist tightened even more, causing Ji Yushi some pain.

In the quiet room, all the small sounds were infinitely amplified. Everything could be heard very clearly.

He was like a wild beast breaking into Ji Yushi’s private space. All the politeness from earlier was gone and all that was on his mind was to take possession of the person before him.

His kisses travelled down. With half-closed eyes, Ji Yushi tilted his head back. His slender neck was dazzlingly fair.

When his earlobe was kissed, his fingers couldn’t help but grasp tightly onto Song Qinglan’s hair as a sound leaked out from his lips.

Hearing it, Song Qinglan’s entire body stiffened. He then proceeded to wordlessly pick up the other person.

Ji Yushi clung tightly onto Song Qinglan’s shoulders. He didn’t dare look at his eyes because he knew that they must be just like his — filled with desire.

The towel Song Qinglan used to dry his hair fell to the ground, almost making them trip. It was then kicked far away, startling the cat at the end of the hallway.

“Meow!”

The cat cry sounded a little lonely when it suddenly sounded in the quiet room.

Just like when they almost drowned last time, Ji Yushi clung onto Song Qinglan like a koala clinging to a piece of driftwood to survive.

Unfamiliar with his way and also unable to see, Song Qinglan stumbled around.

Only the nightlight was on in the bedroom. It was the same as what Song Qinglan remembered.

The sheets seemed to have just been changed. Song Qinglan smelt the nice fragrance of detergent as soon as he placed the other person down on it.

“You just changed the sheets?” Song Qinglan asked as he pressed him down from above.

“Mhn.” The collar of Ji Yushi’s bathrobe had loosened, revealing his fair collarbone. He hooked his beautiful hands around Song Qinglan’s neck. It was as if his eyes could speak.

Song Qinglan let out a low laugh. He pulled the two long legs up next to his waist and leaned down again to continue to kiss that was cut off earlier.

The kiss this time held a different meaning compared to the one earlier.

Song Qinglan hadn’t put on a shirt yet and was only wearing a pair of shorts Ji Yushi had found for him. His broad chest and defined abdominal muscles gave off an almost honey-like lustre under the orange nightlight—  
Unbeknownst to the others, in terms of appearance, personality and abilities, Song Qinglan was completely Ji Yushi’s ideal type. It was as if he was moulded directly to fit his preferences.

His hands moved down.

It reached the elastic band and traced along the mermaid lines.

Song Qinglan suddenly grabbed his hand. Whilst breathing heavily, he bit his earlobe and warned, “Are you sure?”

“Can’t touch?” Ji Yushi’s face was completely flushed. He was no longer his usual cold state, but he still asked calmly, “Can you do it?”

He wanted Song Qinglan to know that gays like them don’t date platonically.

Song Qinglan pressed his arms above his head, He was not only angered, he also narrowed his eyes, “Advisor Ji, you’ve turned bad.”

“I,” Ji Yushi’s heart was beating wildly and his body was burning hot, “....You’ve forgotten. I have never been a good person in the first place.”

When Song Qinglan heard this, he felt that it was true.

He originally hadn’t planned on doing anything but now he changed his mind. He wanted to teach this Advisor Ji who is covered in thorns how to be a good person.

Song Qinglan didn’t say much and just slammed against him hard, almost making Ji Yushi jump up. After reacting, Ji Yushi sent him a glare.

Following that, Ji Yushi’s waist suddenly felt weak.

Song Qinglan had done the same thing as him.

He asked calmly, “Can’t touch? Can you do it?”

In an instant, everything faded away.

Ji Yushi felt like his ears were immersed in water and nothing could be heard clearly.

.....

The bathrobe fell away completely. He bent his legs and could feel heat spreading throughout his body. Looking up at the snow-white ceiling, his mind had also gone completely blank.

He felt his hand being pulled away and pressed onto something hot. Song Qinglan's voice was low and hoarse, "Help me out."

# Chapter 85: Chapter 85

## Our Reality

### Chapter 85

How to help?

Ji Yushi only felt that his fingers and palms were hot, making him hardly dare touch let alone hold it.

“Ji Yushi.” Song Qinglan sounded like he was enduring with difficulty, but he still couldn’t help but tease, “You don’t know how?”

Ji Yushi, “Mhn.”

Song Qinglan immediately understood.

He gently held the other person’s pale hands, covering the back of their hand with his palm, and his voice became even hoarser, “Just....like this.”

....Like this.

Ji Yushi didn’t have much strength left and his arms were limp. If it wasn’t for Song Qinglan guiding him, even his five fingers would have been unable to exert strength.

His heart was pounding loudly. It was even faster than when he finished off just now. The pounding in his ears felt like it was almost about to burst through his eardrums. The sensation coming from his palm was too terrifying. He laid on his back looking up. Although he actually wanted to take a look, he still covered his eyes with his arm.

After all, this was his first time doing this kind of thing. He was not much better than Song Qinglan.

They had been together for less than three days.

Were they progressing too quickly?

It was like a dream.

Ji Yushi belatedly had this thought surface in his mind when his arm was pulled away.

Song Qinglan lowered his head, his eyes heavy and deep, “Will you remember?”

“Remember what?” As soon as Ji Yushi spoke, he discovered that his voice was also very hoarse. It only contained the aftermath of just now, and also some shame.

Suddenly, and with some force, Song Qinglan’s body gave him a demonstration.

Ji Yushi’s palm felt like it was about to catch fire.

He immediately understood, “.....No!”

Song Qinglan released his hand, but he didn’t show any signs of finishing.

This time Ji Yushi could see it clearly. Blood instantly boiled inside him, and his entire body was burning from head to toe. Before he could turn his head away, he was lifted up by the waist by Song Qinglan.

“You will.” Song Qinglan panted. He brushed away the hair sticking to his sweaty forehead. Once his breathing calmed down slightly, he pressed the tip of his nose against Ji Yushi’s and rubbed against it affectionately, “How I kiss you, hug you, where and what I do, you will remember every detail, unable to forget. Isn’t that right?”

Everything Song Qinglan said was a fact.



At least, with regard to the kiss they shared in the private training room, the memories from that time would resurface again and again without a warning.

Ji Yushi's face was completely red, but his tone was cold: "Yeah, including sore hands."

"Then," Song Qinglan couldn't help laughing. He kissed his chin, "Help me a little more, just a little longer."

Ji Yushi: ".....Can I take a break?"

Song Qinglan begged in a low voice, "The arrow is already on the bow. Xiao Ji, please have mercy."

Sitting on Song Qinglan's lap like this, it was actually quite uncomfortable for Ji Yushi.

The loose bathrobe hung loosely from his body, covering everything except for his long legs and shoulders. His hand lowered again, ".....Mhn."

.....

"Advisor Ji, go wash your hands."

Song Qinglan kissed his ear like he was coaxing him and even deliberately spoke seriously.

Everywhere was a mess. The bed was crumpled to no end and clothes were strewn messily across the floor.

There was the sound of a cat scratching at the door.

It was unknown which 'predecessor' had been attracted over by the fierce battle just now.

Ji Yushi sprawled against Song Qinglan's shoulder without any shame. He didn't want to move, "Want to change the sheets."

Song Qinglan, “You even don’t like your own?”

Ji Yushi, “Yeah, and it has yours too.”

Song Qinglan laughed, “In that case, it looks like you’re not that averse towards me.”

He picked up Ji Yushi’s bathrobe and helped wipe him down first so that this person who liked cleanliness would feel a little better.

He then said, “You go wash. I’ll change the sheets.”

\*

Ji Yushi not only washed his hands, but he also took another shower. When he looked in the mirror, he saw that he had some marks on his body. They were probably left by Song Qinglan when he didn’t control his strength well. The two had no experience and they clearly hadn’t gone all the way but everything looked rather erotic and sensual when they were done, as if they really had done everything that could be done.

Helping each other out was actually nothing. Ji Yushi originally thought more would have happened.

But he had to admit that Song Qinglan’s restraint made this relationship progress at a perfect rate.

Everything was just right.

The one scratching the door was Little Black.

It was the timidest one. When Ji Yushi left the bathroom, it meowed as if it had been wronged.

Ji Yushi picked it up, petted it, fed it some snacks brought over by Song Qinglan and then returned to the room.

The smell in the room was strong.

After Song Qinglan changed the sheets, he had opened the window, but the room still faintly smelt a little despite the ventilation.

Seeing him come in, Song Qinglan let him sit down and then naturally took over the job of drying his hair with a towel.

“How many years have you lived alone?” Song Qinglan asked.

Song Qinglan had already washed his hands and found Ji Yushi’s beach shorts to wear — It was the one he had worn to the beach when he was seventeen, the one Song Qinglan saw him wear in the transfer station. It wasn’t that there weren’t any clothes he could wear; Ji Minyue was large enough and Ji Yushi had some of his clothes, but Song Qinglan was unwilling to wear them.

Ji Yushi, “In two months it’ll be eight years. I moved out after graduating high school.”

The two had already talked about Ji Yushi’s matters before but they had only touched on it.

Song Qinglan wasn’t in the position to ask more about it back then and now that he was able to, he wanted to know everything about Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi didn’t seem to have many friends, and he also rarely mentioned his family.

Even where he lived, he only had three cats accompanying him. Remembering that the other person had come to Jiang City alone, Song Qinglan felt very uncomfortable inside and even felt a little distressed for the Ji Yushi at the time.

Hearing this answer, Song Qinglan’s actions stopped, “Why?”

He thought of a possibility and asked, “Was the adoptive family not good to you? Or you couldn’t get used to it?”

“Neither. They treat me very well.” Ji Yushi grabbed his wrist and got him to sit down, “I moved out because I wanted to secretly join Tianqiong

behind my family's back.”

There was a red mark behind Ji Yushi's ear.

He probably hadn't noticed it himself, but it was very obvious from Song Qinglan's angle. That cold and distant person with a fresh kiss mark on his pale skin, it made Song Qinglan's throat dry.

“Secretly join Tianqiong?”

Song Qinglan continued to dry Ji Yushi's hair while sitting down.

Ji Yushi made a sound of affirmation. He told him the reason, “My teacher, who is also my adoptive father, as well as my adoptive mother are against me being involved with work related to ‘time’ and even my university majors cannot be related so they would naturally be against me joining Tianqiong. I used the excuse of moving out to have more peace and quiet and at the same time deliberately enrolled in more majors to pretend to be busy, but I was in fact preparing to join Tianqiong the entire time. With Ji Minyue covering for me, it went well.”

It seems that Ji Yushi can lie very well.

Except for Song Qinglan, everyone else would have probably been deceived by his appearance and thus fooled by him.

Song Qinglan frowned, “Why didn't they want you involved with work relating to ‘time’?”

Ji Yushi was silent for a moment.

He then raised his head and said to Song Qinglan, “I had a period of cognitive dysfunction when I was a child.”

Song Qinglan's actions completely stopped.

Ji Yushi didn't speak with any pessimism and just spoke of the facts like a bystander, “Including learning disability, not being able to speak or recognise people and the likes, I couldn't distinguish between my memory

and reality. That is to say, I didn't know what had already happened and what had never happened. With reality and memory playing at the same time in my mind, it caused me to make repeated actions, be unable to recognise familiar things and be unable to understand what others were saying."

".....How long?"

Song Qinglan's voice sounded like gravel grinding against each other.

"You don't have to worry. It's all in the past."

Ji Yushi grabbed his hand and gently squeezed it. His eyes were half lowered, "About three years."

"The doctors in the Paediatric Department all said that my situation was hopeless, that I would probably never be able to escape from the shadows. What's more, the caudate nucleus and frontal lobe had some abnormalities resulting in me being unable to distinguish reality yet be able to clearly remember everything that happened since I was an infant. Teacher is a psychologist and a good friend of my father's. After adopting me, he quit his job and spend three years at home with me together with my adoptive mother."

As long as it is something I have experienced, it doesn't make any difference whether I have experienced it once or countless times. In other words, I am just like you. I am going through this again after the first time.

— Song Qinglan suddenly remembered the words Ji Yushi said to him at the bookstore.

The seemingly plain description, the seemingly insignificant illness.

Some even jokingly called it a superpower.

No one knew how much torment must have been concealed behind those words.

That was why Ji Yushi once said that without his teacher, there wouldn't be the current him.

Song Qinglan understood: "They were against you joining Tianqiong because they were afraid of you being involved with work related to 'time' and your condition relapsing."

Ji Yushi, "Yes."

The two hands held each other more tightly.

Song Qinglan couldn't help but ask, "Then, have you had anything similar happen again after that?"

Before they met, Ji Yushi had alone completed 89 B-level missions, so he had gone back to the past at least 89 times. This was even excluding the ones which required him to go back several times.

Unlike Guardians, in order to minimise their presence in history, Recorders do not work in a team and would always act alone. If anything went wrong with Ji Yushi during those times.....Song Qinglan didn't dare think about it.

"Occasionally, but it wasn't serious." Ji Yushi responded, "When we repeated Ouroboros the first time, I once suspected that it was a case of memory overload."

Song Qinglan's expression changed.

At that time, outside the park management office, he had even specially found Ji Yushi to talk and questioned rather critically Ji Yushi's psychological endurance.

Ji Yushi's answer was — "It might not be so good."

After he left, Ji Yushi was the last to reach the park management office. His face was very pale and he had asked Song Qinglan to help twist open a bottle cap.

Regardless of whether Ji Yushi would really have difficulty opening a bottle with his combative abilities, everyone at the time shared the same thought and felt that Ji Yushi was so weak that he couldn't even open a bottle.

The more he thought about it, the darker Song Qinglan's expression became. His heart felt like there was a tear in it.

What he owed from that time had sure enough returned to bite him.

"Your medicine." Song Qinglan quickly thought of something, "Your medicine is not only used to clear your thoughts and refresh your mind, but you are also dependent on it, isn't that right?"

Ji Yushi silently acquiesced.

He had always carried the box of medicine around with him, never leaving his side.

Relying on these pills, he could reduce the number of occasions his memories would replay in his mind and reduce the repetitive dreams, allowing him to fall asleep more easily.

But there were also quite a lot of side effects that followed. In addition to dependence, there was also his face becoming pale, sudden weakness as well as sudden feeling of despair and other negative emotions.

Song Qinglan's voice was low, "When I called you just now, you were about to take the medicine."

Ji Yushi was startled.

How did Song Qinglan know?

But he soon remembered that Song Qinglan had gone to the bathroom to shower after packing everything away. He probably saw the bottle of medicine he had left on the counter.

Song Qinglan got out of bed and went to the bathroom. When he returned, he had the bottle of medicine in his hand.

He asked, “Have you taken one tonight yet?”

Ji Yushi said, “Haven’t taken it yet.”

Song Qinglan sat back down on the edge of the bed, causing the mattress to sink. Along the way, he reached out and pulled Ji Yushi over.

Men shouldn’t be so clingy like this, but he still insisted on holding Ji Yushi like he was some sort of treasure.

Ji Yushi sat in his lap a little awkwardly with his arms around Song Qinglan’s neck.

Seeing his serious expression, he lowered his head and kissed him “Why?”

Song Qinglan, “It seems that I was right to take your medicine.”

Ji Yushi had a bad feeling, “.....”

Sure enough, Song Qinglan said, “I’ll hold onto this bottle of medicine first. When you really need it, you can take it. Let’s not abuse it too much. You should try becoming less dependent on it.”

Ji Yushi put up some struggle, “I don’t always take it. I didn’t take much in Rubik’s Cube.”

It was better if he hadn’t mentioned it.

As soon as this was mentioned, Song Qinglan’s face became even darker.

In Rubik’s Cube, Ji Yushi had not only refused to listen to dissuasion and insisted on clearing the mission, making him go through room after room in search for him, but after the mission was cleared, he even ran off without a word with no intentions to return.

Under the influence of the medicine, a calm person would suddenly become resolute. The consequences were unimaginable.



“No.” Song Qinglan said, “Advisor Ji, you now have family. In the future, your family will have the final say on this matter.”

# Chapter 86: Chapter 86

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 86

The first rays of morning light entered the room through the sheer curtains.

The person on the bed was disturbed by the light. His quietly dormant eyelashes quivered slightly, and the person then frowned. He still hadn't woken yet, but he didn't sleep as well as before.

He had slept late last night but Song Qinglan on the other hand had already maintained a habit of getting up early for many years. He lightly got out of bed, adjusted the position of his pillow, and then picked up the pillow which had fallen onto the ground last night and similarly stacked it up to block the light falling onto Ji Yushi's face. After ten or so minutes, this ray of light would move onto the wall beside the bed and no longer disturb him.

Ji Yushi didn't sleep well, but he didn't use blackout curtains. This was a sign of insecurity.

Coupled with the fact that he lived alone, for someone who couldn't fall asleep in the dark, perhaps he didn't like waking up in the dark even more.

Song Qinglan quietly left the bedroom and closed the door behind him.

The three cats in the living room quickly fled. They hid in their hiding places, observing this outsider.

The food bowls were all empty.

Song Qinglan found the cat food and filled the bowls up before going to wash up.

Once he was done, the ‘predecessors’ seemed to no longer be that scared of him.

Pitch-black, briquette-like balls of fluff walked around him while keeping their distance.

Song Qinglan began to warm up.

He wasn’t the type with bulging muscles and was instead the type with a rather slender body with every part of his body in perfect proportion. He didn’t usually pursue strength training, so the usual push-ups and abdominal crunches was enough to achieve his goal of waking up his body every morning, regardless of the location.

In Ji Yushi’s living room, apart from sofa and books, there was also an open space for Song Qinglan to use.

Just as he officially started working out, the cats had already sat down one by one next to each other, following his movements with their heads tilted in curiosity.

This was the first morning Song Qinglan experienced of Ji Yushi’s life after they officially started dating.

Quiet and relaxed, everything was perfect.

After he was done working out, he beckoned to the cats. One of the black cats tentatively walked over. As soon as Song Qinglan scratched its chin, it could no longer maintain its aloof attitude and completely succumbed to him.

Pets were like their owners. After determining that this outsider could be trusted, it softened and allowed Song Qinglan to carry it to the kitchen.

The fridge was filled with food.

Song Qinglan found the ingredients he needed and piled them all onto the countertop before putting the cat back down.

The cat didn't go and just stood on the countertop, watching him.

Song Qinglan gently ushered it away again and this time it finally jumped off.

But when Song Qinglan returned after leaving to retrieve milk from the fridge, a cat was sitting on the countertop again.

Sunlight also spilled into the kitchen, falling onto the various kitchenware and sink. The black fur on the cat's body was glowing. It lowered its head curiously, nudged each of the food items one by one with its nose and then meowed in doubt, as if wondering since when did this family start making breakfast.

Song Qinglan hooked up his lips and rubbed its head, "Why are you up here again?"

Black cat: "Meow?"

At the same time, there was a cat cry from next to his feet, "Meow~"

Song Qinglan looked down. The cat on the ground was rubbing against his leg, showing intimacy. He understood at once that the cat on the countertop wasn't the one earlier. The one on the ground was.

The doorbell rang.

The cat on the countertop lightly jumped to the ground and, with the addition of the black cat who was hiding who knows where, three black shadows quickly ran down the hallway.

A guest?

Song Qinglan placed down the things in his hands and followed the cats out.

As if these cats knew who came, they looked up and meowed with excitement.

Ji Yushi was woken by the doorbell. He stood at the door to his bedroom with a grey nightgown casually thrown on. He saw Song Qinglan and said, “Our morning is gone.”

His expression was lazy and there were still red marks on his face from his sleep.

His voice contained the usual coldness but there was an obvious hint of complaint as well.

Song Qinglan walked over and pulled the person into his arms, “Not awake yet?”

The doorbell rang again. There was also the vague sound of a dog barking.

The person outside seemed to be very patient.

Ji Yushi sighed. He said helplessly, “It’s my brother. He has the code to the door. He came to see you.”

\*

As soon as Ji Minyue entered the door with his dog, Middle Black entered a fighting stance and hissed from a high location. Sure enough, it didn’t get along with this corgi. The corgi also activated it’s barking, and the originally quiet house immediately turned rowdy.

The person who opened the door for Ji Minyue was Song Qinglan.

In the narrow entrance, the two stood quite close together. Ji Minyue had to look up to see the other person’s face and felt that the other party must be a little over one metre ninety.

Upon first sight of the other party, the dissatisfaction and doubts originally in his heart had disappeared to who-knows-where. After all, the other party’s sharp and handsome features as well as the oppressive feeling he

gave off was something one would only gain after training for a long time and after undergoing numerous dangerous missions.

“Teacher Ji.” Song Qinglan politely greeted him first, “Please come in.”

Ji Minyue was startled, “We’ve met?”

They have indeed met in the bubble world.

But in fact, they haven’t met in the real world.

Song Qinglan said, “I heard about Teacher Ji from Ji Yushi. Hello, my name is Song Qinglan.”

The small amount of dissatisfaction and doubt once again surfaced in Ji Minyue. He said subtly, “When Jian Jian was transferred to Jiang City, I have also heard him mention you.”

The people in Ning City call the youngest daughters in their family Nan Nan and the youngest son Jian Jian. It could be considered a nickname.

Song Qinglan was also called this when he was a child in Ning City, but he was no longer called that after he grew up.

He didn’t expect Ji Yushi to still have this nickname.

In contrast, the words ‘Ji Yushi’ didn’t sound as intimate as compared to Jian Jian.

Middle Black and the corgi were still passionately facing each other off.

The two glanced at each other and then left the hallway.

“I had a bit of misunderstanding with civilian staff and my self-esteem was high.” Song Qinglan didn’t avoid this topic, “Now look, fate gave me a big slap in the face and now I’ve fallen into Advisor Ji’s hands.”

He smiled, revealing his white teeth. It made him appear even more handsome and the aggressiveness from earlier lessened considerably.

Ji Minyue: “.....”

He didn't know what to say in response to that.

Thanks to Chief Wang's teaching, Song Qinglan continued, “In any job, it's not enough just charging ahead, there must be people like Teacher Ji and Advisor Ji around to guide us to ensure that everything is successful. The reason why we could return safely this time was because of Advisor Ji.”

Ji Minyue felt a lot better. He couldn't bring himself to say anything else, “Where's Jian Jian?”

What a joke. He actually was left stumped for words for the first time at his younger brother's place.

Song Qinglan said, “He just woke up. Changing his clothes.”

Ji Minyue stiffened, “Only just woke up?!”

Song Qinglan frowned, “He usually wakes up early?”

Ji Minyue had already conjured a whole bunch of scenes in his mind. His chubby body almost couldn't bear it, “Well.....I guess. His sleep quality isn't very good. Sometimes he gets up at two or three o'clock.”

As he spoke, Ji Yushi walked out of his bedroom.

He wore a simple white T-shirt and shorts and had cleaned himself up. He looked like those students in Ji Minyue's class who looked obedient but were actually very rebellious.

Ji Yushi: “Brother, why are you so early?”

Ji Minyue said solemnly, “I was walking the dog and just happened to pass by so I thought about inviting you out for breakfast. I didn't expect Cap Song to also be here!”

Ji Yushi's tone showed disbelief, “Oh.”

“Teacher Ji also hasn’t had breakfast?” Song Qinglan suggested naturally, “I just happened to be preparing it. Let’s eat together.”

\*

There really wasn’t much to say about Song Qinglan’s omelettes. The words Ji Yushi said last time wasn’t a lie.

This time, Song Qinglan also prepared toast and made sandwiches. It was just a simple Western style breakfast, but it was enough to shock Ji Minyue. With the rumours he had heard, he thought Song Qinglan would be someone who didn’t cook.

It’s quite noticeable when people are in love.

The three of them sat at the same table and, even if the couple didn’t show any special interactions, Ji Minyue could sense that there was something different between them.

The two big men didn’t show any intimacy, nor did they say any cheesy love talk. They only conversed normally.

After finishing breakfast, Ji Yushi even took the initiative to clean up and bring the dishes into the kitchen to be washed.

Ji Minyue had come over to check on the situation and, seeing that there was nothing to worry about, he decided to leave.

Before leaving, Ji Yushi asked him amidst the sound of water running, “Brother, you’re not coming tomorrow too, are you?”

Ji Minyue, “How can I not come tomorrow?! I can just not bring the dog along next time.”

Ji Yushi was merciless, “I’m on vacation and my boyfriend is also on vacation. If you have time, why don’t you run two more laps?”

Sure enough, he had changed now that he had a boyfriend.



Ji Minyue was angered, "I'm leaving."

Ji Minyue brought the corgi to the door. Song Qinglan had already changed his shoes. "Teacher Ji, I'll send you off."

Ji Minyue's felt a little bad for his sudden intrusion, so he said, "No need to trouble you too much."

Song Qinglan was a lot more direct than Ji Minyue expected. As they spoke, the door had already opened, "I just happen to have something to ask Teacher Ji so I can ask you about it on the way."

Ji Minyue: "Alright then."

The two went downstairs.

There were many people going to work at this moment, so the elevator was crowded, and it wasn't convenient to talk. When they reached a shady area in the community, Song Qinglan took something out from his pocket, "Teacher Ji, I've noticed that Ji Yushi is a little dependent on this medicine and want to help him quit but I'm worried that doing it the wrong way will cause side effects. I heard from him that his father has been in charge of his situation and want to ask him for his opinion."

Ji Minyue received it and his expression changed, "He's still taking this?"

"Yes." Seeing his reaction, Song Qinglan had some doubts, "Is something wrong?"

Ji Minyue, "This was something he used for a few years when he was a child and when he got older, my father stopped it. He had passed all the psychological and physical examinations all these years and would always receive a high score in them. I didn't know he was still taking this."

Song Qinglan clenched his fists.

He knew better than anyone the reason why Ji Yushi did this.

As he was in thought, he heard Ji Minyue say, “Thank you for telling me. I will go back and let my father know. Once I know how to cut it off completely, I will contact you.”

The two exchanged phone numbers.

Before leaving, Ji Minyue called out to him, “Cap Song!”

Song Qinglan stopped.

Ji Minyue said to him, “Our little classmate Ji.....actually doesn’t accept another person that easily.”

Song Qinglan nodded, “I know.”

“So you must have something in you that he likes.” Ji Minyue said, “He was very lonely for various reasons when he was a child and even after growing up, he had never completely let himself go. I know that he actually likes thrilling and exciting activities and there is a part of him that is naïve. With this vacation and since you are with him, why don’t you take him out to have some fun? Trust me, nobody but you will be able to convince him.”

After Ji Minyue left, Song Qinglan stood alone in the community for a while.

When he returned, Ji Yushi was sitting cross-legged on the floor, playing his game console.

Song Qinglan sat down next to him, rubbed the cat of unknown identity who had come over and glanced at the scores, “What are you doing little classmate Ji? For what reason do you need to distract yourself?”

Ji Yushi’s fingers didn’t stop. His high concentration was interrupted by Song Qinglan. That title was probably something Song Qinglan learnt from Ji Minyue.

The falling block made a mistake and the game ended within a few seconds. Ji Yushi placed down the game console, “What did Ji Minyue say to you?”

“You’re nervous?” Song Qinglan chuckled and hugged him from behind, “Afraid that he wouldn’t agree?”

Ji Yushi silently acquiesced.

He wasn’t too confident about bringing his boyfriend back to introduce to his family.

“With me so tall and handsome, you and I are a perfect pair. How could he be against it?” Song Qinglan said, “He also said that since I’m not familiar with Ning City, you should take me out to play.”

Ji Yushi: “Really?”

Song Qinglan, “Really. Advisor Ji, since we are on vacation now, where do you plan to take me?”

Ji Yushi asked, “Then where do you want to go?”

**KK has something to say:**

I was a little worried last chapter but I’m glad Song Qinglan asked about the proper way to stop the medication and is seeking advice from a professional instead of just taking away the medication 😊

Also, I’m LOVING the domestic scenesssss ♥ ♥ ♥ (I’m a sucker for them hehe)

# Chapter 87: Chapter 87

## Our Reality

### Chapter 87

Song Qinglan originally wanted Ji Yushi to suggest something.

But Ji Yushi originally wasn't someone who went out often so his level of understanding of places to go in Ning City was about the same as Song Qinglan's and he couldn't really recommend anything. After the two discussed a few options, Ji Yushi even felt that staying at home may be the better way to pass their vacation.

"This is a date." Song Qinglan persuaded him, "Since it's a date, staying at home the whole time won't do. When I return to the squad later, I still want to share with those single dogs our romantic experiences. This will motivate them to escape singlehood."

This reason was spoken very righteously, leaving Ji Yushi with a rare, confused expression, "But I really don't know where to go. Have lunch, watch a movie and walk around in the park?"

The classic date routine?

Song Qinglan pulled him up from the carpet, "Go to the amusement park."

Ji Yushi's eyes widened, "Amusement park?!"

Song Qinglan turned him around and pushed him into the room. As he made him stand in front of the closet, he said, "Yes, the amusement park."

The amusement park. A must have destination for school-aged straight men to bring their dates.

Ji Yushi didn't expect Song Qinglan to suggest this and just felt that this level of childishness didn't go well with the other person's personality. He could only tell himself that the other party was still a child at heart.

To be a qualified boyfriend, Ji Yushi silently accepted this proposal.

The two changed and got ready to leave.

In order to make himself look less incompatible with a place like the amusement park, Ji Yushi kept the simple T-shirt he wore in the morning and only changed his shorts to jeans and paired it with a pair of sneakers. With his slender figure and straight back, this way of dressing failed to make him look ordinary and conversely made him look like an eye-catching top student.

The clothes Song Qinglan wore the day before had already been washed and dried and they weren't very formal clothes so they sufficed.

The two stood in the elevator. It was only when they saw each other in the mirror that they finally felt that they were going out for a date.

Ji Yushi, "Wouldn't it be a little strange?"

Song Qinglan looked at him through the mirror, "How would it be strange? Adults have no right to seek thrill and relax?"

Ji Yushi, "....."

Song Qinglan continued to look at the Ji Yushi reflected in the mirror. He tilted his head and said to him, "You can pretend that I am still a child."

"If you can change to your appearance in Chaos, I can try but 1.92 metres...." Ji Yushi commented calmly, "What a big kid."

The little Cap Song with a tender face and a soft voice.

Because of his small size, the sleeves were dragged across the floor and he wore a pair of short boots several sizes too large for him as he tried to keep up with him with Shen Mian in his arms.

Stubborn and cute.

Ji Yushi recalled that scene and his eyes couldn't help but soften. Afraid of Song Qinglan noticing, he even turned his head away.

Reaching the parking lot, Song Qinglan took the initiative to be the driver, but even with his height advantage, he couldn't find the black off-road car anywhere.

Ji Yushi stepped forward and unlocked a car nearby, "Here."

This car was quite retro and elegant in shape. It was a car from the 80's or 90's, completely different from the domineering car Song Qinglan saw last time. They were practically on two extremes.

Song Qinglan circled the car with interest, "Where is the car from last time?"

Ji Yushi's gun and car all matched well with the image he gave off.

He sure does like retro things.

"Don't have it. My car has always been this one in reality but the bubble world made a different choice for me." Ji Yushi threw the keys at him, "Do you want to drive? Manual with no automatic function. It's laborious but enjoyable."

"Drive!" Song Qinglan was very willing to be the driver. He caught the key and sat in the car.

Ji Yushi circled the car and got into the front passenger seat. As soon as he closed the door, he heard Song Qinglan call out his name, "Ji Yushi."

He turned his head.

He was kissed on his lips.

Song Qinglan's lips pressed against his, rubbing gently, "Welcome. Let our first date officially begin."

\*

Drop towers, roller coasters, the big pendulum.

The amusement park on a weekday was still crowded with people. While completing those three thrilling rides, the expressions of the two men didn't change. When Song Qinglan was on the pendulum, he even calmly took out his phone, took a video and sent it to Li Chun.

The sunlight was just right. Colourful bubbles floated in the sky. Ji Yushi's side profile briefly appeared in the recording.

Li Chun: [?]

Li Chun: [Cap Song, are you trying to kill single dogs?]

Song Qinglan promptly replied: [No, I mainly wanted to ask how many rounds of the pendulum you have completed this vacation.]

Li Chun: [.....Actually, I don't vomit as much now! I can do it!]

Song Qinglan didn't pay any heed to his answer and continued: [My second reason is because I want to kill single dogs.]

Li Chun: [Ahhhhh 【Suicide.JPG】 ]

Song Qinglan: [Look at our Advisor Ji, as a civilian worker——]

As he typed, the pendulum stopped.

Ji Yushi who had already unstrapped himself called out to him, "It's time to get off."

Song Qinglan immediately turned off his phone and ignored Li Chun on the other side. He reached the edge and jumped off first before holding his hand out, “Be careful.”

Ji Yushi gave him his hand and also jumped down.

The other people on the ride with them all had pale faces. They looked at them like they were monsters.

Despite all the rides, Ji Yushi’s face wasn’t red nor was he breathless. It was as if he was on a sightseeing tour bus instead.

Song Qinglan wanted to change things up and get him to choose, “What do you want to play next?”

They had spent a lot of time just queuing up for the rides earlier. Ji Yushi turned on his phone and moved the map projection around. Most of the amusement park rides were red and only a few of them were green and not so busy.

“Go to the haunted house?” Ji Yushi suggested, “There are fewer people there.”

“Haunted house?” Seeing the high-risk warning on the holographic projection, Song Qinglan hesitated, “The experience is too realistic. Are you sure?”

When others receive a scare, they would soon forget about it.

But Ji Yushi wouldn’t. For him, a scary experience would never disappear, and it was because of this that Song Qinglan was hesitant.

“I want to go because it is realistic.” It was Ji Yushi’s turn this time to pull Song Qinglan along, “Also, no matter how realistic it is, can it be as realistic as being surrounded by zombies in a convenience store? I want to try and see if high-tech can scare me.”

“Alright.” Song Qinglan agreed.



The haunted house was a little far from the pendulum.

Instead of taking a tour bus, they chose to walk.

Along the way, Song Qinglan tried out a shooting game and easily obtained a plush toy. Ji Yushi saw it and also wanted to give it a try and similarly acquired another one. The two felt that that it was too troublesome to carry around, so they gave it to the children waiting in line behind them.

After coming out of the shooting place, Song Qinglan bought cotton candy for Ji Yushi, “Since other children have it, our Advisor Ji can’t not have it.”

Ji Yushi graciously accepted it.

He bit into the pink cotton candy and it quickly melted in his mouth, “This place still tastes the same.”

Song Qinglan, “You have been here before?”

Ji Yushi, “Yeah, the first time was when I was eleven. Ji Minyue brought me here. After that, we came here three more times. We would always buy it from this place.”

The haunted house was ahead.

Ji Yushi had already joined the line.

Song Qinglan watched his relaxed back figure and deeply suspected — Could Ji Minyue’s understanding of Ji Yushi be stuck at the moment when he was a child?

When they left the haunted house, Song Qinglan basically confirmed this.

Amidst the howls and screams from the other visitors, the two of them went through the haunted house together, exploring the map in detail. They even cleared an instance that was expected to take an hour in a little more than ten minutes. This included the time they waited for the female ghost to reappear because Ji Yushi wanted to see it again.

To Ji Yushi, this amusement park wasn't anything new or fresh.

Song Qinglan could imagine what Ji Yushi could've been like when he was a child as he sought out thrilling experiences but unfortunately, he couldn't go back in time to accompany him.

Perhaps for ordinary couples, as long as they were together, it could be considered a good date.

But their date shouldn't be like this.

Song Qinglan left for a moment to make a phone call before returning.

Ji Yushi was holding a cup of iced milk tea. Seeing that he was back, he asked, "Want it?"

Song Qinglan held Ji Yushi's hand and naturally took a sip through the straw.

This action of his was very intimate, making Ji Yushi's heart to soften. He had asked Song Qinglan earlier if he wanted it thinking that he would buy him one if he did.

When Song Qinglan was done, he saw his look and asked, "What's wrong?"

Ji Yushi said, "Someone gave it."

Song Qinglan followed his gaze. Not far away, three girls saw them look over and ran away in embarrassment.

He raised his eyebrow slightly and said unhappily, "I just left for a while and someone bought you milk tea?"

Ji Yushi nodded, "I am very popular."

Song Qinglan laughed.

He didn't know what kind of grudges this person has noted down. Song Qinglan took the milk tea from him and asked, "Want to go skydiving?"

Ji Yushi, "Skydiving?"

"My comrade-in-arms retired and opened a skydiving club." Song Qinglan explained briefly, "It's not far from Ning City. I gave him a call just now. If we go now, we will be back tomorrow morning."

\*

For the first time in his twenty-five years, Ji Yushi agreed on an impromptu trip.

They directly set off from the amusement park and didn't even go home. He only gave Ji Minyue a call to ask him to help take care of his three little masters.

Ji Yushi's car didn't have an automatic driving mode and couldn't go onto the highway with an unrestricted speed limit so they could only take the ordinary highway to get to the club about 500 kilometres away. This however didn't make them change their minds. On the way, they bought some food and water. If they didn't delay for too long, they would be able to reach there in time for the last skydiving session before the sky darkens.

The ordinary highway passed through the old part of Ning City. A lone car followed the spacious road.

It sped freely down with no obstacles in its way.

From the highway, one could see a building that was waiting to be rebuilt. Against the backdrop of skyscrapers and suspension train tracks in the new part of the city, it gave off a strange beauty of desolateness.

"When I was young, I went to kindergarten in that area." Song Qinglan pointed ahead, "See that? The green area next to the red building."

Ji Yushi nodded.

He also saw the green space. His side profile was calm.

Just as Song Qinglan thought he didn't hear him, he turned and said, "What a coincidence. I also went to kindergarten there."

Song Qinglan: "You're joking."

Ji Yushi: "Really. The kindergarten attached to Ning University."

Song Qinglan thought he was really joking with him, "That's a pity then. Why didn't I pursue you in kindergarten?"

**KK has something to say:**

Is Song Qinglan finally going to find out??

# Chapter 88: Chapter 88

## Our Reality

### Chapter 88

Ji Yushi continued, “Didn’t you already have that ‘Han Han’ at the time?”

“Fuck.” Song Qinglan lowly laughed, “This is too high of a hurdle to cross.”

Ji Yushi looked back out the window. As he watched the old buildings pass by, the corners of his lips curved into an obvious arc.

He was joking around.

Song Qinglan tapped the steering wheel with his finger. Thinking about what it would be like if Ji Yushi’s words were true, he asked, “If we really were in the same kindergarten, you must remember me.”

Others may not remember their childhood years, but Ji Yushi would most definitely remember.

“Let me think.” Ji Yushi followed his line of thought and said, “I do remember a fat little boy constantly sticking to another little boy and would cause a fuss if he wasn’t allowed to be with him. He was quite a famous little demon king.”

Song Qinglan: “Then that’s not right.”

Ji Yushi turned around, his eyes bright, “How is it not right?”

“I was pretty fat as a child but at that time I wasn’t bent.” Song Qinglan laughed, “Although I can’t remember ‘Han Han’s’ appearance, I did follow her around all day. If you saw a little fat boy constantly sticking to another little girl back then, that was probably me.”

Ji Yushi didn’t speak.

The window lowered slightly, messing his dark black hair.

I wonder what Ji Yushi looked like as a child?

As soon as Song Qinglan thought this, he covered Ji Yushi’s hand with his and added, “If the little boy was you, I would only play with you all day.”

\*

After more than three hours, the car drove into the area where the skydiving club was located.

It was far from the city and after a few kilometres of forests and farms, the space suddenly opened up. Surrounded by trees was a large green plain where even the ends of it were hard to see. The highway continued straight on. In an instant, all the commotion and noise from the city was gone.

From a distance, Ji Yushi saw a few planes stopped on the tarmac as well as a large glass building on the side. That should be the skydiving club.

They parked the car outside and someone came over as soon as they got out.

The other party was a valiant looking young man. Dressed in tight black clothes, he gave off the same air as Song Qinglan and Zhou Mingxuan.

This should be the comrade-in-arms Song Qinglan mentioned.

“Cap Song!”

“Old Xue.”

As soon as the two met, they stretched out their fists and bumped them before bumping shoulders. It was all done in tacit understanding.

Song Qinglan was also a captain in the army. His many years in the army had allowed him to form deep friendship with his comrade-in-arms.

Song Qinglan introduced, “This is my comrade-in-arms, Xue Zhao, who has now retired. This club is run by him. Old Zhou used to come often.”

Xue Zhao smiled modestly, “It was actually opened together with friends, but you’re welcome to come any time.”

Song Qinglan turned and introduced Ji Yushi to him, “Ji Yushi, my boyfriend.”

Xue Zhao’s smile froze, “Huh?”

Song Qinglan knew he would react like this. He just repeated without a change in his expression, “That’s right, my boyfriend.”

Ji Yushi stretched his hand out first, “Hello.”

Xue Zhao mechanically shook hands with the handsome young man and gave his greetings.

The three entered the building.

Xue Zhao was still a little shocked. He still wasn’t able to recover from the surprise of Cap Song suddenly becoming bent. It wasn’t that he hadn’t seen comrades develop good feelings while they were in service, but it hadn’t happened in his team. Song Qinglan had also always maintained a straight man’s attitude towards this the entire time.

There were still some skydiving visitors in the building. It was just in time for the late afternoon session and some of them had already gone through all the formalities and are ready to leave.

“You came at the right time.” Xue Zhao said, “Starting tomorrow, the wind will be too strong, and we will be closed for two days.”

“No need for training?” Ji Yushi asked, “Will there be an instructor?”

“Instructor?” Xue Zhao laughed and looked at Song Qinglan, “Your....”

He really couldn't say the words 'your boyfriend' so he changed his words, “The person next to you is the best instructor! He is someone with a professional certificate.”

Ji Yushi looked over and saw Song Qinglan looking back at him with a hint of a smile in his eyes. It was clear that there was some contentment and pride in there as well.

No wonder he offered to take him skydiving. It just happened to be a certain someone's strong point.

“We can do it together.” Song Qinglan said, “I'll take you first and if you are interested, you can try alone later.”

“Okay.” Ji Yushi agreed.

Under Xue Zhao's guidance, they first did a simple physical examination to confirm that their heart rate and blood pressures were all normal before they were brought over to put on the equipment. Song Qinglan was familiar with it, so he put it on first and then helped strap Ji Yushi in. He even ensured to check it several times.

When it came to things that he wasn't good at or hadn't done before, Ji Yushi readily accepted the help of others.

Song Qinglan said to him, “Advisor Ji, you're so well behaved today.”

Ji Yushi replied frankly, “Because I am also afraid of death.”

Xue Zhao arranged a plane for them.

There were also two other instructors Song Qinglan knew personally leading the other students. The two students were here for a three-day course, and this was already their fourth class. Seeing Song Qinglan on the



plane, they wondered why they didn't meet such a handsome instructor while they were here.

After take-off, Song Qinglan began to tell Ji Yushi the things to look out for, "We will be tied together before we leave the cabin. After jumping off, I will always be behind you. I will let you know before I open the parachute."

One of the two students asked Ji Yushi, "This is your first time skydiving?"

Ji Yushi nodded, "Yes."

The student asked, "How high?"

Song Qinglan answered this question for Ji Yushi, "4500."

The student suggested to Ji Yushi, "For first timers, choose 3000. It'll be easier."

Reaching a different height, the two students and their instructors jumped off the plane one after another.

Every time the cabin opened, a flood of wind would pour in. Ji Yushi gradually began to feel a little nervous.

In fact, he was a little afraid of heights.

4000 metres.

Song Qinglan began to tie the two of them together. He hugged him from behind and asked, "Afraid?"

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan, "If you are afraid, you should say it. How can I protect you if you don't say anything?"

Ji Yushi, "Afraid."

Song Qinglan chuckled and then lowered his head and kissed his cheek with some force, “What are you afraid of? I will never let you die.”

4500 metres.

Song Qinglan helped Ji Yushi put on his goggle.

The cabin door opened. Wind roared in his ears. Song Qinglan was saying something, but Ji Yushi couldn't hear him at all.

Directly below them were vast plains.

This height was higher than Ji Yushi imagined. Everything on the ground appeared very small, making breathing a little difficult. His palms were covered with cold sweat.

“Three! Two! One!”

At a time like this, the more hesitant one is, the more afraid they become. As soon as Song Qinglan finished the countdown, he jumped out into the air with Ji Yushi!!!

In an instant, he felt his heart lifting, as if it was leaving his chest. He felt a strong feeling of weightlessness.

Strong wind hit all parts of his body and it roared loudly in his ears.

They were free falling at a high speed but everything around him didn't move as quickly as he had imagined.

In that moment, everything in the horizon seemed to be within reach. The mountains, rivers, plains and forests, a picturesque scene was slowly revealed. It was completely different from what one would see from a plane.

“Opening!” Song Qinglan's voice sounded closely behind his ears, giving him a sense of security, “Imagine you are a piece of paper floating in the wind!”

Ji Yushi stretched his arms out.

He started to breathe.

He started to welcome the world coming towards him.

There was no point of reference in the sky, making it impossible for Ji Yushi to tell how quickly they were falling.

In fact, they were falling at a speed of 200km/hr. After passing through a layer of almost invisible clouds, he saw two brightly coloured parachutes floating below him. They belonged to the students who had jumped off before him.

Before long, a strong force pulled Ji Yushi up.

At a height of about 1,600 metres above ground, Song Qinglan opened the parachute.

Everything slowed down. The howling wind abruptly stopped.

The world was quiet.

“Look over there.” Song Qinglan said, “Ahead to the left. Raise your head.”

Ji Yushi raised his head.

He had always been looking down so when he raised his head at this moment, he was shocked.

It was currently late afternoon and almost evening. The sky in the distance was dyed orange-red by the setting sun while the sky further out was still blue.

As they drifted down in this magnificent scene, it felt like they had witnessed the earth enveloped in clouds and witnessed nature's everyday change from day to night.

This slow fall continued for a long time.

Ji Yushi's heart was more peaceful than ever.

\*

The moment their feet touched the ground, gravity had returned to normal.

Song Qinglan had perfectly controlled this skydiving experience, allowing Ji Yushi to properly experience what it meant by winning while lying down. He didn't even have to do anything the entire time.

"Want to try solo?" Song Qinglan checked the communicator on his wrist, "Tomorrow's wind will be too strong so if you want to give it a try, you can only do it today."

Ji Yushi, "No need. Just this once is enough."

Song Qinglan, "Alright."

For Song Qinglan, the thrill from skydiving wasn't as good as bungee jumping.

After all, the excitement from skydiving was only strongest when they were free-falling while the latter part was more enjoyable and relaxing. He had brought Ji Yushi along to skydive instead of bungee jumping because he didn't want to burden Ji Yushi's memory.

A staff drove over to pick them up.

After taking off the equipment and getting into the car to head back to the building, the setting sun had already reached the horizon.

In the car, the orange light softened Song Qinglan's features. He asked, "How was it?"

Ji Yushi looked back at him. The light made his eyes look amber, "You're referring to today's date?"

Song Qinglan actually wanted to ask him how he felt skydiving, but it was fine if he interpreted his question that way.

He put an arm around Ji Yushi's shoulder and let Ji Yushi lean against him. He rested his chin against the other's head.

The light shampoo fragrance coming from Ji Yushi's hair was quite pleasant. He kissed the top of the other party's hair, "Yes, what do you think of today's date?"

Ji Yushi grabbed his fingers, "It was great."

Song Qinglan spoke with a smile, "Then will you be willing to go on an even better date with me next time?"

Ji Yushi: "I will think about it."

The two were holding hands when they got out of the car.

Doing something like this at night wasn't too high-profile, but the people waiting for them at the building were still fed a lot of dog food.

Seeing the familiar faces, Song Qinglan: "....."

Ji Yushi was also expressionless.

"Cap Song!"

"Advisor Ji!!"

All five people who were supposed to be on vacation in Jiang City were gathered here. Song Qinglan asked, "Are you all little chicks or have you not been weaned? Don't you know that we need time alone?"

Zhou Mingxuan was next to Xue Zhao. He said with a grin, "We also came here to skydive. We didn't expect to run into you two here!"

Xue Zhao could only laugh awkwardly.

Even Ji Yushi didn't believe him.

“I admit my brother and I came here to find Advisor Ji!” Tang Le admitted, “After not seeing him for a few days, I missed him. There are over ten thousand questions I want to ask Advisor Ji!”

“That’s right.” Tang Qi said.

Duan Wen on the other hand said, “I’m different. I came here to find Cap Song. I wanted to see how the historical meeting between Cap Song and the ‘three boyfriends’ went!”

Song Qinglan laughed and gave him a kick, “Scram.”

The two were surrounded by this group of people. Ji Yushi looked directly at Li Chun, “How did you guys know we’re here?”

Li Chun’s scalp went numb. Having been caught so quickly, he could only smile and retreat a little, “Haa, the photo Cap Song sent of your date stimulated me—I mean, it reminded us of how lonely we are. Didn’t we say that we should go to a bar together last time? I was thinking of inviting them over to Ning City to find you but on our way here, Old Zhou said Cap Song brought you here to skydive.”

The case was solved.

This group of light bulbs were all brought over here by themselves.

Song Qinglan could only wave his hand, “Alright, I’ll treat you all tonight at the bar!”

\*

At night, with the teammates joining, the date temporarily changed into a last-minute celebration party.

Xue Zhao gave them a private room in the club, and they didn’t officially leave until the early hours of the next day.

Ji Yushi was drunk. Song Qinglan only realised this when he saw him return to his room, planning to sleep without washing up.

In fact, those who have drunk too much shouldn't be taking a bath, but in order to prevent Ji Yushi from being uncomfortable, Song Qinglan still undressed him to give him a quick rinse. Ji Yushi didn't resist the entire time and obediently cooperated.

He was stripped naked.

Song Qinglan couldn't help but kiss him.

Ji Yushi's mouth was sweet and very soft, just like how he usually looked.

The bathroom gradually heated up and the ground was wet with water.

Song Qinglan's body was also wet.

The two wet bodies leaned against each other. Droplets of water hung from Ji Yushi's eyelashes. He panted gently, letting Song Qinglan kiss him.

He grabbed Song Qinglan's thick and coarse hair. He couldn't really control his strength.

The other party didn't understand, he didn't understand either.

He only knew that the taste was strange when the other person kissed him again. He didn't like it very much.

Then they moved to the bed.

While in a half awake/half dreaming state, he rode on top of Song Qinglan, continuing to kiss the other person forcefully. The situation then suddenly reversed, and he found himself pressed down.

He was pressed there. His hand clutched the bedsheet while Song Qinglan clutched his hand.

"It hurts a little." He complained. The skin being rubbed between his legs was red and sore.

Song Qinglan's movements stopped.

Through his blurred vision, he saw green veins bulging out from the hand covering the back of his hand. He continued, "But it's okay."

Finally.

Held in the other person's arms, he fell asleep. Just before he fell asleep, he murmured quietly, "Song Qinglan....."

After staying at the club for a night, the two woke up earlier than everyone else the next morning with the intent to escape while the rest were still asleep.

What a joke. Who would want to spend their vacation with their teammates? What difference would that be from work?

Ji Yushi walked a little slowly. Song Qinglan threw their belongings into the car, "Quick."

Unexpectedly, Ji Yushi said, "Legs hurt."

Both couldn't speak.

Two drunk hot-blooded men in a relationship sleeping in the same room. It wouldn't sound realistic if someone said that nothing happened.

Ji Yushi didn't mind these things and even felt that it felt good.

But the skin on his inner thighs had a different opinion.

"Fuck." Song Qinglan grimaced, "I fucking..."

He had also drank too much last night and didn't control his strength.

Ji Yushi threw him a bottle of milk, his voice was natural, "It should be fine if we bought some ointment on the way back. Let's hurry and go."

Seeing Song Qinglan's expression, he continued, "What? I'm not a woman so there's no need to treat me so delicately. Besides, you didn't do anything to me."



After that, he passed by Song Qinglan and got into the car first.

Before the door could close, Song Qinglan blocked it, “Ji Yushi, you’re feeling shy.”

Ji Yushi said coldly, “I’m not.”

Song Qinglan, “Then why are your ears red?”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Alright, he was just embarrassed about the sounds he made last night!!!

\*

Ji Yushi didn’t plan on going home right away because he felt that this group of people may follow them there too. He called Ji Minyue again and asked him to help feed his cats for a few more days and Ji Minyue complained that he was being treated like a slave.

The two went to a city neither of them had been to.

On their fifth day of vacation, Song Qinglan received a call from Chief Wang.

Ji Yushi was scouring the city’s municipal library.

With the reduction in paper books, many books were out of print. Ji Yushi couldn’t borrow these books because he wasn’t from this city so he could only bring out his quantum wave reading speed to read the books here ten lines at a time.

“Xiao Song, how was your vacation?”

Chief Wang was as gentle as ever.

“Not bad.” Song Qinglan said, “Since you’re calling me, is it to inform me that my vacation is over?”

“Although it’s not a formal notice that it’s over but it’ll be soon.” Chief Wang said, “I’m calling you to tell you that the mission rating and reward has been settled. Everyones personal ranks have improved.”

Song Qinglan heard this, but he didn’t express any happiness. He just frowned and had a bad feeling inside.

“But....” Sure enough, Chief Wang paused, “Ji Yushi’s reward request, it may not be able to proceed for the time being.”

“Why?” Song Qinglan asked.

“He failed his psychological assessment.” Chief Wang’s tone was more serious. She explained, “Together with the mission report, his overall score was too low.”

In the bubble world, Ji Yushi could achieve a perfect score in the psychological assessment by deceiving the experts.

Song Qinglan laughed coldly. This wasn’t directed at Chief Wang but at the ridiculous situation, “Just because he told the truth this time? Do those experts have any brains? Do they want to see the truth or be lied t—”

“No.” Chief Wang interrupted him, “It wasn’t because of that.”

Song Qinglan, “Then why?”

Chief Wang sighed deeply before finally speaking, “Xiao Song, your mission report said that you met two people in the Rubik’s Cube mission, right? One of them was a middle-aged man with glasses.”

Song Qinglan remembered that person.

He also remembered that the fat middle-aged man called the man with glasses “Old Sheng.”

But what did this have to do with Ji Yushi?

Chief Wang, “That person was the scientist in charge of some of Tianqiong’s research and development projects more than ten years ago, Sheng Yun.”

Song Qinglan, “He’s Sheng Yun?!”

Xie Sian had once mentioned this person. Song Qinglan didn’t expect that he would have the opportunity to see someone like that in person in Rubik’s Cube.

“Yes.” Chief Wang continued, “More than ten years ago, he was found to have committed suicide at home. Unfortunately, his eight-year-old son was the first person to discover him.”

It was like Song Qinglan was struck by lightning. He immediately understood everything. He understood why Xie Sian said that Ji Yushi and Sheng Yun were similar, and he also understood who the child Xie Sian mentioned was.

“Ji Yushi, formerly Sheng Han.” Chief Wang revealed the truth, “The person you met in Rubik’s Cube was his biological father, Sheng Yun.”

Song Qinglan gripped his phone tightly to the point that it was almost about to crack.

Ji Yushi’s appearance and actions from back in Rubik’s Cube played repeatedly in his mind. The superficial calmness as he sat in place holding his game console and the confession that was concealed as a farewell.....

Chief Wang’s next words mechanically reached his ears.

“Through assessment, Ji Yushi lost control of his emotions after encountering Sheng Yun and chose to go directly to the day of the incident. His mental state is extremely unstable. The superiors have postponed the reward for the time being, and he will need to wait until the next assessment.”

# Chapter 89: Chapter 89

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 89

After Song Qinglan ended the call, he left the secluded corridor and returned to the library.

This library was a very modern building with tapered transparent stairs modelled after the Penrose stairs and had mechanisms installed to allow readers to be able to access different floors with ease.

Going through the changing staircase, Song Qinglan saw the person he was looking for sitting at the table reading intently.

There was a tall stack of books around Ji Yushi. It seems like he probably wouldn't be moving away from that spot any time soon. He didn't need to take any notes when reading and he turned the pages faster than the average person, but his expression was also more focused than everyone else.

Some people say that people with hyperthymesia can remember clearly every detail in their life, from the big changes in life to the smallest of thoughts that surface in their minds. They are unable to forget, thirst for knowledge, and it makes them a genius in a certain sense.

But for the first time, Song Qinglan strongly wished that Ji Yushi's memory and thoughts were ordinary.

He wished that he would carelessly misread the question, hurry out the house and forget to feed the cats, and would run into old classmates outside but be unable to recall their names.

Ji Yushi sat quietly by the large bookshelf that seemed to have no end in sight.

He appeared relaxed.

During these past few days of vacation, he had been happier than ever.

“What’s the matter?”

Sensing Song Qinglan’s return, Ji Yushi raised his head and asked with his dark eyes clear and clean.

Ji Yushi.

Formerly Sheng Han.

Suddenly, those eyes overlapped with the eyes from his childhood.

Song Qinglan felt like he had reached enlightenment. The kindergarten attached to Ning University, the little girl he could no longer remember the appearance of, the joke about his ‘first love’.....Ji Yushi had given a number of hints and reminders the entire time but, because of Ji Yushi’s tendency to hold grudges and likely because he had mistaken him for a little girl, Ji Yushi had teased him like this.

Song Qinglan pulled out the chair next to him and sat down.

There were very few people on this floor and there were only the two of them sitting at this long table.

Time flowed on like a river.

The ignorant child back then had grown up to into a mature man. Their two lives had briefly intersected and then after more than a decade, it had intersected again.

This wonderful and extraordinary fate filled Song Qinglan’s heart with excitement. He directly asked, “When did you realise it?”

Ji Yushi didn't understand, "When did I realise what?"

Song Qinglan's eyes contained a hint of a smile and there was also some helplessness, "When did you realise that I was the little fat boy who constantly stuck to you in kindergarten?"

Song Qinglan pulled Ji Yushi's hand over and closed the book in front of him.

He wanted him to look at him.

"Han Han."

Ji Yushi paused for a moment, "How did you...."

Song Qinglan however asked, "Why did you wear a dress as a child?"

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan continued, "Advisor Ji, at such a young age you cross-dressed, deceived my feelings and made me bent. Are you going to take responsibility?"

Ji Yushi's breathing stopped. He reluctantly explained, "That was a performance, not crossdressing! You were the one who couldn't distinguish between male and female and constantly followed me around. How would I have known that you thought that I was a girl?"

Song Qinglan pretended not to hear and added, "You even cried when I left."

"I didn't."

"You did."

"I didn't."

"You did."

As if they had returned to kindergarten, the two continued this childish exchange several times before it ended with Song Qinglan sealing Ji Yushi's lips with a kiss.

Sitting in the quiet library, they shared a kiss.

Tongues and lips entangled gently.

The glass reflected their kissing appearance.

When the kiss ended, Song Qinglan rested his forehead against his and asked again, "When did you recognise me?"

Ji Yushi finally answered this question, "The first time we met in Jiang City."

That time, he and Chief Wang were visiting the base together when he heard someone enter.

The visitor had long legs and a handsome appearance, but he exuded an air of arrogance and oppressiveness.

"His name is Song Qinglan. The sunny 'Qing' and the mountain wind 'Lan' ...."

One's appearance would change with age but it would still contain some similarities. What's more, with Ji Yushi's memory, it was even easier for him to make a connection. He originally still had some suspicions and thought it was too coincidental, but everything was confirmed as soon as he heard Chief Wang's introduction.

"Fuck." Song Qinglan couldn't help but let out a low curse, "Then why didn't you tell me?"

Ji Yushi said, "Because I thought you were annoying at the time."

Song Qinglan laughed out loud. Even his chest shook, "That's true. I'm sure you noted down a lot of grudges back then. Why else would you have kept it from me for so long?"

Ji Yushi wasn't the type to hide things. As long as Song Qinglan asked, he would definitely tell him.

But the key point was 'as long as Song Qinglan asked'.

"You clearly told me all the other important things, but you didn't tell me this." Song Qinglan asked, "Why did you change your name?"

Ji Yushi, "A name is just a title. It actually doesn't matter."

Song Qinglan frowned.

This was something Ji Yushi had said before, but he didn't think much of it at the time. Now, he felt that this line was more meaningful than he had initially thought.

Sure enough, Ji Yushi slowly stored away the smiling expression and asked, "Did Chief Wang call just now?"

Everything was within Ji Yushi's expectations.

In the first place, he didn't plan on hiding the fact that he was 'Han Han' from Song Qinglan for this long.

"Yes." Song Qinglan said, "If it weren't for your mission report, even now I wouldn't have known that you.... met your father in Rubik's Cube."

Song Qinglan could almost imagine how Ji Yushi felt at the time.

Song Qinglan could also imagine that when Sheng Yun said "What a coincidence. My son also has a similar game console to the one this young brother has", how difficult Ji Yushi's "It really is" answer must've been. After all, the person who gave him the game console was right before him

But there was no real empathy in this world.

So Ji Yushi's feelings at the time, Song Qinglan will never be able to fully understand. Just understanding a part of it was enough to fill his heart with a bitter taste.



The father and son had met in a time and space where the past and future were indistinguishable.

There was no sequence in time there so even the simplest of reminder or the smallest sentence could completely change one's destiny.

And Ji Yushi just sat there watching his father leave before saying to his teammates, "Let's go."

"After returning, I have actually been thinking of a problem." Ji Yushi slowly spoke up, "Do you think he recognised me?"

Song Qinglan's heart felt like it was being fiercely crushed. The pain made it difficult to breathe.

This question was very cruel.

Should he reply with yes or no? He didn't know. If he said that he did, then Sheng Yun would be too heartless, but if he said that he didn't, Ji Yushi would be disappointed.

Song Qinglan knew that under Ji Yushi's cold appearance, there was still a pure, childlike heart in him. After losing so much in his younger years, no matter how old he was, he still yearned for the affection from his father like any other child in the world.

"Who would have expected that Han Han would be so good looking after growing up?" Song Qinglan decided to respond this way, "Even I didn't recognise you, so he most certainly didn't. You changed too much."

Ji Yushi blinked a few times, "Oh, you said before I looked very good as a child. Turns out you were lying."

Song Qinglan laughed.

He didn't expect Ji Yushi to be able to make a joke so quickly.

Ji Yushi returned to the topic just now, "As for changing my name...."

Song Qinglan said, “Was it related to your father’s ‘suicide’?”

Seeing Ji Yushi nod, Song Qinglan analysed, “You said you passed the murderer in the corridor and that this was an unsolved murder case. Tianqiong however deemed it as ‘suicide’?”

There must be some inextricable connections in this case.

Ji Yushi never thought that there would be a day where he would meet someone he could tell all his secrets to. He sorted out his feelings and thoughts and got ready to tell Song Qinglan all the clues and mysteries he had gathered over the years.

“In those few years, the understanding of time and space travel had advanced quite rapidly. If they really wanted to solve the case, it would’ve actually been an easy task. Furthermore, my father was originally an important personnel involved with the research and development of Tianqiong.” Ji Yushi said, “But on the contrary, this case was not only closed late, but there were also endless inquiries about me. My mother died in a car accident in my early years and with my father gone, I no longer have a legal guardian. Teacher wanted to protect me, so I went through the adoption procedures, changed my name and used legal means to completely disappear from public eyes.”

He had lost his father and even his name.

Professor Ji had told him that a name was just a title. It wasn’t important.

He was still Jian Jian inside; he was still Sheng Han.

But what Professor Ji didn’t expect was that Ji Yushi would suffer from hyperthymesia as a result of this stimulus. Even if he changed his identity, he never gave up his determination to pursue the truth. As the years passed, the core personnel responsible for Sheng Yun’s case had long since changed and there was no longer any resistance. When Sheng Han grew up and successfully joined Tianqiong, his outstanding abilities received recognition from the Recorder department and with the agreed condition, he began to earn points by completing missions.

Ji Yushi: “I think my father’s death has something to do with this so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’.”

Song Qinglan frowned, “He was a member of the R&D team.”

It was said that the members of the R&D team either died or went crazy. Looks like it wasn’t just a rumour.

The so-called Tianqiong of all eras however was finally completed and put into use.

“Not only that.” Ji Yushi looked at him, “Rubik’s Cube was also designed by him.”

Song Qinglan’s expression changed. He was deeply shocked.

Rubik’s Cube’s changes were unpredictable and in a certain sense, it could even be considered as the converging point of ‘all eras’. That was why they could see Lin Xinlan from a year ago, Zoe from decades later, and even Morita Yu from a different time and space.

“A souvenir he brought back for me from a meeting was a real Rubik’s Cube.” Ji Yushi told him about the dream he had in Rubik’s Cube and then said, “I wasn’t certain about this matter, and I also didn’t know how Rubik’s Cube was designed so I didn’t know how to clear it at the beginning. After figuring out the way to clear it, I still wasn’t certain but when I saw him with his colleague, I became certain that he really was involved with the design of Rubik’s Cube.”

Someone who wasn’t a Guardian had appeared at a place where Guardians were required to complete a mission.

Skipping over the other matters, Ji Yushi asked Song Qinglan, “Don’t you think that Rubik’s Cube’s mission itself was very strange?”

Song Qinglan, “Go on.”

Ji Yushi: “The previous Ouroboros and Chaos missions at least had a purpose. Whether it was destroying a collapsing world or closing a crevice

in time and space, we know why we did it and there was logic in the mission. Rubik's Cube's mission however...."

"Was different." Song Qinglan expressed his complaints, "It appeared complicated and grand but after completing it, we still didn't know anything and only knew that the timeline was messy and needed to be rearranged."

"That's right."

Ji Yushi nodded in agreement. He then voiced his thoughts, "It was originally an incomplete product."

"Incomplete product?"

"Yes."

Ji Yushi explained, "In other words, it had no purpose at all. It was just an idea, an experiment."

"They were experimenting. If the timeline was completely broken, was it possible to use a method to bring Guardians with no connections from different times and spaces, regardless of whether they are from the past or the future, to gather at one point in time. This was a very big hypothesis — All eras existing at the same time."

Time was inherently linear and sequential.

The process by which things change sequentially was time itself.

But what if time was a puddle of water?

Without a beginning or end, without the concern of before or after, it remains stopped in place, only rippling as things change but always remaining in its original state.

In a sense, humans would be living in another dimension.

Song Qinglan shivered. He felt a little uncomfortable.

Ji Yushi also felt the same.

The universe was vast. Humans were like tiny ants in comparison.

No matter how advanced humanity was, they could never truly become a god. Just the thought of it was terrifying.

Ji Yushi said, “I don’t know if it was because it was discovered that this R&D project had violated the principles of nature so they.....”

Reaching this point, he seemed to be unable to continue. After pausing for a moment and recovering, he continued, “In the end, the project was stopped. In a place unknown to everyone, a ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ formed along with these difficult missions and it became the parent system in charge of implementing these missions.”

“This is the intelligent system you mentioned the other day.” Song Qinglan held the other person in his arms and kissed their forehead, “In other words, the parent system responsible for maintaining time and space stability.”

Everything seemed to be covered by a cloud of mist.

They were deeply involved. As long as they find a breakthrough point, they will be able to fully understand the truth.

That was why Ji Yushi must go back.

The two stayed in the library for a while. Ji Yushi asked, “Is our vacation over?”

Chief Wang’s phone call probably signalled the end of their vacation.

They had all expected this.

“Yes.” Song Qinglan said, “It’s too short.”

Ji Yushi sighed softly.

Song Qinglan laughed, “Why? Haven’t had enough fun?”

Ji Yushi made a sound of affirmation. He rested his head against Song Qinglan's shoulder and seemed to be thinking about something.

Song Qinglan said, "However, our mission rewards have been passed. Through application, we can acquire our reward first before returning to work."

Ji Yushi sat up.

He looked at Song Qinglan as if waiting for him to tell him the final outcome.

"The Jiang City branch sincerely wants you to join them. Chief Wang has made several phone calls to Chief Lin requesting for this." Song Qinglan said, "That was why she readily agreed with your request at the time to give you time to sort out your personal affairs first."

"Really?" Ji Yushi didn't show any excitement. Seeing that Song Qinglan had said so much without getting to the point, Ji Yushi was able to guess a part of it, "Did my psychological assessment fail?"

Song Qinglan, "Yes."

Ji Yushi: "....."

"What are you disappointed for? Don't you still have me?" Song Qinglan looked at him and spoke arrogantly, "I have accumulated two rewards. After applying, I'll become your temporary guardian and the superiors allowed me to take you back to that day together."

Ji Yushi was stunned, "You're using both rewards? But what if you want something else?"

Song Qinglan casually stood up and carried a stack of his books to the robot nearby, "Let's go, Advisor Ji. The restaurant reservation is at six. We should quickly make use of the remaining time to enjoy our date and return to Jiang City after we're done eating."

Ji Yushi also stood up. He seriously insisted, “I can wait for the next evaluation. You don’t need to use both rewards.”

Song Qinglan, “I only want one reward.”

Ji Yushi asked, “What is it?”

“I’ve said it many times already.” Song Qinglan walked over, “I want you to stay.”

# Chapter 90: Chapter 90

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 90

A day later, in the locker room of the third command centre in the Jiang City Tianqiong branch.

Song Qinglan who was done changing left the locker room.

Except for him and Ji Yushi, everyone else from the seventh squad had not yet returned and were still on vacation.

This was Song Qinglan's first time seeing such a quiet locker room. Even now, everyone on the seventh squad didn't know that their Cap Song and Advisor Ji will be going back 10+ years for a reason that had nothing to do with any missions.

Song Qinglan checked the communicator on his wrist again. He heard the door open and saw Ji Yushi similarly walk out.

Like Song Qinglan, Ji Yushi also wore an outdated top paired with ripped jeans which were popular at the time as well as a pair of canvas shoes.

"Great, we can now both be stars in a movie." Song Qinglan said, "Two idiots from remote villages visiting the city for the first time."

The clothes from more than ten years ago did indeed look quite old-fashioned. It couldn't even be considered retro. What's more, in order for them to better integrate with that time period, the people in the command centre made it a little tacky looking as well. This was something Song Qinglan had never worn in his entire life.



Ji Yushi said to him, “This is still okay. I once had to wear tattered clothes.”

Song Qinglan, “Tattered clothes?”

“Yeah, to pretend to be a beggar.” Ji Yushi was uncomfortable just recalling it and spoke very quickly, “They actually got me clothes worn previously by a beggar. The ones that also had fleas.”

Reaching this point, he emphasised, “Can you believe it? Fleas.”

Hearing the cold and aloof Advisor Ji speak with such deep resentment, Song Qinglan had a small urge to laugh, “Then this is actually not bad. I’m grateful.”

Ji Yushi was already very familiar with the routine of travelling to the past.

They had to be extremely careful with something like this to preserve the integrity of time. Those who return to the past were required to minimise their existence as much as possible so that they would not interfere with the timeline in any way.

As an experienced Recorder who had completed 89 missions, Ji Yushi who used his reward after clearing Rubik’s Cube without making any preparations had actually made a very irresponsible and reckless move. The reason why his psychological assessment failed was entirely because of this.

Both completed their disguise and tacitly went towards the command centre.

As soon as they walked out the door, they saw a commotion ahead in the corridor.

This time it wasn’t a mission. Two people traversing didn’t require many people so only Chief Wang and a couple of other people in the know were present to assist them.

But there were currently a lot of people at the end of the corridor. Their colleagues were on high alert and running around busily, and there were

also many staff from the medical centre. Carts, fluids and first aid equipment were quickly brought over. This was something they would only see when someone returns from an important mission.

Song Qinglan grabbed a colleague hurrying past, “What happened?”

The colleague was in a rush, “That twelfth squad is back!”

Both of them were shocked.

Song Qinglan still didn’t let the other person go, “Twelfth squad?”

There were dozens of squads in the Jiang City branch and of those there was naturally a squad with the number twelve.

But based on the current situation, especially based on the words ‘that twelfth squad’ used by their colleague and the amount of commotion going on, it was clear that it wasn’t the current twelfth squad they were referring to.

“It’s the twelfth squad that disappeared on their mission fifteen years ago!” The colleague was still in shock. He pulled Song Qinglan’s arm off, “I’ll talk to you about it later Cap Song!”

After that, he also joined the crowd at the end of the corridor.

Song Qinglan looked at Ji Yushi. Ji Yushi also just happened to be looking at him.

The two exchanged a look. Their hearts inside were stormy.

In the crevice of time and space, they had rescued the twelfth squad from fifteen years ago, but because the two timelines from the past and future overlapped and wasn’t consistent, a bubble world was born.

The seventh squad all knew that the twelfth squad’s charges would be cleared after they return and submit their mission reports, but they didn’t expect the twelfth squad to actually return to their current time and space.

Their feet seemed to be nailed in place. They both stood in place, unable to move.

Ji Yushi's eyesight was excellent. His eyes travelled through the crowd, accurately landing on a face in the crowd.

Time had seemed to have gone backwards for the middle-aged Chief with white hairs on his temples.

The traces of aging were gone.

It overlapped with this young face in the crowd.

In the heavy rain.

The city reflections resembled a kaleidoscope.

As rain rolled down the young captain's face, he drew his gun and pointed it at the traitor: "Xie Sian, I, as the witness and guardian of time, will give you your sentence."

Qi Lang wore a black combat uniform with the number 12 on his chest. The teammates beside him were also dressed in a similar uniform.

One of them had his hands handcuffed behind his back. It was Xie Sian.

Fifteen years had passed.

They still retained their appearance from back then.

They walked out of the crowd. Everyone's heads followed them.

None of the people in the twelfth squad noticed the two people they had encountered in the crevice of time and space.

They went right past them.

After they left, the crowd of onlookers also similarly left, and the corridor was quiet again. Song Qinglan frowned, "How could this be?"

Ji Yushi was in thought. After a moment of silence, he spoke. “It’s the same as what we thought before....”

Song Qinglan’s tense expression relaxed slightly. “You mean the theory of ‘all eras existing at the same time’?”

“Yes. Don’t you think that the situation in the crevice in time and space was somewhat similar to Rubik’s Cube?” Ji Yushi said, “If the theory from that year really did develop successfully, then a situation like today would be very common.”

But it wasn’t something they should worry about right now.

Perhaps they could get more information when they return.

\*

The two arrived at the third command centre.

Everything here was the same as usual and the staff were all doing their respective jobs. Perhaps they still had not been made aware of news of the twelfth squad from fifteen years ago suddenly returning.

[1456:06:25 14:23:07]

The current time coordinate was displayed on the large projection.

Chief Wang and the commander-in-chief were both there. After speaking to them briefly, Chief Wang hurriedly left following a phone call. From her expression, she probably received news about the twelfth squad’s return.

Before she left, she looked at Ji Yushi and then said to Song Qinglan, “Come back soon.”

Song Qinglan nodded, “You don’t have to worry.”

Once Chief Wang left, they did a final physical assessment to confirm that they were in good condition and the staff also checked the compatibility of

their subcutaneous communicator with the intended timeline. Everything seemed to be no different from the previous missions.

This was until they were assigned artificial faces.

“When going back in time, in order to maintain the integrity of the timeline as much as possible, we have to reduce our existence as much as possible.” The commander-in-chief came over, “Xiao Ji is more experienced with this and has received professional training. As for Xiao Song, you....”

The commander-in-chief paused. Everyone understood why he said that.

Song Qinglan’s presence was too strong.

Even with an artificial face that didn’t have any memorable features, his figure and height was still very eye-catching.

“Before setting off last time, you said at the meeting that you would apply for an S-level mission once the mission was over. Who would have expected that, let alone an S-level mission, you even completed a Super S-level mission!” This commander-in-chief didn’t say it with the intention to make things difficult for him. He turned around and said, “Xiao Song, don’t say anything this time. Don’t raise another flag.”

Ji Yushi: “.....

Song Qinglan, “Roger!”

The countdown started counting down from five minutes.

“In order to retain talents, Xiao Song is even going to this extent to help his teammate. This sacrificial attitude of his is commendable.”

Completely ignorant of the relationship between the two, the commander-in-chief praised Song Qinglan.

He then looked at Ji Yushi, “Ji Yushi, with your captain personally helping you, I wish you success in your endeavours. Quickly become one of our Guardians and return Cap Song’s goodwill by being his right-hand man.”

Ji Yushi lowered his eyes, “Thank you commander-in-chief.”

The two got onto the transmission platform.

This time, without the company of their teammates, there were only two capsules.

The capsule doors opened.

Ji Yushi moved to step in but was suddenly called, “Ji Yushi.”

Before he could respond, Song Qinglan had already strode over. Under the watch of everyone outside the glass barrier, he grabbed the back of Ji Yushi’s head and kissed him.

Ji Yushi’s lips came into contact with something soft.

Behind them were extremely precise machinery and equipment, as well as the third command centre colleagues who had similarly sent them off to their mission last time. Even if all sounds were blocked by the glass barrier, Ji Yushi felt like he could hear everyone gasping.

“Officially coming out of the closet.” Song Qinglan’s eyes were like a dark whirlpool but his lips curved into a devilish smirk, “Let them know that this is not a sacrifice and you don’t need to pay me back.”

Ji Yushi only now realised how fast his heart was beating. His entire body was also trembling slightly, and his palms were covered in cold sweat.

This was different from when he went alone last time, and it was also different from his imaginations.

This time, he would actually be properly facing that day, and he was no longer alone. The silver-white capsules sat quietly on the platform. As soon as he stepped into it, he would begin the journey of saying goodbye to his past self.

“Let’s go.”

Song Qinglan released him and turned to sit into his capsule.

Ji Yushi also sat into the capsule.

Countdown of one minute.

The hatch closed. Safety belts slowly wrapped around starting from his calf. The communicator on his left wrist glowed green. It was no longer six lights. There was only one light and it indicated Song Qinglan's current position as well as his physical status.

[You have been connected to the public channel.]

A brief reminder sounded. Tianqiong's laws were displayed on the transparent panel.

"I am a witness of time and I hereby swear an oath."

"Never change the past!"

"Never talk about the present!"

"Never be obsessed with the future!"

Song Qinglan's voice sounded through the public channel, "Get ready."

It was just like the first time he heard Song Qinglan's voice through the subcutaneous communicator. Ji Yushi tightened his grip on his armrest slightly and prepared to set off.

Unexpectedly, Song Qinglan called out his name through the private channel.

"Sheng Han."

Ji Yushi squeezed the armrest so tightly, his fingers turned white from the force.

No one knew what those two words meant to him at a time like this.

That pleasant male voice said: “Let’s go.”

\*

[1439.04.06 06:00:21]

The capsules landed in a secluded part of the city and was quietly hidden away.

It was raining lightly.

The two of them walked down the quiet streets in the early morning hours. Neither of them spoke.

With the artificial face concealing Ji Yushi’s expressions, Song Qinglan was unable to see his true emotions. There would occasionally be other people passing by on the street. They walked for a long time before they passed by an old-fashioned cake shop on the corner of the street and ran into customers who had just left the shop to head to work.

When walking a short distance side by side with these people, for a moment, Song Qinglan almost couldn’t tell which one was Ji Yushi.

Fortunately, they were going the same way.

In spring, the rain was somewhat chilly.

Ji Yushi suddenly stopped and hid in the corner.

Song Qinglan also stopped. He asked, “What’s wrong?”

He seemed to be cold. His teeth chattered as he spoke, “Ahead at ten o’clock.”

Song Qinglan looked in the direction he pointed out.

He saw a man in a black combat uniform sitting on a bench on the side of the street.



He held a small cake in his hands. In the rain, he stared motionlessly at it with lowered eyes.

Song Qinglan retracted his gaze and similarly leaned against the wall.

Ji Yushi looked at him. His breathing was a little chaotic. He felt a little at loss facing all of this again.

Song Qinglan's face was unfamiliar, but his gaze and tone were the same as always, "When you secretly ran off last time, you even had a cake behind our backs?"

# Chapter 91: Chapter 91

## Our Reality.

### Chapter 91

The cake wasn't the main issue here. Song Qinglan asked something else, but Ji Yushi didn't hear him clearly, "Huh?"

Song Qinglan asked, "How was the taste?"

He looked closely at Ji Yushi's face as he spoke in a relaxed, laid-back tone, "With you sitting there staring dumbly at it for so long without eating, was it because it tasted bad? Where did you get it?"

When Ji Yushi returned last time, he didn't have any money on him and because of the restrictions with his equipment, he also couldn't make mobile payments.

That was why Song Qinglan asked this question.

"The owner of the cake shop gave it." Ji Yushi answered, ".....It was delicious."

At least, the taste was exactly the same as the one in his memories.

"As long as I don't have my eyes on you, someone would give you something." Song Qinglan clicked his tongue, "Looks like I will need to watch you more closely."

Ji Yushi's thoughts followed Song Qinglan's words. These ridiculous words helped alleviate much of his panic and confusion from earlier, pulling him back to reality. His mind was clear again, "The owner is thirty years older

than me.” He leaned back against the wall and responded to Song Qinglan’s words, “I used to visit her shop often when I was young. She was very nice.”

Song Qinglan smiled.

In the rain and fog, Ji Yushi’s voice sounded a little hazy.

He went on to say, “On the day of the incident, I also bought a cake from her shop before going home.”

On that day more than ten years ago, although it was a distant memory, Ji Yushi still remembered every detail.

“I bought four so that if he worked very late because of overtime, I wouldn’t be hungry. He would usually get takeaway from a restaurant he frequented when he returned late and sometimes would also bring back a small card from there. The card had the smell of perfume. The owner of the restaurant wanted to pursue him, but he had no idea. I later felt that I maybe should’ve told him about it. Perhaps he would’ve started a new relationship and perhaps something different may have happened that day.”

There was no what if’s in this world. This was something they both knew.

But Song Qinglan didn’t refute or console him.

This day was destined to be a day belonging to Ji Yushi, a day belonging to Sheng Han.

They stood under the eaves for a while. Gradually, there were more people. From time to time, passers-by would look at them—It was mostly because Song Qinglan was too tall and the two stood too closely together so it attracted their attention. Fortunately, they were too busy rushing to work or the morning market so they didn’t pay them much heed.

About ten minutes later.

Song Qinglan glanced out from the corner.

He saw that the Ji Yushi from before was still sitting in daze looking at the small cake.

“How long did you sit there for?” Song Qinglan asked, “When did you leave?”

“Left at 7:44.” Ji Yushi remembered very clearly.

The incident happened around 7:50. Last time he had made up his mind, so he left before the time came.

Song Qinglan looked down at his communicator. It displayed [1439:04:06 07:16:32].

There was still about thirty minutes. It was pretty much what Ji Yushi told him when he returned after secretly running off. Ji Yushi had used the entire time to be in daze.

“What’s the matter?” Ji Yushi beside him was a little nervous.

Song Qinglan was about to answer but he was instead slightly surprised.

Less than ten metres away from them, the Ji Yushi in the black combat uniform habitually took out the game console from his pocket and a piece of paper fell out as he did this. It glittered as it fell to the ground.

It was a piece of golden foil.

The kind that wrapped around chocolate.

Ji Yushi held it between his fingers. He had his head lowered so his expression couldn’t be seen.

When they were in Rubik’s Cube, Song Qinglan had secretly given him a chocolate. This was something only the two of them knew.

Seeing this scene, Song Qinglan’s heart was hit hard. It was as if someone was smacking his chest forcefully with a stick. He suddenly retracted his

gaze and pressed the Ji Yushi who was about to check the outside situation against the wall.

People came and went.

The eyes of passers-by stopped on them again.

“There are people watching.” Ji Yushi whispered a reminder.

“I know.” Song Qinglan’s hands were very strong. He gripped Ji Yushi’s shoulders with so much force, it was a little painful. His voice was low and filled with restraint, “Otherwise I would’ve....”

Because they were too close, those words were spoken extremely softly, and his breath could be felt distinctly. It made the situation a little more ambiguous than usual.

The faces of the two were different.

But their eyes reflected each other’s true appearance.

A fire seemed to have been lit in Song Qinglan’s dark eyes. It made Ji Yushi feel like he was about to be scalded. He didn’t understand why the other party would suddenly behave like this. He had never seen such strong emotions in Song Qinglan’s eyes.

Fortunately, three or four seconds later, Song Qinglan slowly relaxed his grip.

He didn’t do anything and just bowed his head, “Suddenly so glad I gave you the chocolate.”

Ji Yushi: “?”

The timing and occasion weren’t right. Now wasn’t the time to talk about this.

And so, Song Qinglan only chuckled lightly and skipped over this topic. He made a live report of the current situation to Ji Yushi, “Right now, the other

‘you’ has started to play Tetris.”

Ji Yushi naturally knew what his other self more than ten metres away from him was doing.

Song Qinglan asked, “If we pass by now, would the other ‘you’ notice?”

The other Ji Yushi sat on a bench that one had to pass by in order to enter the community.

Song Qinglan wasn’t sure if it was appropriate to do something like this now or if they should wait until the other Ji Yushi left first because as long as they didn’t dally, they could still catch up with the murder little Sheng Han met.

As long as they took over the perfect location —— that bench, they would be able to see clearly the murderer’s appearance.

“Probably not.” Ji Yushi said, “In my memory, I don’t remember seeing two sneaky looking, suspicious gay men.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

It was his first time hearing someone describe himself and his boyfriend like this.

It was very precise.

Ji Yushi had already done many Recorder missions and many of them would only be successful after doing it several times. He had accepted the fact that there could be several of him at the same time but this was his first time where he encountered a situation where he couldn’t be seen by his other self.

Any mistake could make his past self change his mind. Even if the odds were small, they couldn’t take risks.

“But we can still wait.” Ji Yushi looked at his watch. His thoughts were the same as Song Qinglan, “The murderer would pass by this place sooner or

later. Waiting for my other self to leave wouldn't be too late.”

\*

[1439:04:06 07:44:12]

Ji Yushi who redeemed his reward following the end of the Rubik's Cube mission left the bench.

Wearing the black combat uniform, his thin and slender figure disappeared into the drizzling rain.

The two people hiding around the corner stepped out and walked over to the bench while following the eaves.

The bench sat under a wooden roof on the side of the road. During spring, the yellow and green vines grew through it, enclosing it into a small world sheltered from the sun and rain. There seemed to still be some warmth left behind by the other Ji Yushi.

There was a small cake left on the bench.

Its owner was too preoccupied and had accidentally left it behind.

Ji Yushi picked it up and then threw it in the bin. Who would have thought that he would help himself from more than ten days ago clean up?

The front entrance of the community faced the main road.

The two were even more conspicuous standing here.

Ji Yushi sat back down on the bench while Song Qinglan stood a little further away. Like this, they looked like they didn't know each other and just happened to be in the same place hiding from the rain.

They tacitly didn't speak.

Both were paying attention to the time ticking past.

[1439:04:06 07:49:45]

Five minutes passed.

The main road was still normal. There was no one suspicious.

Ji Yushi almost couldn't wait any longer.

Song Qinglan leaned against the wooden column. He twisted a leaf in his hand and quietly looked around the community.

Time passed very quickly but also very slowly.

Every minute and every second felt like it stretched on infinitely, but it also disappeared very quickly.

[1439:04:06 07:51:45]

“What if he was originally in the community and didn't enter from here in the first place?” Ji Yushi suddenly stood up. Ignoring everything else, he felt uneasy, “I didn't see the exact time that year so I'm not certain what minute and what second it was, but ‘I’ should be out soon. My first class should start at 8:15.”

He was talking about his other self who should be getting ready for school.

The little eight-year-old Sheng Han.

If they waited any longer, they would see little Sheng Han walk out of the community and it would mean that they had missed the critical time point.

Song Qinglan also thought of this issue and immediately said, “Let's go in together.”

Ji Yushi's lips had lost its colour.

Upon closer inspection, he was trembling slightly too.



Song Qinglan approached him and grabbed his shoulder. He said quickly, “Don’t worry. Even if we miss the critical time point, we can still see his appearance when he comes out!”

Ji Yushi knew this of course.

None of this could be changed anyway. The death of his father was already something set into stone so it didn’t matter whether he saw the murderer before or after the murder and it wouldn’t affect his objective of returning to his time and closing the case.

But even if he understood this, he couldn’t just watch his father die.

It was as if.....as long as he saw the murderer in advance, he could stop all of this.

It was a kind of instinct.

This thought was very dangerous.

It was raining harder.

The two of them were cold and wet. They didn’t bring any umbrellas.

Song Qinglan quickly pulled up Ji Yushi’s hood to help protect him from the rain.

Everything Song Qinglan did was very meticulous. When he was done, he kissed him on the forehead and give him a strong hug, “Don’t be afraid. We’re in this together.”

Ji Yushi, “Yeah.”

The two entered the rain.

After taking no more than a few steps, Ji Yushi suddenly stopped. His face turned pale, “Song Qinglan....”

In the rain, water droplets fell from Song Qinglan’s nose, “What?”

Ji Yushi's entire body was wet with rain.

The old-fashioned hoodie had darkened considerably. At first glance, it looked almost purple.

His artificial face with no distinctive features was partially covered by the hood. Raindrops fell from his eyebrows and eyelashes, making his eyes appear even darker and his face even paler.

"I know now." He said, "I...."

Not waiting for Song Qinglan to ask, he clenched his fists, his nails digging deeply into his palms. Each word was slowly spoken, "I have to go in alone."

Song Qinglan felt that something seemed off. He sternly refused, "No."

Ji Yushi didn't speak.

Song Qinglan helped him wipe away the tears on his face which had started to fall at some unknown point in time. His thumb brushed over his long and thick eyelashes, and he said amidst the sound of the rain, "I am your guardian this time. If you went in alone, there is no guarantee that something wouldn't happen."

Ji Yushi raised his eyes to look at him. The look in his eyes was shocking, "It has already happened."

Song Qinglan felt a chill, "What has already happened?!"

"There's no time!!" Ji Yushi's entire body was trembling. He grabbed his clothes, his joints turning white from how much strength he was exerting, "I have to meet the conditions! You have to let me go alone! To complete a set event at a set time, have you forgotten?!"

To complete a set event at a set time.

This line activated the switch of absolute trust. Song Qinglan's heart trembled.

He let go of him.

Ji Yushi also released him. He turned around and entered the community without looking back.

Flowers and vegetation flourished, everything was just like before.

He had gone back to this point countless times in his dreams and those dreams felt more realistic than now.

Step by step, he walked upstairs like a zombie. Small s that had not yet been cleaned up were scattered everywhere.

Floor by floor, the corridor lights turned on.

He stepped onto the last set of stairs leading to the ninth floor and reached the point where the stairs turned.

There was a child in a yellow raincoat and a backpack. He looked well-behaved and he was holding onto the strap of his schoolbag.

He stopped and looked at the child.

The child also looked up at him.

Those eyes were clean and clear, and very innocent.

Destiny was a circle.

They passed each other by.

**KK has something to say:**



# Chapter 92: Chapter 92

## Our Reality

### Chapter 92

“How is the situation inside?”

Song Qinglan’s voice sounded in his mind.

Through the subcutaneous communicator, Song Qinglan tried his best to remain calm and composed, but there was still a hint of some anxiousness.

Ji Yushi still had one more step left. His movements were mechanical. When he heard this question, he stopped.

“Ji Yushi.” Song Qinglan ordered sternly, “Say something!”

The corridor had returned to silence.

The sound of the other person’s footsteps disappeared.

Ji Yushi looked back. He saw through the window the small figure carrying a schoolbag leave. The yellow raincoat was made of waterproof material. Light raindrops fell onto the surface, gathering together to form large drops. He passed through the shadows of the camphor trees and disappeared in the distance.

“It’s me.” Ji Yushi replied to Song Qinglan through his mind. His tone was much calmer than he thought, “The so-called ‘murderer’ I met in the corridor back then.....the one wearing a purple hoodie whose face I couldn’t see, it was me.”

The two weren't able to see the murderer appear despite waiting for so long. It was only until Song Qinglan helped him put on the hood and he was soaked by the rain that he realised this.

Song Qinglan's breathing stopped for a few seconds. It was soon followed by a low curse.

He also understood what Ji Yushi meant by meeting the conditions and what he meant by completing a set event at a set time. They had already experienced something like this in the Ouroboros mission!

Not to mention Ji Yushi who was the involved party, even the palms of himself as an outsider was covered in cold sweat.

Without a murderer, could Sheng Yun's case really have been a suicide? Or was there another murderer?

Song Qinglan almost wanted to rush into the community because he knew better than ever Ji Yushi's current situation and mood.

But he couldn't comfort Ji Yushi at this moment, nor could he intervene with the rest of the matter. In his shock, he could only suppress his frustration and quickly ask, "What are you going to do?"

"I plan to.....continue."

He took another step and continued moving

Those past seventeen years had been dark days for him.

He had constantly been searching for a face he couldn't remember and even thought he didn't see it. He had never thought that it would turn out to be himself.

Everything had a cause and effect.

Everything he was doing now was something that was done in the past. Did anything change? He didn't know. He could only follow his intuition.

Perhaps this was the only way he could finish drawing the circle — The only way he could reach the truth.

Hearing his answer, Song Qinglan's voice through the private channel was scarily low.

“Okay.” He said, “I’m here with you.”

Ji Yushi didn’t know if he had responded to him. Perhaps he responded with a ‘mhn’ or perhaps he didn’t.

He stepped onto the new floor.

He didn’t notice that his breathing was very quick, and he also didn’t notice how quickly his heart was beating.

In front of him was a familiar old, black door.

A minute ago, the eight-year-old Sheng Han closed it and went to school.

Seventeen years ago, Ji Yushi bid farewell to his father here.

He raised his hand and rang the doorbell.

No one answered.

He rang the doorbell again because he knew his father was still at home.

This time the door opened.

The young professor wearing glasses appeared behind the door. He looked at him and asked, “You are?”

Hearing Sheng Yun’s voice, Song Qinglan’s breathing stopped.

Ji Yush’s eyelashes trembled slightly. He didn’t know if it was thanks to the artificial face or if it was because his mental state had collapsed to the point that he had become numb, he appeared very calm, “Hello Teacher Sheng, my name is Ji Yushi.”

Not Sheng Han.

Ji Yushi.

A name was just a title, but it was enough to change the goal he would pursue his entire life.

“Ji Yushi?”

“Yes. Professor Ji asked me to come. Can I come in?”

Hearing that a friend had asked him to come and the other party also happened to have the surname Ji, Sheng Yun only hesitated for a moment before nodding, “Come in.”

Ji Yushi stepped inside.

No one knew how important this one step of his was to him.

The place where the father and son lived didn’t have any womanly air, and it was even a little messy.

He turned and looked at the dried Boston fern. In those countless dreams he had, he had constantly thought that he should water it a little.

“Please sit.” Sheng Yun moved away the clothes piled up on the sofa to make some room, “Sorry, the place is a little messy.”

Ji Yushi, “Thank you.”

The Sheng Yun before him had changed his clothes. He wasn’t wearing the outfit he wore two or three minutes ago when he had breakfast with Sheng Han.

In Ji Yushi’s memory, he remembered clearly that his father was wearing a light grey dress shirt and black trousers. His eyes moved to the dining table not far away. The plates there had not yet been cleaned up and there was still half a sandwich left on the plate belonging to Sheng Yun—His father was usually quite casual. Even if some crumbs or sauce fell onto his

trousers during his meal, he wouldn't change out of it if it wasn't too visible. Something like this had happened during the breakfast he had just now and his father had just subconsciously patted it off and continued to eat while writing notes.

At this moment, Sheng Yun had changed into a pair of beige trousers and even changed his shirt.

The visitor was a guest. Sheng Yun went and poured some water for Ji Yushi, "Why didn't Old Ji call if he needed something? He even made you come all this way? I would have already gone to work at this time."

Ji Yushi, "I met your son just now, so I knew you were at home."

Sheng Yun asked, "You know my son?"

Ji Yushi said, "I saw him once at Professor Ji's place."

Sheng Yun's voice travelled to the kitchen, "I see. When the doorbell rang just now, I thought he forgot something."

Ji Yushi's eyes fell onto the bookshelf again. There was a stack of documents compiled by his father. It could be said that all those years of hard work were all there.

They were supposed to be in the study but at this moment they were in the living room.

He had recalled this moment countless times before and he also saw that stack of documents many times but why didn't he notice this until now?

There was the sound of water from the kitchen.

It was Sheng Yun washing the cup.

Ji Yushi stood up and walked towards the documents.

He saw on the very top information his father had written that morning when he was having breakfast and beside it was the transparent panel his



father used for work.

he asked, “With so much paperwork packed, are you going on a business trip?”

The sound of water stopped.

Sheng Yun didn’t answer.

Ji Yushi subconsciously took another two steps and arrived at the entrance of the study.

The door was tightly closed here and flowing out through the crack under the door was bright red blood. It quietly sank into the dark carpet, so it was almost undetectable.

In an instant, Ji Yushi’s ears were roaring.

Seventeen years ago, Sheng Han who had returned home from school found his father’s body in a pool of blood in the study.

“Clunk.” A soft sound.

Ji Yushi looked back. The Sheng Yun behind him had placed down the cup half filled with water, leaving fingerprints on the wall of the cup.

They looked at each other.

For a moment, even the sound of a needle falling could be heard.

“Why aren’t you speaking?” Song Qinglan asked through the private channel, “What’s wrong?!”

Ji Yushi looked at the Sheng Yun in front of him. He heard himself ask, “Who are you?”

Sheng Yun didn’t speak.

“Or more specifically, which year are you from?” Ji Yushi paused at this point and quickly followed it up with the answer to his own question, “I think you should be from a year ago, that is, April 6, 1438. The morning you went to work, you discovered that all your clothes had not been washed and there wasn’t anything to wear so you could only randomly put together this set on you. Those beige trousers were originally paired with a white shirt but unfortunately in the evening of October 14, 1437, Sheng Han used the washing machine for the first time and accidentally ruined that shirt.”

He had managed to casually mention all the fine details of his daily life with his son from a year ago. Sheng Yun was alert, “Who are you?!”

Ji Yushi was also silent.

The blood in the study was still spreading. The colour of the carpet was getting darker.

When Sheng Han later returns from school, he would find the carpet completely soaked and the air filled with the smell of blood. Following that, he would hesitantly open the door to the study and be met with a sight that would change his life from then on.

Ji Yushi took out the small black and white game console. It was a little mottled at the back and looked very worn out. It was unknown how many years it had been used for.

And right now, on the cabinet beside the cup of water, sat a completely intact game console. It was a gift Sheng Yun had given his son a year ago.

Ji Yushi placed the one in his hand next to it.

The two game consoles, one old and one new. They were identical.

Sheng Yun was struck by lightning. He understood everything in an instant. He was stunned in place: “You——”

Just like that, tears fell from Ji Yushi’s eyes.

It was like Sheng Yun had suddenly returned to his senses. He strode over but he bypassed Ji Yushi who stood there and instead went straight to the stack of documents as well as the transparent panel beside him

Ji Yushi had never felt so cold before.

Even when he was about to freeze to death during the Chaos mission, it was a thousand times better than how he felt right now, “Why?!”

Sheng Yun gathered the documents and made a move to leave but he eventually stopped, “I have to do this!”

Ji Yushi continued to ask, “Why?!”

Tears flowed down Ji Yushi’s face. The face under the artificial face was extremely fragile and he was actually on the verge of breaking down. Disregarding all his rational thoughts, he only hysterically asked, “Why are you doing this?!”

“Listen to me, this is the only way to get out of that project.” Sheng Yun held tightly onto the documents and transparent panel, “These materials are very important to me. I’ve planned this for a year but couldn’t do it a year ago because there were still many puzzles that hadn’t been solved. I gave myself a year. One year should be enough for me to thoroughly research everything!”

Facing the young man who was already about the same height as himself, Sheng Yun couldn’t use his fatherly tone. Rather than giving his son an explanation, he was instead explaining the entire situation, “Humans are not gods. Time has to continue in a linear manner. No one should change the way it works! I have to stop it!”

Ji Yushi’s lips trembled, “So you.....”

In order to terminate that project and get out of it completely, decided to kill yourself?!

Sheng Yun's eyes were red, "I just didn't think that on the appointed day, I would encounter the future you!"

Reaching this point, he also couldn't control his tears, "I'm sorry."

They had respectively crossed through one year and seventeen years. They met in this place which contained the memories of the two people.

Two generations of traversers. Two people with different purposes.

"So all of this was predetermined?" Ji Yushi's vision was blurred, "You planned today's death a year ago?"

"It's a death in a biological sense." Time was tight so Sheng Yun spoke very quickly, "I will go back to one year ago and from there travel to another time and space. Perhaps it would be a few years later, or perhaps twenty years later. I will stay here for as long as possible until I complete my project and find a better way to stabilise everything and let time move forward smoothly!"

"Sheng Han."

"Dad didn't really die." He said, "You have to be strong."

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"The Inspectors are coming."

Ji Yushi's entire body was shaking.

By the time he returned to his senses, the place was empty. Only the smell of blood from the study had become more intense.

He rushed out the door and ran down the stairs two steps at a time.

What should happen had already happened. It didn't matter if history was changed, he had more to say and more questions to ask!

Through the subcutaneous communicator, Ji Yushi shouted, “Song Qinglan!”

As if standing by, Song Qinglan didn’t dally for even a second, “I’m here.”

Hearing those two words, hearing Song Qinglan’s voice, Ji Yushi had the urge to cry again.

Without having to verbally make his request, Song Qinglan who had heard the entire thing while outside the community completely understood his thoughts.

“Don’t worry.” The pleasant male voice was cold, “I saw him.”

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Ji Yushi ran past the area shaded by camphor trees that he had walked through numerous times as a child and ran out of the community he had lived in for eight years which carried all of his childhood memories.

At this moment, Ji Yushi was even thinking, no wonder the incident was deemed a suicide back then!

A person had travelled from the past to the future to kill themselves. As long as they returned to their original time and space after killing their future self and continued to live without incident and without changing their mind, they could just wait for the moment their past self comes to kill them. This was simply a perfect circle. It was flawless.

The past and future were intertwined. It was so messy, it was like a spiderweb that couldn’t be unravelled.

The more he thought about it, the more frightened he felt.

Wait a minute!

Ji Yushi stopped in his steps. If that was the case, then——On the day of his death, his father should have already known for a long time that his past self would come and find his future self!

In other words, his father knew the day of his death at least a year in advance.

Smiling while in the face of death, acting calmly like usual, what kind of perseverance and strong mentality did he need to be able to do that?!

Ji Yushi had too many questions and too many things he needed an answer to.

He ran straight out of the community. It was raining wherever he could see. The bus across the street drove away, taking away with it a wave of busy office workers and students. Sheng Yun was more familiar with the surveillance system here than he was and definitely wouldn't appear in a conspicuous place, so he was certain he didn't get on that bus.

As soon as the bus left, there were fewer people in the rain.

Ji Yushi suddenly looked in one direction and his breathing hastened — With his excellent eyesight, he saw Sheng Yun flash by carrying a bag. He disappeared into the area covered with vines.

That was exactly where he and Song Qinglan was before.

He gritted his teeth and rushed over towards the bench.

In the heavy rain, he saw Song Qinglan employ a one-handed grappling technique and successfully suppress Sheng Yun. He had his head bowed as he said something before the two of them turned and looked over at him. Both of their expression suddenly changed.

“Carefu——”

“Bang——”

It was a muffled sound of gun firing.

At that moment, time seemed to have slowed down.

Song Qinglan's voice ripped into Ji Yushi's ears and at the same time, a bullet also entered his body.

The feeling of a bullet penetrating through his skin and muscle was very familiar. He first felt the heavy blow and it was soon followed by overwhelming pain. The moment blood spattered out, he slipped and fell into the mud.

It hurts.

Ji Yushi's face was pressed against the cold asphalt. His eyelashes were wet from the rain. He saw several people in dark blue uniforms walk out from a hidden part of the street, all with guns in their hands and a dignified expression.

They were the Inspectors who had come to inspect the scene after that incident happened that year.

And he was regarded as the murderer described by Sheng Han.

Suddenly, someone pulled him into their embrace and pressed his face against their body, bringing him a touch of warmth.

“.....How are you?”

That person held him tightly and his voice trembled so much, it was almost inaudible. He continued to apply pressure to the wound on his chest.

“Ji Yushi, say something. Answer me.”

Warm liquid fell onto Ji Yushi's face. He opened his eyes with great difficulty and saw an unfamiliar face with no memorable features crying. Only that pair of dark eyes allowed him to recognise who it was. He didn't have the superb abilities of Lin Xinlan who could recognise Song Qinglan despite the fact that he was using an artificial face, but he recognised those eyes.

“Song.....Qinglan.”

He said unconsciously.

Song Qinglan's hands were completely soaked with blood. He kissed his forehead with his cold lips, ".....I'm here."

Ji Yushi looked over at the bench. Not far away, a figure knelt under the vines, completely distraught. He didn't dare step out of the shadows that obscured him.

On the other side, several Inspectors approached them with their guns. Onlookers screamed from the other side of the road.

He was held in Song Qinglan's arms. He didn't want to move a single finger. In fact, he wanted to tell Song Qinglan that only with this could the conditions be considered as being met.

But he really had no strength left.

He tried his best but could only move his lips. He silently said one word to that person in the distance, "Go."

Go and do what needed to be done.

Go to another time and space.

Go and find that stabilised point more than ten years in the future and create the parent Tianqiong system.

Let me use my last efforts to complete this circle.

The young professor used all his energy to support himself up before finally disappearing under the wooden roof covered in vines.

Ji Yushi's heart was very calm.

The Inspectors surrounded them. Facing those guns, Song Qinglan raised his head and said something to them, like an angry beast roaring.

He couldn't hear it clearly.



The bin on the roadside had fallen over at some unknown point in time. Trash from within it scattered all over the ground and the little cake from earlier had also fallen out.

The last time he came here, that cake was left forgotten on the bench.

This time, the sweet smell attracted over stray animals looking to scavenge through the bin.

The rain was becoming smaller, and the raindrops were becoming finer.

It was like there was a hazy mist covering his eyes.

Through his blurred vision, Ji Yushi saw a group of kittens who seemed to have just been weaned. They looked like they were only two months old at most.

It was unknown where the mother had gone. Perhaps it was because they were too hungry, they constantly cried and eagerly ate the sweet tasting cake.

It was three little black kittens.

Their entire body was pitch-black. There weren't any other colours mixed in.

**KK has something to say:**

So much to comment about but too overwhelmed to say anything ><

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But shouldn't those Inspectors be acting more discretely? To avoid causing changes to the past.....

# Chapter 93: Chapter 93

## Closed Cycle

### Chapter 93

[1448.08.13 16:03:51]

The weather was hot and sultry. It seemed like it was soon about to rain.

Ji Yushi leaned against the car window as Ji Minyue nagged, “Mum and I have already helped clean up your place. After my careful inspection, we have already prepared everything you need. Look at this, according to the weather forecast, the next few days will be heavy rain. Why don’t you move out later and stay home for a few more days?”

At the age of seventeen, he had just graduated from high school.

He was suddenly hit with an impulsive urge and booked a plane ticket without saying a word before running off to Kado Island to play.

By the time the Ji family received a call from him, he had already arrived at his destination.

Returning today, it was Ji Minyue who drove over to pick him up.

Ji Yushi had been in the sun in Kado for more than half a month and his skin was darker than before, giving him a healthy glow.

Hearing Ji Minyue’s suggestion, he replied, “Whether or not it rains shouldn’t have anything to do with going home? Didn’t you also move out before you turned eighteen?”

Young and rebellious.

Everyone had a time like this. It was just that this rebellious stage came to Ji Yushi a little late.

Ji Minyue was also still in his twenties, and he still retained his youthful heart, “Alright then. Instead of learning the good things, you just had to learn my bad habits.”

Ji Yushi looked over, “Who said I was learning from you?”

Ji Minyue, “Old Ji said it.”

After dropping Ji Yushi off, Ji Minyue left.

Sure enough, everything had been cleaned up very well. Aunt Su was so meticulous, even the most basic daily necessities were prepared, including but not limited to paper towels, handwash and the likes. It was filled with motherly love. This was Ji Yushi’s first time living alone. His family was worried but those days with someone taking care of him was too easy of a life for him. He just wanted to learn to be independent as soon as possible.

When he woke up the next morning, the sky was gloomy. It really was about to rain.

Ji Yushi’s suitcase was still on the wooden floor. After returning yesterday, he didn’t have time to tidy up. There were only a few clothes inside and most of it were small gimmicks he had brought back from Kado.

He walked back and forth through his place barefoot and when he went to the kitchen to pour himself some water, he vaguely heard a small cry.

At first, he thought it was just his imagination.

But even after he finished drinking his glass of water, the cry continued.

“Meow~”

It was small and soft, like it belonged to a young kitten. It also sounded like there was more than one.

The kitchen had a large window with white venetian blinds. Through the window, he could see the garden behind the community where luscious plants grew. He pushed aside the blinds and found that the sky outside was incredibly cloudy, and it had also started to rain. The rain came very quickly and fell with great force.

After opening the window, the sound of rain hitting the leaves and ground grew louder. The faint cries seemed to come from the garden.

How could there be cats?

He hesitated for a moment and then put on his shoes and brought along an umbrella. He planned to take a look.

Holding an umbrella, the young man walked into the community garden for the first time.

The rain was falling heavily. It fell onto the umbrella, drawing a line as it flowed to the edge and fell to the ground. The edges of his pants were wet. After reaching a deep part of the garden, he saw a litter of kittens.

There was a cardboard box under the bushes. It was already drenched by the rain.

The three kittens that looked no more than two months old were completely black. They scratched at the cardboard box in attempt to crawl out and were also meowing in panic.

Inside the box were also milk powder and cat food, but there was no one nearby.

Ji Yushi squatted down. He gently stroked a kitten's head with his finger. Only after he was certain that they weren't very dirty did he feel reassured enough to pet them properly. He held the umbrella so that the rain wouldn't

reach the cardboard box. He waited patiently in place for a long time but didn't see anyone come to take them away.

He determined that this was an abandoned litter of kittens.

Ji Yushi carried the cardboard box in his arms and got ready to take the kittens to the property management office to see if they knew what to do.

As soon as he stood up, he saw that there was a person standing in the garden pavilion not far away.

In the heavy rain, Ji Yushi couldn't see very clearly. He could only tell that the person was very tall, probably more than one metre ninety. Despite being unable to see their appearance, it was hard for him to overlook those long legs. Just standing there, that person was very noticeable.

Appearing in the garden during a heavy rain like this, he was likely a resident taking shelter here.

Ji Yushi decided to call out, "Hey!"

His voice was muffled by the rain that grew louder and louder, "Did you see who put the cats here just now?"

That person didn't move.

Afraid that the other party might not have heard him, he started to walk over, "Hello, can you hear me?"

One hand held the umbrella and the other held the cardboard box.

To prevent the kittens from getting wet, Ji Yushi had tilted the umbrella to the side and half of his body was wet.

He walked along the paved path and was soon about to reach the pavilion.

That person clearly had his back to him but, as if there were eyes on his back, his body suddenly stiffened.

Immediately afterwards, that man suddenly left without looking back.

Ji Yushi was stunned. He wasn't able to catch up.

He changed his route and took the three kittens to the property management office. The staff there said that they hadn't heard of anyone raising kittens recently, but they could help and see if any of the residents wanted to adopt them and if there weren't any, they would be sent to the stray animal rescue centre. Before Ji Yushi went, he heard the staff complain about the heartless owner abandoning such small kittens outside during a rainstorm and remembered the figure he saw in the garden.

Ji Yushi asked, "Can you help check the surveillance cameras for me?"

Ji Yushi was only a seventeen or eighteen-year-old student who looked someone who had been raised preciously.

The staff didn't expect him to take this matter so seriously, "Check the surveillance cameras?"

"Yes." Ji Yushi said, "It shouldn't infringe on other people's privacy. Just the cameras in the public areas should be fine?"

They replayed the recordings.

Moving to an hour ago, they saw someone enter the garden holding a cardboard box.

The person was very tall, and the cardboard box looked almost a size smaller in his arms. Ji Yushi saw him stand below his building for almost half an hour and he would also look up at the building from time to time as if he was waiting for someone.

It was rather dark just before the rainstorm and the man also wore a hat, making it difficult for them to properly see his appearance.

The staff scolded, "Damn! Such a big person would still abandon pets! If you can't raise it, don't buy it. At least give them away or send them to a rescue. This is too immoral!"

Ji Yushi didn't mention anything about the matter in the garden just now. He didn't think it was necessary. He just asked, "Is he a resident here?"

The staff said, "He shouldn't be. I haven't seen anyone so tall here!"

Speaking of this, the staff got even more angry. That person even went specifically to their community to abandon their cats!

Ji Yushi left the property management office.

When he got back and changed out of his wet clothes to shower, he saw a few black cat hairs stuck to his T-shirt.

After his shower, he left the bathroom.

He had some bread for breakfast and then laid onto the sofa to read a book.

The house was quiet but the rain outside was still falling.

The loneliness in this place was overwhelming.

He stood up, put on his shoes and found the umbrella that was still dripping despite shaking off the rain earlier. He went back to the property management office.

"Why are you back again?" The other person asked, "Did you find that person?"

"No." Ji Yushi said, "I want to raise it."

The staff was surprised, "You want to raise it?"

The one who clearly dropped those cats off earlier was this young man.

Ji Yushi, "Yeah."

The staff asked, "But, if you want to raise a cat, did your family agree?"

Ji Yushi said, "I live alone."



Staff, “Alright then. Which one do you want to raise?”

“All of them.” Ji Yushi said, “My place is big. I want to raise all three.”

# Chapter 94: Chapter 94

## Closed Cycle

Chapter 94

[1451.11.22 23:35:47]

Ning City.

Outside Venus Bar.

Drunk people noisily left through the bar's back door. Under the neon lights, someone noticed a man leaning near the door.

The man was smoking a cigarette and wearing a rather outdated windbreaker. He looked like someone who had come from who knows what era. That person however was simply a person born for clothes. His enviable height and near perfect proportions made even clothes like this appear different on him, even making it look several degrees more attractive.

Unfortunately when one follows the clothes and look up, his face was hidden in the shadows.

Meeting such a man here, even if they couldn't see his face clearly, it was enough for the more daring people to come forward and strike up a conversation.

“Handsome.” A young man with dyed chestnut coloured hair walked over. His pants hung loosely around his waist, revealing his thin hip bones, “Wanna hook up?”

A red ball of flame flashed between the man's slender fingers.

A ring of smoke escaped from his mouth.

“Not interested.”

The other party's voice was also very pleasant to hear. It wasn't too thick and was instead a very sensual mid-bass that carried a slight resonance. It was enough to make one's heart itch when heard.

The young man was very bold. He got a little closer and provocatively hooked his finger around the other person's belt, “Don't be so cold. Let's have some fun together. It's better than standing here alone smoking.”

The hand that loosened the belt didn't leave.

It continued down like a snake. Just as he was about to deliberately make the next move, the hand was suddenly grabbed.

The young man was caught by surprise by this sudden sharp pain on his wrist and let out a cry.

“Not interested.”

The man said again. His voice was piercingly cold. He spoke mercilessly, “Scram.”

The young man was thrown aside.

When he did this, the man's face that was hidden in the shadows was also exposed.

It was a very ordinary face. The eyebrows were not thick or stylish, the nose wasn't tall, and even the lips were extremely plain. Except for the pair of eyes which were quite deep, the rest of the appearance was rather disappointing. This ordinary face didn't match with the enviable figure, it was such a waste.

The young man had strong self-esteem. He was about to make a fuss after being rejected but he lost interest when he saw the face, so he cursed and left while massaging his wrist.

Venus was a gay bar in Ning City. The name sounded very gaudy, but it was actually a rather clean place.

The man however showed a look of disgust. After driving away a fly, he felt that this place was even more of a problematic place.

He extinguished the cigarette in his hand and easily flicked it into a nearby bin.

He didn't manage to wait for the person he was waiting for.

Perhaps that person won't be coming today.

He got up to leave and entered an alley with his hands in his pockets.

Ning City's early winter nights were very cold. The night winds felt like knives.

The man walked through Ning City's never-ending night, went through alley after alley, went through business district with high-rise buildings, and went through all the hustle and bustle.

He lived in a cheap hotel.

As long as he worked a simple, non-eye-catching job, he would be able to pay the rent without much trouble.

The area where the hotel was in was dark and poor. There were small vendors who opened in the early hours with tendencies to cheat people, young people struggling to make a living residing in basements as well gangsters and prostitutes running their businesses. He didn't fit in here but he also somehow blended in well.

He could hear low laughter coming from the room next door. He opened his own door and moved his hand along the damp wall to find the switch.

“Click.”

The moment the dim light turned on; he narrowed his eyes.

There was another person in the room.

The visitor wore glasses as well as a white dress shirt. He appeared to be less than forty years old. Having just entered his middle-ages, he still looked quite young. He had a somewhat familiar bookish air, but it was still completely different from a certain someone.

“Professor Sheng.” He said coldly.

“Cap Song.” There were slightly wrinkles between Sheng Yun’s eyebrows, “You aren’t easy to find.”

They had already met in the Rubik’s Cube mission. It was actually very easy for Sheng Yun to find out his identity.

But Song Qinglan used an artificial face which could simulate different facial features, and this made it more difficult for Sheng Yun to find him.

“As a witness of time coming from the future, I believe you have memorised and recited Tianqiong’s three laws: Never change the past, never talk about the present, never be obsessed with the future.” Sheng Yun said, “Strictly speaking, you haven’t violated those three laws because you are obsessed with the past.”

Song Qinglan raised his hand and lightly touched the device behind his ear to turn off the artificial face.

His originally heroic and handsome appearance was revealed. Facing Sheng Yun with his original face, he made no attempt to hide his coldness towards him.

Sheng Yun didn’t mind this dissatisfaction. Instead, he said, “The Inspectors in 1456 still have not discovered your disappearance but with you travelling so frequently, even if you turn off the communicator, you will inevitably leave traces. They will find you sooner or later.”

“You coming to find me is also risky.” Song Qinglan showed disdain, “Are you not afraid of being discovered by the Inspectors and making everything you did until now all in vain?”

“Not afraid.” Sheng Yun said, “Since you and Sheng Han would come to find me, it meant that I didn’t leave behind any clues in your time and space, and you only had the option of travelling back to that day to figure out the truth. I should be safe.”

As a father, Sheng Yun seemed too heartless when he said those things.

As an elder, he was still young at this time and his words didn’t carry much authority.

But the traitor in the twelfth squad, Xie Sian, was right. Although Sheng Yun didn’t look like Ji Yushi, the temperament of the two was very similar and the way they conversed and analysed was also very similar. They were both calm to the point that it was scary. As expected of this pair of father and son.

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth.

Just noticing this point was enough to make his heart rage.

His state hadn’t been very good these past few days. He knew it himself.

He couldn’t sleep at night and would wake up again and again from dreams where his hands were covered in blood. He was like an addict suffering from withdrawal symptoms. He could only traverse again and again to see what Ji Yushi used to be like so that the desires burning in him would diminish a little.

It was just watching. He didn’t do anything.

And he couldn’t do anything either.

If he continued like this, he didn’t know if he would one day lose his mind and rush out in desperation to let Ji Yushi recognise him.

Letting him know him three or five years in advance.

With that, they could push everything that has happened ahead. Who cares about the stability of time and space, who cares about the grandfather paradox, who cares about the circle of fate.

He didn't want to care about those at all.

To be a traitor.

Snatch away the Ji Yushi from before that incident and together fleeing to another time and space.

Song Qinglan had considered this idea more than once.

Facing Sheng Yun's appearance, Song Qinglan almost couldn't show his anger at this elder who had long been 'deceased', but the other party's calm and self-assured tone made him feel incredulous. Rather than anger, he found that he couldn't feel any respect towards this Sheng Yun.

Song Qinglan sneered, "You are indeed safe. Seeing that he was accidentally killed, you could actually still turn around and leave."

Reaching this point, Song Qinglan's eyes suddenly turned red. His eyes were full of anger, "I don't care about your so-called stability or how much sacrifice you have made for this world. Perhaps you are indeed a great person in a certain sense, but you have completely failed in your responsibilities as a father. You are not worthy of him keeping you in his heart for all those seventeen years!"

The eight-year-old who had lost his childhood.

Hyperthymesia, cognitive dysfunction.

No one had a childhood like this.

The outburst was directed at Sheng Yun, but he didn't say anything to justify himself.

He took off his glasses and squeezed the bridge of his nose tiredly. Although he was still young, he already had a lot of grey hairs.

“I originally thought that you two were perhaps good friends.” Sheng Yun murmured, ‘That’s why he would take you back with him to such an important day. Now it seems that this wasn’t the case....Your relationship was far from what I had I thought it was.”

“That’s right.” Song Qinglan directly declared possession, “He is mine.”

Sheng Yun wasn’t surprised.

He had been following the traces Song Qinglan had left behind in time and space the entire time, and the other party’s actions were enough to explain the whole situation.

As a scholar and a scientist who sees the big picture, Sheng Yun’s understanding of time and space may be better than anyone and possibly even more so than Ji Yushi.

Except for the moment when Ji Yushi was accidentally killed, Sheng Yun didn’t reveal any further breaks in his composure.

Even when witnessing his own death and given no choice but to travel around incognito all the time, his shirt had no wrinkles and was completely clean.

Song Qinglan, “Why? You still want to care about his sexual orientation?”

Sheng Yun shook his head, “No, I’m very happy that in a future that I cannot see, there would be someone who would love him like this.”

In fact, the two of them hadn’t spend much time together after confirming their relationship.

Song Qinglan’s throat tightened.

Sheng Yun put his glasses on again and asked, “So, how far can you go for him?”



Song Qinglan didn't answer immediately.

Because he was able to keenly identify the deep meaning contained in Sheng Yun's tone. He subconsciously clenched his fists, "What do you mean?"

Sheng Yun: "Or to be more precise, are you willing to sacrifice for him, even if it's your life?"

"Your understanding of us is too limited. What we have experienced may not be less than you." Song Qinglan replied through clenched teeth, "As long as this ending can be changed, I am willing to die for him a thousand times."

The young man's tone was filled with arrogance and determination. It left Sheng Yun stunned.

In the past, he also once had such courage. Although it wasn't for love, he was also full of enthusiasm.

The traversing through time and space made one forget about the importance of time as well as everything he originally had around him. He hadn't felt this way in a long time.

After a brief period of shock, Sheng Yun said a short 'good' and then returned to the dust covered table in the hotel room and turned on the transparent panel he had brought with him.

Song Qinglan stood in place, watching him closely.

"For me, several years had passed since that day." Sheng Yun said as he typed on the keyboard, "In addition to looking for you over the years, I have also achieved some results."

Song Qinglan was slightly surprised.

He knew that Sheng Yun was talking about the so-called 'Tianqiong of all eras' which was later known as Tianqiong's parent system.

The interface flashed.

The Tianqiong symbol appeared on the holographic projection projected by the transparent panel.

Immediately afterwards, a mechanical female voice sounded, “Hello, Sheng Yun. Welcome to Tianqiong. It is detected that your current time coordinate is November 22, 1451, which is more than 12 years from your point of origin. The time and space fluctuation in the current coordinate is 7. There are a total of 7 traversing activities present.....”

Song Qinglan felt that her voice sounded familiar. She was currently reporting the coordinates of the seven points of fluctuation including their point of origin and their destination. It was accurate and exhaustive. She had actually monitored the trajectories of all the Tianqiong branches in the world in one go.

This was the early form of the so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’.

Song Qinglan didn’t expect that Sheng Yun would be able to develop it to this level in such a short period of time.

“This wasn’t achieved by me alone.”

As if he could see what Song Qinglan was thinking, Sheng Yun said, “In addition to me, there are many people like me in time and space who are working hard and have sacrificed a lot more than me. For example, the one you met in Rubik’s Cube.”

Song Qinglan suddenly recalled the fat middle-aged man who appeared with Sheng Yun in Rubik’s Cube, and he also recalled the rumours of the R&D either dying or going mad.

In other words, perhaps what happened to them wasn’t what everyone had speculated and instead, everyone had used different ways of breaking free from the project and are now hiding undetected in time and space, secretly working on this.

Seeing Song Qinglan's expression change, it was clear that he had understood everything. Sheng Yun nodded at him.

“The results we got was more than this.”

Sheng Yun re-entered a code.

Then, another softer and more human-like female voice sounded.

“Welcome, Song Qinglan. Welcome to Tianqiong. I am very happy to see you again. It has been detected that you have performed and completed 12 A-level missions, 21 B-level missions, 2 Super S-level missions and 1 S-level mission. Current rating: Super one star. Your reward is zero. Do you wish to perform more missions to earn more rewards?”

Song Qinglan this time was really shocked.

Time, space, and what kind of existence they were. For the first time, he felt like he was inside a large chaotic mess and for the first time, he deeply realised how small and insignificant he was.

“When the prototype was first made, Tianqiong's parent system's complete body appeared and replaced it.” Sheng Yun said, “It's like we.....only planted down a seed, and it had already at some unknown point in time in a world far in the future, grown into a large tree. The moment the seed appears, it could already control the entirety of time and space. Perhaps in a sense, this was the original meaning of ‘Tianqiong of all eras’.”

All eras cannot exist at the same time.

But it could exist in all eras at the same time.

Song Qinglan crossed his arms, “Its appearance can change this?”

Sheng Yun shook his head, “What happened to Sheng Han in 1439 was already in the past. It cannot be changed. But in 1456 where you two came from, in terms of time and space, he is considered to still be in a state of traversing. His death wasn't his final ending.”

Song Qinglan slowly lowered his arms.

“Time is a continuous line. As long as your original line remains the same, the possibilities are endless. This means that you can choose to go back to 1456 from another point in time.” Sheng Yun continued, “Thank you for being obsessed with the past and not immediately returning to your original time and space in 1456. It allowed this to be able to be carried out.”

Sheng Yun wasn't Ji Yushi. His analysis of the matter and his explanations were far less clear compared to that of Ji Yushi's.

To him, it was like he was explaining  $1+1=2$ . It was simple but too brief.

But Song Qinglan soon thought of something and asked, “So you're saying that, without changing our original timeline and without changing the established fact that we have returned to the past, we just return to our original point from another point in the timeline?”

Thinking about it from the opposite direction, that was in fact—Crossing back from the future.

And they happened to have previously gone to the future in 1470!!

Tianqiong's female voice sounded, “I will seize you during your traversing from 1456 and take you to 1470 and overlap the current point in time with that point in time.”

Song Qinglan suddenly understood, “Wouldn't this form a time anchor?”

The anchored point was the third second after they were hijacked.

It was equivalent to them being in a huge time anchor, never having left it. They would randomly overlap with their other self in a certain cycle of the Ouroboros mission and respawn together at the starting point.

“It could be understood that way.” Tianqiong said, “To be precise, it is a time anchor only belonging to you and Ji Yushi.”

“The Ouroboros mission in 1470 is both the past and the future for you. You will need to pay attention to the paradoxes arising from the new overlap of time and space and try not to affect the existing past while maintaining the final result. Once the mission is completed, you will return from 1470 to 1456, and the time coordinate would be after you redeemed the mission reward.”

That is to say, they would return to their original point in time and space, and it would be after he accompanied Ji Yushi to 1439.

With this, the timeline remains unchanged, and history also remains intact.

What happened to them in 1439 was nothing more than a past that repeats itself in the anchor of time.

In addition to the small time anchor, there would be an even larger time anchor belonging only to the two of them added over to the top of it.

If anyone else was to hear this, they would’ve had a very difficult time understanding it.

Sheng Yun’s logical thinking ability was precise and more meticulous than ever. He had actually managed to come up with such a perfect method of resurrection.

“I asked you earlier if you were willing to sacrifice for him,” Sheng Yun faced Song Qinglan, “was because of the trigger conditions for the time anchor.”

With that, Sheng Yun took out a pistol.

A silver-white compact pistol designed after the PPK style, named Diamond Bird.

The preferences of both father and son were very similar.

Song Qinglan received it. The cold and heavy body nestled in his hand, reminding him of the hand that gradually lost its temperature that day.

The trigger condition for the time anchor: All members dead.

And this was a time anchor for himself and Ji Yushi. What he needed to do was self-evident.

“Why are you doing this?”

Song Qinglan asked lowly.

Sheng Yun knew that Song Qinglan was asking the so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’.

The gentle female voice spoke up, “I have already reminded you. After more than 170 million calculations, the probability of your squad succeeding is higher than all the other Guardian squads. I hope you can lead your squad to complete more missions. We need you to maintain the stability of time and space.”

Song Qinglan silently raised the corners of his lips. It was unknown if he was smiling or if it was mockery, “So the condition is how many missions?”

Tianqiong, “Next, I have prepared for you and your squad 2 Super S-level missions, 1 S-level mission and 1 A-level mission.”

“My squad.” Song Qinglan said, “I didn’t fucking help them agree to this condition. Don’t blame me if I break the promise when the time comes.”

Tianqiong remained silent. It didn’t refute. Perhaps it already knew the result.

This feeling of being left hanging made one feel irritated.

The energy bullets were already placed in the gun.

Song Qinglan copied Ji Yushi and pulled the safety latch. He suddenly fell silent for a few long seconds.

2 Super S-level missions, 1 S-level mission and 1 A-level mission.

The familiar rating reminded him of something. He stored away all his emotions and asked one final but deep question, “So, could this have been the reason why the seventh squad was originally hijacked?”

Otherwise, how would they explain the missions they completed after they were hijacked?

Everything had a cause and effect. Which came first and which came later?

Did the original hijacking happen first so that everything else that happened followed, or did the parent system hijack the entire squad because of everything that happened later?

Perhaps what Ji Yushi didn’t see, was this even larger circle.

They who were inside it were like ants running around.

“I cannot answer your question.” Tianqiong said, “Time progresses at the same time for me, irrespective of cause and effect, irrespective of before and after.”

Song Qinglan pointed the gun to his heart.

The answer was no longer important to him.

Sheng Yun, Inspector, 1439.

That was all in the past.

In any case, he would be returning to square one. Before pulling the trigger, he heard Tianqiong say, “You have triggered a branch mission and have exceeded the original mission conditions. The name of the mission for you: 【Overload】 .”

**KK has something to say:**

I can see why Sheng Yun did all that but I just can’t find myself liking him.....Such a failure as a father

# Chapter 95: Chapter 95

## Overload

### Chapter 95

The cold rain left a slightly tingling sensation when it hit his face.

Ji Yushi coughed out some blood which flowed out his mouth and traced down his lips and neck. He knew that this must be a sign that his lungs had been shot. With every breath taken, more blood came out.

He wanted to speak, but he couldn't say anything.

Someone was applying pressure to his chest. Seemingly realising that it was too late, that violently trembling hand then moved to his cheek and tried to wipe away the blood from his lips.

Faintly, he heard a man crying.

He wanted to say, Song Qinglan, I know now.

Those three little kittens who had accompanied me for eight years were something you gave my seventeen-year-old self who had just started living alone.

—It was after I left this world.

But every time he tried to open his mouth; more blood poured out. He could clearly feel the pain, but he couldn't control the blood flowing out.

This was his doomed ending.



His life ended here in 1439.

—He had returned to the past and became a part of history. It could no longer be changed.

He breathed sharply. He wanted to look at that face again. He wanted to tell Song Qinglan, tell him that in this short, lonely and painful life of his, he was glad he had met him.

Before falling into eternal darkness, he had a strong thought.

He didn't want to die.

.....

.....

【 Warning! Warning! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! You have deviated from the destination coordinates! 】

Ji Yushi suddenly opened his eyes.

The red light in front of him flashed and countless bizarre images flashed past his eyes. Amidst the violent shaking, familiar warnings could be heard: “Illegal transition detected! Illegal transition detected!”. He saw that he was in a confined space— It was his capsule!!

What was going on?

The capsule shook violently. Ji Yushi could only grip tightly onto the armrest. His mind had no time to think about his current situation. It only felt like it was about to explode with all the memories stuffed into it.

When everything finally calmed back down, the robotic arm delivered over some nutrient solution. He downed all of it in just a few mouthfuls. He didn't know where he was.

The gunshot wound on his chest was gone. His rapid pulse and heart rate and the side effects from traversing all reminded him that he was still alive.

After taking a while to catch his breath, he raised his head and saw what was displayed on the transparent panel in front of him. In an instant, he felt a chill run through him.

[? ? p0754%\$#37]

[: “”LRR”/’1’89”]

These strings of garbled characters were something he had seen in the Ouroboros mission.

Perhaps others may not be certain whether these garbled characters were truly the same as the ones they saw before, but with Ji Yushi’s superhuman memories, he would be able to recognise it even if it was written backwards!

He opened the capsule and walked out.

The early morning sky was dark grey and there would occasionally be cold wind cutting through the forest. Faint light came from the several silver-white capsules near him.

Someone patted him, “Advisor Ji, how do you feel? Are you okay?”

He looked back. The one who spoke was Duan Wen. Like him, the other person had just left his capsule and looked very normal. He didn’t react differently to the current situation, as if they were supposed to be in this mission that should’ve already been completed a long time ago.

Ji Yushi’s pale face looked like an ice sculpture in the dim light, “.....”

For the first time, he couldn’t make a proper sound.

There were more people now.

Tang Le and Tang Qi quietly discussed something with each other, Li Chun who continued to have no memories in each cycle, Zhou Mingxuan who remembered the previous cycles like Duan Wen, and the tall figure standing beside Zhou Mingxuan currently opening the equipment storage unit.

Wearing a black combat uniform, Song Qinglan's pair of enviable long legs were outlined, and it gave him an imposing air.

He selected his weapons and equipment, routinely checked Shen Mian, and then looked at the communicator on his wrist, "It is currently 4:43 in the morning. Let's quickly set off. After arriving at the bookstore, we will split up and go to Golden Crow No.1 and No.2."

Zhou Mingxuan asked, "Cap Song, we have already figured out the current situation so why are we still going to the bookstore?"

Song Qinglan bent over to pick out something from the storage unit and tossed it over at Ji Yushi.

Ji Yushi subconsciously caught the heavy object. It felt cold. When he looked down, he saw that it was a silver-white pistol. It was his Diamond Bird.

As if he didn't notice Ji Yushi's dazed state, Song Qinglan raised his chin and answered Zhou Mingxuan's question, "Last time we were interrupted by the survivors and didn't have enough time. Advisor Ji still needs to finish looking for clues in the books and find out what we should do when we arrive at those bases. If we don't know, no matter how many times we repeat this and no matter how many Team A's and Team B's there are, we will still end up dying."

Team A and Team B?

Ji Yushi was even more confused. Which team were they?

Why did his memory not have a scene like this? Was this just his mind playing tricks or was this reality?

Everyone was allocated their equipment.

Once they were done, they advanced towards the park management office. Duan Wen lowered his voice and explained to the remaining teammates with no memory of the cycles the current situation.

Ji Yushi followed behind everyone.

Suddenly, there was the sound of a blade cutting through the air. With a loud ‘thud’, the dark figure a short distance away from Ji Yushi fell.

It was the drifter!

Song Qinglan strode over and pulled out his military knife from the drifter’s forehead. He casually wiped it clean using the corpse’s clothes and then reattached it to the strap on his calf before walking back, “Advisor Ji, your condition isn’t good.”

Ji Yushi’s footsteps paused slightly. He didn’t know where to start.

Song Qinglan’s expression was really unfamiliar. It was the kind that he hadn’t seen in a long time. Although it didn’t have the distant feeling belonging to those who had only just become acquainted, it was a look that was only limited to a teammate. The gaze that made him feel hot was gone.

He looked at Song Qinglan and the other party’s eyes, nose and lips. They were all something he was familiar with. He remembered the warmth and gentleness when the other party kissed him, he remembered the tight embrace he was in when they skydived together, he remembered the other party’s despair and sorrow before he died, and he also remembered the figure who stood alone in the garden below his place eight years ago.

He also remembered how the other party once knew him so well, how he once solemnly and with great cherish called out his real name through their private channel.

“Sheng Han.”

That was the first time he felt a shiver run through him when he heard that name being uttered again.

“Advisor Ji?”

It was like Ji Yushi had just woken up from a dream.

In front of him, Song Qinglan was looking at him with one of his brows raised slightly. He asked in a polite tone, “Was the last death too unpleasant that you feel psychologically unwell?”

Which one?

Ji Yushi couldn’t answer this question so he could only say, “I’m fine.”

“That’s good. Find me anytime if you have any problems.” Song Qinglan nodded, “The captain’s duties include but are not limited to giving the team members psychological counselling.”

Seeing that he was about to continue ahead, Ji Yushi called out to him, “Wait a minute.”

Song Qinglan looked back and quipped, “You really need counselling?”

Ji Yushi opened his mouth, “Don’t.....you think that something isn’t right?”

Song Qinglan, “In which aspect?”

There was nothing else in those deep, black eyes except for the desire to succeed and clear the mission. It was the same as the Song Qinglan in his memory who led everyone forward time and time again.

Scenes flashed through Ji Yushi’s mind. In just one second, the pain from all the scenes gathering together and overlapping filled his mind.

The dark grey sky gradually brightened. Li Chun even found that the unpleasant smell in the air was familiar.

It was like those cycles they had gone through.

Ji Yushi who was suffering from memory overload felt like his head was about to split. Cold sweat almost completely drenched his singlet. He casually shook his head, “I’m fine.”

Unable to distinguish between memory and reality.

Unable to distinguish between something that had already happened and something that had never happened.

It has been a long time since Ji Yushi suffered from so much pain.

He followed behind the other teammates like a walking dead as they retrieved the keys for the spacecar and even calmly killed a few zombies. From his teammate's perspectives, he probably seemed no different from the past.

The spacecar filled with their equipment travelled through PU-31's devastated city.

Groups of zombies rushed towards them with their turbid eyes and pale faces while waving their hands around. They were all mercilessly crushed into pulp by the spacecar.

They arrived at the bookstore at the fastest speed possible. After dealing with the elderly zombie in the bookstore, the copy of <Golden Crow No. 1: Propagation> was stuffed into Ji Yushi's hands. He had been interrupted by the dark-skinned man last time and wasn't able to finish looking through the last half of the contents. That part happened to be a brief introduction to the Golden Crow bases and how they worked—Even though the answer was already in his memories, Ji Yushi still quickly read through it.

He couldn't be certain whether the answer in his mind was accurate.

And he also didn't know what the current situation was. He really wasn't in a good condition.

“Team 3 is about to arrive.” Song Qinglan urged, “We can't run into them now. We must find a way to leave them clues. Advisor Ji, have you found anything?”

Team 3 was the team that came to the bookstore from the park management office using the spacecar. Along the way, they also crushed Team 1 who had just arrived in this cycle.

In terms of time, they would arrive here very soon.

Ji Yushi, “Does anyone have water?”

Zhou Mingxuan on the side unscrewed a bottle and passed it over, “Here.”

Ji Yushi looked up and saw that his teammates were nervously standing around him while keeping an eye out for zombies. In front of everyone, he took out the box of medicine in his pocket and took two of them in one go before placing the box onto the bookshelf nearby.

Song Qinglan only frowned at his behaviour of taking medication so casually. He looked thoughtfully at the box of medicine on the bookshelf.

Ji Yushi lowered his eyes.

His hands trembled a little.

The person who said he would care about him, the one who claimed to be his family.....Was it all just his imagination?

“Almost done.” He said through his chaotic state, “Let’s go first. I can look at the rest on the way.”

The group quickly set off again and went straight to Golden Crow No. 1.

On the way, Ji Yushi confirmed that the energy transmitters of Golden Crow No. 1 and No. 2 had to be shut down at the same time to completely destroy this colony that shouldn’t exist in this parallel world. It was exactly the same as the answer in his mind.

“We don’t have enough people so we will split up into two groups. Leave as much information as you can for Team A and Team B.”

In Golden Crow No. 1’s security room, Song Qinglan stood in the middle of the crowd and scanned his eyes across everyone before continuing, “Some of you may not have memory of what we said here in the last cycle so I will say it again. As analysed in the last cycle, in order to break through this situation, it is necessary to choose the most suitable point on the circle to

extend and cover the previous points. That point is the Team A and Team B who will soon arrive here! Only by constantly letting them find traces left by us before they die and allowing them to avoid dying will we be able to truly clear this. That is why there is only one purpose for us every time we are reborn — Help pave the way for Team A and Team B! Do you understand?”

Everyone, “Understood!”

Song Qinglan smirked, “Good.”

He counted the heads and the equipment, “Myself, Old Duan and Li Chun will remain in Golden Crow No. 1. Advisor Ji, Tang Qi, Tang Le and Zhou Mingxuan, the four of you will go to Golden Crow No. 2.”

Everyone, “Roger!”

Song Qinglan pulled out his military knife and carved a line onto the ground:

Turn off energy supply of the two bases.

Team 5.

Ji Yushi now understood—It turns out that they were Team 5, the first team to disappear from the cycle!

No wonder Song Qinglan stared thoughtfully at the box of medicine back in the bookstore. It was because they had already analysed why it could exist at the same time as the box of medicine in Team 3. What he did earlier had accidentally fulfilled the conditions, regardless of cause and effect, but also becoming the cause and effect of each other!

After completing the Ouroboros mission, the memories of their selves in Teams A and B had merged. They didn’t have any memories from their other selves that had disappeared because of the paradox.

Ji Yushi’s felt his scalp go numb.



He didn't expect that he would be able to witness this moment.

But now....

Why did he return to this cycle?

Or had he never left the cycle in the first place?

\*

On the other end.

Song Qinglan had also returned to the Ouroboros mission.

Another traversing warning, another nightmarish PU-31. The first thing Song Qinglan did after landing was to open the door to find someone.

“Cap Song!”

“Is Chun'er going to throw u——”

“Bleagh!!”

As the teammates joked and complained, Song Qinglan only kicked the door shut when he passed Li Chun's capsule, “If you want to vomit, vomit in your own home. Who told you to fucking slack off and only sit on the pendulum twice during this long vacation?”

He then strode towards Ji Yushi's capsule.

The door opened.

The person inside was handsome and slim. Even the act of stepping out of the capsule was very good looking.

Song Qinglan stared fixatedly at the other party's face. Having that person appear before him again alive and well, he almost couldn't control himself. Right now, even just taking a breath sent pain throughout his body. But when the other party raised his head and looked over, his heart went cold.

Those beautiful eyes were polite and distant. He was even a little surprised to see him outside his capsule, “Cap Song.”

There was no excitement, no joy, and no trace of shock of coming back to life after dying.

Just like a video playback, Song Qinglan even felt that the situation was unreal. He suspected that the so-called Tianqiong parent system only simply turned time back and there was in fact no time anchor belonging only to him and Ji Yushi set up. Everything here was familiar; it was just one of those countless cycles.

Seeing that he wasn't moving, Ji Yushi then said, “Thank you for pulling me out of the car.”

Ji Yushi was referring to the time when Song Qinglan pulled him out of the car after they ran into the wire fence outside the bookstore.

Song Qinglan couldn't breathe.

Which cycle was this? The third one? Why didn't he remember having a conversation like this before?

Only God knew how much he didn't want to complete this mission. Regardless of which Ji Yushi the one before him was, he just wanted to give him a fierce hug until the other person was almost blended into his own body. The pain in his chest however reminded him that he couldn't do this. Even if the details and dialogue had changed, he couldn't change the general direction of this ‘past’. He had to let the mission develop according to how it went in his memory.

Ji Yushi noticed the clenched fists.

He asked, “What's wrong?”

What's wrong?

He could fucking see him but couldn't touch him.

.....

Song Qinglan suppressed his irritation, “Nothing.”

He turned around and managed to barely restrain himself from destroying the current situation. Following his memories, he assigned out tasks.

He could only patiently analyse the situation himself. Tianqiong had named this time anchor 【Overload】. It referred to the fact that it had exceeded the original mission plan. Having stuffed two people into the original cycle, there was a possibility that he wasn’t reborn into the same cycle as Ji Yushi. He had to wait it out and see.

He had already gone through an even more difficult period, so something like this was nothing.

The person behind him however wasn’t cooperating.

Ji Yushi stepped forward and stood very close to him. Song Qinglan could almost feel the faint cold air coming from his body, “Cap Song.”

Ji Yushi spoke every word very clearly and his voice was also very nice. When he called him like this, it always made him feel special.

Song Qinglan hardened his throat, “What?”

Ji Yushi said, “Go straight to the bookstore. There was a clue I wasn’t able to finish checking.”

Song Qinglan agreed.

They quickly left the forest. The route was the same as what he remembered. Ji Yushi gave the teammates who had not yet figured out the situation an explanation regarding the time anchor and also his initial guesses about the meaning of the rule ‘Death elimination’. Even if it was not the same as what it turned out to be, the current Ji Yushi was still very amazing.

They drove the spacecar out.

At the intersection, they encountered a car that managed to avoid them.

Song Qinglan finally figured out that they were Team 4. In other words, he and the Ji Yushi next to him were Team B in the latter half of the cycle.

The more he thought about it, the colder his expression became—In the end, he had to continue until the end of this cycle, all the way until he reached Golden Crow No. 2 before he could move to the next cycle.

As remembered, after separating from the rest of their teammates at Runjin Building, he and Ji Yushi found themselves surrounded by zombies on their way to the bookstore and were forced to hide in a power distribution room.

The small and cramped room was completely dark.

The two of them almost had to have their faces pressed against each other to be able to stand properly in the room. Ji Yushi was stepping on his foot.

It was both tolerable and intolerable.

“Advisor Ji.” Song Qinglan turned his head to the side and almost sniffed Ji Yushi’s hair, “You’re stepping on me.”

He could feel Ji Yushi’s body stiffen.

He originally did it to satisfy his own evil desires and wanted to take advantage of Ji Yushi but because of how close they were, his heart was beating wildly.

Before the other party could move his feet, he said, “Don’t.”

Ji Yushi’s actions stopped.

“I’ll give you this opportunity to step on me so that next time you can remember something nice. Don’t always hold grudges.”

As he said this, he tried to see Ji Yushi’s face in the darkness. The current situation reminded him of the last time he was at Ji Yushi’s place. When he

came out of the bathroom, Ji Yushi had pulled him down into his posture and kissed him.

Remember something nice.

Don't always remember who he gave the dice to, how he mistakenly thought he was involved in 4P, and how he liked a pretty little girl in kindergarten.

Unfortunately, the current Ji Yushi wasn't his one. He didn't understand the deep meaning behind his words.

Just as Song Qinglan said that, pain came from his foot. Ji Yushi didn't adjust the strength and just answered, "Oh."

Alright, it was still too early.

This guy still remembered the fact that Song Qinglan had pressed him against the bookshelf in the last cycle, making his wrist become bruised.

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth, "Having said that, you're stepping really hard."

Ji Yushi finally moved his foot away and apologised, "Sorry, it wasn't deliberate."

Song Qinglan, "I forgive you."

Unknown to the others, he was actually willing to be stepped on a hundred times.

It didn't take long for them to reunite with the teammates in Team 3. After competing with his other self, the two of them and the rest of the team members from Team 3 formed Team B and headed for Golden Crow No. 1.

In a place unknown to the others, Song Qinglan observed the Ji Yushi in Team A.

The moment the other party appeared through the binoculars, his heart also hurt.

Wearing a white T-shirt, the man sitting on the balcony had just been injured and there was a bullet wound on his abdomen. That scene slowly overlapped with that person who was mistakenly shot in the chest.

“What’s wrong?” Someone spoke up.

“Huh?” He lowered the binoculars and looked back.

Ji Yushi next to him asked, “Cap Song, your expression suddenly didn’t look good. Did something happen?”

“No.” Song Qinglan smiled. He looked at the other party’s clean and pale face, “I just wanted to say that we will all return alive.”

.....

Later, they got in touch with their other selves in Team A.

The teammates worked hand in hand. Alongside Ji Yushi’s analysis and calculation, Song Qinglan cooperated and turned off the energy transmitters for Golden Crow No. 1.

Towards Cap Song’s sudden cooperation with Ji Yushi to the point that he would do anything he said, the other teammates expressed shock. They didn’t understand what happened between them.

During the call between the two teams, Ji Yushi reminded him, “Cap Song, fourth row, the sixth from the left.”

Song Qinglan subconsciously replied, “Righto, I’m on it.”

As soon as those words were spoken, he remembered how he found the way he and Ji Yushi from Team B interacted a little strange back when he overheard it when he was in Team A.

Even Ji Yushi was a little stunned when he heard his answer. He glanced back at him for a moment.

Ji Yushi however had a tendency to keep to himself. He didn't say anything about Song Qinglan's change and just silently continued to calculate, "Seventh row, second from the left."

Everything seemed to be destined.

Which cycle was covering over which cycle?

Song Qinglan no longer dwelled on this problem.

After finishing everything they needed to do in Golden Crow No. 1, he brought the team to Golden Crow No. 2 to help Team A.

Finally, they returned to the capsule and completed the smaller cycle.

Before the black wall arrived, Song Qinglan made a wish. He hoped that he could be reborn into the same cycle as Ji Yushi.

When Song Qinglan appeared at the new anchor point and faced the Ji Yushi who still didn't remember everything that had happened between them, he just wanted to curse at the Tianqiong parent system a million times.

Again.

And again.

In each cycle, the person he encountered wasn't the Ji Yushi he wanted.

Song Qinglan couldn't control himself anymore.

# Chapter 96: Chapter 96

## Overload

### Chapter 96

The fierce sound of gunfire in the corridor, the giant spider that suddenly charged out....

Dragging his bloodied body, he and his teammates rushed as far into the depths of Golden Crow No. 2 as they could.....The chaotic scene was constantly imprinted into Ji Yushi's mind.

As Team 5, they had used their blood and flesh to cut out a route for Team B, leaving enough information behind to let them escape from death. The moment Team B successfully closed the gate, a paradox emerged—Team B who should've died had survived. Team 5 thus would disappear.

As if it had never happened, all the bloody corpses and traces left by them disappeared completely.

They were a cycle that no longer existed.

Even after the Ouroboros mission was completely over, Ji Yushi didn't retain any memories from Team 5, but this time, he was experiencing it in detail.

This time, his capsule appeared on the roof of a building.

The communicator displayed [1470.08.05 02:41:31]. It was 2 hours earlier than when they first arrived at PU-31.

The hours before dawn was the darkest time of the day.



This building had a total of 122 floors. Standing on such a tall building, the wind was very strong, as if it would blow you off any moment if you weren't being careful.

There was no traffic passing by. There were only a couple of scattered dim streetlights illuminating the roads below. From this height, it was almost impossible for one to see the zombies roaming the roads, but everyone knew that they were attracted by lights and had gone to a brighter place among the tall buildings. They wouldn't come out until the sun rises again.

On the roof were several large words: Guangyuan Group.

The capsules of his other teammates were all hidden in the shadows of these large words. They all exited their capsules and began to discuss what they should do next.

From the looks of it, this wasn't everyone's first time arriving at the big cycle.

That's right, Ji Yushi was currently in the big cycle in the Ouroboros mission.

They needed to activate the first black wall that appeared at the park management office at 5:30 in the morning to let their other selves who had just been hijacked and brought into this mission see it and then let the black wall drive them forward towards Golden Crow No. 1 and Golden Crow No. 2.

Ji Yushi was a little confused.

From Team 5 who had disappeared to this big cycle, there didn't seem to be a regular pattern.

Right now, it was like he was playing an out of control role-playing character that was randomly stuffed into the plot. Fortunately, he happened to remember all the plot points so he wouldn't be caught or regarded as a crazy person by his teammates.

“Advisor Ji.” Tang Qi walked over and said to him, “This time, Tang Le and I will go down to the 116<sup>th</sup> floor first. Once we have checked on the situation there, the rest of you can come down.”

This scene was also something that had happened before.

In their previous endeavours, they had already figured out that this building belonging to Guangyuan Group was the company behind Golden Crow. Their existence had contributed to the operation and development of the artificial sun. As the initial research and development site, there were still several early energy transmitters in the building. Like what they did at the Golden Crow bases, the seventh squad had to turn off the energy transmitters here to completely close the cycle.

The building had a total of 122 floors. The elevators had been damaged and the stairs leading to the top few floors had also been destroyed. There were traces of a helicopter leaving the roof. It seemed that someone had cut off the way up so that they could escape without running into any difficulties.

Therefore, to reach the floors below, the squad could only use the grappling hook and zipline down to check on the status of each of the floors.

Probably because the floors were high enough to receive plenty of artificial sun rays, the zombies here were considerably more mutated than the ones on the ground and their speed and intelligence had also increased significantly. As of now, their squad had already been annihilated twice.

In general, this big cycle was much simpler than the ones from before, but it was a mission with no retreat.

“Any objections?”

Song Qinglan also walked over.

He looked at Ji Yushi and said the same thing as what Ji Yushi remembered, “Advisor Ji, you need to rest. You will soon have a lot of work to do when we find the energy transmitters. This time, let Tang Qi and Tang Le go down first. If they can’t, the rest of us will continue.”

The so-called 'can't' referred to death.

With one or two people forming a group, if the previous group died, the next group would immediately take over.

Song Qinglan spoke very quickly and sounded a little ruthless.

But everyone knew very well that they didn't have much time. There was less than 3 hours before the first black wall is due to appear at 5am. As of now, they had explored six floors and had not yet found the control room.

But Ji Yushi knew that the control room was on the 100<sup>th</sup> floor.

If they went directly to the 100<sup>th</sup> floor, perhaps they wouldn't need to continue rushing to their deaths.

Regarding these chaotic memories, there were still some that he couldn't distinguish between reality and illusion. His condition was worsening. He could only take out a pill and crush it with his teeth before swallowing it.

The current situation however made him reluctant to keep at it. He didn't want to go through those cycles again. Just as he hesitated over whether he should say something, Song Qinglan was called away by his teammates.

Everything happened according to plan.

Tang Qi and Tang Le slid directly down the rope from the inner courtyard and, after reaching the 116<sup>th</sup> floor, they hung in the air like a spider and swept away a bunch of zombies before swinging and landing onto the corridor

Everyone watched from the 122<sup>nd</sup> floor.

They all waited nervously while holding their breaths.

Not hearing the gunshot signal they were waiting for, Song Qinglan gave an order, and everyone set up the grappling hooks again.

With prior experience paving the way for their other selves in the Golden Crow bases, they were no longer afraid of dying. Even if they knew that the road ahead was a dead end, they continued to rush ahead without hesitation.

When the building's stairs were blown up, half the building was destroyed. The lights inside flickered on and off intermittently.

The night breeze blew past, messing up Ji Yushi's black hair. He stood on the edge with a calm expression.

“You first or me first?”

A familiar voice asked.

Ji Yushi looked back. He saw Song Qinglan carrying Shen Mian. He was ready to set off.

The blue energy bullets glowed, making his tall figure appear almost divine.

Ji Yushi answered according to his memory, “I'll go first.”

\*

Song Qinglan exited his capsule and strode over to the centre of the roof.

The dark sky seemed like it was only a short distance from them. The seven faintly glowing capsules resembled a lotus.

Reaching a capsule, Song Qinglan stopped in his steps.

The people who had just left their capsules were surprised at his abnormality. They all looked over at him, “Cap Song?”

The capsule opened and out came Ji Yushi who ran into Song Qinglan head-on.

Song Qinglan examined him closely for two or three seconds but didn't say anything and just turned and said to everyone, “This time we'll go to the 119<sup>th</sup> floor. We'll take turns. Old Zhou, you take the lead.”

Zhou Mingxuan, “Aye!”

One after another, the teammates began searching again.

Song Qinglan was in a very bad mood. Everyone could see it. They could also see that he was trying to suppress his emotions and not let it affect the mission at hand.

Everyone thought Song Qinglan was like this because of this damned mission. Let alone the captain, even they themselves were angry at their current predicament where they had no choice but to continue advancing ahead—To think that there was another bigger cycle after turning off all the energy transmitters. It was like they were being played with.

After a while, only half of the teammates were left on the roof.

Gunshots rang from below. Song Qinglan heard Ji Yushi ask him something.

“Huh?” He didn’t hear him clearly.

He only saw Ji Yushi ask again with his usually cold and calm expression, “Cap Song, did I make a mistake somewhere?”

Song Qinglan was slightly startled.

Hearing Ji Yushi’s words, Li Chun and Duan Wen behind them also looked over.

“After arriving here, you have been behaving a little differently.” Ji Yushi said, “If I did something wrong, you can tell me directly.”

Standing from Ji Yushi’s perspective, after turning off all the energy transmitters in the control room at Golden Crow No. 2, Song Qinglan had even comforted him and expressed his wish for him to remain in the seventh squad, but after repeating the cycle here twice, Song Qinglan’s mood had grown worse and worse. It made Ji Yushi feel like it was directed at him.

Ji Yushi may appear unaffected but in fact, it was the opposite. Under his cold appearance, he was actually quite sensitive.

How could Song Qinglan not know this? When he was asked this, he only felt his heart ache. Even his breathing stopped: “I——”

Ji Yushi didn’t care about his answer. He had already leapt off and slid down.

“Fuck, is Advisor Ji angry?” Duan Wen was shocked, “I thought he wouldn’t say anything.”

“Boss, let me give you a warning. Watch out for Advisor Ji ‘crack’——” Li Chun also calmly gave his advice. He imitated Ji Yushi’s action of breaking a zombie’s neck in Golden Crow No. 2, “Tsk, I was almost left dumbfounded. That move was both handsome and powerful.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

He asked with a grim expression, “My attitude towards him wasn’t good?”

The two nodded at once like chicken pecking at rice.

“Very bad.”

“Completely different from before.”

“Not like you anymore.”

Fuck.

Even his teammates could see it. It meant that his unconscious attitude must have been very bad.

Song Qinglan gritted his teeth and similarly slid down the rope.

The battle below was fierce. Song Qinglan went past the 121<sup>st</sup> floor and the 120<sup>th</sup> floor and saw his bloodied teammates from the previous cycle. All the

rules in this big cycle were the same as the small cycle; space and time overlap, the existence of multiple teams at the same time.

While sliding down the rope, Song Qinglan saw Li Chun and Zhou Mingxuan on the 121<sup>st</sup> floor being bitten by a group of crazy zombies. On the 120<sup>th</sup> floor, he, Tang Qi and Tang Le were running like mad down the corridor while Duan Wen and Ji Yushi on the other end were shooting at the waves of zombies charging at them.

Like all the other teammates, Song Qinglan turned a blind eye to this and smoothly went down to the 119<sup>th</sup> floor, looking for Ji Yushi.

This place had already been cleaned up considerably by the teammates who had arrived earlier.

The floor was covered with blood stains.

After landing, Song Qinglan flipped forward, pulled out his military knife and killed a zombie that was charging towards him.

Just ahead was Ji Yushi.

Song Qinglan: “Ji Yushi——”

Before he could finish speaking, he saw Ji Yushi’s expression suddenly change. Holding Diamond Bird, he pointed it at him and fired.

“Bang!”

Song Qinglan’s cheeks felt warm. A zombie behind him was shot in the head and its foul-smelling blood had splattered onto his face, “.....”

Even if he was still angry, even if they weren’t together yet, Ji Yushi was afraid of him being bitten to death?

Song Qinglan was almost rendered deaf from the gunfire, but his heart felt warm.

He even felt that he was a little perverted.

“You’re welcome.” Ji Yushi said coldly and then turned and left.



# Chapter 97: Chapter 97

## Overload

### Chapter 97

Following the rope, Ji Yushi slid all the way down.

He knew that Tang Qi and Tang Le had gone to the 116<sup>th</sup> floor unsuccessfully and had already encountered zombies while Zhou Mingxuan and Duan Wen were also overwhelmed by them when they went down afterwards so he could only reluctantly determine that the control room wasn't on the 116<sup>th</sup> floor. At this moment, Duan Wen very bravely hung from the railing on the 116<sup>th</sup> floor and jumped down to the 115<sup>th</sup> floor, accurately joining Li Chun who was shooting at the zombies. They had already begun to search the next floor.

Everything was developing the way Ji Yushi remembered. He could even clearly remember their next set of actions and what their next words would be.

Amidst the intense gunfire coming from each floor, Ji Yushi calmly watched on. He did his best to stay clear minded without being disturbed by his memories.

When he slid down from the 122<sup>nd</sup> floor to the 119<sup>th</sup> floor, he heard a loud explosion. The shaking made him subconsciously come to a stop.

“What’s going on?!”

Song Qinglan who hung from the rope above him suddenly asked.

Ji Yushi looked back only to see that a giant hole had formed on the 119<sup>th</sup> floor railing. A large group of zombies fell from it like dumplings.

Dust and smoke scattered. The situation behind the railing couldn't be seeing clearly.

Ji Yushi accidentally inhaled some of the dust and smoke and couldn't stop coughing, ".....Cough, cough, cough!!"

This scene was something that never happened in Ji Yushi's memory.

If he really wanted to use the 'role playing' analogy to describe his current situation, then this was a plot point outside of his expectations.

Song Qinglan who had just experienced death and rebirth also discovered this. This development clearly wasn't something he remembered and that was why he asked that question.

Ji Yushi coughed until his eyes were red and teary.

Just as he was about to answer, he saw through the smoke and dust a tall figure slowly appear.

That person had broad shoulders and he domineeringly held Shen Mian in his hands. The red energy magazine was glowing.

It was another Song Qinglan!!

Ji Yushi instantly understood that this was the Song Qinglan from the earlier cycle. It was only after they were all annihilated on the 119<sup>th</sup> floor, that their current cycle started. In other words, he had met with the Song Qinglan from the previous cycle—This was about to create a paradox. It meant his current self and his teammates may soon disappear!

The other party also saw him. That cold expression changed slightly.

One hung in the air while the other stood in the opening in the railing.

There was only about a two or three metre distance between them.

This Song Qinglan was clearly the same as the one above him at this moment.

But strangely, those seemingly bottomless dark eyes made Ji Yushi feel that there was something different. A faint electric current seemed to rise from the depths of his heart, making the tips of his fingers numb.

The Song Qinglan above him was still saying something but Ji Yushi couldn't hear him anymore.

At this moment, all the gunfire, zombie growls and curses coming from the teammates from every floor and from every cycle sounded very distant.

How could this be?

Why was the Song Qinglan from the previous cycle reacting differently from his memory?

Could it be that he actually wasn't from the previous cycle? But why was he on the 119<sup>th</sup> floor?

The other party was in a dangerous situation. After only staring at him for two or three seconds, a new wave of zombies appeared behind him, and he had no choice but to direct his attention to them.

Everything seemed to have slowed down in Ji Yushi's eyes.

He sensed that he was disappearing.

Starting from his feet to his calves, it spread all the way up.

As the other party caught his breath and turned to look back, his expression suddenly changed when he saw this scene and he subconsciously shouted something.

At this moment, Ji Yushi, along with all his other teammates in this cycle, had completely disappeared.

\*

[1470.08.05 02:41:31]

When Ji Yushi opened his eyes, garbled characters appeared again on the transparent panel before him. It was the same time and space coordinates as the one on his communicator.

Again.

He numbly accepted this fact and only took few sips of the nutrient solution delivered over by the robotic arm. He felt like he was now becoming immune to the sequelae of traversing.

That scene from just now appeared in his mind. What was going on with those developments that weren't following the original plotline?

Ji Yushi had no clue.

His fingers tightened unconsciously around the nutrient solution. He didn't allow himself to continue to dwell on this and very quickly opened the door of his capsule.

The sky was still very dark.

One by one, his teammates all came out of their capsules.

Ji Yushi subconsciously looked at the tallest one. The other party behaved like usual, completely different from the one he saw on the 119<sup>th</sup> floor. He didn't notice his assessing gaze at all.

After a few brief words, Song Qinglan said to everyone, "This time we will go to the 116<sup>th</sup> floor. Tang Qi and Tang Le will go down first and take the lead and the others will follow. Everyone will take turns, any objections?!"

Everyone, "No!!"

The 116<sup>th</sup> floor?

Ji Yushi was frozen. Didn't they go there just now?

Song Qinglan didn't notice anything and just looked over, "Advisor Ji, you will go down last. Firstly, it is because you carry the most mental burden and require rest and secondly, it is because only you can do the calculations required to figure out the order of turning off the energy transmitters. With every cycle, you will need to do everything you can to survive."

Seeing that Ji Yushi's reaction was a little strange, Song Qinglan frowned, "What's wrong?"

Everyone looked over at their Advisor Ji with concern.

With everyone's attention on him, Ji Yushi could only say, "I'm fine."

Except for him, no one else had any impression of their previous cycle. This included Song Qinglan.

Moreover, it seems that ever since he saw the other Song Qinglan who came from a different, yet to have developed plot point, everything was now a little different.

Was there something wrong with his memory, or had things changed?

Ji Yushi didn't know the answer. He originally wanted to tell the others about the change, but he was no longer certain.

Tang Qi and Tang Le went down the rope.

The rest of the teammates followed behind them one after another.

Everyone ignored the danger before them and used their own blood and flesh to once again advance ahead and pave a path for themselves.

Ji Yushi took out another two pills from his medicine box. He once again crushed them with his teeth and swallowed it.

Song Qinglan just happened to witness this scene when he turned around, "Advisor Ji, you don't find it bitter?"

Ji Yushi's expression was calm, "It's alright."

Once you do it enough times, you no longer find it bitter.

As soon as he was done speaking, Ji Yushi buckled himself to the rope and slide down.

122, 121, 119.....

When he passed the 119<sup>th</sup> floor, he didn't even give it a glance. Without looking, he knew that those floors were all replaying their previous bloody battles from their earlier cycles.

The small squad scattered across different floors. Reaching the 116<sup>th</sup> floor, Ji Yushi suddenly curled up his legs and then stretched it out. Relying on his strength and flexibility and using a posture that looked very dangerous but was also done with great ease, he hooked onto the 116<sup>th</sup> floor railing. As soon as he landed, he saw Duan Wen ahead being pursued by zombies.

Ji Yushi quickly took out Diamond Bird and shot the zombies in the head one after another.

His marksmanship was extremely accurate. He almost didn't need to stop and think before he shot. This time, he was so fast, Duan Wen was unable to react.

Zombies fell to the ground. Duan Wen was covered in blood, "I'll go to the left!!"

Splitting up was the fastest way.

Li Chun who should be with Duan Wen was probably no more. Ji Yushi didn't say much and just nodded and went in the opposite direction as Duan Wen.

The Guangyuan Group building was of a cylindrical shape, so the inner courtyard was also a circular structure. It made it very difficult for one to evade and defend. The zombies on the higher floors had completely mutated and were able to easily read their intentions. It was not uncommon to find them charging at them from behind.

Ji Yushi threw a few energy grenades. He didn't try to save any of his equipment. The Diamond Bird in his hand seemed like it had a life of its own. Wherever he went, blood and brains splattered.

He had formed a bloody path, but he still felt that it wasn't enough.

Lying in the blood and flesh was a laser gun. It belonged to Zhou Mingxuan.

Ji Yushi picked up the laser gun and fired rapidly.

It was unknown if it was because his medicine was working, but in this chaotic state, he actually found pleasure in killing.

He had never had such a moment.

“Thud!”

Suddenly, someone landed beside him. Someone had jumped over to this floor and then fiercely pushed Ji Yushi against the wall.

He raised his head and saw a pair of angry eyes.

It was Song Qinglan.

He was more awake now. He noticed that his breathing was quick, and his hands were also trembling quite badly. It was due to the recoil from using guns for so long.

He had lost control.

The two looked at each other. Both didn't say anything.

He thought Song Qinglan would let go of him and they would then split up to search the floor, but he still found himself pressed against the wall, unable to move.

Then, he noticed that something was different.

Those dark eyes in front of him contained completely different emotions. As if there was a volcano buried under the dark sea, just looking at it made him feel sad and in pain.

Those eyes overlapped with the eyes he saw during his final moments in 1439.

The other person seemed to have confirmed something.

The next second, he bowed his head down and kissed him

Ji Yushi's mind was completely blank. His entire body trembled.

The temperature from his lips was very familiar. It made him feel like his body was electrified. Even his lips were trembling.

“Clang——”

The heavy laser gun in his hand fell to the ground.

Song Qinglan kissed him fiercely. Using his hand, he pressed down the other person's trembling, completely weak arms. Very soon, there was the metallic taste of blood.

Ji Yushi knew that his tongue was bleeding but during this exchange he had lost all sensation of pain.

There was noisy gunfire all around them. Waves of explosions sounded again and again.

The world was still in chaos.

But the heavy breathing of the two of them was very clear.

Song Qinglan opened the door next to them without raising his head. As he continued to kiss him, he pushed him in.

There may be zombies in the room but Ji Yushi didn't want to pay it any attention. He heard the sound of bones breaking.



Song Qinglan had already used his bare hands to break a zombie's neck.

Then, that big hand reached into Ji Yushi's clothes, claspings tightly around his waist—It was as if only with skin contact, as if only by touching his skin directly and feeling his warmth, could he be certain that he was real.

This kiss was very frenzied.

Song Qinglan hardly gave him a chance to breathe.

Their tongues hooked and entangled. He constantly licked his jaw, teeth and every inch of his mouth, sucking at his lips greedily and changing the angle with every turn of his head. All of it left Ji Yushi trembling and weak.

This kind of craving made it hard for Ji Yushi to hold back his tears.

His tears intensified the feverish kiss.

Ji Yushi shuddered. He couldn't help but let out a sound. It sounded a little in pain.

Song Qinglan finally released him. Pressing his thumb on those swollen lips, he found that it was also trembling.

Their foreheads were pressed together. Neither of them could utter a complete sentence.

This kind of separation was something they didn't want to experience anymore.

Finally, Song Qinglan took a deep breath and got ready to speak. But he only saw a wide-eyed Ji Yushi.

He was disappearing.

Within two minutes after they reunited, a paradox occurred.

He disappeared in Song Qinglan's arms.

Song Qinglan held an armful of air. He ground his teeth.

After a long time, he finally cursed, “Fuck.....”

He slammed a fist against the wall. His expression became cold again. He got ready to go out and once again search for Ji Yushi.

Their cycles were staggered. He would always die and the Ji Yushi belonging to the next cycle would appear.

Unexpectedly, as soon as he turned around, he saw someone standing at the door.

Ji Yushi’s black combat uniform was covered with zombie blood and flesh. He stood at the door looking at him coldly, “Song Qinglan, what are you doing?”

Song Qinglan’s heart went cold.

This was the Ji Yushi belonging to the current cycle. It was the Ji Yushi when nothing had yet happened between them.

Clearly, the other party had witnessed everything.

Song Qinglan suddenly felt that the situation wasn’t good, “.....”

He awkwardly tried to explain, “If I say that it’s not what you’re thinking, would you believe me?”

# Chapter 98: Chapter 98

## Overload

### Chapter 98

The two were too engrossed with the kiss and hadn't noticed another person entering the room.

Even the usually vigilant Song Qinglan was completely unaware.

Needless to say, Song Qinglan could guess what this Ji Yushi before him thought he was doing.

Firstly, he had pushed the other person and pressed them against the wall without saying a single word and then he restrained the other person's arms, preventing them from moving before finally going for the lips. Probably because he was afraid of other people seeing him in this evil act, he even pushed the other person into a room. Not only forcing a kiss and even getting physical, bullying the other person to the point of tearing up and cry out in pain.....

Adding to that the fact that he had noticed that something wasn't right since the beginning of this cycle and asked if he did something wrong.....

In short, it was three words: Being a thug.

After asking this question, Song Qinglan who knew very clearly that he was still carrying the title of a 'homophobic steel straight man' found himself unable to speak, "Forget it, I don't think you will believe me even if I explain."

Ji Yushi's expression was as cold as ever, "Oh? How would you know if you don't try?"

Those words sounded reasonable.

But the expression on Ji Yushi's face clearly had the word 'disbelief' written on it and there was also a look of warning.

This was completely ridiculous. What should he say to let the Ji Yushi before him believe him?

But, as long as Song Qinglan thought about the current development, Song Qinglan's heart relaxed.

At least he was able to confirm that Ji Yushi really was in this mission. Even if their cycles were not the same, they could still return to their original time and space together.

Song Qinglan ended the awkward silence. He spoke without any scruples, "I came from the future."

Ji Yushi's expression didn't change.

He waited for him to continue 'bullshitting'.

"The you you saw just now was also from the future." Song Qinglan looked a little proud, "We are a couple in the future. That is to say, I not only bent, I also became your boyfriend."

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan slowly approached him and looked down at him, "Don't be so distrustful. I'm really your dearest boyfriend. Everyone in Tianqiong knows it. The one and only."

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan abandoned himself and continued, "In fact, we have already done this mission. The me you see now is actually another me and the you

you saw earlier was another you. Because of some special reasons, we were separated and were forced back to this mission to reunite. Perhaps it was because the traversing point was the same, irrespective of before and after, we were misplaced into different cycles in this mission. What you saw just now was the result of becoming too excited after finally reuniting. As the saying goes, absence makes the heart grow fonder.”

Ji Yushi seemed to finally be shocked. After a period of silence, he asked, “Which future?”

Song Qinglan, “June 25, 1456.”

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Alright, continue making it up.

There was reason and there was evidence. Song Qinglan felt that he was about to believe his words and spoke calmly, “I know it sounds like only a month had passed and it didn’t seem possible for our relationship to have progressed so quickly but it in fact wasn’t like that. You just need to carefully think it over and you will know that I’m speaking the truth. In fact, we’ve actually known each other for a very long——“

Ji Yushi interrupted him, “Why did we separate?”

Song Qinglan was stuck again.

Looking at the other party’s pale face and clear eyes, he couldn’t tell the Ji Yushi before him the reason why they ‘separated’.

Everything that happened in 1439 was too cruel.

Whether it was for him or for Ji Yushi.

As long as he recalled that scene that day, his heart would hurt so much, he couldn’t even speak.

Ji Yushi waited for him for a few seconds before he lowered his eyes and used his fairly clean hem to clean off the blood splattered onto Diamond

Bird.

After doing this silently, he raised his head again. His expression had become even more distant than before, “In other words, you and the other me are from the future and we just happened to fancy each other and become a couple, just happened to be separated and just happened to be ‘sent back’ to this mission that was already completed.”

He paused and asked, “Cap Song, then you must already know which floor the control room is on.”

Song Qinglan was rendered completely speechless.

Even if he knew that the control room was on the 100<sup>th</sup> floor, he couldn’t immediately tell the Ji Yushi before him about it.

Tianqiong’s so-called 【Overload】 referred to the big cycle formed after a larger time anchor was created, just like an extra circle was drawn. Following the completion of this mission, they have to return to the same hijacked point, but the two of them were currently in two different cycles and Ji Yushi would always belong to the next cycle. Even if there was a small paradox, the people of the previous cycle would continue to live while Ji Yushi who belonged to the next cycle would disappear.

Song Qinglan still wasn’t certain how they would be able to return to their original time and space together.

Therefore, this mission couldn’t end yet.

He couldn’t give them the answer yet.

“Can’t say it?” Ji Yushi didn’t seem to be expecting an answer. He just said indifferently, “Clear the mission first.”

When he was done speaking, he turned and walked out.

He seemed to be taking into consideration the current situation and holding back his anger.

With a loud ‘bang’ the door that was pulled open by Ji Yushi bounced off the wall.

The two left the room one after another.

Tang Qi, Tang Le, Li Chun and others were all coming over as well. Their exploration this time was smoother than before. Not only were they not annihilated, but they also lived longer than Song Qinglan remembered and could continue to check on the next floor.

This was because, just as analysed by Ji Yushi before, their point on the circle had been extended.

Song Qinglan looked at the building’s roof.

The top was empty and there were only ropes from the grappler hooks hanging in the air. The new group was nowhere in sight.

He frowned. He seemed to understand the situation a little.

He knew what he should do if he wanted to see the Ji Yushi in the next cycle again.

The Ji Yushi before him was very fierce. He had already fired a number of shots and taken out several zombies.

Seeing him so angry, Song Qinglan felt both lost and amused.

It was only a short difference in time but was the current Ji Yushi that disgusted with the current him?

“Advisor Ji.” He lowly called out.

Ji Yushi stopped in his steps. He probably thought he was going to give him a reasonable explanation or apology.

But unexpectedly, Song Qinglan lowered his voice and seemed to be deliberately trying to anger him, “After thinking about it, I did indeed forcibly kiss you just now. A pity I didn’t have much time.”

Ji Yushi turned around and glared at him.

This time, even if he was reluctantly considering the truthfulness of Song Qinglan's words, all of that was angrily tossed aside.

Their teammates were approaching them. Gradually, it became a situation where they protected each other's backs.

“Cap Song, nothing was found on this floor!”

“Let's go to the next one!”

“Fuck! There are so many zombies down here! I'll fucking sweep through them first!”

Noticing that the two of them weren't speaking, Li Chun looked over, “Cap Song, Advisor Ji, how is it for you?!”

The two still didn't speak.

Everyone turned around and looked over.

They saw their squad's two core members looking very tense. The atmosphere was strange.

It was Song Qinglan who spoke first. In front of everyone, he said to Ji Yushi, “Advisor Ji, as long as you let me kiss you again, I will even be willing to jump off here and fall to my death.”

Everyone: “????”

What?!

What was this development?!

Ji Yushi was expressionless, “Oh.”

In front of everyone, Advisor Ji proceeded to kick their Cap Song off.



They were all shocked, “Cap Song!!!”

Ji Yushi stood in place and took out his box of medicine.

He took a pill, calmly placed the box back into his pocket and then turned to the others, “Everyone stay vigilant. In a strange place like this, mass hallucinations may occur.”

Everyone: I see!

# Chapter 99: Chapter 99

## Overload

### Chapter 99

After being ruthlessly kicked off the high-rise building, Song Qinglan free-fell from a height of 116 floors.

Suddenly, his entire body felt an upwards pull. Someone had grabbed his arm in the nick of time, causing him to hang in the air. Only the dark Shen Mian fell down into the depths below.

“Come up!!!”

Someone yelled from above his head. The words were forced out through gritted teeth.

Song Qinglan looked up. The person who had grabbed him was another Ji Yushi.

Half of Ji Yushi’s body was stuck on the railing. Because the speed and weight of a falling human body was more than what he could support, the arm holding Song Qinglan was in a very unnatural angle. His entire face was flushed red, “Quick.....come up!!!”

The veins on the back of his slender hand were bulging.

This Ji Yushi came from the new cycle. It was the Ji Yushi who disappeared in Song Qinglan’s arms earlier.

Clearly, Song Qinglan who was kicked to his death after teasing his boyfriend and his teammates who were about to meet their ends allowed for

the new cycle to appear. Ji Yushi who was on the 115<sup>th</sup> floor managed to intercept him before his death.

One time and space, one floor apart, two Ji Yushi's.

Two completely different treatments.

This strange and absurd experience was probably something only traversers like them would experience.

Song Qinglan immediately held onto the other party's wrist and pulled himself up.

The railing was broken and crumbling. Bearing the weight of two people, it creaked dully, as if it was about to break the next second and send the two of them into the abyss below.

Fortunately, Song Qinglan had amazing arm strength. With Ji Yushi's assistance, he managed to pull himself up, grab hold of the railing and use both the railing and Ji Yushi's strength to successfully climb up.

After climbing over the railing, Ji Yushi rushed over before Song Qinglan could even have the chance to stabilise himself.

The two stumbled back a few steps. This time it was Song Qinglan who was pushed against the wall. Ji Yushi wasn't weak and the impact on his back was painful.

The adrenaline from the fall still hadn't subsided. Song Qinglan was still in a highly tense mental state.

He leaned against the wall, breathing heavily.

He couldn't help but let out a few low laughs. He seemed to be very satisfied.

Immediately afterwards, he used an even greater strength to embrace the other party back. Relying on his height advantage, he buried his face deeply into the neck of the person in his arms.

It was hot.

This was real.

Tears couldn't help but well up.

The two embraced tightly, wanting to squeeze each other into their bodies.

The kiss from when they first reunited was already done. Right now, they just wanted to completely take in the fact that the other party was real, feel the other persons presence and feel their heartbeat.

For Ji Yushi, only this would allow him to feel that he was truly alive.

Since returning to Ouroboros, he had always felt like he was about to go mad.

The moment he met Song Qinglan, he knew that he wasn't alone and knew that it wasn't a hallucination. He was finally able to return to the world called sanity.

This excited him more than anything else.

Ji Yushi's heart raced very quickly, the blood pounding in his ears. Song Qinglan said something by his ear, but he didn't hear him. He loosened his hand slightly and looked up, "What?"

His eyes were clean and clear, and filled with calmness and wisdom.

Only when facing Song Qinglan would those defences completely disappear, leaving only the trust and dependence that even he himself was unaware of.

Song Qinglan was left unable to speak by those eyes of his.

Time and space had changed, time flowed past like water.

The past that they had travelled through had eventually become the future they were approaching,

The past was the past.

Song Qinglan's emotions settled very quickly. He was able to quickly toss the past aside.

He repeated what he said earlier, "I was just saying, this really is like fire and ice. As soon as I was kicked off by you, I was rescued by another you and pulled into your arms. Who knew dating would be this exciting?"

Ji Yushi's position was directly below where he was earlier.

He had naturally heard the entire thing and was in fact a little speechless. What his other self did was completely within reason.

Song Qinglan continued to tease him "Advisor Ji, are you using the carrot and the stick method?"

Ji Yushi could only try and clear 'his' name, "Didn't you say you were willing? I would call this granting your wishes."

Song Qinglan raised his hand. A cold light flashed, and his military knife killed a zombie coming over, "You should be more reasonable. I haven't kissed yet."

"19 years ago, 4:05pm, at the kindergarten attached to Ning University, you kissed me for three minutes." Ji Yushi easily recalled the past, "If you consider a kiss as three seconds and do the calculations.....Cap Song, you can still die sixty times."

Song Qinglan narrowed his eyes.

Why didn't he remember doing something like that as a child?

A small part of him wanted to know the details.

Ji Yushi expressed, "I don't think you're making a loss."

"Why not?" Song Qinglan chuckled lowly. He put aside that matter for now and started to settle their accounts, "Just take the last one as an example. It

was filled with the bitter taste of medicine. Speak honestly, how many did you take? You're not listening to your family's words anymore?"

Ji Yushi: "....."

"Refusing to confess?" Song Qinglan kissed the tip of his nose, "Come here, I'll give it a taste."

"Bang, bang, bang!!"

Gunshots suddenly exploded around them.

Zombies gathered from both sides. While overwhelmed by zombies, their teammates rushed over.

From a distance, the Song Qinglan belonging to the new cycle used the Shen Mian in his hands to clear out the zombies rushing over.

Sparks flew everywhere.

Song Qinglan looked back. His eyes met with his other self.

Perhaps it was because they have constantly been seeing their other selves in the other cycles, they had developed some immunity.

Except for the other Song Qinglan not quite understanding what the two of them were doing, they reacted to the situation quite calmly.

In an instant, more and more zombies rushed out from the surrounding rooms.

Without saying much, Song Qinglan pulled Ji Yushi away from his other self, "Leave this place first!!"

With this pull, he noticed that something wasn't right. Ji Yushi's right arm was soft and angled strangely.

No wonder the embrace was a little awkward earlier.

Song Qinglan's expression changed, "Your arm——"

Song Qinglan was an adult with a height greater than 1.9 metres and weighed more than 70kg.

Having caught something of that size and weight from a height, something like this wasn't surprising.

Ji Yushi unconsciously changed diamond bird to his left hand, "Go!!"

Song Qinglan returned to his senses.

The Ji Yushi he likes had never been someone who needed protection.

\*

Having experienced far more missions than just Ouroboros, the tacit understanding between the two no longer needed words. Working together, only half the effort would be required to achieve twice the result.

Everyone saw that they were able to open a path using just Diamond Bird and a few energy grenades.

"So, what's the current situation?" Ji Yushi retreated as he fired and he asked this question, "Role-playing or mission review?! I remember I was dead."

"Dead?" Song Qinglan broke a few zombie necks. When he looked back, his eyes were fierce, "This is just a bigger cycle."

They retreated to a corner.

The teammates immediately joined in, sending blood and dust flying.

"A new time anchor, a bigger cycle." Song Qinglan explained quickly and briefly, "Done by Tianqiong. Tailored for the two of us."

Someone as intelligent as Ji Yushi immediately understood what he was talking about—Tianqiong had set up a new time anchor for them, allowing

them to return to their current time from the future. It was no different from what they encountered in the Ouroboros mission, and the initial time anchor was even borrowed and used to forcibly stuff them into the cycle.

If that was the case, the condition for this time anchor must be the same.

He was indeed dead, but Song Qinglan wasn't.

He looked at Song Qinglan. The other's handsome eyes and determined profile all told him a certain fact.

After his death, Song Qinglan had followed after him.

Regarding the time anchor, regarding what happened during those times, it seems that it had been destined for a long time.

Ji Yushi had a lot of things he wanted to say but now wasn't a good time.

Countless holes were blasted into the wall sending dust scattering. Song Qinglan even spat out a mouthful of dirt and smashed a zombie's head with a fist hook. He continued, "It named this cycle 【Overload】."

Ji Yushi: "Overload?"

That's right!

They didn't belong to any of the existing cycles in Ouroboros and in these cycles the two of them were unique entities.

From the time anchor's point of view, every cycle occurred at the same time, so them appearing in different cycles was a high probability event. After all, the addition of them could be regarded as an overloaded state.

No wonder the other party they saw in each cycle didn't retain memories of the last cycle.

Despite this, Ji Yushi was still shocked.



He was shocked by the so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’, and even somewhat understood the meaning of ‘departing from the traditional linear development of time and having all eras exist at the same time’.

For example the twelfth squad returning to 1456, for example their current situation....If there was no so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’ claiming itself to be the parent system to control it, and this terrible possibility was allowed to continue indefinitely, such a situation would be everywhere. By then, there would no longer be a boundary between life and death.

This kind of development depended entirely on——

“Have to thank your father who sacrificed and dedicated himself to the world.” Song Qinglan spoke without emotion, “Seems like it’s not like he didn’t do anything for you.”

Ji Yushi was stunned.

In fact, ever since waking up and discovering that he was back in Ouroboros, he had never thought of Sheng Yun.

He returned to that day and died once.

After witnessing everything, he seemed to have completely separated the past from the present.

Even if he returned to the cycle, he was no longer the Ji Yushi who was burdened by the past.

Song Qinglan observed the situation outside and saw that their teammates were all approaching them, “This is the current situation. It is best that we can both wait until the black wall comes so that we can return to the capsule together. The problem is that we’re not in the same cycle.”

“It’s not difficult.” Ji Yushi pondered and said, “As long as we ensure that our cycles overlap when completing the mission and we complete the mission just before the paradox occurs, we will be able to go back together.”

Song Qinglan also thought of it, “It indeed isn’t difficult.”

During his encounters with Ji Yushi in these cycles, Song Qinglan was also able to gradually reach the answer.

But he liked to listen to Ji Yushi analyse their situation.

“Then you will have to find me every time before I die.” Song Qinglan said, “Since I’m so eye-catching, it shouldn’t be hard.”

He had said this but there was no reaction behind him.

Song Qinglan looked back. The space next to him was empty. Ji Yushi had disappeared again.

The teammates not far away had also disappeared.

The zombies that had just been killed by them came back to life.

Song Qinglan’s heart felt empty.

He lightly punched the wall and sat down.

Three or four zombies charged towards him from around the corner. He didn’t show any intentions to move.

“Bang, bang, bang!!”

Several gunshot sounds.

A bloody hole was blown through their heads. One by one, they fell to the ground.

The stench of blood filled the air.

A tall and slender figure wearing a black combat uniform appeared from around the corner. His right hand held Diamond Bird and his left hand stretched out.

Song Qinglan raised his arm and held onto that hand.

He borrowed their strength and stood up.

“So fast this time.” He said.

“Yeah.” Ji Yushi replied, “Afraid of making you wait too long.”

Song Qinglan lowered his head and kissed those lips.

Ji Yushi hugged his neck and responded to the kiss.

Gunpowder scattered across the air.

They were each other’s salvation.

# Chapter 100: Chapter 100

## Resplendent Times

### Chapter 100

“Congratulations! You have completed the branch mission 【Overload】 . Mission rating: None. Mission points: None. You will now be redirected to the time coordinate: 1456.06.25 15:30:00.”

“Please wait.”

“Connection successful.”

An hour after they left, two silver-white capsules appeared on the transmission platform.

The people in the command centre who have been paying close attention to the data being reported back on their screens quickly entered a busy state as they prepared for their return.

A capsule door opened. Song Qinglan got out first. Surrounded by staff who were checking on him, he passed over the nutrient solution in his hand to a staff.

The other capsule door also opened, and Ji Yushi came out.

He was similarly surrounded by staff.

Chief Wang had already returned to the command centre. Together with the commander-in-chief, they watched them through the glass window.

When she saw Song Qinglan, Chief Wang's expression was very complicated, as if something had shocked her. The commander-in-chief on the side was still saying something to her but she seemed to be having some difficulty registering all this information.

A distant memory returned.

While being checked on by the staff and given some time to register the change in environment, Song Qinglan soon remembered what he had done before he left — Publicly coming out.

Although it had been many days for him, but for the people in this original time and space, it was only one hour ago. This was news that had shocked the entire third command centre and even Chief Wang. As of now, that news probably hadn't reached the rest of the Tianqiong network.

Song Qinglan sat on the steps with his sleeves rolled up waiting for his blood pressure to be checked.

Seeing that Chief Wang was still looking at him, he raised his other free hand to salute the still dumbfounded Chief Wang and then revealed a lazy grin.

The meaning of it was: That's right, it is exactly what you're thinking. Not only did I bend, I also captured an excellent and very fine partner.

It was a blessing.

That arrogant look was the same expression Song Qinglan had when he managed to stand out during the training camp and became the first new captain with a medal.

“Advisor Ji——”

Someone exclaimed.

Song Qinglan expression changed. He immediately waved away the staff and strode over towards the crowd.

Everyone gave way.

He saw Ji Yushi sitting with his back against the raised part of the platform with his eyes lightly closed, arms resting on his knees and his dark, silky hair scattered loosely over his forehead. He was in a completely relaxed state. The staff checking his pulse was about to reach over to check his eyes.

“Don’t move.” Song Qinglan stopped him.

Everyone was puzzled.

Song Qinglan bent down and quietly watched Ji Yushi for a few seconds before saying, “Don’t disturb him.”

He had returned back to 1439 to address something that had been weighing heavily on his mind for many years and was forced to accept a truth that was difficult to accept and even died once.

After that, he went back to the Ouroboros mission in 1470 and, in repeated cycles over and over again, he did his best to reunite with Song Qinglan who was in another cycle.

The mission that had already been completed by them before was simple and they were able to reach the 100<sup>th</sup> floor and find the control room without much difficulty. Ji Yushi however was reborn again and again as Song Qinglan advanced towards his destined deaths and he also needed to ensure that they complete the mission together before the paradox occurred.

Ji Yushi was very tired. This wasn’t a psychological kind, but a physical kind.

For all these years, he had never rested like this before but the moment he walked out of the capsule, he fell asleep right before everyone’s eyes.

The people dispersed again. Chief Wang and the commander-in-chief stepped onto the transmission platform.

Chief Wang asked nervously, “What’s wrong?”

Song Qinglan looked back. His dark eyes contained gentleness and warmth she had never seen before, “Asleep.”

“Then he should still wake up first. The Inspectors are still waiting for your reports.” The commander-in-chief said, “Xiao Ji’s situation is special, and this time is also an exception so once you’re done with the report, you can rest as you like.”

Song Qinglan understood this.

As a squad leader, it was commonplace for him to find himself delayed by three or four hours after returning before he could truly rest. He was already very used to this.

But he looked at Ji Yushi and stood up, “You’re right, his situation is indeed very special. After experiencing so much, even Ironman would be tired. I will do the report first. After he wakes up, you can question him however you like.”

Song Qinglan wore a black combat uniform. The same was true for Ji Yushi.

They were wearing something completely different when they left. Chief Wang found it strange but after talking to the two, that feeling of strangeness disappeared without a trace. It was as if they were actually dressed like this before setting off.

Without history being changed, this change in time and space had patched up everyone’s memories.

Except for the two who had experienced the new time anchor, no one remembered these differences.

The commander-in-chief frowned. He seemed a little hesitant over this request.

Chief Wang had already made her decision, “Alright then.”

As a leader and also as a mother, Chief Wang showed 120% charisma.

After making the decision, no one else around them refuted it, including the usually by-the-book commander-in-chief. In front of everyone, Song Qinglan picked him up and brought him over to the lounge in the seventh squad training ground.

\*

Ji Yushi didn't sleep very long. He only slept from afternoon to night.

After waking up, he went to give his report and his thoughts were clear, but as soon as he returned to Song Qinglan's car, he fell back into a dark and sweet dream and continued to sleep.

After the two returned from 1439, the higher-ups had planned on immediately assigning them with missions to complete but through their reports, it was revealed that there was actually a lot more to Sheng Yun's 'suicide' incident and many highly confidential files will need to be investigated again. As a result, after completing the preliminary discussions, the superiors decided to give them extra time off.

In other words, they would not carry out new missions until this matter was completely dealt with.

It would be a long process.

The Tianqiong seventh squad was finally granted a proper long vacation.

On the way back, Song Qinglan received a call from Ji Minyue, "Teacher Ji."

"Cap Song?" Ji Minyue was taken aback, "Where's Ji Yushi?"

Song Qinglan answered the other party's phone as if it was very natural. The male voice travelling through the phone also carried some fondness, "He's still asleep. I didn't wake him up."

Ji Minyue: "....."



Why was he always forgetting the fact that his younger brother now had someone with him?

The sports car followed the roads. Jiang City at night was still very lively.

The night breeze sent hot air into the car. Fearing that it would make Ji Yushi uncomfortable, Song Qinglan only left a small gap in the window, minimising the noises coming in from outside.

Ji Yushi slept in the front passenger seat. The seat was leaned back quite far.

With neon lights coming in through the car windows, his profile in the colourful but dim lights looked like a painting.

“How was it?” Ji Minyue seemed to be unsure of what to ask. He was afraid of the outcome being far outside of their expectations and even more afraid of Ji Yushi being unable to take it, “What did you see that year? Did you catch the murderer?”

The lights turned red.

Song Qinglan held one of Ji Yushi’s hands, his thumb gently caressing the back of it, “He’s fine. When he wakes up, I will get him to call you back....He might go home for a visit.”

The Ji family had played a very important role in Ji Yushi’s life.

After waking up, the most likely thing Ji Yushi would do first would be visiting the Ji residence. He had the obligation and need to tell his family everything that had been troubling him over the past seventeen years and everything that happened in 1439.

When Song Qinglan said that, Ji Minyue realised that things probably weren’t as simple as they thought.

Even if he wanted to know the truth now, when he heard that Ji Yushi was fine, he was reassured. Ji Minyue just said another few words before hanging up.

“Song Qinglan.” Ji Yushi woke up, “Was it my brother?”

He opened his pair of beautiful eyes and was lying on the black car seat in a rather lazy and relaxed manner.

Song Qinglan could hardly remove his eyes.

The quiet car, the noisy city. It reminded Ji Yushi that he was finally back.

Song Qinglan: “It was Teacher Ji. He wanted to ask how you were and was reassured when he heard that you’re with me.”

Ji Yushi maintained the same position as when he was asleep, “So he wouldn’t be reassured if I wasn’t with you?”

The lights turned green.

Song Qinglan let go of Ji Yushi’s hand and moved his hand back onto the steering wheel, “Who said that? I think you’re quite relaxed, to even fall asleep so courageously. Not afraid that I would do something to you?”

“Will you?” Ji Yushi blinked a few times, “You have been secretly watching me for so long, but I’ve never seen you take action.”

He was talking about the things Song Qinglan did after he left the world in 1439.

After returning to Ouroboros, the two had constantly been rushing around. In order to make the cycles overlap, they had to appear again and again before each other before the paradox occurred and they didn’t have any time to talk about these things.

Those cycles, those intricate connections that existed before the two even knew about it, had given them something that felt like a destined fate.

Ji Yushi said, “The pervert I mentioned staring at me at the bar, that was you, wasn’t it?”

Song Qinglan's long and slender fingers tapped at the wheel. From Ji Yushi's perspective, he could only see his firm jawline. He heard him chuckle, "Damn, you even remember that? I sat there for many days and only saw you once."

Song Qinglan had been following Ji Yushi for a long time.

At that time, Ji Yushi was twenty years old, still a university student who liked to go around alone.

But perhaps it was because his attitude towards his sexual orientation was too calm or perhaps because his social circle was lacking, he thought of going to a gay bar to see what people of the same sexual orientation were doing.

That night, the theme was a masquerade party, so they all wore masks.

Ji Yushi sat in the corner, ordered a glass of wine and rejected three men who came over to strike up a conversation, before leaving the bar having gained nothing.

Song Qinglan stood on the other side of the dance floor for a long time.

Through the crowd of people dancing and partying, he greedily watched Ji Yushi for over forty minutes.

That was also the longest time he was able to see Ji Yushi during his traverses. Who would have thought that he was the 'pervert' in Ji Yushi's memory?

Ji Yushi quickly choked up. He forced the dampness in his eyes back, "Because I only went there once. Are you stupid?"

"I am." Song Qinglan found it funny. He looked back at him and said meaningfully, "When I went back, I was caught by your father."

This was also a topic the two hadn't spoken about.

Ji Yushi was already awake, and the way back was still long. Song Qinglan very simply explained to him everything that happened after Sheng Yun appeared.

He spoke of the prototype of the so-called ‘Tianqiong of all eras’. When he spoke about when Sheng Yun said that Ji Yushi’s death wasn’t the final ending, Ji Yushi sat up.

He adjusted the seat, drank some water to clear his mind and thought over those words for a while, “That time and space hijack.....could it have been what we originally thought it was?”

First the seventh squad was hijacked.

Then, in order to rewrite Ji Yushi’s fate, they once again returned to the moment they were hijacked.

Which came first and which came later?

Song Qinglan had also thought about this question before. Ji Yushi’s reaction was something he had expected. He said to Ji Yushi, “A circle going around another circle. A perfect coincidence.”

“No.” Ji Yushi shook his head, “This is not a coincidence, nor did it happen in accordance to the developments.”

Song Qinglan, “What do you mean?”

“We thought that under the operation of the parent system, there would be no distinction between cause and effect, before and after. A sequence of events could be considered as everything happening at the same time.” Ji Yushi explained, “In fact, have you ever thought that it was in fact manipulating us to perfect this cause-and-effect relationship? It needed a starting point and also needed a closed cycle, or it would be unable to remain consistent.”

Song Qinglan followed his thoughts and frowned slightly, “You mean, your death in 1439 was probably also an originally planned event?”

“Yes. My death was the reason behind his motivation to delve deeply into developing a time anchor.” Ji Yushi said, “If I am not wrong, perhaps this was the reason why we could survive in the Super S-level missions. Without a time anchor, completing missions like Ouroboros would be impossible with just us.”

Song Qinglan’s eyebrows were deeply furrowed, “Then Sheng Yun knew.....”

His tone suddenly became colder. The anger contained in it was very obvious.

Ji Yushi grabbed his arm and slowly spoke, “I can understand why he did it.”

It was another red light.

Song Qinglan pushed down on the brakes and turned on the automatic driving mode.

He turned and touched Ji Yushi’s face. He seemed to be almost heartbroken, “He is your father! His most basic responsibility as a father is to care for you and protect you as you grow up, not to make sacrifices for the sake of the world or for the big picture. You are not his pawn! He can’t be regarded as a great man, he’s a madman!”

Ji Yushi said, “If it was me, I might’ve done the same.”

Song Qinglan’s eyes contained even more anger. He gritted his teeth, “I won’t——”

“From the moment humanity came into contact with the secret of time, regardless of whether or not they wanted to, they had already become deeply involved.” Ji Yushi said, “In a broad sense, he was also a chess piece. All his choices and everything he did was predetermined.”

People who engage in science are all madmen.

Those who try to control time were all madmen. Those who try to correct it were also all madmen.

Ji Yushi would always have clearest thought process. He rubbed his face against Song Qinglan's hand, "Looking at it from another angle, he had rewritten everything."

That was why a larger time anchor was set up.

This was a blessing amidst all the misfortunes. It was the best a father who had no other choice could do for his child.

Song Qinglan lowered his head. He pressed his forehead against Ji Yushi's forehead.

At this moment, he hated Sheng Yun and he also hated Ji Yushi's calmness. He would rather Ji Yushi cry and be upset than hear him make such a rational analysis.

But it was precisely this calmness of Ji Yushi's that made him so hopelessly attracted. This was the true Ji Yushi.

Song Qinglan was lost for words.

Ji Yushi said, "You can think of it from another angle."

Song Qinglan snorted coldly.

Ji Yushi just continued, "Think about it. If it weren't for these things happening, how could I have cats?"

Song Qinglan, "....."

He also made three love rivals.

Ji Yushi kissed the tip of his nose and spoke solemnly, "Song Qinglan, thank you for sending the cats to my seventeen-year-old self."

He stretched out his arms and wrapped it around Song Qinglan's neck, "Having seen my seventeen-year-old self, what were your thoughts?"

It sounded almost coquettish.

Or to be more accurate, it was a form of temptation.

Song Qinglan knew that Ji Yushi was secretly changing the topic.

But at this moment, he couldn't help but fall for it. His throat bobbed, "Thoughts?"

In the rainstorm, he actually didn't see the other person clearly, but he didn't mention it.

Song Qinglan almost couldn't hold himself back. All the trials he had experienced in his entire life had not been as difficult as that moment when the seventeen-year-old Ji Yushi called out to him.

He grumbled, "I fucking almost died holding back."

There was a lot of space in the car.

But at this distance, their lips were almost touching.

They could feel the heat from each other's breaths.

The moment they were about to touch, Ji Yushi retreated back and asked, "So, Cap Song who lets Ji Minyue feel reassured, where are you taking me now?"

**KK has something to say:**



*Anyway, is the uncensored version which I managed to dig out huehuehue.*

# Chapter 101: Chapter 101

## Resplendent Times

### Chapter 101

Where was Song Qinglan taking Ji Yushi?

Originally, since Ji Yushi was asleep the entire time, Song Qinglan had decided to take him directly home and then make him something to eat when he wakes up, but now that he had woken up on their way back, Song Qinglan changed his mind.

“Take you to eat.” Song Qinglan said, “What do you want to eat?”

Ji Yushi was so hungry, he felt like his chest was about to stick to his back. In fact, he was woken up from hunger. After thinking about it, he suggested, “I want to eat hot pot.”

Song Qinglan, “Hot pot?”

Ji Yushi, “Yes, the kind that is very spicy.”

Song Qinglan was very familiar with Jiang City so this request would most certainly not stump him. The two had been together for so long during the break last time, he had already figured out Ji Yushi’s preferences—The way they progressed their relationship was completely opposite to that of ordinary couples. Usually, couples would start with gradually understanding each other’s preferences before becoming attracted and getting together and naturally wouldn’t have any issues with preferences clashing. As for them, they had become a couple first before they knew more about each other’s preferences and daily habits.



Ji Yushi liked spicy food and he also liked sweet food. Unlike his cold and calm appearance, he preferred strong tastes.

Song Qinglan on the other hand wasn't picky. He not only liked to eat, but he also liked the cook. The two unexpectedly got along very well.

At an intersection, Song Qinglan turned the steering wheel and turned into a hot pot restaurant that was open late into the night. There, they found a quiet private room.

Ji Yushi's appetite had never been better. He focused on eating, eating until his eyes were red and nose was covered in a layer of sweat. He even drank a bottle of ice-cold beer.

Someone came to greet Song Qinglan in the private room. The owner of the store turned out to be another one of Song Qinglan's comrade-in-arms.

The three exchanged a few words. The friend wasn't at all curious about Ji Yushi's identity. Ji Yushi immediately thought of Xue Zhao who he had met at the skydiving club last time.

It was likely that everyone already knew about Song Qinglan coming out and having a boyfriend.

After that friend left, Ji Yushi asked, "A lot of your comrades have changed careers."

Song Qinglan ordered a drink, helped Ji Yushi open the bottle and then gave it to him to help eliminate the spiciness in his mouth, "Very few changed careers. Most of them had to retire due to old injuries. Old Zhou and I were comparatively lucky and to them, we can be regarded as having changed careers. Guardians and soldiers are two different things."

Ji Yushi's lips were red from the spiciness. His eyes were shiny like they were washed by water, "If you didn't become a Guardian, what would you have done?"

Song Qinglan thought about it for a while, “There probably wouldn’t be that possibility.”

Ji Yushi: “Why?”

Song Qinglan, “If I didn’t become a Guardian, how could I meet you again?”

That made sense.

If Song Qinglan didn’t become a Guardian, Ji Yushi would always just be that ‘Han Han’ in his memories.

Ji Yushi took a few gulps of his drink and then noticed that Song Qinglan was still looking at him, “What’s wrong?”

Song Qinglan’s eyes were deeper than usual.

After experiencing that separation, his thoughts had changed a lot.

For him, sitting here at this moment in a down-to-earth hot pot restaurant and eating with a living Ji Yushi was already a luxury.

Time had changed this world, and it had also gifted a lot of things to his world.

No matter what the cause and effect was, no matter how one circle connected to another circle, it was enough as long as they were still together.

“I was thinking,” Song Qinglan said, “if I grew up in Ning City as a child and went to the same elementary school, middle school etc as you, what would’ve happened?”

Ji Yushi had never thought about this question.

He couldn’t imagine what it would be like if he had Song Qinglan growing up with him.

“You asked me earlier what my thoughts were after seeing the seventeen-year-old you.” Song Qinglan continued, “I only had one thought at that time, and that was—If I had never left Ning City, would we have gotten together earlier? If that was the case, you wouldn’t have been so lonely, and I would’ve been able to accompany you though the coming-of-age ceremony and accompany you when you joined Tianqiong. It didn’t matter whether or not I become a Guardian myself.”

Ji Yushi thought about it and answered seriously, “Perhaps in another parallel world, things really developed the way you described.”

The universe was infinite. The worlds were numerous.

Different choices made a person could produce countless parallel worlds, and in each of them, they led a different life.

And he and Song Qinglan happened to be one of them.

Song Qinglan smiled, “If I have the opportunity to, I would like to go to such a parallel world and see.”

\*

It was almost midnight when they were done eating.

Song Qinglan parked the car and then entered the elevator and went directly to the door to his place.

Because of his job, Song Qinglan had moved out from home and moved here. Except for his traces, there were no traces of any other life. Even Old Zhou and the other teammates rarely had the opportunity to come let alone Ji Yushi who was here for the first time.

As soon as they entered, the smart system automatically started up and the spacious and bright living room appeared before Ji Yushi.

The white-toned decorations were almost minimalist in style. At first glance, there was only a carpet and sofa in the living room. It made the three-metre high and seven- or eight-metre-long floor-to-ceiling window

that reflected the Jiang City's nightscape become the best decoration in the house.

The house keeping robot rolled over. It automatically picked up the belongings of its master and their guest and helped hang them up before going to the bathroom to prepare the water for their bath. It was done all in accordance with Song Qinglan's habits.

Ji Yushi entered the living room. He looked at the floor-to-ceiling window first.

He noticed that from this angle, he could see the suspended train tracks stretching far into the distance.

A pair of arms embraced Ji Yushi from behind. Immediately afterwards, his ear was lightly bitten, leaving both a numb and itchy sensation.

Song Qinglan didn't hold back, nor did he find it too sudden. He only relied on his tall height to openly take advantage of the other person, "After you left in the bubble world, I stood here and imagined whether those trains will bring you back from Ning City."

Ji Yushi's throat bobbed. His expression however remained indifferent.

Song Qinglan asked again, "Will you come?"

Just as Ji Yushi was about to say something, Song Qinglan kissed him on the neck and then ambiguously licked it. This action made a soft wet sound, making him forget what he was going to say.

As Song Qinglan softly kissed him, "Advisor Ji, it's late."

"Mhn." Ji Yushi's back was trembling slightly from the kiss, "Go wash."

Those words were spoken a little lightly, the breathing unstable.

The content of his words however was filled with disgust, because Ji Yushi couldn't tolerate his own smell.

In fact, the two of them smelt of hot pot, which indeed wasn't too good.

But Song Qinglan didn't mind at all. With his head buried in Ji Yushi's neck, he took in the scent coming from Ji Yushi's body.

He didn't stop teasing. Looking at Ji Yushi's reflection in the floor-to-ceiling window deviously, he proposed, "Let's wash together? How about doing something to help digest along the way?"

Ji Yushi looked at the other person's expression through the glass, "....."

Since the two of them were together, of course what should happen would happen. They didn't plan on going around in circles and dragging it out.

He just regretted choosing to eat hot pot. Wouldn't it have been better to have come here directly instead?

"Let's go together." Song Qinglan still looked at him through the reflection. He plotted evilly, "It's not like we haven't washed together before."

The furthest they had gone was that night at the skydiving club.

Song Qinglan was originally supposed to help him wash, but the situation changed and the two ended up making a big mess in the bathroom.

Not waiting for Ji Yushi's refusal, Song Qinglan proceeded to bump against him from behind to demonstrate how eager he was.

Ji Yushi's scalp went numb. His hands subconsciously pressed against the glass in front of him to stabilise himself, "Don't——"

"I can't help it." Song Qinglan said, "You feel it."

Ji Yushi was flipped around by him and pressed against the glass.

"Can see but can't touch. You have always been torturing me in those cycles." Song Qinglan got closer and bumped against him again to show his eagerness. He looked at Ji Yushi deeply, "How is it? Isn't it very anxious?"

It was like there was a fire ignited inside Song Qinglan's eyes. The words he spoke were explicit and his actions were aggressive.

When the gazes of the two met, he lowered his head and gently kissed Ji Yushi's lips like he was touching a beloved treasure.

This person was so sleepy, he directly fell asleep in the command centre.

He was also sleepy on their way back after having hot pot. The time where he was sober and clear-minded was very short. It was like he wanted to catch up on all the sleep he had lost over those years. If he didn't do something while he was still awake, Song Qinglan probably would be too reluctant to wake him up.

Song Qinglan kissed him again, "Ji Yushi...."

The soft lips touched and then separated.

It was like their first kiss.

Ji Yushi's heart was beating very quickly. Thanks to his memory, even such a shallow kiss made him to automatically recall all the details from when Song Qinglan kissed him previously. He knew what Song Qinglan might do next, he knew how he would be kissed until his entire body felt weak, and he also knew how he would concede to Song Qinglan's requests the moment he loses all his strength.

As a result, his body began to heat up.

He asked Song Qinglan, "Do you know what you should really do to help with digestion?"

After he was done asking, he felt his body become lighter. Song Qinglan had picked him up, "I would like to hear the details."

Song Qinglan had already moved to the bathroom as he said this. Ji Yushi could only once again hook his arms around his neck to barely stabilise himself. He leaned forward and whispered two words.

Song Qinglan stopped in place. His body had stiffened, and his voice was hoarse, “Are you sure?”

“In any case,” Ji Yushi muttered, “.....I don’t want the skin on my thighs to hurt his time.”

Those familiar words once again made Ji Yushi recall what happened to them last time at the club.

In fact, he had thought that they would reach the last step that time, but the result was a little outside of his expectations. He had thought Song Qinglan didn’t know what to do but after recalling everything that happened that night after waking up, he understood how much restraint Song Qinglan had to exercise at the time.

Ji Yushi wasn’t an abstinent person. He didn’t value certain things that much.

He didn’t care about top or bottom, let alone whether it was romantic or not. If they wanted to do it, they can do it. As long as the other person was the person he wanted, he could accept anything.

Ji Yushi sounded very calm.

But for Song Qinglan, it was shocking.

He returned to his senses, pulled open Ji Yushi’s pair of long legs, and wrapped it around his waist, “You said it yourself. I had never heard of an invitation like that.”

Ji Yushi spoke expressionlessly, “You can choose to refuse.”

“Refuse?” Song Qinglan, “It seems that you have a deep misunderstanding of your own attractiveness.”

Perhaps all the devious teasing in the car had already set things on fire, Ji Yushi knew that he was currently in a rather dangerous situation.

He was carried to the bathroom by Song Qinglan like a child and he couldn't help but do some self-reflection along the way. Having discovered his conscience, he took the initiative to lower his head and kiss Song Qinglan.

This kind of flattery obviously didn't have any effect. Song Qinglan placed Ji Yushi on the cold vanity in the bathroom and returned the kiss more passionately as he took off his own shirt.

Ji Yushi remembered that they had kissed like this back in the club. The showerhead had made Song Qinglan's clothes wet, causing it to stick to his warm body. Water flowed out from their entangled tongues and lips and was quickly sucked back in by Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan's hand reached into his clothes, causing his heart to race wildly.

Those hands were large enough. Following the slender and flexible waist that also had firm muscles, it was enough to easily hold him without much difficulty.

As Ji Yushi kissed back, his hands were also not idle. He helped Song Qinglan pull down his pant zipper.

The edges of his underwear were exposed. The large bulge in the black briefs were particularly obvious.

"You're so hard." He said with his eyes lowered.

"I told you." Song Qinglan didn't try to deny it.

Ji Yushi used his finger to gently touch it. It lightly bounced.

He reached over to touch it over the fabric.

Song Qinglan however grabbed his hand. As he kissed him, he spoke incoherently, "Wait."

A second later, Ji Yushi's hand was hot.



Song Qinglan had taken off his briefs and placed it directly into his palm. Like their first time, he held his hand and taught him how to move, “Hold mine.”

Ji Yushi was caught unprepared by that big and thick thing. Feeling the heat coming from it, his own body also underwent some changes.

Song Qinglan started to move.

He continued to suck at Ji Yushi’s lips.

He invaded Ji Yushi’s mouth with his tongue and continued to tease Ji Yushi’s tongue as he forcefully moved.

Ji Yushi used one hand to control Song Qinglan’s hand and moved it over to his own pants, “Don’t just take care of yourself.”

Song Qinglan lowly laughed. He very cooperatively helped unzip his pants and helped hold his.

This feeling felt like he was scratching at an itch through a layer of thick material. Ji Yushi wasn’t satisfied.

This position didn’t allow him to do anything. Not only was his hand sore, he also couldn’t control the rhythm like Song Qinglan. It was only when Song Qinglan loosened his hand and held both of theirs together that he felt slightly more satisfied.

The housekeeping robot was still in the bathroom, waiting to test the water temperature.

At this moment, it was standing quietly in the corner, the camera light flashing red like it was spying on the two.

Ji Yushi rested on Song Qinglan’s shoulder. He found it difficult to concentrate, “It’s watching us.”

Song Qinglan looked back, “Fuck.”

He let go of Ji Yushi, lifted the housekeeping robot and threw it outside before returning and closing the door, "I've given it a warning. It definitely won't tell the others."

Ji Yushi:"....."

There were only the two of them in the bathroom now.

Song Qinglan took off his clothes and turned around. He approached Ji Yushi like this without hiding anything.

He was originally tall and well-built. His solid, wheat-coloured chest, his well-defined abdominal muscles and his mermaid lines, they were something that had been perfectly sculpted after many years of intensive training. Ji Yushi only needed to glance at it to have that scene deeply engraved into his mind.

It had to be said that Ji Yushi really liked Song Qinglan's body.

And the gangster-like air Song Qinglan's body gave off undoubtedly gave him more sex appeal.

At this moment, this man was like a cheetah slowly approaching his prey.

He half oppressively peeled the clothes off Ji Yushi and then picked him up and got into the bathtub.

The water in the bathtub spilled out.

Ji Yushi's beautiful body appeared even more pale in the water. He was pulled over by Song Qinglan so that he was sitting in his lap again and was bitten on his neck, clavicle and nipples. Countless marks were left behind.

The difference in skin colour made the scene appear somewhat erotic. They continued to kiss and embrace, doing the most erotic yet also the most sacred activity. It was instinctual, it was love.

Ji Yushi was slippery, like a particularly charming fish.

Song Qinglan's large hands massaged his snow-white butt cheeks. As if he wanted to make up for the regrets from the last time he touched this place, he wasn't very gentle. Using the water and bath gel as a lubricant, his finger for the first time touched the concealed entrance.

The water temperature wasn't high and just right for a summers day, but the slow process of widening the entrance still resulted in a layer of sweat to form on Song Qinglan's forehead.

Ji Yushi bit his shoulder. His face was pale.

They didn't stop.

The process of entering took a very long time.

Although Song Qinglan had displayed plenty of patience and gentleness, the pain was greater than what Ji Yushi had expected.

Both of them were covered in small beads of sweat.

Ji Yushi's breathing was a little rough, "Move a little....."

The veins on the sides of Song Qinglan's temples were bulging, but he only moved ever so slightly.

Sure enough, Ji Yushi's body once again stiffened. The pain made it difficult for him to speak.

Song Qinglan stopped. He turned his head and kissed his clavicle and lower jaw.

At this moment, Ji Yushi's usually calm and rational face carried heavy desire. His eyes were gently closed, the long eyelashes casting a shadow under his eyes

But there was also some pain in his expression, making people want to make him cry out, make him become taken in by desire, until he completely let himself go and indulged himself in lust.

Song Qinglan could no longer hold back.

He picked the person up in his arms and stood up.

Ji Yushi hung from his body. Because the act of standing touched a certain place, his entire body suddenly trembled, “D-don’t move…….”

Song Qinglan didn’t listen.

He felt him tightening around him when he did that and knew that Ji Yushi had felt pleasure that left him on the verge of collapsing. He proceeded to press the person against the edge of the bathtub and forcefully thrust.

Again and again.

The constant deep thrusts made Ji Yushi feel like his body and mind was about to go out of control.

Behind him was the cold edge of the bathtub and before him was a hot chest.

He was forced into moving up and down, following the thrusts that grew more and more forceful each time. The pleasure from it reached all the way to his scalp, making him feel like an electric current was surging through his spine. His limbs were so weak, they could hardly support Song Qinglan. This strange feeling where he was losing control of himself made Ji Yushi scared.

His fingers were grabbed.

He felt Song Qinglan insert his own fingers between his one by one and clasp his hand tightly.

“Ji Yushi.”

He heard Song Qinglan’s sexy and hoarse voice sound next to his ear as he continued to invade him.

“You will remember our first time, won’t you?”

Song Qinglan changed it into a statement, “You will remember....the first time I give you this feeling.”

“So look at my face.”

Ji Yushi opened his eyes.

The edges of his eyes were red.

The room was filled with mist.

The long night was romantic and gentle.

Song Qinglan kissed him and then slammed into his body even more fiercely.

The moment the two convulsed at the same time, Song Qinglan called out his name.

“.....Han Han.”

**KK has something to say:**

Only two more chapters to go until the end!

# Chapter 102: Chapter 102

## Resplendent Times

### Chapter 102

The Ji Yushi in his youth had never thought that he would have an intimate relationship with another person.

Even if he knew his sexuality, he didn't have any special thoughts about it, and even after going to a gay bar and studying how things were done between people of the same sex, he never thought that it would happen to him. He couldn't imagine what his other half would look like, nor could he imagine how he would be able to accept forming such a close union with another human being and exchanging their everything with each other.

Humid and sweaty.

The cicadas cried out in the summer night.

The room was very quiet with only one nightlight turned on.

The bed sheets were a dark blue colour. As the moonlight entered through the blinds, it left lines of pale light across the snow-white and sweaty back.

The mattress was so soft, it felt like he was sinking in.

Ji Yushi sank into the fluffy blanket face down and was forced to sway with the rhythm. He saw a pillow fall onto the carpet.

The feeling building up was very scary. His fingers unconsciously grabbed the only pillow left on the bed while another larger hand grabbed his hand.

Because of the force and effort used, the veins on the back of that hand were bulging.

“Don’t bite the sheets.”

Song Qinglan pressed against his back. The light and shadow of the blinds moved across his wheat-coloured body and his sweat made his broad shoulders glisten like honey.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Song Qinglan stuck a finger into his mouth to rescue the pitiful and wet bedsheet, and then gently stroked his teeth and rubbed his lips.

“Don’t want to hear your own voice?”

Ji Yushi closed his eyes and didn’t want to answer. He unconsciously bit his lips.

Unlike ordinary people, he not only remembered all the useful information, but also things that left him embarrassed. He had no choice. Those memories would always appear without warning, embarrassing him. How could he allow himself to feed his memories with more of it?

“What to do? I want to hear.” Song Qinglan let out a low and evil laugh, “Han Han.....Let me hear you.”

Ji Yushi was both hot and uncomfortable.

He already could no longer bear with this kind of torture anymore. He wanted to crawl away but because Song Qinglan was too heavy, he couldn’t go anywhere.

“Okay?”

“I’ll also let you hear?”

“Mnn.....”

That annoying pleasant voice entered his ears, reaching the depths of his mind.

Suddenly, Ji Yushi raised his neck, his body trembling and spasming, and his mind turning blank. He wasn't able to calm down for a while. By the time it was over, and he turned his head back, his eyes were already filled with tears.

Song Qinglan was startled. He had actually made Ji Yushi cry.

Immediately following that, his face was hit by a pillow.

Ji Yushi's voice was low and a little hoarse, "Have you had enough?!"

It definitely wasn't enough.

Song Qinglan wasn't ashamed or annoyed. His skin was thicker than the bed.

He turned the man over and leaned down to kiss him. While Ji Yushi was caught unprepared, he continued the expedition he had only just started.

They hid into the sheets.

Don't let the moonlight see.

Ji Yushi once again hooked his arms around his neck and sank into the deep sea.

\*

Ji Yushi didn't dream last night.

He slept deeply, just like how he did when he returned to the third command centre and didn't want to wake up because of physical exhaustion. The difference between now and that time was that he was lying defencelessly in Song Qinglan's arms. He slept deeply the entire time and only woke up when the sky darkened the next day.



This was Ji Yushi's first time experiencing what people meant by oversleeping.

He sat up in bed, his mind still groggy. It took him some time to remember that he was later brought into the bathroom for another bath and had fallen asleep directly on the sofa afterwards.

Ji Yushi belatedly realised that this was called being spoiled.

After doing those things, his body felt a little strange.

Especially that certain place, it made his act of getting out of bed very unnatural.

But when both his feet touched the ground, he finally knew that it was in fact nothing compared to this. His legs and waist felt like they had been pierced by multiple needles. Along with the stabbing pain was muscle soreness. He could hardly walk.

Ji Yushi stood in place for a while to adapt. After his body got used to it, he slowly walked out the bedroom.

Song Qinglan wasn't in the living room.

Ji Yushi turned towards the kitchen and found a glass on the island in the centre to pour himself a glass of water. He emptied half of it in one go.

The housekeeping robot followed behind him. It had been trying to offer him its assistance ever since he started pouring water for himself.

Seeing that Ji Yushi was done, it wanted to help him wash the glass, but Ji Yushi only turned on the faucet and skilfully washed the glass himself.

Ji Yushi then left.

The housekeeping robot watched his leaving figure with a tilted head.

Although the sore feeling from doing those things was still there, it was feeling much better now.

When he practiced Jiu-Jitsu during his younger years, he had often hurt himself and since then he had developed the ability to recover quickly following strenuous exercise. They were all men; he didn't need to wait in bed for Song Qinglan to take care of him. What's more——

A voice could be heard coming from the lounge room.

Song Qinglan was making a call.

“Then next time.” His tone was gentle, “I can't step away yet.”

Ji Yushi stood at the door. He leaned against the door frame and watched his back.

Song Qinglan hadn't put on a shirt. He sat in an armchair with his bare back facing the door.

There were many nail marks on his well-proportioned and defined back muscles, some of which were faintly bruised——If Ji Yushi had grown his nails out, it probably wouldn't have been just that and there may even be bloody scratch marks instead. In addition to that, Song Qinglan also had some hickeys on his body, mostly on the shoulders which were the places Ji Yushi could barely reach. It was just that the ring of teeth marks in that area was somewhat obvious.

When it came to biting, Ji Yushi realised that he was quite gifted.

The more he bit, the harder Song Qinglan moved.

Therefore, he had also contributed a lot to the wonderful experience last night.

This made his cheeks burn up.

He originally wanted to walk away, but he heard Song Qinglan continue to say, “Yeah, didn't want to hide it from you. Haven't been together for that long.”

Ji Yushi gave up the thought of leaving and openly listened to Song Qinglan's phone call.

"It's someone from Tianqiong." Song Qinglan seemed to be interrogated by an elder, "But not just a colleague, we knew each other since we were a child."

"From Ning City."

".....The kindergarten attached to Ning University. We were in the same class."

"I don't know if you've met before, you only came to pick me up a few times back then."

"Yes, a few months younger than me. Very smart. Has several degrees."

"You don't need to buy those things." Song Qinglan laughed, "Won't need those."

"He's a man."

Ji Yushi's expression changed slightly. He knew that Song Qinglan would tell his family sooner or later, but he didn't expect it to be so soon. After all, regardless of what they have experienced, to the others, they have only known each other for a month.

For a person to change their sexuality in just a month and even reach a state where he was willing to do anything for the other party, it really didn't sound true.

Even he himself and Ji Minyue had tacitly not said anything to Professor Ji. Though after Song Qinglan's public act of coming out, the news would probably reach Chief Lin and then enter Professor Ji's ears soon enough.

Sure enough, after Song Qinglan finished saying that, silence followed for several seconds.

The person on the other end didn't know how to react.

Ji Yushi couldn't see Song Qinglan's face and didn't know what was being said through the phone.

He was originally leaning against the door frame but at some point in time he had unconsciously straightened up.

“Okay.” Song Qinglan finally spoke. His tone as usual was relaxed, “When we have the chance, I will arrange for you to meet.”

Song Qinglan ended the call and stood up. When he went over to Ji Yushi, he didn't seem surprised by his presence.

After getting closer, he bowed his head and kissed Ji Yushi, “You walk like a cat. Completely soundless.”

Ji Yushi asked, “Who called?”

Song Qinglan, “My mother.”

Song Qinglan rarely talked about his family. Ji Yushi only knew that he came from a single-parent household, and he went to the kindergarten in Ning City because his parents had separated and were fighting for custody at the time. He suddenly realised that he didn't know much about Song Qinglan. Because of the other party's strong psychological strength and optimistic and relaxed attitude towards life, it made it hard for one to associate him with negativity.

Even in the bubble world, Song Qinglan didn't have any desires and there were very few changes in his life. It was as if he never hesitated when making decisions and lived straightforwardly without regret.

“She works out of town, and I just happened to be on vacation while she's passing by Jiang City so she originally wanted to arrange a time to meet.” Song Qinglan said, “She immediately guessed that I had a partner. Why are women instincts so scary?”

Ji Yushi, “.....”

Song Qinglan, “Fortunately I bent quickly.”

Ji Yushi however was more concerned about something else, “What did she say?”

Song Qinglan knew that he was asking about the gender matter.

Knowing that Ji Yushi would be nervous, he didn’t go around in circles, “My mother is a progressive woman and very accepting. She originally had a necklace she wanted to give you but got angry when she found out it wouldn’t be of use.”

Ji Yushi had a way with getting along with middle-aged women.

His adoptive mother, Aunt Su, was also a university lecturer before she retired. He had plenty of experience coaxing her and making her happy.

“Let’s buy a present for her.” Ji Yushi, “Okay?”

This kind of Ji Yushi seemed livelier.

Song Qinglan liked it very much.

He made a sound of agreement and pulled the person into his arms. Just as he was emotionally thinking over what to say, he heard Ji Yushi say, “Hungry.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

Ji Yushi, “Does your place have anything to eat?”

Although he had eaten his fill of hot pot, even Ironman wouldn’t be able to stand it after a whole night of exercise and a whole day of sleep.

Ji Yushi was in urgent need of energy replenishment.

Song Qinglan had already prepared the food. He wasn’t going to let him go hungry.

But he still had something he wanted to say, “This is also your place.”

Ji Yushi: “?”

Song Qinglan said, “Three bedrooms, one living room and one lounge room. The one on the left will be your study, the one in the middle for the cats and the one on the right will be our bedroom. The balcony is large, you can plant your favourite plants and install cat towers there. We can change to a big table so that we can eat at home and even be able to cater when the squad comes over.”

Ji Yushi froze.

Song Qinglan’s words made him feel strange.

Was this their future plans?

“Why?” Song Qinglan let go of him and bowed his head, “You want to turn back now?”

Ji Yushi, “Wait a minute——”

Song Qinglan pointed at the teeth marks on his shoulders and said very naturally, “You want to go back on your words after we slept together? Didn’t you agree that you would stay in Jiang City and become an official member of the squad?”

Ji Yushi didn’t want to go back on his words, “Since when did I.....”

“Forget it.” Song Qinglan said, “In any case, you won’t be able to go anywhere under my watch.”

He was pushed back into the kitchen.

Like he was casting magic, Song Qinglan conjured up a table filled with lightly flavoured food. He even sat down and helped him pick out fish bones.

Ji Yushi focused on eating for a while before remembering something.

He thought for a while and said seriously, “You can’t install a cat tower on the balcony, it’s too dangerous. Let’s put it in the cat’s room.”

**KK has something to say:**

One more till the end!

# Chapter 103: Chapter 103

## Resplendent Times

### Chapter 103

Ji Yushi rested in Jiang City for two days before leaving for Ning City.

He wasn't dropped off by Song Qinglan this time because he had to go directly to the Ji residence and seeing the parents would be too troublesome. In fact, neither of them wanted to push that matter ahead. The two of them took their time taking in each other's warmth before he left. Song Qinglan hugged him from behind, reluctant to part with him.

The marks on Ji Yushi's body had mostly faded. Ji Yushi naturally didn't let him mess around. He didn't want Song Qinglan to leave Old Ji with a bad impression.

"Really don't need me to send you there?" Song Qinglan tried to make him change his mind.

"No need." Ji Yushi spoke calmly, "This time you can just stand and watch the train take me away and then watch it bring me back from Ning City. As your boyfriend, I should fulfil your wish."

Song Qinglan, "....."

Who the hell wants this kind of wish.

Ji Yushi didn't say much. He didn't show any hesitation when he left.

Song Qinglan watched him enter the elevator and only went back inside when he saw the elevator number reach the first floor.



The place suddenly seemed very empty without Ji Yushi. Song Qinglan circled the living room and began to think about how to change up the place. There was a reason why he didn't insist on going to Ning City with Ji Yushi. He had to remodel all the rooms over the next few days while Ji Yushi is gone and give him a nice surprise.

When he waited for Ji Yushi's reply after his confession, he felt that time was too slow.

Now that they were together, he conversely felt that time went by too quickly. He felt that even if they spend their entire life together, it still wasn't enough.

While calling someone he knew who worked in the relevant field, he entered his room.

Two things at the bedside table caught his attention.

One was a small square box with a clean surface.

It was Ji Yushi's box of medicine.

The other was a small black and white handheld game console. It was very retro in design and the symbols on the buttons had long worn off.

It was Ji Yushi's game console.

It was unknown when Ji Yushi had hid that box of medicine. When Song Qinglan confiscated his medicine last time, it was clear that he hadn't honestly handed all of it in and secretly kept some stashed away. After they returned to get their personal belongings from the third command centre, Ji Yushi had brought it with him.

As for the game console. That was something that Ji Yushi would never part with.

Song Qinglan remembered how angry Ji Yushi was after the dark-skinned man smashed his game console in PU-31. Even Song Qinglan felt the pain when the knife penetrated through the back of that man's hand.

Song Qinglan's lips bent upwards.

Ji Yushi had left these two things because he would be back.

The windows were clean and bright. The sky was clear blue.

In fact, his life with Ji Yushi was still very long.

\*

Ji Yushi returned to Ning City.

When Ji Minyue heard that he was finally willing to come back from his partner's side, he couldn't wait to bring the three cats over to the station to pick him up. The cat-dog battle between Middle Black and the corgi at home was about to drive him crazy.

"Little classmate Ji, you've changed." Ji Minyue said ruefully, "I have always thought that you wouldn't fuss over mundane things but who knew that not only did your mortal heart get moved, but your mind has also become filled with love! You don't want your cats or your family anymore?!"

"What?" Ji Yushi was shocked, "You and sister-in-law moved in together after being together for three months. Why are you complaining about me?"

Ji Minyue, "So what about it?!"

Ji Yushi got in the car and randomly took out a cat from the cat carrier, "Nothing much. I just wanted to tell you that we will be moving in together too. It only took one and a half months."

Ji Minyue felt like his head was about to explode.

Even something like this had to be a competition?!

Seeing that his younger brother was treating him like air and focusing on petting the cat, Ji Minyue roared, "Cohabitation? Have you asked for my

opinion? Have you asked for Old Ji's opinion? Let me tell you, Old Ji will definitely not agree!"

Ji Yushi petted Big Black. His fingers slid across its silky black fur.

The other two cats were meowing in the cat carrier. Surrounded by the three cats, his expression was calm, "Work requirement."

These three cats are in fact already seventeen years old.

From that summer rainstorm where he first started living alone, he had them accompanying him until now. It was about time for them to find a new owner to be with.

It is said that cats don't have good memories.

But Ji Yushi felt that Big Black must have recognised the person who had rescued them that day when Song Qinglan properly came to his place for the first time.

Ji Minyue was stunned, "Work?"

Ji Yushi raised his head. His expression was as cold and calm as ever, but his eyes contained something Ji Minyue had never seen before. It was an interest towards his new life, filled with vitality. That Ji Yushi from before who used to carry all his burdens alone seemed to have disappeared.

"I have already agreed to be transferred to Jiang City to be an official Guardian." Ji Yushi said, "Teacher should already know about it."

Anything Chief Lin knew; Old Ji would also know.

Ji Minyue hadn't heard anything about that. It seems that Old Ji was still waiting for Ji Yushi to return and tell him about it himself.

Probably because Ji Yushi appeared serious and behaved too naturally, Ji Minyue found that he couldn't find words to refute him. Only after driving for several more kilometres, he belatedly realised, "Wait a minute."

Ji Yushi turned his head and looked out the window.

He was in fact laughing.

“What work requirement?” Ji Minyue slammed his fist against the steering wheel, “You’re clearly transferring there just so that you can cohabit with your man!”

The two returned to Ji Yushi’s place first. They released the cats, helped fill their bowls and add water and even gave them a few pieces of dried fish along the way before heading off to the Ji residence together.

Today was a very important day to the Ji family.

Since the day Ji Yushi officially became a member of the Ji family, the shadow belonging to 1439 had continued to hang over their heads. Over the years, it had not only made it difficult for Ji Yushi to sleep, but it also became a source of heartache for the rest of the Ji family.

The small Ji Yushi was taken care of and protected as he grew. There were traces of him left everywhere in this big house.

To him, he didn’t go back to 1439 to seek his roots. After all, this place was his real home.

Everyone in the Ji family was waiting for him to reveal the answer to the mystery. They waited for him to tell them everything about that year.

When Ji Yushi arrived at the Ji residence, Aunt Su said that Professor Ji had a guest.

There usually wouldn’t be many guests over, and the occasional ones were mostly Professor Ji’s students or a few good friends like Chief Lin.

Ji Yushi didn’t disturb them and went back to his room first.

A certain captain surnamed Song was upset about how he had ‘kissed Han Han for three minutes’ when he was a child and insisted that the person who was kissed had remembered wrongly. He wanted to look at photos of Han

Han when he was a child in search for that subconscious ‘three-minute kiss’ memory buried in the depths of his mind and even righteously complained that a certain someone with hyperthymesia cannot deprive him of the right to remember it.

“How did I kiss you?”

The kisses that fell one after another were sometimes light, sometimes heavy. From the back of his neck to the end of his spine, that person asked mischievously while breathing heavily, “Tell me, Han Han. How do you remember it so clearly?”

Ji Yushi stood before the table. The ringing of his phone returned him to his senses.

Some inappropriate scenes flashed across his mind. It made his face red and he even sweated a little.

Fortunately, something like this happened to him often. At least this time it was a pleasant memory.

He took out his phone. It was just the person he was thinking about.

Song Qinglan was calling him.

“Have you arrived home?” Song Qinglan’s tone was light, “Picking up so quickly, were you missing me?”

He hit the right mark.

Ji Yushi didn’t panic. He just said, “I sent the cats home first and just got here. What’s that sound on your end?”

“Café?” Song Qinglan’s end seemed a little noisy. He just had to tease him, “I’m on a blind date.”

Ji Yushi was speechless.

Song Qinglan no longer continued the act, “I’m accompanying Old Duan to his blind date.”

Someone cleared their throat next to him, “Advisor Ji, can you rein him in?! Who would need someone like him to accompany them? Someone like me is enough!”

That voice was Li Chun’s.

The other end was rowdy. Ji Yushi also heard the voices of other people; the Tang Qi and Tang Le brothers, Zhou Mingxuan and Duan Wen.

Everyone had gathered together. It was very lively.

Song Qinglan cursed at them and drove them away. Once it quietened down slightly, Ji Yushi asked, “Old Duan really needs a blind date?”

“He’s after all not that much of a scum like Li Chun. A single old man in his thirties with only men around him, apart from going on a blind date, he can only come out of the closet.” Song Qinglan laughed, “Just kidding, the lady already left. We’re just having a meal since we’re here. When you’re back, we can all go out for another meal.”

Ji Yushi agreed.

“Oh right.” Song Qinglan continued, “A good news and a bad news. Which one do you want to hear.”

“Good news.” He didn’t hesitate.

Song Qinglan laughed, “The command centre received a distress call from an unknown coordinate. It likely came from another time and space. I read the contents of it after Chief Wang sent it through and those strange characters were something I’m certain about. They’re definitely from Big Beard’s time and space. That is to say, their time and space may be in trouble.”

Ji Yushi, “?”

Song Qinglan, “The good news is that our squad is currently on leave so the ninth squad received the mission.”

Ji Yushi lit a candle for Lin Xinlan, “What about the bad news?”

Song Qinglan said, “The bad news is that you will need to take out some of your time to make some language references for those brats in the ninth squad to refer to.”

Ji Yushi felt that this really wasn’t that bad. He wouldn’t need much time to do that.

Song Qinglan then asked him about the food and snacks the cats often ate and even remembered to remind him, “Remember to bring photos back.”

After hanging up, Ji Yushi briefly thought about how he should go about writing that reference.

Then, he found a photo album that seemed like a relic in this time and age and began to flip through the photos of his younger self.

Turning page after page, he went through those distant memories that were still clear in his memories and went through those old times.

Ji Yushi didn’t have many photos of himself when he was young. He was from a single-parent household and because his father had to take the photos, he was alone in these photos. After he was brought into the Ji household, there was a gap. In order to care for his illness, the Ji family at the time were too preoccupied and didn’t have the time or energy to take photos. Only after two or three years later, after he gradually got better, did the records of him and his family increase.

When he reached one of the photos, he stopped.

The child in the photo was about four or five years old, with fair skin and dark and bright eyes. He held a small duck in his hand as he smiled brightly at the camera.

Nothing had happened that year.

That was the most carefree time.

This was the photo Song Qinglan wanted.

Ji Yushi was reluctant to take it out of the photo album, so he took a photo using his phone and sent it to Song Qinglan to complete his task.

After doing this, he casually flipped through the rest of the album but abruptly came to a stop.

There was an extra photo in the album.

A young man with glasses holding a small baby in his arms and a beautiful woman standing beside him.

The two stood very close, the two wedding rings shining brightly on their fingers. They faced the camera, smiling happily.

Ji Yushi remembered very clearly that this photo wasn't in the album before!

His hands trembled slightly. Although he was young at the time, he still remembered that this photo was accidentally torn apart by his heartbroken father after his mother's car accident. Those photo fragments were long gone, so how could it cross over twenty or so years and appear inside this album?!

The only reasonable explanation——

Ji Yushi closed the album and quickly hurried to Professor Ji's study.

He walked very quickly, his hasty footsteps attracting the attention of Ji Minyue and Aunt Su downstairs. He however had no time to take care of that. Ji Yushi who had never been so reckless in his life ran for the first time to the study and pushed open the door. There was however only Professor Ji alone inside.

“What's wrong?” Professor Ji was standing in front of the window using a magnifying glass to examine the patterns on a rock.



“I....” Ji Yushi panted, “Where’s the guest?!”

Professor Ji said, “Already left.”

The wooden fan in the study creaked softly. The wind from it rustled the pages on the desk.

It was a very ordinary summer day.

Ji Yushi’s tense body suddenly relaxed and his expression turned blank, but when his eyes inadvertently saw the cup on the table, his pupils suddenly dilated,

There were two ceramic cups on the table.

Professor Ji loved to drink tea, a light jasmine tea.

Only half of it was drunk and the water was still hot. It meant that the guest was only recently here.

But the handle of one of the cups was perpendicular to the edge of the table.

On the day he returned to 1439 and noticed the blood spilling out from the study, Sheng Yun had brought over a cup of water for him. When he saw this, he had placed the cup on the table.

The cup handle and the edge of the table were perpendicular.

His father had always disliked cups with handles, so every time he used them, he would turn the handles so that they were perpendicular to the edge of the table. This habit was something he had maintained for many years. It was unknown how many times he had done this in Ji Yushi’s memory.

The large hand that placed the cup down countless times during breakfast, dinner, and at work....All those scenes overlapped perfectly with the cup in front of him.

Ji Yushi’s lips trembled. He asked with a part of him in disbelief and a part of him certain, “He was here, wasn’t he?”

Professor Ji also looked at the cup. He could only give up hiding it. He placed down the magnifying glass and said, “Yes.”

Was it a good thing when a child is too smart?

Ji Yushi didn't speak.

He seemed to be in daze.

“Jian Jian.” Professor Ji spoke earnestly, “It's time to let it go.”

Ji Yushi thought he had already let it go.

But at this moment, he didn't know how to answer.

Was this the first time or had it happened many times already?

Has his teacher seen his father many times without his knowledge? When he asked his teacher about the portrait he drew of the other person he met in Rubik's Cube last time, did his teacher tell him the truth?

For a while, he had some difficulty sorting out his thoughts.

He just heard Professor Ji ask, “Do you know why I am so against you joining Tianqiong to become a Recorder?”

Ji Yushi stood stunned in place.

“It was because, as soon as humans gain the ability to look back in time, they will become obsessed with it. They become unable to distinguish between the past and present, and there is no longer a clear boundary between right and wrong.” Professor Ji said, “Because you can't let go, the more you try to correct the mistakes, the deeper you sink in. You become a prisoner of time.”

“After seeing that you have let go, he was able to truly let go.”

“After so many years, he has learnt to let go of you.”

Scene after scene returned to him.

The stranger who had kindly carried him away from an oncoming car when he was crossing the road as a child.

The stranger who helped him up and put ointment on his knee after tripping over a rock and scraping his knee.

The stranger who gave him a bottle of iced water when he walked out of the examination room after his college entrance examination.

.....

Those different faces weren't memorable at all, but they all had the same body type. It all overlapped in an instant and changed into a lone figure.

It was the back figure from deep in his memories.

It was his father's back figure.

Turns out, he had always been loved.

Ji Yushi's tears fell.

The phone in his hand vibrated. He subconsciously looked at it. It was a reply from Song Qinglan.

Song Qinglan: [Waiting for you at home.]

The trees outside the window were lush.

The sun was bright.

The mist will eventually be dispelled by the bright sun. (*KKnotes: SQL's name: 宋晴岚 (Song Qinglan) – Sunny haze/mist/fog*)

Time continues on, but love was everlasting.

He had never felt this blessed before.

From possessing nothing to possessing everything.

He was Ji Yushi, and he was also Sheng Han.

[END]

**KK has something to say:**

The end! Phew, I hope I did alright with my translations. This one was definitely a complicated novel that requires some thinking and rereading to understand 😊 Hopefully my translations were clear enough and you guys weren't too confused....(Honestly there are still things I'm a little confused about, especially about Tianqiong of all eras and also about JYS's father.....I look forward to reading everyone's theories and discussions!)

In all honesty, writing a story about time travel and parallel universes and all that without plot holes/ paradoxes/obvious mistakes is actually really, really hard. I personally think Mist did a pretty good job with it especially with something this complex (but something this complex is also something that can turn people off so it's perfectly understandable if this wasn't your cup of tea haha). I can't say that there weren't any issues, but it was pretty nice to see that the entire novel was planned out by the author from the very beginning and that most things made somewhat sense.

Anyway, it's not over yet! We've still got three extras to go~

Happy reading!

# Chapter 104: Chapter 104

## Extras

Chapter 104: Extra 1 (The Mystery of Ji Yushi's Voice-Con)

Outside Tianqiong's Jiang City branch.

Thick snow had piled up on both sides of the road and a thin layer of ice covered the road surface. A large red automatic snow removal vehicle slowly drove along it.

It was evening, but there weren't many people around.

As soon as Song Qinglan came out, he saw the retro car parked on the side of the road. The car body was very clean, and the paint was shiny, but the lower part was already stained with a lot of mud—Having spent his first winter here in Jiang City, the owner had already become used to the consequences of going out on a snowy day.

Song Qinglan got in the car. As soon as he opened the door to the front passenger seat, warm air from inside the car drove away the chill on his body.

The radio was playing a documentary.

In this era where humanity had already perfected cars with the automatic driving function, people can directly watch a holographic projection while driving so there weren't many people who would listen to the radio anymore. Only Ji Yushi's car would have this function.

“Moose, the largest member of the deer family. Can grow up to three metres in length and weigh up to 1,000kg. It is a....”

Song Qinglan: “.....”

He leaned over and kissed Ji Yushi’s face, “You’ve even listening to documentary about deer?”

Ji Yushi wore a black fluffy down jacket. His pale face was stained light orange by the streetlight outside. He had just left home, and he still retained a lazy at-home expression on his face. He leaned over and kissed Song Qinglan’s lips, “Mhn.”

The car was parked outside the Jiang City branch. It wouldn’t be a good influence.

Chief Wang had warned the two of them many times not to show public displays of affection in the branch as it would affect the mood of the single dogs there. After all, most of the Guardians here were single. Even if they were a gay couple, they still looked on at the two of them enviously.

When news of Song Qinglan, the homophobic straight captain of the seventh squad, and Ji Yushi, the special advisor transferred over from Ning City, getting together spread, it immediately caused a sensation throughout the Tianqiong network.

Apart from being in disbelief, they could only be even more in disbelief. With how ruthless Song Qinglan’s words were before all this, the current situation was even more shocking.

The commander-in-chief who witnessed their affectionate kiss on the transmission platform in the third command centre was the first to receive the shock but he was able to accept it calmly. Whenever someone talked about how shocking the incident was, he would calmly ask back, “Don’t just focus on being shocked. Do you have a partner?” and successfully shut them up.

The day Ji Yushi went to Ning City to handle the transfer procedures, Chief Lin’s hands were trembling slightly, “Y-you really captured him?”

Ji Yushi: “Captured.”

At first, in order to refuse Chief Lin's transfer request, he had once said to him, "Going to a place where the proportion of men is much higher, I am worried that I may not be able to control my feelings and possibly develop an unsatisfactory relationship which can disrupt the harmony in the Jiang City branch."

Chief Lin smacked his forehead, "I didn't take your words back then seriously. It's my fault for not considering the emotional needs of young people. Just thinking about it, if I was put into a team of people of the opposite sex when I was younger, I probably wouldn't be able to handle it.....But it's okay, this is still a relationship. Xiao Song really got lucky with you....."

What originally was just a one-off transfer to temporarily fill in a position had resulted in his talented subordinate being officially recruited to join the Jiang City branch.

Chief Lin regretted it a little.

As for those in Tianqiong, Lin Xinlan was the most resentful one.

The ninth squad's training grounds were constantly filled with anger and dark clouds. When Ji Yushi went to give them the references he had prepared for them, the people in the seventh squad even wondered if he would be able to come back out alive.

But Ji Yushi was able to leave without a hair on his body missing.

Because of Sheng Yun's matter, the concealed case of Ji Yushi being mistakenly killed was also dug up. With the past and present involved and many matters not yet clarified, Ji Yushi wasn't assigned any missions for the time being. They all knew that it would take a while.

Except for Ji Yushi, all the members of the seventh squad had returned and even completed several A-level missions. Right now, after the so-called 'Tianqiong of all eras' took over as the parent system, there were still new missions waiting for Ji Yushi to complete after he can return to the squad.

Song Qinglan had been away for two days. He had already guessed that Ji Yushi would come and pick him up.

But he didn't expect Ji Yushi to still be listening to this program.

Song Qinglan didn't understand what was so interesting about animal documentaries. He knew that Ji Yushi as a child had listened to the complete set of this documentary and was able to write it all down word for word and even write it all backwards if he wanted to, but every time, Ji Yushi seemed to be very immersed in it.

Fortunately, as soon as he got in the car, Ji Yushi had quickly turned off the radio.

Song Qinglan turned the situation around and rubbed his lips against Ji Yushi's soft lips and proceeded to invade his mouth with the tip of his tongue. They exchanged a long 'reunion' kiss in the car. They could hear each other's hearts beating chaotically.

The kiss ended.

Song Qinglan let out a low curse and a laugh.

Someone whistled.

Ji Yushi only now noticed that there were a group of people standing across the street.

Their five teammates stood there with cheesy grins on their faces, watching the entire time in amusement. When they saw Ji Yushi look over, the five even hooked their arms across each other's shoulders and shouted, "One more!" before whistling even louder.

Enough.

The other five straight men in the squad formed a strange party. Not only did they change their original homophobic settings, but they had even started to blatantly ship the couple in their squad.



When Ji Yushi moved in, Song Qinglan had invited them over for dinner at his place. With all five of them staring at them the whole day, he wasn't able to touch Ji Yushi at all.

Ji Yushi turned his head back. Without another word, he drove the car out.

The retro car made a beautiful flick, leaving them in a cloud of exhaust smoke.

\*

Song Qinglan could rest for two days after completing this mission.

In the evening, the two did some vigorous exercise, the noise causing the three cats to take turns scratching at the door.

Song Qinglan was like a rogue. He often tried different ways to make the other person make a sound and also often said very shameless things in bed. Ji Yushi gritted his teeth and refused to give in, but Song Qinglan would always deliberately ask if it was here or if it was there that felt good.

When Ji Yushi finally couldn't help but let out some sounds, Song Qinglan became even more hooked and could no longer control himself.

The two of them did it like they were fighting. After the fight, Ji Yushi would lie there paralysed for a long time, unable to move a single finger. He however would still be very cooperative the next time.

That was how young people were.

Their love was strong, and they were also hot-blooded young men.

They had a good night's sleep.

When Song Qinglan returned after his morning exercises, he saw that Ji Yushi was once again listening to the animal documentary.

This time it was talking about birds of prey.

“The eagle owl, a nocturnal hunter. It flies close to the ground, slowly and silently, making it difficult for their prey to notice it approaching....”

The young male voice narrated. His tone was calm and not boring or dull to listen to. There was slight hoarseness in his energetic voice, making it sound like some kind of musical instrument.

As Ji Yushi listened, he fried some eggs.

Under Song Qinglan’s patient guidance, he was now able to fry eggs similar to how Song Qinglan made them.

The housekeeping robot stood on the side with its head tilted. It seemed to always be curious about this recently moved in human who would often rob it of its work.

Little Black jumped onto the counter and stared at the bright orange egg in the pan. It was unknown where the other two went.

“Why are you listening to this again?” Song Qinglan’s arms wrapped around Ji Yushi’s waist, “Are you going to listen to the whole series?”

Ji Yushi, “Something like that.”

The fried eggs were plated up. Ji Yushi told him, “This is the version from the 70’s. I only heard it when I was a child and didn’t expect to hear it again on the radio the other day. After searching online, I was able to find the audio files.”

He had been listening to it since before Song Qinglan left and still wasn’t done when he was back.

Song Qinglan laughed, “Reliving your childhood.”

“Just a bit.” Said Ji Yushi, “It’s mainly because the dubber’s voice is very nice to listen to.”

In the next few days, Ji Yushi finished listening to the documentaries. After a day or two of silence, Song Qinglan found that he had started to listen to

another program called “Wonderful Earth”. It spoke about the unique places on Earth and was narrated by the same voice.

“The McMurdo Dry Valleys, located west of McMurdo Sound, Antarctica, has not rained in millions of years.....”

A few more days passed.

Ji Yushi started listening to “The Profound Meaning of Time”.

The previous ones were fine, but this program touched on their field of profession. As a Guardian of their current time and space, the knowledge from the 70’s was rather behind and still had many loopholes. In less than a hundred years, the world had changed. What they knew now was far beyond what people knew back then.

Song Qinglan listened to a short segment and found it unbearable.

But Ji Yushi still looked the same as usual, as if he didn’t notice any problems with the program.

“If possible, I would go back and tell the production team that time doesn’t work like that.” Song Qinglan stopped typing and looked up from behind his transparent panel, “Unfortunately it’s not possible.”

The two sat on the same sofa. Ji Yushi was lying down with his head resting on Song Qinglan’s lap as he read a book.

Hearing this, he showed a trace of confusion and placed down his book, “What?”

Song Qinglan said, “Listen to it. His program is talking about a wormhole being a tunnel connecting two times and spaces. It sounds plausible theoretically but it’s technically impossible. This makes his entire program pointless.”

Ji Yushi let out an ‘oh’. He didn’t make any comments and just continued to read.

From the looks of it, he wasn't listening to the contents of the show at all. He was just playing it as background noise while he read.

Song Qinglan asked, "You actually aren't listening to it?"

"I am." Ji Yushi turned a page and said the same thing as last time, "It doesn't matter if there are mistakes. The dubber is very good. I can just ignore the contents."

After a few seconds of silence, Ji Yushi finally noticed that something wasn't right.

He placed down his book and saw that Song Qinglan had already turned off his transparent panel and pushed it aside. Song Qinglan looked down at him with interest. The situation felt a little dangerous.

The male voice in the stereo continued, his voice low and charming.

Ji Yushi blinked a few times and raised his hand to turn it off.

Song Qinglan: "Advisor Ji, are you a voice-con?" (*KKnotes: Someone who likes nice voices*)

Ji Yushi: "....."

Song Qinglan raised his eyebrow slowly and took away the book in his hand. He picked up the other person and asked, "You like his voice that much?"

Even to the extent of being able to tolerate all the mistakes?

As if he had discovered some big secret, Song Qinglan's voice was kept low and deliberately seductive.

Ji Yushi didn't think much of it initially but when he was asked this, he suddenly realised that this was indeed the case. The new knowledge made him a little ashamed and the atmosphere for some reason turned ambiguous.

His personality was cold and distant, and he also looked unaffected most of the time.

But whenever Song Qinglan explored a little more deeply, he would discover all sorts of amazing little secrets hidden under his shell.

Ji Yushi: “.....”

Song Qinglan thought of something. He pinched the tip of his nose and asked aggressively, “The chatterbox in the ninth squad. You were able to endure talking to him for so long on the phone a few days ago, could it have been because he had a nice voice?”

Ji Yushi thought about it. For some reason he felt like he was caught red-handed, “.....It was okay.”

The 1.9m tall Cap Song was jealous. He was clingier than the cats at home. He pinched Ji Yushi’s waist and asked, “If one day someone with a particularly pleasant voice appears, would you be lured away by him?”

Ji Yushi answered seriously, “Impossible.”

Song Qinglan snorted coldly to express his disbelief.

It was hard to imagine, but he was currently burning with jealousy. Ji Yushi had few friends, and his personality was introverted. It was his first time feeling like this.

And it was just because of a few voices.

“No one has a better voice than yours. I wouldn’t have been able to bear with you in the beginning if that wasn’t the case.”

Ji Yushi said this and then picked up his book and walked away.

Song Qinglan was stunned for several seconds. He suddenly laughed, “So it’s because of my voice that your tolerance for me increased?”

He chased after him and followed behind Ji Yushi, “When was ‘the beginning’? When Chief Wang introduced us?”

Ji Yushi entered the study. He made it seem like he was going to get another book, but his red ears betrayed him, “Something like that.”

Song Qinglan easily blocked him at the bookshelf. Biting the tip of his ear from behind, he chuckled, “I don’t think so. You’re lying again.”

The familiar voice reverberated in his ears. It made his ears extremely hot. Ji Yushi trembled slightly from the bite.

Both knew very well that there was some truth in Ji Yushi’s words, and it was the fact that he particularly liked Song Qinglan’s voice. Whenever they were intimate, he would always reach the peak the moment Song Qinglan called his name.

“Everyone get ready. Tianqiong’s seventh squad, the thirteenth A-level mission, let’s go!”

That was the medium-low male voice that invaded his mind for the first time, accurate numbing Ji Yushi’s auditory nerves.

Since then, everything about Song Qinglan from his appearance to his voice, became an existence that he couldn’t ignore.

“It was the first time I heard your voice through the public channel.”

Facing the bookshelf, Ji Yushi closed his eyes and decided to tell Song Qinglan this secret of his.

“Public channel?” Song Qinglan sounded very satisfied, “Then, Advisor Ji, can you tell me how you felt when you heard me in your mind for the first time?”

Ji Yushi placed the book back.

He turned around and looked at Song Qinglan. A man’s desire to win was hidden in his beautiful eyes, “I thought that you were a little annoying, but I

could still bear with it with enough patience.”

Song Qinglan’s shiny dark eyes also looked at him.

Neither of them spoke.

They both knew. That feeling was probably the first instance his heart was moved.

# Chapter 105: Chapter 105

## Extras

### Chapter 105: Extra 2 (Song Qinglan's Beard)

In the summer of Star Era 1457, Tianqiong organised a special training program for the elites all across the world.

As the captain, Song Qinglan, together with Zhou Mingxuan who similarly came from the special forces, took part in this highly intense training program. It took an entire month. Once it was over, the World Time Alliance also arranged a one-week competition which was broadcasted throughout the world. The contributed efforts of all the representatives from their country allowed them to bring back first place, and Song Qinglan and Zhou Mingxuan also won individual gold medals themselves.

The Jiang City branch warmly celebrated this good news and they even had banners put up in the hall.

The people who went together with them to this special training program also included the captains and team members from the other squads; a total of seven people. One of them was Qi Lang, the captain of the twelfth squad who disappeared many years ago and suddenly returned last year.

From a certain point of view, time had stopped for fifteen years for the members of the twelfth squad. After returning to Jiang City, the members had to undergo various degrees of adaptation courses to help them reconnect with the world fifteen years later, but their abilities exceeded everyone's expectations—Except for Xie Sian, after they were released from the crevice of time and space, they had completed several high-level missions under the arrangement of the Tianqiong parent system. Led by Qi



Lang, the twelfth squad silently went to work and when they returned, they had accumulated points that was almost on par to the seventh squad, making them a new dark horse.

Qi Lang as a result became well known in Jiang City and even in other time alliances. His peculiar experience had made him almost a legend.

Qi Lang was mature, handsome and single.

A large number of fans had gathered because of him.

The day they returned to the country, half of the people rushing to welcome them back came for him.

As for the former most popular bachelor Song Qinglan, because he had become gay and would often show public displays of affection in front of everyone, he had long fallen from that throne. Even if he was still the tallest captain in the Jiang City branch, it was no longer enough to attract everyone's attention.

But this time, the moment he got out of the car, everyone's eyes landed on him.

Everyone: “!!!”

With his domineering height, Song Qinglan had a strong presence, and with the addition of his long legs and short boots, the visual effect was even more out of this world. Adding to that his handsome appearance, wide shoulders and narrow waist, his external appearance was absolutely flawless.

However, after a torturing month abroad, it was unknown if it was because he was too busy to the point that he didn't even have the time to shave, the Song Qinglan who reappeared in front of everyone had a dark stubble.

“What is it?” He swept his gaze across the people from above, “I'm so dazzling that I've blinded your eyes?”

Everyone: “Damn!!”

When the noisy welcoming ceremony was over, Song Qinglan picked out a colleague and asked, “Where’s Advisor Ji?”

That colleague turned around and was startled, “Cap Song?!”

Song Qinglan asked his question again.

The colleague told him that Advisor Ji was still teaching the students in the training camp and couldn’t step away, but it should almost be time for classes to end.

After being transferred to the Jiang City branch, although Ji Yushi had joined formerly as the scout for the seventh squad, he not only had the knowledge and experience surpassing that of the Guardians the same level as him, but he had also worked as a Recorder and gained extensive experience there, so he still retained the ‘Advisor’ title. As for the time anchor and how the Tianqiong parent system worked, it still hadn’t been thoroughly studied but the matter regarding Sheng Yun had basically all come to light. Everything he and the research and development team had done in order to stabilise time and space had been corrected in the archives. As the key person who linked all this, Ji Yushi became a rising star in the Tianqiong network.

Ji Yushi used to be the student who listened to the lectures given during training camps but now he had become the one who gave the lectures.

Song Qinglan had already seen how he looked when he stood on the podium. Refined and knowledgeable, smooth communicator, he was simply a person who was born to be involved with scientific research, to be a teacher.

Song Qinglan strode into the lecture hall. The classroom was already empty except for Ji Yushi who was standing alone on the podium with his head down. He seemed to be sorting out the handouts.

Hearing a knock on the door, he raised his head.

Song Qinglan who had been away for more than a month stood at the door. He teasingly called out, “Teacher Ji.”

One day apart felt like three years had passed.

It had been more than thirty days but both of them looked calm, as if they had only seen each other that morning.

Song Qinglan said, “Everyone is already gone, why are you still here? Aren’t you being too dedicated?”

Ji Yushi put away the transparent panel. Song Qinglan managed to catch a glimpse of the content on the screen—What sorting out handouts? It was clearly a recently released sports anime. Ji Yushi liked it very much and would constantly keep up to date with it without missing a single episode.

Song Qinglan wanted to laugh. The current Ji Yushi seemed to be getting more and more lovely.

Ji Yushi’s expression didn’t change, “I knew you would come so I decided to wait for you here. What if we miss each other if I left?”

The Jiang City branch was big, but there were only two or three roads from the lobby to the student training camp.

Ji Yushi didn’t know which path Song Qinglan would take so he decided to just wait here so that they could see each other again in the shortest time possible.

It was calm on the surface, but the actual undercurrents were surging.

It was almost about to go on fire.

Song Qinglan came over. He stepped onto the podium and brought the other person into his arms.

He sniffed Ji Yushi’s hair and took a deep breath of that familiar fragrance. Before he could speak again, he heard Ji Yushi say, “You have a stubble.”

Song Qinglan, “.....”

He belatedly realised, “It looks sloppy, doesn’t it?”

When the seventh squad first returned to the real world following the hijacking incident, Chief Wang had also told him to shave his beard. Recalling it now, it seemed to contain a nagging tone. Song Qinglan didn’t look in the mirror much and he didn’t have the time to check his appearance during missions or special training, so he hadn’t paid much attention to his appearance.

Ji Yushi looked up at him. His bright eyes didn’t seem to be lying, “No....”

Song Qinglan raised a brow, “Then? Why is everyone reacting so strongly?”

Ji Yushi rubbed his chin with his thumb. Feeling those hard stubbles pricking his thumb, he said, “Looks a little fierce.”

“Really fierce.” Ji Yushi continued, “Kids will cry when they see you.”

Song Qinglan, “....Then I’ll go back and shave.”

Ji Yushi said with a black belly, “That’s not necessary. It’s actually pretty good. You can leave it and help me scare those new students.”

The scheming and vengeful Teacher Ji had already planned on using his family to intimidate his students.

That group of new students were still unaware. Before they could get up to any mischief, they had already been dealt with by the seemingly gentle Advisor Ji.

\*

This time, the stubble left from the special training program surprised the three cats at home. It took them a while to confirm that the one who entered their place was really their other owner.

Song Qinglan wanted to shave it off after leaving it for two days, but Ji Yushi would gnaw at his chin when they were being intimate. He seemed to be interested in his beard and was especially enthusiastic.

This made him a little reluctant. He again endured for another two days.

A few days later, everyone gradually got used to his new image. Even Chief Wang stopped talking about it and no longer asked him to shave it.

This continued until one day, Song Qinglan went to the student training camp to teach them combative skills. Perhaps he appeared too strict, a female student really ended up crying. He promptly went back to his lounge and shaved off his beard, revealing his clean and refreshing face underneath.

When he appeared at the training camp again, a brave student stopped him and asked, “Who are you?”

Song Qinglan was speechless, “What do you mean?”

Hearing his voice, the student was stunned. After combining it with his height and determining that he was their instructor, he was shocked, “What? Instructor Song?!”

Not only this student was like this. After Song Qinglan finished his class, everyone who had grown used to his new image were all stunned. It took them all a while to return to their senses and greet him.

Song Qinglan thought it was rather amusing. Was it such a big deal whether or not he had a beard?

He ran into Qi Lang on his way to the parking lot.

The Qi Lang in the bubble world was strategic, elegant and extraordinarily skilled, allowing him to become the Chief. Although he himself didn't know anything about what he was like in the bubble world, but from the looks of it, he seemed to have embarked on a completely different life path

in the real world—With all those years of salary as well as bonuses, he had become a young socialite who burnt his money like crazy.

The handsome Qi Lang also drove a sports car. When he opened the door, he happened to catch sight of Song Qinglan.

He paused for a second and then nodded in greeting, “Cap Song.”

Because of the events in the crevice of time and space, the two had a pretty good relationship with each other. They had also taken care of each other when they went abroad for special training.

Song Qinglan asked, “Cap Qi, I have something I want to ask you.”

Qi Lang casually said, “Ask away.”

Song Qinglan voice his doubts.

Qi Lang laughed. He told him, “It’s because you look too different. With a stubble, you’re practically like another person. Those who aren’t familiar with you really would not be able to recognise you and as for those who are familiar, they would feel strange when facing a different you. Someone in my squad asked me a few days ago if you came from a parallel world. They knew that you’re Cap Song but you felt fierce and unfamiliar.”

Song Qinglan felt like he had just heard something extremely far-fetched, “Following that line of thought, I won’t even need to use the artificial face?”

Qi Lang sat into his car and started it up. He advised meaningfully, “Don’t be so doubtful. Some people really have that kind of talent. Why don’t you go back and ask your Advisor Ji?”

After Qi Lang drove off, Song Qinglan was thoughtful. He then suddenly smiled. He got ready to go home to find a certain someone to settle accounts with.

\*

Ji Yushi sat barefoot on the carpet. His left hand was petting a cat while his right hand picked up fruits to eat. His eyes were staring at the holographic projection ahead.

He was fully engrossed with keeping up with the newest episode of his beloved anime.

Hearing the sound of the door opening, Little Black slipped away from under his hand and, together with the other two cats, they rushed to the door to greet their owner, meowing loudly. Song Qinglan changed his shoes, picked one of them up and went to the living room. As soon as Ji Yushi saw his face, he asked, “You shaved?”

This tone. It was exactly the same tone he used when he said “You have a stubble”.

As if he had found a switch or something, one could hear a hint of novelty and interest in that tone.

Song Qinglan walked over, picked up the person from the ground and pressed them down onto the sofa, “Advisor Ji, was role-playing fun?”

Ji Yushi was eating cantaloupe. His eyes were even sweeter than the cantaloupe he had, “It was alright.”

He had admitted it so quickly.

Song Qinglan was both angry and amused, “It’s really that different? Or was it because you’re getting sick of me?”

If the people in the training camp saw the current Advisor Ji, they would probably be shocked speechless.

The usually cold and serious, and extremely knowledgeable person who could easily provide logical explanations was like the whitest cloud in the sky, a being that a mere mortal couldn’t reach.

But at this moment, that person was still that person, but just like the Song Qinglan with a beard, Ji Yushi’s personality seemed to have completely

changed. He was willing to be subdued on the sofa, completely unable to move.

Ji Yushi, “Very different.”

Song Qinglan with a beard, not only did he appear fiercer, he also didn’t seem like the original Song Qinglan. He originally had a ruffian-like air but with the addition of the beard, that air grew a lot stronger, making people afraid to look directly at him and even feel some fear.

It was simply another version of Song Qinglan.

“Every time I saw you grow a beard, that unfamiliar feeling was always very strong. It’s like dating two of you at the same time.” Ji Yushi said slyly, “Later I realised that if a person wants to manage two relationships at the same time, it’s actually not that difficult.”

While joking, he still brought up old grudges.

Song Qinglan lowered his head to bite him.

Ji Yushi smoothly turned and pushed Song Qinglan down onto the sofa instead.

With the anime sounds in the background, he leaned down and rubbed Song Qinglan’s smooth chin with his thumb. He said a little reluctantly, “I like both of them.....Xiao Song 1.0, welcome back.”



# Chapter 106: Chapter 106

## Extras

### Chapter 106: Extra 3 (Party)

After returning from one mission after another, the people from the seventh squad had said that they should have some fun at a nightclub.

It didn't take them long for this agreement to be realised. That night, everyone set off from their own homes to head to Li Chun's friends place that he claims to have 'very nice lights'.

Before departing, Song Qinglan had trouble finding clothes. He hardly went to such places and also didn't like to play like this, so he didn't have any suitable clothes. It was all sports wear on the left side of his wardrobe and shirts and trousers on the right as well as a few ordinary T-shirts. Much of the wardrobe was black, white or grey; high class with a bit of coldness. It didn't look casual at all.

Ji Yushi was different. After moving in, half of the space here contained his clothes. Although his clothes weren't fancy and were more on the simpler side, but if you looked closely, you would see that all the details and cuts of his clothes were different. Two clothes that may appear to be similar would actually be completely different in style.

Towards this, Ji Yushi concluded as follows: Since he had been gay for so many years, it was natural that he would be a little more particular in this area.

For young people twenty-five or twenty-six in age, they couldn't always be so uptight.

When everyone gathered at night, every one of them were more dressed up than the other.

Because he wasn't going back to work any time soon, Li Chun had even dyed his head and dressed hip-hop style. Even the oldest Old Duan who would usually have an old-fashioned sense of dress had a new look—He had followed Li Chun to several nightclubs before and had already learnt the tricks.

The two who finally arrived at the nightclub entrance made the entire place brighten up.

They were used to seeing Advisor Ji in the black combat uniform but when they saw him in his own clothes, they knew immediately that he had good tastes.

Ji Yushi wore a beige short sleeved shirt with the top buttons undone and it was paired with a pair of dark cropped trousers and white sneakers. He originally had a very outstanding temperament and appearance but, after dressing up, it was even more eye-catching. He waved at the group from across the road, his expression calm and quiet. There was a scholarly and refined air unique to him.

They had always known that Ji Yushi was good-looking.

But only now did everyone realise how good-looking he really was. As soon as he got out of the car, there were already people watching him.

Song Qinglan stopped the car and opened the door. His appearance suddenly brightened the place up even further. His height itself was already a cheat for him but, with his usual white shirt unbuttoned at the top and his hair combed back to reveal his smooth forehead and sharp features, the rebelliousness and ruffian-like air of his could no longer be contained.

The two stood on the side of the road and waited for a while. When the lights turned green, they both strode over.

Duan Wen cursed, “Damn, this is just an ordinary nightclub. Why are those two gays dressed up so nicely for?”

Duan Wen’s small eyes narrowed. He sighed, “They have already taken down the girls inside but now they want to take down the girls outside too. I pity those naïve and ignorant young girls who don’t know the real truth.”

Just as they were reaching the peak of their complaints.

Song Qinglan who was crossing the road suddenly stretched out his hand and held Ji Yushi’s.

The two held hands with their fingers interlocked. They naturally walked over, ignoring the eyes of other onlookers.

Everyone: “!!!”

Why was this a little sweet?

Li Chun breathed a sigh of relief, “It’s okay, it’s okay. They took the initiative to show that they’re already taken. There probably won’t be any chicks going after them.”

The straight men only had girls in their minds. Tang Le nudged Tang Qi, “Big brother, Chun’er said the girls here are of high-quality. Many white-collar workers nearby like to come and hang out here. You can talk to more girls tonight. Perhaps you may fall in love at first sight.”

Tang Qi who was very disciplined and didn’t want anything to develop in a nightclub said expressionlessly, “Love at first sight? More like a one-night stand.”

“Don’t be shy.” Tang Le said, “When you see a type you like, I will go first and then you can just say that I was you. Sound good?”

Tang Qi:”.....Thanks.”

His younger brother was too stupid, what to do?

The desire for love was written on the faces of these five single dogs.

It was as if they weren't here to catch up with their teammates, but to go on a blind date.

The two greeted everyone when they arrived in front of them. Song Qinglan asked, "Why aren't you going in?"

Li Chun, "Isn't it because of you, boss?"

Song Qinglan found it funny, "Why is it because of me?"

"Every time I invite you out to drink, you don't come." Zhou Mingxuan joked, "Afraid that you are too serious and rigid and don't even know how to enter a nightclub."

Everyone joked and went in.

Song Qinglan glanced at Ji Yushi beside him. He lowered his head and whispered, "Who the hell doesn't know? When I went to a nightclub, these people didn't even know what a nightclub is."

Ji Yushi couldn't help but say, "They're obediently doing their university homework."

Song Qinglan laughed. He suddenly thought of something and squeezed Ji Yushi's hand, "Then why didn't Advisor Ji obediently do his homework at that time?"

Ji Yushi, "In order to go to the bar and let a certain someone watch me."

Zhou Mingxuan turned back and glared at them, "Hey you two, enough. I don't want the others to think that we're all gay!"

The two nodded perfunctorily.

"Yes, yes, I know."

"Understood, understood."

\*

After passing through a long soundproofed passage, the bouncer opened the door. Deafening music and dazzling lights instantly poured out.

On the large holographic projection, a sexy bunny girl was dancing. The projection was at least seven or eight metres high. She was an electronic version of a live performer. Her sexy moves contrasted greatly with her delicate and retro appearance. The men and women on the dance floor danced along with her and shouted loudly with the music.

Talking here, one wouldn't be able to hear each other unless they shouted themselves hoarse.

Li Chun's friend came and settled them at the best seats in the club and very enthusiastically greeted Song Qinglan and Ji Yushi. Everyone didn't hear clearly what this young man said to them, but when the alcohol was served, they realised that the friend had gifted them their best wine here.

Song Qinglan had said that he would treat them so he naturally wouldn't let the others spend money.

But that wasn't the point now. Li Chun had taken the lead in playing a game and the atmosphere around the table had completely heated up.

A dice game. The people present may not be able to beat Ji Yushi.

After going around a lap, he didn't touch the alcohol at all. He even took the initiative to take a few sips to satisfy himself. Later, Song Qinglan lost two games without any foul play. The old-fashioned drinking game had increased the stakes and he was asked to drink twice the amount.

"That's too much. Can't you see that there's only one of me?" Song Qinglan wanted to find someone to help him but when he looked back, "....."

Ji Yushi had opened two bottles of beer with each hand.

Everyone cheered.

Song Qinglan didn't say much. He could only accept his loss.

He tilted his head back and drank a bottle in one go. That smooth move even made the people on the neighbouring table cheer for him.

The only dual wielding player present at the table performed a stunt. Ji Yushi could not only open two bottles of beer at the same time, but he could also juggle the dice. He was like a street busker busking for money to help with his next journey.

“What else can Advisor Ji do?!”

“Amazing!”

Ji Yushi smiled, “It's very simple. I'll teach you when I have the chance to.”

No one believed him. How could that be easy?

The music changed. The tempo had slowed down and the people on the dance floor began to dance slowly, face to face.

A waiter brought over a cocktail and gave it to Song Qinglan. Following the waiter's gestures, a girl in a miniskirt raised a glass at him and blew a kiss.

Everyone: “!!!”

“Hurry and explain!”

“Advisor Ji is going to note it into his little notebook!”

“It's not too late to refuse!!”

Everyone joked and teased him, but Song Qinglan the involved party didn't refuse the cocktail.

Ji Yushi next to him was leaning back in his seat. The changing lights illuminated his tall nose and from time to time there would be shadows cast over his face from his long eyelashes. His dark eyes watched him, seemingly very interested.

In front of the girl and everyone else, Song Qinglan leaned in to kiss him on the lips. Amidst the music, he pushed the glass over and said softly, “Margarita. You like it.”

This game was too easy to crack.

After Song Qinglan released his lips, everyone was completely stunned, “This is also okay?!”

Song Qinglan lazily asked, “Why not?”

Everyone: “Advisor Ji?!”

Ji Yushi drank the cocktail bought by someone else, “Tastes pretty good.”

Everyone: “Damn!”

“Advisor Ji, you’ve changed!” Tang Le complained bitterly, “You’re no longer that cool Advisor Ji anymore!”

“Love makes people blind.” Zhou Mingxuan said, “Even celestial beings cannot escape it.”

Li Chun suddenly expressed, “Haa, I still remember back at Guangyuan building when Advisor Ji was pressed against the wall by Song Qinglan with an extremely reluctant expression.”

Ji Yushi paused. The cold liquor had not been completely swallowed.

He was pressed against the wall by Song Qinglan?

That was something that happened between the two of them in the big circle. Based on what they knew, these people who were originally in the Ouroboros mission shouldn’t have memories of this.

After they entered 【Overload】 , they were both in different, staggered cycles. They both existed as a point paving the way for the original squad and when the original squad completes the mission, they would disappear,

so the original members in the Ouroboros mission shouldn't remember what happened.

They continued to appear at the anchored point, and, just like what Tianqiong's parent system requested, they tried to maintain the situation such that it developed the way it originally developed. As long as the final result didn't change, it wouldn't affect the timeline.

That is to say, to them who were in the big cycle 【Overload】 , they who were in Ouroboros were like NPCs. It stood to reason that they shouldn't have these memories.

Just like the memories of Team A and Team B combining into one, before all of that happened, Ji Yushi only remembered that Team B seemed different, and Song Qinglan also remembered the time when they hid in the power distribution room and Ji Yushi stepped on his foot—The anchored point had coincidentally coincided such that Song Qinglan was reborn into Team B and became the point in the circle that was extended. All the things he did in that cycle left traces behind in their memories. It was just that the memory of himself being pressed against the wall should only belong to the big circle, to the two of them in 【Overload】 .

Seeing Ji Yushi's confusion, Duan Wen added, "You didn't see it Advisor Ji? That was probably you two from another cycle. At that time, it was on the corridor of the 115<sup>th</sup> floor. We saw from the distance Cap Song pressing you against the wall and even now we still didn't know what you two were doing. We just felt that you were going to punch him."

Duan Wen looked at Song Qinglan and said, "I'm not lying. Cap Song also saw it!"

Ji Yushi understood now. At that time, Song Qinglan was kicked off the building by his other self and was caught while he was falling to his death by him.

They were talking in the corridor at the time and there was indeed another Song Qinglan looking at them from a distance.



Turns out, traces of this had been left in the original timeline.

It was just that his other self wasn't present.

But wait a minute——

Ji Yushi suddenly reacted. If Duan Wen, Li Chun and co remembered, didn't it mean that Song Qinglan also remembered?

“What were we doing?” Song Qinglan bullshitted, “Most likely Advisor Ji wasn't being obedient and I as the captain was performing my duty of educating him.”

Everyone sneered, “If you're taking advantage of him, then just admit that you were. No need to word it so nicely!!”

A new round of drinking started.

Song Qinglan held Ji Yushi's fingers, intentionally or unintentionally scratching his palm. He looked very calm.

When Tang Qi lost and was being urged noisily by the others to ask a meek looking girl for her number, Song Qinglan turned his head and leaned close to Ji Yushi's ear, “I saw it.”

One could imagine what Song Qinglan's mood was like at the time.

After all, the Song Qinglan at the time was completely different from the current Song Qinglan. He was still straight.

Ji Yushi raised the corners of his lips and asked, “Where you shocked?”

Song Qinglan, “Not really shocked.”

He couldn't help but laugh at his thoughts at the time, “I didn't even see myself kiss you on the tip of your nose and just thought that I really was teaching you a lesson.”

“Boom——”

The music stopped abruptly. Their vision went black. Only the lingering sound of music still hung in the air for half a second or two.

The entire place had suddenly darkened and even all the sounds were gone. Everyone stood still for half a second before suddenly becoming rowdy again.

The power was out.

Li Chun cursed, “The fuck? What’s going on?!”

Tang Qi complained, “Chun’er was right. The lights really are good here.”

Everyone laughed.

Li Chun became angry out of embarrassment. He turned on the flashlight on his phone and ran to find his friend to see what was going on.

Along the way, he accidentally bumped into a man and quickly stopped to apologise.

Everyone began to take out their phones. For most of the people here, having a power outage at a nightclub was probably something they had encountered for the first time. Many people complained and left their seats and the dance floor. Occasionally there would be sounds of glass or alcohol bottles accidentally being smashed.

Duan Wen’s phone vibrated. He opened the message. It was a message from the girl he had a blind date with last time.

Zhou Mingxuan and Tang Qi were helping out. In a situation like this, order must be maintained, or a stampede may occur.

Several emergency lights had turned on, but it was still very dark. Tang Le remembered something, “Is Advisor Ji afraid of the dark? Cap Song, why don’t you two first——”

When he turned back, he saw Advisor Ji, the one who was rumoured to be afraid of the dark such that the Ning City branch made an exception and

didn't give him night shifts, was currently whispering this and that to their captain, looking very relaxed.

The two continued to whisper to each other, not caring about this small interlude.

An unexpected situation and a slightly noisy environment.

The various coloured lights coming from everyone's phones looked like a sea of stars.

Perhaps in the near future, they would embark onto a new journey and once again complete their duties as the Guardians of time and space. They would witness all sorts of strange and unbelievable things and venture into all sorts of places, all for the sake of protecting their ordinary and warm life in this time and space.

But right now, they weren't in a hurry to go anywhere, because they had their friends and lover by their sides.

The party had only just begun.

[END]